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Proverbs - Introduction

Proverbs

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Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of Proverbs

1. Introduction and purpose for Proverbs (1:1–7)
2. A father teaches his son about wisdom (1:8–9:18)
3. Proverbs from Solomon (10:1–22:16)
4. Sayings from wise men (22:17–24:22)
5. More sayings from wise men (24:23–34)
6. Hezekiah's proverbs from Solomon (25:1–29:27)
7. Sayings from Agur (30:1–33)
8. Sayings from Lemuel (31:1–9)
9. Description of a good and capable wife (31:10–31)

What is the book of Proverbs about?

The book of Proverbs is a collection of proverbs. A proverb is a saying that gives wise advice or teaches something that is generally true about life. Most societies have their own proverbs and may use specific language that indicates something is a proverb. (See: Proverbs)

How should the title of this book be translated?

The title of this book is often translated as "Proverbs." A more general translation would be "Sayings for Wise People," "Wise Sayings," or something similar.

Who wrote the book of Proverbs?

Proverbs begins with the words, "The Proverbs of Solomon, son of David and King of Israel." However, Solomon did not write all of the proverbs in this book. Unnamed wise men wrote the proverbs in 22:17–24:34. Agur the son of Jakeh wrote the proverbs in 30:1–33 and King Lemuel wrote the proverbs in 31:1–31.

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

What is meant by "wisdom" in the book of Proverbs?

"Wisdom" refers to understanding and doing what is true and morally right. A wise person understands and does what Yahweh considers to be right. Anyone living in this way will also learn to live well with other people and to make good practical decisions in life. (See: wise, wisdom)

What types of fools are mentioned in the book of Proverbs?

Proverbs contains three different Hebrew words for a person who lacks sense. Many Bible translations translate all three of these as "fool." However, most scholars think there is a slight difference in meaning between each of these words, each one depicting a different degree of seriousness of the foolish condition.

To reflect this difference, the ULT translates each of these Hebrew words with a different English word. For the most frequently occurring and perhaps mildest word in this group, such as in 1:22, 8:5, 29:20, and many other places, the ULT uses forms of the word "stupid." While a lack of intelligence may be implied by this word, in Proverbs it primarily refers to someone lacking common sense and morality. In Proverbs, a "stupid one" is someone who is lazy and thoughtless, but may be capable of learning to be wise.

The next word refers to a condition of thoughtlessness that many scholars consider to be worse than "stupid." For this, the ULT uses forms of "fool." This word refers to someone who is insolent and stubbornly continues to act thoughtlessly and immorally, such as in 1:7, 7:22, and 29:9.

Lastly, the ULT uses the phrase "worthless one" for the most negative word in this group. This third term only occurs three times in Proverbs (17:7, 21; 30:22) and refers to someone who is especially disgraceful and lacks any sense of morality whatsoever. This "worthless one" is someone who completely rejects God and refuses to do what pleases God (Psalm 14:1). The UST uses forms of the term "fool" for the two most frequently used terms and uses "worthless people" for the third term. (See: fool, foolish, folly)

My Son

Several parts of the book of Proverbs contain a series of proverbs addressed to "my son" or "sons" (1:8–9:18; 19:27; 23:15–24:22; 27:11; 31:2–31) This does not mean that all the lessons in those proverbs only apply to males. Rather, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son. Whenever the lesson of such proverbs is not specifically about common temptations of young men, the UST uses more general language that could refer to both male and female children. (See: When Masculine Words Include Women)

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

Proverbs

Most of this book consists of individual proverbs. A proverb is a short saying about something that is generally true in life. Proverbs often use parallelism and metaphors to teach a lesson by referring to something or some event that would be familiar to the readers. These proverbs say as much as they can in as few

words as possible. Because of that, it is often necessary to supply words from the context in order for the sentences to make sense in translation. The Notes will suggest words that can be used where necessary. If possible, translate each proverb in a way that will be recognized as a proverb and be meaningful in your language and culture. (See: Proverbs)

Parallelism
Many proverbs consist of two parts that have a relationship to each other. The second part may strengthen the first part, give more details about the first part, or say something that is a contrast to the first part. The two parts are meant to be read as a whole so that together they say more about the subject than either part says by itself. Sometimes the second part seems to say the same thing again in different words. In this case, the second part reinforces the truth of the first part by repeating the message; It is not trying to say something different. Translators should also take into account that each proverb is also part of a larger group of proverbs. (See: Parallelism)

Personification
In Proverbs, certain qualities such as wisdom and stupidity are often represented as if they were human. Proverbs 1:20–33, 3:15–18, 4:6–9, and 8:1–9:12 refer to wisdom as if it were a woman. Proverbs 9:13–18 might also refer to stupidity as if it were a woman. In languages where it is possible for a female figure to represent these qualities, the translator can translate directly. However, if direct translation does not work in your language, consider translating these personifications as similes instead. In that case, wisdom or stupidity would be presented as being like a wise or stupid woman. Alternatively, consider translating these passages without using figurative language, as in the UST. (See: Personification)

Generic Nouns
Proverbs contains many generic noun phrases that refer to people or things in general even though they may appear to refer to specific individuals or things. This type of noun occurs frequently in this book because proverbs tell about things that are true about people in general. Most of the cases of generic nouns will be addressed in the notes. (See: Generic Noun Phrases)

Nominal Adjectives
Throughout this book, Solomon uses adjectives that describe characteristics of people to refer to those kinds of people. For example, he refers to wicked people as "the wicked" and to righteous people as "the righteous." When he seems to be referring to an individual rather than to a group, the ULT will represent this as "a wicked {one}" or "a righteous {one}." Your language may work in the same way, or you may want to translate these as "wicked people" and "righteous people" or "a wicked person" and "a righteous person" or in some other way. (See: Nominal Adjectives)

Proverbs - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Introduction and purpose for Proverbs (1:1–7)

- Title (1:1)
- The purpose of Proverbs (1:2–6)
- Main theme: Fearing Yahweh is essential to being wise (1:7)

1. A father teaches his son about wisdom (1:8–9:18)

- Avoid evil companions (1:8–19)
- Do not reject wisdom (1:20–33)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Personification
In 1:20–33, Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a person, specifically, as if it were a woman, because the word "wisdom" is grammatically feminine in Hebrew. In languages where it makes sense for a woman figure to represent an abstract concept like wisdom, the translator can translate the personification directly. If this does not work in your language because the word "wisdom" is grammatically masculine, consider personifying wisdom as a man. If it does not work in your language to represent an abstract concept like wisdom as a person, consider translating these personifications as similes instead. In that case, wisdom would be presented as being like a wise person. Alternatively, consider translating these passages without using figurative language, as in the UST. (See: Personification)

Proverbs 1:1 (#2)

מִשְׁלֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

"The proverbs of Solomon"

Here the author is using the possessive form to describe **proverbs** that were written by **Solomon**. If this is not clear in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The proverbs that were written by Solomon]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:1 (#1)

מִשְׁלֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“The proverbs of Solomon”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [These are the proverbs of Solomon]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:2 (#5)

אִמְרֵי בִינָה

“sayings of understanding”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **understanding**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [sayings of people who understand things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:2 (#1)

לָדַעַת חָכְמָה וּמוּסָר

“To know wisdom and instruction”

1:2–6 form one long sentence that lacks some of the words that a sentence in many languages would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [The purposes of these proverbs are to know wisdom and instruction]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:2 (#3)

חָכְמָה וּמוּסָר

“wisdom and instruction”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **wisdom** and **instruction**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [wise and instructive things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:2 (#4)

אִמְרֵי בִינָה

“sayings of understanding”

Here, the author is using the possessive form to describe **sayings** that give a person **understanding**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [sayings that give a person understanding]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:2 (#2)

לָדַעַת & לְהָבִין

“To know & to understand”

To know and **to understand** here indicate two purposes for these proverbs. Use a natural way in your language to introduce purpose clauses. Alternate translation: [These proverbs are for the purpose of knowing ... and they are for the purpose of understanding]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 1:3 (#3)

מוּסַר הַשְׂכֵּל צֶדֶק וּמִשְׁפָּט וּמֵישָׁרִים

“instruction of insight, righteousness and justice and integrity”

Here, the author is using the possessive form to describe **instruction** that is characterized by **insight**, **righteousness**, **justice**, and **integrity**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [instruction in how to have insight, righteousness, justice, and integrity]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:3 (#2)

לָקַחַת מוּסַר הַשְׂכֵּל צֶדֶק וּמִשְׁפָּט וּמֵישָׁרִים

“to receive instruction of insight, righteousness and justice and integrity”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **instruction**, **insight**, **righteousness**, **justice**, and **integrity**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [to be instructed in ways that are insightful, righteous, just, and honest]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:3 (#1)

לָקַחַת מוּסַר

“to receive instruction of”

Here, **to receive** indicates a third purpose for these proverbs. Use a natural way in your language to introduce a purpose clause. You may want to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [These proverbs are for the purpose of receiving instruction of]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 1:4 (#2)

עָרְמָה & דַּעַת וּמְזִמָּה

“prudence & knowledge and discretion”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **prudence**, **knowledge**, and **discretion**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [what is prudent … what he should know and how he can be discreet]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:4 (#3)

לְנַ֑עַר

“to a young man”

Although the term **young man** is masculine, these proverbs are beneficial for both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [to young men and women]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 1:4 (#1)

לָתֵ֣ת לִפְתָאיִ֣ם עָרְמָ֑ה

“to give to naive ones prudence”

Here, **to give** indicates a fourth purpose for these proverbs. Use a natural way in your language to introduce a purpose clause. You may want to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [These proverbs are for the purpose of giving naive ones prudence]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 1:5 (#1)

יִשְׁמַ֣ע חָ֭כָם וְיִוֹסֶ֣ף לֶ֑קַח וְנָבוֹן֙ תַּחְבֻּל֣וֹת יִקְנֶֽה

“may a wise one hear and increase learning, and an understanding one acquire guidance”

This verse interrupts the list of purposes for the proverbs in 1:2–6 to add the idea that those who are already wise might use these to add to their wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could add parentheses, as in the ULT, or use a natural way in your language to indicate a parenthetical or background statement.

See: Background Information

Proverbs 1:5 (#4)

תַּחְבֻּל֣וֹת יִקְנֶֽה

“acquire guidance”

The author implies that this person **will acquire guidance** from these proverbs. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will acquire guidance from these proverbs]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:5 (#5)

תַּחְבֻּל֣וֹת יִקְנֶֽה

“acquire guidance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **guidance**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [know how to live]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:5 (#2)

יִשְׁמַ֣ע חָ֭כָם וְיִוֹסֶ֣ף לֶ֑קַח וְנָבוֹן֙ תַּחְבֻּל֣וֹת יִקְנֶֽה

“may a wise one hear and increase learning, and an understanding one acquire guidance”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, so it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [let a wise one hear and increase insight, yes, may an understanding one acquire guidance]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:5 (#3)

יִשְׁמַ֣ע חָ֭כָם

“may a wise one hear”

The author is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [let a wise one hear these proverbs]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:6 (#3)

מָשָׁ֣ל וּמְלִיצָ֑ה

“a proverb and a parable”

Here, **a proverb** and **a parable** refer to these things in general, not to a specific proverb and parable.

If it would be helpful in your language, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any proverb and any parable]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 1:6 (#1)

לְהָבִ֣ין מָשָׁ֣ל וּמְלִיצָ֑ה דִּבְרֵ֖י חֲכָמִ֣ים וְחִידֹתָֽם

“to understand a proverb and a parable, the words of the wise ones and their riddles”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that indicates that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [to understand a proverb and a parable, yes, to understand the words of the wise ones and their riddles]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:6 (#4)

דִּבְרֵ֖י חֲכָמִ֣ים

“the words of the wise ones”

The author is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [to understand the words of the wise ones]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:6 (#2)

לְהָבִ֣ין מָשָׁ֣ל וּמְלִיצָ֑ה

“to understand a proverb and a parable”

Here, **to** indicates a fifth purpose for these proverbs. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a purpose clause. You may want to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [These proverbs are for the purpose of understanding a proverb and a parable]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 1:6 (#5)

דִּבְרֵ֖י

“the words of”

Here, the author uses the term **words** to describe what **the wise ones** say by using **words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the sayings of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:7 (#3)

יִרְאַ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“The fear of Yahweh”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **fear**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Being deeply respectful of Yahweh] or [Revering Yahweh]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:7 (#4)

רֵאשִׁ֣ית דָּ֭עַת

“is} the beginning of knowledge”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **knowledge**, you could express the same idea in another way. See how you translated **knowledge** in 1:4. Alternate translation: [is what enables you to know what is true] or [allows you to think wisely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:7 (#5)

חָ֝כְמָ֗ה וּמוּסָ֥ר אֱוִילִ֥ים בָּֽזוּ

“fools despise wisdom and instruction”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **wisdom** and **instruction**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **wisdom** and **instruction** in 1:2. Alternate translation: [But fools do not care about being wise or learning from others]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:7 (#1)

יִרְאַ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“The fear of Yahweh”

Here, the author is using the possessive form to describe **fear** that a person should have for **Yahweh**. If this is not clear in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The fear for Yahweh]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:7 (#2)

רֵאשִׁ֣ית דָּ֭עַת

“is} the beginning of knowledge”

Here, **beginning** refers to the basis of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is the prerequisite for acquiring knowledge] or [is what knowledge is based upon]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:7 (#6)

חָכְמָ֣ה וּ֭מוּסָ֣ר אֱוִילִ֑ים בָּזוּ

“fools despise wisdom and instruction”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [By contrast, fools despise wisdom and instruction]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 1:8 (#6)

וְאַל־תִּ֝טֹּ֗שׁ

“and do not forsake”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **forsake**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [and heed]

See: Double Negatives

Proverbs 1:8 (#7)

תּוֹרַ֥ת

“the law of”

Here, the word **law** is singular in form, but it refers to several laws as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the rules of]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 1:8 (#3)

בְּנִ֑י

“my son”

Although the term **son** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to either a male or female child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [my offspring]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 1:8 (#2)

שְׁמַ֤ע בְּנִ֨י מוּסַ֪ר

“Hear, my son, the instruction of”

Hear in the Bible often means “hear and obey.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language. Alternate translation: [Pay attention, my son, to the instruction of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:8 (#4)

מוּסַ֪ר

“the instruction of”

See how you translated **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:8 (#5)

מוּסַ֪ר אָבִ֡יךָ

“the instruction of your father”

Solomon is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first person form. Alternate translation: [the instruction of me, your father]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Proverbs 1:8 (#1)

שְׁמַ֤ע בְּנִ֨י מוּסַ֪ר אָבִ֡יךָ וְאַל־תִּ֝טֹּ֗שׁ תּוֹרַ֥ת אִמֶּֽךָ

“Hear, my son, the instruction of your father and do not forsake the law of your mother”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Hear, my son, the instruction of your father, yes, do not forsake the law of your mother]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:9 (#6)

לִוְיַ֣ת חֵ֭ן

“are} a garland of grace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in an-

other way. Alternate translation: [a gracious garland] or [an attractive garland]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:9 (#2)

לִוְיַ֣ת חֵ֭ן הֵ֣ם לְרֹאשֶׁ֑ךָ וַֽעֲנָקִ֥ים לְגַרְגְּרֹתֶֽיךָ

“they {are} a garland of grace for your head and pendants for your neck”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [they are a garland of grace for your head, yes, even pendants for your neck]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:9 (#5)

לִוְיַ֣ת חֵ֭ן

“are} a garland of grace”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **garland** that is characterized by **grace**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [are a gracious garland]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:9 (#3)

הֵ֣ם

“they”

Here, the pronoun **they** refers to the instruction and teaching of one’s parents, as stated in the previous verse. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the instruction and law from your parents are] or [the things your parents taught you are]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:9 (#1)

כִּ֤י

“for”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Obey these instructions because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:9 (#4)

לִוְיַ֣ת חֵ֭ן הֵ֣ם לְרֹאשֶׁ֑ךָ וַֽעֲנָקִ֥ים לְגַרְגְּרֹתֶֽיךָ

“they {are} a garland of grace for your head and pendants for your neck”

Here Solomon speaks of the rules and instructions that parents teach their children as if they were a **garland** or **pendants**. These two items make a person look more attractive to other people and may cause other people to respect that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. Alternate translation: [they make you look more beautiful and respectable] or [they are like a garland of grace for your head and like pendants for your neck]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:10 (#1)

בְּנִ֑י

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 1:10 (#3)

אִם־יְפַתּ֥וּךָ חַטָּאִ֑ים אַל־תֹּאבֶֽא

“if sinners entice you, do not consent”

Solomon implies that the **sinners** would **entice** his **son** to sin with them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [if sinners entice you to join them in sinning, do not consent to sin with them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:10 (#2)

אִם־יְפַתּ֥וּךָ חַטָּאִ֑ים

“if sinners entice you”

Solomon is using a hypothetical situation to help his readers understand how important it is to resist temptation from **sinners**. Use the natural form in your language for expressing a hypothetical situation. Alternate translation: [should it happen that sinners entice you]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Proverbs 1:11 (#5)

לְדָמֶ֑ם

“for blood”

Here, **blood** refers to violently murdering someone, which usually causes **blood** to come out of the person who is murdered. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to shed blood] or [to murder someone]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:11 (#4)

נֶאֶרְבָ֣ה & נִצְפְּנֶ֣נָּה

“Let us lie in wait & Let us hide to ambush”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a word that shows the connection between these two phrases. Alternate translation: [Let us lie in wait ... Yes, let us hide to ambush]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:11 (#1)

אִם־יֹאמְר֣וּ

“If they say”

Solomon is using a hypothetical situation to help his readers understand how sinners might entice someone to join them in sinning. Use the natural form in your language for expressing a hypothetical situation. Alternate translation: [Suppose they say]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Proverbs 1:11 (#6)

לְדָמֶ֑ם נִצְפְּנֶ֣נָּה

“for blood. Let us hide to ambush”

Here, **for** and **to** introduce the purposes for these actions. The purpose for lying in wait is to shed blood. The purpose for hiding is to ambush someone. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate purposes. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of shedding blood. Let us hide for the purpose of ambushing]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 1:11 (#7)

לְנָקִ֥י

“the innocent one”

The sinners are speaking of an **innocent** person in general, not of one particular **innocent one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [some innocent person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 1:11 (#2)

יֹאמְר֣וּ

“they say”

Here, the pronoun **they** refers to sinners, as mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those sinners say]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:11 (#3)

אִתָּ֑נוּ נֶאֶרְבָ֣ה & נִצְפְּנֶ֣נָּה

“with us! Let us lie in wait & Let us hide to ambush”

By **us**, the sinners are referring to themselves but not other people, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Proverbs 1:12 (#4)

כִּשְׁאוֹל֙

“like Sheol”

The sinners are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [like Sheol swallows people]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:12 (#9)

כְּיֹרְדֵ֥י בֽוֹר

“like those going down to a pit”

The Israelites referred to dying as **going down to Sheol** or a **pit**. Here the sinners are saying that their victims are like **those going down to a pit** because those people will die. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [like those who die]

See: Simile

Proverbs 1:12 (#3)

כִּשְׁאוֹל חַיִּים וּתְמִימִים כְּיֹרְדֵי בוֹר

“the living ones, like Sheol, and the whole ones like those going down to a pit”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [the living ones, like Sheol, yes, the whole ones, like those going down to a pit]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:12 (#2)

נְבַלְּעֵם

“Let us swallow them”

The sinners speak of murdering people as if they were swallowing them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let us destroy them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:12 (#7)

וּתְמִימִים

“and the whole ones”

Here, **whole** refers to being completely healthy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the healthy ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:12 (#6)

וּתְמִימִים

“and the whole ones”

The sinners are leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the beginning of the verse. Alternate translation: [and let us swallow the whole ones]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:12 (#8)

כְּיֹרְדֵי בוֹר

“like those going down to a pit”

The sinners are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [like those going down to a pit are swallowed]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:12 (#1)

נְבַלְּעֵם

“Let us swallow them”

By **us**, the sinners are referring to themselves but not other people, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Proverbs 1:12 (#5)

כִּשְׁאוֹל

“like Sheol”

Here, **Sheol** is spoken of as if it were a living thing that could **swallow** someone. The idea of **Sheol** swallowing someone refers to how people are completely gone after they die and are buried. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [like Sheol completely covers people]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:13 (#1)

נִמְצָא נְמַלֵּא בָתֵּינוּ

“We will find & We will fill our houses”

In this verse, the sinners use **We** and **our** to refer to themselves but not other people. Use the exclusive form of those words in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Proverbs 1:13 (#2)

כָּל

“all”

The sinners say **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [very much]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 1:14 (#1)

גּוֹרָלֵךְ תַּפִּיל בְּתוֹכֵנוּ

“You must cause your lot to fall in our midst”

This is an idiom. It refers to joining with a group of people that will share the same life or destiny. Alternate translation: [You must join us and share our destiny]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:14 (#3)

בְּתוֹכֵנוּ & לְכֻלָּנוּ

“in our midst & for all of us”

In this verse, the sinners use **our** to refer to themselves but not other people. However, they use **us** to include the person they are addressing. Use the appropriate form of those words in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Proverbs 1:14 (#2)

כִּיס אֶחָד יִהְיֶה לְכֻלָּנוּ

“one purse will be for all of us”

Here, **purse** represents the contents of the purse, which would be money and valuables. They are saying that they will share equally whatever they steal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everything that we steal we will share equally]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:15 (#1)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 1:15 (#3)

אַל־תֵּלֵךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ אִתָּם מְנַע רַגְלְךָ מִנְּתִיבָתָם

“do not walk on the road with them; restrain your foot from their path”

Here Solomon speaks of walking with the sinners as a way to express associating with them, and he uses **road** and **path** to refer to the way that the sinners behave. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [have nothing to do with those sinners; keep yourself from behaving like them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:15 (#4)

רַגְלְךָ

“your foot”

Solomon is using one part of a person, the **foot**, to represent the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [yourself]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 1:15 (#2)

אַל־תֵּלֵךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ אִתָּם מְנַע רַגְלְךָ מִנְּתִיבָתָם

“do not walk on the road with them; restrain your foot from their path”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases in a way that would show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [do not walk on the road with them; I am saying, restrain your foot from their path]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:16 (#4)

לִשְׁפֹּךְ־דָּם

“to pour out blood”

The phrase **pour out blood** refers to violently murdering people, which usually causes **blood** to come out of the people who are murdered. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to kill others]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:16 (#2)

רַגְלֵיהֶם & יָרוּצוּ

“their feet run”

Here, “feet” represents the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they run]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 1:16 (#1)

כִּי

“for”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not walk with them because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:16 (#3)

רַגְלֵיהֶם לָרַע יָרוּצוּ

“their feet run to evil”

Here Solomon speaks of how eager the sinners are to do evil as if **their feet** were running to do it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they are quick to do evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:17 (#4)

בַּבַּעַל כָּנָף

“owner of wing”

The phrase **owner of wing** refers to a bird. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:17 (#1)

מְזֹרָה הָרֶשֶׁת

“is} the net spread out”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [does someone spread out a net]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 1:17 (#3)

בְּעֵינֵי

“in the eyes of”

Here, **eyes** refers to what is seen with the **eyes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in view of] or [in the sight of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:17 (#2)

מְזֹרָה הָרֶשֶׁת

“is} the net spread out”

A **net** is a trap made of woven rope or string that hunters use to catch animals. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of trap, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [is the trap set up]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 1:18 (#2)

וְהֵם לְדָמָם יֶאֱרֹבוּ יִצְפְּנוּ לְנַפְשֹׁתָם

“but they lie in wait for their blood; they hide in ambush for their lives”

This verse compares the sinners to the birds being hunted in the previous verse. But here it speaks of the sinners as both the hunters and the hunted. Unlike a bird that is smart enough to avoid a net, these sinners destroy themselves by doing sinful things that cause them to be killed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but because they intend to kill others, they will be killed; their attempts to attack others will cost them their lives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:18 (#4)

וְהֵם לְדָמָם יֶאֱרֹבוּ יִצְפְּנוּ לְנַפְשֹׁתָם

“but they lie in wait for their blood; they hide in ambush for their lives”

In this verse, the pronouns **they** and **their** refer to the sinners described in 1:10–16. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but those sinners lie in wait for their own blood; those sinners hide in ambush for their own lives]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:18 (#3)

וְהֵם לְדָמָם יֶאֱרֹבוּ יִצְפְּנוּ לְנַפְשֹׁתָם

“but they lie in wait for their blood; they hide in ambush for their lives”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a word that shows the connection between these two clauses. Alternate translation: [but they lie in wait for their blood; yes, they hide in ambush for their lives]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:18 (#5)

וְהֵם לְדָמָם יֶאֱרֹבוּ יִצְפְּנוּ לְנַפְשֹׁתָם

“but they lie in wait for their blood; they hide in ambush for their lives”

In this verse, **for** introduces the result of these actions. They **lie in wait** and **hide in ambush** and the result is that it costs them **their blood** and **their lives**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. Alternate translation: [but they lie in wait, which costs them their blood; they hide in ambush, which costs them their lives]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:18 (#6)

לְדָמָם

“for their blood”

See how you translated **blood** in 1:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:18 (#1)

וְהֵם

“but they”

Here, **but** indicates a contrast between the bird mentioned in the previous verse and the sinners who speak in 1:11–14. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. You may want to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [By contrast, they]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 1:19 (#3)

בֹּצֵעַ בָּצַע

“who unjustly gain unjust gain”

Here, **unjustly gain unjust gain** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [who are greedy for unjust gain]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 1:19 (#1)

אָרְחוֹת

“are} the paths of”

Here Solomon uses **paths** to refer to the destiny of those sinners. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are the destinies of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:19 (#2)

כָּל

“all”

Here Solomon uses the adjective **all** as a noun to mean “every person.” Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [all people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 1:19 (#4)

בָּצַע

“unjust gain”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **gain**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what they gain unjustly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:19 (#6)

אֶת־נֶפֶשׁ בְּעָלָיו יִקָּח

“it takes the life of its owner”

Solomon speaks of **unjust gain** as if it were a person who could kill its **owner**. He means that the wicked things that sinful people do to **unjustly gain unjust gain** will cause them to die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly

or use a simile. Alternate translation: [unjust gain results in its owner dying] or [seeking unjust gain kills those who do it] or [it is as if unjust gain takes the life of its owner]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:19 (#7)

אֶת־נֶ֫פֶשׁ & יִקָּח

“it takes the life of”

Here, the phrase **takes the life of** means to kill someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it kills]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:19 (#5)

אֶת־נֶ֫פֶשׁ בְּעָלָ֥יו יִקָּח

“it takes the life of its owner”

Here, the pronouns **it** and **its** refer to the **unjust gain** that is mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that unjust gain takes the life of the unjust gain’s owner]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:20 (#2)

חָ֭כְמוֹת בַּחוּץ תָּרֹ֑נָּה בָּ֝רְחֹבוֹת תִּתֵּ֥ן קוֹלָֽהּ

“Wisdom calls out outside; she gives her voice in the open areas”

In 1:20–33, Solomon speaks of **Wisdom** as if it were a woman speaking to the people. See the discussion of this in the Introduction for this chapter. By saying that **Wisdom calls out** or **gives her voice**, he means that wisdom is available to all people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Wisdom is available openly; it is available freely] or [Wisdom is like a woman who calls out outside, like a woman who gives forth her voice in the open] or [It is as if wisdom calls out outside; it is as if wisdom gives forth its voice in the town square]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:20 (#1)

חָ֭כְמוֹת בַּחוּץ תָּרֹ֑נָּה בָּ֝רְחֹבוֹת תִּתֵּ֥ן קוֹלָֽהּ

“Wisdom calls out outside; she gives her voice in the open areas”

These two clauses and the two clauses of the next verse mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a word that shows the connection between these two clauses. Alternate translation: [Wisdom calls out outside, indeed, she gives forth her voice in the open places]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:20 (#3)

חָ֭כְמוֹת

“Wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **Wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:20 (#4)

בַּחוּץ

“outside”

Here, **outside** refers to the public space **outside** of one’s house where there would be many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the streets]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:20 (#5)

תִּתֵּ֥ן קוֹלָֽהּ

“she gives her voice”

This is an idiom that means **she** spoke very loudly. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she lifts her voice] or [she speaks with a loud voice]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:20 (#6)

בָּ֝רְחֹבוֹת

“in the open areas”

Here, **open areas** refers to large, outdoor public places where there would usually be many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the marketplaces] or [in the plazas]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:21 (#1)

בְּרֹ֣אשׁ הֹמִיּ֣וֹת תִּתְקָרָ֑א בְּפִתְחֵ֖י שְׁעָרִ֣ים בָּעִ֔יר אֲמָרֶ֖יהָ תֹּאמֵֽר

“At the head of the tumultuous places she calls out; at the opening of the gates in the city, she says her sayings”

These two clauses and the two clauses of the previous verse mean basically the same thing. These two clauses emphasize the meaning of the first clause of the previous verse by repeating the same idea but naming different places in the city. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that would show that these clauses are repeating the same idea from the previous verse, not saying something different. Alternate translation: [Yes, at the head of the tumultuous places she calls out; yes, at the opening of the gates in the city she says her sayings]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:21 (#3)

תִּתְקָרָ֑א & אֲמָרֶ֖יהָ תֹּאמֵֽר

“she calls out & she says her sayings”

Here Solomon continues to speak of wisdom as if it were a woman who **calls out** or **says her sayings**. As in the previous verse, he means that wisdom is available to all people. Continue the strategy that you used in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [wisdom is available ... it is available] or [it is as if wisdom calls out ... it is as if wisdom says its sayings]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:21 (#4)

בְּפִתְחֵ֖י שְׁעָרִ֣ים בָּעִ֔יר

“at the opening of the gates in the city”

Solomon’s readers would have understood that the **the opening of the gates in the city** was a crowded place where many people gathered. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [at the opening of the gates in the city, where many people gather]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:21 (#2)

בְּרֹ֣אשׁ

“At the head of”

Here, **head** refers to the place where busy streets intersect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [At the intersection of streets in]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:21 (#5)

אֲמָרֶ֖יהָ תֹּאמֵֽר

“she says her sayings”

Here, **says her sayings** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis.

See: Poetry

Proverbs 1:22 (#3)

פְּתָיִ֑י & לְלָצ֥וֹן & דֵּעַ֖ת

“naiveté & mockery & knowledge”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **naiveté**, **mockery**, and **knowledge**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **knowledge** in 1:4. Alternate translation: [thinking naively ... mocking ... knowing things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:22 (#2)

עַד־מָתַ֣י ׀ פְּתָיִ֣ים ׀ תְּאֱהָבֽוּ־ פֶ֭תִי וְלֵצִ֣ים לָ֑לֶצוֹן חָמְד֥וּ לָ֝הֶ֗ם וּ֭כְסִילִים יִשְׂנְא֣וּ־דָֽעַת

“Until when will naive ones love naiveté and mockers delight {in} mockery for themselves and stupid ones hate knowledge”

Wisdom is using the question form to emphasize that these types of people should stop acting the way that they do. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [For too long the naive ones have loved naiveté, and mockers have delighted in mockery for themselves, and stupid ones have hated knowledge!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 1:22 (#1)

עַד־מָתַ֣י

“Until when”

1:22–33 are one long quotation that Solomon presents as if wisdom itself were speaking. Consider natural

ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [She says, “Until when”] or [It is as if Wisdom says, “Until when”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 1:23 (#6)

לָכֶם & אֶתְכֶם

“to you & you”

In this speech from verse 23 through verse 27, Wisdom addresses foolish people directly as a group. Therefore, use the plural forms of address in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Proverbs 1:23 (#4)

רוּחִי

“my spirit”

Here, **spirit** refers to a person’s thoughts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:23 (#5)

אַבִּיעָה לָכֶם רוּחִי

“I shall allow my spirit to gush forth to you”

Wisdom telling the people what she thinks is spoken of as if her thoughts were a liquid that would come flowing out. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I shall freely tell you what I think]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:23 (#7)

דְּבָרַי

“my words”

Here, Wisdom uses the term **words** to describe what she says by using **words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the things that I have to say]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:23 (#3)

אַבִּיעָה לָכֶם רוּחִי אוֹדִיעָה דְבָרַי אֶתְכֶם

“I shall allow my spirit to gush forth to you, I shall cause you to know my words”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that would show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I shall allow my spirit to gush forth to you, yes, I shall cause you to know my words]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:23 (#2)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

Behold is a term meant to focus the attention of the listener on what the speaker is about to say. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use some emphatic term or expression in your language that would have this same effect. Alternate translation: [Note this] or [Listen]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:23 (#1)

תָּשׁוּבוּ

“Turn”

Turn here implies turning one’s head in order to listen better to what someone is saying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Turn your heads and listen]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:24 (#1)

יַעַן

“Because”

Because here indicates that what follows in this verse and the next verse is the reason for the result, which is stated in 1:26–27. Use the most natural way in your language to state a reason. If you divide 1:24–27 into two sentences, then you could either remove **Because** here and add a word to express result at the beginning of 1:26 as in the UST, or you could add the word “because” to each of the clauses of 1:24–25. Alternate translation: [Since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:24 (#2)

קָרָאתִי וַתְּמָאֲנוּ נָטִיתִי יָדִי וְאֵין מַקְשִׁיב

“I have called and you have refused, I have stretched out my hand, and there was no one listening attentively”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that would show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I have called and you have refused, yes, I have stretched out my hand and there was no one listening attentively] or [I have called and you have refused, because I have stretched out my hand and there was no one listening attentively]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:24 (#3)

וַתְּמָאֲנוּ

“and you have refused”

Wisdom implies that people **refused** to listen to what she said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and you have refused to listen to me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:24 (#4)

נָטִיתִי יָדִי

“I have stretched out my hand”

This phrase **stretched out my hand** is an idiom that refers to beckoning someone or inviting a person to come. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I stretched out my hand to beckon you] or [I beckoned you]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:25 (#1)

וַתִּפְרְעוּ כָל־עֲצָתִי וְתוֹכַחְתִּי לֹא אֲבִיתֶם

“and you have ignored all my counsel, and my rebuke you did not accept”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Both of these clauses continue the reason that was begun in verse 24 with the word “because.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** or you could add the word “because” to each of the clauses. Alternate translation: [and you have ignored all my counsel, yes, my rebuke you did not accept] or [and because you have ignored all my counsel and because my rebuke you did not accept]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:25 (#2)

עֲצָתִי וְתוֹכַחְתִּי

“my counsel, and my rebuke”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **counsel** and **rebuke**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [that I have counseled, and what I said to rebuke you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:26 (#3)

גַּם־אֲנִי

“I too”

The phrase translated as **I too** shifts the focus from the foolish people mentioned in 1:24–25 to the person speaking, who represents wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I, in turn,] or [I, for my part,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:26 (#4)

בְּאֵידְכֶם & בְּבֹא פַּחְדְּכֶם

“at your calamity & when your dread comes”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **calamity** and **dread**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [when you suffer ... when you are scared]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:26 (#1)

גַּם־אֲנִי

“I too”

1:26–27 state the result of what was stated in 1:24–25. If you divided 1:24–27 into two sentences and removed **Because** from 1:24, then you will need to add a word here to express the result of the reasons given in 1:24–25. Alternate translation: [As a result, I too] or [So, I too]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:26 (#2)

גַּם־אֲנִי בְּאֵידְכֶם אֶשְׂחָק אֶלְעַג בְּבֹא פַּחְדְּכֶם

“I too shall laugh at your calamity, I shall mock when your dread comes”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I too shall laugh at your calamity, yes, I shall mock when your dread comes]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:26 (#5)

בְּבֹא פַּחְדְּכֶם

“when your dread comes”

Here, wisdom speaks of experiencing **dread** as if it were a person who **comes** to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when you experience dread]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:27 (#6)

צָרָה וְצוּקָה

“distress and anguish”

The terms **distress** and **anguish** mean similar things. The two terms are used together here for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [distressing events]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 1:27 (#1)

פַּחְדְּכֶם & בְּבֹא

“when your dread comes”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:27 (#2)

פַּחְדְּכֶם וֶאֵידְכֶם

“your dread & and your calamity”

See how you translated **dread** and **calamity** in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:27 (#5)

צָרָה וְצוּקָה

“distress and anguish”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **distress** and **anguish**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [distressing things that make you anguished]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:27 (#4)

בְּבֹא עֲלֵיכֶם צָרָה וְצוּקָה

“when distress and anguish come upon you”

Here, wisdom speaks of experiencing **distress and anguish** as if they were objects that could **come upon** someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when you experience distress and anguish]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:27 (#3)

כשאוה & כְּסוּפָה

“like a storm & like a whirlwind”

Here, Wisdom compares the manner in which **dread** and **calamity** will happen to the sudden, destructive power of a **storm** or **whirlwind**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [powerfully ... suddenly]

See: Simile

Proverbs 1:28 (#1)

אָז יִקְרָאֻנְנִי וְלֹא אֶעֱנֶה יְשַׁחֲרֻנְנִי וְלֹא יִמְצָאֻנְנִי

“Then they will call out to me, but I will not answer. They will diligently seek me, but they will not find me”

These two sentences mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the sentences with a word that shows that the second sentence is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Then they will call out to me, but I will not answer. Yes, they will diligently seek me, but they will not find me]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:28 (#3)

יְקָרְאֻנְנִי

“they will call out to me”

Here, **call out** implies crying out for help. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [they will call out to me for help]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:28 (#2)

יְקָרְאֻנְנִי & יְשַׁחֲרֻנַנִי וְלֹא יִמְצָאֻנְנִי

“they will call out to me & They will diligently seek me, but they will not find me”

In this verse, the pronoun **they** refers to the foolish people who ignored wisdom, as described in 1:22–27. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those who ignored me will call out to me ... those people will diligently seek me, but they will not find me]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:29 (#2)

דָּעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:29 (#3)

וְיִרְאַת יְהוָה

“and the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated **the fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:29 (#1)

תַּחַת כִּי

“for the reason that”

This phrase indicates that what follows in this verse and the next verse are the reasons why the foolish people will not find wisdom, as stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to express reasons. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:30 (#3)

לַעֲצָתִי & כָּל־תּוֹכַחְתִּי

“my counsel & my every rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **counsel** and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:30 (#1)

לֹא־אָבְוּ לַעֲצָתִי נָאֲצוּ כָּל־תּוֹכַחְתִּי

“they did not want my counsel, and they despised my every rebuke”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [they did not want my counsel, yes, they despised my every rebuke]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:30 (#2)

לֹא־אָבְוּ & נָאֲצוּ

“they did not want & and they despised”

In this verse, the pronoun **they** refers to the foolish people who ignored wisdom, as described in 1:22–27. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those who ignored me did not want ... and those people despised]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:31 (#2)

וְיֹאכְלוּ מִפְּרִי דַרְכָּם

“And they will eat from the fruit of their way”

Here, people suffering the consequences of their behavior are spoken of as if they were eating **the fruit of their way**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar idiom from your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they will experience the consequences of their behavior]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:31 (#4)

וּמִמֹּעֲצֹתֵיהֶם יִשְׂבָּעוּ

“and from their plans they will be satisfied”

Here, the word translated as **satisfied** means “to be made full of.” This word can have either a positive or negative meaning, but here the meaning is negative. It means that these foolish people will suffer the full consequences of **their** foolish **plans**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [they will experience the consequences of their plans]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:31 (#1)

וְיֹאכְלוּ מִפְּרִי־דַרְכָּם וּמִמֹּעֲצֹתֵיהֶם יִשְׂבָּעוּ

“And they will eat from the fruit of their way, and from their plans they will be satisfied”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And they will eat from the fruit of their way, yes, from their plans they will be satisfied]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:31 (#3)

וּמִמֹּעֲצֹתֵיהֶם יִשְׂבָּעוּ

“and from their plans they will be satisfied”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and their plans will satisfy them]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 1:32 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows in 1:32–33 is the conclusion to what Wisdom stated in 1:22–31. Alternate translation: [In conclusion,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 1:32 (#3)

מְשׁוּבַ֣ת פְּתָיִ֣ים תַּהַרְגֵ֑ם

“the turning away of the naive ones will slay them”

Here, **turning away** is spoken of as if it were a person who could **slay** someone. This expression means that **the naive ones** will die because of their **turning away**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [the naive ones will die because of their turning away] or [the turning away of the naive ones is like someone who will slay them]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:32 (#2)

מְשׁוּבַ֣ת פְּתָיִ֣ים תַּהַרְגֵ֑ם וְשַׁלְוַ֖ת כְּסִילִ֣ים תְּאַבְּדֵֽם

“the turning away of the naive ones will slay them and {false} security will lead stupid ones to ruin”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [the turning away of the naive ones will slay them, yes, false security will lead stupid ones to ruin]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:32 (#4)

מְשׁוּבַ֣ת פְּתָיִ֣ים

“the turning away of the naive ones”

Here, refusing to listen to wisdom is spoken of as **turning away** from the one who is speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the refusing to listen of the naive ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:32 (#6)

וְשַׁלְוַ֖ת כְּסִילִ֣ים תְּאַבְּדֵֽם

“and {false} security will lead stupid ones to ruin”

Here, **false security** is spoken of as if it were a person who could **lead** someone. This expression means that **stupid ones** will die because of their **false** sense of **security**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and stupid ones will be ruined because of their false security] or [false security of stupid ones is like someone who will ruin them]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:32 (#5)

וְשַׁלְוַ֣ת

“and {false} security”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **false security**, you could express the same idea with a different expression. Alternate translation: [wrongly feeling secure]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:33 (#3)

מִפַּ֥חַד רָעָֽה

“from the dread of evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **dread** in 1:26 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:33 (#2)

מִפַּ֥חַד רָעָֽה

“from the dread of evil”

Here, the possessive form describes **dread** that a person has for **evil**. If this is not clear in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from dreading evil]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:33 (#1)

וְשֹׁמֵ֣עַ

“But the one who listens”

But here indicates a strong contrast between **the one who listens** and “the naive ones,” who were mentioned in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [However, the one who listens]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

The benefits of wisdom

- God watches over those who see wisdom (2:1–11)
- Wisdom saves you from wicked men (2:12–15)
- Wisdom saves you from adulterous women (2:16–19)
- Following wisdom leads to a good life (2:20–22)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My Son

Occasionally, Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” This does not mean that all of those proverbs only apply to males. Instead, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son, and the kind of advice in these proverbs is about common temptations of young men.

Proverbs 2:1 (#1)

בְּנִ֑י

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 2:1 (#3)

וּמִצְוֹתַ֖י תִּצְפֹּ֣ן אִתָּֽךְ

“and my commandments you store up with you”

Valuing the father’s **commandments** is spoken of as if the **commandments** were a treasure and the person were a safe place to store that treasure. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and consider my commandments to be as valuable as a treasure]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:1 (#2)

אִם

“if”

Here, **if** indicates the beginning of a conditional sentence that extends from this verse to 2:5. This is the first of three **if** clauses in this long sentence. If it would be clearer in your language, you could divide this long sentence into shorter sentences and indicate the condition along with the result in 2:5, as in the UST.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Proverbs 2:2 (#4)

תַּטֶּ֣ה לִ֭בְּךָ

“you incline your heart”

In many languages this sentence would need the word “if” here in order to be complete. You could supply this word from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if you incline your heart]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:2 (#3)

לַחָכְמָ֑ה & לַתְּבוּנָֽה

“to wisdom & to understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:2 (#1)

לְהַקְשִׁ֣יב לַחָכְמָ֣ה אָזְנֶ֑ךָ תַּטֵּ֥ה לִ֝בְּךָ֗ לַתְּבוּנָֽה

“to cause your ear to be attentive to wisdom, you incline your heart to understanding”

The word translated as **to** here indicates that what follows in this verse explains the means by which a person can receive the sayings and commandments mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by causing your ear to be attentive to wisdom, and by inclining your heart to understanding]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:2 (#5)

תַּטֵּ֥ה לִ֝בְּךָ֗ לַתְּבוּנָֽה

“you incline your heart to understanding”

The phrase **incline your heart** is an idiom that refers to fully committing one’s mind or will to doing something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if you fully commit yourself to gaining understanding]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 2:2 (#2)

לְהַקְשִׁ֣יב אָזְנֶ֑ךָ & תַּטֵּ֥ה לִ֝בְּךָ֗

“to cause your ear to be attentive”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to forcing oneself to listen carefully. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [force yourself to listen attentively]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 2:3 (#3)

לַתְּבוּנָ֥ה תִתֵּ֥ן קוֹלֶֽךָ

“for understanding you lift up your voice”

In many languages this sentence would need the word “if” here in order to be complete. You could supply this word from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if for understanding you lift up your voice]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:3 (#2)

לַבִּינָ֑ה & לַתְּבוּנָֽה

“for insight & for understanding”

Here Solomon speaks of calling out to receive **insight** and **understanding** as if they were people whom someone could summon. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to receive insight ... to receive understanding]

See: Personification

Proverbs 2:3 (#1)

אִ֭ם לַבִּינָ֣ה תִקְרָ֑א לַ֝תְּבוּנָ֗ה תִּתֵּ֥ן קוֹלֶֽךָ

“if for insight you call out, for understanding you lift up your voice”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [if for insightful understanding you lift up your voice to call out]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:3 (#5)

לַתְּבוּנָֽה

“for understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:3 (#4)

לַבִּינָֽה

“for insight”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **insight**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for what should be perceived]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:3 (#6)

תִּתֵּ֣ן קוֹלֶ֑ךָ

“you lift up your voice”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to speaking loudly. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you speak with a loud voice]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 2:4 (#3)

תְּבַקְּשֶׁ֥נָּה & תַּחְפְּשֶׂ֑נָּה

“you seek it & you search for it”

In this verse, the pronoun **it** refers to wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you seek wisdom ... search for wisdom]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 2:4 (#1)

אִם־תְּבַקְּשֶׁ֥נָּה כַכֶּ֗סֶף וְכַמְּטֻמֹ֥ונִ֑ים תַּחְפְּשֶׂ֑נָּה

“if you seek it as silver, and as hidden treasures you search for it”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [if you diligently search for it like a valuable hidden treasure]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:4 (#4)

אִם־תְּבַקְּשֶׁ֥נָּה כַכֶּ֗סֶף וְכַמְּטֻמֹ֥ונִ֑ים תַּחְפְּשֶׂ֑נָּה

“if you seek it as silver, and as hidden treasures you search for it”

Solomon is saying that wisdom is like **silver** and **hidden treasures** because those are items that people value greatly and work very hard to find. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [if you seek it diligently, like one seeks silver, and search for it diligently, like one searches for hidden treasures]

See: Simile

Proverbs 2:4 (#2)

אִם־תְּבַקְּשֶׁ֥נָּה כַכֶּ֗סֶף וְכַמְּטֻמֹ֥ונִ֑ים תַּחְפְּשֶׂ֑נָּה

“if you seek it as silver, and as hidden treasures you search for it”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if you seek it as if it were silver and search for it as if it were hidden treasures] or [if you seek it as you would seek silver and search for it as you would search for hidden treasures]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:5 (#2)

יִרְאַ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:5 (#1)

אָ֣ז

“then”

Here, **then** indicates that what follows is the result of meeting the conditions that are stated in 2:1–4. If you divided this long sentence in 2:1–5 into shorter sentences, then you will need to indicate the condition before the result here in this new sentence, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [If you do so, then the result will be that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:5 (#3)

וְדַ֖עַת אֱלֹהִ֣ים תִּמְצָֽא

“and the knowledge of God you will find”

Obtaining **the knowledge of God** is spoken of as if **the knowledge of God** were an object that a person can **find** by searching for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will have the knowledge of God]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:5 (#4)

וְדַעַת אֱלֹהִים תִּמְצָא

“and the knowledge of God you will find”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe knowing **God**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and you will find how to know God]

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:6 (#2)

חָכְמָה & דַּעַת וּתְבוּנָה

“wisdom & are} knowledge and understanding”

See how you translated **wisdom** in 1:2 and **knowledge** and **understanding** in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:6 (#3)

מִפִּיו דַּעַת וּתְבוּנָה

“from his mouth {are} knowledge and understanding”

Here, **mouth** represents Yahweh himself or what he says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from Yahweh comes knowledge and understanding]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 2:6 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason why what Solomon stated in 2:1–4 is true. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is due to the fact that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:7 (#5)

תֹּם

“with} integrity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:7 (#1)

וצפן לַיְשָׁרִים תּוּשִׁיָּה

“And he stores up for the upright ones sound wisdom”

Yahweh possessing **sound wisdom** that he gives to people is spoken of as if **sound wisdom** were an item that Yahweh **stores up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he has sound wisdom to provide for the upright ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:7 (#4)

לְהֹלְכֵי תֹם

“for those walking {with} integrity”

Here, **walking** refers to how people behave. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who conduct themselves with integrity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:7 (#2)

תּוּשִׁיָּה

“sound wisdom”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sound wisdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [soundly wise things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:7 (#3)

מָגֵן לְהֹלְכֵי תֹם

“a shield for those walking {with} integrity”

Yahweh protecting his people is spoken of as if he were a **shield**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he shields those walking with integrity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:8 (#1)

לִנְצֹר

“to guard”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose for Yahweh giving “sound wisdom” and being a “shield,” as stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural

way in your language to indicate a purpose. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Yahweh does these things for the purpose of guarding]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 2:8 (#2)

אָרְחוֹת מִשְׁפָּט

“the paths of justice”

Here, **paths** could refer to: (1) the behavior of people, in which case the meaning is similar to the next clause in the verse. Alternate translation: [those who behave justly]; (2) **justice** itself, as if it were **paths**. Alternate translation: [the path that is justice] or [justice]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:8 (#3)

וְדֶרֶךְ חסידו יִשְׁמֹר

“and the way of his faithful ones he will preserve”

Here Solomon speaks of the lives of God’s **faithful ones** as if they were a **way** or road. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will preserve the lives of his faithful ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:9 (#3)

כָּל־מַעְגַּל־טוֹב

“every good track”

Here Solomon speaks of wise behavior as if it were a **good track**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [every good way of living]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:9 (#1)

אָז

“Then”

Then here indicates that what follows is another result of meeting the conditions stated in 2:1–4. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate the result of meeting conditions. Alternate translation: [If you do those things, then the result will be that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:9 (#2)

צֶדֶק וּמִשְׁפָּט וּמֵישָׁרִים

“righteousness and justice and integrity”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness**, **justice**, and **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:10 (#2)

תָּבוֹא בְלִבֶּךָ

“will enter into your heart”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to fully knowing something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2. Alternate translation: [will be fully in your mind] or [will become a part of you] or [will be the way that you think]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 2:10 (#3)

לְנַפְשְׁךָ יִנְעָם

“will be pleasant to your soul”

Here, **soul** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be pleasant to you]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 2:10 (#1)

חָכְמָה & וְדַעַת

“wisdom & and knowledge”

See how you translated **wisdom** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:11 (#3)

מְזִמָּה & תְּבוּנָה

“Discretion & understanding”

See how you translated **Discretion** in 1:4 and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:11 (#2)

מְזִמָּה תִּשְׁמֹר עָלֶיךָ תְּבוּנָה תִנְצְרֶכָּה

“Discretion will watch over you; understanding will guard you”

Here Solomon speaks of **discretion** and **understanding** as if they were people who could **protect** and **guard** someone else. He means that someone who has **discretion** and **understanding** will be safe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [If you have discretion, you will be safe; if you have understanding, you will be secure]

See: Personification

Proverbs 2:11 (#1)

מְזִמָּה תִּשְׁמֹר עָלֶיךָ תְּבוּנָה תִנְצְרֶכָּה

“Discretion will watch over you; understanding will guard you”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Discretion will watch over you, yes, understanding will protect you]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:12 (#1)

לְהַצִּילְךָ מִדֶּרֶךְ רָעָה מֵאִישׁ מְדַבֵּר תַּהְפֻּכוֹת

“to rescue you from the way of evil, from a man speaking perversions”

2:11–17 are one long sentence. If you divide these verses into multiple sentences then you may need to repeat some phrases in order to make the meaning clear, as the UST does.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:12 (#2)

לְהַצִּילְךָ

“to rescue you”

Here Solomon speaks of “discretion” and “understanding” as if they were people who could **rescue** someone. He means that people who have “discretion” and “understanding” will keep themselves away from harm. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to keep you away]

See: Personification

Proverbs 2:12 (#8)

מֵאִישׁ

“from a man”

The word **man** here represents a type of person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [from any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 2:12 (#3)

לְהַצִּילְךָ

“to rescue you”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose for “discretion” and “understanding” protecting a person, as stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a purpose. Alternate translation: [Discretion and understanding will protect you for the purpose of rescuing you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 2:12 (#6)

רָעָה

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:12 (#4)

מִדֶּרֶךְ רָעָה

“from the way of evil”

This phase **the way of evil** could refer to: (1) the **way** of an **evil** person. This interpretation fits the context of the descriptions of evil people given in 2:12–17. Alternate translation: [from the way of an evil person]; (2) a **way** that is characterized by **evil**. Alternate translation: [from any evil way]

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:12 (#7)

מֵאִישׁ

“from a man”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and to rescue you from a man]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:12 (#5)

מִדֶּ֣רֶךְ

“from the way of”

Here Solomon uses **way** to refer to how people behave. See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:13 (#1)

הַֽעֹזְבִ֗ים

“the ones who forsake”

See how you translated the same use of **forsake** in 1:8.

See: Personification

Proverbs 2:13 (#2)

אָרְח֣וֹת יֹ֭שֶׁר

“the paths of straightness”

Here, **the paths of straightness** refers to behaving in a right manner. The word **paths** refers to human behavior, and **straightness** refers to being righteous. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [doing what is right] or [acting rightly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:13 (#4)

לָלֶ֣כֶת בְּדַרְכֵי־חֹ֑שֶׁךְ

“to walk in the ways of darkness”

This phrase refers to behaving in an evil manner. The biblical authors often use **walk** to refer to how someone behaves and they use **darkness** to refer to evil. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to do what is evil] or [to behave in an evil manner]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 2:13 (#3)

לָלֶ֣כֶת

“to walk”

Here, **to** introduces the purpose for forsaking **the paths of straightness**. Use a natural way in your language to indicate purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of walking]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 2:14 (#1)

רָ֭ע & רֵֽע

“evil & evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:14 (#2)

בָּ֝תַּהְפֻּכ֗וֹת רָֽע

“in perverse things of evil”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **perverse things** that are characterized by **evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [evil perverse things]

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:15 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר אָ֭רְחֹתֵיהֶם עִקְּשִׁ֑ים וְנִלְוֹזִ֖ים בְּמַעְגְּלֹתָֽם

“whose paths {are} crooked and going astray in their tracks”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [whose paths are crooked, yes, who go astray in their tracks]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:15 (#2)

אָ֭רְחֹתֵיהֶם עִקְּשִׁ֑ים וְנִלְוֹזִ֖ים בְּמַעְגְּלֹתָֽם

“paths {are} crooked and going astray in their tracks”

Here Solomon refers to people’s wrong behavior as if they were walking on the wrong **paths** and **tracks**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [behavior is dishonest and who do things to deceive others]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:16 (#4)

מִמְּנָכְרִיָּֽה

“from a foreign woman”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and to rescue you from a foreign woman]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:16 (#5)

אֲמָרֶ֣יהָ הֶחֱלִֽיקָה

“who makes her sayings smooth”

Here Solomon speaks of this woman speaking seductively as if she were making what she says **smooth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who makes her sayings seductive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:16 (#1)

לְהַצִּֽילְךָ֥

“to rescue you”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is another purpose for “discretion” and “understanding” guarding a person, as stated in the 2:11. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a purpose. If you divided up the long sentence in 2:11–17 into shorter sentences, then here, beginning a new sentence, you will need to repeat some information from 2:11. Alternate translation: [Discretion and understanding will guard you for the additional purpose of rescuing you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 2:16 (#2)

מֵאִשָּׁ֣ה זָרָ֑ה מִנָּכְרִיָּֽה

“from a strange woman, from a foreign woman”

Here Solomon refers to an immoral and adulterous **woman** as if she were a stranger or foreigner. The woman is **strange** or **foreign** not because she is from a different ethnic group, but because she belongs to another man; she is a stranger to the son’s own marriage. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:16 (#3)

מֵאִשָּׁ֣ה זָרָ֑ה מִנָּכְרִיָּֽה

“from a strange woman, from a foreign woman”

Solomon is speaking of any women who do these things, not of one particular **woman**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [from any strange woman, from any foreign woman]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 2:17 (#1)

אַלּ֣וּף

“the companion of”

Here, **companion** refers to the husband of the adulterous woman mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the husband of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:17 (#3)

נְעוּרֶ֑יהָ

“her youth”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **youth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the time when she was young]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:17 (#2)

אַלּ֣וּף נְעוּרֶ֑יהָ

“the companion of her youth”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the companion** whom this woman married while she was in **her youth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the companion whom she married in her youth]

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:17 (#4)

בְּרִ֖ית אֱלֹהֶ֣יהָ

“the covenant of her God”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the covenant** that this woman made with **her God**. If

it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the covenant that she made with her God]

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:17 (#5)

בְּרִ֣ית אֱלֹהֶ֔יהָ

“the covenant of her God”

Here, **covenant** refers specifically to the **covenant** that a man and woman made with each other and God when they married. This **covenant** included promising not to commit adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the covenant that she made with her God when she married her husband]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:18 (#3)

שָׁ֭שְׁחָה & בֵּיתָ֣הּ

“her house sinks down”

Here, **her house** represents the woman herself and her activities. Alternate translation: [being involved with her takes you down]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 2:18 (#4)

שָׁ֭שְׁחָה אֶל־מָ֣וֶת

“sinks down to death”

Here Solomon speaks of death as a place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [results in a man dying] or [is a way to die]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:18 (#6)

מַעְגְּלֹתֶ֣יהָ

“her tracks”

Here, Solomon speaks of the activities that a man would participate in with this woman as **her tracks**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [becoming involved with her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:18 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason why “discretion” and “understanding” rescue a man from an adulterous woman, as stated in 2:16. Use the most natural way in your language to state a reason. Alternate translation: [Discretion and understanding will rescue you from her because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:18 (#7)

רְפָאִ֑ים

“the spirits of dead ones”

Here, **the spirits of dead ones** refers to the place where people’s spirits go when they die, which was called “Sheol” in 1:12. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the place where the spirits of dead people dwell] or [the place of the dead]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 2:18 (#5)

וְאֶל־רְפָאִ֥ים מַעְגְּלֹתֶֽיהָ

“and her tracks, to the spirits of dead ones”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. If necessary, you could supply these words from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [and her tracks sink down to the spirits of the dead] or [and her tracks lead to the spirits of the dead]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:18 (#2)

שָׁ֭שְׁחָה אֶל־מָ֣וֶת בֵּיתָ֑הּ וְאֶל־רְפָאִ֥ים מַעְגְּלֹתֶֽיהָ

“her house sinks down to death and her tracks, to the spirits of dead ones”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [involvement with her will totally destroy you]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:19 (#2)

לֹ֣א יְשׁוּבֻ֑ון

“will not return”

Here, Solomon refers to being restored to a righteous life as a **return** from the path that leads to death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will never again have a righteous life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:19 (#3)

וְלֹא־יַשִּׂיגוּ אָרְחוֹת חַיִּים

“and they will not reach the paths of life”

Solomon speaks of living in God’s way that leads to life with him as **the paths of life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will never again live happily as God desires]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:19 (#1)

בָּאֶיהָ

“those who enter her”

Here, **enter** refers to someone having sex with another person. This is a polite way of referring to something that is offensive or embarrassing in some cultures. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different polite way of referring to this act or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [those who have sex with her] or [those who sleep with her]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 2:20 (#3)

תֵּלֵךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ טוֹבִים וְאָרְחוֹת צַדִּיקִים תִּשְׁמֹר

“you shall walk in the way of the good ones and the paths of the righteous ones you shall keep”

Solomon is using a future statement to give an instruction or command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command or instruction form. Alternate translation: [walk in the way of the good ones and keep the paths of the righteous ones]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Proverbs 2:20 (#2)

תֵּלֵךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ טוֹבִים וְאָרְחוֹת צַדִּיקִים תִּשְׁמֹר

“you shall walk in the way of the good ones and the paths of the righteous ones you shall keep”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you shall walk in the way of the good ones, yes, keep the path of the righteous ones]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:20 (#4)

תֵּלֵךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ & וְאָרְחוֹת

“you shall walk in the way of & and the paths of”

Solomon is speaking of how people behave or live their lives as walking along a certain **way** or staying on certain **paths**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you shall behave like … and the behaviors of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:20 (#1)

לְמַעַן

“So”

So here indicates that what follows is the result of what was stated in 2:11–19 as being true. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [Because this is true,]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:21 (#4)

וּתְמִימִים

“and the blameless”

Here, **the blameless** refers to people who do what is right. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the people who do what is right]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:21 (#3)

יִשְׁכְּנוּ אֶרֶץ & יִוָּתְרוּ בָהּ

“will dwell {in} the land & will remain in it”

Here, **the land** and **it** could refer to: (1) the **land** of Israel, which God had given to the Jewish people and which Solomon was ruling over when he wrote these proverbs. Alternate translation: [will dwell in the land of Israel … will remain in Israel] or [will dwell in our land … will remain in our land]; (2) the earth in general,

in which case this would refer to staying alive. Alternate translation: [will dwell on the earth ... will remain alive on the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:21 (#2)

יְשָׁרִים יִשְׁכְּנוּ אָ֑רֶץ וּתְמִימִ֥ים יִוָּתְרוּ בָֽהּ

“the upright will dwell {in} the land, and the blameless will remain in it”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [the blameless, upright ones will remain to dwell in the land]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:21 (#1)

כִּ֤י

“For”

For here indicates that what follows in 2:21–22 is the reason for what was stated in 2:11–20. Use an expression for this that is natural in your language. See how you translated a similar use of **For** in 1:32. Alternate translation: [Do this, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:22 (#2)

וּרְשָׁעִ֥ים מֵאֶ֗רֶץ יִכָּרֵ֫תוּ וּבוֹגְדִ֥ים יִסְּחוּ מִמֶּנָּה

“but wicked ones will be cut off from the land, and treacherous ones will be torn away from it”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [but wicked ones will be cut off from the land, yes, all the treacherous ones will be torn away from it]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:22 (#3)

יִכָּרֵ֫תוּ & יִסְּחוּ

“will be cut off & will be torn away”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context indicates that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will cut off ... Yahweh will tear away]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 2:22 (#4)

יִכָּרֵ֫תוּ & יִסְּחוּ

“will be cut off & will be torn away”

Solomon speaks of Yahweh removing people from **the land** as if he were cutting those people off, like a person cuts a branch from a tree, or as if he were tearing those people away, like a person violently pulls someone off of something. Solomon does not state if these people are removed by being killed or by being forced to leave **the land**, so it is best to use general expressions for these phrases. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be removed ... will be taken away]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:22 (#5)

מֵאֶ֗רֶץ & מִמֶּנָּה

“from the land & from it”

See how you translated **the land** and **it** in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:22 (#1)

וּרְשָׁעִ֥ים

“but wicked ones”

Here, **but** indicates a strong contrast between the **wicked** and **treacherous** people in this verse and the “upright” and “blameless” people, who were mentioned in the previous verse. See how you translated a similar strong contrast in 1:33.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Benefits of wisdom

- Humbly trust Yahweh (3:1–12)
- The value of wisdom (3:13–20)
- Do not act wickedly (3:21–35)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My Son
Occasionally, Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to "my son" or "sons." While some of these proverbs are about common temptations of young men, the proverbs in this chapter apply more generally to people and their relationships with others.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Personification
In 3:15–18, wisdom is referred to as if it were a woman. In languages where it makes sense for a woman figure to represent an abstract concept like wisdom, the translator can translate the personification directly. However, if direct translation does not work in your language, consider translating these personifications as similes instead. In that case, wisdom would be presented as being like a wise woman. (See: Personification)

Proverbs 3:1 (#1)

בְּנִי

"My son"

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 3:1 (#5)

וּמִצְוֹתַי

"and my commandments"

See how you translated the abstract noun **commandments** in 2:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:1 (#6)

יִצֹּר לִבֶּךָ

"let your heart guard"

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:1 (#4)

תּוֹרָתִי

"my law"

Here, the word **law** is singular in form, but it refers to several laws as a group. See how you translated this use of **law** in 1:8.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 3:1 (#2)

תּוֹרָתִי אַל־תִּשְׁכָּחָ וּמִצְוֹתַי יִצֹּר לִבֶּךָ

"do not forget my law, and my commandments let your heart guard"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [do not forget my law, yes, my commandments let your heart guard]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:1 (#3)

אַל־תִּשְׁכָּחָ

"do not forget"

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning positively, as in the UST.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 3:1 (#7)

יִצֹּר לִבֶּךָ

"let your heart guard"

Here Solomon speaks of a person's **heart** as if it were a person who could **guard** something, and he speaks of **commandments** as if they were things that could be guarded. He means that he wants his son to remember these **commandments** in order to obey them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [remember to obey]

See: Personification

Proverbs 3:2 (#3)

אֹרֶךְ יָמִים

"length of days"

Here, **length of days** is an idiom that means "a long life." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language

that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a long life]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 3:2 (#6)

יוֹסִיפוּ

“they will add”

Here, the pronoun **they** refers to the law and commandments mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [my law and commandments will add]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:2 (#4)

וּשְׁנוֹת חַיִּים

“and years of life”

Here, **years of life** is an idiom that means “a long and fulfilling life.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a fulfilling life] or [and years of fulfilling life]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 3:2 (#7)

יוֹסִיפוּ לָךְ

“they will add to you”

Here Solomon speaks of his commandments as if they could **add length** to a person’s life. He means that obeying his commandments will enable a person to live a long life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [obeying them will add to you] or [by obeying them you will add to yourself]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:2 (#5)

וְשָׁלוֹם

“and peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and a peaceful life]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:2 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Remember my commandments because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:2 (#2)

אֹרֶךְ יָמִים וּשְׁנוֹת חַיִּים וְשָׁלוֹם יוֹסִיפוּ לָךְ

“length of days and years of life and peace, they will add to you”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [they will add to you length of days and years of life and peace]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 3:3 (#3)

חֶסֶד וֶאֱמֶת אַל־יַעַזְבֻךָ

“Do not let covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness leave you”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **leave**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [Retain covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness]

See: Double Negatives

Proverbs 3:3 (#7)

כָּתְבֵם עַל־לוּחַ לִבֶּךָ

“write them on the tablet of your heart”

Here Solomon speaks of the **heart** as if it were a **tablet** upon which someone could **write covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness**. He means that people should always remember to behave with **covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [keep these things in your mind] or [always remember them, as if you had written them permanently on a tablet]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:3 (#6)

כָּתְבֵם עַל־לֻוחַ לִבֶּךָ

“write them on the tablet of your heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:3 (#2)

חֶסֶד וֶאֱמֶת אַל־יַעַזְבֻךָ

“Do not let covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness leave you”

Here Solomon speaks of **covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness** as if they were people who could **leave** someone. He means that a person should not stop being faithful and trustworthy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not stop being faithful and trustworthy]

See: Personification

Proverbs 3:3 (#4)

חֶסֶד וֶאֱמֶת

“covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [being faithful and trustworthy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:3 (#5)

קְשָׁרֵם עַל־גַּרְגְּרוֹתֶיךָ

“tie them on your neck”

Here Solomon speaks of **covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness** as if they were objects that a person could **tie** around his **neck** like a necklace. He means that these are valuable qualities that people should display outwardly by their behavior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [show them outwardly by how you behave] or [display them like one would wear a necklace]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:3 (#1)

חֶסֶד וֶאֱמֶת אַל־יַעַזְבֻךָ קְשָׁרֵם עַל־גַּרְגְּרוֹתֶיךָ כָּתְבֵם עַל־לֻוחַ לִבֶּךָ

“Do not let covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness leave you; tie them on your neck, write them on the tablet of your heart”

These three clauses mean basically the same thing. The second and third clauses emphasize the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a word that shows the connection between these three clauses. Alternate translation: [Do not let covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness leave you, yes, bind them on your throats, indeed, write them on the tablet of your heart]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:4 (#2)

וּמְצָא

“and find”

The word translated **find** is an imperative, but it communicates a good result rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a good result. Alternate translation: [and then you will get]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 3:4 (#3)

וּמְצָא־חֵן וְשֵׂכֶל־טֹוב

“and find favor and good insight”

Here Solomon speaks of **favor and good insight** as if they were objects that a person could find. He means that **God and man** will show **favor** and **good insight** to the person who does what Solomon commanded in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will experience favor and good insight]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:4 (#5)

וְאָדָם

“and man”

Solomon is speaking of people in general, not of one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [and others]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 3:4 (#4)

בְּעֵינֵי

“in the eyes of”

Here, **eyes** refers to seeing, and seeing is a metaphor for knowledge, notice, attention, or judgment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:4 (#1)

וּמְצָא־חֵ֗ן

“and find favor”

Here the word **and** introduces the result of obeying the commands stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do these things, then you will find favor] or [This will result in you finding favor]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:5 (#1)

לִבֶּ֑ךָ

“your heart”

See how you translated **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:5 (#2)

וְאֶל־בִּ֝ינָתְךָ֗ אַל־תִּשָּׁעֵֽן

“and on your understanding do not lean”

Here Solomon speaks of relying on one’s own **understanding** as if **understanding** were an object on which a person could **lean**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [do not rely on your own understanding]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:5 (#3)

בִּ֝ינָתְךָ֗

“your understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:6 (#2)

וְה֣וּא יְיַשֵּׁ֑ר

“and he himself will straighten”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the commands stated in the previous verse and the beginning of this verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do these things, then he himself will straighten] or [This will result in he himself straightening]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:6 (#4)

וְה֣וּא יְיַשֵּׁ֑ר אֹרְחֹתָֽיִךְ

“and he himself will straighten your paths”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh showing people what they should do as if Yahweh were removing obstacles and smoothing out **paths** that people walk on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he himself will make clear to you what you should do] or [and he himself will guide your actions]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:6 (#1)

בְּכָל־דְּרָכֶ֗יךָ & אֹרְחֹתָֽיִךְ

“In all your ways & your paths”

Here Solomon speaks of a person’s actions as if they were **ways** or **paths** on which that person walks. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In all that you do ... how you live]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:6 (#3)

וְה֣וּא יְיַשֵּׁ֑ר

“and he himself will straighten”

For emphasis, Solomon is explicitly stating a pronoun even though the meaning **he** is already there. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **himself**. Alternate translation: [he indeed will straighten]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:7 (#1)

בְּעֵינֶ֑יךָ

“in your eyes”

Here Solomon speaks of a person’s opinion as if that person were seeing something with his **eyes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in your own opinion]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:7 (#4)

מֵרָֽע

“from evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:7 (#3)

וְסוּר מֵרָֽע

“and turn away from evil”

Here Solomon speaks of refusing to do **evil** actions as if a person were turning away **from evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and do not commit evil acts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:7 (#2)

יְרָ֣א אֶת־יְהוָ֑ה וְסוּר֥ מֵרָֽע

“fear Yahweh and turn away from evil”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. While the previous clause said what a person should not do, this clause says what that person should do instead. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Rather, fear Yahweh and turn from evil]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 3:8 (#1)

רִפְאוּת֙ תִּהְיֶ֣ה לְשָׁרֶ֔כֶד וְשִׁקּ֖וּי לְעַצְמוֹתֶֽיךָ

“It will be healing for your navel and refreshment for your bones”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [It will be healing for your navel, yes, refreshment for your bones]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:8 (#4)

וְשִׁקּ֖וּי לְעַצְמוֹתֶֽיךָ

“and refreshment for your bones”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and it will be refreshment for your bones]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 3:8 (#3)

לְשָׁרֶ֔כֶד & לְעַצְמוֹתֶֽיךָ

“for your navel & for your bones”

Solomon is using parts of a person, the **navel** and **bones**, to represent a person’s whole body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for your body ... for your whole body]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 3:8 (#2)

תִּהְיֶ֣ה

“It will be”

The pronoun **It** here refers to following the commands that Solomon stated in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Obeying these commands will be]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:8 (#5)

וְשִׁקּ֖וּי לְעַצְמוֹתֶֽיךָ

“and refreshment for your bones”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **refreshment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and will cause your bones to be refreshed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:9 (#1)

מֵהוֹנֶךָ וּמֵרֵאשִׁית כָּל־תְּבוּאָתֶךָ

“from your wealth and from the first of all your produce”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [by giving from your wealth and by giving from the first of all your produce]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 3:9 (#2)

וּמֵרֵאשִׁית

“and from the first of”

Here, **first** refers to the **first** crops that were harvested at harvest time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and from the first crops harvested of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:10 (#5)

וְתִירוֹשׁ יְקָבֶיךָ יִפְרָצוּ

“and with new wine, your wine vats will burst open”

The word **vats** refers to large containers in which the juice of grapes called **new wine** was processed into **wine**. If a very large amount of **new wine** was put in the **vat**, it could flow out and spill over the top of the **vat**. If your readers would not be familiar with **wine** or the way it is produced, you could refer to something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and your storage containers for juice will become so extremely full that they break open]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 3:10 (#3)

אֲסָמֶיךָ

“your storehouses”

The word **storehouses** refers to buildings or rooms where crops are stored after farmers have harvested them. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of storage place, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [your barns] or [your place for storing harvested crops]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 3:10 (#4)

שָׂבָע

“abundance”

Here, **abundance** refers to a plentiful amount of harvested crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a plentiful amount of harvested crops]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:10 (#2)

וְיִמָּלְאוּ אֲסָמֶיךָ שָׂבָע

“and your storehouses will be filled with abundance”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and your store houses will become abundantly full] or [and Yahweh will abundantly fill your storehouses]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 3:10 (#1)

וְיִמָּלְאוּ אֲסָמֶיךָ שָׂבָע

“and your storehouses will be filled with abundance”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do these things, then your storehouses will be filled with plenty] or [This will result in your storehouses being abundantly full]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:11 (#2)

בְּנִי

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 3:11 (#1)

מוּסַר & בְּתוֹכַחְתּוֹ

“The correction of & his rebuke”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **correction** and **rebuke**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [Being corrected by ... being rebuked by him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:12 (#3)

אֶת־בֵּ֗ן יִרְצֶֽה

“a son in whom he delights”

The phrase **in whom he delights** refers to the father’s affection for his **son**. It does not mean that the father approves of his son’s behavior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a son for whom he has great affection]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:12 (#2)

וְכְאָ֗ב אֶת־בֵּ֗ן יִרְצֶֽה

“and like a father, a son in whom he delights”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and like a father, he disciplines a son in whom he delights]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 3:12 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

For here introduces the reason for obeying the commands stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate reasons. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Do not do these things, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:12 (#4)

אֶת־בֵּ֗ן

“a son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 3:13 (#3)

מָצָ֣א חָכְמָ֑ה

“who finds wisdom”

Here Solomon speaks of attaining **wisdom** as if it were an object that a person **finds**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who attains wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:13 (#5)

חָכְמָ֑ה & תְּבוּנָֽה

“wisdom & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:13 (#2)

אָדָ֗ם & וְאָדָ֥ם

“is} a man & and a man”

In this verse, **a man** represents a person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is a person ... and a person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 3:13 (#4)

וְאָדָ֥ם יָפִ֗יק תְּבוּנָֽה

“and a man who obtains understanding”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and happy is a man who obtains understanding]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 3:13 (#1)

אַשְׁרֵ֣י אָ֭דָם מָצָ֣א חָכְמָ֑ה וְאָדָ֥ם יָפִ֗יק תְּבוּנָֽה

“Happy {is} a man who finds wisdom and a man who obtains understanding”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Happy is a man who

finds wisdom, yes, happy is a man who obtains understanding]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:14 (#2)

טֹוב סַחְרָהּ מִסְּחַר־כֶּסֶף וּמֵחָרוּץ תְּבוּאָתָהּ

“better {is} its profit than the profit of silver, and than gold, its produce”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [better {is} its profit than the profit of silver, yes, better than the produce of gold is its produce]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:14 (#4)

סַחְרָהּ & תְּבוּאָתָהּ

“is} its profit & its produce”

In this verse, **its** refers to wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is wisdom’s profit ... wisdom’s produce]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:14 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason what was stated in the previous verse is true. Use the most natural way in your language to state a reason. Alternate translation: [This is due to the fact that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:14 (#7)

וּמֵחָרוּץ תְּבוּאָתָהּ

“and than gold, its produce”

Although the word **produce** usually refers to harvested crops, Solomon uses it here to refer to a benefit in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and than gold, its benefit]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:14 (#3)

וּמֵחָרוּץ תְּבוּאָתָהּ

“and than gold, its produce”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and better than the produce of gold is its produce]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 3:14 (#6)

מִסְּחַר־כֶּסֶף

“than the profit of silver”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **profit** or wealth that one gains by having **silver**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [than the benefit one gets from having silver]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:14 (#5)

סַחְרָהּ מִסְּחַר־כֶּסֶף

“is} its profit than the profit of silver”

Although the word **profit** usually refers to money that someone earns, Solomon uses it here to refer to a benefit in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is its benefit than the benefit of silver]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:15 (#2)

יְקָרָה & מפניים

“is more precious than coral pearls”

The word translated **coral pearls** could also refer to precious stones called “rubies.” Either word refers to an item that is extremely valuable. If your readers would not be familiar with **coral pearls** or rubies, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [is more precious than valuable stones] or [is more precious than something that is extremely valuable]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 3:15 (#1)

הִ֣יא & בָּ֑הּ

“She & with her”

In 3:15–18 Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this in the Chapter Introduction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [It ... with it]

See: Personification

Proverbs 3:16 (#3)

בִּ֭ימִינָהּ בִּשְׂמֹאולָ֣הּ עֹ֑שֶׁר

“is} in her right hand; in her left hand {are} riches”

Here Solomon speaks of wise people receiving **length of days**, **riches**, and **honor** as if they were objects received from the **right** and **left** hands of wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is received by those who have wisdom; those who have wisdom receive riches]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:16 (#2)

בִּ֭ימִינָהּ בִּשְׂמֹאולָ֣הּ

“is} in her right hand; in her left hand”

In this verse, **her** refers to wisdom as if it were a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is in wisdom’s right hand; in wisdom’s left hand]

See: Personification

Proverbs 3:16 (#1)

אֹ֣רֶךְ יָ֭מִים

“Length of days”

See how you translated this idiom in 3:2.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 3:16 (#4)

וְכָב֑וֹד

“and honor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **honor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and being honored]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:17 (#3)

דְּרָכֶ֥יהָ דַרְכֵי & נֹ֑עַם וְנְתִיבוֹתֶ֖יהָ שָׁלֽוֹם

“Her ways {are} ways of & her paths {are} peace”

In this verse, **ways** and **paths** refer to how being wise guides a person’s behavior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Wise behavior is behavior of ... wise behavior brings peace]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:17 (#2)

דְּרָכֶ֥יהָ & נְתִיבוֹתֶ֖יהָ

“Her ways & her paths”

Her and **her** here refer to wisdom as if it were a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Wisdom’s ways ... wisdom’s paths]

See: Personification

Proverbs 3:17 (#4)

דַּרְכֵי־נֹ֑עַם

“are} ways of pleasantness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **ways** that result in **pleasantness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [are ways that lead to pleasantness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:17 (#1)

דְּרָכֶ֥יהָ דַרְכֵי־נֹ֑עַם וְכָל־נְתִיבוֹתֶ֖יהָ שָׁלֽוֹם

“Her ways {are} ways of pleasantness, and all her paths {are} peace”

These two phrases mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Her way of life is one of peaceful pleasantness]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:17 (#5)

שָׁלֽוֹם

“are} peace”

Here Solomon implies that **peace** is the result of following wisdom's **paths**. Use a natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [lead to being peaceful] or [result in living peacefully]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:17 (#6)

שָׁלֽוֹם

"are} peace"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another. Alternate translation: [are what is peaceful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:18 (#4)

לַמַּחֲזִיקִ֣ים בָּ֔הּ וְתֹמְכֶ֖יהָ

"to the ones who take hold of her, and those who grasp her"

Here Solomon refers to people who persist in being wise as if they **take hold of** or **grasp** wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the ones who obtain wisdom, and those who hold on to wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:18 (#3)

עֵץ־חַיִּ֥ים & לַמַּחֲזִיקִ֣ים בָּ֔הּ

"is} a tree of life to the ones who take hold of her"

Here Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a **tree** that gives **life** to those who eat its fruit. He means that wisdom causes a person to live a long and happy life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [results in a good life for the ones who take hold of her] or [is like a tree that sustains the lives of the ones who take hold of her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:18 (#2)

עֵץ־חַיִּ֥ים

"is} a tree of life"

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **tree** with fruit that sustains **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is a tree that gives life] or [is a tree with fruit that sustains life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:18 (#1)

הִ֑יא & בָּ֔הּ וְתֹמְכֶ֖יהָ

"She & of her, and those who grasp her"

She and **her** here refer to wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Wisdom ... of wisdom, and those who grasp wisdom]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:19 (#1)

יְסַד־אֶ֣רֶץ

"founded the earth"

Here Solomon speaks of **Yahweh** creating **the earth** as if he were laying the foundation of a building. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [created the earth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:19 (#2)

בְּחָכְמָ֣ה & בִּתְבוּנָ֑ה

"by wisdom & by understanding"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** in 1:2 and **understanding** in 2:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:20 (#1)

בְּדַעְתּ֔וֹ

"By his knowledge"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **knowledge**, you could express the same idea as in the UST.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:20 (#3)

נִבְקְע֣וּ

"broke open"

Here, **broke open** refers to: (1) the water from **the depths** bursting out from under the ground and coming to the surface of the earth. Alternate translation: [burst forth water onto the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:20 (#2)

תְּהוֹמֹות

“the depths”

Here, **depths** refers to bodies of water that were deep under the earth’s surface. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the underground bodies of water]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:21 (#4)

נְצֹר

“guard”

Here Solomon speaks of **prudence** and **discretion** as if they were things that could be guarded. He means that he wants his son to remember these qualities in order to practice them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [remember to practice]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:21 (#1)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 3:21 (#5)

תֻּשִׁיָּה וּמְזִמָּה

“prudence and discretion”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **prudence** and **discretion** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:21 (#3)

אַל־יָלֻזוּ מֵעֵינֶיךָ

“do not let them depart from your eyes”

Here Solomon speaks of someone not forgetting something as if he were always able to see that thing with his **eyes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [do not forget them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:21 (#2)

אַל־יָלֻזוּ מֵעֵינֶיךָ נְצֹר תֻּשִׁיָּה וּמְזִמָּה

“do not let them depart from your eyes; guard prudence and discretion”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [guard prudence and discretion, do not let them depart from your eyes]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 3:22 (#2)

וְיִהְיוּ

“and they will be”

Here, **they** refers to the “prudence” and “discretion” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and prudence and discretion will be]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:22 (#5)

וְחֵן לְגַרְגְּרֹתֶיךָ

“and grace for your neck”

Here, **grace** refers to something that looks graceful or attractive to others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and graceful ornaments for your neck]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:22 (#3)

לְנַפְשֶׁךָ

“for your soul”

See how you translated the same use of **soul** in 2:10.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 3:22 (#4)

וְיִהְיוּ חַיִּים לְנַפְשֶׁךָ

“and they will be life for your soul”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to having a full life, in both quality and length. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will allow you to have a good, long life]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 3:22 (#6)

וְחֵ֣ן לְגַרְגְּרֹתֶֽיךָ

“and grace for your neck”

Here Solomon speaks of “prudence” and “discretion” as if they were objects that a person could wear around their **neck** like a necklace. The image suggests that these are valuable things that the person displays outwardly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. See how you translated a similar expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [and be attractive to others, like a necklace around your neck]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:22 (#1)

וְיִהְיֽוּ

“and they will be”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the commands stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [and this will result in them being] or [If you do this, then they will be]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:23 (#2)

תֵּלֵ֣ךְ לָבֶ֣טַח דַּרְכֶּ֑ךָ וְרַגְלְךָ֖ לֹ֣א תִגּֽוֹף

“you will walk your way to security and your foot will not stumble”

Here Solomon speaks of living one’s life as if one were walking along a **way**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you will live your life in security and you will not do what is wrong]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:23 (#1)

אָ֣ז תֵּלֵ֣ךְ

“Then you will walk”

Then here introduces more results, stated in verses 23 and 24, of obeying the commands stated in 3:21. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. Alternate translation: [Because of having prudence and discretion, you will walk]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:23 (#3)

לָבֶ֣טַח

“to security”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **security**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [confidently]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:24 (#1)

תִּשְׁכַּ֥ב & וְשָׁכַ֑בְתָּ

“you lie down & You will lie down”

In this verse, **lie down** implies lying down in order to sleep. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:25 (#2)

וּמִשֹּׁאַ֖ת רְשָׁעִ֣ים

“and of the devastation of the wicked”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the devastation** that is related to **the wicked** in some way. This could mean: (1) the devastation that God will do to the wicked people. Alternate translation: [and of the devastation that happens to wicked people]; (2) the devastation that wicked people do to others. Alternate translation: [and of the devastation that wicked people do]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:25 (#3)

תָּבֹֽא

“it comes”

Here, **it** refers to **the devastation** mentioned earlier in the verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that devastation comes]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:25 (#1)

מִפַּ֣חַד פִּתְאֹ֑ם וּמִשֹּׁאַ֖ת

“of sudden dread and of the devastation of”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **dread** and **devastation**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation:

[of dreadful things that happen suddenly and of any terrible thing concerning]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:26 (#2)

בְּכִסְלֶֽךָ

“your confidence”

Here Solomon uses **confidence** to refer to the source of a person’s **confidence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your source of confidence]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:26 (#5)

וְשָׁמַ֣ר רַגְלְךָ֣ מִלָּֽכֶד

“and he will keep your foot from capture”

Here Solomon is referring to the “sudden dread” or “devastation” from verse 25 as being caught in a trap. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will keep you from being caught by devastation as by a trap] or [and he will keep you from harm]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:26 (#4)

וְשָׁמַ֣ר רַגְלְךָ֣ מִלָּֽכֶד

“and he will keep your foot from capture”

Here, **foot** represents the whole person. See how you translated the similar use of **foot** in 1:15.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 3:26 (#3)

בְּכִסְלֶֽךָ

“your confidence”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **confidence**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the one who makes you confident]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:26 (#1)

כִּ֤י

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the command in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not be afraid of these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:27 (#2)

מִבְּעָלָ֑יו

“from its owners”

Here Solomon speaks of the **good** that people deserve as if they were **its owners**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from those to whom it is due]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:27 (#3)

בִּֽהְיוֹת֥ לְאֵ֖ל ידיך

“when it is in the power of your hand”

Here Solomon speaks of being able to do something as if doing something were **in the power of** one’s **hand**. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when you have the ability]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 3:27 (#1)

טָ֝ט֗וֹב

“good”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **good**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [something that is good]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:28 (#2)

אֶתֵּ֣ן וְיֵ֑שׁ

“I will give {it},” and it is”

In this verse, **it** refers to the thing that the **neighbor** needs. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I will give you what you need, yet that thing is]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:28 (#3)

וְיֵ֑שׁ

“and it is”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is true at the same time as the speaker is speaking in the previous clause. This means that the person speaking refuses to give something to someone even though he has it with him. You can make this clear in your translation with an appropriate connecting word or phrase. Alternate translation: [when it is]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Proverbs 3:28 (#1)

אַל־תֹּ֭אמַר לרעיך

“Do not say to your neighbor”

Solomon implies that the **neighbor** needs something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When your neighbor needs something, do not say to your neighbor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:29 (#3)

לָ֝בֶ֗טַח

“securely”

Here, **securely** implies that this person trusts **you** and does not expect to be harmed by **you**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [trustfully]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:29 (#1)

אַל־תַּחֲרֹ֣שׁ & רָעָ֑ה

“Do not plot evil”

Here, **plot evil** implies someone plotting to do an **evil** action. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Do not scheme to do something evil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:29 (#2)

רָעָ֑ה

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:29 (#4)

אִתָּֽךְ

“with you”

Here, **with you** refers to being near someone. It does not mean necessarily that these people dwell in the same house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [nearby]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:30 (#1)

אָדָ֗ם & לֹ֤א גָמְלֽ֫וּךָ

“a man & he has not done you”

Here, **man** and **he** represent a person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a person ... that person has not done you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 3:30 (#2)

רָעָֽה

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:31 (#1)

בְּאִ֥ישׁ חָ֝מָ֗ס

“of a man of violence”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **violence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [of a violent man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:31 (#2)

בְּאִ֥ישׁ

“of a man of”

Here, **man** represents a person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [of any person of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 3:31 (#3)

דְּרָכָיו

“his ways”

Here Solomon uses **ways** to refer to the behavior of **a man of violence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the things he does]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:32 (#4)

וְאֶת־יְשָׁרִים סוֹדוֹ

“but with the upright ones {is} his secret counsel”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh giving **secret counsel** to people as if it were an object that could be **with** those people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but to the upright ones he gives his secret counsel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:32 (#5)

סוֹדוֹ

“is} his secret counsel”

The phrase **secret counsel** refers to confidential conversation between friends. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [his confidential conversation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:32 (#2)

תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה

“an abomination to Yahweh”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abomination**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [an abominable person to Yahweh]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:32 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the command in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:32 (#3)

נָלֹוז

“is} he who goes astray”

Here Solomon refers to someone who refuses to act righteously, instead deliberately doing what is wicked, as if that person **goes astray** from a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is he who acts wickedly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:33 (#3)

בְּבֵית & וּנְוֵה & יְבָרֵךְ

“is} on the house of & but he blesses the abode of”

Here, the words **house** and **abode** represent the families who live in those houses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is on the households of ... but he blesses the households of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:33 (#1)

מְאֵרַת יְהוָה

“The curse of Yahweh”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **curse** that comes from **Yahweh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The curse from Yahweh]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:33 (#2)

בְּבֵית

“is} on the house of”

Solomon speaks of the **curse of Yahweh** as if it were an object that he placed **on** top of the wicked person’s **house**. He means that Yahweh curses that **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is against the house of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:33 (#4)

רָשָׁ֑ע

“a wicked {one”

Here, **the wicked one** refers to wicked people in general, not a specific **wicked** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any wicked person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 3:34 (#1)

הֽוּא־לַלְצִ֥ים

“he himself mocks”

Here, the pronoun **himself** is added to **he** to give greater emphasis to this action of Yahweh. Use a natural way in your language for bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [he indeed mocks]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 3:34 (#2)

יִתֵּ֥ן־חֵ֗ן

“he gives favor”

The writer speaks of Yahweh favoring people as if his **favor** were an object that he gives to people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he acts favorably] or [he gives grace]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:35 (#4)

מֵרִ֣ים קָ֭לוֹן

“lift up dishonor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **dishonor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [will be dishonored] or [will be shamed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:35 (#1)

יִנְחָ֣לוּ

“will inherit”

Here Solomon speaks of wise people receiving **honor** as if **honor** were property or wealth that they could **inherit** from a family member. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will receive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:35 (#3)

מֵרִ֣ים

“lift up”

Here Solomon speaks of **stupid** people being dishonored as if their **dishonor** was lifted up for everyone to see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will receive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:35 (#2)

יִנְחָ֣לוּ & כָּ֑בוֹד

“will inherit honor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **honor**, you could express the same idea in another way. See how you translated **honor** in 3:16. Alternate translation: [will be honored] or [will be respected]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Live wisely and do what is right

- Wisdom will benefit you (4:1–9)
- Behave wisely and avoid those who do not (4:10–19)
- Live righteously (4:20–27)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My son

Occasionally, Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” This does not mean that those proverbs only apply to males. Instead, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son, and the kind of advice in these proverbs is about common temptations of young men.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Personification

In 4:6–9, Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a person, specifically, as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this issue in the book introduction.

Proverbs 4:1 (#3)

מִמָּוּסַר & בִּינָה

“the instruction of & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **instruction** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:1 (#1)

שִׁמְעוּ

“Hear”

See how you translated **Hear** in 1:8.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:1 (#4)

אָב

“a father”

Here Solomon is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first person form. Alternate translation: [me, your father]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Proverbs 4:1 (#2)

בָּנִים

“sons”

Although the term **sons** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to both male and female children. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [young people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 4:2 (#3)

תּוֹרָתִי אַל־תַּעֲזֹבוּ

“do not forsake my law”

This clause is the result of what came before in the previous clause. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [this is why you must not forsake my law]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:2 (#4)

אַל־תַּעֲזֹבוּ

“do not forsake”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:8.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 4:2 (#2)

לָכֶם

“to you”

Here, **you** is plural and refers to the “sons” referred to in the previous verse.

See: Forms of You

Proverbs 4:2 (#5)

תּוֹרָתִי

“my law”

See how you translated the collective noun **law** in 1:8.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 4:2 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Hear these instructions because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:3 (#1)

כִּי־בֵן הָיִיתִי לְאָבִי

“When I was a son of my father”

When here indicates that what follows refers to the time when Solomon was a child and still lived under his father’s care. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When I was still a boy learning from my father]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 4:3 (#4)

לִפְנֵי אִמִּי

“to the face of my mother”

Here Solomon speaks of his **mother** considering him to be **the tender and only one** as if he were **before** her **face**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to my mother] or [in my mother's estimation]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:3 (#3)

וְיָחִיד

"and only one"

Here, **only one** could mean: (1) he was his mother's only child. Alternate translation: [and only child]; (2) he was a unique child of his mother. Alternate translation: [and unique one]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 4:3 (#2)

רַךְ וְיָחִיד

"the tender and only one"

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **tender** tells what the **only one** was like. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use **and**. Alternate translation: [the tender only one]

See: Hendiadys

Proverbs 4:4 (#1)

וַיֹּרֵנִי

"then he taught me"

Here, **he** refers to Solomon's father. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:4 (#2)

לִבֶּךָ

"your heart"

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:4 (#5)

מִצְוֹתַי

"my commandments"

See how you translated the abstract noun **commandments** in 2:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:4 (#3)

יִתְמָךְ & לִבֶּךָ

"Let your heart grasp"

Here Solomon speaks of remembering **words** as if the **heart** were holding on tightly to them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let your heart remember]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:4 (#4)

דְּבָרַי

"my words"

See how you translated the similar use of **my words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:4 (#6)

וְחֵיֵה

"and live"

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [and it will result in life for you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:5 (#3)

אַל־תִּשְׁכַּח וְאַל־תֵּט מֵאִמְרֵי־פִי

"do not forget and do not veer from the sayings of my mouth"

Here Solomon speaks of not forgetting something as if a person were not veering off of a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [remember and keep obeying the sayings of my mouth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:5 (#1)

חָכְמָה & בִינָה

"wisdom & understanding"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:5 (#2)

אַל־תִּשְׁכַּ֣ח וְאַל־תֵּ֔ט מֵאִמְרֵי־פִֽי

“do not forget and do not veer from the sayings of my mouth”

Here, the phrases **do not forget** and **do not veer from** are figures of speech that express strongly positive meanings by using a negative word, **not**, together with expressions that are the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meanings. Alternate translation: [remember and keep going in the direction of the sayings of my mouth]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 4:5 (#4)

מֵאִמְרֵי־פִֽי

“from the sayings of my mouth”

Here, **mouth** represents Solomon’s father himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from my sayings]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 4:6 (#2)

וְתִשְׁמְרֶ֖ךָּ & וְתִצְּרֶֽךָּ

“and she will preserve you & and she will guard you”

Both occurrences of **and** in this verse indicate that what follows are the results of the phrases that precede them. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. Alternate translation: [and it will result in her preserving you ... and it will result in her guarding you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:6 (#1)

אַל־תַּעַזְבֶ֑הָּ

“Do not forsake her”

See how you translated **Do not forsake** in 1:8.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 4:6 (#3)

אַל־תַּעַזְבֶ֑הָּ וְתִשְׁמְרֶ֖ךָּ אֱהָבֶ֑הָּ וְתִצְּרֶֽךָּ

“Do not forsake her, and she will preserve you; love her, and she will guard you”

In 4:6–9 Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this in the Chapter Introduction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly as in the UST or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Do not forsake wisdom, and wisdom will be like a woman who preserves you; love wisdom, and wisdom will be like a woman who guards you]

See: Personification

Proverbs 4:7 (#4)

וּבְכָל־קִנְיָנֶ֖ךָ

“And with all your acquisition”

Here, **with all your acquisition** could mean: (1) “by using all of your resources” Alternate translation: [And by means of everything that you have,]; (2) “along with the other things that you acquire” Alternate translation: [And as you get other things,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 4:7 (#3)

וּבְכָל־קִנְיָנֶ֖ךָ

“And with all your acquisition”

The word **acquisition** here is singular in form, but it refers to all of a person’s possessions as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [And with all your acquisitions] or [And with everything that you acquire]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 4:7 (#2)

קְנֵ֣ה חָכְמָ֑ה & קְנֵ֥ה בִינָֽה

“Acquire wisdom & acquire understanding”

See how you translated these phrases in 4:5.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:7 (#1)

רֵאשִׁ֣ית חָ֭כְמָה

“Wisdom {is} first”

Here, **first** could refer to: (1) first in importance, the most important thing. Alternate translation: [the most

important thing is wisdom] or [wisdom is supreme]; (2) the foundation or basis of something, as it means in 1:7. Alternate translation: [the foundation of wisdom] or [the prerequisite for acquiring wisdom]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 4:8 (#2)

סַלְסְלֶהָ וּתְרוֹמְמֶךָּ

“Cherish her, and she will raise you up”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [If you cherish her, then she will raise you up] or [Cherish her, and it will result in her raising you up]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:8 (#3)

וּתְרוֹמְמֶךָּ

“and she will raise you up”

Here Solomon speaks of a wise person receiving honor as if wisdom were raising that person **up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she will cause you to be honored]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:8 (#4)

תְּכַבֶּדְךָּ

“she will honor you”

Here Solomon speaks of a wise person receiving honor as if wisdom were honoring that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wisdom will cause people to honor you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:8 (#5)

תְּחַבְּקֶנָּה

“you embrace her”

Here Solomon speaks of someone valuing wisdom as if he were embracing a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you value wisdom]

See: Personification

Proverbs 4:8 (#1)

סַלְסְלֶהָ וּתְרוֹמְמֶךָּ תְּכַבֶּדְךָּ כִּי תְחַבְּקֶנָּה

“Cherish her, and she will raise you up; she will honor you when you embrace her”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this in the Chapter Introduction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Wisdom is like a woman who raises you up when you cherish her; wisdom is like a woman who honors you when you embrace her]

See: Personification

Proverbs 4:9 (#3)

לִוְיַת־חֵן

“a garland of grace”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:9.

See: Possession

Proverbs 4:9 (#1)

תִּתֵּתֶן לְרֹאשֶׁךָ לִוְיַת־חֵן עֲטֶרֶת תִּפְאֶרֶת תְּמַגְּנֶךָּ

“She will give for your head a garland of grace; {with} a crown of splendor she will cover you”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [She will give for your head a garland of grace; yes, with a crown of splendor she will cover you]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:9 (#4)

עֲטֶרֶת תִּפְאֶרֶת תְּמַגְּנֶךָּ

“with} a crown of splendor she will cover you”

Here Solomon speaks of the honor that a person will have from gaining wisdom as if wisdom placed a **crown** upon that person’s head. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [wisdom will cause people to honor you] or [wisdom will be like someone who puts a crown of splendor on your head]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:9 (#5)

עֲטֶ֣רֶת תִּפְאֶ֔רֶת

“with} a crown of splendor”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **crown** that is characterized by **splendor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [with a splendorous crown]

See: Possession

Proverbs 4:9 (#2)

תִּתֵּ֣ן לְרֹאשְׁךָ֣ לִוְיַת־חֵ֑ן עֲטֶ֥רֶת תִּפְאֶ֖רֶת תְּמַגְּנֶֽךָּ

“She will give for your head a garland of grace; {with} a crown of splendor she will cover you”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this in the Chapter Introduction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Wisdom will be like a woman who gives a garland of grace for your head; wisdom will be like a woman who covers you with a crown of splendor]

See: Personification

Proverbs 4:10 (#1)

שְׁמַ֣ע

“Hear”

See how you translated the same use of **Hear** in 1:8.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:10 (#2)

בְּנִ֣י

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 4:10 (#4)

וְיִרְבּ֖וּ לְךָ֣ שְׁנ֣וֹת חַיִּֽים

“and they will multiply for you the years of life”

Here Solomon speaks of his **sayings** as if they were able to cause someone to live longer. He means that someone who obeys his **sayings** will live longer than if they did not do so. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and obeying my sayings will multiply for you the years of life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:10 (#5)

שְׁנ֣וֹת חַיִּֽים

“the years of life”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **years** that a person lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the years that you are alive]

See: Possession

Proverbs 4:10 (#3)

וְיִרְבּ֖וּ

“and they will multiply”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the commands stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do this, then they will multiply] or [The result will be that they will multiply]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:11 (#2)

בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ חָכְמָ֣ה

“In the way of wisdom”

Here, **the way** refers to how people behave or live their lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In wise behavior,] or [How to behave wisely,]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:11 (#3)

הִ֭וֹרַתִּיךָ בְּמַעְגְּלֵי־יֹ֑שֶׁר

“I caused you to tread in the tracks of uprightness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **tracks** that are characterized by **uprightness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [I caused you to tread in the upright tracks]

See: Possession

Proverbs 4:11 (#4)

הִ֭וֹרַתִּיךָ בְּמַעְגְּלֵי־יֹ֑שֶׁר

“I caused you to tread in the tracks of uprightness”

Here Solomon refers to how people behave or live their lives as if they **tread in the tracks** of a certain path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I caused you to behave uprightly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:11 (#1)

בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ חָכְמָ֑ה

“In the way of wisdom”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **way** that is characterized by **wisdom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [In the wise way]

See: Possession

Proverbs 4:12 (#2)

בְּלֶכְתֶּ֥ךָ לֹא־יֵצַ֖ר צַעֲדֶ֑ךָ וְאִם־תָּ֝רֹ֗וץ לֹ֣א תִכָּשֵֽׁל

“In your walking, your step will not be restricted; and if you run, you will not stumble”

In this verse, Solomon refers to what people do as if they were walking or running along paths, and he refers to their success in what they do as if the paths were free of obstacles that might make the person **stumble**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When you do something, you will not be hindered; and if you attempt big things, you will not fail]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:12 (#1)

בְּלֶכְתֶּ֥ךָ לֹא־יֵצַ֖ר צַעֲדֶ֑ךָ וְאִם־תָּ֝רֹ֗וץ לֹ֣א תִכָּשֵֽׁל

“In your walking, your step will not be restricted; and if you run, you will not stumble”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [When you walk, your step will not be restricted; yes, if you run, you will not stumble]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:12 (#3)

לֹא־יֵצַ֖ר & לֹ֣א תִכָּשֵֽׁל

“will not be restricted & you will not stumble”

Solomon is using a figure of speech in these two phrases that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will be free ... you will keep going]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 4:13 (#3)

אַל־תֶּ֝֗רֶף

“do not let go”

Solomon is using a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative idea **let go**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [keep holding on]

See: Double Negatives

Proverbs 4:13 (#4)

נִ֝צְרֶ֗הָ

“guard it”

Here Solomon speaks of **instruction** as if it were an object that someone should **guard**. He means that he wants his son to remember to do what he has taught him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of **guard** in 3:21. Alternate translation: [remember to practice it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:13 (#1)

הַחֲזֵ֣ק בַּמּוּסָ֑ר אַל־תֶּ֝֗רֶף

“Grasp on to instruction, do not let go”

Here Solomon speaks of a person remembering **instruction** as if it were an object that the person could **grasp** and **not let go**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated **grasp** in 3:18. Alternate translation: [Keep on remembering instruction; do not forget it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:13 (#5)

הִהָיא חַיֶּיךָ

“it {is} your life”

Here Solomon speaks of **instruction** preserving a person’s **life** as if instruction were that person’s **life** itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it will preserve your life]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:13 (#2)

בַּמּוּסָ֑ר

“to instruction”

See how you translated the abstract noun **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:14 (#1)

בְּאֹ֣רַח רְ֭שָׁעִים אַל־תָּבֹ֑א וְאַל־תְּ֝תְאַשַּׁ֗ר בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ רָעִֽים

“On the path of wicked ones do not go, and do not advance on the way of evil ones”

These two phrases mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Do not follow the ways of wicked, evil people]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:14 (#2)

בְּאֹ֣רַח & בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ

“On the path of & on the way of”

See how you translated the similar use of “paths” and “ways” in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:15 (#1)

פְּרָעֵ֣הוּ & בּ֑וֹ & מֵ֝עָלָ֗יו

“Avoid it & it & from it”

In this verse, the pronoun **it** refers to “the way of evil ones” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Avoid the way of evil ones … that way … from that evil way]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:15 (#2)

פְּרָעֵ֣הוּ אַל־תַּעֲבָר־בּ֑וֹ שְׁטֵ֥ה מֵ֝עָלָ֗יו וַעֲבֹֽר

“Avoid it, do not pass through it; veer from it and pass on”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of behaving wickedly as if wicked behavior were a path that people could **pass through**, **veer from**, and **pass on**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Avoid acting evilly; do not try it; completely avoid doing evil and do not even think about it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:16 (#2)

לֹ֤א יָ֭שְׁנוּ אִם־לֹ֣א יָרֵ֑עוּ וְנִגְזְלָ֥ה שְׁ֝נָתָ֗ם אִם־לֹ֣א יכשולו

“they do not sleep if they do not do evil and their sleep is robbed if they do not cause stumbling”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [they do not sleep if they do not do evil. Indeed, their sleep is robbed if they do not cause stumbling]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:16 (#6)

וְנִגְזְלָ֥ה שְׁ֝נָתָ֗ם

“and their sleep is robbed”

If your language does not use a passive form like **is robbed**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and they are not able to sleep]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 4:16 (#3)

לֹ֤א יָ֭שְׁנוּ אִם־לֹ֣א יָרֵ֑עוּ וְנִגְזְלָ֥ה שְׁ֝נָתָ֗ם אִם־לֹ֣א יכשולו

“they do not sleep if they do not do evil and their sleep is robbed if they do not cause stumbling”

In this verse, the pronoun **they** refers to the wicked people mentioned in 4:14. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [wicked ones do not sleep if they do not do evil, and the sleep of wicked ones is robbed if those wicked ones do not cause stumbling]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:16 (#4)

לֹ֣א יָ֭שְׁנוּ אִם־לֹ֣א יָרֵ֑עוּ וְנִגְזָ֥לָה שְׁ֝נָתָ֗ם אִם־לֹ֣א יכשולו

“they do not sleep if they do not do evil and their sleep is robbed if they do not cause stumbling”

In these two clauses, Solomon exaggerates to express how intensely these wicked people desire to do evil actions. Solomon did not literally mean that these people could not **sleep** if they had not done **evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [they desire to do evil so much that it is as if they would not be able to sleep unless they did evil]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 4:16 (#5)

וְנִגְזָ֥לָה שְׁ֝נָתָ֗ם

“and their sleep is robbed”

Here Solomon is speaking of not being able to **sleep** as if **sleep** were an object that someone could rob from someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they are not able to sleep]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:16 (#7)

אִם־לֹ֣א יכשולו

“if they do not cause stumbling”

Here Solomon speaks of causing harm to another person as if it were causing that person to **stumble**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if they do not harm someone]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:16 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows are reasons why someone should avoid doing **evil**, as stated in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Avoid acting wickedly because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:17 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows are more reasons why someone should avoid doing evil, as commanded in 4:15. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Avoid being one who acts wickedly, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:17 (#2)

לָ֭חֲמוּ & יִשְׁתּוּ

“they eat & they drink”

In this verse, the pronoun **they** refers to the wicked people mentioned in 4:14. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [wicked ones eat ... wicked ones drink]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:17 (#3)

לָ֭חֲמוּ לֶ֣חֶם רֶ֑שַׁע וְיֵ֖ין חֲמָסִ֣ים יִשְׁתּוּ

“they eat the bread of wickedness and the wine of violent {acts}, they drink”

These two clauses could mean: (1) these wicked people do acts of **wickedness** and **violence** as regularly as they **eat bread** and **drink wine**. Alternate translation: [wickedness is like the bread that they eat and violence is like the wine that they drink] or (2) these wicked people do acts of **wickedness** and **violence** in order to get their **bread** and **wine**. Alternate translation: [they eat bread that they obtain by doing wicked things and they drink wine that they obtain through violent acts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:18 (#2)

כְּאוֹר֮ נֹגַ֪הּ

“is} like the light of brightness”

Here, **the light of brightness** could refer to the first sunlight that appears in the morning. In this case, it would contrast with the full light when **the day {is} established**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is like the light of dawn] or [is like the first sunlight in the morning]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 4:18 (#5)

הוֹלֵ֣ךְ וְאָא֑וֹר עַד־נָכֹ֖ון הַיּֽוֹם

“going and shining until the day {is} established”

Here Solomon continues the comparison of **the path of the righteous ones** to **the light** of the sun. Just like the sunlight shines increasingly brighter from sunrise until the middle of the day, so also **the righteous ones** increase in wisdom and safety as they understand more and more of how God wants them to live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the path of the righteous leading to more and more wisdom and safety just as the path of the sun leads to more and more light until midday]

See: Simile

Proverbs 4:18 (#1)

וְאֹרַ֣ח צַדִּיקִ֑ים

“But the path of the righteous ones”

Here, **the path** could refer to: (1) the things that people experience during their lives. Alternate translation: [But what the righteous ones experience]; (2) how people behave, as it does in 1:15. Alternate translation: [But the lifestyle of the righteous ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:18 (#3)

כְּאֹ֣ור נֹגַ֑הּ

“is} like the light of brightness”

Here Solomon compares **the path of the righteous ones** to **the light** of the sun in the morning. He means that **righteous** people are safe because they understand what God wants them to do during their lives, just like people can walk safely on a path because **the light** enables them to see where they are going. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is safe]

See: Simile

Proverbs 4:18 (#4)

הוֹלֵ֣ךְ וְאָא֑וֹר עַד־נָכֹ֖ון הַיּֽוֹם

“going and shining until the day {is} established”

The phrase **the day is established** refers to the time of **day** when the sun shines the brightest. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [going and shining until the sun shines the brightest] or [going and shining brighter until full daylight]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:19 (#3)

לֹ֣א יָ֭דְעוּ בַּמֶּ֣ה יִכָּשֵׁלוּ

“they do not know on what they stumble”

Here Solomon speaks of people experiencing harm as if they were stumbling over an object in the path on which they were walking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they do not know why they experience harm]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:19 (#1)

דֶּ֣רֶךְ

“The way of”

Here, **way** has the same meaning as “path” in the previous verse. See how you translated “path” there.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:19 (#2)

כַּאֲפֵלָ֑ה

“is} like the darkness”

Here Solomon compares the **way of the wicked** to **darkness**. He means that the wicked people are always in danger, just like people who walk in darkness are in danger because they cannot see where they are going. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is dangerous]

See: Simile

Proverbs 4:20 (#1)

בְּנִ֑י

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 4:20 (#3)

לְדְבָרַ֥י

“to my words”

See how you translated **my words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:20 (#4)

הַט־אָזְנְךָ

“incline your ear”

The phrase **incline your ear** is an idiom that refers to listening carefully to what someone is saying as if the listener was turning his **ear** toward the person speaking. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [listen well]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:20 (#2)

לְדְבָרַי הַקְשִׁיבָה לַאֲמָרַי הַט־אָזְנְךָ

“listen attentively to my words; incline your ear to my sayings”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [listen attentively to my words, yes, incline your ear to my sayings]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:21 (#3)

שָׁשְׁמְרֵם בְּתוֹךְ לִבֶּךָ

“keep them in the midst of your heart”

Here Solomon speaks of remembering something as if someone were keeping it **in the midst of** his **heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [always remember them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:21 (#2)

שָׁשְׁמְרֵם בְּתוֹךְ לִבֶּךָ

“keep them in the midst of your heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:21 (#1)

אַל־יַלְּיזוּ מֵעֵינֶיךָ

“Do not let them depart from your eyes”

See how you translated this clause in 3:21.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:22 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows are more reasons why someone should pay attention to the father’s words, as stated in 4:20–21. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Pay attention to my words, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:22 (#2)

הֵם לִמְצֹאֵיהֶם

“they & to those who find them”

In this verse, the pronouns **they** and **them** refer to the “sayings” mentioned in 4:20. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [my sayings ... to those who find my sayings]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:22 (#6)

בְּשָׂרָו

“his flesh”

Although **his** is singular, here it refers to all who remember Solomon’s sayings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [their flesh]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 4:22 (#7)

וּלְכָל־בְּשָׂרָו מַרְפֵּא

“and healing to all of his flesh”

Here Solomon speaks of his sayings as if they were **healing** for those who remember them. He means that those who remember what he says will have healthy bodies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate transla-

tion: [and they preserve their health] or [and they cause their bodies to stay healthy]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:22 (#5)

וּלְכָל־בְּשָׂרָו מַרְפֵּא

“and healing to all of his flesh”

Here Solomon uses the word **flesh** to refer to a person’s whole body, which is made of flesh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and healing to all of his body]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 4:22 (#3)

חַיִּים הֵם לְמֹצְאֵיהֶם

“they {are} life to those who find them”

Here Solomon speaks of his sayings as if they were **life** for those who obey them. He means that those who do what he says will have good lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they allow those who find them to have good lives] or [they cause those who find them to live well]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:22 (#4)

לְמֹצְאֵיהֶם

“to those who find them”

Here Solomon speaks of people remembering his sayings as if those people have found them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to those who remember them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:23 (#1)

נְצֹר לִבֶּךָ

“Guard your heart”

Here Solomon refers to the **heart** as the container of a person’s thoughts and desires, and speaks of it as though it were an object that could be guarded. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Guard your mind] or [Guard your liver] or [Guard your thinking]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:23 (#2)

לִבֶּךָ

“your heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:23 (#5)

מִמֶּנּוּ

“from it”

Here, **it** refers to the **heart**, which refers to a person’s mind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from your heart] or [from your mind]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:23 (#6)

מִמֶּנּוּ תּוֹצְאוֹת חַיִּים

“from it {are} the sources of life”

Here Solomon speaks of the influence that a person’s **heart** has over what happens in that person’s life as if the **heart** supplied **sources** that produce **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from your heart comes what will direct your life] or [your thinking determines what your life will be like]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:23 (#3)

מִכָּל־מִשְׁמָר

“more than all {that} is protected”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [more than all that you protect]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 4:23 (#4)

מִכָּל־מִשְׁמָר

“more than all {that} is protected”

This phrase is an idiom that means “with all diligence.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your

language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with utmost diligence]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:24 (#1)

הָסֵר מִמְּךָ עִקְּשׁוּת פֶּה וּלְזוּת שְׂפָתַיִם הַרְחֵק מִמֶּךָּ

“Remove from you perversity of mouth, and the deviousness of lips put far away from you”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Remove from you perversity of mouth, yes, the deviousness of lips put far away from you]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:24 (#2)

הָסֵר מִמְּךָ עִקְּשׁוּת פֶּה וּלְזוּת שְׂפָתַיִם הַרְחֵק מִמֶּךָּ

“Remove from you perversity of mouth, and the deviousness of lips put far away from you”

The phrases **perversity of mouth** and **deviousness of lips** both refer to someone using his **mouth** or **lips** to speak deceitfully. If these phrases do not have that meaning in your language, you could use idioms from your language that do have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Remove from you perverse speech, and devious speech put far away from you]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:24 (#3)

הָסֵר מִמְּךָ עִקְּשׁוּת פֶּה וּלְזוּת שְׂפָתַיִם הַרְחֵק מִמֶּךָּ

“Remove from you perversity of mouth, and the deviousness of lips put far away from you”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **perversity of mouth** and **the deviousness of lips** as if they were objects that someone could **Remove** or **put far away**. He means that a person should not speak deceitfully. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not speak perversely and do not speak deviously]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:25 (#3)

עֵינֶיךָ לְנֹכַח יַבִּיטוּ וְעַפְעַפֶּיךָ יְיַשְּׁרוּ נֶגְדֶּךָ

“Cause your eyes to gaze to the front, and cause your eyelids to be straight in front of you”

In these two clauses, Solomon speaks of committing oneself to behaving wisely and righteously as if those qualities were always **in front** of the person, and perverse or devious behavior is to the right or left. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Keep your attention on doing what is right, and keep looking straight ahead to doing what is good]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:25 (#2)

עֵינֶיךָ לְנֹכַח יַבִּיטוּ וְעַפְעַפֶּיךָ יְיַשְּׁרוּ נֶגְדֶּךָ

“Cause your eyes to gaze to the front, and cause your eyelids to be straight in front of you”

In this verse, **eyes** and **eyelids** represent the person who is looking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Cause yourself to gaze to the front, and cause yourself to look straight in front of you]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 4:25 (#1)

עֵינֶיךָ לְנֹכַח יַבִּיטוּ וְעַפְעַפֶּיךָ יְיַשְּׁרוּ נֶגְדֶּךָ

“Cause your eyes to gaze to the front, and cause your eyelids to be straight in front of you”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Cause your eyes to gaze to the front, yes, cause your eyelids to be straight in front of you]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:26 (#1)

פַּלֵּס מַעְגַּל רַגְלֶךָ

“Make level the track of your foot”

Here Solomon speaks of being careful how one lives as if someone were making the ground in front of them flat for walking on it. See how you translated the same use of **track** in 2:9. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Be careful how you live] or [Take heed to what you are doing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:26 (#4)

דְּרָכֶ֑יךָ

“your ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:26 (#5)

יִכֹּנוּ

“will be firm”

Here Solomon speaks of person’s life being successful as if that person were walking safely on solid ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be successful]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:26 (#2)

מַעְגַּ֣ל רַגְלֶ֔ךָ

“the track of your foot”

Here, the word **foot** represents the whole person who is walking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your track]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 4:26 (#3)

וְכָל

“and all”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do this, then all] or [The result will be that all]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:27 (#2)

אַל־תֵּט־יָמִ֥ין וּשְׂמֹאול֮ הָסֵ֪ר רַגְלְךָ֫ מֵרָ֥ע

“Do not veer right or left; cause your foot to turn away from evil”

In this verse, Solomon continues to talk about how a person behaves as though the person is walking on a path. On this path of right living, the person should “gaze to the front” (verse 25), make the track “level” (verse 26), and not **veer** or **turn away** from it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not stop behaving rightly; make yourself avoid doing evil]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

Proverbs 4:27 (#4)

מֵרָ֥ע

“from evil”

See how you translated **from evil** in 3:7.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:27 (#1)

אַל־תֵּט־יָמִ֥ין וּשְׂמֹאול֮

“Do not veer right or left”

Here Solomon uses **right** and **left** to refer to going in any direction other than straight ahead. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not go in any direction other than straight ahead]

See: Merism

Proverbs 4:27 (#3)

רַגְלְךָ֫

“your foot”

See how you translated the same use of **foot** in the previous verse.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Avoid temptation to commit adultery (5:1–23)

- The dangers of adultery (5:1–14)
- The joys of marital fidelity (5:15–20)
- Yahweh’s ways are better (5:21–23)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My son

Occasionally, Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” This does not mean that those

proverbs only apply to males. Instead, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son, and the kind of advice in these proverbs is about common temptations of young men.

Adulterous women
This chapter repeatedly warns young men to avoid any adulterous woman, whom Solomon calls "strange" and "foreign." (See: adultery, adulterous, adulterer, adulteress)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Euphemism
In 5:15–20, Solomon uses several euphemisms to refer to sexual activity between a man and his wife or an adulterous woman. Although the UST expresses the meaning of these euphemisms plainly, only do so if sexual language would not be offensive in your culture. It is usually best to use a euphemism from your own language that means the same thing.

Proverbs 5:1 (#4)

הַט־אָזְנְךָ

"incline your ear"

See how you translated this idiom in 4:20.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 5:1 (#2)

לְחָכְמָתִי & לִתְבוּנָתִי

"to my wisdom & to my understanding"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 5:1 (#3)

לְחָכְמָתִי & לִתְבוּנָתִי

"to my wisdom & to my understanding"

Here, **my wisdom** and **my understanding** refer to the wise lessons that Solomon teaches his **son** and what he tells his **son** to understand. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to my wise lessons ... to what I tell you to understand]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:1 (#1)

לְחָכְמָתִי הַקְשִׁיבָה לִתְבוּנָתִי הַט־אָזְנְךָ

"listen attentively to my wisdom; incline your ear to my understanding"

These two phrases mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [listen attentively to my wisdom; apply yourself to learn what I understand]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:2 (#4)

וְדַעַת

"and & knowledge"

Here, **knowledge** refers to what the son has learned from his father. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and ... what you have learned]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:2 (#2)

מְזִמּוֹת

"discretion"

See how you translated the abstract noun **discretion** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 5:2 (#3)

וְדַעַת שְׂפָתֶיךָ יִנְצֹרוּ

"and your lips may guard knowledge"

Here, **lips** represents the person who speaks by moving his **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you may guard knowledge by what you say]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 5:2 (#1)

לִשְׁמֹר מְזִמּוֹת וְדַעַת שְׂפָתֶיךָ יִנְצֹרוּ

"in order to keep discretion, and your lips may guard knowledge"

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **discretion** as if it were an object that someone should **keep**, and he speaks of **knowledge** as if it were an object that someone's **lips** should **guard**. He means that he wants his son to be wise in his choices and in the things that he says. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in order to keep making good choices and speaking with knowledge]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:3 (#2)

נֹ֭פֶת תִּתְּפֹ֣נָה שִׂפְתֵ֣י זָרָ֑ה

“the lips of a strange woman drip fresh honey”

Here, **lips** represent the words that the **strange woman** speaks, and they are compared to **fresh honey**. This means that what the strange woman says is sweet and appealing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the words that a strange woman says seem sweet and appealing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:3 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason why someone should obey the commands introduced in 5:1. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do what I say, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 5:3 (#3)

זָרָ֑ה

“a strange woman”

See how you translated **strange woman** in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:3 (#4)

וְחָלָ֖ק מִשֶּׁ֣מֶן חִכָּֽהּ

“and smoother than oil {is} her palate”

Here Solomon represents the tempting words that the **strange woman** speaks as **her palate** and he compares them to smooth **oil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and are pleasant and persuasive] or [and are as persuasive as olive oil is smooth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:4 (#5)

חַ֭דָּ֣ה כְּחֶרֶב֮ פִּיּוֹת֒

“sharp as a sword of mouths”

The phrase **sword of mouths** refers to a **sword** with a blade that is sharpened on both sides. Each side can cut a person like a mouth that bites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [sharp like a sword with a blade that is sharpened on both sides]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:4 (#4)

חַ֭דָּ֣ה כְּחֶרֶב֮ פִּיּוֹת֒

“sharp as a sword of mouths”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [her aftermath is sharp like a sword of mouths]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:4 (#1)

וְ֝אַחֲרִיתָ֗הּ

“but her aftermath”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **aftermath**, or result, of having a sexual relationship with an adulterous woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the outcome of having a sexual relationship with her]

See: Possession

Proverbs 5:4 (#3)

מָ֭רָה כַּלַּעֲנָ֑ה

“is} bitter as wormwood”

Here Solomon compares the disgust that comes after having a relationship with an adulterous woman to tasting bitter **wormwood**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [is disgusting like bitter-tasting wormwood]

See: Simile

Proverbs 5:4 (#6)

חַ֭דָּ֣ה כְּחֶרֶב֮ פִּיּוֹת֒

“sharp as a sword of mouths”

Here Solomon speaks of the pain that the adulteress will cause to the one who has a relationship with her as if it were a **sharp sword** that cuts the person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it wounds a person, as if it were a sharp sword of mouths]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:4 (#2)

כָּלַ֥עֲנָֽה

“as wormwood”

The word **wormwood** refers to a plant that tastes bitter. People made medicine out of it, but they also believed that it was poisonous in some amounts. If your readers would not be familiar with this plant, you could use the name of a bitter-tasting plant in your area, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [like a bitter-tasting plant]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 5:5 (#2)

רַגְלֶ֣יהָ יֹרְדָ֣ות מָ֭וֶת שְׁאֹ֣ול צְעָדֶ֑יהָ יִתְמֹֽכוּ

“Her feet are going down {to} death; her steps take hold of Sheol”

Here Solomon speaks of the behavior of the adulterous woman as **her feet** and **her steps**. He speaks of this behavior causing her death and the death of whoever commits adultery with her as if they were walking on a path that leads **down to death** or to **Sheol**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Her lifestyle ends in death; her way of living takes a person straight to Sheol] or [Her behavior results in death; by doing what she does, she will end up dead]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:5 (#1)

רַגְלֶ֣יהָ יֹרְדָ֣ות מָ֭וֶת שְׁאֹ֣ול צְעָדֶ֑יהָ יִתְמֹֽכוּ

“Her feet are going down {to} death; her steps take hold of Sheol”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Her feet are going down to death; yes, her steps take hold of Sheol]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:6 (#2)

אֹ֣רַח חַ֭יִּים פֶּן־תְּפַלָּ֑ס

“lest she observe the path of life”

Here Solomon speaks of behavior that results in living a good **life** as if it were a **path** that leads to **life** and can be observed. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Lest she care about behavior that leads to life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:6 (#3)

מַ֝עְגְּלֹתֶ֗יהָ

“her tracks”

See how you translated the same use of **tracks** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:6 (#1)

אֹ֣רַח חַ֭יִּים פֶּן־תְּפַלָּ֑ס

“lest she observe the path of life”

Lest here implies that the adulterous woman has an aversion to **the path of life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She refuses to observe the path of life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:7 (#2)

וְעַתָּ֣ה בָנִ֣ים שִׁמְעוּ־לִ֑י וְאַל־תָּ֝סֻ֗רוּ מֵאִמְרֵי־פִֽי

“And now, sons, listen to me; and do not turn away from the sayings of my mouth”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And now, sons, listen to me; yes, do not turn aside from the sayings of my mouth]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:7 (#5)

וְאַל־תָּ֝סֻ֗רוּ מֵאִמְרֵי־פִֽי

“and do not turn away from the sayings of my mouth”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [and listen to the sayings of my mouth]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 5:7 (#6)

מֵאִמְרֵי־פִֽי

“from the sayings of my mouth”

See how you translated **the sayings of my mouth** in 4:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 5:7 (#4)

וְאַל־תָּ֝סֻ֗רוּ מֵאִמְרֵי־פִֽי

“and do not turn away from the sayings of my mouth”

Here Solomon speaks of someone not listening to someone else as if the person physically turned **away** from what he was saying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [do not stop listening to the sayings of my mouth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:7 (#3)

בָּנִ֑ים

“sons”

See how you translated the same use of **sons** in 4:1.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 5:7 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֥ה

“And now”

And now here indicates a transition from the description of the adulterous woman in 5:3–6 to the call to pay attention, which follows. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a transition. Alternate translation: [Next]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 5:8 (#2)

מַעָ֭לֶיהָ & בֵּיתָֽהּ

“from her & her house”

In this verse, **her** refers to the adulterous woman described in 5:3–6. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from an adulteress ... the house of an adulteress]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 5:8 (#1)

הַרְחֵ֣ק מֵעָ֭לֶיהָ דַּרְכֶּ֑ךָ

“Keep your way far from her”

Here, **way** represents the person and the person’s daily activities. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Keep yourself far away from her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:8 (#3)

וְאַל־תִּ֝קְרַ֗ב

“and do not come near”

In a context such as this, your language might say “go” instead of **come**. Alternate translation: [and do not go near]

See: Go and Come

Proverbs 5:9 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

The word **lest** here indicates that what follows in this verse is what would happen to young men if they did not obey the commands given in the previous verse. Use a natural form in your language for connecting this statement to the previous one. Alternate translation, beginning a new sentence: [If you fail to obey this, then]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 5:9 (#4)

וּ֝שְׁנֹתֶ֗יךָ

“and your years”

Here, **your years** could refer to: (1) everything that a person achieves during the time in a person's life when he is his healthiest and strongest. Alternate translation: [and all you have achieved in the best years of your life]; (2) the **years** that a person is alive, meaning that **a cruel one** would kill this person. Alternate translation: [and your life]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 5:9 (#3)

וּשְׁנֹתֶ֑יךָ

"and your years"

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and lest you give your years]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:9 (#2)

תִּתֵּ֣ן לַאֲחֵרִ֣ים הוֹדֶ֑ךָ

"you give to others your splendor"

Here, **splendor** could refer to: (1) everything that a person achieves during the time in a person's life when he is the strongest, which would be the same meaning as **your years** in the next clause. This includes the offspring that he is giving up to the adulteress and her husband. Alternate translation: [you give to others your vigor] or [you give to others your achievements from your vigorous time of life]; (2) a person's reputation, in which case this clause would refer to a person getting a bad reputation. Alternate translation: [you will lose your good reputation with others]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:9 (#5)

לְאַכְזָרִ֑י

"to a cruel one"

Here, **a cruel one** could refer to: (1) one person, possibly the husband of the adulterous woman. Alternate translation: [a cruel person] or [a cruel man]; (2) a group of **cruel** people who are called **others** in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [to cruel people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:10 (#1)

פֶּן־יִשְׂבְּעוּ֣ זָרִ֣ים

"lest strangers be satisfied"

The word **lest** here indicates that what follows in this verse are more things that will happen to young men if they do not obey the commands in 5:8. Use a natural form in your language to connect this statement to the previous one. Alternate translation: [yes, if you fail to obey my teaching, strangers will be satisfied]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 5:10 (#5)

וַֽעֲצָבֶ֗יךָ בְּבֵ֣ית

"and your toils in the house of"

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and your toils be in the house of]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:10 (#6)

נָכְרִֽי

"a foreigner"

Here, **a foreigner** refers to anyone outside of the young man's family. It refers to the same kind of people as **strangers** earlier in the verse and "others" in verse 9. This probably refers to the family of the adulterous woman, who will benefit from the young man's **strength** and **toils**. Alternate translation: [those who are not your family]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:10 (#2)

יִשְׂבְּעוּ֣

"be satisfied"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language, as in the UST.

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 5:10 (#4)

וַֽעֲצָבֶ֗יךָ

"and your toils"

Here, **your toils** refers to everything that a person earns by working hard. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what you gain from toiling]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 5:10 (#3)

כֹּחֶךָ

“with your strength”

Here, **your strength** refers to everything that a person achieves during the time in a person’s life when he has the most **strength**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with what you achieved when you were strong]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 5:11 (#2)

וְנָהַמְתָּ

“and you groan”

This verse continues the meaning of the word **lest** in 5:10. What follows in this verse are more things that will happen to young men if they do not obey the commands in 5:8. Use a natural form in your language to connect this statement to the previous one. Alternate translation: [and furthermore, if you fail to obey my teaching, you will groan]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 5:11 (#1)

בְּאַחֲרִיתֶךָ בִּכְלוֹת בְּשָׂרְךָ וּשְׁאֵרֶךָ

“at your end, when your flesh and your body are finished”

Here Solomon is referring to dying in a polite way by using the word **end** and the phrase **your body and your flesh are finished**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to death in your language, or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the time of your death, when your flesh and your body die]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 5:11 (#3)

בְּשָׂרְךָ וּשְׁאֵרֶךָ

“your flesh and your body”

The words **flesh** and **body** mean basically the same thing and represent the whole person. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [you yourself]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 5:12 (#4)

לִבִּי

“my heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 5:12 (#1)

שָׂנֵאתִי מוּסָר וְתוֹכַחַת נָאַץ לִבִּי

“I hated correction, and my heart despised rebuke”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I hated correction, yes, my heart despised rebuke]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:12 (#2)

אֵיךְ שָׂנֵאתִי מוּסָר

“How I hated correction”

“How” here is an exclamation that emphasizes how much he **hated correction**. Use an exclamation that would communicate that meaning in your language. Alternate translation: [I hated correction so very much]

See: Exclamations

Proverbs 5:12 (#3)

מוּסָר וְתוֹכַחַת

“correction, and & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **correction** and **rebuke** in 3:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 5:13 (#3)

לֹא־הִטֵּיתִי אָזְנִי

“I did not incline my ear”

See how you translated this idiom in 4:20.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 5:13 (#1)

וְלֹא־שָׁמַעְתִּי בְקוֹל מוֹרָי וְלַמְלַמְּדַי לֹא־הִטֵּיתִי אָזְנִי

“And I did not listen to the voice of my teachers, and to my instructors I did not incline my ear”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And I did not listen to the voice of my teachers, no, to my instructors I did not incline my ear]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:13 (#2)

וְלֹא־שָׁמַעְתִּי בְקוֹל

“And I did not listen to the voice of”

The phrase **listen to the voice of** is an idiom that refers to obeying someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I did not obey the instructions of]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 5:14 (#1)

כִּכְמְעַט

“as a little”

Here, **as a little** is a common expression that means “very close to.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on the brink of being] or [just about]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 5:14 (#3)

בְּתוֹךְ

“in the midst of”

Here, **in the midst of** refers to the judgment of the people of the assembly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the opinion of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 5:14 (#4)

קָהָל וְעֵדָה

“the assembly and the congregation”

The terms **assembly** and **congregation** mean the same thing and refer to the man’s community. The man is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the entire assembly]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 5:14 (#2)

בְּכָל־רָעָ֑ה

“in all evil”

Here, the adulterous man speaks of experiencing complete disgrace as if **all evil** were a location he was **in**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [experiencing total disgrace]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:15 (#1)

שְׁתֵה־מַ֭יִם מִבּוֹרֶ֑ךָ וְנֹזְלִ֥ים מִתּ֝וֹךְ בְּאֵרֶֽךָ

“Drink water from your cistern and flowing waters from the midst of your well”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Drink water from your cistern, yes, drink flowing waters from the midst of your well]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:15 (#2)

שְׁתֵה־מַ֭יִם מִבּוֹרֶ֑ךָ וְנֹזְלִ֥ים מִתּ֝וֹךְ בְּאֵרֶֽךָ

“Drink water from your cistern and flowing waters from the midst of your well”

Solomon is leaving out a word in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Drink water from your cistern, and drink flowing waters from the midst of your well]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:15 (#3)

שְׁתֵה־מַ֭יִם מִבּוֹרֶ֑ךָ וְ֝נֹזְלִ֗ים מִתּ֣וֹךְ בְּאֵרֶֽךָ

“Drink water from your cistern and flowing waters from the midst of your well”

In both of these clauses, Solomon is referring in a polite way to a man satisfying his sexual desire with his own wife. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more normal polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could express the meaning plainly. See the discussion of euphemisms in the Chapter Introduction. Alternate translation: [Sleep with your own wife only and satisfy yourself only with her] or [Satisfy your sexual desire only with your wife, yes, satisfy your sexual desire only with her]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 5:16 (#2)

יָפֻ֥צוּ מַעְיְנֹתֶ֑יךָ חֻ֝צ֗וֹת בָּ֣בָּרְחֹבֹ֣ות פַּלְגֵי־מָֽיִם

“Should your springs overflow outside, channels of water in the open areas”

Solomon is leaving out some words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. You may need to make a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Should your springs overflow outside? Should your channels of water overflow in the open areas?]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:16 (#1)

יָפֻ֥צוּ מַעְיְנֹתֶ֑יךָ חֻ֝צ֗וֹת בָּ֣בָּרְחֹבֹ֣ות פַּלְגֵי־מָֽיִם

“Should your springs overflow outside, channels of water in the open areas”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize that a man should not commit adultery. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Your springs should not overflow outside, channels of water in the open areas!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 5:16 (#4)

חֻ֝צ֗וֹת בָּ֣בָּרְחֹבֹ֣ות

“outside & in the open areas”

Here, **outside** and **open areas** refer to public places where there are many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [outside of your home ... in public places]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:16 (#3)

יָפֻ֥צוּ מַעְיְנֹתֶ֑יךָ חֻ֝צ֗וֹת בָּ֣בָּרְחֹבֹ֣ות פַּלְגֵי־מָֽיִם

“Should your springs overflow outside, channels of water in the open areas”

In both clauses, Solomon is using a polite way to refer to a man having sex with women other than his wife by speaking as if that man allowed his **springs** or **water** to flow in public places. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could express the meaning plainly. See the discussion of euphemisms in the Chapter Introduction. Alternate translation: [Should you sleep with other women, making something public that should be private]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 5:17 (#2)

לְךָ֥ לְבַדֶּ֑ךָ

“for you, for you alone”

The phrases **for you** and **for you alone** mean the same thing. Solomon is using the two phrases together for emphasis. By **you** he means the man and his wife together. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [only for your marriage alone] or [for you and your wife only]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 5:17 (#1)

יִֽהְיוּ

“Let them be”

Here, **them** refers to the “springs” and “channels of water” mentioned in the previous verse, which are euphemisms for sexual activity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated those euphemisms in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Let your sexual activity be]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 5:18 (#2)

וּשְׂמַח מֵאֵשֶׁת

“and be glad because of the wife of”

Here the phrase **be glad** refers to experiencing joy or sexual pleasure. If it would be helpful, you could use a natural expression for this in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [take pleasure in the wife of]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 5:18 (#4)

נְעוּרֶךָ

“your youth”

See how you translated the abstract noun **youth** in 2:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 5:18 (#3)

מֵאֵשֶׁת נְעוּרֶךָ

“because of the wife of your youth”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **wife** whom his son married while he was in his **youth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [with the wife whom you married in your youth]

See: Possession

Proverbs 5:18 (#1)

יְהִי־מְקוֹרְךָ בָּרוּךְ

“May your fountain be blessed”

Here Solomon speaks of his son’s wife as if she were a **fountain** that can be **blessed** by Yahweh. This probably refers to the blessing of children. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [May your wife bless you with children]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:19 (#1)

אַיֶּלֶת אֲהָבִים וְיַעֲלַת־חֵן

“A doe of loves and a mountain goat of grace”

Here Solomon speaks of how beautiful the “wife of your youth” is as if she were a **doe of loves and a mountain goat of grace**. The Israelites considered these two animals to be symbols of physical beauty and graceful movements. If it would be helpful, you could refer to animals that are more appropriate for this comparison in your language. If it would not be appropriate in your language to compare a woman to an animal, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [She is as beautiful as a doe of loves and as graceful as a goat of grace] or [she is beautiful and graceful, and she loves you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:19 (#5)

תִּשְׁגֶּה תָמִיד

“may you continually stagger”

Here Solomon speaks of the exhilarating delight of the love that a man should have for his wife as if he were staggering like an intoxicated person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [may you continually revel] or [may you continually lose yourself]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:19 (#3)

וְיַעֲלַת־חֵן

“and a mountain goat of grace”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe a **mountain goat** that is characterized by **grace**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with a different expression. Alternate translation: [a graceful mountain goat]

See: Possession

Proverbs 5:19 (#4)

דַּדֶּיהָ יְרַוֻּךָ

“may her breasts drench you”

Here Solomon speaks of a wife’s **breasts** satisfying her husband’s sexual desires as they would satisfy the thirst of a hungry baby. Here, **drench** refers to giving a baby a satisfying amount of milk. If it would be helpful in your language or if it would be offensive in your language to refer to **breasts**, then you could use a more general expression. Alternate translation: [may her bosom fill you with delight as a mother’s breasts fill her child with food] or [may her body satisfy your sexual desires]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:19 (#2)

אַיֶּלֶת אֲהָבִים

“A doe of loves”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe a **doe** that is characterized by **loves**. The word **loves** is plural here, in which form it refers to sexual love. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with a different expression. Alternate translation: [A loving doe] or [A sexy doe]

See: Possession

Proverbs 5:20 (#1)

וְלָמָּה תִשְׁגֶּה בְנִי בְזָרָה וּתְחַבֵּק חֵיק נָכְרִיָּה

“And why would you stagger, my son, with a strange woman, or embrace the bosom of a foreign woman”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize that a man should not commit adultery. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [And you should not stagger, my son, with a strange woman, or embrace the bosom of a foreign woman!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 5:20 (#4)

בְזָרָה & נָכְרִיָּה

“with a strange woman & a foreign woman”

See how you translated **strange woman** and **foreign woman** in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:20 (#3)

תִשְׁגֶּה

“would you stagger”

See how you translated the same use of **stagger** in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:20 (#2)

וְלָמָּה תִשְׁגֶּה בְנִי בְזָרָה וּתְחַבֵּק חֵיק נָכְרִיָּה

“And why would you stagger, my son, with a strange woman, or embrace the bosom of a foreign woman”

Solomon is leaving out some words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And why would you stagger, my son, with a strange woman, or why would you embrace the bosom of a foreign woman]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:21 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here introduces the reason for obeying the commands stated in 5:15–20. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a reason. Alternate translation: [Do not commit adultery because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 5:21 (#2)

נֹכַח ׀ עֵינֵי יְהוָה דַּרְכֵי־אִישׁ וְכָל־מַעְגְּלֹתָיו מְפַלֵּס

“in front of the eyes of Yahweh {are} the ways of a man, and all of his paths he observes”

These two clauses mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that they express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the clauses and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [God observes everyone, so he sees how a man lives]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:21 (#4)

דַּרְכֵי & מַעְגְּלֹתָיו

“the ways of & his paths”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** and **paths** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:21 (#3)

נֹכַח ׀ עֵינֵי יְהוָה & מְפַלֵּס

“in front of the eyes of Yahweh {are & he observes”

Here Solomon speaks of **Yahweh** knowing what people do as if everything people do is **in front of** his **eyes** or is what **he observes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is fully aware of ... he is fully aware of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:21 (#5)

אִישׁ & מַעְגְּלֹתָיו

“a man & his paths”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... that person’s paths]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 5:22 (#3)

עֲוֹנוֹתָיו יִלְכְּדֶנּוּ & וּבְחַבְלֵי חַטָּאתוֹ יִתָּמֵךְ

“His iniquities capture him & and by the cords of his sin he is grasped”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of a wicked person being unable to avoid the consequences of his **iniquities** and **sin** as if those **iniquities** and **sin** were people who could **capture** or grasp that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He will not escape being punished for his iniquities ... and he is trapped because of the cords of his sin]

See: Personification

Proverbs 5:22 (#2)

עֲוֹנוֹתָיו יִלְכְּדֶנּוּ אֶת־הָרְשָׁעָע וּבְחַבְלֵי חַטָּאתוֹ יִתָּמֵךְ

“His iniquities capture him, the wicked one, and by the cords of his sin he is grasped”

Although the terms **His**, **him**, and **he** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [The wicked person’s iniquities capture that person, and by the cords of that person’s sins that person is grasped]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 5:22 (#6)

וּבְחַבְלֵי חַטָּאתוֹ

“and by the cords of his sin”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the cords** that are **sin**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and by the cords, that is, his sin,]

See: Possession

Proverbs 5:22 (#5)

וּבְחַבְלֵי חַטָּאתוֹ יִתָּמֵךְ

“and by the cords of his sin he is grasped”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the cords of his sin grasp him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 5:22 (#1)

עֲוֹנוֹתָיו יִלְכְּדֶנּוּ אֶת־הָרְשָׁעָע וּבְחַבְלֵי חַטָּאתוֹ יִתָּמֵךְ

“His iniquities capture him, the wicked one, and by the cords of his sin he is grasped”

His in this verse refers to **the wicked one** mentioned in the first clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The iniquities of the wicked one capture him, and by the cords of the wicked one’s sin, he is grasped]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 5:22 (#4)

עֲוֹנוֹתָיו & חַטָּאתוֹ

“His iniquities & his sin”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **iniquities** and **sin**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [The wicked things he does ... the sinful things he does]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 5:23 (#1)

הוּא & וּבְרֹב אִוַּלְתּוֹ יִשְׁגֶּה

“He & and in the abundance of his folly he staggers”

Although the terms **He** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [That person ... and in the abundance of that person’s folly that person staggers]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 5:23 (#3)

יִשְׁגֶּה

“he staggers”

Here Solomon speaks of a person behaving in a sinful manner that will cause him to die as if he were staggering like an intoxicated person who gets lost. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he loses his way] or [he behaves recklessly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:23 (#2)

בְּאֵין מוּסָר וּבְרֹב אִוַּלְתּוֹ

“because there is no correction, and in the abundance of his folly”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **correction**, **abundance**, and **folly**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [because he is not corrected; and in how abundantly foolish he is]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

- Practical warnings (6:1–19)
- Advice on indebtedness (6:1–5)
- Warnings against laziness (6:6–11)
- Things that Yahweh hates (6:12–19)
- Adultery will be punished (6:20–35)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My son
Occasionally, Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” This does not mean that those proverbs only apply to males. Instead, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son, and the kind of advice in these proverbs is about common temptations of young men.

Adulterous women
This chapter repeatedly warns young men to avoid any adulterous woman, who is called “strange” and “foreign.” (See: adultery, adulterous, adulterer, adulteress)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Rhetorical questions
In 6:9, 27, and 28, Solomon uses rhetorical questions to emphasize the importance of what he is saying. (See: Rhetorical Question)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Animals used as examples
In this chapter, the gazelle, bird, and ant have certain characteristics which Solomon uses to teach about wisdom. If your language does not recognize those animals as being wise, you could add a footnote to explain or possibly substitute other animals from your culture that would help explain the same concept.

Proverbs 6:1 (#3)

אִם־עָרַבְתָּ לְרֵעֶךָ תָּקַעְתָּ לַזָּר כַּפֶּיךָ

“if you pledge for your neighbor, you clasp your palms for a stranger”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the clauses into one and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [if you have pledged yourself to pay back a loan for someone else]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:1 (#5)

לְרֵעֶךָ & לַזָּר

“for your neighbor & for a stranger”

The words **neighbor** and **stranger** here refer to the same person. Therefore, this person is an acquaintance of the **son** whom he does not know well. If possible, use a word or words in your language for this type of person.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:1 (#4)

אִם־עָרַבְתָּ לְרֵעֶךָ

“if you pledge for your neighbor”

Here Solomon implies that the **pledge** is a promise to pay back a loan of money that a **neighbor** who is a **stranger** is unable to pay back. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [if you promise to pay back the loan for your neighbor when he is unable to pay it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:1 (#1)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:1 (#7)

תָּקַעְתָּ & כַּפֶּיךָ

“you clasp your palms”

The function of this action in this culture was to confirm a contractual agreement with someone. If there is a gesture with similar meaning in your culture, you could consider using it here in your translation, or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you shake hands to confirm an agreement] or [you confirm an agreement]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 6:1 (#6)

תָּקַעְתָּ לַזָּר כַּפֶּיךָ

“you clasp your palms for a stranger”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if you clasp your palms for a stranger]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:1 (#2)

אִם

“if”

Here, **if** indicates that Solomon is using a hypothetical situation to teach his **son**. This verse and the next verse are one long, conditional sentence. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation that could happen. Alternate translation: [suppose]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Proverbs 6:2 (#2)

נוֹקַשְׁתָּ בְאִמְרֵי־פִיךָ נִלְכַּדְתָּ בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךָ

“you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, you are caught by the sayings of your mouth”

In both of these clauses, Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the first clause of the previous verse if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, if you are caught by the sayings of your mouth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:2 (#3)

נוֹקַשְׁתָּ בְאִמְרֵי־פִיךָ נִלְכַּדְתָּ בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךָ

“you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, you are caught by the sayings of your mouth”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active forms or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the sayings of your mouth have ensnared you, the sayings of your mouth have caught you]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 6:2 (#4)

נוֹקַשְׁתָּ בְאִמְרֵי־פִיךָ נִלְכַּדְתָּ בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךָ

“you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, you are caught by the sayings of your mouth”

In these clauses, Solomon refers to someone getting into trouble because of what he said as if his **sayings** were a trap that could ensnare or catch him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if you get into trouble by the sayings of your mouth, if you encounter difficulty by the sayings of your mouth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:2 (#1)

נוֹקַשְׁתָּ בְאִמְרֵי־פִיךָ נִלְכַּדְתָּ בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךָ

“you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, you are caught by the sayings of your mouth”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, yes, you are caught by the sayings of your mouth]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:2 (#5)

בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךָ & בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךָ

“by the sayings of your mouth & by the sayings of your mouth”

Here, **mouth** represents the words of a promise that the person said with his mouth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by your sayings ... by your sayings]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:3 (#5)

בָּאתָ בְכַף־רֵעֶךָ

“you have come into the palm of your neighbor”

Here Solomon speaks of his **son** being controlled by his **neighbor** as if he had **come into the palm** of his **neighbor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your neighbor has power over you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:3 (#3)

וְהִנָּצֵל

“and rescue yourself”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is the purpose for doing what Solomon commands his son to do in this verse. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of rescuing yourself]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 6:3 (#2)

בְּנִי

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:3 (#6)

וּרְהַב

“and press”

Here Solomon speaks of his **son** begging his **neighbor** as if he were pressing him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and plead with]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:3 (#7)

וּרְהַב רֵעֶיךָ

“and press your neighbor”

Here Solomon implies that his **son** should **press** his **neighbor** to free him from his obligation to fulfill the promise referred to in 6:1–2. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and press your neighbor to release you from your obligation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:3 (#4)

וְהִנָּצֵל

“and rescue yourself”

Here Solomon implies that his **son** should **rescue** himself from his obligation to fulfill the promise referred to in 6:1–2. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and rescue yourself from your obligation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:3 (#1)

עֲשֵׂה זֹאת אֵפוֹא

“then do this”

Here, **then** indicates that what follows is what someone should do if the hypothetical conditions stated in the previous two verses take place. Use the most natural way to express this in your language. Alternate translation: [then do this in response]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:4 (#1)

אַל־תִּתֵּתֵּן שֵׁנָה לְעֵינֶיךָ וּתְנוּמָה לְעַפְעַפֶּיךָ

“Do not give sleep to your eyes and slumber to your eyelids”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Do not give sleep to your eyes and do not give slumber to your eyelids]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:4 (#3)

אַל־תִּתֵּ֣ן שֵׁנָ֣ה לְעֵינֶ֑יךָ וּתְנוּמָ֥ה לְעַפְעַפֶּֽיךָ

“Do not give sleep to your eyes and slumber to your eyelids”

Here Solomon is speaking of allowing oneself to **sleep** and **slumber** as if they were objects that one could **give** to oneself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not let your eyes sleep or your eyelids slumber]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:4 (#5)

לְעֵינֶ֑יךָ & לְעַפְעַפֶּֽיךָ

“to your eyes & to your eyelids”

Here Solomon is using **eyes** and **eyelids** to refer to one’s whole body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to yourself ... to yourself]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 6:4 (#2)

אַל־תִּתֵּ֣ן שֵׁנָ֣ה לְעֵינֶ֑יךָ וּתְנוּמָ֥ה לְעַפְעַפֶּֽיךָ

“Do not give sleep to your eyes and slumber to your eyelids”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Do not give sleep to your eyes, yes, do not give slumber to your eyelids]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:4 (#4)

אַל־תִּתֵּ֣ן שֵׁנָ֣ה

“Do not give sleep”

Solomon implies that this person should not allow himself to **sleep** until he goes to his neighbor to get out of the agreement. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Until you rescue yourself from this problem, do not give sleep]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:5 (#1)

הִנָּצֵ֣ל כִּצְבִ֣י מִיָּ֣ד וּכְצִפּ֣וֹר מִיַּ֣ד יָקֽוּשׁ

“Rescue yourself like a gazelle from a hand and like a bird from the hand of the trapper”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Rescue yourself like a gazelle would rescue itself from a hand, and rescue yourself like a bird would rescue itself from the hand of the trapper]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:5 (#4)

כִּצְבִ֣י

“like a gazelle”

A **gazelle** is a land animal that is known for running quickly and gracefully. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [like an animal that runs swiftly]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 6:5 (#2)

הִנָּצֵ֣ל כִּצְבִ֣י מִיָּ֣ד וּכְצִפּ֣וֹר מִיַּ֣ד יָקֽוּשׁ

“Rescue yourself like a gazelle from a hand and like a bird from the hand of the trapper”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Rescue yourself like a gazelle from a hand, yes, rescue yourself like a bird from the hand of the trapper]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:5 (#3)

כִּצְבִ֣י & וּכְצִפּ֣וֹר

“like a gazelle & and like a bird”

Solomon is saying that the person should act like a **gazelle** and a **bird** because both of those animals are quick enough to escape from hunters. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explic-

itly. Alternate translation: [quickly, like a gazelle ... and quickly, like a bird]

See: Simile

Proverbs 6:6 (#5)

דְּרָכֶ֖יהָ

“its ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:6 (#1)

לֵ֣ךְ־אֶל־נְמָלָ֑ה

“Go to the ant”

Go here implies going for the purpose of looking at **the ant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Go and observe the ant]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:6 (#4)

רְאֵ֥ה

“See”

See here means to observe for the purpose of learning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [See and learn]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:6 (#2)

נְמָלָ֑ה

“the ant”

The word **ant** represents ants in general, not one particular **ant**. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [ants]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:6 (#6)

וַחֲכָ֥ם

“and be wise”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is the purpose for doing what Solomon commands his son to do in this verse. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of becoming wise]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 6:6 (#3)

נְמָלָ֑ה

“the ant”

An **ant** is a small insect that lives underground in large groups. Ants are known for diligently working together to collect food and maintain their nests. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of insect, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the hard-working insect]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 6:7 (#1)

קָצִ֣ין שֹׁטֵ֣ר וּמֹשֵׁ֑ל

“a commander, officer, or ruler”

These three words mean basically the same thing and are used to emphasize that no one commands ants to work diligently. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [any ruler whatsoever]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 6:8 (#5)

בַּקַּ֖יִץ & בַּ֣קָּצִ֑יר

“in the summer & in the harvest”

In the location where this book was written, **summer** is the time of year when people **harvest** crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the time for harvesting crops ... in the harvesting time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:8 (#4)

לַחְמָ֣הּ אָגְרָ֔ה & מַאֲכָלָ֖הּ

“its bread & it gathers its food”

In this verse, **its** refers to “the ant” mentioned in 6:7, which is a collective word for ants in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the ant’s bread ... the ant gathers its food] or [the ants’ bread ... the ants gather their food]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 6:8 (#2)

תָּכִ֣ין בַּקַּ֭יִץ לַחְמָ֑הּ אָגְרָ֖ה בַּ֣קָּצִ֣יר מַאֲכָלָֽהּ

“prepares its bread in the summer; it gathers its food in the harvest”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [prepares its bread in the summer; yes, it gathers its food in the harvest]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:8 (#3)

תָּכִ֣ין & אָגְרָ֖ה

“prepares & it gathers”

Here, **prepares** and **gathers** refer to collecting and storing food for winter, which is the time when food is scarce. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [acquires … it stockpiles]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:8 (#1)

תָּכִ֣ין

“prepares”

The idea in this verse is contrary to what one would expect after knowing the information in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [even so, prepares]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 6:9 (#3)

תָּקוּם֮ מִשְּׁנָתֶ֪ךָ

“will you rise from your sleep”

Here Solomon refers to waking up as if a person were rising up from **sleep**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will you wake up]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:9 (#2)

תִּשְׁכָּֽב

“will you lie down”

The phrase **lie down** implies that the person has been lying on a bed to sleep. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will you sleep in your bed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:9 (#1)

עַד־מָתַ֥י עָ֝צֵ֗ל ׀ תִּשְׁכָּ֥ב מָתַ֑י תָּקוּם֮ מִשְּׁנָתֶ֪ךָ

“Until when, lazy one, will you lie down? When will you rise from your sleep”

Solomon is using the question form twice in this verse for emphasis. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Lazy person, you should stop lying down! You should rise from your sleep!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 6:10 (#4)

מְעַ֣ט ׀ חִבֶּ֣ק יָ֭דַיִם לִשְׁכָּֽב

“a little folding of the hands to lie down”

This phrase refers to an action that people often do in order to rest more comfortably when they **lie down** to sleep. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a little folding of the hands comfortably to lie down and sleep]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:10 (#1)

מְעַ֣ט שֵׁ֭שָׁנוֹת מְעַ֣ט תְּנוּמ֑וֹת מְעַ֣ט ׀ חִבֶּ֣ק יָ֭דַיִם לִשְׁכָּֽב

“A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to lie down”

This verse is a quotation of what the “lazy one” might say. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Proverbs 6:10 (#3)

מְעַ֣ט שֵׁ֭שָׁנוֹת מְעַ֣ט תְּנוּמ֑וֹת

“A little sleep, a little slumber”

These two phrases mean the same thing. The lazy person is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the

emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Just a little more sleep]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 6:10 (#2)

מְעַ֣ט שֵׁנ֣וֹת מְעַ֣ט תְּנוּמ֑וֹת

“A little sleep, a little slumber”

The lazy person is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Let me have a little more sleep; let me have a little more slumber]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:11 (#1)

וּבָ֣א כִמְהַלֵּ֣ךְ רֵאשֶׁ֣ךָ וּמַחְסֹרְךָ֖ כְּאִ֣ישׁ מָגֵֽן

“and your poverty will come like one who walks and your need like a man of shield”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and your poverty will come like one who walks and your need will come like a man of shield]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:11 (#8)

כְּאִ֣ישׁ מָגֵֽן

“like a man of shield”

Here, the phrase **a man of shield** refers to a robber with weapons. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [like a robber with weapons] or [like an armed man]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:11 (#3)

וּבָ֣א & רֵאשֶׁ֣ךָ

“and your poverty will come”

Here, **and** introduces the result of what the lazy person does and says in the two previous verses. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. Alternate translation: [and all this will cause your poverty to come]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:11 (#2)

וּבָ֣א כִמְהַלֵּ֣ךְ רֵאשֶׁ֣ךָ וּמַחְסֹרְךָ֖ כְּאִ֣ישׁ מָגֵֽן

“and your poverty will come like one who walks and your need like a man of shield”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [and your poverty will come like one who walks, yes, your need will come like a man of shield]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:11 (#6)

כִמְהַלֵּ֣ךְ

“like one who walks”

Here, the phrase **one who walks** refers to a robber. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [like a robber]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:11 (#5)

וּבָ֣א כִמְהַלֵּ֣ךְ רֵאשֶׁ֣ךָ

“and your poverty will come like one who walks”

Here Solomon speaks of experiencing **poverty** as if it were a person who could **come** walking to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will surely experience poverty]

See: Personification

Proverbs 6:11 (#9)

כְּאִ֣ישׁ מָגֵֽן

“like a man of shield”

Here Solomon speaks of how surely and completely a lazy person becomes needy as if **need** were an armed robber who takes by force everything that the person owns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be complete]

See: Simile

Proverbs 6:11 (#7)

כְּמְהַלֵּךְ

“like one who walks”

Here Solomon speaks of how certain it is that a lazy person will become poor as if **poverty** were a robber who walks right into his house and steals everything the person owns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [without fail]

See: Simile

Proverbs 6:11 (#4)

רֵאשֶׁשֶׁךָ וּמַחְסֹרֶךָ

“your poverty & and your need”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **poverty** and **need**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [you being poor ... and you being needy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:12 (#4)

הֹלֵךְ

“is} one who walks”

See how you translated the similar use of “walking” in 2:7. Alternate translation: [is one who lives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:12 (#2)

אָדָם בְּלִיַּעַל אִישׁ אָוֶן

“A man of worthlessness, a man of iniquity”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** that is characterized by **worthlessness** and **iniquity**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A worthless man, an iniquitous man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:12 (#3)

אָדָם & אִישׁ

“A man of & a man of”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [A person of ... a person of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:12 (#1)

אָדָם בְּלִיַּעַל אִישׁ אָוֶן

“A man of worthlessness, a man of iniquity”

The phrases **man of worthlessness** and **man of iniquity** mean the same thing. Solomon is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [A completely useless man]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 6:12 (#5)

עִקְּשׁוּת פֶּה

“with} perversity of mouth”

See how you translated this phrase in 4:24.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:13 (#3)

קֹרֵץ בְּעֵינָו מֹלֵל בְּרַגְלָו מֹרֶה בְּאֶצְבְּעֹתָיו

“one who winks with his eye, one who rubs with his foot, one who points with his fingers”

These three clauses refer to actions that someone uses when deceiving people. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of these actions in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [one who winks with his eye, signals with his foot, and points with his fingers to deceive people]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 6:13 (#2)

קֹרֵץ בְּעֵינָו מֹלֵל בְּרַגְלָו מֹרֶה בְּאֶצְבְּעֹתָיו

“one who winks with his eye, one who rubs with his foot, one who points with his fingers”

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that make this clear. Alternate translation: [one who winks with one’s eye, one who signals with one’s foot, one who points with one’s fingers]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:13 (#1)

קֹרֵ֣ץ בְּעֵינָ֗ו מֹלֵ֤ל בְּרַגְלָ֙ו֙ מֹרֶ֣ה בְּאֶצְבְּעֹתָֽיו

“one who winks with his eye, one who rubs with his foot, one who points with his fingers”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous verse if it would be clearer in your language. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [He is one who winks with his eye, one who signals with his foot, and one who points with his fingers]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:14 (#5)

מדנים יְשַׁלֵּֽחַ

“he sends forth quarrels”

Here Solomon speaks of **quarrels** as if they were objects that a person **sends forth**. He means that this person causes other people to quarrel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he causes people to quarrel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:14 (#3)

בְּלִבּ֣וֹ

“are} in his heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:14 (#2)

בְּלִבּ֣וֹ & יְשַׁלֵּֽחַ

“are} in his heart & he sends forth”

Although the terms **his** and **he** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [are in that person’s heart … that person sends forth]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:14 (#4)

רָ֑עַ

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:14 (#1)

תַּהְפֻּכ֥וֹת ׀ בְּלִבּ֣וֹ חֹרֵ֣שׁ רָ֑עַ בְּכָל־עֵ֖ת

“Perverse things {are} in his heart, plotting evil on every occasion”

These two clauses are describing two situations that are occurring at the same time. You can make this clear in your translation with an appropriate connecting word or phrase. Alternate translation: [Perverse things are in his heart while he plots evil on every occasion]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Proverbs 6:15 (#4)

יִשָּׁבֵ֥ר וְאֵ֖ין מַרְפֵּֽא

“he will be broken and without healing”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the calamity will break him and he will not heal]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 6:15 (#1)

אֵידֹ֣ו & יִשָּׁבֵ֑ר

“his calamity & he will be broken”

Although the terms **his** and **he** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [that person’s calamity … that person will be broken]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:15 (#2)

אֵידֹ֣ו

“his calamity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:15 (#3)

יְבֹ֑וא

“will come”

Here Solomon speaks of **calamity** occurring as if it were a person who could **come** to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will occur]

See: Personification

Proverbs 6:16 (#2)

שֵׁשׁ & וְשִׁבְעָה

“Six & and seven”

Here Solomon is using the adjectives **Six** and **seven** as nouns to mean **six** and **seven** things. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [Six things ... and seven things]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 6:16 (#1)

שֵׁשׁ־הֵנָּה שָׂנֵא יְהוָה וְשִׁבְעָה תועבות נַפְשׁוֹ

“Six {are} they {that} Yahweh hates, and seven {are} abominations to his self”

To make a comprehensive statement, Solomon is using a rhetorical device in which the speaker names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh absolutely hates these seven things, and they are abominations to his self]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:16 (#4)

נַפְשׁוֹ

“his self”

Here, **self** refers to **Yahweh** himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [him]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:16 (#3)

תועבות

“are} abominations to”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abominations**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [are abominable to]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:17 (#4)

וְיָדַיִם

“and hands”

Here, **hands** refers to the whole person who does this action with his hands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and people]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 6:17 (#2)

לְשׁוֹן שָׁקֶר

“a tongue of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **tongue** that is characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a false tongue] or [lying] or [telling lies]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:17 (#3)

לְשׁוֹן שָׁקֶר

“a tongue of falsehood”

Here, **tongue** represents what a person says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [telling lies]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:17 (#5)

שֹׁפְכוֹת דָּם־נָקִי

“pouring out innocent blood”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 1:16.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:17 (#1)

עֵינַיִם רָמוֹת

“uplifted eyes”

Here Solomon refers to pride as **uplifted eyes**, which is a characteristic facial expression of proud people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [pride]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:18 (#1)

לֵ֭ב & רַגְלַ֣יִם

“a heart & feet”

Here, **heart** and **feet** refer to the whole person who does these things in his heart or with his feet. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people ... people]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 6:18 (#3)

אָ֑וֶן & לָרָעָֽה

“iniquity & to evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **iniquity** in 6:12 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:18 (#2)

מַחְשְׁבֹ֣ות אָ֑וֶן

“plans of iniquity”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **plans** that are characterized by **iniquity**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [iniquitous plans] or [sinful plans]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:18 (#4)

מְמַהֲרִ֖ות לָרֻ֣וץ לָרָעָֽה

“hurrying to run to evil”

Here Solomon speaks of being eager to do **evil** as if **evil** were a place that a person could **run to**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [eager to do evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:19 (#3)

וּמְשַׁלֵּ֖חַ מְמַדָנִֽים

“and sending forth quarrels”

See how you translated **sends forth quarrels** in 6:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:19 (#1)

עֵ֣ד שָׁ֭קֶר

“a witness of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **witness** that is characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a false witness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:19 (#4)

אַחִֽים

“brothers”

Although the term **brothers** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [family members]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:19 (#2)

יָפִ֖יחַ כְּזָבִֽים

“breathing out lies”

Here Solomon speaks of someone who lies easily and repeatedly as if that person **breathes out lies**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who easily lies]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:20 (#3)

נְצֹ֣ר

“Guard”

Here Solomon speaks of a **commandment** as if it were an object that someone should **Guard**. He means that he wants his son to remember to do what he has commanded him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of guard in 3:21. Alternate translation: [Remember to practice]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:20 (#1)

אָבִ֑יךָ

“your father”

See how you translated the same use of **your father** in 1:8.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Proverbs 6:20 (#4)

בְּנִי

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:20 (#5)

וְאַל־תִּטֹּשׁ תּוֹרַת אִמֶּךָ

“and do not forsake the law of your mother”

See how you translated this clause in 1:8.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 6:20 (#2)

נְצֹר בְּנִי מִצְוַת אָבִיךָ וְאַל־תִּטֹּשׁ תּוֹרַת אִמֶּךָ

“Guard, my son, the commandment of your father and do not forsake the law of your mother”

These two clauses mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the clauses express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Be careful, son, to follow all of the instructions from your father and mother]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:21 (#2)

קָשְׁרֵם עַל־לִבֶּךָ

“Bind them on your heart”

Here Solomon is speaking of remembering his commands as if they were objects that people could **bind** on their **hearts**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Remember them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:21 (#1)

קָשְׁרֵם עַל־לִבֶּךָ תָּמִיד עָנְדֵם עַל־גַּרְגְּרֹתֶךָ

“Bind them on your heart continually; tie them around your neck”

These two phrases mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Keep them very close to you at all times]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:21 (#3)

עָנְדֵם עַל־גַּרְגְּרֹתֶךָ

“tie them around your neck”

Here Solomon is speaking of remembering his commands as if they were objects that people could **tie around** their **necks**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [remember them] or [keep them close to you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:22 (#3)

תַּנְחֶה

“it will guide”

The pronoun **it** in this verse refers to everything that the parents have taught the son, which can be summarized in the word “wisdom.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use that word here, or you could use a plural pronoun to refer to the parents’ teachings, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [this wisdom will guide you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 6:22 (#5)

הִוא תְשִׂיחֶךָ

“it itself will converse with you”

For emphasis, Solomon is stating the pronoun **it**, whose meaning is already included in the verb translated as **converse**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **itself**. Alternate translation: [it will be the one that converses with you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 6:22 (#2)

בְּהִתְהַלֶּכְךָ

“When you walk about”

Here, **walk about** refers to doing one’s daily activities. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When you do your daily activities]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:22 (#1)

בְּהִתְהַלֶּכְךָ ׀ תַּנְחֶה אֹתָךְ בְּשָׁכְבְּךָ תִּשְׁמֹר עָלֶיךָ וַהֲקִיצֹתָ הִיא תְשִׂיחָךְ

“When you walk about, it will guide you; when you lie down, it will preserve you; then you will wake up; it itself will converse with you”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of the lessons he called “the command” and “the teaching” in 6:20 as if they were a person who could **guide**, **preserve**, and **converse with** a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. Alternate translation: [When you walk about, it will enable you to know what to do; when you lie down, it will enable you to be safe; and you will wake up, it will be advice for you] or [When you walk about, it will be like a guide for you; when you lie down, it will be like someone who preserves you; and you will wake up, it will be like someone who converses with you]

See: Personification

Proverbs 6:22 (#4)

בְּשָׁכְבְּךָ

“when you lie down”

See how you translated the same use of **lie down** in 3:24.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:23 (#7)

מִצְוָה וְתוֹרָה

“commandment & and law & the & the”

See how you translated this use of **law** in 1:8.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 6:23 (#2)

נֵר מִצְוָה וְתוֹרָה אוֹר

“commandment {is} a lamp and law {is} a light & the & the”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [commandment is a lamp, yes, law is a light]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:23 (#6)

נֵר & אוֹר

“is} a lamp & is} a light”

Here Solomon refers to **commandment** and **law** enabling people to understand how to live as if they were a **lamp** and a **light** that shows people the path in front of them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [enables one to understand ... enables one to perceive the right way to live]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:23 (#9)

תּוֹכְחוֹת מוּסָר

“rebukes of instruction”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **rebukes** that are included in the **instruction** process. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the rebukes that come from instruction]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:23 (#3)

מִצְוָה וְתוֹרָה

“commandment & and law & the & the”

Here, **commandment** and **law** could refer to: (1) the commands of the father and mother, which were referred to in the previous two verses. Alternate translation: [each of my commandments ... and your mother’s law]; (2) good commandments and laws in general. Alternate translation: [every good commandment ... and every good law]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:23 (#8)

תּוֹכְחוֹת מוּסָר

“rebukes of instruction”

See how you translated the abstract nouns “rebuke” in 1:25 and **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:23 (#10)

וְדֶ֣רֶךְ חַיִּ֑ים

“and & are & way of life”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that results in **life**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and ... are the way that results in life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:23 (#4)

מִצְוָ֥ה

“commandment & the”

Solomon is speaking of commandments in general, and he is not speaking of one particular **commandment**. If it would be helpful in your language, use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [every commandment]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:23 (#5)

מִצְוָ֥ה

“commandment & the”

See how you translated the abstract noun “commandments” in 2:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:23 (#11)

וְדֶ֣רֶךְ

“and & are & way of”

Here Solomon uses **way** to refer to how people behave. See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:23 (#1)

כִּֽי־

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:24 (#1)

לִשְׁמָרְךָ֥

“to keep you”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose for the “commandments,” “law,” and “rebukes of instruction” referred to in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of keeping you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 6:24 (#4)

נָכְרִיָּ֑ה

“a foreign woman”

See how you translated the same use of **foreign woman** in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:24 (#2)

מֵאֵ֥שֶׁת רָֽ֝ע

“from a woman of evil”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **woman** who is characterized by **evil**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [from an evil woman]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:24 (#3)

מֵ֭חֶלְקַ֣ת לְשׁ֣וֹן

“from the smoothness of the tongue of”

Here Solomon refers to the seductive speech of an adulterous woman as if it were **the smoothness of the tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the seductive speech of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:25 (#1)

יָפְיָ֑הּ

“her beauty”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **beauty**, you could express the same idea in another way, as in the UST.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:25 (#2)

בִּלְבָבֶךָ

“in your heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:25 (#3)

וְאַל־תִּתְּפָשְׂךָ

“and do not let her take you”

Here Solomon refers to a woman seducing a man as if she could **take** him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and do not let her tempt you]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:25 (#4)

בְּעַפְעַפֶּיהָ

“with her eyelashes”

This phrase refers to a woman using her **eyelashes** to look more attractive and seduce a man. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or use an expression that has the same meaning in your language. Alternate translation: [by batting her eyes] or [by glancing seductively]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:26 (#4)

וְאֵאֶשֶׁת אִישׁ

“but the wife of a man”

Here Solomon implies that this **wife of a man** is an adulterous woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but a married woman who commits adultery]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:26 (#3)

כִּכַּר לָחֶם

“a loaf of bread”

In this culture, **a loaf of bread** was inexpensive daily food. A **loaf of bread** is a lump of flour dough that a person has shaped and baked. If your readers would not be familiar with **bread** you could use the name of an inexpensive food that is commonly eaten in your country or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [inexpensive food]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 6:26 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do those things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:26 (#2)

בְּעַד־אִשָּׁה זוֹנָה

“the price of a prostitute woman”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to refer to **the price** that a person pays to have sex with **a prostitute woman**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or use a euphemism for this idea. Alternate translation: [the price to sleep with a prostitute woman]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:26 (#5)

נֶפֶשׁ יְקָרָה תָּצוּד

“hunts a precious life”

Here Solomon speaks of a adulterous woman causing the man she commits adultery with to die as if she **hunts** him the way a hunter **hunts** an animal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [kills a precious life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:27 (#2)

הֲיַחְתֶּה אִישׁ אֵשׁ בְּחֵיקוֹ וּשְׂלָמָיו לֹא תִשָּׂרַפְנָה

“Could a man carry a fire on his chest and his clothes not be burned”

Here Solomon is referring to the negative consequences of committing adultery as if a man were

burning himself with **fire**. Since this comparison is explained in 6:29, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Proverbs 6:27 (#3)

אִ֭ישׁ & בְּחֵיקּ֣וֹ וּבְגָדָ֑יו

“a man & on his chest and his clothes”

Here, **a man** and **his** do not refer to a specific **man**. They refer to any person who does this thing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any person ... on that person’s chest and that person’s clothes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:27 (#1)

הֲיַחְתֶּ֣ה אִ֭ישׁ אֵ֣שׁ בְּחֵיקּ֣וֹ וּבְגָדָ֑יו לֹ֥א תִשָּׂרַֽפְנָה

“Could a man carry a fire on his chest and his clothes not be burned”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Surely a man could not carry a fire on his chest and his clothes not be burned!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 6:27 (#5)

וּבְגָדָֽיו

“and his clothes”

Here, **clothes** refers to the person who is wearing those **clothes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he] or [and that person]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:27 (#4)

וּבְגָדָ֑יו לֹ֥א תִשָּׂרַֽפְנָה

“and his clothes not be burned”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the fire not burn his clothes]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 6:27–28 (#1)

הֲיַחְתֶּ֣ה אִ֭ישׁ אֵ֣שׁ בְּחֵיקּ֣וֹ וּבְגָדָ֑יו לֹ֥א תִשָּׂרַֽפְנָה: אִם־יְהַלֵּ֥ךְ אִ֝ישׁ עַל־הַגֶּחָלִ֗ים וְרַגְלָ֥יו לֹ֝א תִכָּוֶֽינָה

“Could a man carry a fire on his chest and his clothes not be burned?If a man walks on coals then will his feet not be scorched”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Could a man carry a fire on his chest and his clothes not be burned? Indeed, if a man walks on coals then will his feet not be scorched?]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:28 (#4)

הַגֶּחָלִֽים

“coals”

Here, **coals** refers to small pieces of burning wood that are often used for cooking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [burning wood pieces]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:28 (#3)

אִ֭ישׁ & וְרַגְלָ֥יו לֹ֝א תִכָּוֶֽינָה

“a man & then will his feet not be scorched”

Here, **a man** and **his** do not refer to a specific **man**. They refer to any person who does this thing. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any person ... then will that person’s feet not be scorched]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:28 (#1)

אִם־יְהַלֵּ֥ךְ אִ֝ישׁ עַל־הַגֶּחָלִ֗ים וְרַגְלָ֥יו לֹ֝א תִכָּוֶֽינָה

“If a man walks on coals then will his feet not be scorched”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation.

Alternate translation: [Surely if a man walks on coals, then his feet will be scorched!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 6:28 (#2)

אִם־יְהַלֵּךְ אִישׁ עַל־הַגֶּחָלִים וְרַגְלָיו לֹא תִכָּוֶינָה

“If a man walks on coals then will his feet not be scorched”

Here Solomon is referring to the negative consequences of committing adultery as if a man were burning himself with **coals**. Since this comparison is explained in 6:29, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Proverbs 6:29 (#4)

לֹא יִנָּקֶה

“will not remain blameless”

Here Solomon uses **not remain blameless** to refer to the outcome of not being **blameless**, which is being punished for being guilty. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not avoid punishment] or [will not remain unpunished]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:29 (#2)

הַבָּא אֶל & הִנֹּגֵעַ בָּהּ

“is the one going to & one who touches her”

Here, **going to** and **touches** both refer to someone having sex with another person. This is a polite way of referring to something that is offensive or embarrassing in some cultures. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different polite way of referring to this act or you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of “enter” in 2:19. Alternate translation: [is the one who has sexual relations with … one who has sexual relations with her] or [is the one who sleeps with … one who sleeps with her]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 6:29 (#1)

כֵּן

“So”

So here indicates that what follows explains the meaning of the statements made in the previous two verses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a fuller expression. Alternate translation: [In the same situation]

See: Simile

Proverbs 6:29 (#3)

לֹא יִנָּקֶה

“will not remain blameless”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [will certainly be guilty]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 6:30 (#4)

לְמַלֵּא נַפְשׁוֹ

“to satisfy his appetite”

The expression **to satisfy his appetite** contains extra information that may be unnatural to express in some languages along with **when he is hungry**. If this is true of your language, you could leave this part unexpressed, as in the UST.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Proverbs 6:30 (#2)

לַגַּנָּב & יִגְנֹב & נַפְשׁוֹ & יִרְעָב

“the thief & he steals & his appetite & he is hungry”

Here, **the thief**, **he**, and **his** do not refer to a specific **thief**, but any person who steals. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [thieves … they steal … their appetites … they are hungry]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:30 (#5)

נַפְשׁוֹ

“his appetite”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **appetite**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [his need for food]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:30 (#1)

לֹא־יָבֻזוּ

“They do not despise”

They here refers to people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [People do not despise]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 6:30 (#3)

יִגְנֹב

“he steals”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context, as in the UST.

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:31 (#2)

וְנִמְצָא

“but if he is found”

Here. **found** implies not only discovering the thief but also catching him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [But if he is caught]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:31 (#4)

יְשַׁלֵּם שִׁבְעָתָיִם

“he must repay sevenfold”

This clause implies that, as punishment for stealing, the thief **must repay** seven times the amount of what he stole to those from whom he stole it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he must repay to the people from whom he stole, sevenfold the amount of what he stole from them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:31 (#5)

אֶת־כָּל־הוֹן בֵּיתוֹ

“all the wealth of his house”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to everything that someone owns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all that he has]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:31 (#1)

וְנִמְצָא יְשַׁלֵּם & בֵּיתוֹ יִתֵּן

“but if he is found, he must repay & his house he must give”

Here, **he** and **his** refer to any person who steals, as indicated in the previous verse. If there are more natural expressions in your language, you could use them here. Alternate translation: [But if someone is found … that person must repay … that person’s house that person must give]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:31 (#3)

וְנִמְצָא

“but if he is found”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but if someone finds him] or [but if someone catches him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 6:32 (#3)

חֲסַר־לֵב

“is} lacking of heart”

Here Solomon refers to the **heart** as the place where a person thinks. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is out of his mind] or [is lacking the ability to think]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:32 (#5)

מַשְׁחִתַ֣ת נַפְשׁוֹ

“destroying his life”

This clause is the result of what is described in the next clause. Use a natural way in your language to indicate a result. Alternate translation: [his life is destroyed because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:32 (#6)

הוּא יַעֲשֶׂנָּה

“he does it”

Here, the pronoun **it** refers to **adultery**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he commits adultery]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 6:32 (#1)

נֹאֵ֣ף

“One who commits adultery”

This verse says something that is in contrast to what was said about the thief in the previous two verses. Use a natural way in your language to express a strong contrast. Alternate translation: [However, one who commits adultery]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 6:32 (#2)

נֹאֵ֣ף

“One who commits adultery”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **adultery**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [One who enters an adulterous relationship]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:32 (#4)

מַשְׁחִתַ֥ת נַפְשׁ֖וֹ הִ֣וא יַעֲשֶׂ֑נָּה

“destroying his life, he does it”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [what he does will destroy his life]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 6:33 (#6)

לֹ֣א תִמָּחֶ֑ה

“will not be wiped out”

Here Solomon refers to the adulterous man’s **shame** never ceasing as if **shame** were a stain that could **not be wiped** away. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not cease]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:33 (#2)

נֶ֣גַע־וְקָלָ֣ון יִמְצָ֑א

“He will find a wound and disgrace”

Here Solomon speaks of the adulterous man receiving **a wound and disgrace** as if they were objects that a person would **find**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He will receive a wound and disgrace] or [He will become wounded and disgraced]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:33 (#4)

לֹ֣א תִמָּחֶ֑ה

“will not be wiped out”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he will never wipe out]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 6:33 (#5)

לֹ֣א תִמָּחֶ֑ה

“will not be wiped out”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will always remain]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 6:33 (#1)

נֶ֣גַע־וְקָלָ֣ון יִמְצָ֑א וְחֶרְפָּתֹ֥ו לֹ֣א תִמָּחֶ֑ה

“He will find a wound and disgrace, and his shame will not be wiped out”

Solomon implies that these things will happen to the adulterous man because he committed adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Because he committed adultery, he will find a wound and disgrace and his shame will not be wiped out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:33 (#3)

וְקָלָ֣ון & וְחֶרְפָּתֹ֥ו

“and disgrace, and his shame”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **disgrace** and **shame**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [and be disgraced, and how shameful he is]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:34 (#2)

קִנְאָ֣ה & נָקָ֑ם

“jealousy & vengeance”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **jealousy** and **vengeance**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [being jealous ... being avenged]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:34 (#3)

חֲמַ֣ת־גֶּ֔בֶר

“is the heat of a man”

Here, **heat** refers to extreme anger, which causes the angry person’s body to become hot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the rage of a man]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:34 (#4)

גֶּ֔בֶר וְלֹא־יַחְמֹ֖ל

“a man, and he will not spare”

Here, **man** and **he** refer to the husband who has just found out that his wife has committed adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a husband of an adulterous woman, and that husband will not spare]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:34 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason why what Solomon stated in the previous verse is true. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is due to the fact that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:34 (#6)

וְלֹא־יַחְמֹ֖ל

“and he will not spare”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will not spare the man who slept with his wife]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:34 (#7)

בְּי֣וֹם נָקָֽם

“in the day of vengeance”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the day** when **vengeance** occurs. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [when vengeance occurs]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:34 (#5)

וְלֹא־יַחְמֹ֖ל

“and he will not spare”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [and he will be merciless]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 6:35 (#2)

לֹֽא־יִשָּׂ֣א פְּנֵי

“He will not lift up the face of”

Here, the phrase **lift up the face of** is an idiom that means “regard favorably.” If it would be helpful, you could use an idiom with that meaning in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He will not be impressed by] or [He will not regard favorably]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:35 (#3)

כֹּ֭פֶר & שֹׁ֣חַד

“ransom & the bribe”

Here, the words **ransom** and **bribe** refer to money that a man would give to the husband of the woman he has committed adultery with in order to avoid harm or stop the man from being angry. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [money offered to appease him ... that money]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:35 (#4)

וְלֹא־יֹאבֶה

“and he will not be willing”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will not be willing to be appeased] or [and he will not stop being angry]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:35 (#1)

לֹא־יֵשָׂא & וְלֹא־יֹאבֶה

“He will not lift up & and he will not be willing”

In this verse, the pronoun **he** refers to the man who has just found out that his wife has committed adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The husband of an adulterous wife will not lift up ... and that husband will not be willing]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

More Warnings about Adultery

- Being wise keeps you from adultery (7:1–5)
- The story of an adulterer (7:6–23)
- The lesson of the story (7:24–27)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My son

Occasionally Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” This does not mean that those proverbs only apply to males. Instead, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son, and the kind of advice in these proverbs is about common temptations of young men.

Adulterous women

This chapter continues the theme about adulterous women and warns young men to avoid any adulterous woman, who is called “strange” and “foreign.” (See: adultery, adulterous, adulterer, adulteress)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

The historic present

To call attention to developments in the story, Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in 7:8–13 and 21–22. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense in your translation. (See: Irregular Use of Tenses)

Proverbs 7:1 (#1)

שְׁמֹר

“keep”

See how you translated the same use of **keep** in 5:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:1 (#2)

תִּצְפֹּן

“store up”

See how you translated the same use of **store up** in 2:1.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:1 (#3)

וּמִצְוֹתַי

“and & my commandments”

See how you translated the abstract noun **commandments** in 2:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 7:2 (#4)

כְּאִישׁוֹן עֵינֶיךָ

“as the pupil of your eyes”

Here Solomon refers to his **law** as if it were **the pupil of your eyes**. He means that people should value wise rules as much as they value their ability to see and protect their eyes. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language with that meaning or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as the light of your life] or [as supremely valuable to you]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 7:2 (#3)

וְ֝תוֹרָתִ֗י

“and my law”

See how you translated **law** in 1:8.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 7:2 (#2)

וְ֝תוֹרָתִ֗י כְּאִישׁ֣וֹן עֵינֶֽיךָ

“and my law, as the pupil of your eyes”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and keep my law as the pupil of your eyes]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 7:2 (#1)

שְׁמֹ֣ר מִצְוֹתַ֣י וֶֽחְיֵ֑ה

“Keep my commandments and live”

See how you translated the same clause in 4:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 7:3 (#3)

כָּ֝תְבֵ֗ם עַל־לֻ֣חַ לִבֶּֽךָ

“write them on the tablet of your heart”

See how you translated this clause in 3:3. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [know them by heart] or [continually think about them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:3 (#2)

קְשָׁרֵ֑ם & כָּ֝תְבֵ֗ם

“Tie them & write them”

In this verse, **them** refers to “my commandments,” which are referred to in the previous two verses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Tie my commandments ... write my commandments]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 7:3 (#1)

קְשָׁרֵ֑ם עַל־אֶ֝צְבְּעֹתֶ֗יךָ

“Tie them on your fingers”

Here Solomon speaks of always remembering something as if what should be remembered were an object tied to the person’s fingers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Remember them at all times]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:4 (#2)

אֱמֹ֣ר לַ֭חָכְמָה אֲחֹ֣תִי אָ֑תְּ וּ֝מֹדָ֗ע לַבִּינָ֥ה תִקְרָֽא

“Say to Wisdom, “You {are} my sister,” and call to Understanding, “Kinsman”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express these two clauses as indirect quotations. Alternate translation: [Say to Wisdom than she is your sister, and call to Understanding that she is your kinsman]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 7:4 (#5)

וּ֝מֹדָ֗ע לַבִּינָ֥ה תִקְרָֽא

“and call to Understanding, “Kinsman”

Solomon speaks of **Understanding** as if it were a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and value understanding as if it were someone to whom you would call, “Kinsman]

See: Personification

Proverbs 7:4 (#6)

וּ֝מֹדָ֗ע לַבִּינָ֥ה תִקְרָֽא

“and call to Understanding, “Kinsman”

Although the term **Kinsman** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to any close relative. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [and call to Understanding, “Family member]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 7:4 (#3)

לַ֭חָכְמָה & לַבִּינָ֥ה

“to Wisdom & to Understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 7:4 (#4)

אֱמֹ֣ר לַֽחָכְמָ֣ה אְחֹ֣תִי אָ֑תְּ

“Say to Wisdom, “You {are} my sister”

Solomon speaks of **Wisdom** as if it were a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Value wisdom as if it were a woman to whom you would say, “You are my sister]

See: Personification

Proverbs 7:4 (#1)

אֱמֹ֣ר לַֽחָכְמָ֣ה אְחֹ֣תִי אָ֑תְּ וּמֹדָ֥ע לַבִּינָ֖ה תִּקְרָֽא

“Say to Wisdom, “You {are} my sister,” and call to Understanding, “Kinsman”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Say to Wisdom, “You {are} my sister,” yes, call to Understanding, “Kinsman]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 7:5 (#3)

מִמְּנֻכְרִיָּ֑ה אֲמָרֶ֖יהָ הֶחֱלִֽיקָה

“from the foreign woman who makes her sayings smooth”

See how you translated the same clause in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:5 (#1)

מֵאִשָּׁ֣ה זָרָ֑ה

“from the strange woman”

See how you translated **strange woman** in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:5 (#2)

מִמְּנֻכְרִיָּֽה

“from the foreign woman”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to keep you from the foreign woman]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 7:6 (#1)

כִּ֤י

“For”

For here introduces a story that Solomon tells in 7:6–23 in order to warn his son against committing adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different word or phrase that introduces a story. Alternate translation: [There was a time when]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 7:6 (#2)

בְּחַלּ֣וֹן בֵּיתִ֑י

“at the window of my house”

Solomon implies that he was standing **at the window** while looking out of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:6 (#4)

אֶשְׁנַבִּ֖י

“the window lattice”

A **lattice** consists of thin strips of wood that cross one another in a slanted pattern and are placed over a **window** to partially cover it. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of **window** covering, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the window screen] or [the covering on the window]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 7:6 (#5)

נִשְׁקָ֥פְתִּי

“I looked down”

Here Solomon implies that he was standing at a location that was higher than the street outside. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I looked down at the street outside]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:6 (#3)

בְּחַלֹּ֥ון בֵּיתִ֖י

“at the window of my house”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **window** that is in the side of his **house**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [at the window that is in the side of my house]

See: Possession

Proverbs 7:7 (#1)

וָאֵ֣רֶא בַפְּתָאיִ֑ם אֶ֝תְבֹּ֗נְנָה בַּבָּנִֽים

“And I saw among the naive ones, I discerned among the sons”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. They are both the first part of a sentence, and the next phrase finishes both sentences. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could supply an object for the first phrase, or you could show that the second phrase is stating the first phrase again. Alternate translation: [And I saw a person among the naive ones; I discerned among the sons] or [And I saw among the naive ones, that is, I discerned among the sons]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 7:7 (#3)

חֲסַר־לֵֽב

“lacking of heart”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:7 (#2)

בַּבָּנִֽים

“among the sons”

Here, **sons** refers to young men. It does not specifically refer to Solomon’s **sons**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [among the young men]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:8 (#3)

וְדֶ֖רֶךְ בֵּיתָ֣הּ יִצְעָֽד

“and he steps {in} the way of her house”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **way** that leads to **her house**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he steps in the way that leads to her house]

See: Possession

Proverbs 7:8 (#2)

פִּנָּ֑הּ

“her corner”

Here, **corner** refers to the place where two roads intersect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [her place at the intersection of two streets]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:8 (#4)

יִצְעָֽד

“he steps {in”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [he stepped in]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:8 (#1)

פִּנָּ֑הּ & בֵּיתָ֣הּ

“her corner & her house”

In this verse, **her** refers to an adulterous woman, as referred to in 7:5. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the corner where an adulterous woman lives … that woman’s house]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 7:9 (#1)

בְּנֶ֣שֶׁף־בְּעֶ֭רֶב יֹ֣ום בְּאִישֹׁ֑ון לַ֝יְלָ֗ה וַאֲפֵלָֽה

“in the twilight breeze, in the evening of day, in the pupil of the night and darkness”

In this verse, Solomon provides this background information about the time period when the young man went to the adulterous woman’s house. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Now it was the time of the

twilight breeze, in the evening of day, in the pupil of the night and darkness]

See: Background Information

Proverbs 7:9 (#2)

בְּנֶשֶׁף־בְּעֶרֶב יוֹם בְּאִישׁוֹן לַיְלָה וַאֲפֵלָה

“in the twilight breeze, in the evening of day, in the pupil of the night and darkness”

The phrases **twilight breeze** and **evening of day** refer to the time when **evening** begins, but **the pupil of the night and darkness** refers to the time later in the **night**. Together these phrases indicate that it was getting progressively darker as the young man went to the adulterous woman’s house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the twilight breeze, in the evening of day, and even in the pupil of the night and darkness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:9 (#3)

בְּאִישׁוֹן לַיְלָה

“in the pupil of the night”

Here, the middle of **the night** is referred to as a **pupil** because the **pupil** is both the middle and the darkest part of the eye. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the middle of the night]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:10 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“And behold, {there is”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [And behold, there was]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:10 (#4)

וּנְצֻרַת לֵב

“and guarded of heart”

The phrase **guarded of heart** is an idiom that refers to hiding one’s intentions or plans from other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an idiom from your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and being wily of heart] or [and she planned to deceive someone]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 7:10 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה

“And behold, {there is”

Here, **behold** is a term meant to focus the attention of the reader on what is about to happen next in the story. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use some emphatic term or expression in your language that would have this same effect. Alternate translation: [And pay attention to this: there was]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:10 (#3)

לִקְרָאתָתְו

“to meet him”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [who came out to meet him]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 7:11 (#1)

הֹמִיָּה & לֹא־יִשְׁכְּנוּ

“is} a loud & do not stay”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [was a loud ... did not stay]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:11 (#2)

בְּבָתֶּיהָ לֹא־יִשְׁכְּנוּ רַגְלֶיהָ

“her feet do not stay in her house”

Solomon is using one part of a person, the **feet**, to represent the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she did not stay in her house]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 7:11–12 (#1)

הֹמִיָּה הִוא וְסֹרֶרֶת בְּבָתֶּיהָ לֹא־יִשְׁכְּנוּ רַגְלֶיהָ: פַּעַם ׀ בַּחוּץ פַּעַם בָּרְחֹבוֹת וְאֵאֶצֶל כָּל־פִּנָּה תֶּאֱרֹב

“She {is} a loud and rebellious one; her feet do not stay in her house.At {one} time in the street, at {another} time in the open areas, and beside every corner she lies in wait”

In these two verses, Solomon provides background information about the adulterous woman. In your translation, present this information in a way that makes it clear that this is background information.

See: Background Information

Proverbs 7:12 (#5)

תֶּאֱרֹב

“she lies in wait”

Here Solomon speaks of the adulterous woman looking for a man to persuade to have sex with her as if she were preparing to attack someone by surprise. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she waited to find a man whom she could persuade to have sex with her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:12 (#2)

בַּחוּץ

“in the street”

The word **street** represents streets in general, not one particular street. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in the streets]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 7:12 (#3)

פִּנָּה

“corner”

See how you translated **corner** in 7:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:12 (#4)

תֶּאֱרֹב

“she lies in wait”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [she lay in wait]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:12 (#1)

פַּעַם ׀ בַּחוּץ פַּעַם בָּרְחֹבוֹת וְאֵאֶצֶל כָּל־פִּנָּה תֶּאֱרֹב

“At {one} time in the street, at {another} time in the open areas, and beside every corner she lies in wait”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [She lies in wait at one time in the street, at another time in the open areas, and beside every corner]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 7:13 (#1)

וְהֶחֱזִיקָה

“And she grabs”

And here indicates that what follows is the continuation of the narrative from 7:10, which Solomon had interrupted with background information in 7:11–12. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show reference to earlier events by translating this relationship by using a fuller phrase. Alternate translation: [After she meets him, she grabs]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Proverbs 7:13 (#2)

וְהֶחֱזִיקָה & וְנָשְׁקָה & הֵעֵזָה & וַתֹּאמַר

“And she grabs & and kisses & she strengthens & and says”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [And she grabbed … and kissed … she strengthened … and said]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:13 (#3)

הֵעֵזָה פָּנָיהָ

“she strengthens her face”

Here, **strengthens her face** means that the woman had a facial expression that showed how shameless or impudent she was. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar expression from your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she has a brazen face] or [she puts a shameless expression on her face]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 7:14 (#2)

הַיּ֥וֹם שִׁלַּ֗מְתִּי נְדָרָֽי

“today I paid my vows”

Here, **vows** refers to the **sacrifices of peace offerings** that the woman promised to sacrifice to God. According to Leviticus 7:16, the woman would have to eat the meat leftover from paying her **vows** by the end of the next day. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [today I made the sacrifices I promised to give to God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:14 (#1)

זִבְחֵ֣י שְׁלָמִ֣ים עָלָ֑י

“The sacrifices of peace offerings {are} with me”

The woman implies that she has meat to eat at her home because someone who made **peace offerings** was allowed to keep some of the meat that was offered to Yahweh in the temple (see Leviticus 7:11–17 and 1 Samuel 9:11–13). If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I have leftover meat from the sacrifices of peace offerings I made to Yahweh in the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:15 (#2)

פָּנֶ֗יךָ

“your face”

Here, **face** refers to being in the presence of the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your presence] or [where you were]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 7:15 (#1)

לְשַׁחֵ֣ר

“to diligently seek”

The woman is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I came out to diligently seek]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 7:16 (#2)

מַמְרַבַּדִּ֑ים & חֻ֝טֵּ֗בוֹת אֵטֻ֥ון מִצְרָֽיִם

“with} coverings, colored linen of Egypt”

Here, the woman describes the **coverings** as being **colored linen of Egypt**, which is expensive and luxurious fabric. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [with coverings, which are luxurious colored linen of Egypt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:16 (#1)

עַרְשִׂ֥י

“my couch”

Here, **couch** refers to a platform that wealthy people would sit or lie on in order to rest or sleep. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of furniture, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [my place for resting]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 7:17 (#2)

מֹ֣ר אֲ֭הָלִים וְקִנָּמֹֽון

“with} myrrh, aloes, and cinnamon”

This mixture of **myrrh**, **aloes**, and **cinnamon** consisted of pleasant-smelling substances that were mixed together and used like perfume. If your readers would not be familiar with these substances, you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [with pleasant-smelling substances]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 7:17 (#1)

נַ֝פְתִּ֗י מִשְׁכָּבִֽי

“I have sprinkled my bed”

Alternate translation: [I have scattered on my bed]

Proverbs 7:18 (#1)

נִרְוֶֽה דֹּדִ֑ים

“let us drink fully of lovemaking”

Here, the woman speaks about satisfying one’s sexual desires as if one were satisfying a thirst. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a more general expression. Alternate translation: [let us satisfy our sexual desires] or [let us satisfy ourselves with sex as a thirsty man drinks wine]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:18 (#2)

דֹּדִ֑ים & בָּאֲהָבִֽים

“of lovemaking & with loves”

The words translated as **lovemaking** and **loves** are plural to indicate an activity rather than a concept. In this verse, both words refer to passionate sexual activity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [of passionate lovemaking … with lustful activity]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:19 (#2)

הָאִ֣ישׁ

“the man”

Here, **the man** refers to the woman’s husband. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the man whom I married]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:19 (#4)

בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ מֵרָחֹ֑וק

“on a road far away”

Here, **road** refers to a journey that would include traveling on a **road**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on a journey to a faraway place]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:19 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason why the woman thinks that it is safe for the young man to come with her, as she told him in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a reason. Alternate translation: [We can do this because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 7:19 (#3)

בְּבֵיתֽוֹ

“in his house”

Here, the woman speaks of the **house** that she lives in with her husband as if it were **his house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in our house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:20 (#4)

בֵּיתֽוֹ

“his house”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:20 (#3)

הַכֶּ֣סֶא

“full moon”

The phrase **full moon** refers to the **moon** when it looks like a perfectly round disk in the sky, shining at its brightest. This occurs at the middle of each month. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the moon shining its brightest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:20 (#2)

צְרֹ֖ור־הַכָּֽסֶף

“the bag of silver”

Here, the woman is using the possessive form to describe a **bag** that is full of **silver**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the bag full of silver]

See: Possession

Proverbs 7:20 (#1)

צְרוֹר־הַכֶּסֶף לָקַח בְּיָדוֹ

“He took the bag of silver in his hand”

This clause implies that the woman’s husband will be gone for a long time because he took a lot of money with him when he left. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [He will be gone for a long time because he took the bag of silver in his hand]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:21 (#4)

בְּרֹב לִקְחָהּ

“with the abundance of her instruction”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to refer to an abundant amount of **instruction**. This word is used elsewhere in Proverbs for good instruction, but here it is bad instruction. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [with her abundant amount of instruction]

See: Possession

Proverbs 7:21 (#6)

תַּדִּיחֶנּוּ

“she compels him”

Here Solomon implies that the adulterous woman compelled the young man to commit adultery with her. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she compelled him to go with her] or [she compelled him to have sex with her]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:21 (#2)

הִהֲטַתּוּ & לִקְחָהּ & שְׂפָתֶיהָ תַּדִּיחֶנּוּ

“She leads him astray & her instruction & her lips she compels him”

She and **her** in this verse refer to the adulterous woman who spoke in 7:14–20 and **him** refers to the young man whom she is seducing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The adulterous woman led the young man astray ... that woman’s teaching ... that woman’s lips she compels that man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 7:21 (#3)

הִהֲטַתּוּ

“She leads him astray”

Here Solomon speaks of the woman persuading the young man to do something as if she were causing him to change the direction in which he was walking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She persuaded him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:21 (#1)

הִהֲטַתּוּ & תַּדִּיחֶנּוּ

“She leads him astray & she compels him”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [She led him astray ... she compelled him]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:21 (#5)

בְּחֵלֶק שְׂפָתֶיהָ

“with the smoothness of her lips”

Here Solomon refers to the seductive speech of the adulterous woman as if it were **the smoothness of her lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with her seductive speech]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:22 (#5)

וּכְעֶקֶב אֶל־מוּסַר אֱוִיל

“and like an ankle chain to the correction of a fool”

Here Solomon compares the man not being able to escape his death as if he were a **fool** who was being led by a **chain** around his **ankle** to his **correction**, which would be some form of severe punishment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the language plainly. Alternate translation: [and like a fool wearing an ankle chain, he goes along to where he will be punished]

See: Simile

Proverbs 7:22 (#3)

יָבֹא

“he goes”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [he went]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:22 (#6)

מוּסַ֥ר

“the correction of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **correction** in 3:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 7:22 (#1)

כְּאֶ֣שׁוֹר אֶל־טָ֑בַח

“like an ox to slaughter”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [like an ox that is going to slaughter]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 7:22 (#2)

כְּאֶ֣שׁוֹר אֶל־טָ֑בַח יָבֹ֥וא

“like an ox to slaughter he goes”

Solomon compares the young man who does not know that he was going to die to **an ox** that was unknowingly going to be slaughtered. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [like a dumb ox, he unknowingly goes to be killed]

See: Simile

Proverbs 7:22 (#4)

וּכְעֶ֥כֶס אֶל־מוּסַ֖ר אֱוִֽיל

“and like an ankle chain to the correction of a fool”

The ULT is a translation of the Hebrew text for this clause. However, some ancient translations of this clause read “and like a deer to a trap.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Proverbs 7:23 (#4)

בְּנַפְשׁ֥וֹ הִֽוא

“it {was} for his life”

This phrase is an idiom that means that this person will die as a result of what he did. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an idiom with the same meaning from your language or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it would cost him his life] or [it would kill him]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 7:23 (#2)

כְּמַהֵ֣ר צִפּ֣וֹר אֶל־פָּ֑ח

“like a bird rushing into a trap”

Solomon compares the young man who is quickly doing something that will kill him to **a bird rushing into a trap**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he quickly goes to be killed like a bird rushing into a trap]

See: Simile

Proverbs 7:23 (#3)

הִֽוא

“it”

The pronoun **it** here refers to committing adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [committing adultery] or [having sex with a married woman]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 7:23 (#1)

יְפַלַּ֖ח חֵ֣ץ כְּבֵדֽוֹ

“an arrow splits his liver”

Here, **liver** refers to an organ in one’s body that one needs in order to remain alive. Solomon means that the **arrow** will kill whomever it strikes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [an arrow pierces his vital organs] or [an arrow kills him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:24 (#2)

שִׁמְעוּ־לִ֭י וְ֝הַקְשִׁ֗יבוּ לְאִמְרֵי־פִֽי

“listen to me, and be attentive to the sayings of my mouth”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [listen to me, yes, be attentive to the sayings of my mouth]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 7:24 (#3)

לְאִמְרֵי־פִֽי

“to the sayings of my mouth”

See how you translated this phrase in 4:5.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 7:24 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֥ה

“And now”

And now here indicates a transition from the story of the adulterous woman and young man in 7:6–23 to the call to pay attention that follows. See how you translated the same clause in 5:7.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 7:25 (#3)

אַל־יֵ֣שְׂטְ & לִבֶּ֣ךָ

“Do not let your heart turn aside”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2. Alternate translation: [Do not allow yourself to give in]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:25 (#1)

אַל־יֵ֣שְׂטְ אֶל־דְּרָכֶ֣יהָ לִבֶּ֑ךָ אַל־תֵּ֖תַע בִּנְתִיבוֹתֶֽיהָ

“Do not let your heart turn aside to her ways; do not wander into her tracks”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Do not let your heart turn aside to her ways; yes, do not wander into her tracks]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 7:25 (#2)

אַל־יֵ֣שְׂטְ אֶל־דְּרָכֶ֣יהָ לִבֶּ֑ךָ אַל־תֵּ֖תַע בִּנְתִיבוֹתֶֽיהָ

“Do not let your heart turn aside to her ways; do not wander into her tracks”

Here Solomon speaks of joining oneself to an adulterous woman as if one were turning **aside** to go on **her ways** or wandering **into her tracks**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated **ways** in 3:6 and **tracks** in 2:15. Alternate translation: [Do not let your heart want to join yourself to an adulterous woman; do not go along with her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:26 (#1)

כִּ֤י

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do those things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 7:26 (#3)

חֲלָלִ֣ים

“pierced ones”

Here, **pierced ones** refers to people who have been killed, since people were often killed by being **pierced** by spears or arrows. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [dead ones]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:26 (#5)

הִרְגָ֑יהָ

“her slain ones”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the ones whom she has slain]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 7:26 (#2)

הִפִּ֣ילָה & חֲרֻגֶ֖יהָ

“she has caused & to fall & her slain ones”

In this verse, **she** and **her** refer to any adulterous woman, not one specific adulterous wife. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [an adulterous woman has caused ... to fall ... the ones slain by such a woman]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 7:26 (#4)

הִפִּ֣ילָה

“she has caused & to fall”

Here Solomon uses **fall** to refer to dying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she has caused ... to die]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:27 (#4)

דַּרְכֵּ֣י שְׁא֑וֹל

“is} the ways of Sheol”

Here Solomon is speaking of the woman’s **house** as if it were located on a path leading to **Sheol**. He means that going there with this woman will result in death for the man, either physical or spiritual or both. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6. Alternate translation: [is a place where you lose your life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:27 (#6)

יֹ֝רְד֗וֹת אֶל־חַדְרֵי־מָֽוֶת

“descending to the rooms of death”

Here Solomon is speaking of **death** as if it were a house with **rooms**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [going there will cause you to die]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:27 (#5)

יֹ֝רְד֗וֹת אֶל־חַדְרֵי־מָֽוֶת

“descending to the rooms of death”

Here Solomon speaks of a man doing something that would result in his death as if he were going on a path that is **descending to the rooms of death**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [resulting in a man dying] or [causing a man to die]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:27 (#1)

בֵּיתָ֑הּ

“Her house”

See how you translated the same use of **Her house** in 2:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:27 (#3)

דַּרְכֵּ֣י שְׁא֑וֹל

“is} the ways of Sheol”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **ways** that result in someone going to **Sheol**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is the way that leads to Sheol] or [is the way that causes one to go to Sheol]

See: Possession

Proverbs 7:27 (#2)

דַּרְכֵּ֣י שְׁא֑וֹל

“is} the ways of Sheol”

Although **ways** here is plural, it refers to the singular **house** at the beginning of this verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the singular form here. Alternate translation: [is the way of Sheol]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Wisdom calls out again

- Foolish people can choose to be wise (8:1–11)
- Characteristics of wisdom (8:12–21)
- God used wisdom in creation (8:22–31)
- Rewards of wisdom (8:32–36)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Wisdom calls out

In this chapter and the next chapter, wisdom is referred to as if it were a woman who calls out for all to learn from her. Wisdom is also pictured as a person who was with God when he created the universe. These are poetic ways of saying that God offers wisdom to all people and that he created the universe through his wisdom. In languages where it is possible for something like wisdom to be spoken of as if it were a person who speaks, the translator should translate in this way. However, if direct translation is not possible in your language, you may translate the personification as similes instead. In that case, wisdom would be presented as being like a wise woman. When wisdom speaks in 8:4–36, the notes will use the proper noun "Wisdom" to indicate that the personification of wisdom is speaking. See how you translated similar references to wisdom in 1:20–33. (See: Personification)

Proverbs 8:1 (#5)

תִּקְרָ֣א & תִּתֵּ֣ן קוֹלָֽהּ

"call out & give her voice"

In this verse and throughout the chapter, **Wisdom** and **Understanding** are spoken of as if they were a person. See the discussion of such personification in the Introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [call out as if it were a woman ... give her voice as if it were a woman]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:1 (#2)

הֲלֹא־חָכְמָ֥ה תִקְרָ֑א וּתְבוּנָ֥ה תִּתֵּ֖ן קוֹלָֽהּ

"Does not Wisdom call out, and Understanding give her voice"

Solomon is leaving out some words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Does not Wisdom call out, and does not Understanding give her voice]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:1 (#6)

תִּתֵּ֣ן קוֹלָֽהּ

"give her voice"

See how you translated this phrase in 1:20.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 8:1 (#4)

חָכְמָ֥ה & וּתְבוּנָ֥ה

"Wisdom & and Understanding"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Wisdom** and **Understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:1 (#1)

הֲלֹא־חָכְמָ֥ה תִקְרָ֑א וּתְבוּנָ֥ה תִּתֵּ֖ן קוֹלָֽהּ

"Does not Wisdom call out, and Understanding give her voice"

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize that **Wisdom** is available to everyone. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Surely Wisdom calls out, and Understanding gives her voice!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 8:1 (#3)

הֲלֹא־חָכְמָ֥ה תִקְרָ֑א וּתְבוּנָ֥ה תִּתֵּ֖ן קוֹלָֽהּ

"Does not Wisdom call out, and Understanding give her voice"

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Both **Wisdom** and **Understanding** represent the same imaginary woman. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Does not Wisdom call out, in other words, does not Understanding give her voice] or [Surely Wisdom calls out, yes, surely Understanding gives her voice!]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 8:2 (#4)

בֵּ֣ית נְתִיבֹ֑ות

"the house of the paths"

This phrase refers to the place where roads intersect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [where roads intersect] or [the crossroads]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 8:2 (#5)

נִצָּבָה

“she stations herself”

Here, **she** refers to wisdom as if it were a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [wisdom stations herself] or [wisdom stations itself as if it were a woman]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:2 (#1)

בְּרֹאשׁ־מְרוֹמִים עֲלֵי־דָּרֶךְ בֵּית נְתִיבוֹת נִצָּבָה

“At the head of the heights beside the road, the house of the paths, she stations herself”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [She stations herself at the head of the heights beside the road, the house of the paths]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:2 (#2)

בְּרֹאשׁ־מְרוֹמִים עֲלֵי־דָּרֶךְ בֵּית נְתִיבוֹת

“At the head of the heights beside the road, the house of the paths”

The phrases **the road** and **the house of the paths** both refer to the same place, which is a place where there would be many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [At the public place at the head of the heights beside the road, the house of the paths]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:2 (#3)

בְּרֹאשׁ־מְרוֹמִים

“At the head of the heights”

The phrase **the head of the heights** refers to the top of a hill or elevated place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [At the top of hill] or [At the highest place]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:3 (#6)

מִבְבֹוא פְּתָחִים

“the entrance of the openings”

This phrase refers to the main **entrance** into the city, which had **gates**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the main entrance]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:3 (#7)

תָּרֹנָּה

“she cries out”

Here, **she** refers to wisdom as if it were a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [wisdom cries out] or [wisdom cries out as if it were a woman]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:3 (#4)

לְפִי־קָרֶת

“at the mouth of the city”

Here, **mouth** refers to the entrance to **the city**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:3 (#2)

לְיַד־שַׁעֲרַיִם לְפִי־קָרֶת מְבֹוא פְּתָחִים

“At the hand of the gates, at the mouth of the city, the entrance of the openings”

The phrases **the hand of the gates**, **the mouth of the city**, and **the entrance of the openings** all refer to the same place, which is inside the main gate of the city where there would be many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [At the public place at the hand of the gates, at the mouth of the city, the entrance of the openings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:3 (#3)

לְיַד

“At the hand of”

Here, **hand** refers to the place beside **the gates**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [At the side of]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:3 (#5)

קָרֶת

“the city”

The word **city** represents cities in general, not one particular **city**. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any city]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 8:3 (#1)

לְיַד־שַׁעֲרִים לִפְי־קָרֶת מְבֹאֹו פְּתָחִים תָּרֹנָּה

“At the hand of the gates, at the mouth of the city, the entrance of the openings, she cries out”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [She cries out at the hand of the gates, at the mouth of the city, the entrance of the openings]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:4 (#1)

אִישִׁים

“men”

Although **men** is masculine, here it refers to people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 8:4 (#3)

בְּנֵי אָדָם

“the sons of man”

Although **sons** and **man** are masculine, this phrase refers to all human beings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [humankind]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 8:4 (#2)

וְקוֹלִי

“and my voice”

Here, **voice** refers to what wisdom is saying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what I am saying]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:5 (#2)

לֵב

“heart”

Here, **heart** refers to the ability to judge things accurately. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [discernment] or [how to judge things well]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:5 (#1)

עָרְמָה

“prudence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **prudence** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:6 (#1)

וּמִפְתַּח שְׂפָתַי

“and the opening of my lips”

Here, **the opening of my lips** refers to what is said when Wisdom opens her **lips** to speak. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what I will say]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:7 (#3)

אֱמֶת & וְתוֹעֲבַת & רֶשַׁע

“truth, and wickedness {is} an abomination to”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **truth**, **wickedness**, and **abomination**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **wickedness** in 4:17 and **abomination** in 3:32. Alternate translation: [true things, and wicked things are abominable to]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:7 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows in 8:7–9 are additional reasons why people should listen to Wisdom, as commanded in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows are reasons. Alternate translation: [Listen because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 8:7 (#2)

חִכִּי & שְׂפָתַי

“my palate & my lips”

Here, **palate** and **lips** refer to the person who is speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I ... me]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 8:8 (#5)

וְעִקֵּשׁ

“or crooked”

See how you translated the same use of **crooked** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:8 (#3)

בְּצֶדֶק

“are} in righteousness”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [are spoken in righteousness] or [are spoken righteously]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:8 (#2)

פִּי

“my mouth”

Here, **mouth** refers to the person who is speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [mine]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 8:8 (#1)

אִמְרֵי

“the words of”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:8 (#4)

נִפְתָּל וְעִקֵּשׁ

“twisted or crooked”

Here, Wisdom speaks of something that is false as if it were **twisted or crooked**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [untrue or deceptive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:8 (#6)

בָּהֶם

“in them”

Here, **them** refers to **the words of my mouth** stated in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in those words] or [in what I say]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 8:9 (#1)

כֻּלָּם

“All of them”

See how you translated **them** in the previous verse.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 8:9 (#4)

דָּעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:9 (#3)

לִמֹּצְאֵי דָּעַת

“for finders of knowledge”

Here, Wisdom speaks of acquiring **knowledge** as if it were something that people find. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for people who acquire knowledge]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:9 (#2)

וְיָשָׁרִים

“and upright things”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and all of them are upright things]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:10 (#6)

מֵחָרָוּץ נִבְחָר

“rather than choice gold”

Here, **choice gold** refers to **gold** that is the best quality. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [rather than the best gold]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:10 (#5)

וְאֵל־כָּסֶף

“and not silver”

Here, **and not** means the same as **rather than** in the next clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [rather than silver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:10 (#1)

קְחוּ־מוּסָרִי וְאַל־כֶּסֶף וְדַעַת מֵחָרָוּץ נִבְחָר

“Take my instruction and not silver, and knowledge rather than choice gold”

The author is leaving out a word in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Take my instruction and not silver, and take knowledge rather than choice gold]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:10 (#4)

מוּסָרִי & וְדַעַת

“my instruction & and knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **instruction** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:10 (#3)

קְחוּ

“Take”

Here, Wisdom speaks of acquiring **instruction** and **knowledge** as if they were objects that a person can **Take**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Acquire]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:10 (#2)

קְחוּ־מוּסָרִי וְאַל־כֶּסֶף וְדַעַת מֵחָרָוּץ נִבְחָר

“Take my instruction and not silver, and knowledge rather than choice gold”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Take my instruction and not silver, yes, take knowledge rather than choice gold]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 8:11 (#1)

טוֹבָה חָכְמָה

“wisdom {is} better”

Here, Wisdom, personified as a woman, speaks about the value of having wisdom, so she is, in a way, speaking about herself. See how you translated the introduction of Lady Wisdom in 8:1, and review how that might affect your translation here. If it causes problems in your language for Lady Wisdom to talk about the idea of wisdom, use a verb or other expression here that is different than the name “Wisdom.” Alternate translation: [being wise is better]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:11 (#2)

בָּהּ

“with her”

The pronoun **her** refers to **wisdom**. Since the word **wisdom** is grammatically feminine in Hebrew, the pronoun that refers to it is also feminine. Because of this, Lady Wisdom can refer to both the idea of wisdom and herself at the same time. It your language must choose to refer to either the woman Wisdom or the idea of wisdom, we recommend that you choose

the idea of wisdom as what is more important here. Alternate translation: [with it] or [with that]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 8:11 (#3)

מִפְּנִינִנִֽים

“than coral pearls”

See how you translated **coral pearls** in 3:15.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 8:12 (#1)

שָׁכַנְתִּי עָרְמָ֫ה

“I dwell with Prudence”

Here, **Wisdom** speaks of being associated with **Prudence** as if **Prudence** were a person with whom **Wisdom** dwells. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [am associated with what is prudent] or [I am similar to prudence. We are like two people who live in the same house]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:12 (#2)

חָ֭כְמָה & עָרְמָ֫ה וְדַ֣עַת מְזִמּ֑וֹת

“Wisdom & Prudence, and knowledge of discretion”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Wisdom** in 1:2, and **prudence**, **knowledge**, and **discretion** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:12 (#4)

וְדַ֣עַת מְזִמּ֑וֹת אֶמְצָֽא

“and knowledge of discretion I find”

Here, **Wisdom** speaks of enabling people to have **knowledge of discretion** as if they were objects that one could **find**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I enable people to acquire knowledge of discretion] or [What is wise enables you to acquire knowledge of discretion]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:12 (#3)

וְדַ֣עַת מְזִמּ֑וֹת

“and knowledge of discretion”

Here, Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe a **knowledge** that is about **discretion**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and knowledge about discretion]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:13 (#1)

יִרְאַ֣ת יְ֭הוָה

“The fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated the **fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:13 (#3)

וְדֶ֖רֶךְ רָ֣ע

“and the evil way”

See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:13 (#2)

רָ֣ע גֵּ֭אֶוָה וָגָ֣אוֹן

“evil. Pride and arrogance”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **evil**, **Pride**, and **arrogance**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **evil** in 1:16. Alternate translation: [evil things. Being proud and arrogant]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:13 (#4)

וּפִ֖י תַּהְפֻּכ֣וֹת

“and the mouth of perverse things”

Here, Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe a **mouth** that speaks **perverse things**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and the mouth that speaks perverse things]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:13 (#5)

וּפִ֖י

“and the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** represents the **perverse things** that are said through it. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the action of speaking]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:14 (#3)

אֲנִי בִּינָה

“I {am} understanding”

Here Wisdom identifies herself with **understanding**. As in 8:1, we are meant to understand that both wisdom and understanding are two words for the same thing, and thus they are pictured as the same woman who is known by both names. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this clear. Alternate translation: [I am also known as Understanding]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:14 (#2)

לִי־עֵצָה וְתוּשִׁיָּה & לִי גְבוּרָה

“Counsel and sound wisdom {are} mine & strength {is} mine”

Here, Wisdom speaks of enabling people to have **Counsel**, **sound wisdom**, and **strength** as if they were objects that belong to Wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I enable you to acquire counsel and sound wisdom ... I enable you to acquire strength] or [What is wise enables you to acquire counsel and sound wisdom ... what is wise enables you to acquire strength]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:14 (#1)

עֵצָה וְתוּשִׁיָּה & בִּינָה & גְבוּרָה

“Counsel and sound wisdom & am} understanding; strength”

See how you translated **Counsel** in 1:25, **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2, and **strength** in 5:10.

Proverbs 8:15 (#2)

צֶדֶק

“righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **righteousness** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:15 (#1)

וְרוֹזְנִים יְחֹקְקוּ צֶדֶק

“and dignitaries decree righteousness”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and by me dignitaries decree righteousness] or [and by what is wise dignitaries decree righteousness]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:16 (#3)

שֹׁפְטֵי צֶדֶק

“judges of righteousness”

Here, Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe **judges** who are characterized by **righteousness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [righteous judges]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:16 (#1)

וּנְדִיבִים

“and nobles”

Wisdom, the speaker, is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and by me nobles rule] or [and by what is wise, nobles rule]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:16 (#2)

כָּל־שֹׁפְטֵי צֶדֶק

“all judges of righteousness”

This phrase applies to **princes** and **nobles** and anyone else who rules by wisdom. It distinguishes all of these **judges of righteousness** from those who do not rule by wisdom and are not righteous. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make the relationship between these phrases more clear. Alternate translation: [that is, all of them who are judges of righteousness]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Proverbs 8:17 (#1)

אֲנִי & אֹהֲבַי

“I myself love”

Here the word **myself** emphasizes that Wisdom has only love for those who love her. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [As for me, I love]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 8:17 (#2)

אֲנִי אהביה אֹהֲבַי

“I myself love those who love me”

Here, wisdom is depicted as if it were a person who can **love** and be loved by people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Wisdom benefits those who value it] or [It is as if wisdom were a woman who loves those who love her]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:17 (#3)

וּמְשַׁחֲרַי יִמְצָאֻנְנִי

“and those who diligently seek me will find me”

Here, wisdom is spoken of as if it were a person whom people can **seek** and **find**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and those who diligently try to become wise will become wise]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:18 (#3)

וְכָבוֹד & וּצְדָקָה

“and honor & and righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **honor** in 3:16 and **righteousness** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:18 (#2)

הַהוֹן עָעָתֵק וּצְדָקָה

“lasting wealth and righteousness”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [surpassing wealth and righteousness are with me] or [surpassing wealth and righteousness are with what is wise]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:18 (#1)

עֹשֶׁר־וְכָבוֹד אִתִּתִי

“Riches and honor {are} with me”

Here, Wisdom speaks of enabling people to have **Riches**, **honor**, **surpassing wealth**, and **righteousness** as if they were objects that were **with** Wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I enable you to have riches, honor, surpassing wealth, and righteousness] or [What is wise enables you to have riches, honor, surpassing wealth, and righteousness]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:19 (#1)

טוֹב פִּרְיִי & וּתְבוּאָתִי

“My fruit {is} better & and my produce”

Here, **fruit** and **produce** refer to the benefits that a person receives from having wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [My benefits are better ... they are better] or [The benefits I can give you are better ... yes, they are more]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:19 (#2)

מֵחָרוּץ וּמִפָּז

“than gold and than refined gold”

The terms **gold** and **refined gold** mean similar things. Wisdom is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [than the finest gold]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 8:19 (#3)

מִכֶּסֶף נִבְחָר

“than choice silver”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is better than choice silver]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:19 (#4)

מִכֶּ֖סֶף נִבְחָֽר

“than choice silver”

Here, **choice silver** refers to **silver** that is the best quality. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [than the best silver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:20 (#1)

בְּאֹ֣רַח־צְדָקָ֣ה אֲהַלֵּ֑ךְ

“I walk in the path of righteousness”

Here Wisdom speaks of behaving righteously as if she were walking on a **path**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I behave righteously]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:20 (#2)

בְּאֹ֣רַח־צְדָקָ֣ה

“in the path of righteousness”

Here, Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe **the path** that is characterized by **righteousness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the righteous path]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:20 (#3)

בְּת֣וֹךְ נְתִיב֖וֹת מִשְׁפָּֽט

“in the midst of the pathways of justice”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I walk in the midst of the pathways of justice]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:20 (#4)

נְתִיב֖וֹת מִשְׁפָּֽט

“the pathways of justice”

Here, Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe **the pathways** that are characterized by **justice**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the just pathways]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:21 (#2)

וְאֹצְרֹתֵיהֶ֖ם

“and their treasuries”

The word **treasuries** refers to buildings or rooms where people store valuable things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and their buildings where they store precious things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:21 (#1)

לְהַנְחִ֣יל אֹהֲבַ֑י

“to cause those who love me to inherit”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose for what Wisdom does in the previous verse. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a purpose. You may want to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [I do that for the purpose of causing those who love me to inherit]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 8:22 (#3)

קָנָ֣נִי

“possessed me”

Some scholars believe that the word translated as **possessed** could also mean “created.” Either way, the point is that **Yahweh** had wisdom before he created the universe. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 8:22 (#2)

יְהוָ֗ה קָנָ֣נִי רֵאשִׁ֣ית דַּרְכּ֑וֹ קֶ֝דֶם מִפְעָלָ֗יו מֵאָֽז

“Yahweh possessed me {at} the beginning of his way, before his works from then”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could

connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Yahweh possessed me at the beginning of his way, yes, Yahweh possessed me before his works from then]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 8:22 (#4)

דַּרְכּוֹ & מִפְעָלָיו

“his way & his works”

The phrases **his way** and **his works** both refer to Yahweh creating the universe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [his creating ... his creative works]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:22 (#1)

יְהוָה קָנָנִי רֵאשִׁית דַּרְכּוֹ קֶדֶם מִפְעָלָיו מֵאָז

“Yahweh possessed me {at} the beginning of his way, before his works from then”

Wisdom is leaving out some words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh possessed me at the beginning of his way; Yahweh possessed me before his works from then]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:22 (#5)

מֵאָז

“from then”

Here, **then** refers to **the beginning** mentioned in the previous clause, which refers to when **Yahweh** started creating the universe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from the beginning]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:23 (#4)

נְסַכְתִּי

“I was poured out”

Here, Wisdom speaks of being established as if she were a liquid that was **poured out**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I was established]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:23 (#3)

נְסַכְתִּי

“I was poured out”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh did the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh poured me out]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 8:23 (#5)

מֵרֹאשׁ

“from the head”

Here, **head** refers to the first in a series of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the first]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:23 (#2)

מֵעוֹלָם

“From eternity”

Here, **eternity** refers to the distant past. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [In the distant past]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:23 (#6)

מִקַּדְמֵי־אָרֶץ

“from the ancient times of the earth”

The phrase **the ancient times of the earth** refers to the time when the earth was made. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from when God created the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:23 (#1)

מֵעוֹלָם נְסַכְתִּי מֵרֹאשׁ מִקַּדְמֵי־אָרֶץ

“From eternity I was poured out, from the head, from the ancient times of the earth”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate transla-

tion: [I was poured out from eternity, from the head, from the ancient times of the earth]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:24 (#2)

חוֹלָלְתִּי

“I was brought forth”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh did the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh brought me forth]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 8:24 (#4)

מַעְיָנוֹת נִכְבְּדֵי־מָיִם

“springs heavy with water”

Here, Wisdom speaks of **springs** being full of **water** that flows out as if they were **heavy with water**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [springs full of flowing water]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:24 (#1)

בְּאֵין־תְּהֹמוֹת חוֹלָלְתִּי בְּאֵין מַעְיָנוֹת נִכְבְּדֵי־מָיִם

“When there were no watery depths, I was brought forth, when there were no springs heavy with water”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [I was brought forth when there were no watery depths and when there were no springs heavy with water]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:24 (#3)

חוֹלָלְתִּי

“I was brought forth”

Here, Wisdom continues to speak as a person who was **brought forth**, which is a dramatic way to say “born.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I came into existence]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:25 (#4)

לִפְנֵי גְבָעוֹת

“to the face of the hills”

Here, **to the face of** is a common expression that means “before.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before the existence of the hills]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 8:25 (#5)

חוֹלָלְתִּי

“I was brought forth”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:25 (#1)

בְּטֶרֶם הָרִרִים הָטְבָּעוּ לִפְנֵי גְבָעוֹת חוֹלָלְתִּי

“Before the mountains were sunk, to the face of the hills, I was brought forth”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [I was brought forth before the mountains were sunk and before the face of the hills]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:25 (#3)

הָרִרִים הָטְבָּעוּ

“the mountains were sunk”

Here Wisdom speaks of the creation of **the mountains** as if their foundations **were sunk** in the earth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the mountains were established]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:25 (#2)

הָרִרִים הָטְבָּעוּ

“the mountains were sunk”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh sunk the mountains]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 8:26 (#2)

וְחוּצוֹת

“or the outside places”

Here, **outside places** refers to the fields in the countryside. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [or the open spaces of the countryside]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:26 (#3)

וְרֹאשׁ

“or the head of”

Here, **the head** refers to the first part of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [or the first of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:26 (#1)

עַד־לֹא עָשָׂה אֶ֭רֶץ וְחוּצ֣וֹת וְרֹ֣אשׁ עָפְרֹ֑ות תֵּבֵֽל

“before he made the earth or the outside places or the head of the loose soil of the world”

This verse continues the sentence that began in the previous verse. If you divide the previous verse and this verse into separate sentences, then you will need to repeat the main clause from the previous verse. Alternate translation: [I was brought forth before he made the earth or the outside places or the head of the loose soil of the world]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:27 (#1)

בַּהֲכִינ֣וֹ שָׁ֭מַיִם שָׁ֣ם אָ֑נִי

“When he established the heavens, I {was} there”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. This verse is the beginning of a sentence that continues through 8:29. If you make each verse a separate sentence, then you will need to repeat the main clause of this verse in each of those verses. Alternate translation: [I was there when he established the heavens]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:27 (#2)

בְּחֻקּ֣וֹ חֹ֭ג עַל־פְּנֵ֣י תְהֹֽום

“when he inscribed a circle over the face of the watery deep”

This clause refers to Yahweh forming the horizon between the sky and ocean as if he were drawing a **circle** on the ocean’s surface. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he made the horizon between the heavens and the surface of the ocean]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:28 (#2)

בַּ֭עַזּוֹז עִינֹ֣ות תְּהֹ֑ום

“when the springs of the watery deep became strong”

Here Wisdom speaks of the **springs** flowing with much water as if they were people who **became strong**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when the springs of the watery deep flowed strongly]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:28 (#3)

עִינֹ֣ות תְּהֹ֑ום

“the springs of the watery deep”

Here Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe **the springs** that supply water to **the watery deep**, which refers to the bottom of the ocean. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the springs that fill the watery deep]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:28 (#1)

בְּאַמְּצ֣וֹ שְׁחָקִ֑ים

“when he made firm the clouds”

Here, Wisdom speaks of God forming **the clouds** as if he made them **firm**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [when he created the clouds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:29 (#5)

מְמֻוסְדֵ֣י אֶ֑רֶץ

“the foundations of the earth”

Here **the earth** is spoken of as though it rested on **foundations** such as a building has. These were sometimes thought of as the bottoms of the mountains (see Micah 6:2). If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the lowest parts of the earth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:29 (#1)

בְּשׁשׂוּמָוֹ & פִּיו בְּחֻקֹּו

“when he set up & his mouth, when he inscribed”

In this verse, **he** and **his** refer to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [when Yahweh set up … Yahweh’s mouth … when Yahweh inscribed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 8:29 (#4)

בְּחֻקֹּו

“when he inscribed”

This clause refers to Yahweh designating **the foundations of the earth** as if he were drawing them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he designated] or [when he decreed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:29 (#3)

פִּיו

“his mouth”

Here, **mouth** refers to God’s **statute** that was mentioned in the previous clause as if it were a command spoken by God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his command] or [that limit]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:29 (#2)

חֻקֹּו

“its statute”

Here, **its statute** refers to the limit or boundary of **sea**, where the **sea** ends and the dry land begins. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [its limit]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:30 (#3)

מְשַׂחֶקֶת

“frolicking”

Here, **frolicking** refers to dancing or playing in a way that expresses great joy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [acting joyfully]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:30 (#2)

שַׁעֲשֻׁעִים

“a delight”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **delight**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [delightful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:30 (#4)

לְפָנָיו

“before his face”

Here, **face** refers to Yahweh’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in his presence]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:30 (#1)

וְאֶהְיֶה אֵצְלֹו אָמֹון

“Then I was beside him {as} a skilled worker”

Here Yahweh’s use of wisdom to create the universe is spoken of as if Wisdom were **a skilled worker** who was **beside him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Then he used wisdom skillfully] or [Then I was like a skilled worker beside him]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:31 (#1)

מְשַׂחֶקֶת

“Frolicking”

See how you translated this word in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:31 (#4)

בְּנֵי אָדָם

“the sons of man”

See how you translated this phrase in 8:4

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 8:31 (#2)

בְּתֵבֵל אַרְצוֹ

“in the world of his earth”

The phrase **world of his earth** could refer to: (1) the whole **world**. Alternate translation: [his entire world]; (2) the inhabited part of the **world**. Alternate translation: [his inhabited world]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 8:31 (#3)

וְשַׁעֲשֻׁעַי

“and my delights”

See how you translated “delight” in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:32 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

And now here indicates a transition from what Wisdom has been saying in 8:4–31 to the conclusion of her speech in 8:32–36. See how you translated the same clause in 5:7 and 7:24. Alternate translation: [Therefore] or [In conclusion]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 8:32 (#4)

דְּרָכַי יִשְׁמֹרוּ

“are} they {who} keep my ways”

Here, someone’s behavior is spoken of as keeping to certain **ways**. See how you translated the similar use of **keep** and “paths” in 2:20. Alternate translation: [are they who behave as I recommend]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:32 (#3)

וְאַשְׁרֵי

“and happy”

Here, **and** introduces the reason for obeying the command stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a reason. Alternate translation: [since happy]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 8:32 (#2)

בָּנִים

“sons”

See how you translated the same use of **sons** in 4:1.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 8:33 (#2)

וְאַל־תִּפְרָעוּ

“and do not neglect {it”

Wisdom is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [be sure to pay attention to it] or [be sure to follow it]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 8:33 (#1)

מוּסָר

“instruction”

See how you translated **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:34 (#4)

לִשְׁקֵד עַל־דַּלְתֹתַי יוֹם ׀ יוֹם לִשְׁמֹר מְזוּזוֹת פְּתָחָי

“keeping vigil over my doors day {by} day, keeping watch {over} the doorposts of my entrances”

The author assumes that his readers will understand that **Happy is the man** also applies to this part of the sentence. You could repeat it here if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [happy is the man keeping vigil over my doors day by day, keeping watch over the doorposts of my entrances]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:34 (#5)

לִשְׁקֵד עַל־דַּלְתֹתַי יוֹם ׀ יוֹם לִשְׁמֹר מְזוּזוֹת פְּתָחָי

“keeping vigil over my doors day {by} day, keeping watch {over} the doorposts of my entrances”

Here, **doors** and **doorposts of my entrances** implies that Wisdom has a house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [keeping vigil over the doors of my house day by day, keeping watch over the doorposts of the entrances of my house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:34 (#2)

לִשְׁקֵד֙ עַל־דַּ֣לְתֹתַ֔י יוֹם ׀ יוֹם֙ לִשְׁמֹ֣ר מְזוּזֹ֔ת פְּתָחָֽי

“keeping vigil over my doors day {by} day, keeping watch {over} the doorposts of my entrances”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [keeping vigil over my doors day by day, yes, keeping watch over the doorposts of my entrances]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 8:34 (#1)

אָדָ֖ם

“is} the man”

The word **man** represents a person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 8:34 (#3)

לִשְׁקֵד֙ עַל־דַּ֣לְתֹתַ֔י יוֹם ׀ יוֹם֙ לִשְׁמֹ֣ר מְזוּזֹ֔ת פְּתָחָֽי

“keeping vigil over my doors day {by} day, keeping watch {over} the doorposts of my entrances”

Here Wisdom speaks of someone being eager to listen to her as if that person were vigilantly waiting at the door to her house, waiting for her to come out. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [being extremely eager to hear wise counsel] or [being eager to listen to me as if one were keeping vigil over my doors day by day, keeping watch over the doorposts of my entrances]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:35 (#2)

מֹצָאַ֣י

“QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: מֹצָאַ֣י”

Here, learning wisdom is spoken of as if wisdom were a person whom someone could find. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar phrase in 3:13 and 8:17. Alternate translation: [those who attain wisdom] or [those who become wise]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:35 (#4)

וַיָּ֖פֶק

“and he obtains”

Although the term **he** is masculine, Wisdom is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to either a man or woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [and that person obtains]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 8:35 (#1)

כִּֽי־

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason why someone who listens to Wisdom will be happy, as stated in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [That man will be happy because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 8:35 (#3)

מצאי חַיִּ֔ים

“is} a finder of life”

Having a good **life** is spoken of as if **life** were an object that a person can find by searching for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are those who will have good lives]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:35 (#5)

וְרָצ֥וֹן

“favor”

See how you translated **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:36 (#1)

וְחֹטְאִי

“But a misser of me”

The phrase translated **a misser of me** refers to someone who misses the goal, which is to find wisdom, as in the previous verse. It does not refer to someone who misses another person in the sense of longing for that person to be present. The phrase could also be translated as “a sinner against me,” since the same word is used both for sinning and for missing the mark or failing to reach a goal. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 8:36 (#4)

אָהֲבוּ מָוֶת

“love death”

This phrase is an exaggeration that emphasizes that people who hate wisdom choose to live in a way that will cause them to die. It does not mean that people who hate wisdom actually **love death**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [show by their actions that they choose to die] or [act as if they love death]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 8:36 (#3)

נַפְשָׁשׁוֹ

“his life”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [himself]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:36 (#2)

חֹמֵס & מָוֶת

“does violence to & death”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **violence** in 3:31 and **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Wisdom and folly (9:1–18)

- Wisdom invites naive people to a meal (9:1–6)
- Wise men become wiser but mockers will suffer (9:7–12)
- Folly invites people to her house (9:13–18)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Wisdom calls out

In this chapter, as in the previous chapter, wisdom is referred to as if it were a woman who prepares a meal and calls out for all to come and learn from her. When wisdom speaks in 9:4–12, the notes will use the proper noun “Wisdom” to indicate that the personification of wisdom is speaking. In languages where it is possible for something like wisdom to be spoken of as if it were a person who speaks, the translator should translate in this way. However, if direct translation is not possible in your language, you may translate the personification as similes instead. In that case, wisdom would be presented as being like a wise woman. See how you translated similar references to wisdom in 1:20–33 and 8:4–36. (See: Personification)

Proverbs 9:1 (#2)

חָצְבָה עַמּוּדֶיהָ שִׁבְעָה

“she has hewn out her seven pillars”

This clause refers to part of the process of building the **house** that was mentioned in the previous clause. A **house** with **seven pillars** would have been very large. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she has hewn out seven pillars to support the roof of her house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:1 (#1)

חָכְמוֹת בָּנְתָה בֵּיתָהּ חָצְבָה עַמּוּדֶיהָ שִׁבְעָה

“Wisdom has built her house; she has hewn out her seven pillars”

In 9:1–12, **Wisdom** is spoken of as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this in the Chapter Introduction. Alternate translation: [It is as if wisdom were a woman

who has built her house and has hewn out her seven pillars]

See: Personification

Proverbs 9:2 (#4)

מָסְכָּה יֵינָהּ

“she has mixed her wine”

In ancient Israel, people often prepared **wine** for special meals by mixing spices into it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she has prepared her wine by mixing spices into it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:2 (#2)

טָבְחָה טִבְחָהּ מָסְכָה יֵינָהּ אַף עָרְכָה שֻׁלְחָנָהּ

“She has slaughtered her slaughter, she has mixed her wine, also she has arranged her table”

All three of these clauses refer to parts of the process of preparing a special meal for guests. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She has prepared a meal for guests by slaughtering her slaughter, mixing her wine, and arranging her table]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:2 (#1)

טָבְחָה טִבְחָהּ מָסְכָה יֵינָהּ אַף עָרְכָה שֻׁלְחָנָהּ

“She has slaughtered her slaughter, she has mixed her wine, also she has arranged her table”

In this verse, wisdom is spoken of as if it were a woman. See the discussion of such personification in the Chapter Introduction. Alternate translation: [It is as if wisdom were a woman who has slaughtered her slaughter, mixed her wine, and arranged her table]

See: Personification

Proverbs 9:2 (#3)

טָבְחָה טִבְחָהּ

“She has slaughtered her slaughter”

Here, **slaughter** refers to the animals that Wisdom has **slaughtered** so that their meat may be eaten at a meal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She has slaughtered the animals so that their meat may be eaten at the meal]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 9:2 (#5)

עָרְכָה שֻׁלְחָנָהּ

“she has arranged her table”

This phrase refers to putting the food and eating utensils on a table in order to prepare for a meal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she has prepared her table for people to eat a meal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:3 (#3)

עַל־גַּגַּפֵּי מְרֹמֵי

“on the tops of the heights of”

See how you translated the similar phrase “the head of the heights” in 8:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:3 (#2)

שָׁלְחָה נַעֲרֹתֶיהָ

“She has sent out her young women”

Solomon implies that the **young women** were **sent out** in order to invite people to the meal that Wisdom had prepared. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She has sent out her young women to invite people to the meal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:3 (#1)

שָׁלְחָה נַעֲרֹתֶיהָ תִּקְרָא

“She has sent out her young women; she calls out”

In this verse, wisdom is spoken of as if it were a wealthy woman who has servants and **calls out** in public. See the discussion of such personification in the Chapter Introduction. Alternate translation: [It is as if wisdom were a woman who has sent out her young women and calls out]

See: Personification

Proverbs 9:4 (#4)

חֲסַר־לֵבָב

“lacking of heart”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 7:7.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 9:4 (#2)

יָסֵר הֵנָּה

“let him turn aside here”

Here, Wisdom implies that the **naive** person should **turn aside** and come to her house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [let him leave his path and come to my house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:4 (#3)

יָסֵר & לוֹ

“let him turn aside & to him”

Although **him** is masculine, here it refers to any **naive** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [let that person turn aside ... to that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 9:4 (#1)

מִי־פֶתִי יָסֵר הֵנָּה חֲסַר־לֵב אָמְרָה לוֹ

“Whoever {is} naive, let him turn aside here,” she says to him lacking of heart”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [She says to him lacking of heart, “Whoever is naive, let him turn aside here.”]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 9:4–5 (#1)

מִי־פֶתִי יָסֵר הֵנָּה חֲסַר־לֵב אָמְרָה לוֹ: לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בָלַחֲמִי וּשְׁתוּ בְיַיִן מָסָכְתִּי

“Whoever {is} naive, let him turn aside here,” she says to him lacking of heart.“Come, eat my bread, and drink the wine I have mixed”

In these two verses, Wisdom speaks of people acquiring wisdom as they were turning **aside** from a path to enter Wisdom’s house, **eat** Wisdom’s **bread**, and **drink** Wisdom’s **wine**. Just as **bread** and **wine** are good and keep people alive, so wisdom also is good and something that enables people to live good lives. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the comparison. Alternate translation: [She says to him lacking of heart, “Whoever is naive, benefit your lives by acquiring wisdom. Doing so is like turning aside here, coming to me, eating my bread, and drinking the wine I have mixed]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

Proverbs 9:5 (#2)

לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ & וּשְׁתוּ

“Come, eat & and drink”

All three of these commands are plural because Wisdom is addressing all the “naive” people at the same time.

See: Forms of You

Proverbs 9:5 (#1)

בָלַחֲמִי

“my bread”

Here, **bread** is used to refer to food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 9:5 (#3)

בְיַיִן מָסָכְתִּי

“the wine I have mixed”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 9:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:6 (#3)

וְחָיִיו

“and live”

Here, **live** refers to living a life that is long and satisfying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and live a good, long life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:6 (#1)

עִזְבוּ & וְחָיִיו וְאִשְׁרוּ

“Forsake & and live; and stride”

All three of these commands are plural because Wisdom is addressing all the **naive** people at the same time.

See: Forms of You

Proverbs 9:6 (#5)

בִּינָה

“understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 9:6 (#4)

וְאִשְׁרוּ בְּדֶרֶךְ בִּינָה

“and stride on the way of understanding”

Here, Wisdom speaks of a people behaving in a manner that will enable them to acquire **understanding** as if they were striding on a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and behave in a manner that will enable you to acquire understanding]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:6 (#2)

וְחָיְיוּ

“and live”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is the purpose for doing what Wisdom commands people to do earlier in this verse. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of living]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 9:7 (#6)

לְרָשָׁע

“a wicked {one”

Wisdom is using the adjective **wicked** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [a wicked person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 9:7 (#4)

קָלְלֹון

“disgrace”

See how you translated the abstract noun **disgrace** in 6:33.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 9:7 (#1)

יֹסֵר ׀ לֵץ לֹקֵחַ לֹו קָלְלֹון וּמוֹכִיחַ לְרָשָׁע מוּמֹו

“The instructor of a mocker receives disgrace for himself, and the rebuker of a wicked {one}, his injury”

Here, the terms **The instructor**, **a mocker**, **himself**, **the rebuker**, **a wicked one**, and **his** do not refer to specific people, but refer to types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Any instructor of any mocker receives disgrace for that person, and any rebuker of any wicked one, that person’s injury]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 9:7 (#3)

לֹקֵחַ לֹו קָלְלֹון

“receives disgrace for himself”

Here, Wisdom speaks of **disgrace** as if it were an object that a person **receives**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will himself be disgraced]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:7 (#5)

וּמוֹכִיחַ לְרָשָׁע מוּמֹו

“and the rebuker of a wicked {one}, his injury”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the rebuker of a wicked one receives his injury]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 9:7 (#2)

יֹסֵר ׀ לֵץ

“The instructor of a mocker”

Since **a mocker** does not accept instruction, this phrase implies that someone attempted to be an **instructor of a mocker**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The one who attempts to instruct a mocker]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:7 (#7)

מוּמוֹ

“his injury”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **injury**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [becomes injured]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 9:8 (#4)

הוֹכַח לְחָכָם וְיֶאֱהָבֶךָּ

“rebuke a wise one, and he will love you”

The word **rebuke** is an imperative, but it communicates a condition under which something will happen, rather than a command. If it is helpful in your language, use a form that communicates a condition. Alternate translation: [if you rebuke a wise one, then he will love you]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 9:8 (#2)

לֵץ פֶּן־יִשְׂנָאֶךָּ & לְחָכָם וְיֶאֱהָבֶךָּ

“a mocker, lest he hate you & a wise one, and he will love you”

Here, **a mocker**, **he**, and **a wise one** do not refer to specific people, but refer to types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any mocker, lest that person hate you ... any wise one, and that person will love you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 9:8 (#3)

הוֹכַח לְחָכָם

“rebuke a wise one”

This clause says something that is in contrast to what was said in the previous clause. Use a natural way in your language to express a strong contrast. Alternate translation: [By contrast, rebuke a wise one]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 9:8 (#1)

אַל־תּוֹכַח

“Do not rebuke”

This clause states what Wisdom wants people to do as a result of what Wisdom said in the previous verse. Use the most natural way to express an intended result in your language. Alternate translation: [Therefore, do not rebuke]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 9:8 (#5)

וְיֶאֱהָבֶךָּ

“and he will love you”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [and it will result in him loving you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 9:9 (#2)

תֵּתֵּן & הוֹדַע

“Give & inform”

The words **Give** and **inform** are imperatives, but they communicate a condition under which something will happen, rather than a command. If it is helpful in your language, use a form that communicates a condition, as in the UST.

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 9:9 (#3)

לְחָכָם וְיֶחְכַּם־עוֹד & לְצַדִּיק וְיוֹסֵף

“to a wise {one}, and he will become more wise & a righteous {one}, and he will increase”

Here, **a wise one**, **he**, and **a righteous one** do not refer to specific people but refer to these types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to any wise one, and that person will become more wise ... any righteous one, and that person will increase]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 9:9 (#1)

תֵּתֵּן

“Give”

Wisdom is leaving out a word that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context. Alternate translation: [Give instruction] or [Give what is wise]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 9:10 (#2)

חָכְמָה & וְדַעַת & בִּינָה

“wisdom & and knowledge of & is} understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 9:10 (#1)

תְּחִלַּת

“The beginning of”

See how you translated the same use of **beginning** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 9:10 (#3)

יִרְאַת יְהוָה

“is} the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 9:11 (#2)

כִּי־בִי יִרְבּוּ יָמֶיךָ וְיוֹסִיפוּ לְּךָ שְׁנוֹת חַיִּים

“Indeed, by me your days will increase, and years of life will be added to you”

These two phrases mean very similar things. Wisdom is repeating the same idea with different words to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Indeed, by me you will live a lot longer]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 9:11 (#4)

וְיוֹסִיפוּ לְּךָ שְׁנוֹת חַיִּים

“and years of life will be added to you”

Here Wisdom speaks of people living for a long time as if the **years** that they are alive were something that could **be added** to their lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will live many more years]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:11 (#5)

שְׁנוֹת חַיִּים

“years of life”

See how you translated this idiom in 3:2.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 9:11 (#3)

יִרְבּוּ יָמֶיךָ

“your days will increase”

Here Wisdom speaks of people living for a long time as if the **days** that they are alive were something that could **increase** in number. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you will live many more days]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:11 (#6)

וְיוֹסִיפוּ לְּךָ

“and & will be added to you”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and ... I will add to you]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 9:11 (#1)

כִּי

“Indeed”

Indeed here indicates that Wisdom is emphasizing what follows in this verse. Use a connector in your language that makes that emphasis clear. Alternate translation: [Truly]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 9:12 (#1)

לְּךָ

“for yourself”

Here, **for** implies that being **wise** is for the benefit of the **wise** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for the benefit of yourself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:12 (#2)

לָבַדְךָ֣ תִשָּׂ֑א

“you alone will bear {it”

Here, Wisdom speaks of someone experiencing the consequences of one’s bad behavior as if **it** were a heavy object that one had to carry on one’s back. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you alone will experience the consequences]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:13 (#1)

אֵ֣שֶׁת כְּסִילוּת֮ הֹמִיָּה֒ פְּתַיּ֣וּת וּבַל־יָ֣דְעָ֔ה מָֽה

“The woman of stupidity {is} loud, naive, and she does not know anything”

The **woman of stupidity** is referred to from this verse through verse 18. Translate consistently according to which of the following options that you choose. This phrase could refer to: (1) a **woman** who is characterized by **stupidity**, in which case this phrase would refer to stupid women in general. Alternate translation: [A stupid woman is loud, naive, and she does not know anything] or [Stupid women are loud, naive, and do not know anything]; (2) **stupidity** as if it were a **woman**, which is how wisdom was spoken of in the previous part of this chapter. Alternate translation: [Lady Stupidity is loud, naive, and she does not know anything]

See: Possession

Proverbs 9:13 (#2)

וּבַל־יָ֣דְעָ֔ה מָֽה

“and she does not know anything”

This phrase is an exaggeration that Solomon uses to emphasize how ignorant this **woman** is. It does not mean that **she does not know anything** at all. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she does not know much] or [and she knows very little]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 9:14 (#1)

וַֽיָּשְׁבָ֗ה לְפֶ֣תַח בֵּיתָ֑הּ עַ֚ל־כִּסֵּ֣א מְרֳמֵ֔י קָרֶֽת

“And she sits at the opening of her house, on a seat {by} the heights of the city”

If you translated the phrase “woman of stupidity” as a plural form in the previous verse, then you should use plural forms in this verse. Alternate translation: [And they sit at the opening of their houses, on seats by the heights of the city]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 9:14 (#2)

לְפֶ֣תַח בֵּיתָ֑הּ

“at the opening of her house”

See how you translated this phrase in 5:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:14 (#4)

מְרֳמֵ֔י קָרֶֽת

“by} the heights of the city”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:3.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:14 (#3)

עַ֚ל־כִּסֵּ֣א

“on a seat”

This clause could refer to: (1) the specific location of **the opening of her house**. Alternate translation: [which is on a seat]; (2) a second location where **she sits**. Alternate translation: [or on a seat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:15 (#3)

הַֽמְיַשְּׁרִ֖ים אׇרְחוֹתָֽם

“the ones going straight {on} their paths”

This clause is an idiom that describes people who are only thinking of their own affairs. If this clause does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones minding their own business] or [the ones going about their own affairs]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 9:15 (#2)

לְעֹבְרֵ֥י־דָ֖רֶךְ

“to those who pass over the way”

Alternate translation: [to those walking by on the road]

Proverbs 9:15 (#1)

לִקְרֹ֣א

“to call”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose for the “woman of stupidity” sitting in a public place, as stated in the previous verse. Use a natural way in your language to express a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of calling]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 9:16 (#1)

מִי־פֶ֣תִי יָסֻ֣ר הֵ֭הֵנָּה וַחֲסַר־לֵ֣ב וְאָ֣מְרָה לּ֑וֹ

“Whoever {is} naive, let him turn aside here!” And she says to him, the lacking of heart”

See how you translated the nearly identical clauses in 9:4. If you are translating the “woman of stupidity” as a person, you could use her name here. Alternate translation: [Whoever is naive, let him turn aside here!” And Lady Stupidity says to him, the lacking of heart]

See: Personification

Proverbs 9:16 (#2)

מִי־פֶ֣תִי יָסֻ֣ר הֵ֭הֵנָּה וַחֲסַר־לֵ֣ב וְאָ֣מְרָה לּ֑וֹ

“Whoever {is} naive, let him turn aside here!” And she says to him, the lacking of heart”

If it is more natural in your language, you could put the introduction of the speaker first. Alternate translation: [And she says to him, the lacking of heart, “Whoever {is} naive, let him turn aside here]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 9:17 (#2)

מַ֭יִם־גְּנוּבִ֣ים יִמְתָּ֑קוּ וְלֶ֥חֶם סְ֝תָרִ֗ים יִנְעָֽם

“Stolen waters are sweet, and bread of secrecies is pleasant”

In this verse, the foolish woman refers to the pleasure of having sex with someone to whom one is not married as if it were as **sweet** as **stolen waters** or as **pleasant** as **bread of secrecies**. Water and food are also used as euphemisms for sexual activity in 5:15–19 and 30:20. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile: “Having sex with me is truly enjoyable” or “Having sex with me is as enjoyable as drinking stolen waters or eating bread of secrecies”

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:17 (#3)

וְלֶ֥חֶם סְ֝תָרִ֗ים

“and bread of secrecies”

The phrase **bread of secrecies** could refer to: (1) **bread** that a person secretly eats by himself. Alternate translation: [and bread that is eaten in secrecy]; (2) **bread** that one obtains through secret deeds, which implies stealing the **bread**. Alternate translation: [and bread obtained secretly] or [and stolen bread]

See: Possession

Proverbs 9:17 (#1)

מַ֭יִם־גְּנוּבִ֣ים יִמְתָּ֑קוּ

“Stolen waters are sweet”

The stupid woman implies that what she says in this verse is the reason why the “naive” should “turn aside” to her. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Turn aside here because stolen waters are sweet]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 9:18 (#3)

קְרֻאֶ֗יהָ

“her called ones”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the ones whom she called]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 9:18 (#2)

רְפָאִ֥ים שֵָׁ֝֗ם

“the spirits of the dead {are} there”

Here Solomon speaks of those men who died because they went to the stupid woman’s house as if their dead **spirits** were **there**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that the men who have gone to her house are now dead]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:18 (#4)

קְרֻאֶ֗יהָ

“her called ones”

This phrase refers to the men who went to the stupid woman's house to commit adultery with her in response to her calling them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the men whom she called and they accepted her call] or [the men who went to her house after she called them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:18 (#1)

וְלֹא־יָדַע

"But he does not know"

Here, **he** refers to any naive man to whom the stupid woman calls. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [But any naive man does not know]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 10 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Outline of Proverbs 10
General proverbs from Solomon contrasting the benefits of being righteous and wise with the trouble that comes to those who are wicked and foolish (10:1–32)

Chapter 10 starts a new section of the book, which is mainly filled with short, individual proverbs that were written by Solomon (10:1–22:16).

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism
Except for 10:10, 18, 22, and 26, all the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Generic use of "righteous" and "wicked"
These proverbs often contrast the behavior of righteous people and wicked people. They usually refer to all righteous people simply as "the righteous" or "a righteous one." In the same way, these proverbs often refer to all wicked people by saying, "the wicked" or "a wicked one." Use a natural expression in your language that refers to any people who can be described in this way.

Proverbs 10:1 (#3)

אָבִ֑יו

"a father"

Here, **father** refers specifically to the **father** of the **son** mentioned earlier in the sentence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:1 (#1)

מִשְׁלֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

"The proverbs of Solomon"

See how you translated this phrase in 1:1.

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:1 (#2)

בֵּ֣ן חָ֭כָם יְשַׂמַּח־אָ֑ב וּבֵ֥ן כְּ֝סִ֗יל תּוּגַ֥ת אִמּֽוֹ

"A wise son gladdens a father, but a stupid son {is} the grief of his mother"

Although the terms **son** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [Any wise person gladdens that person's father, but any stupid person is the grief of that person's mother]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 10:1 (#4)

תּוּגַ֥ת אִמּֽוֹ

"is} the grief of his mother"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grief**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [grieves his mother]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:2 (#3)

וּצְדָקָ֥ה & מִמָּֽוֶת

"but righteousness & from death"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness** in 1:3 and **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:2 (#2)

לֹא־יוֹעִ֑ילוּ

"do not profit"

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the con-

text if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [do not profit those who possess them]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:2 (#4)

תַּצִּ֣יל

“delivers”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [delivers a person]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:2 (#1)

אוֹצְרוֹת֙ רֶ֣שַׁע

“Treasures of wickedness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **Treasures** that someone gained by **wickedness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Treasures gained in wicked ways] or [Treasures obtained by wicked means]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:3 (#2)

וַיְהַדֹּ֖ף

“he thrusts away”

Here Solomon speaks of **Yahweh** preventing **the wicked ones** from getting what they **desire** as if that **desire** were an object that **Yahweh thrusts away**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he denies]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:3 (#1)

נֶ֣פֶשׁ צַדִּ֑יק

“the life of the righteous”

Here **life** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the righteous person]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 10:4 (#3)

רָ֭אָשׁ עֹשָׂ֣ה & תַּעֲשִׁ֑יר

“makes poverty & makes rich”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [makes the person poor ... makes the person rich]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:4 (#2)

רָ֭אָשׁ

“poverty”

See how you translated the abstract noun **poverty** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:4 (#1)

כַּף־רְמִיָּ֣ה וְיַ֣ד חָרוּצִ֑ים

“A palm of idleness & but the hand of the diligent ones”

Here, **palm** and **hand** represent the whole person, who works by using a **palm** or **hand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A person unwilling to work ... but a person who works diligently]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 10:5 (#2)

אֹגֵ֣ר בַּבַּ֭קָּיִץ & בַּ֣קָּצִ֑יר

“One who gathers in the summer & in the harvest”

In the location where this book was written, **summer** is the time of year when people **harvest** crops. See how you translated the same use of **gathers**, **summer**, and **harvest** in 6:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:5 (#3)

אֹגֵ֣ר

“One who gathers”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [One who gathers food]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:5 (#1)

אֹגֵר & נִרְדָּם

“One who gathers & but one who sleeps”

One who gathers and **one who sleeps** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who gathers ... but any person who sleeps]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:5 (#4)

מַשְׂכִּיל

“who has insight”

See how you translated the abstract noun **insight** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:6 (#2)

וּפִי רְשָׁעִים

“but the mouth of the wicked”

Here, **mouth** refers to what **the wicked** say with their mouths. Alternate translation: [but the speech of the wicked ones]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:6 (#3)

יְכַסֶּה

“covers”

Here, Solomon refers to someone concealing **violence** as if it were an object that someone **covers**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [conceals]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:6 (#4)

חָמָס

“violence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **violence** in 3:31.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:6 (#1)

לְרֹאשׁ צַדִּיק

“are} for the head of the righteous”

Here, **head** represents the whole person. In Solomon’s culture people would place their hands on top of the **head** of the person whom they were blessing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are given to the righteous person]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 10:7 (#5)

וְשֵׁם

“but the name of”

Here, **name** refers to a person’s reputation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the reputation of] or [but what people think of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:7 (#6)

יִרְקָב

“will rot”

Here Solomon speaks of people forgetting **the name of the wicked ones** as if that **name** is an object that rots and disappears. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [will be forgotten] or [will be forgotten like something that rots away]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:7 (#2)

צַדִּיק

“the righteous one”

Although **righteous one** here is singular, it refers to all **righteous** people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [any righteous person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:7 (#4)

וְשֵׁם

“but the name of”

Although **name** here is singular, it refers to the names of all the **wicked ones** in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but the names of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:7 (#3)

לִבְרָכָֽה

“is} for a blessing”

This phrase indicates that people will be blessed when they remember **the righteous one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will be a blessing to others] or [will bless others]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:7 (#1)

זֵ֣כֶר צַדִּ֣יק לִבְרָכָ֑ה

“The memory of the righteous one {is} for a blessing”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **memory** that other people have about **the righteous one**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [The righteous one will be remembered as a blessing]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:8 (#6)

יִלָּ֑בֵט

“will be thrown down”

Here Solomon refers to a person’s life becoming ruined or destroyed as if that person were **thrown down** on the ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be destroyed] or [will be made useless]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:8 (#1)

חֲכַם־לֵ֭בָב

“The one wise of heart”

This phrase refers to a person who thinks wisely. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A wise thinker]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:8 (#4)

וְאֱוִ֥יל שִׂ֝שְׂפָתַ֗יִם

“but the one stupid of lips”

Here, **the one stupid of lips** refers to someone who speaks foolishly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar expression in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but a chattering fool] or [but one who speaks stupidly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:8 (#2)

יִקַּ֥ח מִצְוֹ֑ת

“receives commands”

Here Solomon refers to obeying **commands** as if they were objects that a person **receives**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [obeys commands]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:8 (#3)

מִצְוֹ֑ת

“commands”

Solomon implies that **wise** people obey **commands** to do good things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [commands to do good things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:8 (#5)

יִלָּ֑בֵט

“will be thrown down”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will throw themselves down]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 10:9 (#2)

יֵלֵ֣ךְ בֶּ֭בֶטַח

“will walk securely”

See how you translated a similar use of **walk** in 3:23.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:9 (#1)

הוֹלֵ֣ךְ בְּתֻמּ֑וֹ

“One who walks with integrity”

See how you translated the similar phrase “walking with integrity” in 2:7.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:9 (#3)

וּמְעַקֵּשׁ דְּרָכָיו

“but one who causes his ways to be crooked”

See how you translated the similar use of “paths” and **crooked** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:9 (#4)

יִוָּדֵעַ

“will be known”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will know] or [God will know]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 10:9 (#5)

יִוָּדֵעַ

“will be known”

Here, **known** refers to the **one who causes his ways to be crooked** being discovered or found out. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will be discovered] or [will be found out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:10 (#2)

יִתֵּתֵן עַצָּבֶת

“gives pain”

Here Solomon speaks of causing people to feel **pain** or grief as if **pain** were an object that someone **gives** to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes pain]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:10 (#3)

וֶאֱוִיל שְׂפָתַיִם יִלָּבֵט

“and the one foolish of lips will be thrown down”

See how you translated the nearly identical clause in 10:8.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:10 (#1)

קֹרֵץ עַיִן

“One who winks an eye”

See how you translated a similar phrase is 6:13.

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 10:11 (#4)

צַדִּיק

“the righteous one”

The phrase **the righteous one** represents all righteous people in general, not one particular righteous person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any righteous person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:11 (#2)

מְקוֹר חַיִּים

“A fountain of life”

Here Solomon is speaking of **the mouth of the righteous one** as if it were a **fountain of life**. He means that what a **righteous** person says is beneficial to the **life** of that person and to others’ lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Something that benefits people’s lives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:11 (#1)

מְקוֹר חַיִּים

“A fountain of life”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **fountain** that gives **life**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A fountain that gives life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:11 (#3)

פִּי

“is} the mouth of”

In this verse, **mouth** refers to what a person says by using his **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the speech of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:11 (#5)

וּפִ֥י רְשָׁעִ֗ים יְכַסֶּ֥ה חָמָֽס

“but the mouth of the wicked ones covers violence”

See how you translated the identical clause in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:12 (#2)

וְעַ֗ל כָּל־פְּשָׁעִ֥ים תְּכַסֶּ֥ה אַהֲבָֽה

“but love covers over all transgressions”

Here Solomon speaks of **love** as if it were a living thing that could cover over **transgressions**. He means that people who love forgive **transgressions**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but loving others causes one to forgive transgressions]

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:12 (#1)

שִׂנְאָ֣ה תְעוֹרֵ֣ר מְדָנִ֑ים

“Hatred stirs up quarrels”

Here Solomon speaks of **Hatred** as if it were a living thing that could cause **quarrels**. He means that people who hate others cause such **quarrels**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Being hateful causes one to stir up quarrels]

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:12 (#3)

פְּשָׁעִֽים

“transgressions”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **transgressions**, you could express the same idea in another way. Here, **transgressions** refers to crimes committed against people. Alternate translation: [kinds of things that people do to harm others]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:13 (#3)

חָכְמָ֣ה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:13 (#5)

חֲסַר־לֵֽב

“the one lacking of heart”

See how you translated **lacking of heart** in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:13 (#4)

וְשֵׁ֖בֶט לְגֵ֣ו

“but a rod {is} for the back of”

The phrase **a rod is for the back** refers to a form of punishment that involved beating a person on **the back** with a **rod**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a general expression for physical punishment. Alternate translation: [but physical punishment is for]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:13 (#1)

בְּשִׂפְתֵ֣י נָ֭בוֹן

“On the lips of the discerning one”

Here Solomon refers to what a **discerning** person says as if it were an object on that person’s **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In what a discerning person says]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:13 (#2)

תִּמָּצֵ֣א חָכְמָ֑ה

“wisdom is found”

Here Solomon refers to the existence of **wisdom** as if it were an object that could be found. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wisdom exists] or [there is wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:14 (#1)

יִצְפְּנ֣וּ

“store up”

See how you translated the same use of **store up** in 2:1.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:14 (#3)

וּפִי

“but the mouth of”

See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 10:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:14 (#4)

מְחִתָּתָה קְרֹבָה

“is} near ruin”

Here Solomon speaks of what a **fool** says causing **ruin** as if that fool’s **mouth** was **near ruin**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes ruin]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:14 (#2)

דָּעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:15 (#2)

קִרְיַת עֻזּוֹ

“is} the city of his strength”

Here Solomon refers to **wealth** enabling its owners to be safe as if it were a strong **city** that protects them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is his protection]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:15 (#4)

דַּלִּים

“lowly ones”

The phrase **lowly ones** refers to poor people as if they were located in a place that is lower than that of people who are not poor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people who are poor]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:15 (#1)

קִרְיַת עֻזּוֹ

“is} the city of his strength”

The phrase **city of his strength** is an idiom that refers to a **city** with walls that protect the people inside the **city**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is a walled city] or [is a city with strong walls]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:15 (#5)

רֵישָׁם

“is} their poverty”

See how you translated the abstract noun **poverty** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:15 (#3)

מְחִתַּת דַּלִּים רֵישָׁם

“the ruin of lowly ones {is} their poverty”

This clause is in strong contrast to the previous clause. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [by contrast, the ruin of lowly ones is their poverty]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 10:16 (#4)

לְחַיִּים

“is} to life”

Here, **life** refers to both living well and living long. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is to a good, long life] or [is to living happily for a long time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:16 (#7)

לְחַטָּאת

“is} to sin”

Here, **sin** could refer to: (1) the punishment that someone receives for **sin**, which is suggested by the contrasting parallelism between this clause and the previous clause. Alternate translation: [is punishment

for sin]; (2) **sin** itself. Alternate translation: [is to sin more]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:16 (#3)

לְחַיִּים & לְחַטָּאת

“is} to life & is} to sin”

In this verse, the phrase **is to** indicates that what follows is the result of what was previously stated. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [leads to life ... leads to sin] or [results in life ... results in sin]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 10:16 (#2)

צַדִּיק & רָשָׁע

“a righteous {one & a wicked {one”

The phrases **the righteous one** and **the wicked one** represent types of people in general, not one particular **righteous one** or **wicked one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any righteous person ... any wicked person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:16 (#5)

תְּבוּאַת רָשָׁע לְחַטָּאת

“the income of a wicked {one} {is} to sin”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, the income of the wicked one is to sin]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 10:16 (#6)

תְּבוּאַת

“the income of”

Here Solomon speaks of the recompense or punishment that **the wicked one** receives as if it were **income**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the recompense for]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:16 (#1)

פְּעֻלַּת

“The wage of”

Here Solomon speaks of the reward that **the righteous one** receives as if it were a **wage** that someone pays. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The reward for]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:17 (#2)

אֹרַח לְחַיִּים שֹׁמֵר מוּסָר

“On} a path to life {is} one who keeps instruction”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One who keeps instruction is on a path to life]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 10:17 (#1)

אֹרַח

“On} a path”

See how you translated the same use of **path** in 8:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:17 (#3)

לְחַיִּים

“to life”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the result of keeping **instruction**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [that leads to life] or [that results in life]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 10:17 (#4)

מוּסָר & תּוֹכַחַת

“instruction & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **instruction** in 1:2 and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:17 (#6)

מַתְעֶה

“goes astray”

Here Solomon refers to someone deliberately doing wicked things that will result in that person’s destruction as if that person were wandering away from a

good road. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [does what will result in that person's destruction]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:17 (#5)

וְעֹזֵ֖ב

"but one who forsakes"

See how you translated the same use of "forsake" in 1:8.

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:18 (#2)

שִׂפְתֵי־שָׁ֣קֶר

"has} lips of falsehood"

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **lips** that are characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [has lips that speak falsely]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:18 (#4)

הֹוֵ֑א

"he"

Although the term **he** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to either a man or woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 10:18 (#3)

שִׂפְתֵי

"has} lips of"

Here, **lips** refers to what people say by moving their **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [speaks]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:18 (#1)

מְכַסֶּ֥ה

"One who covers"

See how you translated the same use of **covers** in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:19 (#3)

לֹ֣א יֶחְדַּ֑ל

"does not cease"

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression, **cease**, that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the positive meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [piles up] or [multiplies]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 10:19 (#1)

בְּרֹ֣ב דְּ֭בָרִים

"With a multitude of words"

Here Solomon implies that someone is speaking **a multitude of words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When someone speaks a multitude of words]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:19 (#4)

וְחֹשֵׂ֖ךְ שְׂפָתָ֣יו

"but one who restrains his lips"

This phrase is an idiom that refers to someone who stops himself from speaking. If it would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who keeps his mouth shut] or [but one who prevents himself from speaking]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:19 (#2)

פֶּ֣שַׁע

"transgression"

See how you translated "transgressions" in 10:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:20 (#3)

לְשׁ֣וֹן צַדִּ֣יק

"is} the tongue of the righteous one"

See how you translated **the righteous one** in 10:16.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:20 (#5)

לֵ֫ב

“the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:20 (#1)

כֶּ֭סֶף נִבְחָר

“Choice silver”

Here Solomon speaks of the value of what righteous people say as if it were the best quality **silver**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Extremely valuable] or [Like choice silver]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:20 (#6)

כִּמְעָט

“is} like little”

Here, **like little** refers to having **little** value. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has little value] or [is not valuable]

See: Simile

Proverbs 10:20 (#2)

לְשׁ֣וֹן

“is} the tongue of”

See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:20 (#4)

לֵ֣ב רְ֭שָׁעִים כִּמְעָט

“the heart of the wicked ones {is} like little”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, the heart of the wicked ones is like little]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 10:21 (#2)

צַדִּ֑יק

“the righteous one”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:16.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:21 (#1)

שִׂפְתֵ֣י

“The lips of”

Here, **lips** refers to what people say by moving their **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The sayings of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:21 (#5)

לֵ֣ב

“heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:21 (#4)

בַּ֝חֲסַר־לֵ֗ב יָמֽוּתוּ

“die by lack of heart”

Here, **by** indicates that what follows is the reason why **fools die**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a reason. Alternate translation: [die as a result of lacking heart]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 10:21 (#3)

יִרְעוּ

“shepherd”

Here Solomon speaks of what **righteous** people say benefitting people as if their words were guiding the hearers the way that a shepherd guides sheep. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [guide]

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:22 (#1)

וְלֹא־יוֹסִ֣ף עֶ֭עָצֶב עִמָּֽהּ

“and striving does not add {more} with it”

The word translated as **striving** has a broad meaning. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT. It can mean: (1) "excessively hard work." Alternate translation: [and toil does not add to it] or [and hard work does not add more riches to it]; (2) "pain." In this interpretation, Yahweh would be the subject of the phrase **does not add** and "pain" would be the object. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh does not add pain to it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:23 (#1)

כִּשְׂחֹק לִכְסִיל עֲשׂוֹת זִמָּה

"Like laughter for a stupid one {is} doing a wicked plan"

Solomon is saying that **doing a wicked plan** is like **laughter** because **a stupid one** enjoys it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [For a stupid one, doing a wicked plan is as much fun as laughing]

See: Simile

Proverbs 10:23 (#2)

וְחָכְמָה לְאִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

"but wisdom, for a man of understanding"

Solomon is leaving out some of the words in this clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but wisdom is like laughter for a man of understanding]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:23 (#3)

וְחָכְמָה & תְּבוּנָה

"but wisdom & understanding"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:23 (#5)

לְאִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

"for a man of understanding"

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **understanding**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [for an understanding man] or [for a person who has understanding]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:23 (#4)

לְאִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

"for a man of understanding"

Although **man** is masculine, here it refers to any person with **understanding**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for a person of understanding]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 10:24 (#4)

יִתֵּן

"will be given"

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [will be given to them]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:24 (#5)

יִתֵּן

"will be given"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will give]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 10:24 (#2)

רָשָׁע הִיא תְבוֹאֶנּוּ

"the wicked one, it will come to him"

In this verse, **the wicked one** and **him** refer to **wicked** people in general. See how you translated **the wicked one** in 3:33. Alternate translation: [any wicked person, it will come to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:24 (#1)

מְגוֹרַת

“The terror of”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **terror**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [That which terrifies]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:24 (#3)

הִהָיא תְּבוֹאֶֽנּוּ

“it will come to him”

Here Solomon speaks of someone experiencing **terror** as if **terror** were a living thing that could **come** to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it will happen to him]

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:25 (#4)

רָשָׁ֑ע

“wicked”

Solomon is using the adjective **wicked** as a noun to mean wicked people in general. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [wicked person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 10:25 (#3)

וְאֵ֣ין רָשָׁ֑ע

“then there is no {more} wicked”

Here Solomon implies that the **whirlwind** blew away every **wicked one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and there is no wicked one because the whirlwind blew them away]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:25 (#2)

וְאֵ֣ין רָשָׁ֑ע

“then there is no {more} wicked”

The word translated **then** here indicates that the event it introduces took place as a result of the event stated in the previous clause. Use a natural form in your language for introducing an event that is the result of another event. Alternate translation: [it results in there being no more wicked]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 10:25 (#6)

יְסֽוֹד עוֹלָֽם

“is} a foundation of eternity”

Here Solomon refers to **a righteous one** being able to endure disasters as if that person were the **foundation** of a building that storms do not damage. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [endures to eternity] or [remains forever]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:25 (#7)

יְסֽוֹד עוֹלָֽם

“is} a foundation of eternity”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **foundation** that lasts to **eternity**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is an eternal foundation] or [is a foundation that lasts to eternity]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:25 (#1)

כַּעֲבֹ֣ר סוּפָ֑ה

“When a whirlwind passes over”

Here, **whirlwind** could refer to: (1) any destructive event. Alternate translation: [At the occurring of a disaster] or [When a disaster occurs]; (2) a storm. Alternate translation: [When a storm occurs]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:25 (#5)

וְ֝צַדִּ֗יק

“but a righteous one”

Solomon is speaking of **righteous** people in general, not of one particular **righteous** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [but any righteous person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:26 (#3)

לִשְׁלְחָֽיו

“to one who sends him”

Here Solomon implies that **the lazy one** was sent to do some errand for the person who sent him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to one who sends him to do an errand]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:26 (#2)

הֶֽעָצֵ֥ל לְשֹׁלְחָֽיו

“is} the lazy one to one who sends him”

In this verse, **the lazy one** and **him** refer to **lazy** people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [is any lazy person to one who sends that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:26 (#1)

כַּחֹ֣מֶץ ׀ לַשִּׁנַּ֗יִם וְכָעָשָׁ֥ן לָעֵינָֽיִם

“Like vinegar to the teeth and smoke to the eyes”

Solomon is saying that **the lazy one** is like **vinegar to the teeth and smoke to the eyes** because **vinegar** irritates **teeth** and **smoke** irritates **eyes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Like vinegar is irritating to teeth and smoke is irritating to eyes]

See: Simile

Proverbs 10:27 (#4)

תּוֹסִ֣יף יָ֭מִים

“will add days”

Here, **days** represents years that are made up of days. It does not imply a shorter amount of life than is meant by **years** in the next clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will add days upon days] or [will add years]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:27 (#1)

יִרְאַ֣ת יְ֭הוָה

“The fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated the **fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:27 (#3)

תּוֹסִ֣יף יָ֭מִים

“will add days”

Here Solomon implies that **days** are added to the length of a person’s life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will add days to the length of a person’s life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:27 (#5)

וּשְׁנ֖וֹת רְשָׁעִ֣ים

“but the years of the wicked ones”

Here Solomon uses **years** to refer to the length of time that a person lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the lifetimes of the wicked ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:27 (#2)

יִרְאַ֣ת יְ֭הוָה תּוֹסִ֣יף יָ֭מִים

“The fear of Yahweh will add days”

Here Solomon speaks as if the **fear of Yahweh** were a person who could **add days** to a person’s life. He means that by fearing **Yahweh**, a person will live a long life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [By fearing Yahweh, the days of a person’s life will increase]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:28 (#2)

שִׂמְחָ֣ה

“is} joy”

Here the thing that **the righteous ones hope** for is referred to by what it produces, which is **joy**. Alternate translation: [results in joy] or [brings joy]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:28 (#3)

וְתִקְוַ֖ת רְשָׁעִ֣ים תֹּאבֵֽד

“but the expectation of the wicked ones will perish”

Here Solomon speaks of **the wicked ones** having unfulfilled expectations as if their **expectation will perish**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the expectation of the wicked ones will remain unfulfilled]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:28 (#1)

תּוֹחֶלֶת & שִׂמְחָה

“The hope of & is} joy”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **hope** and **joy**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [What is hoped for by ... is what is joyful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:29 (#3)

דֶּרֶךְ יְהוָה

“is} the way of Yahweh”

Here, **the way of Yahweh** refers to the righteous way that Yahweh teaches people to live. This is the “way of wisdom” that Solomon speaks of in 4:11. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is living by Yahweh’s instruction]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:29 (#4)

וּמְחִתָּה

“but ruin”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. The **way of Yahweh** causes ruin for **doers of iniquity** because they walk on a different path, as in 4:14. Alternate translation: [but the way of Yahweh causes ruin]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:29 (#2)

לַתֹּם & אָוֶן

“for the one with integrity & iniquity”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **integrity** in 1:3 and **iniquity** in 6:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:29 (#1)

מָעוֹז

“A stronghold”

Here Solomon refers to **the way of Yahweh** protecting people as if it were a **stronghold**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Protection]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:30 (#1)

צַדִּיק

“A righteous one”

See how you translated the same phrase in 9:9.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:30 (#3)

אֶרֶץ

“the land”

See how you translated the same use of **the land** in 2:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:30 (#2)

בַּל־יִמּוֹט

“will not falter”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the positive meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [will remain secure]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 10:31 (#1)

פִּי־צַדִּיק

“The mouth of the righteous one”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:31 (#3)

וּלְשׁוֹן

“but the tongue of”

See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:31 (#4)

תִּכָּרֵֽת

“will be cut off”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will cut off]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 10:31 (#5)

תִּכָּרֵֽת

“will be cut off”

Here Solomon speaks of **the perverse ones** not being permitted to speak as if someone **cut off** their tongues. This does not mean that someone would literally **cut off** their tongues; it simply means that they will be stopped. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not be allowed to speak] or [will be stopped]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:31 (#2)

יָנוּב חָכְמָֽה

“bears the fruit of wisdom”

Here Solomon refers to a **righteous** person saying wise things as if his **mouth** were a plant that **bears wisdom** as a **fruit**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [speaks wisdom] or [speaks wisdom like a plant bears fruit]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:32 (#1)

שִׂפְתֵי צַדִּיק

“The lips of the righteous one”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:21.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:32 (#2)

יֵדְעוּן רָצ֑וֹן

“know favor”

Here Solomon speaks of a **righteous** person saying pleasing things as if that person’s **lips** were people who **know favor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [express favor]

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:32 (#4)

וּפִי רְשָׁעִים תַּהְפֻּכֽוֹת

“but the mouth of the wicked ones, perverse things”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but the mouth of the wicked ones speaks perverse things] or [but the mouth of the wicked ones expresses perverse things]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:32 (#3)

רָצ֑וֹן

“favor”

See how you translated **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:32 (#5)

וּפִי רְשָׁעִים

“but the mouth of the wicked ones”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs - Chapter 11 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 11 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs. These proverbs continue to contrast the benefits of being righteous and wise with the trouble that comes to those who are wicked and foolish (11:1–31).

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism
Except for 11:7, 10, 22, 25, and 11:29–31, all the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Proverbs 11:1 (#5)

וְאֶ֣בֶן שְׁלֵמָ֑ה

“but a whole stone”

Here, **whole stone** refers to a **stone** people use as a standard weight on a pair of **Scales** that accurately weighs the **whole** amount that people expect it to weigh. Merchants could deceive and cheat their customers by using a stone that was not the correct weight. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but an accurate weight] or [but a stone that weighs the correct weight]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 11:1 (#1)

מֹאזְנֵ֣י מִרְמָ֔ה תּוֹעֲבַ֖ת & וְאֶ֣בֶן שְׁלֵמָ֑ה

“Scales of deceit {are} an abomination to & but a whole stone”

Solomon does not mean that **Yahweh** actually hates these **Scales** or has **delight** in this **whole stone**. Rather, he means that **Yahweh** hates it when people use these **Scales** and has **delight** when people use **a whole stone**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The use of scales of deceit is an abomination to … but the use of a whole stone]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:1 (#6)

רְצוֹנֽוֹ

“is} his delight”

See how you translated the abstract noun **delight** in 8:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:1 (#2)

מֹאזְנֵ֣י מִרְמָ֔ה

“Scales of deceit”

Scales describes an instrument for determining the weight of an object or comparing the weight of two objects. It consists of a central post with a crossbar from which two pans are hung. An object may be placed in one pan and known weights placed in the other pan until the crossbar remains level, indicating that both pans contain an equal weight. Or one object may be placed in one pan and a different object in the other pan; the pan that hangs lower contains the heavier object. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of weighing instrument, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a balancing scale of deceit] or [a weighing instrument of deceit]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 11:1 (#4)

תּוֹעֲבַ֖ת יְהוָֽה

“are} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated **an abomination to Yahweh** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:1 (#3)

מֹאזְנֵ֣י מִרְמָ֔ה

“Scales of deceit”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **Scales** that are used for **deceit**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Scales used to deceive people] or [Scales people use to deceive others]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:2 (#4)

קָלְל֑וֹן & חָכְמָֽה

“disgrace & is} wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **disgrace** in 6:33 and **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:2 (#1)

בָּ֣א־זָ֭דוֹן וַיָּבֹ֣א קָלְל֑וֹן

“When presumptuousness comes, then disgrace comes”

Here Solomon speaks of a person acting with **presumptuousness** and experiencing **disgrace** as if **presumptuousness** and **disgrace** were living things that come to someone. If it would be helpful in your lan-

guage, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When someone acts with presumptuousness, then that person experiences disgrace]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:2 (#3)

וַיָּבֹא קָלָלוֹן

“then disgrace comes”

The word translated **then** at the beginning of this phrase indicates that this event happens after the event described in the previous phrase. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the next event in a sequence of events. Alternate translation: [disgrace comes afterward]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Proverbs 11:2 (#2)

בָּא־זָדוֹן

“When presumptuousness comes”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **presumptuousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [When a person is presumptuous]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:3 (#4)

וְסֶלֶף

“but the crookedness of”

See how you translated a similar use of “crooked” in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:3 (#2)

תֻּמַּת

“The integrity of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:3 (#3)

וְסֶלֶף בּוֹגְדִים ושדם

“but the crookedness of the treacherous ones will destroy them”

Here Solomon speaks of **crookedness** as if it were a living thing that could **destroy** a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. Alternate translation: [but when treacherous ones act with crookedness, doing so will destroy them] or [but the crookedness of the treacherous ones is like a person who destroys them]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:3 (#1)

תֻּמַּת יְשָׁרִים תַּנְחֵם

“The integrity of the upright ones will guide them”

Here Solomon speaks of **integrity** as if it were a living thing that could **guide** a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [When upright ones act with integrity, doing so will enable them to know what to do] or [The integrity of the upright ones is like a guide for them]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:4 (#3)

בְּיוֹם עֶבְרָה

“in the day of rage”

Here, **the day of rage** refers to any time when God punishes wicked people. It does not necessarily refer to the final Judgment Day. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [when Yahweh punishes wicked people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:4 (#2)

לֹא־יוֹעִיל

“will not profit”

See how you translated the same use of **profit** in 3:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:4 (#5)

וּצְדָקָה & מִמָּוֶת

“but righteousness & from death”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness** in 1:3 and **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:4 (#4)

וּצְדָקָה תַּצִּיל מִמָּוֶת

“but righteousness will deliver from death”

Here Solomon speaks of **righteousness** enabling a person to escape **death** as if **righteousness** were a living thing that could **deliver** that person **from death**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but righteousness will enable someone to be delivered from death] or [but righteousness is like someone who delivers a person from death]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:4 (#1)

לֹא־יוֹעִ֣יל הׇ֭הוֹן בְּי֣וֹם עֶבְרָ֑ה וּ֝צְדָקָ֗ה תַּצִּ֥יל מִמָּֽוֶת

“Wealth will not profit in the day of rage, but righteousness will deliver from death”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages both of these clauses would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Wealth will not profit you in the day of rage, but righteousness will deliver you from death] or [Wealth will not profit people in the day of rage, but righteousness will deliver people from death]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:5 (#4)

תְּיַשֵּׁ֖שֶׁר דַּרְכּ֣וֹ

“will make his way straight”

Here Solomon refers to enabling someone to live without bad things happening to him as making that person’s **way straight**. It is a comparison of a person’s life to a path, and righteousness keeps the path from having twists and turns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar idea in 3:6. Alternate translation: [will cause that person to avoid bad things in life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:5 (#1)

צְדָקַ֣ת & וּ֭בְרִשְׁעָתּ֣וֹ

“The righteousness of & but by his wickedness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness** in 1:3 and **wickedness** in 4:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:5 (#5)

רָשָׁ֗ע

“a wicked one”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:5 (#6)

יִפֹּֽל

“will fall”

Here Solomon speaks of someone experiencing disaster as if that person were falling down. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will experience disaster]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:5 (#2)

תָּ֝מִֽים

“a blameless one”

The phrase **a blameless one** represents **blameless** people in general, not one particular **blameless one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any blameless person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:5 (#3)

תָּ֝מִֽים

“a blameless one”

Here, **a blameless one** refers to someone whom Yahweh does not blame for acting wickedly. See how you translated the same use of “blameless ones” in 2:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:6 (#3)

יְשָׁרִ֣ים & בֹּגְדִ֣ים

“the upright & treacherous {ones”

Solomon is using the adjectives **upright** and **treacherous** as nouns to mean people who are upright and treacherous. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate these words with a equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [upright people ... treacherous people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 11:6 (#4)

יִלָּכְדוּ

“they will be captured”

The pronoun **they** here refers to **the treacherous ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those treacherous ones will be captured]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 11:6 (#2)

צִדְקַ֣ת יְ֭שָׁרִים תַּצִּילֵ֑ם

“The righteousness of the upright will deliver them”

Here Solomon speaks of **righteousness** enabling a person to escape something as if **righteousness** were a person who could **deliver** that person from harm. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated a similar expression in 11:4. Alternate translation: [The righteousness of the upright ones will enable them to be delivered] or [The righteousness of the upright ones is like someone who delivers them]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:6 (#1)

צִדְקַ֣ת

“The righteousness of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **righteousness** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:6 (#5)

יִלָּכְדוּ

“they will be captured”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they will end up in captivity]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 11:7 (#3)

תֹּאבַ֣ד תִּקְוָ֣ה

“expectation will perish”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **expectation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he can no longer expect anything good]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:7 (#5)

וְתוֹחֶ֖לֶת

“and the hope of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **hope** in 10:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:7 (#4)

תֹּאבַ֣ד & אָ֑בָדָה

“will perish & perishes”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **expectation** and **hope** remaining unfulfilled as if they were living things that could **perish**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. Alternate translation: [will remain unfulfilled ... remains unfulfilled] or [will be like someone who perishes ... is like someone who perishes]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:7 (#6)

אוֹנִ֗ים

“strength”

Here, **strength** could refer to: (1) people who rely on their own strength to get what they hope for. Alternate translation: [those who rely on their own strength]; (2) people who rely on their wealth to get what they hope for. Alternate translation: [those who rely on their wealth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:7 (#2)

אָדָ֥ם רָ֝שָׁ֗ע

“a wicked man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a wicked person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 11:7 (#1)

בְּמ֣וֹת אָדָ֣ם רָ֭שָׁע

“At the death of a wicked man”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **death**, you could express the same idea

in another way. Alternate translation: [When a wicked man dies]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:8 (#5)

וְיָבֹא רָשָׁע

“and a wicked {one} enters”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but a wicked one enters distress]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:8 (#1)

צַדִּיק מִצָּרָה נֶחֱלָץ וַיָּבֹא רָשָׁע תַּחְתָּיו

“A righteous {one} is drawn away from distress, and a wicked {one} enters instead of him”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of avoiding and experiencing **distress** as if **distress** were a place that someone could be **drawn away from** or enter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A righteous one is prevented from experiencing distress, but a wicked one experiences distress instead of him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:8 (#2)

צַדִּיק & רָשָׁע

“A righteous {one & a wicked {one”

See how you translated **A righteous {one}** in 9:9 and **a wicked {one}** in 9:7.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 11:8 (#3)

צַדִּיק & נֶחֱלָץ

“A righteous {one} is drawn away”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh does the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh draws away a righteous one]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 11:8 (#4)

מִצָּרָה

“from distress”

See how you translated the abstract noun **distress** in 1:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:9 (#7)

צַדִּיקִים

“the righteous”

Solomon is using the adjective **righteous** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [righteous people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 11:9 (#1)

בְּפִי

“With a mouth”

See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 10:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:9 (#6)

וּבְדַעַת צַדִּיקִים יֵחָלֵצוּ

“but with knowledge, the righteous will be delivered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but knowledge will deliver the righteous]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 11:9 (#5)

וּבְדַעַת

“but with knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:9 (#4)

רֵעֵהוּ

“his neighbor”

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men

and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [that person's neighbor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 11:9 (#2)

חָנֵף

"a godless {one"

The phrase **a godless {one}** represents **godless** people in general, not one particular **godless {one}**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any godless person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 11:9 (#3)

חָנֵף

"a godless {one"

Here, **a godless one** refers to any person who rebels against God or behaves as if God did not exist. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a person who rebels against God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:10 (#1)

בְּטוּב צַדִּיקִים

"In the good of the righteous"

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the good** things that happen to **the righteous ones**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [In the good things that happen to righteous ones,] or [When good things happen to the righteous ones,]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:10 (#2)

תַּעֲלֹז קִרְיָה

"a city exults"

Here, **city** refers to the people who live in a **city**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of a city exult]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:10 (#3)

וּבַאֲבֹד רְשָׁעִים רִנָּה

"and when the wicked perish, a shout of joy"

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and when wicked ones perish, there is a shout of joy] or [and when wicked ones perish, a the people give a shout of joy]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:11 (#4)

וּבְפִי

"but with the mouth of"

See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 10:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:11 (#5)

תֵּהָרֵס

"it is torn down"

Here Solomon uses **a city** being **torn down** to refer to it being destroyed, which could include tearing **down** its walls and buildings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a city is destroyed]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:11 (#2)

בִּבְרַכַּת יְשָׁרִים

"With the blessing of the upright"

Here, **the blessing of the upright** could refer to: (1) **the blessing** that **the upright** give to **a city**. Alternate translation: [With the blessing given by the upright ones]; (2) **the blessing** that God gives **the upright**. Alternate translation: [With the blessing that God gives to the upright ones]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:11 (#3)

תָּרוּם קָרֶת

"a city is raised up"

Here Solomon refers to **a city** becoming great as if it were **raised up**. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a city is made great]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:11 (#1)

בִּבְרַכַת יְשָׁרִים תְּרוּמַם קָרֶת וּבְפִי רְשָׁעִים תֵּהָרֵס

“With the blessing of the upright a city is raised up, but with the mouth of the wicked it is torn down”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The blessing of the upright raises up a city, but the mouth of the wicked tears down a city]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 11:12 (#4)

וְאִישׁ תְּבוּנוֹת

“but a man of understandings”

Solomon is using this possessive form to mean that a characteristic of this man is that he understands many things. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. See how you translated the similar “a man of understanding” in 10:23. Alternate translation: [but a man who understands things]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:12 (#5)

תְּבוּנוֹת

“understandings”

Here Solomon is using the plural **understandings** where he could have used the singular form. This suggests that he is using the plural form to emphasize the breadth or depth of this person’s understanding. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the singular and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [great understanding] or [deep understanding]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

Proverbs 11:12 (#1)

בָּז־לְרֵעֵהוּ

“One despising his neighbor”

Contrasting this clause with the second clause indicates that Solomon is referring to someone **despising his neighbor** by what he says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who vocally despises his neighbor] or [One who despises his neighbor in what he says]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:12 (#2)

לְרֵעֵהוּ & וְאִישׁ תְּבוּנוֹת

“his neighbor & but a man of understandings”

Although **his** and **man** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that could refer to either a man or woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [that person’s neighbor ... but a person of understanding]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 11:12 (#3)

חֲסַר־לֵב

“is} lacking of heart”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:13 (#1)

מְגַלֶּה

“uncovers”

Here Solomon refers to revealing **secret** information as if that information were a hidden object that someone **uncovers**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [reveals]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:13 (#2)

וְנֶאֱמַן־רוּחַ

“but one faithful of spirit”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe someone whose **spirit** is characterized by being **faithful**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but a faithful person]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:13 (#3)

מְכַסֶּה

“covers”

See how you translated the same use of **covers** in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:14 (#3)

יִפָּל

“falls”

See how you translated the same use of “fall” in 11:5.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:14 (#1)

בְּאֵין תַּחֲבֻלוֹת & וּתְשׁוּעָה בְּרֹב יוֹעֵץ

“When there are no directions & but salvation {is} in an abundance of counsel”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **directions**, **salvation**, **abundance**, and **counsel**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **abundance** in 5:23 and **counsel** in 1:25. Alternate translation: [When no one directs ... but many people counseling someone will save that person]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:14 (#2)

עָם

“a people”

In this verse, the word **people** is singular in form, but it refers to multiple people as a group that could also be called a “nation” or “country.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [a group of people] or [a nation]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 11:14 (#4)

וּתְשׁוּעָה בְּרֹב יוֹעֵץ

“but salvation {is} in an abundance of counsel”

Here Solomon is speaking of **salvation** as if it were an object that could be found **in an abundance of counsel**. He means that **an abundance of counsel** can result in **salvation**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but salvation is the result of an abundance of counsel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:15 (#2)

רַע־יֵרוֹעַ

“One will be harmed {with} harm”

For emphasis, Solomon is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [One will come to great harm]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 11:15 (#4)

וְשֹׂנֵא תִקְּעִים

“but one hating hand clasps”

By **hating hand clasps**, Solomon means specifically clasping hands to agree to pay a debt for someone. He is not referring to clasping hands in greeting or to make another kind of agreement. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [but one who rejects this kind of agreement]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:15 (#1)

עָרַב

“he pledges for”

Although the term **he** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [one pledged for] or [that person pledges for]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 11:15 (#3)

עָרַב

“he pledges for”

See how you translated the same use of “pledge” in 6:1.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:15 (#5)

תִקְּעִים

“hand clasps”

The function of this action in this culture was to confirm a contractual agreement between people. If there is a gesture with a similar meaning in your culture, you could consider using it here in your translation, or you could express the meaning plainly. See how

you translated the similar phrase “clasp your palms” in 6:1. Alternate translation: [shaking hands to confirm an agreement] or [confirming an agreement]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 11:16 (#2)

אֵשֶׁת־חֵ֑ן

“A woman of grace”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **woman** who is characterized by **grace**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A woman who is gracious]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:16 (#5)

יִתְמְכוּ־עֹ֣שֶׁר

“will grasp riches”

Solomon contrasts this clause with the previous clause in order to imply that **riches** are not as important as **honor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will merely grasp riches]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:16 (#3)

תִּתְמֹ֣מֶךְ & יִתְמְכוּ

“will grasp & will grasp”

Here Solomon speaks of people obtaining **honor** and **riches** as if they were objects that someone could **grasp**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will obtain … will obtain]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:16 (#4)

כָּבֽוֹד

“honor”

See how you translated the abstract noun **honor** in 3:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:16 (#1)

אֵשֶׁת־חֵ֑ן

“A woman of grace”

Here, **woman** refers to a type of **woman** in general, not one particular **woman**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Any woman of grace]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:17 (#4)

נַפְשׁ֑וֹ & שְׁאֵרֽוֹ

“his soul & his flesh”

Here, **soul** and **flesh** refer to people, who have a **soul** and **flesh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 11:17 (#5)

אַכְזָרִֽי

“a cruel {one”

The phrase **a cruel {one}** represents cruel people in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any cruel person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:17 (#1)

גֹּמֵ֣ל נַפְשׁ֑וֹ אִ֥ישׁ חֶ֝סֶד & שְׁאֵרֽוֹ

“A man of covenant faithfulness repays his soul & his flesh”

Although **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [A person of covenant faithfulness deals fully with that person’s soul … that person’s flesh]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 11:17 (#2)

אִ֥ישׁ חֶ֝סֶד

“A man of covenant faithfulness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **covenant faithfulness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A man who has covenant faithfulness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:17 (#3)

גֹּמֵ֣ל

“repays”

Here, **repays** refers to rewarding or benefiting someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [rewards]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 11:18 (#2)

פְּעֻלַּת־שָׁ֭וְא & שֶׂ֣כֶר אֱמֶ֑ת

“a wage of falsehood & a wage of truth”

In this verse, Solomon is using possessive forms to describe a **wage** that is characterized by **falsehood** and to describe a **wage** that is characterized by **truth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use different expressions. Alternate translation: [a false wage ... a true wage]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:18 (#1)

רָשָׁ֗ע

“A wicked {one”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:18 (#3)

פְּעֻלַּת־שָׁ֭וְא & שֶׂ֣כֶר אֱמֶ֑ת

“a wage of falsehood & a wage of truth”

Here Solomon speaks of results or rewards as if they were a **wage** someone receives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a false reward ... a true reward]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:18 (#4)

וְזֹרֵ֥עַ צְ֝דָקָ֗ה שֶׂ֣כֶר אֱמֶֽת

“but {one} sowing righteousness, a wage of truth”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but one who sows righteousness makes a wage of truth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:18 (#5)

וְזֹרֵ֥עַ צְ֝דָקָ֗ה

“but {one} sowing righteousness”

Here Solomon refers to doing righteous deeds as if one were sowing seeds in a field. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who does righteous deeds]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:19 (#5)

לְמוֹתֽוֹ

“is} to his death”

See how you translated the abstract noun **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:19 (#4)

וּמְרַדֵּ֣ף רָ֭עָה

“but one who pursues evil”

Here Solomon refers to someone who constantly does **evil** as if that person were pursuing it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who constantly does evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:19 (#1)

כֵּן־צְדָקָ֗ה

“True righteousness”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words in this clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the next clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Pursuing true righteousness] or [Behaving with true righteousness]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:19 (#3)

לְחַיִּ֑ים

“is} to life”

See how you translated the same use of **life** in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:19 (#2)

לְחַיִּ֑ים & לְמוֹתוֹ

“is} to life & is} to his death”

In this verse, **{is} to** indicates that what follows is the result of what preceded. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [leads to life ... leads him to his death]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 11:20 (#1)

תּוֹעֲבַ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“An abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:20 (#6)

דָּרְכּ֣וֹ

“way”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:20 (#3)

לֵבָ֣ב

“heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:20 (#5)

תְּמִימֵ֥י דָֽרֶךְ

“is} the blameless of way”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **way** that is characterized by being **blameless**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is those whose way is blameless]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:20 (#2)

עִקְּשֵׁ֖י

“is} the crooked of”

See how you translated the same use of **crooked** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:20 (#4)

וּרְצוֹנֽוֹ

“but his delight”

See how you translated the abstract noun **delight** in 8:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:21 (#5)

וְזֶ֣רַע

“but the seed of”

Here Solomon refers to all righteous people as though they were **the seed** of a righteous plant, or of all righteous people as though they were all descendants in a line of righteous people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but everyone having the characteristic of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:21 (#2)

רָ֗ע

“a wicked {one”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:21 (#4)

וְזֶ֣רַע

“but the seed of”

Here, the word **seed** is singular in form, but it refers to all seeds as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [but the seeds of]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 11:21 (#1)

יָ֤ד לְיָ֨ד

“Hand to hand”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to something being certain. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [As sure as the sun comes up] or [Assuredly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 11:21 (#6)

נִמְלָט

“will safely escape”

Here Solomon implies that the **escape** is from punishment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will escape punishment] or [will not be punished]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:21 (#3)

לֹא־יִנָּקֶה

“will not remain blameless”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 11:22 (#3)

חֲזִיר

“a pig”

A **pig** is an animal that is considered to be unclean and disgusting by Jews and many cultures of the Ancient Near East. It would be very inappropriate for a **pig** to have **a ring of gold** in its **nose**. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of a disgusting animal in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a disgusting animal]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:22 (#4)

וְסָרַת טָעַם

“turning away {from} discretion”

Here Solomon speaks of refusing to act with **discretion** as if someone were **turning away** from it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who does not act with discretion]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:22 (#1)

נֶזֶם זָהָב בְּאַף חֲזִיר אִשָּׁה יָפָה וְסָרַת טָעַם

“A ring of gold in the nose of a pig {is} a beautiful woman turning away {from} discretion”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A beautiful woman that turns away from discretion is a ring of gold in the nose of a pig]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 11:22 (#2)

נֶזֶם זָהָב בְּאַף חֲזִיר אִשָּׁה יָפָה וְסָרַת טָעַם

“A ring of gold in the nose of a pig {is} a beautiful woman turning away {from} discretion”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of how inappropriate it is for a **beautiful woman** not to have **discretion**. He speaks as if that **woman** were a **ring of gold** in a pig’s **nose**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [A beautiful woman that turns away from discretion is inappropriate, like a ring of gold in the nose of a pig]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:22 (#5)

טָעַם

“discretion”

See how you translated the abstract noun **discretion** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:23 (#3)

תִּקְוַת רְשָׁעִים עֶבְרָה

“the expectation of the wicked {is} rage”

Solomon does not mean to communicate here that **the wicked** do wicked things because they expect **rage**. He means to communicate that it is as though they expect rage, because that is what they get. If a speaker of your language would not do that, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [whatever the wicked ones might expect, rage is all that they will get]

See: Irony

Proverbs 11:23 (#5)

עֶבְרָה

“is} rage”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rage**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is being enraged] or [enrages]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:23 (#4)

עֶבְרָה

“is} rage”

Here, **rage** could refer to: (1) Yahweh’s wrath. Alternate translation: [is the wrath of Yahweh]; (2) the wrath of other people. Alternate translation: [is the wrath of other people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:23 (#2)

תִּקְוַת רְשָׁעִים עֶבְרָה

“the expectation of the wicked {is} rage”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, the expectation of the wicked ones is rage]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 11:23 (#1)

תַּאֲוַת צַדִּיקִים אַךְ־טוֹב תִּקְוַת רְשָׁעִים עֶבְרָה

“The desire of the righteous {is} only good; the expectation of the wicked {is} rage”

This verse could mean: (1) **The desire** of **righteous** people results in what is **good**, but **the expectation** of **wicked** people results in **rage**. Alternate translation: [The desire of the righteous ones leads only to good; the expectation of the wicked ones leads to rage]; (2) **righteous** people **only desire** what is **good**, but **wicked** people expect anger. Alternate translation: [The righteous ones only desire good things; the wicked ones expect rage]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:24 (#5)

אַךְ־לְמַחְסוֹר

“yet to poverty”

Here, **yet** introduces the unexpected result of what was stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate an unexpected result. Alternate translation: [but only comes to poverty as a result]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 11:24 (#6)

אַךְ־לְמַחְסוֹר

“yet to poverty”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [yet he comes to poverty]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:24 (#1)

יֵשׁ מְפַזֵּר וְנוֹסָף עֹוד

“There is a scatterer yet being added to more”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. The context is about a person sharing what he has with others. Alternate translation: [There is a person who scatters what he has and yet adds more to what he has]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:24 (#4)

וְחוֹשֵׂךְ מִמַּיִּשָׁר

“and {one} withholding more than {what is} right”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. The context is about a person not sharing what they have with others. Alternate translation: [and one who withholds from those in need more of what he has than is right]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:24 (#2)

מְפַזֵּר & וְחוֹשֵׂךְ

“a scatterer & and {one} withholding”

In this verse, the **scatterer** and the **one withholding** are examples of types of people. It does not mean that there is only one person who does each of these two things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [a type of person who scatters … but a type of person who withholds]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:24 (#3)

וְנוֹסָף עֹוד

“yet being added to more”

Here, **yet** introduces the unexpected result of what was stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate an unexpected result. Alternate translation: [even so, it results in that person having more]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 11:25 (#3)

נָפֶשׁ

“A life of”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 8:36.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:25 (#7)

וּמַרְוֶה גַּם־הוּא יוֹרֶא

“and the one who drenches, he also will be drenched”

Here Solomon refers to someone giving and receiving a generous amount of the good things of life as if the people were plants giving and receiving abundant rain. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the one who freely gives to others will also freely receive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:25 (#5)

תְּדֻשָּׁן & יוֹרֶא

“will be fattened & will be drenched”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will fatten … Yahweh will drench]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 11:25 (#2)

נָפֶשׁ־בְּרָכָה

“A life of blessing”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **life** that is characterized by **blessing**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A life that blesses]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:25 (#1)

נָפֶשׁ & וּמַרְוֶה & הַהוּא

“A life of & and the one who drenches, he”

In this verse, **A life**, **the one**, and **he** refer to types of people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any life of … and any person who drenches, that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:25 (#6)

תְּדֻשָּׁן

“will be fattened”

Here Solomon refers to a person becoming prosperous as if they were **fattened**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will become prosperous]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:25 (#4)

בְּרָכָה

“blessing”

Here Solomon implies that the **blessing** is given to other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [blessing other people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:26 (#3)

וּבְרָכָה לְרֹאשׁ

“but a blessing {is} for the head of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:6.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 11:26 (#4)

מַשְׁבִּיר

“the seller”

Here Solomon implies that **the seller** sells **grain**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the one who sells his grain]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:26 (#2)

מֹנֵעַ בָּר

“One withholding grain”

Here Solomon implies that this person is selfishly **withholding grain** in order to sell it later for a greater profit. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who is withholding grain in order to sell it later for a higher price]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:26 (#1)

מֹנֵעַ & יִקְּבֻהוּ & מַשְׁבִּיר

“One withholding & will curse him & the seller”

In this verse, **One**, **him**, and **the seller** refer to types of people in general. They do not refer to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who withholds ... will curse that person ... any seller]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:27 (#4)

טָטוֹב

“good”

Solomon is using the adjective **good** as a noun to mean good things. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [to do good things]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 11:27 (#3)

טָטוֹב & רָצוֹן & רָעָה

“good & favor & evil”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **good**, **favor**, and **evil**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [what is good ... to be favored ... what is evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:27 (#2)

שֹׁשֵׂחַר & וְדֹרֵשׁ

“One diligently seeking & but one searching {for”

In this verse, Solomon refers to people trying to do **good** and trying to do **evil** as if **good** and **evil** were objects that someone **seeks** or **searches for**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who diligently tries to do good ... but one who tries to do evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:27 (#1)

שֹׁשֵׂחַר & וְדֹרֵשׁ & תְּבוֹאֶנּוּ

“One diligently seeking & but one searching {for & it will come {to} him”

In this verse, **One diligently seeking**, **one searching for**, and **him** refer to types of people in general. They do not refer to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who diligently seeks ... but any person who searches for ... it will come to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:27 (#6)

תְּבוֹאֶנּוּ

“it will come {to} him”

Here Solomon speaks of someone experiencing **evil** as if **evil** were a person who could **come** to that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will experience it] or [it will happen to him]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:27 (#5)

יְבַקֵּשׁ רָצוֹן

“seeks favor”

Solomon says that someone **diligently seeking good** also **seeks favor** because that is what that person receives from Yahweh and other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [finds favor from Yahweh and people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:28 (#2)

הֵהָוּא יִפֹּל

“he himself will fall”

In the original, Solomon adds the pronoun "you," the meaning of which is already included in the verb translated as **fall**. This adds emphasis to what he is saying. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **himself**. Alternate translation: [that very person will fall]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 11:28 (#3)

הַ֭הוּא יִפֹּֽל

"he himself will fall"

See how you translated the same use of **fall** in 11:5.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:28 (#4)

וְ֝כֶעָלֶ֗ה צַדִּיקִ֥ים יִפְרָֽחוּ

"but like a leaf, the righteous will sprout"

Solomon is saying that **the righteous** are like **a leaf** that sprouts out of a plant because they prosper and thrive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [but righteous ones prosper like a leaf that sprouts and grows]

See: Simile

Proverbs 11:28 (#5)

וְ֝כֶעָלֶ֗ה

"but like a leaf"

Solomon refers to a green **leaf** that is growing, rather than a fallen or withered **leaf**. If it would be helpful in your language, or if your language uses different words for a fresh or withered **leaf**, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but like a healthy leaf]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:28 (#1)

בּוֹטֵ֣חַ בְּ֭עָשְׁרוֹ הַ֣הוּא יִפֹּֽל

"One trusting in his riches, he himself will fall"

One, **his**, and **he** in this verse refer to a type of person in general. They do not refer to a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who trusts in that person's own riches, that person will fall]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:29 (#4)

לַֽחֲכַם־לֵֽב

"to the wise of heart"

See how you translated **wise of heart** in 10:8.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 11:29 (#3)

יִנְחַ֣ל־רֽוּחַ

"will inherit wind"

Here Solomon speaks of **wind** as if it were property that someone could **inherit**. He means that someone **who troubles his house** will not **inherit** anything. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will inherit nothing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:29 (#1)

עוֹכֵ֥ר בֵּיתֽוֹ

"One troubling his house"

One and **his** in this verse refer to a type of person in general. They do not refer to a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Any person who troubles that person's own house]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:29 (#2)

בֵּיתֽוֹ

"his house"

Here, **house** represents the family who lives in **his house**. See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:30 (#4)

עֵ֣ץ חַיִּ֣ים

"is} a tree of life"

See how you translated this phrase in 3:18. Here Solomon speaks of what righteous people say and do as if it were a **tree** that gives **life** to those who eat

its fruit. He means that the actions and teaching of righteous people help others to live a long and happy life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [offers a good life to people] or [is like a fruit tree that sustains the lives of people]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:30 (#5)

וְלֹקֵחַ נְפָשׁוֹת

“and one taking souls”

Here, **one taking souls** refers to someone who influences other people. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the one who wins hearts] or [and the one who influences others]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 11:30 (#2)

פְּרִי־צַדִּיק

“The fruit of the righteous”

Here Solomon refers to what **righteous** people do as if it were **fruit** that they produced. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What righteous people do]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:30 (#1)

פְּרִי־צַדִּיק

“The fruit of the righteous”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **fruit** that is produced by **the righteous one**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [The fruit produced by the righteous one]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:30 (#3)

צַדִּיק & וְלֹקֵחַ נְפָשׁוֹת

“the righteous & and one taking souls”

In this verse, **the righteous** and the **one taking souls** refer to types of people in general. They do not refer to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated **the righteous** in 10:3. Alternate translation: [any righteous person ... and any person who takes souls]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:31 (#7)

רָשָׁע וְחוֹטֵא

“a wicked {one} and a sinner”

The terms **a wicked {one}** and **a sinner** mean similar things and refer to the same person, who represents this kind of people. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [a very wicked person]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 11:31 (#1)

הֵ֣ן

“Behold”

See how you translated the same use of **Behold** in 1:23.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:31 (#5)

יְשֻׁלָּ֑ם

“will be repaid”

Here Solomon refers to people receiving what they deserve for their actions as if they were being **repaid** for what they have done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will receive what is due to them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:31 (#6)

אַ֭אַף כִּי־רָשָׁע וְחוֹטֵא

“how much more a wicked {one} and a sinner”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [how much more will a wicked one and a sinner be repaid]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:31 (#3)

בָּאָ֥רֶץ

“in the land”

Here, **the land** refers to the earth in general. It does not refer to the land of Israel, as it does in 2:21–22 and 10:30. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:31 (#2)

צַדִּיק & רָשָׁע וְחוֹטֵא

“a righteous {one & a wicked {one} and a sinner”

In this verse, **a righteous {one}**, **a wicked {one}**, and **a sinner** refer to types of people in general. They do not refer to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. See how you translated “a righteous {one}” in 9:9 and “a wicked {one}” in 9:7. Alternate translation: [any righteous person ... any wicked person and any sinner]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:31 (#4)

יְשֻׁלָּֽם

“will be repaid”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will repay]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs - Chapter 12 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 12 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism

Except for 12:7, 14, and 28, all of the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Proverbs 12:1 (#1)

מִמּוּסָר & דְּעַת & תוֹכֵחַת

“correction & knowledge & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **correction** in 3:11, **knowledge** in 1:4, and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:2 (#4)

וְאִישׁ מְזִמּוֹת

“but a man of schemes”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who makes **schemes**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but a man who schemes]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:2 (#3)

וְאִישׁ

“but a man of”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to either a man or woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [but a person of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:2 (#2)

רָצוֹן

“favor”

See how you translated the abstract noun **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:2 (#1)

טֹוב

“A good one”

A good one here does not refer to a specific person, but refers to this type of person in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [Any good person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:3 (#4)

בְּרֶשַׁע

“by wickedness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wickedness** in 4:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:3 (#3)

לֹא־יִכּוֹן

“will not be established”

Here the word translated as **established** refers to having a stable and secure life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will not be made stable]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:3 (#5)

וְשֹׁרֶשׁ צַדִּיקִים בַּל־יִמּוֹט

“but the root of the righteous will not be shaken”

Here Solomon refers to someone’s life remaining secure as if that person were a tree with a **root** that could **not be shaken**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the righteous will be fully secure] or [but the lives of the righteous will remain stable]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:3 (#2)

לֹא־יִכּוֹן & בַּל־יִמּוֹט

“will not be established & will not be shaken”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will not establish himself ... nobody will shake]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:3 (#1)

אָדָם

“A man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to either a man or woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [A person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:4 (#3)

וּכְרָקָב בְּעַצְמוֹתָיו מְבִישָׁה

“but she who causes shame {is} like rottenness in his bones”

Solomon is saying that a woman **who causes shame** for her husband is like **rottenness in his bones** because she gradually ruins his life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but she who causes shame is what makes his life miserable]

See: Simile

Proverbs 12:4 (#1)

אֵשֶׁת־חַיִל

“A wife of worth”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **wife** that is characterized by **worth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A worthy wife]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:4 (#4)

וּכְרָקָב בְּעַצְמוֹתָיו

“but & is} like rottenness in his bones”

Here, **rottenness** refers to a disease like cancer that slowly destroys a person’s body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is like cancer in his bones]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:4 (#5)

בְּעַצְמוֹתָיו

“in his bones”

Here, the pronoun **his** refers to the husband of the woman **who causes shame**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in her husband’s bones]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 12:4 (#2)

עֲטֶרֶת בַּעְלָהּ

“is} the crown of her husband”

Here Solomon refers to a woman causing her husband to be honored as if she were his **crown**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [brings great honor to her husband] or [honors her husband as if she were his crown]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:5 (#3)

מִרְמָֽה

“are} deceit”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **deceit**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [are deceptive]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:5 (#1)

מִשְׁפָּֽט

“are} justice”

See how you translated the abstract noun **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:5 (#2)

תַּחְבֻּלֹ֣ות רְשָׁעִ֣ים מִרְמָֽה

“the directions of the wicked {are} deceit”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, the directions of the wicked ones are deceit]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 12:6 (#1)

דִּבְרֵ֣י & וּפִ֣י

“The words of & but the mouth of”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23 and **mouth** in 10:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:6 (#2)

אֹ֖רֶב־דָּ֣מִים

“lie in wait {for} blood”

Here Solomon refers to **the wicked ones** saying things that will cause other people to die as if what they say is a person who waits to ambush someone on the road. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated this phrase in 1:11. Alternate translation: [result in people dying] or [are like someone who lies in wait to murder someone]

See: Personification

Proverbs 12:6 (#3)

יַצִּילֵֽם

“will deliver them”

Here Solomon refers to **the upright** rescuing themselves from trouble through what they say as if what they say were a person who could **deliver them**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will allow them to deliver themselves]

See: Personification

Proverbs 12:7 (#2)

וּבֵ֖ית

“but the house of”

See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:7 (#1)

הָפְכ֣וּ

“are overthrown”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The word **overthrown** here refers to being ruined or destroyed. Alternate translation: [Wicked people experience destruction]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:7 (#3)

יַעֲמֹֽד

“will stand”

Here Solomon refers to the families of **the righteous ones** continuing to exist as if they were a **house** that would continue to **stand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will remain] or [will keep on existing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:8 (#6)

יִהְיֶ֖ה לָבֽוּז

“will be for contempt”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **contempt**, you could express the same idea in

another way. Alternate translation: [will be considered contemptible] or [will be despised by people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:8 (#2)

שִׂכְלוֹ & אִישׁ

“his insight a man”

Although **his** and **man** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [that person’s insight that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:8 (#5)

וְנַעֲוֵה־לֵבָב

“but {one} twisted of heart”

Here Solomon is speaking of people who think wrongly, as if they have a **twisted heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who thinks wrongly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:8 (#4)

יְהֻלַּל־אִישׁ

“a man will be praised”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will praise that man]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:8 (#3)

שִׂכְלוֹ

“his insight”

See how you translated the abstract noun **insight** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:8 (#1)

לְפִי

“For the mouth of”

For the mouth of is an idiom that means “According to.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In proportion to]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 12:9 (#3)

לָחֶם

“bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 12:9 (#2)

וְעֶבֶד לוֹ & וְחַסַר־לָחֶם

“and having a servant & and lacking bread”

In both of these phrases, what follows **and** is in contrast to what people would expect. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate this contrast. Alternate translation: [but has a servant … but is lacking of bread]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 12:9 (#1)

נָקְלֶה וְעֶבֶד לוֹ

“is} being disregarded and having a servant”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is the one whom others disregard and has a servant]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:10 (#2)

יוֹדֵעַ & נֶפֶשׁ

“knows the life of”

Here, the phrase **knows the life** refers to being concerned with the wellbeing of one’s **animal**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is concerned with the wellbeing of] or [cares about the life of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:10 (#3)

בְּהֶמְתּוֹ

“his animal”

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [that person's animal]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:10 (#1)

צַדִּיק

"A righteous {one"

See how you translated this phrase in 9:9.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:10 (#4)

וְרַחֲמֵי רְשָׁעִים

"but the compassion of the wicked"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **compassion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [but anything compassionate that wicked people do]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:11 (#1)

לֶחֶם

"Bread"

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 12:11 (#3)

אַדְמָתוֹ

"his ground"

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [that person's ground]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:11 (#5)

חֲסַר־לֵב

"is} lacking of heart"

See how you translated **lacking of heart** in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:11 (#2)

עֹבֵד אַדְמָתוֹ

"one who works his ground"

This phrase refers to a farmer who plants, cultivates, and harvests crops on **his ground**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or you could use a general expression for working hard. Alternate translation: [a farmer who cultivates his land] or [someone who works hard at his job]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:11 (#4)

רֵיקִים

"empty things"

Here Solomon refers to worthless things that people do as if they were **empty** containers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [worthless activities]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:12 (#3)

רָעִים

"the evil"

Solomon is using the adjective **evil** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [evil people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 12:12 (#1)

רָשָׁע

"A wicked {one"

See how you translated this phrase in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:12 (#4)

וְשֹׁרֶשׁ צַדִּיקִים

"but the root of the righteous"

See how you translated this phrase in 12:3.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:12 (#2)

מְצוֹד

“the snare of”

Here Solomon refers to what **the evil** catch in a **snare** as if it were the **snare** itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the plunder of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:12 (#5)

יִתֵּן

“will give”

Here Solomon uses **give** to refer to producing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will produce fruit] or [will be productive]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:13 (#4)

רָעֵ֣ & צַדִּ֑יק

“an evil {one & a righteous {one”

See how you translated **a righteous {one}** and **a wicked {one}** in 11:8.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:13 (#2)

שְׂפָתַ֣יִם

“lips”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:13 (#3)

מוֹקֵ֥שׁ רָ֝עֵ֗

“is} the snare of an evil {one”

Here Solomon refers to the disasters that **an evil one** experiences because of what he says as if it were a **snare** that he was trapped in. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is what destroys an evil one]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:13 (#5)

וַיֵּצֵ֣א מִצָּרָ֣ה צַדִּ֑יק

“but a righteous {one} will go out from distress”

Here Solomon refers to avoiding **distress** as if it were a place that one could **go out from**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the righteous one will avoid distress]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:13 (#1)

בְּפֶ֣שַׁע שְׂפָתַ֑יִם

“In the transgression of lips”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **lips** that are characterized by **transgression**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [In the lips that speak transgression]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:13 (#6)

מִצָּרָ֣ה

“from distress”

See how you translated the abstract noun **distress** in 1:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:14 (#6)

ישוב לְ֝וֹ

“will return to him”

Here Solomon refers to the benefits that a person receives as a result of working hard as if that **accomplishment** were a person who could **return to him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will help him]

See: Personification

Proverbs 12:14 (#3)

מִפְּרִ֣י פִֽי־אִ֭ישׁ יִשְׂבַּע־טּ֑וֹב

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man will he be satisfied {with} good”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The fruit of the mouth of a man will satisfy him with good]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:14 (#4)

טוֹב

“good”

See how you translated the abstract noun **good** in 11:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:14 (#1)

מִפְּרִי־פִי־אִישׁ

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man”

Here Solomon refers to what a person says as if it were **fruit** that was produced by that person’s **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [From what a man says]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:14 (#2)

אִישׁ יִשְׂבַּע & אָדָם ישוב לוֹ

“a man will he be satisfied {with & a man will return to him”

Although **a man**, **he**, and **him** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person will that person be satisfied with ... a person will return to that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:14 (#5)

וּגְמוּל יְדֵי־אָדָם

“and the accomplishment of the hands of a man”

Here Solomon refers to what a person accomplishes through physical labor as if it were the **accomplishment** of that person’s **hands**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what a man accomplishes through physical labor]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:15 (#2)

בְּעֵינָיו

“in his eyes”

Solomon is using the expression **in his eyes** to mean “in his judgement” or “in his opinion.” See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 3:7. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in his opinion]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:15 (#1)

דֶּרֶךְ

“The way of”

See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:15 (#3)

לְעֵצָה

“to counsel”

See how you translated the abstract noun **counsel** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:16 (#4)

בַּיּוֹם

“on the day”

Solomon is using the term **day** to refer to a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on the same day] or [right away]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:16 (#6)

קָלְלָוֹן

“dishonor”

See how you translated the abstract noun **dishonor** in 3:35.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:16 (#2)

כַּעְסוֹ

“his anger”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **anger**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [when he is angry, it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:16 (#3)

יִוָּדַע

“is known”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people know]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:16 (#1)

כַּעְסוֹ

“his anger”

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [that person’s anger]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:16 (#5)

וְכֹסֶה

“but & covers”

See how you translated the same use of **covers** in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:17 (#2)

יָפִיחַ

“He who breathes out”

See how you translated the same use of **breathes out** in 6:19. Here Solomon speaks of someone who easily and habitually tells the truth as if that person **breathes out faithfulness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who easily speaks]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:17 (#4)

וְעֵד שְׁקָרִים מִרְמָה

“but a witness of falsehoods, deceit”

Solomon is leaving out a word in this clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but a witness of falsehoods tells deceit]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 12:17 (#3)

אֱמֶת יַגִּיד צֶדֶק & שְׁקָרִים מִרְמָה

“faithfulness tells righteousness & falsehoods, deceit”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **faithfulness** and **righteousness**, **falsehoods**, and **deceit**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [what is faithful tells what is righteous ... false things, what is deceitful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:17 (#6)

וְעֵד שְׁקָרִים

“but a witness of falsehoods”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **witness** who speaks **falsehoods**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but any witness who speaks falsehoods]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:17 (#1)

יָפִיחַ

“He who breathes out”

Although the term **He** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [A person who breathes out]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:17 (#5)

וְעֵד שְׁקָרִים

“but a witness of falsehoods”

Although **a witness** here is singular, it refers to any **witness of falsehoods** in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different form. Alternate translation: [but any witness of falsehoods]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:18 (#3)

וּלְשׁוֹן חֲכָמִים מַרְפֵּא

“but the tongue of the wise ones—healing”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but the tongue of the wise ones causes healing]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 12:18 (#5)

וּלְשׁוֹן

“but the tongue of”

See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17. Solomon is using the term **tongue** to represent what people say with their tongues. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the speech of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:18 (#1)

בַּבּוֹטֶה

“one speaking thoughtlessly”

Here, **one** refers to a type of person. It does not mean that there is only **one** person who does this thing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a type of person who speaks thoughtlessly]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:18 (#2)

כְּמַדְקְרוֹת חָרֶב

“like the thrusts of a sword”

Solomon is saying that what people who speak **thoughtlessly** say is **like the thrusts of a sword** because it hurts people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and hurting others as if he stabbed them with a sword]

See: Simile

Proverbs 12:18 (#4)

וּלְשׁוֹן

“but the tongue of”

The word **tongue** represents tongues in general, not one particular **tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but the tongues of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:19 (#2)

שֶׂפַת

“A lip of”

Here, **lip** refers to what people say by moving their lips. See how you translated the same use of “lips” in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:19 (#8)

וְעַד־אַרְגִּיעָה

“but & as long as I would blink”

The phrase **as long as I would blink** is an idiom that refers to a short amount of time, such as the time it takes to **blink** an eye. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but ... is gone in the blink of an eye] or [but ... only for a brief time]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 12:19 (#4)

תִּכּוֹן

“will be established”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will exist]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:19 (#1)

שֶׂפַת

“A lip of”

Here, the word **lip** represents lips in general, not one particular **lip**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Lips of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:19 (#7)

לְשׁוֹן שָׁקֶר

“a tongue of falsehood”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:19 (#6)

וְעַד־אַ֝רְגִּ֗יעָה לְשׁ֣וֹן שֶׁ֑קֶר

“but a tongue of falsehood as long as I would blink”

Solomon is leaving out a word in this clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but a tongue of falsehood will be established for as long as I would blink] or [but a tongue of falsehood will exist for as long as I would blink]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 12:19 (#5)

לָ֝עַ֗ד

“to perpetuity”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **perpetuity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [perpetually]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:19 (#3)

שֶׂ֣פַת־אֱ֭מֶת

“A lip of truth”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **lip** that speaks **truth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A lip that speaks truth] or [True sayings]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:20 (#1)

מְמַרְמָ֑ה & רָ֝עָ֗ה & שָׂלְל֣וֹם שִׂמְחָֽה

“Deceit & evil & joy & peace”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Deceit** in 11:1, **evil** in 1:16, **joy** in 10:28, and **peace** in 3:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:20 (#2)

בְּלֵ֥ב

“is} in the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:20 (#3)

וְלִיֹּעֲצֵ֖י שָׂלְל֣וֹם שִׂמְחָֽה

“but joy {is} for advisers of peace”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **advisers** who advise others to do what results in **peace**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but joy is for people who advise others to do what will result in peace]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:21 (#1)

לֹא־יְאֻנֶּ֥ה לַצַּדִּ֗יק כָּל־אָ֑וֶן

“Any iniquity will not be allowed to happen to the righteous”

Solomon is saying this as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way, as in the UST.

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 12:21 (#4)

לַצַּדִּ֗יק

“to the righteous”

See how you translated **the righteous** in 10:16.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:21 (#2)

אָ֑וֶן

“iniquity”

Here, **iniquity** refers to harm that someone might experience as a result of **iniquity**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [harm]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:21 (#5)

מָ֝לְא֗וּ רָֽע

“are full of evil”

The phrase **full of evil** could mean: (1) the **wicked ones** experience much evil. Alternate translation: [experience much evil]; (2) the **wicked ones** do much evil. Alternate translation: [do much evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:21 (#3)

לֹא־יְאֻנֶּה

“will not be allowed to happen”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will not allow to happen]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:21 (#6)

רָֽע

“evil”

Here, **evil** refers to trouble that someone might experience as a result of **evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [trouble]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:22 (#1)

תּוֹעֲבַ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“An abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:22 (#2)

שִׂפְתֵי־שָׁ֝קֶר

“are} lips of falsehood”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:18.

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:22 (#3)

אֱמוּנָ֥ה רְצוֹנֽוֹ

“faithfulness {are} his delight”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **faithfulness** in 12:17 and **delight** in 8:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:23 (#1)

אָדָ֣ם עָ֭רוּם

“A prudent man”

Although **man** is masculine, here it refers to any **prudent** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [A prudent person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:23 (#4)

וְלֵ֣ב כְּ֭סִילִים

“but the heart of the stupid”

Here, **heart** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the stupid one]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 12:23 (#3)

דָּ֣עַת & אִוֶּֽלֶת

“knowledge & folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **knowledge** in 1:4 and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:23 (#2)

כֹּ֣סֶה

“covers”

See how you translated the same use of **covers** in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:24 (#1)

יַד־חָרוּצִ֥ים

“The hand of the diligent”

See how you translated the same phrase in 10:4.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 12:24 (#2)

וּרְמִיָּ֖ה

“but an idle one”

Although **an idle one** here is singular, it refers to all **idle** people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any idle person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:25 (#2)

בְּלֵ֣ב

“in the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:25 (#1)

דְּאָגָה

“Concern”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **Concern**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [That which is concerning]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:25 (#4)

יַשְׁחֶנָּה

“weighs it down”

Here Solomon refers to **Concern** making a person depressed as if it were something that **weighs down** a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes the heart of a man to become sad]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:25 (#3)

אִישׁ

“a man”

Although **man** is masculine, here it refers to any person in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:25 (#5)

וְדָבָר טוֹב

“but a good word”

Here Solomon uses the phrase **good word** to describe something kind that someone says by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but a kind message that someone speaks]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:26 (#4)

וְדֶרֶךְ רְשָׁעִים

“but the way of the wicked”

See how you translated **the way of the wicked ones** in 4:19.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:26 (#1)

צַדִּיק

“A righteous {one”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:9.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:26 (#5)

תַּתְעֵם

“leads them astray”

Here Solomon refers to **wicked ones** deliberately doing wicked things that will result in their destruction as if their behavior is a person who leads them **astray**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar meaning for **astray** in 10:17. Alternate translation: [will cause them to do what will result in their destruction]

See: Personification

Proverbs 12:26 (#2)

יָתֻר מֵרֵעֵהוּ

“searches out from his neighbor”

This could mean: (1) **A righteous {one}** guides **his neighbor**. Alternate translation: [guides his neighbor]; (2) **A righteous {one}** carefully examines a person before choosing that person to be **his neighbor**. Alternate translation: [examines carefully whom he chooses to be his neighbor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:26 (#3)

מֵרֵעֵהוּ

“from his neighbor”

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [from that person’s neighbor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:27 (#4)

אָדָם & חָרוּץ

“a man & for} a diligent one”

Here, **a man** and **a diligent one** do not refer to a specific person, but refer to a type of person in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any person ... for any diligent person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:27 (#3)

וְהוֹן־אָדָם יָקָר חָרוּץ

“but the wealth of a man {is} precious {for} a diligent one”

This could mean: (1) **a diligent one** considers his **wealth** to be **precious**. Alternate translation: [but a diligent one’s wealth is precious to him]; (2) **a diligent one** will acquire precious wealth. Alternate translation: [but a diligent one will acquire precious wealth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:27 (#2)

לֹא־יַחֲרֹךְ & צֵידוֹ

“will not roast his game”

Here, **game** refers to animals that someone has hunted and killed in order to eat their meat. And **roast** refers to cooking food over a fire. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will not use fire to cook the meat from the animals he has hunted]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:27 (#1)

רְמִיָּה

“A negligent one”

A negligent one here does not refer to a specific person, but refers to a type of person in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Any negligent one]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:28 (#1)

בְּאֹרַח־צְדָקָה חַיִּים וְדֶרֶךְ נְתִיבָה אַל־מָוֶת

“In the path of righteousness {is} life, and the way of the beaten path {is} no death”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [In the path of righteousness is life, yes, the way of the beaten path is not death]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 12:28 (#4)

חַיִּים

“is} life”

See how you translated the same use of **life** in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:28 (#6)

וְדֶרֶךְ נְתִיבָה

“and the way of the beaten path”

Here, **the way of the beaten path** refers to **the path of righteousness** in the previous clause. Solomon refers to living righteously as if one were walking on a **beaten path** that is safe because it was made well. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and living righteously]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:28 (#3)

חַיִּים & אַל־מָוֶת

“is} life & is} no death”

In this verse, **is** indicates that what follows is the result of the preceding phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [results in life ... results in no death]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 12:28 (#7)

אַל־מָוֶת

“is} no death”

Here, **no death** could refer to: (1) a person not dying earlier than expected, which is the opposite way of saying the same idea used for **life** in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [is not dying early]; (2) a person having immortality. Alternate translation: [is immortality]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:28 (#5)

וְדֶ֣רֶךְ נְתִיבָ֑ה

“and the way of the beaten path”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to indicate that **the way** is **the beaten path**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the way that is the beaten path]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:28 (#2)

בְּאֹ֣רַח־צְדָקָ֑ה

“In the path of righteousness”

See how you translated **the path of righteousness** in 8:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs - Chapter 13 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 13 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism

Except for 13:14, all the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Proverbs 13:1 (#6)

וְ֝לֵ֗ץ

“but a mocking {one”

Solomon is using the adjective **mocking** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [but a mocker]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 13:1 (#4)

אָ֑ב

“a father”

Here, **father** refers to the **father** of the **son** mentioned earlier in the clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [his father]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:1 (#5)

וְ֝לֵ֗ץ

“but a mocking {one”

Here, **a mocker** refers to this type of person in general, not a specific **mocker**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but any mocker]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:1 (#3)

מִמּוּסַ֥ר & גְּעָרָֽה

“the instruction of & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **instruction** in 1:2 and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:1 (#1)

בֵּ֣ן חָ֭כָם מִמּוּסַ֣ר אָ֑ב

“A wise son, the instruction of a father”

Solomon is leaving out words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A wise son listens to the instruction of a father]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:1 (#2)

בֵּ֣ן חָ֭כָם

“A wise son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 13:2 (#2)

יֹ֣אכַל טֹ֑וב

“he eats good”

Here, Solomon is speaking of a man receiving good things as though he were eating them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he receives good things]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:2 (#3)

טֹ֑וב

“good”

Solomon is using the adjective **good** as a noun to mean good things. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [good things]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 13:2 (#4)

וְנֶ֥פֶשׁ & חָמָֽס

“but the appetite of & violence”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **appetite** in 6:30, and **violence** in 3:31.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:2 (#6)

חָמָֽס

“violence”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply this word from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [eats violence] or [craves violence]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:2 (#5)

וְנֶ֥פֶשׁ

“but the appetite of”

Here Solomon refers to the desire of **the treacherous ones** as if it were their **appetite**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the desire of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:2 (#1)

מִפְּרִ֣י פִי־אִ֔ישׁ

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man”

See how you translated the same phrase in 12:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:3 (#1)

נֹצֵ֥ר פִּ֖יו שֹׁמֵ֣ר נַפְשׁ֑וֹ פֹּשֵׂ֥שׂ שְׂפָתָ֖יו מְחִתָּה־לֽוֹ

“One guarding his mouth keeps his life; one opening his lips, ruin for him”

One guarding his mouth, **his**, **one opening his lips**, and **him** here do not refer to specific people, but to types of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Anyone who guards one’s mouth keeps one’s life; anyone who opens one’s lips is ruin for that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:3 (#3)

שֹׁמֵ֣ר נַפְשׁ֑וֹ

“keeps his life”

Here Solomon speaks of someone preserving one’s **life** as if one’s **life** were an object that one **keeps**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [preserves his life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:3 (#2)

נֹצֵ֥ר פִּ֖יו

“One guarding his mouth”

The phrase **guarding his mouth** is an idiom that refers to being careful about what one says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who speaks carefully]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 13:3 (#6)

פֹּשֵׂ֥שׂ שְׂפָתָ֖יו

“one opening his lips”

The phrase **opening his lips** is an idiom that could refer to: (1) speaking carelessly, which would be in contrast to the meaning of **guards his mouth** in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [one who talks without thinking]; (2) speaking too much. Alternate translation: [one who talks too much]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 13:3 (#5)

פֹּשֵׂ֥שׂ שְׂפָתָ֖יו מְחִתָּה־לֽוֹ

“one opening his lips, ruin for him”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would

be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [one who opens his lips keeps ruin for himself]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:3 (#4)

פֹּשֵׂשֵׂק שְׂפָתָ֥יו מְחִתָּה־לֹּ֑ו

“one opening his lips, ruin for him”

This clause is in strong contrast to the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [on the contrary, one who opens his lips, ruin for him]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 13:3 (#7)

מְחִתָּה־לֹּ֑ו

“ruin for him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **ruin**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [ruins himself]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:4 (#5)

וָאָֽיִן

“and there is nothing”

Solomon says **there is nothing** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and often gets nothing]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 13:4 (#2)

נַפְשֹׁ֣ו & וְנֶ֖פֶשׁ

“his appetite & but the appetite of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **appetite** in 6:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:4 (#4)

וָאָֽיִן

“and there is nothing”

Here Solomon implies that **there is nothing** to satisfy the **lazy** person’s **craving**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and there is nothing to satisfy that craving]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:4 (#3)

מִתְאַוָּ֣ה & נַפְשֹׁ֣ו

“his appetite is craving”

Here, **craving** describes the **appetite** of a **lazy** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he has a craving appetite] or [he craves]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:4 (#7)

תְּדֻשָּֽׁן

“will be fattened”

Here Solomon refers to **the appetite of the diligent ones** being satisfied as if **the appetite** were a person who could be **fattened**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be satisfied]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:4 (#1)

נַפְשֹׁ֣ו עָצֵ֑ל

“A lazy one, his appetite”

A lazy one and **his** do not refer to a specific person, put to a type of person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Anyone who is lazy, that one’s appetite]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:4 (#6)

תְּדֻשָּֽׁן

“will be fattened”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will become fat]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:5 (#1)

צַדִּ֣יק

“A righteous {one”

See how you translated **A righteous one** in 9:9.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 13:5 (#5)

יַבְאִישׁ

“causes a stink”

Here Solomon refers to people causing others to feel disgust for them as if they smell bad. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes others to feel disgust for him] or [disgusts others]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:5 (#2)

דְּבַר־שֶׁקֶר

“a word of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **word** that is characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a false word]

See: Possession

Proverbs 13:5 (#3)

דְּבַר

“a word of”

See how you translated the similar use of **word** in 12:25.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 13:5 (#4)

וְרָשָׁע

“but a wicked {one”

See how you translated **a wicked one** in 9:7.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 13:6 (#3)

תָּם־דָּרֶךְ

“the blameless of way”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:20.

See: Possession

Proverbs 13:6 (#1)

צְדָקָה & וְרִשְׁעָה

“Righteousness & but wickedness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Righteousness** in 1:3 and **wickedness** in 4:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:6 (#2)

צְדָקָה תִּצַּר תָּם־דָּרֶךְ

“Righteousness guards the blameless of way”

Here Solomon refers to people protecting themselves by acting righteously as if **Righteousness** were a person who **guards** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Being righteous enables the blameless of way to be protected] or [Those who live blamelessly protect themselves by being righteous]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:6 (#4)

תְּסַלֵּף חַטָּאת

“leads a sinful one astray”

Here Solomon refers to people deliberately doing wicked things that will result in their destruction as if **wickedness** were a person who **leads** them **astray**. See how you translated the same use of **leads astray** in 12:16.

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:7 (#3)

וְהוֹן רָב

“but much wealth”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but there is much wealth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:7 (#2)

וְאֵין כֹּל

“but there is nothing {at} all”

Solomon says **nothing at all** here as a generalization for emphasis. He means either that this person has **nothing** valuable or has very few possessions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [but has nothing valuable at all] or [but truly does not have much wealth]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 13:7 (#1)

יֵ֣שׁ מִמְתְעַשֵּׁר & מִמְתְרוֹשֵׁ֖שׁ

“There is one pretending to be rich & one pretending to be poor”

The phrases **one pretending to be rich** and **one pretending to be poor** do not refer to specific people, but to types of people. If it would be helpful, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [There are people who pretend to be rich ... people who pretend to be poor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:8 (#4)

לֹא־שָׁמַ֥ע

“does not hear”

Here Solomon refers to **a poor one** completely ignoring **a rebuke** as if that person did not even hear it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [ignores] or [ignores as if he did not even hear]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:8 (#2)

אִ֭ישׁ עָשְׁרֹ֑ו

“a man {is} his riches”

Although **a man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that could refer to either **a man** or a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person is that person’s riches]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 13:8 (#5)

גְּעָרָ֗ה

“a rebuke”

Here, the word translated **rebuke** refers to a threat that someone makes against the life of **a poor one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a threat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:8 (#3)

וְ֝רָ֗ש

“but a poor one”

Solomon is speaking of **poor** people in general, not of one particular **poor one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but any poor person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:8 (#1)

כֹּ֣פֶר נֶ֭פֶשׁ־אִישׁ

“The ransom of the life of a man”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **ransom** that relates to **the life** and **the life** that relates to **a man**. If your language would not use the possessive form for these, you could use different expressions. Alternate translation: [The ransom that must be paid to redeem a man’s life] or [What a man must pay to buy back his own life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 13:9 (#2)

א֭וֹר־צַדִּיקִ֣ים יִשְׂמָ֑ח

“The light of the righteous will be glad”

Here Solomon refers to the lives of **the righteous ones** being enjoyable as if their lives were a **light** that could be **glad**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [The lives of the righteous ones will be enjoyable] or [The lives of the righteous ones will be enjoyable like a brightly shining light]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:9 (#3)

וְנֵ֣ר רְ֭שָׁעִים יִדְעָֽךְ

“but the lamp of the wicked goes out”

Here Solomon refers to the death of **the wicked ones** as if their lives were lamps that stop burning to produce light. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but the life of the wicked ones will end] or [but the life of the wicked ones is like a lamp that will be extinguished]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:9 (#1)

א֭וֹר & וְנֵ֣ר

“The light of & but the lamp of”

The light and **the lamp** refer to lights and lamps in general, not one particular **light** and **lamp**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [The lights of ... but the lamps of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:10 (#2)

רַק־בְּזָדוֹן יִתֵּתֵן מַצָּה

“With presumptuousness comes only contention”

Solomon says **only** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [With presumptuousness one should expect contention]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 13:10 (#3)

וְאֶת־נִוָּעָצִים חָכְמָה

“but with those who are counseled, wisdom”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but with those who are counseled comes wisdom]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:10 (#4)

נִוָּעָצִים

“those who are counseled”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [those whom people counsel]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:10 (#1)

רַק־בְּזָדוֹן יִתֵּתֵן מַצָּה & חָכְמָה

“With presumptuousness comes only contention & wisdom”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **presumptuousness**, **contention**, and **wisdom**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **presumptuousness** in 11:2 and **wisdom** in 1:2. Alternate translation: [When people are presumptuous they only make people contend with each other ... being wise]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:11 (#3)

וְקֹבֵץ עַל־יָיִד

“but one gathering by hand”

Here, **gathers by hand** could refer to: (1) gathering something gradually in small amounts as if one were gathering it in one’s **hand**. Alternate translation: [but one who gathers gradually]; (2) working hard to gather something, as if one were using one’s hands to do the work. Alternate translation: [but one who gathers by laboring]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 13:11 (#2)

וְקֹבֵץ עַל־יָיִד

“but one gathering by hand”

Solomon is speaking of people who gather **by hand** in general, not of one particular person **gathering by hand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but any person who gathers by hand]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:11 (#1)

מֵהֶבֶל

“from emptiness”

Here, **from emptiness** refers to obtaining something easily or without effort. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [obtained easily] or [that someone gains without effort]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:11 (#4)

יַרְבֶּה

“will increase”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [will increase wealth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:12 (#4)

תַּאֲוָה בָאָה

“a desire fulfilled”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desire**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [when people get what they have wanted for a long time, it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:12 (#2)

מְמֻמֶּשָׁכָה & בָּאָה

“deferred & fulfilled”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that does not yet become reality ... that becomes reality] or [that does not happen ... that does happen]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:12 (#1)

תּוֹחֶלֶת

“Hope”

See how you translated the abstract noun **hope** in 10:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:12 (#3)

מַחֲלַה־לֵבָב

“makes a heart sick”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to someone despairing or feeling sad. If it would be helpful in you language, you could express the meaning plainly or use an equivalent idiom in your language. Alternate translation: [makes a person sad] or [breaks a person’s heart]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 13:12 (#5)

וְעֵץ חַיִּים

“but & is} a tree of life”

See how you translated **a tree of life** in 3:18.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:13 (#3)

יֵחָבֵל לוֹ

“it will go badly for him”

The pronoun **it** here refers to the situation of **despising a word**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [by doing that, bad things will happen to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 13:13 (#2)

לַדָּבָר

“a word”

Here, **word** refers to instructions or advice that people say by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [instruction] or [people instructing him]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 13:13 (#4)

הַהוּא יְשֻׁלָּם

“that one will be rewarded”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will reward that person]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:13 (#1)

בָּזָ

“One despising”

Solomon is speaking of people who despise advice in general, not of one particular person **who despises**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Anyone who despises]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:14 (#4)

לָסוּר מִמֹּקְשֵׁי מָוֶת

“to turn away from the snares of death”

Here Solomon speaks of someone avoiding dangerous situations that could result in that person dying as if that person were physically turning away from deadly **snares** that were in his path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to avoid deadly situations] or [to avoid dangers that are like traps that cause death]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:14 (#5)

לָסוּר

“to turn away”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the law of the wise turns people away]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:14 (#2)

חֲכָמִים

“the wise”

Here Solomon is using the adjective **wise** as a noun to mean **wise** people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the wise ones]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 13:14 (#3)

מְקוֹר חַיִּים

“is} a fountain of life”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:11.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:14 (#1)

תּוֹרַת

“The law of”

The law here does not refer to any specific **law** but refers to lessons or instructions in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [The instruction of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:15 (#4)

אֵיתָן

“is} permanent”

Here the word translated **permanent** refers to something that is unrelenting or unchanging. The idea would be that treacherous people are obstinate in their sin. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternatively, many scholars think that a different word should be here, meaning “their destruction.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT. Alternate translation: [is unrelenting] or [does not change]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:15 (#3)

וְדֶרֶךְ

“but the way of”

See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:15 (#2)

שֵׂכֶל & חֵן

“insight & favor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **insight** in 1:3 and **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:15 (#1)

שֵׂכֶל־טוֹב יִתֶּן־חֵן

“Good insight gives favor”

Here Solomon speaks of a person receiving **favor** because that person has **Good insight** as if the **insight** were a person who could give **favor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Good insight causes the person who has it to be favored by others]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:16 (#3)

יִפְרֹשׂ אִוֶּלֶת

“displays folly”

Here Solomon implies that **a stupid one displays folly** by how he acts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [displays his folly by what he says and does]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:16 (#2)

יִפְרֹשׂ אִוֶּלֶת

“displays folly”

Here Solomon refers to **a stupid person** allowing other people to know how foolish he is as if his **folly** were objects that he could spread out for other people to see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [makes it obvious that he is foolish]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:16 (#1)

בְּדָעַת & אִוֶּלֶת

“with knowledge & folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **knowledge** in 1:4 and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:17 (#5)

מַרְפֵּא

“causes} healing”

Here, Solomon is speaking as if the mental well-being that **an envoy of faithfulness** causes were physical **healing**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes peace] or [gives his senders confidence]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:17 (#4)

וְצִיר אֱמוּנִים

“but an envoy of faithfulness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe an **envoy** that is characterized by **faithfulness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but a faithful envoy]

See: Possession

Proverbs 13:17 (#3)

בְּרָע

“into evil”

Here, **evil** refers to trouble that someone might experience as a result of **evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into trouble]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 13:17 (#2)

יִפֹּל בְּרָע

“falls into evil”

Here Solomon refers to someone experiencing **evil** as if it were a place into which that person **falls**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [experiences evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:17 (#1)

מַלְאָךְ רָשָׁע

“A wicked messenger”

Here, **wicked messenger** specifically refers to a **messenger** who is unreliable. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [An unreliable messenger]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:18 (#2)

פּוֹרֵעַ & וְשֹׁמֵר

“are for} one avoiding & but one keeping”

Here, **one avoiding** and **one keeping** refer to people who do these things in general, but not to any specific **one**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [are for those who avoid ... but those who keep]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:18 (#4)

יְכֻבָּד

“will be honored”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will honor]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:18 (#1)

רֵישׁ וָקָלוֹן & מוּסָר & תּוֹכֵחַת

“Poverty and shame & correction & a rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Poverty** in 6:11, **shame** in 6:33, and **correction** and **rebuke** in 3:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:18 (#3)

וְשֹׁמֵר

“but one keeping”

Here Solomon refers to someone accepting **a rebuke** from someone else as if **a rebuke** were an object that one **keeps**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who accepts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:19 (#3)

וְתוֹעֲבַת כְּסִילִים

“but the abomination of the stupid”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe an **abomination** that relates to **stupid** people. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [but what stupid people consider to be an abomination]

See: Possession

Proverbs 13:19 (#4)

סָר֣וּ מֵרָ֑ע

“is} turning away from evil”

See how you translated “turn away from evil” in 3:7.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:19 (#1)

לְנַפְשׁ

“to the self”

Here Solomon implies that **self** refers to the same person who has the **desire** mentioned earlier in the verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to one’s self]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:19 (#2)

וְתוֹעֲבַת & מֵרָ֑ע

“but the abomination of & from evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **abomination** in 3:32 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:20 (#3)

יֵרוֹעַ

“will be harmed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will experience harm]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:20 (#1)

הלוך & וְרֹעֶ֑ה

“One walking & but one associating with”

One walking and **one associating with** refer to people who do these things in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Those who walk ... but those who associate with]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:20 (#2)

הלוך

“One walking”

See how you translated the same use of “walk” in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:21 (#2)

תְּרַדְּפָ֣ךְ

“will pursue”

Here Solomon refers to **sinners** experiencing **Evil** as if **Evil** were a person who could **pursue** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will happen to] or [will be experienced by]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:21 (#3)

יְשֻׁלַּ֣ם

“will reward”

Here Solomon refers to **righteous ones** experiencing **goodness** as if **goodness** were a person who could **reward** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will happen to] or [will be experienced by]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:21 (#1)

רָעָ֑ה & טוֹב

“Evil & goodness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Evil** and **goodness**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **Evil** in 1:16. Alternate translation: [What is evil ... what is good]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:22 (#4)

וְצָפוּן לַצַּדִּיק חֵיל חוֹטֵא

“but the wealth of a sinner is stored up for the righteous”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but the righteous will receive the wealth that a sinner has stored up] or [but the wealth that a sinner has stored up will go to the righteous]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:22 (#2)

יַנְחִיל בְּנֵי־בָנִים

“will cause sons of sons to inherit”

Solomon is leaving out words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the next clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [will cause sons of sons to inherit his wealth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:22 (#1)

טוֹב & לַצַּדִּיק & חוֹטֵא

“The good & a sinner & for the righteous”

The good, **a sinner**, and **the righteous** refer to types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any good person ... any sinner ... for righteous people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:22 (#3)

בְּנֵי־בָנִים

“sons of sons”

Here Solomon implies that **sons of sons** refers to the grandchildren of **The good** mentioned earlier in the verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [their sons of sons]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:23 (#2)

וְיֵשׁ נִסְפֶּה

“but there is {food} being swept away”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but there is the poor ones’ food being swept away]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:23 (#3)

נִסְפֶּה בְּלֹא מִשְׁפָּט

“being swept away by no justice”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that injustice sweeps away]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:23 (#4)

נִסְפֶּה

“being swept away”

Here, **swept away** refers to completely removing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that is removed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:23 (#5)

בְּלֹא מִשְׁפָּט

“by no justice”

Here Solomon refers to **no justice** as if it were a person who causes the food of poor people to be **swept away**. He means that injustice results in poor people lacking food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of injustice] or [because people act unjustly]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:23 (#1)

נִיר

“is in} the unplowed field of”

An **unplowed field** is a **field** that has not been prepared for growing crops. If your readers would not be familiar with plowing fields for farming, you could use the name of a similar farming practice in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [is in the field that has not been prepared for food production by]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 13:24 (#4)

שְׁחָרָ֥ו מוּסָֽר

“diligently seeks him {with} discipline”

Here Solomon refers to a parent **diligently** disciplining that parent’s child as if that parent were **diligently** seeking that child **with discipline**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [diligently disciplines him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:24 (#2)

שֹׂונֵֽא

“hates”

Solomon says **hates** here as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [acts unlovingly toward]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 13:24 (#3)

בְּנ֗וֹ וְ֭אֹהֲבֹו שְׁחָרָֽו

“his son, but one who loves him diligently seeks him”

Although the term **son** and **him** are masculine, Solomon is using those words in a generic sense that could refer to either a male or female child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [his child, but one who loves that child diligently seeks that child]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 13:24 (#1)

חוֹשֵׂ֣ךְ שִׁבְטֹ֣ו שֹׂונֵ֣א בְנ֑וֹ וְ֭אֹהֲבֹו שְׁחָרָ֣ו מוּסָֽר

“One who withholds his rod hates his son, but one who loves him diligently seeks him {with} discipline”

Here the terms **One who withholds**, **his**, **one who loves**, and **him** do not refer to specific people, but refer to these types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Those who withhold their rods hate their sons, but those who love them diligently seek them with discipline]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:25 (#1)

צַדִּ֥יק & נַפְשֹׁ֑ו

“A righteous {one & his appetite”

A righteous one and **his** here do not refer to specific people, but refer to a type of person in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any righteous one … that person’s appetite]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:25 (#3)

וּבֶ֖טֶן רְ֣שָׁעִ֑ים תֶּחְסָֽר

“but the stomach of the wicked will lack”

Here Solomon refers to **the wicked** always being hungry as if their stomachs **lack**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the wicked ones will not have enough] or [but the hunger of the wicked ones will not be satisfied]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 13:25 (#2)

וּבֶ֖טֶן

“but the stomach of”

The word **stomach** represents stomachs in general, not one particular **stomach**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but the stomachs of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 14 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 14 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism
Except for 14:7, 10, 13, 17, 26, 27, and 34, all the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Proverbs 14:1 (#2)

בָּנְתָתָה בֵיתָהּ

“builds her house”

Here Solomon refers to a woman making her family prosper as if she were building a **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes her family to prosper]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:1 (#1)

חַכְמֹות נָשִׁים בָּנְתָתָה בֵיתָהּ

“The wisest of women builds her house”

The wisest of women and **her** here do not refer to a specific person, but refer to a type of person in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Those women who are most wise build their houses]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:1 (#4)

תֲהָרְסֶנּוּ

“tears it down”

Here Solomon refers to a woman ruining her family as if she were tearing **down** a house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [harms it] or [destroys it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:1 (#3)

וְאִוֶּלֶת בְּיָדֶיהָ תֲהָרְסֶנּוּ

“but a foolish woman tears it down with her hands”

Here, **a foolish woman** and **her** do not refer to a specific person, but refer to a type of person in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [but those women who are foolish tear it down with their hands]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:1 (#5)

בְּיָדֶיהָ

“with her hands”

Here, **hands** refers to what a person does, which often involves using **hands**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by her deeds] or [by what she does]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:2 (#1)

הוֹלֵךְ בְּתֻמּוֹ & וְנִלְוָז דְּרָכָיו

“The one walking in his uprightness & but the one crooked in his ways”

One walking, **his**, and **the one crooked** refers to types of people in general, not to any specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who walks in uprightness ... but any person who is crooked in his ways]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:2 (#2)

הוֹלֵךְ בְּתֻמּוֹ

“The one walking in his uprightness”

Here Solomon refers to someone behaving in a upright manner as if that person were **walking in his uprightness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of “walk” in 3:23. Alternate translation: [One who conducts his life in an upright manner]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:2 (#3)

וְנִלְוָז דְּרָכָיו

“but the one crooked in his ways”

Here Solomon uses the phrase **crooked in his ways** to refer to someone who acts deceptively. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **crooked** in 2:15. Alternate translation: [but one who is deceptive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:3 (#1)

בְּפִי־אֱוִיל חֹטֶר גַּאֲוָה

“In the mouth of a fool {is} a rod of pride”

In this clause, Solomon refers to what **a fool** says with his **mouth** resulting in him being punished with **a rod** as if he were offering the rod for his punishment along with the words that come out of his mouth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Because of what a fool says, he is punished for pride] or [A fool is punished because of the proud things he says]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:3 (#2)

בְּפִי־אֱוִיל

“In the mouth of a fool”

Here, **mouth** represents what a person says with his mouth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In what a fool says]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:3 (#3)

חֹטֶר גַּאֲוָה

“is} a rod of pride”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **rod** that is used to punish someone for having **pride**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is a rod for punishing proud people]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:3 (#4)

וְשִׂפְתֵי

“but the lips of”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:21.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:3 (#5)

תִּשְׁמוּרֵם

“will preserve them”

Alternate translation: [will keep them from harm] or [will keep them safe]

Proverbs 14:4 (#6)

שׁוֹר

“an ox”

Here, the word **ox** represents oxen in general, not one particular **ox**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression, as in the UST.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:4 (#2)

אֵבוּס

“is} a trough of”

A **trough** is a container that holds food for domesticated animals such as **cattle**. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal food container, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [is a food container of]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 14:4 (#1)

אֵבוּס בָּרָה

“is} a trough of cleanness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **trough** that is characterized by **cleanness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is a clean trough]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:4 (#3)

וְרָב

“but an abundance of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **abundance** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:4 (#4)

בְּכֹחַ שׁוֹר

“is} by the strength of an ox”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is produced by the strength of an ox]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 14:4 (#5)

בְּכֹחַ שׁוֹר

“is} by the strength of an ox”

Here, **strength** refers to the work **an ox** does that involves using **strength**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is by the work done by a strong ox]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:5 (#3)

וְיָפִ֖יחַ כְּזָבִֽים

“but & breathes out lies”

See how you translated **breathes out lies** in 6:19.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 14:5 (#2)

עֵ֣עד שֶׁ֑קֶר

“a witness of falsehood”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:19.

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:5 (#1)

עֵ֣עד אֱ֭מוּנִים

“A witness of faithfulness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **witness** who is characterized by **faithfulness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A faithful witness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:6 (#2)

בְּקֶ֗שׁ

“seeks”

Here, **wisdom** is described as if it were an object that people, trying to be wise, could “seek.” See how you translated the same use of **seeks** in 11:27.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:6 (#3)

חָכְמָ֣ה & וְדַ֑עַת

“wisdom & but knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:6 (#1)

לֵ֭ץ & לְנָבוֹן

“A mocker & for the understanding one”

See how you translated **a mocker** in 9:7 and **the understanding one** in 1:5.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:6 (#5)

וְדַ֑עַת

“but knowledge”

Solomon is leaving out a word that, in many languages, a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but finding knowledge] or [but acquiring knowledge]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 14:6 (#4)

וְאָ֣יִן

“and there is none”

Here Solomon means that **a mocker** cannot acquire **wisdom**, not that **wisdom** does not exist. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he cannot find it] or [and there is no wisdom for him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:7 (#1)

לֵ֤ךְ מִ֭נֶּגֶד לְאִ֣ישׁ כְּסִ֑יל וּבַל־יָ֝דַ֗עְתָּ שִׂפְתֵי־דָֽעַת

“Go before a man of stupidity, and you will not know lips of knowledge”

Here, **Go** is an imperative, but it begins a conditional statement rather than a command. It is a warning; it is not something that Solomon wants anyone to do. Use a form in your language that communicates a conditional statement. Alternate translation: [If you go before a man of stupidity, then you will not know lips of knowledge]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 14:7 (#2)

לֵ֤ךְ מִ֭נֶּגֶד

“Go before”

Here, **Go before** means to go into the presence of this person, not to go somewhere in front of this person or to go somewhere in advance of this person. Alternate translation: [Go into the presence of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:7 (#5)

שִׂפְתֵי־דָֽעַת

“lips of knowledge”

Here, **lips** refers to what people say by moving their **lips**. Solomon is referring to words that express **knowledge**. See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [words that express knowledge]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:7 (#4)

לְאִ֣ישׁ

“a man of”

Here, **a man** represents a type of people in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any person of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:7 (#3)

לְאִ֣ישׁ כְּסִ֑יל

“a man of stupidity”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **stupidity**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a stupid man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:8 (#4)

כְּסִילִ֑ים

“the stupid”

Solomon is using the adjective **stupid** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [foolish people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 14:8 (#3)

דַּרְכּ֣וֹ

“his way”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:8 (#1)

חָכְמַ֣ת & וְאִוֶּ֣לֶת & מִרְמָ֑ה

“The wisdom of & but the folly of & is} deceit”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** in 1:2, **folly** in 5:23, and **deceit** in 11:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:8 (#2)

עָרִ֥ום

“a prudent {one”

See how you translated this phrase in 12:16.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 14:9 (#3)

רָצ֑וֹן

“is} favor”

Here Solomon implies that this **favor** is from Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is Yahweh’s favor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:9 (#1)

אָשָׁ֑ם

“the guilt offering”

Mocking **the guilt offering** implies that **The foolish mock** the need for people to offer **the guilt offering** in order to ask Yahweh to forgive them for sinning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [offering guilt offerings to Yahweh for forgiveness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:9 (#2)

רָצ֑וֹן

“is} favor”

See how you translated **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:10 (#1)

לֵּ֫לֶב

“A heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The inner being of a person]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:10 (#2)

מָ֭רַת & וּֽבְשִׂמְחָתֹ֑ו

“the bitterness of & and in its joy”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **bitterness** and **joy**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [how bitter it is ... and in its feeling joyful,]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:11 (#3)

יַפְרִ֑יחַ

“will flourish”

Here Solomon refers to a family prospering as if it were a plant with blooming flowers that **flourish**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will prosper]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:11 (#2)

יִשָּׁמֵֽד

“will be destroyed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will destroy]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:11 (#1)

בֵּ֣בֵית & וְאֹ֖הֶל

“The house of & but the tent of”

In this verse, **house** and **tent** refer to the people who live in them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The household of ... but the household of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:12 (#1)

דֶּ֣רֶךְ יָ֭שָׁר

“a straight road”

Solomon is speaking of how a person lives as if that were a **road** or path that the person was walking along. Here, **straight** refers to the road being easy rather than being morally right. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [an easy way to live]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:12 (#4)

וְ֝אַחֲרִיתָ֗הּ

“but its end”

Here, the **end** of this **road** refers to the final result of living in this way. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but its result]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:12 (#5)

דַּרְכֵי־מָֽוֶת

“is} the ways of death”

Here Solomon uses **ways** to refer to the destiny of those people who live according to what they have chosen as **a straight road**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the destiny of death]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:12 (#2)

לִ֝פְנֵי־אִ֗ישׁ

“to the face of a man”

Here, **to the face of** refers to what is directly in front of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [right in front of a man]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:12 (#3)

אִ֗ישׁ

“a man”

The word **man** represents a person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:12 (#6)

דַּרְכֵי־מָוֶת

“is} the ways of death”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the ways** that are **death**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is the ways that are death] or [is the destiny that is death]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:13 (#2)

לֵבָב

“a heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [a person’s inner being]

Proverbs 14:13 (#1)

בִּשְׂחָק & שִׂמְחָה תוּגָה

“in laughter & joy {may be} grief”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **laughter**, **joy**, and **grief**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [when laughing ... feeling joyful may be feeling sad]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:14 (#1)

סָג֣וֹג לֵבָ֣ב & אִ֭ישׁ טֽוֹב

“A backsliding heart & a good man”

A backsliding heart and **a good man** each refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person backsliding in heart ... any good person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:14 (#2)

סָג֣וֹג לֵבָ֣ב

“A backsliding heart”

Here Solomon refers to the person who has stopped behaving righteously and is now behaving wickedly as if that person were a **backsliding heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The person who stops living righteously]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:14 (#5)

מִדְּרָכָ֑יו

“from his ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:14 (#4)

יִשְׂבַּ֥ע

“will be filled”

In this clause, the word translated **filled** implies that the person who has decided to live unrighteously will fully experience the negative consequences of **his ways**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will experience all the consequences] or [will be fully repaid]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:14 (#3)

יִשְׂבַּ֥ע

“will be filled”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will fill]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:14 (#6)

וּמֵעָלָ֥יו אִ֝ישׁ טֽוֹב

“but a good man, from his deeds”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language.

Alternate translation: [but a good man will be filled from his deeds]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 14:15 (#3)

לַאֲשֻׁרָו

“his step”

Here, **step** refers to a person’s behavior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his behavior] or [his actions]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:15 (#2)

דָּבָֽר

“word”

See how you translated the same use of **word** in 12:25.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:15 (#1)

פֶּ֭תִי & וְ֝עָרֽוּם

“A naive one & but a prudent {one”

A naive one and **a prudent one** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a prudent one** in 12:16. Alternate translation: [Any naive person ... but any prudent person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:16 (#2)

וְסָ֣ר מֵרָֽע

“and turns away from trouble”

Solomon is speaking as if **trouble** were an object that **A wise one** physically **turns away** to walk in a different direction from. He means that he decides not to join in situations that could get him into trouble. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and does not take part in troubling situations]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:16 (#3)

מִתְעַבֵּ֣ר וּבוֹטֵֽחַ

“interferes and is confident”

The phrase **interferes and is confident** expresses a single idea. The word **confident** tells more about how the stupid one **interferes**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [carelessly intrudes] or [overconfidently interferes]

See: Hendiadys

Proverbs 14:16 (#1)

חָכָ֥ם & וּ֝כְסִ֗יל

“A wise {one & but a stupid {one”

See how you translated **a wise one** in 1:5 and **a stupid one** in 10:18.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:17 (#3)

אִוֶּ֑לֶת

“folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:17 (#1)

קְצַר־אַ֭פַּיִם

“One} short of nostrils”

The phrase **short of nostrils** is an idiom that refers to a person who becomes angry quickly. The word **nostrils** means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose, causing his **nostrils** to open wide. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [One who easily vents his spleen] or [One who becomes angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 14:17 (#4)

וְאִ֥ישׁ מְ֝זִמּ֗וֹת

“and a man of schemes”

See how you translated **a man of schemes** in 12:2.

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:17 (#5)

יִשָּֽׂנָא

“is hated”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language, as in the UST.

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:17 (#2)

קְצַר־אַפַּיִם & וְאִישׁ מְמֻזְּמוֹת

“One} short of nostrils & and a man of schemes”

One short of nostrils and **a man of schemes** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a man of schemes** in 12:2. Alternate translation: [Any person short of nostrils ... and any person of schemes] or [Any person who gets angry quickly ... and any person who schemes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:18 (#2)

אִוֶּלֶת & דָּעַת

“folly & knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **folly** in 5:23 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:18 (#1)

נָחֲלָ֥ו & אִוֶּלֶת

“inherit folly”

Here Solomon speaks of **Naive ones** becoming foolish as if **folly** were property or wealth that they could **inherit** from a family member. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **inherit** in 3:35. Alternate translation: [become foolish]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:18 (#3)

יַכְתִּתְּרוּ דָּעַת

“will wear a crown of knowledge”

Here Solomon speaks of people being rewarded with **knowledge** as if **knowledge** were a **crown** they **will wear**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [will be rewarded with knowledge] or [will be rewarded with knowledge as if it were a crown that they wore]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:19 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

Here, the word **face** represents the presence of a person by association with the way people can see the **face** of someone who is present. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:19 (#5)

צַדִּיק

“the righteous one”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 10:3.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:19 (#4)

עַל־שַׁעֲרֵי

“at the gates of”

Here, **gates** refers to the doorway of the house of **the righteous one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [at the gates of the house of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:19 (#1)

שָׁחֲחוּ

“will bow down”

To **bow down** is a symbolic action that shows humble respect or submission to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [will bow down to show respect]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 14:19 (#3)

וְרְשָׁעִים עַל־שַׁעֲרֵי צַדִּיק

“and the wicked at the gates of the righteous one”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be

complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the wicked will bow down at the gates of the righteous one]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 14:20 (#2)

גַּם־לְרֵעֵהוּ יִשָּׂנֵא רָאשׁ

“One who is poor is hated even by his neighbor”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Even a poor person’s neighbor hates him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:20 (#1)

לְרֵעֵהוּ & רָאשׁ & עָשִׁיר

“One who is poor & by his neighbor & the rich”

The expressions **One who is poor**, **his neighbor**, and **the rich** each refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who is poor … by that person’s neighbors … any rich person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:21 (#1)

בָּז־לְרֵעֵהוּ חוֹטֵא וּמְחוֹנֵן עֲנִיִּים אַשְׁרָיו

“The one despising his neighbor sins, but the one who shows favor to the lowly, happy {is} he”

The one despising, **his neighbor**, **the one who shows favor**, and **he** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who despises that person’s neighbors sins, but any person who shows favor to lowly people, happy is that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:21 (#2)

וּמְחוֹנֵן

“but the one who shows favor to”

Here, **shows favor** refers to being kind to someone, not to favoring one person over another. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but the one who is compassionate to]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:22 (#3)

וְחֶסֶד וֶאֱמֶת חֹרְשֵׁי טוֹב

“But covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness {are} devisers of good”

The relationship between **covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness** and **devisers of good** is unspecified. This line could mean: (1) **covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness** are characteristics of the **devisers of good**. Alternate translation: [But devisers of good show covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness] or (2) **covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness** are benefits that **devisers of good** will receive from others. Alternate translation: [But covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness will benefit devisers of good]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:22 (#1)

הֲלוֹא־יִתְעוּ חֹרְשֵׁי רָע

“Do not devisers of evil go astray”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Devisers of evil certainly go astray!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 14:22 (#2)

רָע & וְחֶסֶד וֶאֱמֶת & טוֹב

“evil & But covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness & good”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **evil** in 1:16, **covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness** in 3:3, and **good** in 11:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:23 (#4)

וּדְבַר־שְׂפָתַיִם

“but the word of lips”

Here, **the word of lips** represents what people say by using their lips. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. See how you translated the similar use of **word** in 12:25. Alternate translation: [but just talking]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:23 (#1)

עֶ֭עָצֵב & מוֹתָ֣ר & לְמַחְסֹ֑ור

“toil & profit & is & for lack”

See how you translated the abstract nouns “toils” in 5:10, **profit** in 3:14, and **lack** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:23 (#2)

וּ֝דְבַר־שְׂ֗פָתַ֥יִם

“but the word of lips”

Here Solomon implies that this refers to **the word of lips** without any **toil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but the word of lips without toil] or [but the word of lips by itself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:23 (#3)

וּ֝דְבַר־שְׂ֗פָתַ֥יִם

“but the word of lips”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the word** that is spoken with **lips**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but the word spoken by lips]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:23 (#5)

אַךְ־לְמַחְסֹ֑ור

“is} only for lack”

Here, **is only** indicates that **lack** is the result of the preceding phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [results only in lack]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 14:24 (#1)

עֲטֶ֣רֶת

“The crown of”

Here Solomon speaks of the reward of **the wise ones** as if it were a **crown** they wear. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated the similar use of **crown** in 14:18. Alternate translation: [The reward of] or [The reward that is like a crown of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:24 (#3)

אִוֶּ֥לֶת & אִוֶּ֗לֶת

“the folly of & is} folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:24 (#2)

אִוֶּ֗לֶת כְּסִילִ֥ים

“the folly of stupid ones”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:8.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:25 (#3)

כְּזָבִ֑ים

“lies”

The implication is that these **lies** are false accusations that harm people. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:25 (#2)

וְיָפִ֖יחַ כְּזָבִ֣ים

“but & breathes out lies”

See how you translated **breathes out lies** in 6:19.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 14:25 (#1)

עֵ֣ד אֱ֭מֻנִים

“A witness of truth”

See how you translated the same use of **A witness of** in 14:5.

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:26 (#4)

וּ֝לְבָנָ֗יו

“and for his sons”

Here, **his** refers to any person who fears Yahweh. Alternate translation: [and for the sons of the person who fears Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 14:26 (#6)

יִהְיֶה מַחְסֶה

“he will be a refuge”

The pronoun **he** refers to: (1) Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will be a refuge] or (2) the fear of Yahweh. Alternate translation: [that fear will be their refuge]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 14:26 (#2)

בְּיִרְאַת יְהוָה

“In the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated **the fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:26 (#3)

מִבְטַח

“is & confidence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **confidence** in 3:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:26 (#5)

וּלְבָנָיו

“and for his sons”

Although the term **sons** is masculine, Solomon is using the word here in a generic sense that could refer to either male or female children. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [and for his children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 14:26 (#1)

בְּיִרְאַת יְהוָה מִבְטַח־עֹז

“In the fear of Yahweh {is} strong confidence”

Here Solomon refers to someone having **confidence** because that person has **the fear of Yahweh** as if **the fear of Yahweh** were a location in which **confidence** resided. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [People who fear Yahweh have strong confidence in him] or [By fearing Yahweh, people have strong confidence in him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:26 (#7)

מַחְסֶה

“a refuge”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **refuge**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [someone who protects them]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:27 (#3)

לָסוּר מִמֹּקְשֵׁי מָוֶת

“to turn away from the snares of death”

See how you translated the same clause in 13:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:27 (#1)

יִרְאַת יְהוָה

“The fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7 and in the previous verse.

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:27 (#2)

מְקֹר חַיִּים

“is} a fountain of life”

See how you translated **a fountain of life** in 10:11 and 13:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:28 (#1)

בְּרָב־עָם הַדְרַת־מֶלֶךְ

“With the abundance of people {is} the majesty of a king”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **abundance** and **majesty**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [An abundant number of people is what makes a king majestic]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:28 (#2)

מֶלֶךְ & רָזוֹן

“a king & the ruler”

Here, **a king** and **the ruler** both refer to people who rule over others in general, not to specific kings. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any king ... any ruler]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:28 (#3)

וּבְאֶ֣פֶס

“but with the end of”

Here, **end** refers to a lack of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but with the decline of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:29 (#5)

מֵרֵ֥ים

“lifts up”

Here Solomon speaks of someone publicly showing **folly** as if **folly** were an object that someone **lifts up** for everyone to see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [publicly displays] or [lets everyone observe]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:29 (#3)

תְּבוּנָ֑ה & אִוֶּ֣לֶת

“understanding & folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **understanding** in 1:2 and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:29 (#1)

אֶ֭רֶךְ אַפַּ֣יִם & וּקְצַר־רֽוּחַ

“One long of nostrils & but one short of spirit”

One long of nostrils and **one short of spirit** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person long of nostrils ... but any person short of spirit]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:29 (#4)

וּקְצַר־רֽוּחַ

“but one short of spirit”

The phrase **short of spirit** is an idiom that refers to a type of person who gets angry quickly. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but a short-tempered person] or [but one who becomes angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 14:29 (#2)

אֶ֭רֶךְ אַפַּ֣יִם

“One long of nostrils”

The phrase **long of nostrils** is an idiom that refers to a type of person who does not become angry quickly. The word “nostrils” means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose, causing his nostrils to open wide. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [One who does not easily vent his spleen] or [One who does not become angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 14:30 (#2)

לֵ֣ב מַרְפֵּ֑א

“A heart of healing”

Here Solomon uses **heart** to refer to a person’s inner being or mind. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [A peaceful liver] or [A tranquil mind]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:30 (#5)

וּרְקָ֣ב עֲצָמ֑וֹת קִנְאָֽה

“but envy {is} the decay of bones”

Here Solomon is saying that **envy** harms a person’s health like a disease that causes **the decay of bones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but envy ruins a person’s health] or [but

envy harms one's health like disease decays one's bones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:30 (#4)

חַיֵּי בְּבָשָׂרִים

"is} life to bodies"

Here, **life to bodies** refers to a something being healthy for a person's **body**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is healthy for one's body] or [causes one's body to be healthy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:30 (#6)

קִנְאָה

"envy"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **envy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [being envious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:30 (#1)

לֵ֣ב מַרְפֵּ֣א

"A heart of healing"

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **heart** that is characterized by **healing**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A healed heart] or [A sound heart]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:30 (#3)

לֵ֣ב

"A heart of"

A heart of healing refers to people's hearts in general, not to a specific **heart**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any heart of ... any body]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:31 (#3)

חֵרֵ֥ף עֹשֵׂ֑הוּ

"taunts his maker"

Since God made the lowly person in his image, to disrespect God's work is to disrespect God. So in that sense, oppressing a lowly person is the same as taunting God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [disrespects the one who made him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:31 (#4)

עֹשֵׂ֑הוּ

"his maker"

The pronoun **his** refers to the **lowly one**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the one who made the lowly one]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 14:31 (#2)

דָּ֝ל

"a lowly one"

The phrase **lowly one** refers to a poor person. See how you translated the same use of "lowly ones" in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:31 (#7)

חֹנֵ֥ן

"one showing favor to"

See how you translated the same use of "shows favor to" in 14:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:31 (#6)

וּמְכַבְּדוֹ

"but & honors him"

Here, **him** refers to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but ... honors Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 14:31 (#1)

עֹ֭שֵׁק דָּ֣ל & עֹשֵׂ֑הוּ & חֹנֵ֖ן אֶבְיֽוֹן

"An oppressor of a lowly one & his maker & one showing favor to a needy one"

An oppressor. **a lowly one**, **his**, **one showing favor**, and **a needy one** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could

use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any oppressor of any lowly person ... that person's maker ... any person who shows favor to any needy person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:31 (#5)

עֹשֵׂהוּ

"his maker"

Here, **maker** refers to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [God, his maker] or [his maker, who is God] or [his Maker]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:32 (#3)

יִדָּחֶנָּה

"is thrust down"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [thrusts himself down]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:32 (#4)

יִדָּחֶנָּה

"is thrust down"

Here Solomon refers to a person's life becoming ruined or destroyed as if that person were **thrust down**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of "thrown down" in 10:8. Alternate translation: [is destroyed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:32 (#2)

בְּרָעָתוֹ & בְּמוֹתָתוֹ

"By his evil & in his death"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **evil** in 1:16 and **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:32 (#6)

בְּמוֹתָתוֹ

"in his death"

Here Solomon speaks of the time when someone dies as if **death** were a place where that person enters. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when dying]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:32 (#5)

וְחֹסֶה & צַדִּיק

"but the righteous {one} finds refuge"

Here Solomon speaks of **refuge** as if it were an object that someone **finds**. He means that someone becomes safe or protected. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the righteous one is protected]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:32 (#1)

בְּרָעָתוֹ & רָשָׁע & בְּמוֹתָתוֹ & צַדִּיק

"By his evil the wicked {one & the righteous {one & in his death"

Here, **his**, **the wicked one**, and **the righteous one** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated **the wicked one** in 3:33 and **the righteous one** in 10:16. Alternate translation: [By the evil of any wicked person that person ... any righteous person ... in that person's death]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:33 (#4)

תִּוָּדֵע

"she will be known"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will know her]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:33 (#3)

חָכְמָה

"wisdom"

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:33 (#1)

בְּלֵ֣ב נָ֭בוֹן תָּנ֣וּחַ חָכְמָ֑ה

“In the heart of the understanding one rests wisdom”

Here Solomon refers to **the understanding one** thinking wisely as if **wisdom** were an object that **rests** inside that person’s **heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2. Alternate translation: [The understanding one thinks with wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:33 (#5)

תִּוָּדֵֽעַ

“she will be known”

Here, **she** refers to **wisdom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wisdom will be known]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 14:33 (#2)

נָבוֹן

“the understanding one”

See how you translated **the understanding one** in 1:5.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:34 (#1)

צְדָקָ֣ה & וְחֶ֣סֶד & חַטָּ֣את

“Righteousness & but sin {is} shame”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Righteousness** in 1:3, **sin** in 5:22, and **shame** in 6:33.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:34 (#3)

לְאֻמִּ֑ים

“for peoples”

The plural use of **peoples** here refers to several groups of people that could also be called “nations” or “countries.” See how you translated “people” in 11:14.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 14:34 (#2)

תְּרוֹמֵ֣ם־גּ֑וֹי

“raises a nation”

Here Solomon refers to a **nation** becoming great as if it were an object that **Righteousness raises** up. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “raised up” in 11:11. Alternate translation: [makes a nation great]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:35 (#1)

רְצ֣וֹן & מַשְׂכִּ֣יל וְ֭עֶבְרָתוֹ

“The delight of & who has insight, but his rage”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **delight** in 8:30, **insight** in 1:3, and **rage** in 11:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:35 (#2)

מֶ֣לֶךְ לְעֶ֣בֶד & וְ֭עֶבְרָתוֹ תִּהְיֶ֣ה מֵבִ֑ישׁ

“a king {is} for the servant & but his rage is {for} one who acts shamefully”

Here, **a king**, **the servant**, **his**, and **one who acts shamefully** refer to types of people, not to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any king is for any servant ... but any king’s rage is for any person who acts shamefully]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 15 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 15 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism

Except for 15:3, 10–12, 16–17, 23–24, 30–31, and 33, all the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Proverbs 15:1 (#3)

יָשִׁ֣יב חֵ֑מָה

“turns back heat”

The phrase is an idiom that refers to decreasing a person's anger as if that anger were **heat** that someone **turns back**. The word **heat** means "anger" by association with the way that an angry person's body increases in **heat**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [decreases anger] or [causes an angry person to become calm]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:1 (#5)

יַעֲלֶה־אָֽף

"lifts up a nose"

The phrase is an idiom that refers to increasing a person's anger. The word **nose** means "anger" by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his **nose**. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [increases anger] or [causes an angry person to become angrier]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:1 (#2)

מַעֲנֶה־רַ֭כ & וּדְבַר־עֶ֣צֶב

"A gentle answer & but a word of pain"

A gentle answer and **a word of pain** refer to types of things people say, not to a specific **answer** or **word**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any gentle answer ... but any word of pain]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:1 (#4)

וּדְבַר־עֶ֣צֶב

"but a word of pain"

The phrase **a word of pain** refers to something that is spoken harshly, as if what is spoken would cause **pain** to the listener. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but what is spoken harshly] or [a hurtful word]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:1 (#1)

מַעֲנֶה־רַ֭ךְ יָשִׁ֣יב חֵמָ֑ה וּדְבַר־עֶ֣צֶב יַעֲלֶה־אָֽף

"A gentle answer turns back heat, but a word of pain lifts up a nose"

In this verse, Solomon implies that the **gentle answer** and **word of pain** are spoken to an angry person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [A gentle answer spoken to an angry person turns back that person's heat, but a word of pain spoken to an angry person lifts up that person's nose]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:2 (#1)

לְשׁ֣וֹן חֲ֭כָמִים & וּפִ֣י כְּסִילִ֑ים

"The tongue of the wise & but the mouth of the stupid"

The tongue of the wise ones and **the mouth of stupid ones** refer to what these types of people say using their tongues and mouths, not to a specific **tongue** or **mouth**. See how you translated similar phrases in 12:18 and in 10:6. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:2 (#4)

וּפִ֣י כְּסִילִ֑ים יַבִּ֖יעַ אִוֶּֽלֶת

"but the mouth of the stupid gushes forth folly"

Here Solomon refers to **stupid** people always saying foolish things as if their mouths were places from which **folly gushes forth** like flowing water. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the mouths of stupid ones are always speaking folly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:2 (#2)

תֵּיטִ֣יב דָּ֭עַת

"makes knowledge good"

The phrase **makes knowledge good** refers to speaking **knowledge** in a way that **makes knowledge** pleasant or attractive to others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [makes knowledge pleasing to others]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:2 (#3)

דָּעַת & אִוֶּלֶת

“knowledge & folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **knowledge** in 1:4 and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:3 (#2)

רָעִים וטוֹבִים

“the evil and the good”

Solomon is using the adjectives **evil** and **good** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases, as in the UST.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:3 (#1)

בְּכָל־מָקוֹם עֵינֵי יְהוָה

“The eyes of Yahweh {are} in every place”

Here Solomon refers to Yahweh’s ability to see everything as if Yahweh had **eyes** that were located **in every place**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh sees what is happening everywhere]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:4 (#2)

מַרְפֵּא לָשׁוֹן

“A healing tongue”

A healing tongue refers to what someone says that soothes the listener. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **tongue** in 6:17. Alternate translation: [The comforting thing someone says]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:4 (#3)

עֵץ חַיִּים

“is} a tree of life”

See how you translated **a tree of life** in 3:18.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:4 (#5)

שֶׁבֶר בְּרוּחַ

“is} a breaking in the spirit”

The phrase **a breaking in the spirit** is an idiom that refers to making a person despair. If it would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [makes a person feel down in the dumps] or [makes a person despair]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:4 (#4)

וְסֶלֶף בָּהּ

“but crookedness in it”

Here Solomon refers to deceitful speech as if it were a crooked tongue. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the deceitful thing someone says]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:4 (#1)

מַרְפֵּא לָשׁוֹן & וְסֶלֶף בָּהּ שֶׁבֶר בְּרוּחַ

“A healing tongue & but crookedness in it {is} a breaking in the spirit”

A healing tongue, **it**, and **a breaking in the spirit** do not refer to specific things but represent these things in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any healing tongue … but crookedness in any such tongue is what breaks spirits]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:5 (#2)

מוּסָר & תּוֹכֵחַת

“the correction of & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **correction** in 3:11 and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:5 (#3)

וְשֹׁמֵר תּוֹכֵחַת

“but one who keeps rebuke”

See how you translated **one who keeps rebuke** in 13:18.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:5 (#1)

אֱוִיל & אָבִיו וְשֹׁמֵר תּוֹכַחַת

“A fool & his father, but one who keeps rebuke”

A fool, **his**, and **one who keeps rebuke** do not refer to specific people but represent types of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any fool ... that fool’s father, but any person who keeps a rebuke]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:6 (#1)

בֵּית צַדִּיק & וּבְתְבוּאַת רָשָׁע

“The house of the righteous & but in the harvest of the wicked”

The house of the righteous and **the harvest of the wicked** do not refer to specific things and people, but represent those things and types of people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any house of righteous people ... but any harvest of wicked people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:6 (#2)

וּבִתְבוּאַת רָשָׁע נֶעְכָּרֶת

“but in the harvest of the wicked is being troubled”

Here Solomon refers to **the harvest of the wicked** causing **the wicked** to be **troubled** as if **being troubled** were an object located **in the harvest**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the harvest of the wicked causes them trouble]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:7 (#3)

דָּעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:7 (#4)

וְלֵב כְּסִילִים

“but the heart of the stupid”

See how you translated **the heart of stupid ones** in 12:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:7 (#2)

יְזָרוּ דָּעַת

“scatter knowledge”

Here Solomon refers to teaching other people knowledge as if **knowledge** were the seeds that a farmer scatters to plant in a field. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [teach others knowledge]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:7 (#1)

שִׂפְתֵי חֲכָמִים

“The lips of the wise”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:3.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:8 (#1)

זֶבַח & וּתְפִלַּת

“The sacrifice of & but the prayer of”

The sacrifice and **the prayer** represent sacrifices and prayers in general, not one particular **sacrifice** or **prayer**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any sacrifice of ... but any prayer of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:8 (#4)

רְצוֹנוֹ

“is} his delight”

See how you translated the abstract noun **delight** in 11:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:8 (#2)

זֶבַח רְשָׁעִים & וּתְפִלַּת יְשָׁרִים

“The sacrifice of the wicked & but the prayer of the upright”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **sacrifice** and **prayer**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation:

[What the wicked ones sacrifice ... but what the upright ones pray]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:8 (#3)

תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה

“is} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated **an abomination to Yahweh** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:9 (#1)

תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה

“An abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:9 (#2)

דֶּרֶךְ

“is} the way of”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:9 (#5)

צְדָקָה

“righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **righteousness** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:9 (#4)

וּמְרַדֵּף צְדָקָה

“but a pursuer of righteousness”

Here Solomon refers to someone being diligent to live righteously as if that person were **a pursuer** of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but someone who strives to be righteous]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:9 (#3)

רָשָׁע וּמְרַדֵּף

“the wicked, but a pursuer of”

Here, **the wicked** and **a pursuer** represent types of people, not one particular **wicked** person or **pursuer**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [all wicked ones ... but everyone who pursues]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:10 (#1)

מוּסָר & תּוֹכֵחַת

“discipline & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **discipline** in 13:24 and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:10 (#2)

לְעֹזֵב & שׂוֹנֵא

“is} for one who forsakes & one who hates”

Here, **one who forsakes** and **one who hates** represent types of people, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [is for any person who forsakes ... any person who hates]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:10 (#3)

לְעֹזֵב אֹרַח

“is} for one who forsakes the path”

Here Solomon refers to a person who is no longer behaving righteously, but behaving wickedly, as if that person **forsakes** the righteous **path**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is for one who stops living righteously]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:11 (#3)

לִבּוֹת

“the hearts of”

See how you translated the same use of “heart” in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:11 (#4)

בְּנֵי־אָדָם

“the sons of man”

See how you translated this phrase in 8:4.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 15:11 (#1)

שְׁאוֹל וַאֲבַדּוֹן

“Sheol and Abaddon”

Sheol and **Abaddon** both refer to the place where people’s spirits go when they die. Solomon is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. See how you translated **Sheol** in 1:12. Alternate translation: [the place where the spirits of dead people dwell] or [the place of the dead]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 15:11 (#2)

נֶגֶד

“are} before”

Here Solomon refers to **Yahweh** knowing everything about **Sheol and Abaddon** as if they were in front of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are fully known by]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:12 (#2)

לֹא יֶאֱהַב

“does not love”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [really hates]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 15:12 (#1)

לֵץ הוֹכֵחַ לוֹ & לֹא יֵלֵךְ

“A mocker & one who rebukes him & he will not go”

A mocker, **one who rebukes**, **he**, and **him** represent types of people, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any mocker … any person who rebukes that person … that person will not go]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:12 (#3)

לֹא יֵלֵךְ

“he will not go”

Here Solomon implies that going **to the wise ones** is in order to get advice from them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will not go to receive their advice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:13 (#4)

רָעָה נְכֵאָה

“a spirit {is} stricken”

Here Solomon refers to a person despairing as if that person’s **spirit** were hit or crushed by something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a person feels despair]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:13 (#1)

לֵב שָׂמֵחַ

“A joyful heart”

Here Solomon uses **heart** to refer a person’s inner being or mind. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:13 (#3)

וּבְעַצְבַּת־לֵב

“but by pain of heart”

Here Solomon refers to a person who is feeling sad as if that person has **pain of heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but by feeling sad]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:13 (#2)

יֵיטִיב פָּנִים

“makes a face glad”

Here Solomon speaks as if a person’s face were glad. He means that the person is smiling. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes one to smile]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 15:14 (#5)

כְּסִילִ֑ים

“the stupid”

Solomon is using the adjective **stupid** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [stupid people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:14 (#3)

יְבַקֶּשׁ

“seeks”

See how you translated the same use of **seeks** in 11:27.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:14 (#2)

לֵ֣ב & ופני

“The heart of & but the mouth of”

In this verse, **heart** and **mouth** refer to the whole person. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 6:18 and **mouth** in 4:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 15:14 (#6)

יִרְעֶ֥ה

“feeds on”

Here Solomon refers to **stupid ones** being satisfied with **folly** as if **folly** were something they feed on like cattle feed on grass. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are satisfied by]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:14 (#4)

דָּ֭עַת & אִוֶּ֣לֶת

“knowledge & folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **knowledge** in 1:4 and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:14 (#1)

לֵ֣ב נָ֭בוֹן יְבַקֶּשׁ־דָּ֑עַת ופני כְּסִילִ֥ים יִרְעֶ֥ה

“The heart of the understanding one seeks knowledge, but the mouth of the stupid feeds on”

The heart, **the understanding one**, and **the mouth** represent these things and type of people in general, not one particular **heart**, **understanding one**, or **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [The hearts of the understanding ones seek knowledge ... but the mouths of the stupid feed on]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:15 (#2)

עָנְיִ֑

“the afflicted”

Solomon is using the adjective **afflicted** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [afflicted people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:15 (#6)

מִשְׁתֶּ֣ה תָמִֽיד

“has} a feast continually”

Here Solomon refers to a person enjoying life as if that person is always eating at a **feast**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a simile or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [lives as if he is continually feasting] or [is always enjoying life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:15 (#1)

כָּל־יְמֵ֣י עָנְיִ֑

“All the days of the afflicted”

All the days here represents what happens during the time that **the afflicted** are alive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The things that happen during all the days that the afflicted are alive]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:15 (#4)

רָעִ֗ים

“are} evil”

Here, **evil** refers to what is miserable or troublesome. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are troublesome ones] or [are troublesome]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:15 (#5)

וְטוֹב־לֵֽב

“but the good of heart”

Here, **the good of heart** refers to a person who feels happy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the one who feels happy]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:15 (#3)

עָנְיִ֑י & וְטוֹב־לֵֽב

“the afflicted & but the good of heart”

Here, **the afflicted** and **the good of heart** represent types of people, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any afflicted one ... but any person who is good of heart]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:16 (#5)

וּמְהוּמָ֥ה בּֽוֹ

“and anxiety with it”

Here Solomon refers to feeling **anxiety** as if that **anxiety** were an object that someone could have with **much treasure**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and having anxiety] or [and being anxious]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:16 (#4)

בְּיִרְאַ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“with the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated **the fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:16 (#3)

בְּיִרְאַ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“with the fear of Yahweh”

Here Solomon refers to fearing **Yahweh** as if that **fear** were an object that someone could have **with** even **a little** of whatever they have. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while having fear of Yahweh] or [and fearing Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:16 (#2)

מְמְעָ֗ט

“is} a little”

Here Solomon is using the adjective **little** as a noun to refer to a small amount of something. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [is having a small amount]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:16 (#6)

וּמְהוּמָ֥ה

“and anxiety”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **anxiety**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and being anxious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:16 (#1)

מְמְעָ֗ט & מֵאוֹצָ֥ר רָ֝ב

“is} a little & than much treasure”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is having a little ... than having much treasure]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 15:17 (#3)

וְאַהֲבָ֥ה & וְשִׂנְאָֽה

“and love & and hatred”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **love** and **hatred** in 10:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:17 (#2)

אֲרֻחַת יָרָק

“is} a portion of vegetables”

Here, **a portion of vegetables** refers to a small meal without much food. This kind of meal would be eaten by someone who cannot afford to buy meat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is very little food] or [is a poor person’s meal]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:17 (#1)

אֲרֻחַת יָרָק וְאַהֲבָה & מִשּׁוֹר אָבוּס וְשִׂנְאָה

“is} a portion of vegetables and love & than a fattened ox and hatred”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is having a portion of vegetables and having love … than having a fattened ox and having hatred]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 15:17 (#4)

מִשּׁוֹר אָבוּס

“than a fattened ox”

Here, **a fattened ox** refers to a large meal including meat such as **a fattened ox**. This kind of meal would be eaten by a wealthy person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [than very much food] or [than a wealthy person’s meal]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:17 (#5)

וְשִׂנְאָה־בּוֹ

“and hatred with it”

Here Solomon refers to feeling **hatred** as if that **hatred** were an object that someone could have **with a fattened ox**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while having hatred]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:18 (#2)

אִישׁ חֵמָה

“A man of heat”

A man of heat refers to someone who gets angry easily. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **heat** in 6:34. Alternate translation: [A person who becomes angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:18 (#7)

יַשְׁקִיט רִיב

“will quiet a dispute”

Here Solomon refers to someone causing people who are arguing to become calm and stop arguing as if that person were causing the **dispute** to become **quiet**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will calm disputing people]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:18 (#4)

מָדוֹן & רִיב

“a quarrel & a dispute”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **quarrel** and **dispute**, you could express the same ideas in another way. See how you translated “quarrels” in 6:14. Alternate translation: [quarreling … disputing]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:18 (#5)

מָדוֹן וְאֶאֱרֶךְ אַפַּיִם & רִיב

“a quarrel, but one long of nostrils & a dispute”

Here, **a quarrel**, **one long of nostrils**, and **a dispute** represent events and a type of person in general, not a specific event or person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [quarrels, but any person long of nostrils … disputes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:18 (#3)

יְגָרֶה

“stirs up”

Here Solomon refers to starting **a quarrel** as if it were something that a person **stirs up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [starts] or [causes]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:18 (#1)

אִישׁ חֵמָה

“A man of heat”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [A person of heat]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 15:18 (#6)

וְאֶרֶךְ אַפַּיִם

“but one long of nostrils”

See how you translated **one long of nostrils** in 14:29.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:19 (#2)

דֶּרֶךְ עָצֵל כִּמְשֻׂכַּת חָדֶק וְאֹרַח יְשָׁרִים סְלֻלָה

“The way of the lazy {is} like a hedge of briar, but the path of the upright {is} a built-up highway”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of a person living his life as though he were walking on a **way**, **path**, or **highway**. This refers to a person’s progress throughout that person’s lifetime. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The way that the lazy live blocks their progress in life like a hedge of brier, but the way that the upright live results in a life of great progress]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:19 (#3)

עָצֵל & יְשָׁרִים

“the lazy & the upright”

Solomon is using the adjectives **lazy** and **upright** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [lazy ones ... upright ones]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:19 (#1)

דֶּרֶךְ עָצֵל כִּמְשֻׂכַּת חָדֶק וְאֹרַח יְשָׁרִים סְלֻלָה

“The way of the lazy {is} like a hedge of briar, but the path of the upright {is} a built-up highway”

The way of the lazy and **the path of the upright** do not refer to specific things and people, but represent those things and types of people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated **the lazy** in 10:26. Alternate translation: [The ways of lazy ones are like a hedge of brier, but the paths of the upright ones are a built-up highway]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:19 (#4)

כִּמְשֻׂכַּת חָדֶק

“is} like a hedge of briar”

Here Solomon compares the difficult and unproductive lifestyle of a **lazy** person with a **hedge of brier** that prevents someone from walking down a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [is difficult]

See: Simile

Proverbs 15:19 (#5)

כִּמְשֻׂכַּת חָדֶק

“is} like a hedge of briar”

The phrase **hedge of brier** refers to a dense group of bushes that contains sharp thorns. Because the **hedge** is thick and has thorns, people cannot walk through it. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of plant, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [is like a large thorn bush] or [is like a thorny plant that blocks the way]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 15:19 (#6)

סְלֻלָה

“is} a built-up highway”

Here Solomon refers to the productive lifestyle of **the upright ones** as if it were a **highway** that was well-made and easy to walk on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is productive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:20 (#2)

וּכְסִיל אָדָם בּוֹזֶה אִמּוֹ

“but a stupid man despises his mother”

Although **a stupid man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that can include both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [but it is a stupid person who despises his or her mother]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 15:20 (#1)

בֵּן חָכָם יְשַׂמַּח־אָב

“A wise son gladdens a father”

See how you translated this clause in 10:1.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:21 (#2)

לַחֲסַר־לֵב

“to the lacking of heart”

See how you translated **the lacking of heart** in 9:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:21 (#3)

וְאִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

“but the man of understanding”

See how you translated **man of understanding** in 10:23.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:21 (#5)

יְיַשֶּׁר־לָכֶת

“makes to go straight”

Here Solomon speaks of a person doing what is right as if he were walking **straight** ahead on a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [does the right thing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:21 (#4)

יְיַשֶּׁר־לָכֶת

“makes to go straight”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [makes himself to go straight]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 15:21 (#1)

אִוֶּלֶת שִׂמְחָה & תְּבוּנָה

“Folly {is} a joy & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Folly** in 5:23, **joy** in 10:28, and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:22 (#2)

סָעוֹד

“counsel”

See how you translated the abstract noun **counsel** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:22 (#3)

תָּקוּם

“it will stand”

The pronoun **it** refers to the **Plans** in the previous clause. If this is not clear for your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those plans will stand]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 15:22 (#1)

הֲפֵרִ֣ מַחְשָׁבוֹת

“Plans are broken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Plans fail]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 15:22 (#4)

תָּקוּם

“it will stand”

Here Solomon refers to **Plans** that are successful as if they were a person who would continue to **stand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they will be successful]

See: Personification

Proverbs 15:23 (#7)

וְדָבָר בְּעִתּוֹ מַה־טּוֹב

“and how good {is} a word in its time”

The phrase **a word in its time** represents the message that **the man** spoke at the appropriate time. See how you translated the similar use of **word** in 12:25. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and how good is a message spoken at the appropriate time]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:23 (#5)

בְּמַעֲנֵה־פִיו

“in the answer of his mouth”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe an **answer** that someone says with **his mouth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [in the good answer he says] or [in what he says well in reply]

See: Possession

Proverbs 15:23 (#3)

שִׂמְחָה

“Joy”

See how you translated the abstract noun **joy** in 10:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:23 (#4)

בְּמַעֲנֵה־פִיו

“in the answer of his mouth”

The phrase **a word in its time** in the second clause implies that **the answer** in the first clause is a good or fitting **answer**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the good answer of his mouth] or [in the fitting reply of his mouth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:23 (#6)

וְדָבָר בְּעִתּוֹ מַה־טּוֹב

“and how good {is} a word in its time”

This clause is a positive exclamation that emphasizes that something spoken at the right time is very good. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show this by making it a separate sentence and using a positive exclamation that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [A word in its time is very good!]

See: Exclamations

Proverbs 15:23 (#1)

שִׂמְחָה לָאִישׁ בְּמַעֲנֵה־פִיו

“Joy {is} for the man in the answer of his mouth”

Solomon is speaking of an answer as if it were a container, and he is speaking of **Joy** as if it were an object that could be inside that container. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The man has joy because of the answer of his mouth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:23 (#2)

שִׂמְחָה לָאִישׁ בְּמַעֲנֵה־פִיו

“Joy {is} for the man in the answer of his mouth”

Here, **the man**, **the answer**, and **his** refer to a type of people and answers in general, not a specific **man** or **answer**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person has joy because of an answer of that person’s mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:24 (#2)

אֹרַח חַיִּים לְמַעְלָה

“The path of life {is} upward”

Here Solomon speaks of a lifestyle that results in a good, long life as if it were a **path** that goes **upward**. This is opposite from the path that leads down to Sheol. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The right way of living results in a good and long life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:24 (#3)

חַיִּים

“life”

Here, **life** refers to both quality and length of **life**. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:24 (#6)

מִשְּׁאוֹל מָטָּה

“from Sheol below”

The Israelites referred to dying as going down to **Sheol**, which is the place where people’s spirits go when they die. Here Solomon refers to **Sheol** as if it were **below** the place where living people are. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. See how you translated **Sheol** in 1:12. Alternate translation: [from the place where the spirits of dead people dwell] or [from the place of the dead]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:24 (#1)

אֹרַח חַיִּים לְמַעְלָה לְמַשְׂכִּיל

“The path of life {is} upward for the insightful one”

The path of life and **the insightful one** represent paths and insightful people in general, not a specific **path** or **insightful one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [The paths of lives are upward for those who are insightful]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:24 (#4)

לְמַעַן סוּר

“in order to turn away”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [in order for the insightful one to turn away]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 15:24 (#5)

לְמַעַן סוּר מִשְּׁאוֹל

“in order to turn away from Sheol”

Here Solomon speaks of avoiding **Sheol** as if **Sheol** were a place that a person could **turn away from**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in order to avoid going to Sheol]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:25 (#4)

גֵּאִים

“the proud”

Solomon is using the adjective **proud** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [proud people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:25 (#2)

בֵּית גֵּאִים & גְּבוּל אַלְמָנָה

“the house of the proud & the boundary of the widow”

Here, **the house**, **the proud**, **the boundary**, and **the widow** refer to houses, proud people, boundaries, and widows in general, not one particular **house**, **proud** person, **boundary**, or **widow**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [the houses of any proud ones ... the boundaries of any widows]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:25 (#7)

אַלְמָנָה

“the widow”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **the widow** is helpless and poor because widows were some of the poorest people in ancient societies. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the helpless widow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:25 (#5)

וְיַצֵּב

“but he will set up”

Here Solomon refers to Yahweh protecting or maintaining **the boundary of the widow** as if it were an object that he **set up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but he will protect]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:25 (#3)

בֵּ֣ית

“the house of”

Here, **house** refers to both the building someone lives in and the items within that **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the property of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:25 (#1)

יִסַּ֣ח

“will tear down”

Here Solomon refers to Yahweh destroying **the house of the proud ones** as if he were tearing it **down**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will ruin]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:25 (#6)

גְּבֻל

“the boundary of”

The word **boundary** refers to stones that were used to mark the borders of the land that a person owned. Here Solomon uses **boundary** to refer to all the land and possessions within the **boundary** of the land that **the widow** owns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the property of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:26 (#2)

אִמְרֵי־נֹ֑עַם

“words of pleasantness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **words** that are characterized by **pleasantness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [pleasant words]

See: Possession

Proverbs 15:26 (#1)

תּוֹעֲבַ֣ת יְהוָ֔ה

“are} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated **an abomination to Yahweh** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:26 (#3)

אִמְרֵי

“words of”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:27 (#3)

בֵּיתֹ֑ו

“his house”

See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:27 (#4)

וְשֹׂנֵ֖א מַתָּנֹ֥ת

“but one who hates bribes”

The phrase **one who hates bribes** refers to a person who refuses to receive **bribes** that someone else might offer them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but one who refuses to accept bribes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:27 (#1)

בֵּיתֹ֑ו בֹּוצֵ֣עַ & וְשֹׂנֵ֖א

“One who unjustly gains & his house, but one who hates”

One who unjustly gains, **his**, and **one who hates** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who unjustly gains ... that person’s house, but any person who hates]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:27 (#2)

בֹּוצֵ֣עַ בָּ֔צַע

“One who unjustly gains unjust gain”

See how you translated the similar emphatic use of “unjustly gain unjust gain” in 1:19.

See: Poetry

Proverbs 15:27 (#5)

יִחְיֶֽה

“will live”

Here, **live** refers to living a good, long life. See how you translated the same use of **live** in 9:6.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:28 (#2)

לֵ֭בָב

“The heart of”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 6:18. Alternate translation: [The mind]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:28 (#5)

יַבִּ֣יעַ

“gushes forth”

See how you translated the same use of **gushes forth** in 15:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:28 (#3)

לַעֲנ֑וֹת

“to answer”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to answer a person]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 15:28 (#1)

לֵ֭בָב צַדִּ֣יק יֶהְגֶּ֑ה & וּפִ֖י רְ֝שָׁעִ֗ים יַבִּ֣יעַ

“The heart of the righteous considers {how & but the mouth of the wicked gushes forth”

The heart, **the righteous**, and **the mouth** represent things and a type of people in general, not a specific **heart**, **righteous** person or **mouth**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The hearts of any righteous ones consider how ... but the mouths of the wicked ones gush forth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:28 (#6)

רָעֽוֹת

“evils”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evils**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [evil things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:28 (#4)

וּפִ֖י

“but the mouth of”

See how you translated the same use of **the mouth of** in 10:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:29 (#2)

וּתְפִלַּ֥ת

“but the prayer of”

The word **prayer** represents prayers in general, not one particular **prayer**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but the prayers of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:29 (#3)

וּתְפִלַּ֥ת

“but the prayer of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **prayer** in 15:8.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:29 (#1)

רָחוֹק֮ יְהוָ֪ה מֵ֫רְשָׁעִ֥ים

“Yahweh {is} far from the wicked”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh not listening to **the wicked** as if he were physically **far** away from them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh does not heed wicked people]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:29 (#4)

יִשְׁמָֽע

“he hears”

Here, **hears** implies that Yahweh not only hears but also responds to what he **hears**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he hears, and he responds to that prayer]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:30 (#2)

מָאוֹר־עֵינַ֥יִם

“The luminary of the eyes”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that he is referring to someone seeing **The luminary of the eyes**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Seeing the luminary of the eyes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:30 (#4)

לֵ֑בָב

“the heart”

Here, **heart** refers to the whole person. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 6:18.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 15:30 (#6)

תְּדַשֶּׁן־עָֽצֶם

“fattens the bone”

Here Solomon refers to **good news** making people feel healthy as if it **fattens** their bones. The word **bone** here refers to a person’s whole body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes people to feel healthy]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:30 (#3)

מָאוֹר־עֵינַ֥יִם

“The luminary of the eyes”

Here Solomon refers to a joyful facial expression as if the person’s **eyes** shined brightly like a **luminary** body, such as the sun. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A cheerful expression]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:30 (#5)

שְׁמוּעָ֣ה טֹובָ֑ה

“good news”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that he is referring to someone hearing **good news**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [hearing good news]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:30 (#1)

מָאוֹר־עֵינַ֥יִם יְשַׂמַּח־לֵ֑בָב & עָֽצֶם

“The luminary of the eyes gladdens the heart & the bone”

The luminary, **the heart**, and **the bone** represents those things in general, not one particular **luminary**, **heart**, or **bone**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Luminaries of the eyes gladdens hearts ... bones]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:31 (#5)

בְּקֶ֖רֶב חֲכָמִ֣ים תָּלִֽין

“will lodge in the midst of the wise ones”

Here Solomon refers to a person being considered wise as if that person were dwelling with **the wise ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be considered one of the wise ones]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:31 (#4)

תּוֹכֵ֣חַת

“the rebuke of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:31 (#2)

אֹ֭זֶן

“An ear”

Here, **ear** refers to the whole person who listens. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A listener]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 15:31 (#3)

תּוֹכֵ֣חַת חַיִּ֑ים

“the rebuke of life”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **rebuke** that results in **life**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the rebuke that leads to life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 15:31 (#1)

אֹ֣זֶן & תּוֹכֵ֣חַת

“An ear & the rebuke of”

An ear and **the rebuke** represent those things in general, not one particular **ear** or **rebuke**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Ears ... the rebukes of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:32 (#2)

מָ֭וּסָר & תִּתְּוֹכַ֣חַת

“correction & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **correction** in 3:11 and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:32 (#5)

לֵ֑ב

“heart”

Here Solomon uses **heart** to refer to a person’s ability to think. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:32 (#4)

נַפְשׁ֗וֹ

“his life”

Here, **his life** refers to the person himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [himself]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 15:32 (#1)

פּוֹרֵ֣עַ & נַפְשׁ֗וֹ וְשׁוֹמֵ֥עַ

“One who avoids & his life, but one who hears”

One who avoids, **his**, and **one who hears** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who avoids ... that person’s life, but any person who hears]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:32 (#3)

מוֹאֵ֣אָס

“rejects”

Solomon says **rejects** here as an overstatement for emphasis. He means that someone who **avoids correction** is doing what will ruin **his life**, as if he actually **rejects his life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [behaves as if he does not care about]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 15:33 (#4)

וְלִ֝פְנֵ֗י כָּבֹ֥וד עֲנָוָֽה

“and to the face of honor {is} humility”

Here Solomon is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **to the face of** in 8:25. Alternate translation: [and humility must come before honor] or [and humility precedes honor]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:33 (#1)

יִרְאַ֣ת יְ֭הוָה

“The fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 15:33 (#2)

מוּסַ֣ר חָכְמָ֣ה & כָּבֹ֑וד

“is} instruction of wisdom & honor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **instruction** in 1:2 and **honor** in 3:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:33 (#5)

עֲנָוָ֥ה

“is} humility”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **humility**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is being humble]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:33 (#3)

מוּסַ֣ר חָכְמָ֣ה

“is} instruction of wisdom”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **instruction** that results in **wisdom**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is instruction that results in wisdom]

See: Possession

Proverbs - Chapter 16 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 16 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 10–15 mostly contain proverbs that consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other. Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 16 also contains contrasting parallelism (16:1, 2, 9, 14, 22, 33) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (16:11, 16, 18, 30). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 16:1 (#1)

לְאָדָ֣ם מַעַרְכֵי־לֵ֭בָב וּמֵיְהוָ֣ה מַעֲנֵ֥ה לָשֽׁוֹן

“The arrangements of the heart {are} a man’s, but the answer of the tongue {is} from Yahweh”

Here, **the heart**, **a man’s**, **the answer**, and **the tongue** refer to these things and people in general, not a specific thing or person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The arrangements of any man’s heart belongs to that man, but the answers of any man’s tongue are from Yahweh]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:1 (#4)

לֵ֭בָב

“the heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:1 (#8)

וּמֵיְהוָ֣ה

“but & is} from Yahweh”

Here, the phrase **is from Yahweh** indicates that **Yahweh** is who determines **the answer of the tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is determined by Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:1 (#3)

מַעַרְכֵי־לֵ֭בָב

“The arrangements of the heart”

The arrangements of the heart here could mean: (1) **arrangements** about what to say, which is suggested by the phrase **the answer of the tongue** in the next clause. Alternate translation: [The arrangements of the heart regarding what to say]; (2) human **arrangements** in general. Alternate translation: [The arrangements of the heart about something]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:1 (#2)

מַעַרְכֵי־לֵ֭בָב & מַעֲנֵ֥ה לָשֽׁוֹן

“The arrangements of the heart & the answer of the tongue”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **arrangements** and **answer**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how

you translated **answer** in 15:1. Alternate translation: [Things that the heart arranges ... what the tongue answers]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:1 (#5)

לְאָדָ֑ם

“are} a man’s”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **arrangements** that are determined by the person who makes them. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [are determined by a man] or [are determined by those who make them]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:1 (#6)

מַעֲנֵ֥ה לָשׁ֖וֹן

“the answer of the tongue”

Here, **the answer of the tongue** refers to **the answer** that someone speaks by using **the tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17. Alternate translation: [what one says in reply] or [the spoken answer]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:1 (#7)

מַעֲנֵ֥ה לָשׁ֖וֹן

“the answer of the tongue”

Here, **the answer of the tongue** could refer to: (1) an **answer** related to the **arrangements** in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [the answer of the tongue about those arrangements]; (2) an **answer** in general. Alternate translation: [any answer of the tongue]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:2 (#3)

בְּעֵינָ֑יו

“in his eyes”

See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 3:4.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:2 (#5)

רוּחֹ֣ת

“spirits”

Here, **spirits** refers to the thoughts and motives of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people’s thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:2 (#1)

דַּרְכֵ֣י

“the ways of”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:2 (#4)

וְתֹכֵ֖ן & יְהוָֽה

“but Yahweh examines”

Here, **examines** refers to judging or evaluating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but Yahweh judges]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:2 (#2)

אִ֣ישׁ & בְּעֵינָ֑יו

“a man & in his eyes”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [any person ... in that person’s eyes]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 16:3 (#2)

מַעֲשֶׂ֑יךָ & מַחְשְׁבֹתֶ֖יךָ

“your works & your plans”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **works** in 8:22 and **plans** in 1:31.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:3 (#1)

גֹּ֣ל אֶל־יְהוָ֣ה מַעֲשֶׂ֑יךָ

“Roll to Yahweh your works”

Here Solomon refers to people depending on Yahweh for the outcome of their **works** as if those **works** were

objects that one could **Roll to Yahweh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Depend on Yahweh to direct your works]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:3 (#4)

וְיִכֹּנוּ

“and & will be established”

Here Solomon uses **established** to refer to something being achieved or successful. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and ... will be successful]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:3 (#3)

וְיִכֹּנוּ מַחְשְׁבֹתֶיךָ

“and your plans will be established”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will establish your plans]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:4 (#5)

לְיוֹם רָעָה

“for the day of evil”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **day** that is characterized by **evil**. This refers to a time when Yahweh will punish **wicked** people, either in this life or on the final day of judgment. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for the time of their punishment]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:4 (#3)

וְגַם־רָשָׁע

“and even a wicked {one”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh has even made a wicked one]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 16:4 (#4)

רָשָׁע

“a wicked {one”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:4 (#2)

לַמַּעֲנֵהוּ & רָעָה

“for its purpose & evil”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **purpose** and **evil**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **evil** in 1:16. Alternate translation: [for what they will accomplish ... what is evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:4 (#1)

כֹּל & לַמַּעֲנֵהוּ

“all for its purpose”

Solomon is using the adjective **all** as a noun to mean everything that exists. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [all things for their own purposes]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 16:5 (#3)

יָד לְיָד

“hand to hand”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:21. Alternate translation: [As sure as the sun comes up] or [Assuredly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:5 (#1)

תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה

“An abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:5 (#5)

לֹא יִנָּקֶה

“he will not remain blameless”

See how you translated **will not remain blameless** in 11:21.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 16:5 (#2)

גְּבַהּ־לֵ֫ב

“one high of heart”

Here Solomon refers to a proud person as if that person had a **heart** that was **high**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one who is proud] or [arrogant one]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:5 (#4)

לֹ֣א יִנָּקֶ֑ה

“he will not remain blameless”

Although the term **he** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [that person will not remain blameless]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:6 (#2)

בְּחֶ֣סֶד וֶ֭אֱמֶת יְכֻפַּ֣ר עָוֹ֑ן

“By covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness, iniquity is atoned {for”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. This appears to mean that a person shows that he has repented of his **iniquity** by his **covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness**. In response, Yahweh forgives him of his iniquity. Since both the person and Yahweh are involved in the atoning, use the passive construction if possible. Alternate translation: [Covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness atone for iniquity] or [A person atones for his iniquity by being faithful to his responsibilities to others and by being trustworthy]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:6 (#3)

בְּחֶ֣סֶד וֶ֭אֱמֶת

“By covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness** in 3:3, **iniquity** in 6:12, and **evil** in 1:16. Alternate translation: [By being faithful and by being trustworthy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:6 (#4)

וּבְיִרְאַ֖ת יְהוָ֣ה

“and by the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated **the fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:6 (#5)

סָ֣ור מֵרָֽע

“one turns away from evil”

See how you translated **turns away from evil** in 14:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:6 (#1)

בְּחֶ֣סֶד וֶ֭אֱמֶת יְכֻפַּ֣ר עָוֹ֑ן

“By covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness, iniquity is atoned {for”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [By a person having covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness, a person’s iniquity is atoned for]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 16:7 (#1)

דַּרְכֵ֣י

“the ways of”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:7 (#2)

אִ֭ישׁ גַּם־אֹיְבָ֣יו & אִתֹּ֑ו

“a man & even his enemies & with him”

Although **man**, **his**, and **him** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... even that person’s enemies ... with that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 16:8 (#1)

טוֹב־מְעַט בְּצֶדֶקָה מֵרֹב תְּבוּאוֹת בְּלוֹא מִשְׁפָּט

“Better {is} a little with righteousness than an abundance of produce with no justice”

The author assumes that his readers will understand that **a little** refers to the things needed to maintain life. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [It is better for a person to have a little of what they need with righteousness than for a person to have an abundance of produce with no justice] or [A person who has a little of what they need with righteousness is better off than a person who has an abundance of produce with no justice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:8 (#2)

טוֹב־מְעַט

“Better {is} a little”

See how you translated this phrase in 15:16.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 16:8 (#4)

מֵרֹב תְּבוּאוֹת בְּלוֹא מִשְׁפָּט

“than an abundance of produce with no justice”

See how you translated **an abundance of produce** in 14:4 and **no justice** in 13:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:8 (#3)

בְּצֶדֶקָה

“with righteousness”

Here Solomon refers to being righteous as if that **righteousness** were an object that someone could have **with a little**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while having righteousness] or [while being righteous]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:8 (#5)

בְּלוֹא מִשְׁפָּט

“with no justice”

Here Solomon refers to a lack of **justice** as if **justice** were an object that someone did not have **with an abundance of produce**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and not having justice] or [while having no justice]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:9 (#4)

יְכֹנֵן צַעֲדֹו

“establishes his step”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh determining the individual events related to the working out of a person’s plans as if Yahweh were guiding that person where to **step**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [determines how that plan proceeds]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:9 (#3)

דַּרְכּוֹ

“his way”

Here Solomon refers to what a person wants to do as if it were a **way** he walks on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what he wants to do]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:9 (#1)

לֵב

“The heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:9 (#2)

אָדָם & דַּרְכּוֹ & צַעֲדֹו

“a man & his way & his step”

Although **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person … that person’s way … that person’s step]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 16:10 (#6)

לֹ֣א יִמְעַל־פִּ֑יו

“his mouth must not act unfaithfully”

Solomon is using **his mouth** to represent what **a king** says by using his mouth to announce his judgment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he must not speak unfaithfully]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:10 (#2)

קֶ֚סֶם & בְּמִשְׁפָּ֔ט

“Divination & in judgment”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Divination** and **judgment**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [God’s message … when he judges]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:10 (#4)

מֶ֖לֶךְ

“a king”

This verse describes the traits of an ideal, righteous **king**, not any **king** in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [an ideal king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:10 (#5)

מֶ֖לֶךְ & פִּ֑יו

“a king & his mouth”

Here, the words **king** and **his** represent righteous kings, not one particular **king**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any good king … that king’s mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:10 (#3)

שִׂפְתֵ֥י

“the lips of”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:21.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:10 (#1)

קֶ֚סֶם ׀ עַל־שִׂפְתֵ֣י־מֶ֔לֶךְ

“Divination {is} on the lips of a king”

Divination usually refers to the practice of trying to get information from spirits, which is a practice that Yahweh prohibited. However, Solomon uses the word here to refer to **a king** correctly communicating God’s decisions as God’s representative. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Divinely inspired decisions are on the lips of a king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:10 (#7)

לֹ֣א יִמְעַ֔ל

“must not act unfaithfully”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning by using positive words. Alternate translation: [will certainly act faithfully]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 16:11 (#4)

פֶּ֣לֶס ׀ וּמֹאזְנֵ֣י

“A scale with the two balances of”

A **scale** is an instrument that is used for determining the weight of an object or comparing the weight of two objects. The **two balances** are the pans that hang from either end of the bar of the scale. This bar sits on a middle support, so that when the weights in the two pans are equal, the pans stay level with each other. A merchant who sells things by weight would use a scale to determine their value. he would have stones that were of a standard weight to place on one side of the scale, and the article for sale on the other. A dishonest merchant might use stones that were lighter than the standard and thus cheat his customer, against Yahweh’s design. See how you translated **scales** in 11:1. Alternate translation: [Weighing instruments of]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 16:11 (#2)

פֶּ֣לֶס ׀ וּמֹאזְנֵ֣י מִ֭שְׁפָּט לַיהוָ֑ה מַעֲשָׂ֖יו כָּל־אַבְנֵי־כִֽיס

“A scale with the two balances of justice {belong} to Yahweh; all the stones of the bag {are} his work”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A scale with its two balances of justice belong to Yahweh; yes, all the stones of the bag are his work]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 16:11 (#6)

כָּל־אַבְנֵי־כִיס

“all the stones of the bag”

The phrase **stones of the bag** refers to the weights that were placed on the **scales** in order to determine the weight of an object. These **stones** were carried by merchants in a **bag**. The **scales** consisted of a central post with a crossbar from which two pans were hung. An object would be placed in one pan and these **stones** that had specific weights were placed in the other pan until the crossbar remained level, meaning that both pans contain an equal weight. If your readers would not be familiar with this method of determining weight, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [all the weights] or [all the stones used for determining weight]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 16:11 (#5)

לַיהוָה מַעֲשֵׂהוּ

“belong} to Yahweh & are} his work”

In this verse, the phrases **belong to Yahweh** and **are his work** indicate that the idea of honest weighing instruments originated with him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [come from Yahweh ... are his design] or [originated with Yahweh ... are designed by him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:11 (#1)

פֶּלֶס ׀ וּמֹאזְנֵי מִרְמָה לַיהוָה מַעֲשֵׂהוּ כָּל־אַבְנֵי־כִיס

“A scale with the two balances of justice {belong} to Yahweh; all the stones of the bag {are} his work”

The implication of the references to a **balance**, **scales**, and **stones** in this verse is that God wants people to be honest when selling or buying things. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [A scale with its two balances of justice belong to Yahweh; all the stones of the bag are his work, so be honest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:11 (#3)

פֶּלֶס ׀ וּמֹאזְנֵי מִרְמָה

“A scale with the two balances of justice”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **scale with its two balances** that are characterized by **justice**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A just scale with its two balances]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:12 (#1)

תּוֹעֲבַת & רֶשַׁע & בִּצְדָקָה

“An abomination of & wickedness & by righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **abomination** in 3:32, **wickedness** in 4:17, and **righteousness** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:12 (#4)

יִכּוֹן כִּסֵּא

“is a throne established”

Here, **established** refers to a king having stable and enduring authority over his people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is a throne made secure] or [is a throne made to endure]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:12 (#3)

בִּצְדָקָה יִכּוֹן כִּסֵּא

“by righteousness is a throne established”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [righteousness establishes a throne]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:12 (#2)

מְלָכִים

“kings”

This verse describes the traits of ideal, righteous **kings**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [ideal kings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:12 (#5)

כִּסֵּא

“a throne”

Here, **throne** refers to a king’s authority, which is represented by the **throne** or royal chair upon which a king sits. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a king’s authority]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:13 (#1)

רְצוֹן מְלָכִים שִׂפְתֵי־צֶדֶק וְדֹבֵר יְשָׁרִים יֶאֱהָב

“The delight of kings {is} lips of righteousness, and he loves one who speaks upright things”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [The delight of kings is lips of righteousness, yes, he loves one who speaks upright things]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 16:13 (#4)

שִׂפְתֵי־צֶדֶק

“is} lips of righteousness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **lips** that are characterized by **righteousness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is righteous lips]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:13 (#2)

רְצוֹן & צֶדֶק

“The delight of & righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **delight** in 14:35 and **righteousness** in 8:20.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:13 (#3)

מְלָכִים

“kings”

This verse describes the traits of ideal, righteous **kings**, not any **kings** in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [ideal kings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:13 (#7)

וְדֹבֵר

“and & one who speaks”

Here, **one who speaks** refers to a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [and ... any person who speaks]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:13 (#6)

יֶאֱהָב

“he loves”

Here, **he** refers to the **kings** in the previous clause, not one particular king. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [kings love]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:13 (#5)

שִׂפְתֵי

“is} lips of”

Here, **lips** refers to what people say by moving their **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is sayings of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:14 (#5)

מָֽוֶת

“death”

See how you translated the abstract noun **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:14 (#1)

חֲמַ֣ת

“The heat of”

See how you translated the same use of **heat** in 6:34.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:14 (#3)

מַלְאֲכֵי־מָ֣וֶת

“is} messengers of death”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **messengers** who cause **death**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is messengers who cause death]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:14 (#6)

יְכַפְּרֶ֥נָּה

“will atone {for} it”

Here, **atone for it** refers to doing something that will cause an angry **king** to stop being angry. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [pacify the king’s anger] or [do what he can stop the king from being angry]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:14 (#2)

מֶ֑לֶךְ & וְאִ֖ישׁ חָכָ֣ם

“a king & but a wise man”

Here, **a king** and **a wise man** represent these types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any king … but any wise man]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:14 (#4)

מַלְאֲכֵי־מָ֣וֶת

“is} messengers of death”

Here Solomon speaks of an angry king causing people to die as if his anger were **messengers** whom he sends out to kill someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [puts people to death] or [causes death]

See: Personification

Proverbs 16:15 (#3)

מֶ֑לֶךְ & וּרְצוֹנ֖וֹ

“the king & and his favor”

The words **the king** and **his** represent kings in general, not one particular **king**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any king … and that king’s favor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:15 (#5)

כְּעָ֥ב מַלְק֖וֹשׁ

“is} like a cloud of spring rain”

Here Solomon compares the king showing **favor** toward someone with a **cloud** that brings **rain** in the **spring** to enable the crops to grow. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [benefits a person] or [refreshes a person like clouds bring rain in springtime to refresh the crops]

See: Simile

Proverbs 16:15 (#1)

בְּא֣וֹר־פְּנֵי־מֶ֣לֶךְ חַיִּ֑ים

“In the light of the face of the king {is} life”

Here Solomon refers to people staying alive as if **life** were an object that is located **In the light of the face of the king**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The light of the face of the king causes people to stay alive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:15 (#2)

בְּא֣וֹר־פְּנֵי

“In the light of the face of”

Here Solomon refers to **the king** smiling because he is happy as if it were **the light of the face**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In the smile of] or [In the happiness of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:15 (#4)

וּרְצוֹנֹ֑ו

“and his favor”

See how you translated **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:16 (#1)

קְנֵ֣ה־חָ֭כְמָה מַה־טּ֣וֹב מֵחָרֻ֑וץ וּקְנ֥וֹת בִּ֝֗ינָה נִבְחָ֥ר מִכָּֽסֶף׃

“How much better {it is} to acquire wisdom than gold, and to acquire understanding is to be chosen {more} than silver”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [How better it is to acquire wisdom than gold, yes, to acquire understanding is to be chosen more than silver]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 16:16 (#3)

וּקְנ֥וֹת בִּ֝֗ינָה נִבְחָ֥ר

“and to acquire understanding is to be chosen”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people should choose to acquire understanding]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:16 (#2)

חָ֭כְמָה & בִּ֝֗ינָה

“wisdom & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** in 1:2 and **understanding** in 2:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:17 (#5)

שֹׁמֵ֣ר נַ֭פְשׁ֑וֹ נֹצֵ֖ר דַּרְכֹּ֣ו

“one who protects his life guards his way”

The implication is that guarding his way is necessary in order to protect his life. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in order to protect his life, he must guard his way]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:17 (#1)

מְסִלַּ֣ת

“The highway of”

Here Solomon speaks of **upright** behavior as if it were a well-built **highway** that is free of obstacles. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The behavior of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:17 (#7)

נֹצֵ֖ר דַּרְכֹּ֣ו

“guards his way”

Here Solomon refers to a person being careful about how he behaves as if his behavior were a **way** that he **guards**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [behaves carefully] or [is careful in how he behaves]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:17 (#3)

מֵרָ֑ע & נַ֭פְשׁ֑וֹ

“from evil & his life”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **evil** in 1:16 and **life** in 10:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:17 (#4)

שֹׁמֵ֣ר נַ֭פְשׁ֑וֹ נֹצֵ֖ר דַּרְכֹּ֣ו

“one who protects his life guards his way”

Here, **one who protects** and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who protects his own life guards his way]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:17 (#2)

סָר֣וּר מֵרָ֑ע

“turns away from evil”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:17 (#6)

שֹׁמֵ֖ר נַפְשׁ֣וֹ

“one who protects his life”

Here Solomon speaks of a person who wants to stay alive as if **his life** were something that he **protects**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one who keeps himself alive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:18 (#2)

לִפְנֵי־שֶׁ֥בֶר גָּאָ֑וֹן

“To the face of a breaking {is} pride”

Here Solomon is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **To the face of** in 8:25. Alternate translation: [Before a breaking there is pride]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:18 (#6)

וְלִפְנֵ֖י כִּשָּׁ֣לוֹן גֹּ֣בַהּ רֽוּחַ

“and to the face of a stumbling {is} a height of spirit”

Here Solomon is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **to the face of** in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [and before a stumbling there is a height of spirit]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:18 (#9)

גֹּ֣בַהּ רֽוּחַ

“is} a height of spirit”

Here Solomon is using **a height of spirit** as a common expression of his culture to mean “proud.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is a swelled head] or [is arrogance]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:18 (#1)

לִפְנֵי־שֶׁ֥בֶר גָּאָ֑וֹן וְלִפְנֵ֖י כִּשָּׁ֣לוֹן גֹּ֣בַהּ רֽוּחַ

“To the face of a breaking {is} pride, and to the face of a stumbling {is} a height of spirit”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [To the face of breaking is pride; yes, to the face of a stumbling is a height of spirit]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 16:18 (#5)

גָּאָ֑וֹן

“is} pride”

See how you translated the abstract noun **pride** in 8:13.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:18 (#7)

וְלִפְנֵ֖י כִּשָּׁ֣לוֹן גֹּ֣בַהּ רֽוּחַ

“and to the face of a stumbling {is} a height of spirit”

Here Solomon implies that **a height of spirit** results in **stumbling**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and a height of spirit results in a stumbling]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:18 (#4)

שֶׁ֥בֶר

“a breaking”

Here Solomon refers to a person being destroyed as if they experience **breaking**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a destruction] or [being destroyed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:18 (#8)

כִּכְשָׁלֹֽון

“a stumbling”

Here Solomon refers to a person being destroyed as if they experience **stumbling**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a destruction] or [being destroyed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:18 (#3)

לִפְנֵי־שֶׁ֥בֶר גָּאָֽון

“To the face of a breaking {is} pride”

Here Solomon implies that **pride** results in **a breaking**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Pride results in a breaking]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:19 (#1)

שְׁפַל־רֽוחַ

“to be lowly of spirit”

Here Solomon is using **lowly of spirit** as a common expression of his culture to mean “humble.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is being down-to-earth] or [to be humble]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:19 (#2)

מֵֽחַלֵּ֥ק שָׁ֝לָ֗ל אֶת־גֵּאִֽים

“than to share a portion {of} spoil {with} proud ones”

Here Solomon uses **share** to imply that the one who is sharing **a portion of spoil** is also one of the **proud ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [than to be one of the proud ones and share a portion of their spoil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:19 (#3)

שָׁלָֽל

“spoil”

The word **spoil** refers to things that victorious soldiers take from the enemies they have defeated. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [goods taken in battle] or [loot]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:20 (#4)

אַשְׁרֵ֣יו

“he {is} happy”

The pronoun **he** refers to the **one who trusts in Yahweh**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [that person who trusts in Yahweh is happy]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 16:20 (#3)

יִמְצָא־טֽוֹב

“will find good”

Here Solomon refers to someone prospering as if they found **good**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will prosper]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:20 (#1)

מַשְׂכִּ֣יל & וּבוֹטֵ֖חַ & אַשְׁרֵֽיו

“One who comprehends & and one who trusts & he {is} happy”

One who comprehends, **one who trusts**, and **he** here represent types of people in general, not particular people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who comprehends ... and any person who trusts ... that person is happy]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:20 (#2)

מַשְׂכִּיל עַל־דָּבָר

“One who comprehends concerning a matter”

This phrase could refer to: (1) someone who acts wisely in various matters. Alternate translation: [One who acts sensibly]; (2) someone who heeds instruction, in which case the word translated **matter** would refer to instruction. Alternate translation: [One who heeds instruction]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:21 (#1)

לֵבָב

“heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:21 (#3)

נָבוֹן

“an understanding one”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:5.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:21 (#5)

שְׂפָתַיִם

“lips”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:21 (#4)

וּמָתֶק שְׂפָתַיִם

“and the sweetness of lips”

Here Solomon speaks of kind or pleasant speech as if it were **sweetness** that comes from what people say by speaking with their **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and pleasant speech]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:21 (#2)

לְחַכַם־לֵבָב יִקָּרֵא נָבוֹן

“The wise of heart will be called an understanding one”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will call the wise of heart an understanding one]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:22 (#3)

וּמוּסַר אֱוִלִים אִוֶּלֶת

“but the instruction of fools {is} folly”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **instruction** that is given by **fools**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [but fools can only teach foolishness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:22 (#1)

מְקוֹר חַיִּים

“A fountain of life”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:11.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:22 (#2)

שֵׂכֶל & וּמוּסַר & אִוֶּלֶת

“is} the insight of & but the instruction of & is} folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **insight** in 1:3, **instruction** in 1:2, and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:23 (#4)

יֹסִיף לֶקַח

“it increases learning”

The pronoun **it** refers to what **the wise** says. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [what he says increases what other people learn]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 16:23 (#2)

לֵבָב

“The heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:23 (#1)

לֵ֣ב חֲכָמִ֗ים יַשְׂכִּ֥יל פִּ֫יהוּ֥ וְעַל־שְׂפָתָ֥יו יֹסִ֗יף לֶֽקַח

“The heart of the wise makes his mouth insightful, and on his lips it increases learning”

The heart of the wise, **his**, and **it** here refer to these things and people in general, not a specific **heart** or **wise** person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The hearts of wise people make their mouths insightful, and on their lips they increase learning]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:23 (#3)

פִּ֫יהוּ֥ & שְׂפָתָ֥יו

“his mouth & his lips”

See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 10:11 and **lips** in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:24 (#1)

צוּף־דְּבַ֑שׁ

“a honeycomb of honey”

Here Solomon is speaking of **words of pleasantness** as if they were **a honeycomb of honey**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [extremely pleasing] or [pleasing like a honeycomb]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:24 (#2)

אִמְרֵי־נֹ֗עַם

“Words of pleasantness {are”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **words** that are characterized by **pleasantness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. See how you translated **words of pleasantness** in 15:26. Alternate translation: [are pleasant words]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:24 (#4)

מָתוֹק֮ לַנֶּ֫פֶשׁ

“sweet to the soul”

Here, the **soul** represents where a person’s feelings and desires exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [pleasing to the inner person] or [making a person feel good]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:24 (#3)

מָתוֹק֮ לַנֶּ֫פֶשׁ וּמַרְפֵּ֥א לָ֝עָֽצֶם

“sweet to the soul and healing to the bone”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [such words are sweet to the soul and healing to the bone]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 16:24 (#5)

וּמַרְפֵּ֥א לָ֝עָֽצֶם

“and healing to the bone”

Here, **bone** refers to a person’s whole physical body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of **bone** in 15:30. Alternate translation: [and healing to the body]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 16:25 (#1)

יֵ֤שׁ דֶּ֨רֶךְ֮ יָ֪שָׁ֫ר לִפְנֵי־אִ֥ישׁ וְ֝אַחֲרִיתָ֗הּ דַּרְכֵי־מָֽוֶת

“There is a straight road to the face of a man but its end {is} the ways of death”

See how you translated the identical sentence in 14:12.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:26 (#2)

נֶ֫פֶשׁ

“The appetite of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **appetite** in 6:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:26 (#4)

פִּ֑יהוּ

“his mouth”

Here, **mouth** refers to the desire to eat, which involves using one's **mouth**. It has the same meaning as **appetite** in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his hunger] or [his desire to eat]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:26 (#3)

עָֽמְלָה לֹּֽו

"labors for him"

Here Solomon speaks of **The appetite of the laborer** benefitting **the laborer** as if **The appetite** were a person who **labors** on his behalf. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [benefits him] or [is like a person who helps him while he is working]

See: Personification

Proverbs 16:26 (#1)

נֶ֭פֶשׁ עָמֵ֣ל עָמְלָ֣ה לֹּ֑ו כִּֽי־אָכַ֖ף עָלָ֣יו פִּיהּֽוּ

"The appetite of the laborer labors for him, for his mouth presses on him"

The appetite, **the laborer**, **him**, and **his** here refer to appetites and laborers in general, not to any particular **appetite** or **laborer**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The appetites of laborers labor for them, for their mouths press on them]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:26 (#5)

אָכַ֣ף עָלָ֣יו פִּיהּֽוּ

"his mouth presses on him"

Here Solomon is using **presses on him** as a common expression of his culture to mean "urges him on." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his mouth is his master] or [being hungry urges him to keep working]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:27 (#6)

כְּאֵ֖שׁ צָרֶֽבֶת

"it is} like a scorching fire"

Solomon is saying that the **evil** things that **A man of worthlessness** says are **like a scorching fire** because both can hurt people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [it hurts people like a scorching fire]

See: Simile

Proverbs 16:27 (#2)

אִ֭ישׁ בְּלִיַּ֣עַל & שִׂפְתֹֽיו

"A man of worthlessness & his lips"

A man of worthlessness and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of worthlessness ... that person's lips]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:27 (#5)

וְעַל־שִׂפְתֹ֖יו כְּאֵ֣שׁ צָרֶֽבֶת

"and on his lips {it is} like a scorching fire"

Here, **on his lips** refers to what a person says while moving his **lips**. See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:13. Alternate translation: [and what he says is like a scorching fire]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:27 (#1)

אִ֭ישׁ בְּלִיַּ֣עַל

"A man of worthlessness"

See how you translated this phrase in 6:12.

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:27 (#4)

רָעָֽה

"evil"

Here, **evil** refers to trouble or harm that someone experiences as a result of the planning done by **A man of worthlessness**. See how you translated the same use of **evil** in 12:21.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:27 (#3)

כֹּרֶ֣ה רָעָ֑ה

"digs up evil"

Here Solomon speaks of a person planning how to harm other people as if that person were digging **evil** out of the ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [plans how to harm people] or [plans how to harm people as if he were digging up evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:28 (#3)

יְשַׁלַּ֣ח מָד֑וֹן

“lets loose strife”

Here Solomon refers to **A man of perverse things** causing **strife** between other people as if **strife** were an animal that he **lets loose**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes strife]

See: Personification

Proverbs 16:28 (#2)

אִ֭ישׁ תַּהְפֻּכ֣וֹת

“A man of perverse things”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by saying **perverse things**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A perverse man] or [A man who says perverse things]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:28 (#4)

מָד֑וֹן

“strife”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **strife**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [arguments] or [confrontations]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:28 (#5)

וְנִרְגָּ֣ן

“and a murmurer”

Here Solomon calls a person who gossips or tells harmful rumors about people **a murmurer** because that person speaks quietly when he gossips. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a gossiper] or [and one who whispers gossip]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:28 (#6)

מַפְרִ֖יד

“separates”

Here Solomon refers to causing friends to no longer be friends as if someone **separates** them from each other. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is one who destroys the friendships of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:28 (#1)

אִ֭ישׁ תַּהְפֻּכ֣וֹת & וְנִרְגָּ֣ן מַפְרִ֖יד אַלּֽוּף

“A man of perverse things & and a murmurer separates the friendly”

A man of perverse things, **a murmurer**, and **the friendly** here refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any man of perverse things ... and any murmurer is a person who separates close friends]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:28 (#7)

מַפְרִ֖יד אַלּֽוּף

“separates the friendly”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that this phrase refers to separating people who were **friendly** from each other. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [is one who separates a close friend from his friend] or [is one who separates close friends]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:29 (#5)

לֹא־טֹ֑וב

“that is} not good”

Here Solomon is using a figure of speech that emphasizes the meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with **good**, which is a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. He does this to emphasize how bad this **road** is. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the meaning

without “not” in another way. Alternate translation: [that is very bad]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 16:29 (#2)

אִישׁ חָמָס

“A man of violence”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:31.

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:29 (#3)

וְהוֹלִיכֹו בְּדֶרֶךְ

“and he leads him on a road”

Here Solomon refers to **A man of violence** causing **his neighbor** to behave in a manner **that is not good** as if he were leading **his neighbor** along **a road**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **road** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [and he causes him to behave in a manner]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:29 (#1)

אִישׁ חָמָס & רֵעֵהוּ וְהוֹלִיכֹו

“A man of violence & his neighbor, and he leads him”

A man of violence, **his neighbor**, **he**, and **him** here refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of violence ... that person’s neighbor, and that person leads that neighbor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:29 (#4)

בְּדֶרֶךְ לֹא־טֹוב

“on a road {that is} not good”

This could refer to: (1) behavior **that is not good**. Alternate translation: [to behave in a manner that is not good]; (2) behavior that results in something **not good** happening to that person. Alternate translation: [to behave in a manner that causes results which are not good]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:30 (#2)

עֹצֶה עֵינָיו & קֹרֵץ שְׂפָתָיו

“One who shuts his eyes & one who compresses his lips”

The phrases **shuts his eyes** and **compresses his lips** both describe facial gestures which people could use to signal to others that they were about to do something **evil** that they had planned. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the meaning of these actions in the text or in a footnote or use similar facial expressions that do have that meaning. Alternate translation: [One who signals to others by shutting his eyes ... one who signals to others by compressing his lips] or [One who winks his eyes ... one who extends his tongue]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 16:30 (#3)

רָעָה

“evil”

Here, **evil** refers to an evil action that **one who compresses his lips** had planned to do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [an evil act he had planned]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:30 (#1)

עֹצֶה עֵינָיו לַחְשֹׁב & קֹרֵץ שְׂפָתָיו כִּלָּה רָעָה

“One who shuts his eyes plans & one who compresses his lips brings evil to completion”

One who shuts his eyes and **one who compresses his lips** here refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [People who shut their eyes plan ... people who compress their lips bring evil to completion]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:31 (#2)

עֲטֶרֶת תִּפְאָרֶת

“is} a crown of splendor”

Here Solomon refers to the honor of being an old person as if the old person’s **Gray hair** were a **crown of splendor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning or use a simile. See how you translated **a crown of splendor** in 4:9. Alternate

translation: [is a great honor] or [is like a crown of splendor on an old person's head]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:31 (#1)

שֵׂיבָה

"Gray hair"

Gray hair here refers to old age, which is when people's **hair** usually becomes **Gray**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Old age]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:31 (#4)

בְּדֶרֶךְ צְדָקָה

"on the road of righteousness"

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **road** that is characterized by **righteousness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [on the righteous road]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:31 (#3)

בְּדֶרֶךְ

"on the road of"

See how you translated the same use of **road** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:31 (#6)

תִּמָּצֵא

"it is found"

Here Solomon refers to becoming old, which **Gray hair** represents, as if it were an object that a person could find. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it is obtained]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:31 (#5)

תִּמָּצֵא

"it is found"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a person finds it]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:32 (#6)

מִלֹּכֵד עִיר

"than one capturing a city"

Here Solomon speaks of a person conquering a **city** and capturing the people who live in it as if the **city** were a person who could be captured. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [than one who conquers a city]

See: Personification

Proverbs 16:32 (#4)

וּמֹשֵׁל בְּרוּחֹו

"and one ruling his spirit"

Here Solomon speaks of a person controlling **his spirit** as if it were a person who could be ruled over. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and one who controls his spirit]

See: Personification

Proverbs 16:32 (#7)

מִלֹּכֵד עִיר

"than one capturing a city"

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **one who captures a city** is very **mighty**. You could include this information if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [than one mighty enough to capture a city]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:32 (#5)

בְּרוּחֹו

"his spirit"

Here, **spirit** refers to a person's emotions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his emotions]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:32 (#3)

וּמֹשֵׁל בְּרוּחֹו

“and one ruling his spirit”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and better is one ruling his spirit]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 16:32 (#1)

אֶֽרֶךְ אַפַּ֥יִם מִגִּבּ֑וֹר וּמֹשֵׁ֥ל בְּרוּחֹ֗ו מִלֹּכֵ֥ד

“is} one long of nostrils than a mighty one, and one ruling his spirit than one capturing”

Here, **one long of nostrils**, **a mighty one**, **one ruling his spirit**, and **one capturing** represent these types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [is any person long of nostrils than any mighty person, and any person who rules over his own spirit than any person who captures]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:32 (#2)

אֶֽרֶךְ אַפַּ֥יִם

“is} one long of nostrils”

See how you translated **one long of nostrils** in 14:29.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:33 (#3)

בַּחֵ֣יק יוּטַ֣ל אֶת־הַגּוֹרָ֑ל

“Into the lap a lot is cast”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [A person throws a lot into a lap]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:33 (#1)

בַּחֵ֣יק יוּטַ֣ל אֶת־הַגּוֹרָ֑ל

“Into the lap a lot is cast”

The terms **a lot**, **the lap**, and **its** refer to these things in general, not to a specific **lot** and **lap**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Lots are cast into people’s laps]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:33 (#4)

כָּל־מִשְׁפָּטֹֽו

“its every judgment”

Here, **judgment** refers to the decision that is made based on the result of casting lots. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [its every decision] or [whatever happens with the lot]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:33 (#2)

בַּחֵ֣יק יוּטַ֣ל אֶת־הַגּוֹרָ֑ל

“Into the lap a lot is cast”

A lot was a marked stone that was thrown or rolled on the ground in order to help decide something. People believed that God would guide the **lot** so that it showed them what to do. If your culture has a similar object, you could use the word for that in your language here. Alternate translation: [A marked stone is cast into the lap] or [People throw dice]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs - Chapter 17 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 17 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 17 also contains contrasting parallelism (17:9, 22, 24) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (17:21, 28). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 17:1 (#4)

מִמְּבַתֵּ֖י מְלֵאָ֑ה

“than a house full of”

Here Solomon refers to a **house** in which people frequently eat meat from **sacrifices** as if the **house** were **full of sacrifices**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [than a house in which people frequently have]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:1 (#6)

זִבְחֵי־רִיב

“sacrifices of quarreling”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe feasts that are characterized by **quarreling**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [feasts characterized by quarreling]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:1 (#3)

וְשַׁלְוָה־בָהֶּ

“and ease with it”

Here Solomon refers to feeling peaceful as if that **ease** were an object that someone could have **with a dry morsel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while feeling ease] or [while feeling peaceful]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:1 (#1)

פַּת חֲרֵבָה & מִמְּלֵאָ

“is} a dry morsel & than a house full of”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. See how you translated the same use of these phrases in 15:16–17. Alternate translation: [is having a dry morsel ... than having a house full of]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 17:1 (#2)

וְשַׁלְוָה

“and ease”

Here, **ease** refers to a situation in which someone feels peaceful because there is no **quarreling**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and a peaceful situation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:1 (#5)

זִבְחֵי

“sacrifices of”

Here, **sacrifices** refers to feasts in which Israelites would eat the meat from the **sacrifices** they had offered to Yahweh at the temple in Jerusalem. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [feasting on meat with]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:2 (#1)

בֶּן מֵבִישׁ & אַחִים

“a shameful son & brothers”

Here Solomon implies that **a son** and **brothers** refer to the children of the master who owns the **servant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [his master’s shameful son ... the brothers of his master’s son]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:2 (#3)

נַחֲלָה

“an inheritance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **inheritance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what people inherit]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:2 (#2)

וּבְתוֹךְ אַחִים

“and in the midst of brothers”

Here Solomon refers to the **servant** having equal status with these **brothers** as if he were **in the midst** of them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and as an equal of the son’s brothers]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:3 (#6)

לִבּוֹת

“hearts”

See how you translated the same use of “heart” in 2:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:3 (#1)

מַצְרֵף לַכֶּסֶף וְכוּר לַזָּהָב

“The smelting-pot {is} for the silver and the furnace {is} for the gold”

The terms **The smelting-pot**, **the silver**, **the furnace**, and **the gold** represent these things in general, not any specific things. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any smelting-pot is for silver and any furnace is for gold]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:3 (#5)

וּבֹחֵ֥ן לִבֹּ֖ות יְהוָֽה

“and Yahweh tests hearts”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh evaluating what people think as if their **hearts** were metal that he was testing to discover impurities. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh evaluates peoples’ hearts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:3 (#4)

וּבֹחֵ֥ן לִבֹּ֖ות יְהוָֽה

“and Yahweh tests hearts”

Solomon uses **and** here to indicate that he is making a comparison between the first clause and the second clause. How **Yahweh tests hearts** is similar to how **The smelting-pot** and **furnace** are used to test **silver** and **gold** to see how pure they are. If this connection is not clear, you may want to use a connecting word to show how this statement relates to what came before it. Alternate translation: [likewise, Yahweh tests hearts]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 17:3 (#3)

מַצְרֵ֣ף לַ֭כֶּסֶף וְכִ֣ור לַזָּהָ֑ב

“The smelting-pot {is} for the silver and the furnace {is} for the gold”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that the **smelting-pot** and **furnace** are used to refine and test the purity of **silver** and **gold**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The smelting-pot is for testing and refining the silver, and the furnace is for testing and refining the gold]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:3 (#2)

מַצְרֵ֣ף

“The smelting-pot”

A **smelting-pot** is a container in which metals are melted at a very high temperature so that impurities may be discovered and removed from the metal. Since the second clause mentions **tests**, most likely Solomon is referring to using the pot to discover impurities. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of container, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [The pot used for testing and refining metal]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 17:4 (#3)

שְׂפַ֣ת

“the lips of”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 16:13.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:4 (#6)

לְשֹׁ֣שֶׁן

“a tongue of”

See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:4 (#1)

מֵ֭רַע & שְׂפַת־אָ֑וֶן שֶׁ֥קֶר & לְשֹׁ֣שֶׁן הַ֝וֹּ֗ת

“The evildoer & the lips of iniquity; a liar & a tongue of destruction”

The evildoer, **the lips of iniquity**, **a liar**, and **a tongue of destruction** represent types of people and things in general, not specific people or things. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any evildoer ... any lips of iniquity; any liar ... any tongues of destruction]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:4 (#4)

מֵ֝זִ֗ין

“gives ear”

The phrase **give ear** refers to listening carefully to what someone is saying as if the listener were giving his **ear** to the person speaking. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a similar expression from your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [listens carefully]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:4 (#5)

לְשֹׁ֣ון הַוֹּ֑ת

“a tongue of destruction”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **a tongue** that is characterized by **destruction**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a destructive tongue]

See: Possession

Proverbs 17:4 (#2)

שִׂפַ֖ת־אָ֣וֶן

“the lips of iniquity”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **lips** that are characterized by **iniquity**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [sinful lips]

See: Possession

Proverbs 17:5 (#2)

חֵרֵ֥ף עֹשֵׂ֑הוּ

“taunts his maker”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:31.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:5 (#4)

לֹ֣א יִנָּקֶ֑ה

“will not remain blameless”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 17:5 (#3)

לְאֵ֣יד

“at calamity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:5 (#1)

לֹעֵ֣ג לָ֭רָשׁ חֵרֵ֣ף עֹשֵׂ֑הוּ שָׂמֵ֥חַ לְ֝אֵ֗יד

“A mocker of one who is poor taunts his maker; one glad at calamity”

The terms **A mocker**, **one who is poor**, **his**, and **one glad at calamity** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any mocker of any poor person taunts that person’s maker; any person glad at calamity]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:6 (#3)

בְּנֵ֣י בָנִ֣ים & בָּנִ֣ים אֲבוֹתָ֑ם

“is} sons of sons & sons {is} their fathers”

Although **sons** and **fathers** are masculine, here Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [are children of children … children is their parents]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 17:6 (#1)

עֲטֶ֣רֶת

“The crown of”

Here Solomon speaks of honor as if it were a **crown** upon the heads of **old ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated a similar use of **crown** in 4:9. Alternate translation: [The honor of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:6 (#4)

וְתִפְאֶ֖רֶת בָּנִ֣ים אֲבוֹתָֽם

“and the splendor of sons {is} their fathers”

Since the word translated as **splendor** is parallel to **crown** in the previous clause, here **the splendor of sons** refers to the honor or pride that **sons** feel for **their fathers**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the honor that sons feel is for their fathers]

See: Possession

Proverbs 17:6 (#2)

עֲטֶ֣רֶת זְ֭קֵנִים בְּנֵי בָנִ֑ים

“The crown of the old {is} sons of sons”

The crown of the old could refer to: (1) the honor or pride that **the old** feel for their **sons of sons**. Alternate translation: [The honor that old people feel is for their sons of sons]; (2) the honor that **the old** receive from others because they have **sons of sons**. Alternate translation: [Old people are honored because of their sons of sons] or [Sons of sons cause others to honor old people]

See: Possession

Proverbs 17:7 (#1)

לְנָבָ֗ל & לְנָדִ֥יב

“for a worthless {one & for a noble”

Here **a worthless one** and **a noble** represent these types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [for worthless ones ... for nobles]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:7 (#2)

שְׂפַת־יֶ֝֗תֶר

“A lip of excess”

The phrase **lips of excess** refers to excellent or eloquent speech that people say by moving their lips. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Fine speech] or [Speaking excellently]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:7 (#3)

שְׂפַת־שֶׁ֑קֶר

“a lip of falsehood”

See how you translated the same use of “a lip of falsehood” in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:8 (#3)

יַשְׂכִּֽיל

“he succeeds”

Here, **he succeeds** refers to what the **owner** of a **bribe** thinks would happen as a result of giving people bribes. It does not refer to something that is true. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he thinks that he succeeds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:8 (#4)

אֶל־כָּל־אֲשֶׁ֖ר יִפְנֶ֣ה

“to all that he turns”

Here Solomon refers to everything that the a person does as if it were **all** the places **that he turns** toward. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in whatever he does]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:8 (#1)

אֶ֣בֶן־חֵ֭ן

“A stone of favor”

A stone of favor refers to an object that someone thinks is magical and will make **its owner** successful. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A lucky rabbit’s foot] or [A charm]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 17:8 (#2)

בְּעֵינֵ֑י

“in the eyes of”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:4.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:9 (#5)

וְשֹׁנֶ֥ה בְּ֝דָבָ֗ר

“but one who repeats a matter”

The phrase **one who repeats a matter** refers to someone who repeatedly speaks about a past situation in which that person or a friend was hurt or offended. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but one who repeatedly mentions a past offense]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:9 (#4)

מְבַקֵּשׁ

“seeks”

See how you translated the same use of **seeks** in 11:27.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:9 (#3)

פֶּשַׁע & אַהֲבָה

“a transgression & love”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **transgression** in 10:19 and **love** in 10:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:9 (#2)

מְכַסֶּה

“One who covers”

Here Solomon speaks of forgiving someone for a **transgression** as if it were an object that someone **covers**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who forgives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:9 (#1)

מְכַסֶּה־פֶּשַׁע & וְשֹׁנֶה בְּדָבָר & אַלּוּף

“One who covers a transgression & but one who repeats a matter & a close friend”

One who covers, **a transgression**, **one who repeats**, **a matter**, and **a close friend** represent these things and people in general, not specific things or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who covers any transgression ... but any person who repeats any matter ... close friends]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:9 (#6)

מַפְרִיד אַלּוּף

“separates a close friend”

See how you translated this phrase in 16:28.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:10 (#3)

תֵּחַת & בְּמֵבִין

“goes down into an understanding one”

Here Solomon refers to **an understanding one** learning from a **rebuke** as if it were an object that **goes down into** that person’s mind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [teaches an understanding one]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:10 (#4)

מֵהַכּוֹת כְּסִיל מֵאָה

“more than striking a stupid one a hundred {times”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [more than striking a stupid one a hundred times goes down into that stupid one] or [more than striking a stupid one a hundred times teaches that stupid one]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 17:10 (#2)

גְּעָרָה

“A rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract noun **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:10 (#1)

גְּעָרָה בְּמֵבִין & כְּסִיל

“A rebuke & into an understanding one & a stupid one”

Here, **a rebuke**, **an understanding one**, and **a stupid one** represent this thing and these types of people in general, not one particular **rebuke** or person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [Any rebuke ... into any understanding person ... any stupid person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:11 (#5)

וּמַלְאָךְ אַכְזָרִי יְשֻׁלָּח

“and a cruel messenger will be sent”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and someone will send a cruel messenger]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 17:11 (#6)

יְשֻׁלַּח־בּוֹ

“will be sent against him”

Here, **against him** implies that the **messenger** will punish the **evil one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will be sent to punish him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:11 (#2)

אַךְ־מְרִי יְבַקֵּשׁ

“seeks only rebellion”

See how you translated the same use of **seeks** in 11:27.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:11 (#1)

רָעָ֣ה וּמַלְאָ֣ךְ אַכְזָרִ֔י & בּ֖וֹ

“An evil one & and a cruel messenger & against him”

An evil one, **a cruel messenger**, and **him** represent types of people in general, not one particular **evil one** or **messenger**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any evil person ... and any cruel messenger ... against that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:11 (#3)

מְרִי

“rebellion”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rebellion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [being rebellious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:11 (#4)

וּמַלְאָ֣ךְ אַכְזָרִ֔י

“and a cruel messenger”

Here, **and** introduces the result of an **evil one** rebelling. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [As a result, a cruel messenger]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 17:12 (#3)

פְּגֹ֣שׁ דֹּ֭ב שַׁכּ֣וּל בְּאִ֑ישׁ וְאַל־כְּסָ֥יל בְּאִוַּלְתּֽוֹ

“Let a female bear robbed of offspring meet a man and not a stupid one in his folly”

Solomon is making this comparison between an angry bear and a fool as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Sometimes it seems like it would be better to meet a female bear robbed of offspring than to meet a stupid person doing something stupid]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 17:12 (#5)

דֹּ֭ב שַׁכּ֣וּל

“a female bear robbed of offspring”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a female bear from which someone has stolen offspring]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 17:12 (#2)

פְּגֹ֣שׁ דֹּ֭ב שַׁכּ֣וּל בְּאִ֑ישׁ וְאַל־כְּסָ֥יל בְּאִוַּלְתּֽוֹ

“Let a female bear robbed of offspring meet a man and not a stupid one in his folly”

In this verse, Solomon implies that meeting **a female bear robbed of offspring** is better than meeting **a stupid one in his folly**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [A female bear robbed of offspring meeting a man is better than a stupid one in his folly meeting the man]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:12 (#8)

בְּאִוַּלְתּֽוֹ

“in his folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:12 (#6)

דֹּ֣ב

“a female bear”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **a female bear robbed of offspring** would be extremely angry and violent. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [an angry female bear]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:12 (#4)

דֹּ֣ב & בְּאִ֔ישׁ & כְּסִלּ֖וֹ בְּאִוַּלְתּֽוֹ

“a female bear & a man & a stupid one in his folly”

Here, **a female bear**, **a man**, **a stupid one**, and **his** represent bears and types of people in general, not one particular **bear** or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any female bear ... any person ... any stupid person in that person’s folly]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:12 (#1)

פְּגֹ֣ושׁ דֹּ֭ב שַׁכּ֣וּל בְּאִ֑ישׁ וְאַל־כְּסִ֥יל בְּאִוַּלְתּֽוֹ

“Let a female bear robbed of offspring meet a man and not a stupid one in his folly”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words to the second clause from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Let a female bear robbed of offspring meet a man. Do not let a stupid one in his folly meet a man]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 17:12 (#7)

שַׁכּ֣וּל

“robbed of offspring”

Although the word **offspring** is singular in form, here it refers to all of a bear’s cubs as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [robbed of cubs]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:13 (#3)

רָעָ֑ה & טוֹבָ֖ה & רָעָֽה

“evil & good, evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **evil** in 1:16 and **good** in 11:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:13 (#5)

מִבֵּיתֽוֹ

“his house”

See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:13 (#4)

לֹא־תָמִ֥ישׁ רָ֝עָ֗ה מִבֵּיתֽוֹ

“evil will not depart from his house”

Here Solomon speaks of **evil** affecting someone’s family as if **evil** were a person who would not leave the person’s **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [evil will not stop affecting his house]

See: Personification

Proverbs 17:13 (#2)

מֵשִׁ֣יב & מִבֵּיתֽוֹ

“One who returns & his house”

One who returns and **his** represent a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who returns ... that person’s house]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:13 (#1)

מֵשִׁ֣יב רָ֭עָה תַּ֣חַת טוֹבָ֑ה לֹא־תָמִ֥ישׁ רָ֝עָ֗ה מִבֵּיתֽוֹ

“One who returns evil for good, evil will not depart from his house”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Evil will not depart from the house of one who returns evil for good]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 17:14 (#3)

הָרֵ֣ריב נָטֹ֑וֹשׁ

“leave the dispute”

Here Solomon refers to stopping a **dispute** before it begins as if **the dispute** were a place that someone could **leave**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [avoid the dispute] or [end the dispute]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:14 (#1)

מָדוֹן & הָרִיב

“a quarrel & the dispute”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **quarrel** and **dispute** in 15:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:14 (#4)

הִתְגַּלַּע

“it breaks out”

Here Solomon refers to a **quarrel** starting as if it were water that suddenly **breaks out** of a container or dam. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it suddenly begins]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:14 (#2)

פּוֹטֵר מַיִם

“is} the releasing of water”

Here Solomon speaks of the difficulty in stopping a **quarrel** after it starts as if the **the beginning of a quarrel** were **water** that began to leak from a container or dam. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is difficult to stop] or [is as difficult to stop as water leaking from a container]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:15 (#2)

מַצְדִּיק רָשָׁע וּמַרְשִׁיעַ צַדִּיק

“One who declares a wicked one righteous and one who declares a righteous one wicked”

In this verse **wicked** refers to being guilty of doing something **wicked**, and **righteous** refers to being innocent of doing something **wicked**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meanings plainly. Alternate translation: [One who declares a guilty one innocent and one who declares an innocent one guilty]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:15 (#3)

תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה

“are} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated **an abomination to Yahweh** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:15 (#1)

מַצְדִּיק רָשָׁע וּמַרְשִׁיעַ צַדִּיק & גַּם־שְׁנֵיהֶם

“One who declares a wicked one righteous and one who declares a righteous one wicked, even the two of them”

One who declares, **a wicked one**, **a righteous one**, and **the two of them** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who declares any wicked person righteous and any person who declares any righteous person wicked, even both types of people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:16 (#3)

מְחִיר בְּיַד־כְּסִיל

“A payment {is} in the hand of a stupid one”

Here Solomon refers to **a stupid one** trying to buy **wisdom** as if he were holding in his **hand** the money with which to buy it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A stupid one tries to pay money]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:16 (#4)

חָכְמָה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:16 (#2)

מְחִיר בְּיַד־כְּסִיל

“A payment {is} in the hand of a stupid one”

Here, **a payment**, **the hand**, and **a stupid one** represent these things and people in general, not specific things or people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [payments are in the hands of stupid people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:16 (#5)

וְלֵב־אָֽיִן

“but there is no heart”

Here Solomon uses **heart** to refer to a person’s ability to reason. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar phrase “lacking of heart” in 6:32. Alternate translation: [but he has no ability to reason]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:16 (#1)

לָמָּה־זֶּ֣ה מְחִ֣יר בְּיַד־כְּסִ֣יל לִקְנ֣וֹת חָכְמָ֔ה וְלֵב־אָֽיִן

“Why {is} this: A payment {is} in the hand of a stupid one to acquire wisdom, but there is no heart”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize how nonsensical it is for a **stupid** person to try to buy **wisdom**. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It is ridiculous that a payment is in the hand of a stupid one to acquire wisdom but there is no heart!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 17:17 (#4)

וְאָ֣ח

“and a brother”

Although the term **brother** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [and a sibling]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 17:17 (#5)

לְצָרָ֖ה

“for distress”

Here Solomon indicates that one purposes for which **a brother is born** is to help his siblings when they are in **distress**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of helping during a time of distress]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:17 (#2)

הָרֵֽעַ

“the friend”

Here, **the friend** refers to friends in general, not a specific **friend**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any friend]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:17 (#3)

אֹהֵ֥ב

“loves”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [loves his friends]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 17:17 (#1)

בְּכָל־עֵ֥ת

“At every time”

Alternate translation: [At all times] or [All the time]

Proverbs 17:17 (#6)

לְצָרָ֖ה

“for distress”

See how you translated the abstract noun **distress** in 1:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:18 (#2)

חֲסַר־לֵ֑ב

“lacking of heart”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 7:7.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:18 (#3)

תּוֹקֵ֥עַ כָּ֝ף

“is} one who clasps a palm”

See how you translated the same idiom in 6:1.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 17:18 (#1)

אָדָ֣ם & תּוֹקֵ֣עַ כָּ֭ף & עֲ֝רֵ֗בָה & רֵעֵֽהוּ

“A man & is} one who clasps a palm & a pledge & his neighbor”

A man, **one who clasps**, **a palm**, **a pledge**, and **his** refer to types of people and things in general, not specific people or things. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person ... is a person who clasps palms ... any pledge ... that person’s neighbor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:18 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֥י

“to the face of”

This could refer to: (1) being in the presence of **his neighbor**, as in 14:19. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]; (2) doing something on the behalf of **his neighbor**. Alternate translation: [on behalf of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:19 (#3)

מַגְבִּ֥יהַּ פִּ֝תְחֹֽו

“one who makes his opening high”

This phrase could refer to: (1) someone who speaks proudly, as if his mouth were an **opening** located at a **high** place above others. Alternate translation: [one who speaks proudly]; (2) someone who makes a fancy doorway for his house, as if he put the doorway at a **high** place. Alternate translation: [one who makes his doorway fancy]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:19 (#2)

פֶּ֭שַׁע & מַצָּֽה

“transgression & contention”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **transgression** in 10:19 and **contention** in 13:10.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:19 (#1)

אֹהֵ֥ב & מַגְבִּ֥יהַּ פִּ֝תְחֹֽו

“One who loves & one who makes his opening high”

One who loves, **one who makes his doorway high**, and **his** refer to types of people and things in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who loves ... any person who makes his opening high]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:19 (#4)

מְבַקֵּ֣שׁ־שָׁ֑בֶר

“seeks a breaking”

Here Solomon speaks of a person doing something that will cause that person to be destroyed as if that person **seeks** for someone to break his bones. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes himself to be destroyed] or [causes his own ruin]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:20 (#3)

לֹ֣א יִמְצָא־טֽוֹב

“will not find goodness”

Here Solomon refers to someone experiencing **goodness** as if **goodness** were an object that a person can **find** by searching for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not experience goodness]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:20 (#2)

עִקֵּ֣שׁ־לֵ֑בָב

“One crooked of heart”

See how you translated **crooked of heart** in 11:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:20 (#4)

טֽוֹב & בְּרָעָֽה

“goodness & into evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **goodness** in 13:21 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:20 (#1)

עִקֶּשׁ־לֵבָב & וְנֶהְפָּךְ בִּבְלְשׁוֹנוֹ

“One crooked of heart & and one who is turned away in his tongue”

One crooked of heart, **one who is turned away**, and **his** refer to types of people and things in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person crooked of heart ... and any person who is turned away in his tongue]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:20 (#5)

וְנֶהְפָּךְ בִּבְלְשׁוֹנוֹ

“and one who is turned away in his tongue”

Here Solomon refers to a person who speaks deceitfully as if that person **is turned away in his tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and one who speaks perversely] or [and one who speaks wickedly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:20 (#6)

יִפֹּל בְּרָעָה

“will fall into evil”

See how you translated “falls into evil” in 13:17.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:21 (#5)

וְלֹא־יִשְׂמַח

“and & will not rejoice”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that emphasizes the meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the meaning without “not” in another way, as in the UST.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 17:21 (#2)

יֹלֵד כְּסִיל & לוֹ & אֲבִי נָבָל

“One who begets a stupid one & for him & the father of a worthless one”

One who begets, **a stupid one**, **him**, **the father**, and **a worthless one** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18 and **a worthless one** in 17:7. Alternate translation: [Any person who begets a stupid person ... for that person ... any father of a worthless one]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:21 (#4)

לְתוּגָה

“it is} for grief”

See how you translated the abstract noun **grief** in 10:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:21 (#1)

יֹלֵד כְּסִיל לְתוּגָה לוֹ וְלֹא־יִשְׂמַח אֲבִי נָבָל

“One who begets a stupid one, {it is} for grief for him, and the father of a worthless one will not rejoice”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [One who begets a stupid one, it is for grief for him; yes, the father of a worthless one will not rejoice]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 17:21 (#3)

לְתוּגָה

“it is} for grief”

Here, **it is for** indicates that what follows is the result of begetting **a stupid one**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [it results in grief]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 17:22 (#1)

לֵב שָׂמֵחַ

“A joyful heart”

See how you translated this phrase in 15:13.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:22 (#4)

תְּיַבֶּשׁ־גֶּרֶם

“dries up bone”

Here Solomon refers to people becoming unhealthy as if their bones were drying up. The word **bone** here refers to a person’s whole body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar phrase “decay of bones” in 14:30. Alternate translation: [causes that person to be unhealthy]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:22 (#2)

יֵיטִיב גֵּהָה

“makes healing good”

Here, **make healing good** refers to causing the person with a **joyful heart** to become healthy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will make that person healthy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:22 (#3)

וְרוּחַ נְכֵאָה

“but a broken spirit”

Here, **a broken spirit** refers to feeling sad. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but being depressed]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:23 (#3)

לְהַטּוֹת אָרְחוֹת מִשְׁפָּט

“to bend the paths of justice”

Here Solomon refers to causing judges to make an unjust verdict as if the legal process had **paths** that a person could **bend**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to prevent justice from being rendered] or [to prevent judges from giving just verdicts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:23 (#1)

שֹׁחַד מֵחֵיק רָשָׁע יִקָּח

“A wicked one takes a bribe from the bosom”

A wicked one, **a bribe**, and **the bosom** represent these things and people in general, not specific things or people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Any wicked person takes a bribe from any bosom]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:23 (#4)

מִשְׁפָּט

“justice”

See how you translated the abstract noun **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:23 (#2)

מֵחֵיק

“from the bosom”

Here, **from the bosom** indicates that **a bribe** is given to someone secretly, as if it were hidden in a person’s clothes near that person’s **bosom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in secret]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:24 (#3)

אֶת־פְּנֵי

“is} with the face of”

Here Solomon refers to **an understanding one** always paying attention to **Wisdom** as if **Wisdom** were in front of **the face** of that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is in the mind of] or [is the focus of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:24 (#1)

חָכְמָה

“Wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **Wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:24 (#2)

מֵבִין & כְּסִיל

“an understanding one & a stupid one”

See how you translated **an understanding one** in 17:10 and **a stupid one** in 10:18.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:24 (#4)

וְעֵינֵי כְסִיל בִּקְצֵה־אָרֶץ

“but the eyes of a stupid one {are} at the end of the earth”

Here Solomon refers to **a stupid one** being unable to pay attention to anything as if that person’s **eyes** were **at the end of the earth**. If it would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but a stupid one’s mind is all over the place] or [but a stupid one is not able to focus his thoughts]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 17:25 (#3)

כַּעַס & וּמָמָר

“is} a grief & and bitterness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **grief** in 10:1 and **bitterness** in 14:10.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:25 (#2)

כַּעַס לְאָבִיו

“is} a grief to his father”

Here Solomon speaks of a **son** causing his father to feel **grief** as if that **son** himself were that **grief**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes grief for his father] or [causes his father to feel grief]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:25 (#1)

לְאָבִיו בֵּן כְּסִיל & לְיוֹלַדְתּוֹ

“A stupid son & to his father & to her who bore him”

A stupid son, **his**, **her**, and **him** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated a **stupid son** in 10:1. Alternate translation: [Any stupid son … to that person’s father … to the mother who bore that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:25 (#4)

וּמָמָר לְיוֹלַדְתּוֹ

“and bitterness to her who bore him”

Here Solomon speaks of a **son** causing his mother to feel **bitterness** as if that **son** himself were that **bitterness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and causes bitterness for her who bore him] or [and causes her who bore him to feel bitter]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:26 (#1)

עֲנוֹשׁ לַצַּדִּיק

“to fine the righteous”

Here, **fine** refers to requiring a **the righteous** to pay money as a penalty for a crime that **the righteous** did not do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to wrongly require the righteous to pay a penalty]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:26 (#5)

יֹשֶׁר

“uprightness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **uprightness** in 4:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:26 (#3)

לֹא־טוֹב

“is} not good”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [is evil]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 17:26 (#4)

לְהַכּוֹת נְדִיבִים

“to strike nobles”

The parallelism with the previous clause indicates that Solomon is referring to striking **nobles** who did not do anything wrong. Here, **nobles** refers to people who

have a position of ruling and also have noble character. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to wrongly strike noble people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:26 (#2)

לַצַּדִּיק

“the righteous”

Solomon is using the adjective **righteous** as a noun to mean **righteous** people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the righteous ones] or [people who act righteously]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 17:27 (#3)

דָּעַת & תְּבוּנָה

“knowledge & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **knowledge** in 1:4 and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:27 (#4)

וקר־רוּחַ

“and the cool of spirit”

Here, **the cool of spirit** is an idiom that refers to someone who controls their emotions. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the coolheaded person] or [and someone who controls his emotions]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 17:27 (#1)

חוֹשֵׂךְ & יוֹדֵעַ & וקר־רוּחַ אִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

“One restraining & is} one knowing & and the cool of spirit {is} a man of understanding”

One restraining, **one knowing knowledge**, **the cool of spirit**, and **a man of understanding** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **One who restrains** in 10:19 and **a man of understanding** in 10:23. Alternate translation: [Any person who restrains ... is a person who knows ... and any person who is cool of spirit is a person of understanding]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:27 (#2)

אֲמָרָיו

“his words”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:28 (#5)

אֹטֵם שְׂפָתָיו נָבוֹן

“one shutting his lips—understanding”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [one shutting his lips will be considered understanding]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 17:28 (#6)

אֹטֵם שְׂפָתָיו

“one shutting his lips”

Here Solomon refers to someone who refrains from speaking unnecessarily as if that person **shuts his lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one who does not speak unnecessarily]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:28 (#2)

אֱוִיל & אֹטֵם שְׂפָתָיו נָבוֹן

“a fool & one shutting his lips—understanding”

Here, **a fool** and **one shutting his lips** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a fool** in 7:22. Alternate translation: [any fool ... any person who shuts his lips—an understanding person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:28 (#1)

גַּם אֱוִיל מַחֲרִישׁ חָכָם יֶחְשָׁב אֹטֵם שְׂפָתָיו נָבוֹן

“Even a fool keeping silent will be considered wise; one shutting his lips—understanding”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Even a fool keeping silent will be considered wise; yes, one shutting his lips—understanding]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 17:28 (#4)

יֵחָשֵׁ֫ב

“will be considered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will consider to be]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 17:28 (#3)

מַמַחֲרִישׁ

“keeping silent”

This phrase refers to someone who refrains from speaking unnecessarily. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who does not speak unnecessarily]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs - Chapter 18 Introduction

Chapter 18 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism
Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 18 also contains contrasting parallelism (18:2, 12, 14, 23, 24) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (18:7, 15, 20). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 18:1 (#1)

לְתַאֲוָ֣ה יְבַקֵּ֣שׁ נִפְרָ֑ד & יִתְגַּלָּֽע

“One who separates himself seeks for desire & he breaks out”

One who separates himself and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [People who separate themselves seek for desire … those people break out]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:1 (#4)

בְּכָל־תּוּשִׁיָּ֥ה יִתְגַּלָּֽע

“against all sound wisdom, he breaks out”

Here Solomon describes a person who **breaks out** into a quarrel with anyone who offers him **sound wisdom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated **breaks out** in 17:14. Alternate translation: [he breaks out into a quarrel with anyone who speaks to him with sound wisdom]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:1 (#5)

בְּכָל־תּוּשִׁיָּֽה

“against all sound wisdom”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sound wisdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [against anything that is soundly wise]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:1 (#3)

לְתַאֲוָ֣ה יְבַקֵּ֣שׁ

“seeks for desire”

Here Solomon implies that this person **seeks** to fulfill his own **desire**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [seeks to fulfill his own desire]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:1 (#2)

נִפְרָ֑ד

“One who separates himself”

Here Solomon implies that this person **separates himself** from other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alter-

nate translation: [One who keeps away from other people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:2 (#5)

בְּהִתְגַּלְּוֹת לִבּוֹ

“in his heart revealing itself”

Here Solomon refers to a **stupid one** telling people what he thinks as if his **heart** were **revealing itself**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated **heart** in 2:2. Alternate translation: [in telling people his opinion]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:2 (#4)

בְּהִתְגַּלְּוֹת לִבּוֹ

“in his heart revealing itself”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [a stupid one delights in his heart revealing itself]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 18:2 (#2)

לֹא־יַחְפֹּץ & בִּתְבוּנָה

“does not delight in understanding”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [detests understanding]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 18:2 (#1)

כְּסִיל & לִבּוֹ

“A stupid one & his heart”

A stupid one and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any stupid person ... that person’s heart]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:2 (#3)

בִּתְבוּנָה

“in understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:3 (#4)

וְעִם־קָלְלָה חֶרְפָּה

“and with shame, reproach”

Here Solomon speaks of a shameful person coming as though **shame** itself were coming, and of people acting reproachfully toward that person as though **reproach** were also a person that was arriving. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and when a shameful person comes, people will reproach that person]

See: Personification

Proverbs 18:3 (#3)

וְעִם־קָלְלָה חֶרְפָּה

“and with shame, reproach”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and with shame comes reproach]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 18:3 (#2)

בּוּז & קָלְלָה חֶרְפָּה

“contempt & shame, reproach”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **contempt**, **shame**, and **reproach**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **contempt** in 12:8 and **shame** in 6:33. Alternate translation: [feeling contemptuous ... feeling shameful, being reproached]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:3 (#1)

בָּבָא גַם־בּוּז

“contempt also comes”

Here Solomon speaks of experiencing **contempt** as if it were a person who can come to a location. This could mean: (1) people show **contempt** towards **a wicked one**. Alternate translation: [people feel contempt for him]; (2) **a wicked one** shows **contempt** for others. Alternate translation: [he shows his contempt for other people]

See: Personification

Proverbs 18:4 (#7)

נַ֭חַל נֹבֵ֣עַ מְקֹ֑ור חָכְמָֽה

“a fountain of wisdom {is} a gushing stream”

Here Solomon speaks of a wise person having plentiful **wisdom** as if wisdom sprang out of him like water out of a **fountain** that became a **gushing stream**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [he speaks wise sayings in abundance] or [He is a source of plentiful wisdom like a fountain that produces a gushing stream]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:4 (#6)

חָכְמָֽה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:4 (#4)

מַ֝֗יִם עֲמֻקִּ֥ים

“are} deep waters”

Here Solomon speaks of a wise man’s words being profound as if they were **deep waters**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [are profound] or [are deep like deep waters]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:4 (#3)

פִּי־אִ֭ישׁ

“the mouth of a man”

Here, **the mouth** and **a man** represent mouths and people in general, not one particular **mouth** and **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [the mouths of people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:4 (#1)

דִּבְרֵ֣י פִי־אִ֑ישׁ

“The words of the mouth of a man”

This phrase refers to the **words** that **a man** says by using his **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The words that a man says with his mouth]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:4 (#5)

מְקֹ֑ור חָכְמָֽה

“a fountain of wisdom”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **fountain** that gives **wisdom**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a fountain that gives wisdom]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:4 (#2)

דִּבְרֵ֣י פִי־אִ֑ישׁ

“The words of the mouth of a man”

The second clause indicates that Solomon is referring to wise **words** spoken by a wise **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The wise words of the mouth of a wise man]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:5 (#5)

רָ֭שָׁע & צַדִּ֣יק

“the wicked & the righteous”

Solomon is using the adjectives **wicked** and **righteous** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [wicked people … righteous people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 18:5 (#6)

לְהַטֹּ֥ות

“to turn aside”

Here, **to** marks **turn aside** as the goal or purpose of lifting **the face of the wicked one**. Use a natural way in your language to express a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of turning aside]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 18:5 (#2)

שְׂאֵ֣את פְּנֵי־רָשָׁ֣ע & צַדִּ֑יק בַּמִּשְׁפָּֽט

“to lift the face of the wicked & the righteous in the judgment”

Here, **the face**, **the wicked**, **the righteous**, and **the judgment** represent these things and people in general, not specific things and people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [to lift the faces of the wicked ones ... the righteous ones in the judgments]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:5 (#7)

לְהַטּ֥וֹת

“to turn aside”

Here, depriving an innocent person of a just **judgment** is spoken of as if **the righteous one** were made to **turn aside** when judged in court. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to deprive of justice]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:5 (#1)

לֹא־ט֥וֹב

“It is} not good”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [It is surely bad]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 18:5 (#8)

בַּמִּשְׁפָּֽט

“in the judgment”

Here, **the judgment** refers to the verdict of a judge in a legal case. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [regarding the verdict of his case] or [when his case is decided]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:5 (#4)

רָשָׁ֥ע & צַדִּ֑יק

“the wicked & the righteous”

In this verse, **the wicked** refers to someone who is guilty of doing something **wicked** and **the righteous** refers to someone who is innocent of doing something wicked. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **wicked** and **righteous** in 17:15. Alternate translation: [the guilty one ... the innocent one]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:5 (#3)

שְׂאֵ֣את פְּנֵי

“to lift the face of”

Here, **to lift the face** is an idiom that means “to show partiality” or “to favor”. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to show favoritism to] or [to be partial to]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 18:6 (#2)

יָבֹ֣אוּ בְרִ֑יב

“enter into a dispute”

Here Solomon speaks of what a **stupid one** says with his **lips** causing that person to start a **dispute** as if his **lips** were a person who could **enter into a dispute**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [results in him starting an argument]

See: Personification

Proverbs 18:6 (#3)

וּ֝פִ֗יו לְמַהֲלֻמּ֥וֹת יִקְרָֽא

“and his mouth calls for blows”

Here Solomon speaks of what a **stupid one** says with **his mouth**, causing people to want to beat him as if he were inviting them with **his mouth** to strike him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what he says causes people to want to beat him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:6 (#1)

כְּסִיל & בְּרִרִיב וּפִיו

“a stupid one & into a dispute, and his mouth”

Here, **a stupid one**, **a dispute** and **his** refer to stupid people and disputes in general, not one particular **stupid one** or **dispute**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any stupid one ... into disputes, and that person’s mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:7 (#5)

נַפְשׁוֹ

“his life”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 8:36.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:7 (#4)

מוֹקֵשׁ נַפְשׁוֹ

“are} a snare of his life”

Here Solomon speaks as if **his lips** were a **snare** that traps **a stupid one** when speaking of how what he says with **his lips** causes him trouble. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [will threaten his life] or [are like a snare that traps him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:7 (#2)

פִּי & וּשְׂפָתָיו

“The mouth of & and his lips”

See how you translated the same use of **mouth** and **lips** in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:7 (#3)

מְחִתָּה־לֹּו

“is} ruin for him”

Here, **is** indicates that what follows is the result of what **a stupid one** says. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [causes ruin for him] or [will result in his ruin]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 18:7 (#1)

פִּי־כְסִיל מְחִתָּה־לֹּו וּשְׂפָתָיו מוֹקֵשׁ נַפְשׁוֹ

“The mouth of a stupid one {is} ruin for him, and his lips {are} a snare of his life”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [The mouth of a stupid one is ruin for him, yes, his lips are a snare of his life]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 18:8 (#4)

וְהֵמָּה יֵרְדוּ

“and they themselves go down into”

The intensive pronoun **themselves** represents the pronoun “they” that Solomon uses in the original even though the verb translated as **go down** already includes this meaning. Doing this emphasizes how significant it was that what murmurers said was listened to by others. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [and those very words go down into]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 18:8 (#2)

כְּמִתְלַהֲמִּים

“are} like things swallowed greedily”

Solomon is saying that the **words of a murmurer** are like **things swallowed greedily** because people are eager to hear gossip. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [are listened to eagerly]

See: Simile

Proverbs 18:8 (#5)

חַדְרֵי־בָטֶן

“the rooms of the belly”

Here, **the rooms of the belly** refers to the innermost part of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the innermost part of a person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:8 (#1)

דִּבְרֵי

“The words of”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:8 (#3)

וְ֝הֵ֗מָּה יָרְד֥וּ חַדְרֵי־בָֽטֶן

“and they themselves go down into the rooms of the belly”

Here Solomon speaks of the **words of a murmurer** staying in a person’s mind and affecting that person’s thoughts as if they were food that goes **down into** a person’s stomach. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they enter a person’s mind and affect his thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:9 (#3)

לְבַעַל מַשְׁחִית

“to an owner of destruction”

Here Solomon refers to a person who destroys things as if that person were **an owner of destruction**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to a person who destroys everything] or [to someone who is always destructive]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 18:9 (#2)

אָ֭חַ

“is} a brother”

Here Solomon speaks of the **one who slacks** being similar to **an owner of destruction** as if **he** were that person’s **brother**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is closely related] or [is very similar]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:9 (#1)

מִתְרַפֶּ֣ה בְ֭מְלַאכְתּ֑וֹ אָ֝חַ ה֗וּא לְבַעַל מַשְׁחִֽית

“one who slacks in his work, he {is} a brother to an owner of destruction”

Here, **one who slacks**, **his**, **a brother**, and **an owner of destruction** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who slacks in that person’s work, that person is a brother to any owner of destruction]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:10 (#3)

מִגְדַּל־עֹ֭ז & בּ֣וֹ־יָר֑וּץ צַדִּ֥יק וְנִשְׂגָּֽב

“is} a tower of strength; the righteous {one} runs into it and is set on high”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh protecting his people as if he were a **tower** into which they could run and take refuge **on high** above their enemies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [protects righteous people and keeps them safe from their enemies] or [protects his people like a strong tower provides protection for those who are inside]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:10 (#2)

מִגְדַּל־עֹ֭ז

“is} a tower of strength”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **tower** that is characterized by **strength**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is a tower characterized by strength]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:10 (#4)

צַדִּ֥יק

“the righteous {one”

Here, **the righteous one** represents **righteous** people in general, not one particular **righteous one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any righteous person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:10 (#5)

וְנִשְׂגָּב

“and is set on high”

Here Solomon speaks of a person being safe as if that person were **set on high** at the top of a tower where no one could harm him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and is secure]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:10 (#1)

שֵׁשֵׁם יְהוָה

“The name of Yahweh”

Here, **name of Yahweh** refers to **Yahweh** himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:11 (#1)

הוֹן עָשִׁיר קִרְיַת עֻזּוֹ

“The wealth of the rich one {is} the city of his strength”

See how you translated the same clause in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:11 (#2)

וּכְחוֹמָה נִשְׂגָּבָה

“and like a wall set on high”

Solomon is saying that the **wealth of a rich one** is like **a wall set on high** because **the rich one** thinks that his **wealth** will protect him from enemies, as a **high wall** protects. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and it will protect him like a wall set on high]

See: Simile

Proverbs 18:11 (#3)

בְּמַשְׂכִּיתוֹ

“in his imagination”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **imagination**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [according to what he imagines]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:12 (#1)

לִפְנֵי־שֶׁבֶר

“To the face of breaking”

Here and in the next clause Solomon is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” Here, **breaking** refers to being ruined or destroyed. See how you translated this phrase in 16:18. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Before he is ruined]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:12 (#3)

לֵב

“the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:12 (#2)

יִגְבַּהּ לֵב־אִישׁ

“the heart of a man is exalted”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a man exalts his heart]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 18:12 (#4)

אִישׁ

“a man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 18:12 (#5)

וְלִפְנֵי כָבוֹד עֲנָוָה

“but to the face of honor—humility”

See how you translated the same clause in 15:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:13 (#3)

דָּבָר

“a word”

See how you translated the similar use of **word** in 12:25. Alternate translation: [an answer]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:13 (#2)

מֵשִׁיב דָּבָר

“One who returns a word”

Here, **returns** refers to replying to what someone has said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who replies with an answer]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:13 (#4)

אִוֶּלֶת & וּכְלִמָּה

“is} folly & and shame”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **folly** in 5:23 and **shame** in 6:33.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:13 (#1)

מֵשִׁיב דָּבָר בְּטֶרֶם יִשְׁמָע & לוֹ

“One who returns a word before he listens & to him”

One who returns, **a word**, **he**, and **him** refer to a type of person and **word** in general, not one particular person or **word**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who returns any word before listening ... to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:14 (#2)

יְכַלְכֵּל

“will endure”

Here Solomon implies that a person’s **spirit** enables that person to **endure his illness**. if it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will enable him to endure]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:14 (#1)

רוּחַ & וְרוּחַ נְכֵאָה

“The spirit of & but a crushed spirit”

In this verse, **spirit** refers to a person’s attitude. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The attitude of ... but a crushed attitude]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:14 (#5)

יְשָׂאֶנָּה

“can lift it”

Here Solomon refers to helping a depressed person feel better as if one could **lift** that person’s **spirit**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [can restore it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:14 (#4)

מִמִּי יְשָׂאֶנָּה

“who can lift it”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize the difficulty of helping a depressed person feel better. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [surely no one can lift it!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 18:14 (#3)

וְרוּחַ נְכֵאָה

“but a crushed spirit”

Here Solomon refers to a person who despairs as if that person’s **spirit** were **crushed** by something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 15:13. Alternate translation: [but an attitude of despair]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:15 (#3)

לֵב נָבוֹן יִקְנֶה

“The heart of an understanding one acquires”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person's intentions and desires exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 15:14. Alternate translation: [An understanding one desires to acquire]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:15 (#5)

וְאׇזֶן חֲכָמִ֥ים תְּבַקֵּֽשׁ

"and the ear of the wise seeks"

Here, **ear** refers to the way that a person learns by listening. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the wise ones seek to hear]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:15 (#1)

לֵ֤ב נָ֭בוֹן יִקְנֶה־דָּ֑עַת וְאׇזֶן חֲכָמִ֥ים תְּבַקֵּֽשׁ־דָּֽעַת

"The heart of an understanding one acquires knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks knowledge"

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [The heart of an understanding one acquires knowledge, yes, and the ear of the wise ones seeks knowledge]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 18:15 (#2)

לֵ֤ב נָ֭בוֹן יִקְנֶה־דָּ֑עַת וְאׇזֶן חֲכָמִ֥ים תְּבַקֵּֽשׁ־דָּֽעַת

"The heart of an understanding one acquires knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks knowledge"

The heart, **an understanding one**, and **the ear** represents these things and type of people in general, not specific things or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The hearts of understanding ones acquire knowledge, and the ears of the wise seek knowledge]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:15 (#6)

תְּבַקֵּֽשׁ

"seeks"

See how you translated the same use of **seeks** in 11:27.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:15 (#4)

דָּ֑עַת & דָּֽעַת

"knowledge & knowledge"

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:16 (#4)

וְלִפְנֵ֖י

"and before the face of"

See how you translated the same use of **before the face of** in 14:19.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:16 (#2)

מַתְּנַ֣ת אָ֭דָם

"The gift of a man"

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **gift** that is given by **a man**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [What a man gives]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:16 (#3)

יַרְחִ֣יב

"will make room"

Here, **make room** is an idiom that means "create an opportunity." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will open doors] or [will create an opportunity]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 18:16 (#5)

יַנְחֶ֑נּוּ

"it will guide him"

Here **it** refers to **The gift**. Solomon speaks of this gift as if it were a living think that could **guide** the person who gives it. He means that giving a gift could result in a person meeting **great ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it will enable him to go]

See: Personification

Proverbs 18:16 (#1)

מַתְּנַ֣ן אָ֭אָדָם & לֹ֣ו & יַנְחֶ֑נּוּ

“The gift of a man & for him & it will guide him”

The gift, **a man**, **him**, and **it** refer to gifts and people in general, not one particular **gift** or person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [A gift of any person ... for that person ... it will guide that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:17 (#4)

יבא־רֵ֣עֵ֔הוּ

“then his neighbor comes”

Solomon implies that there is a contrast between the idea of the previous clause and this clause. Solomon implies that the results of examining the **first one** will be that **his case** is not **right**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [but then his neighbor comes]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 18:17 (#3)

הָרִאשֹׁ֖ון

“The first one”

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [Person one]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Proverbs 18:17 (#2)

הָרִאשֹׁ֖ון בְּרִיבֹ֑ו & רֵ֣עֵ֔הוּ וְחָקָרֹֽו

“The first one with his case & his neighbor & and examines him”

The first one, **his**, and **him** refer to a type of person, not a particular **first one**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who first brings his case ... that person’s neighbor ... and examines that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:17 (#1)

צַדִּ֥יק הָרִאשֹׁ֖ון בְּרִיבֹ֑ו יבא־רֵ֣עֵ֔הוּ וְחָקָרֹֽו

“The first one with his case {is} right; then his neighbor comes and examines him”

This verse refers to a dispute in which one person states **his case** that seems to be **right** until that person’s **neighbor examines him** by asking him questions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When people dispute, the first one states his case and seems to be right. Then his neighbor comes and questions what he said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:18 (#3)

מְמַדְּנִ֣ים

“quarrels”

See how you translated the abstract noun **quarrels** in 6:14.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:18 (#4)

יַפְרִ֣יד

“it makes a separation”

The phrase **makes a separation** refers to discerning which of the **mighty ones** is correct in an argument. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [it discerns who is correct]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:18 (#1)

הַגּוֹרָ֑לֹ

“The lot”

The lot refers to casting lots in general, not a specific **lot**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Casting lots]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:18 (#2)

הַגּוֹרָ֑לֹ

“The lot”

See how you translated **lot** in 16:33.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 18:19 (#5)

כִּבְרִיַ֣ח אַרְמ֑וֹן

“are} like the gate bar of a fortress”

This could mean: (1) **quarrels** cause people to stay away from each other as though a **bar** blocking the **gate** of a **fortress** were between them. Alternate translation: [separate people like the gate bar of a fortress]; (2) resolving **quarrels** is as difficult as trying to enter a **fortress** that has a **bar** across its **gate**. Alternate translation: [are as difficult to resolve as breaking the gate bar of a fortress]

See: Simile

Proverbs 18:19 (#4)

ומדונים

“and quarrels”

See how you translated the abstract noun **quarrels** in 6:14.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:19 (#3)

מִקִּרְיַ֥ת־עֹ֗ז

“is} more than a city of strength”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **city** that is characterized by **strength**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is more than a strong city]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:19 (#1)

אָ֭ח

“A brother”

Here, **brother** refers to any relative or close friend. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A relative]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:19 (#2)

מִקִּרְיַ֥ת־עֹ֗ז

“is} more than a city of strength”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word or phrase if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is more unyielding than a city of strength] or [is more difficult to approach than a city of strength]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 18:19 (#6)

כִּבְרִיַ֣ח

“are} like the gate bar of”

A **gate bar** was a large piece of metal or wood that was placed across a **gate** in order to make the **gate** difficult to break down or open. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of **bar**, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [are like the large beam placed across the gate of]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 18:20 (#3)

מִפְּרִ֣י פִֽי־אִ֭ישׁ

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man”

See how you translated this phrase in 12:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:20 (#5)

תְּבוּאַ֣ת שְׂ֭פָתָיו יִשְׂבָּֽע

“with} the produce of his lips, he is satisfied”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the produce of his lips satisfies him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 18:20 (#4)

תִּשְׂבַּ֣ע בִּטְנ֑וֹ

“his belly is satisfied”

Here Solomon is using one part of a person, his **belly**, to mean all of him in the act of being satisfied with fruit. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will eat enough to feel satisfied]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 18:20 (#1)

מִפְּרִי־פִ֣י אִ֭ישׁ תִּשְׂבַּ֣ע בִּטְנ֑וֹ תְּבוּאַ֥ת שְׂ֝פָתָ֗יו יִשְׂבָּֽע

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man his belly is satisfied; {with} the produce of his lips, he is satisfied”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [From the fruit of the mouth of a man his belly is satisfied; yes, with the produce of his lips, he is satisfied]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 18:20 (#6)

תְּבוּאַ֥ת שְׂ֝פָתָ֗יו

“with} the produce of his lips”

Here Solomon refers to what a person says as if it were **produce** from that person’s **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with what he says]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:20 (#2)

מִפְּרִי־פִ֣י אִ֭ישׁ תִּשְׂבַּ֣ע בִּטְנ֑וֹ

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man his belly is satisfied”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The fruit of the mouth of a man satisfies his belly]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 18:21 (#3)

בְּיַד

“are} in the hand of”

Solomon is using **in the hand of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “determined by.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are determined by] or [are in the power of]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 18:21 (#5)

וְ֝אֹהֲבֶ֗יהָ יֹאכַ֥ל פִּרְיָֽהּ

“and those who love it will eat its fruit”

Here, **it** refers to **the tongue**, which represents what someone says by using the tongue. Solomon speaks of having respect for what one says and speaking well as loving the tongue. Those who speak well, recognizing and using well the power of their words, will **eat** the **fruit** of speaking well. Eating the **fruit** represents receiving the consequences for what they say, as also in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and those who speak well will benefit from the words that they say]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:21 (#4)

לָ֑שׁוֹן

“the tongue”

See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:21 (#1)

מָ֭וֶת וְחַיִּ֣ים בְּיַד־לָ֑שׁוֹן

“Death and life {are} in the hand of the tongue”

Here Solomon speaks of a person’s **tongue** as if it were a person who held **Death and life** in his **hand**. He means that what people say can cause people to die or stay alive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A person’s death and life can be determined by what a person says]

See: Personification

Proverbs 18:21 (#2)

מָ֭וֶת וְחַיִּ֣ים

“Death and life”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Death** in 2:18 and **life** in 8:36.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:22 (#4)

רָ֝צ֗וֹן

“favor”

Here, **favor** could refer to: (1) Yahweh being pleased with the man **who finds a wife**, as in the identical phrase in 8:35. Alternate translation: [approval]; (2) the **wife** mentioned in the previous clause, in which case **favor** would mean "gift." Alternate translation: [a gift]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:22 (#3)

טוֹב & רָצוֹן

"good & favor"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **good** in 11:27 and **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:22 (#2)

מָצָא & מָצָא

"He who finds & finds"

Obtaining **a wife** and something **good** are spoken of as if they are objects that a person **finds** by searching. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He who obtains ... obtains]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:22 (#1)

מָצָא אִשָּׁה & וַיִּפְקֹ

"He who finds a wife & and he obtains"

He who finds, **a wife**, and **he** refer to people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who finds a wife ... and that person obtains]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:23 (#2)

תַּחֲנוּנִים יְדַבֵּר

"speaks pleas"

The phrase **speaks pleas** refers to someone humbly asking or begging for mercy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [pleads for mercy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:23 (#3)

יַעֲנֶה

"answers"

Here Solomon implies that **a rich one answers** the **pleas** of **One who is poor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [answers the poor one]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:23 (#1)

רָאשׁ וְעָשִׁיר

"One who is poor & but a rich one"

One who is poor and **a rich one** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any poor person ... but any rich person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:24 (#2)

אִישׁ רֵעִים

"A man of companions"

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who has **companions**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A man with companions]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:24 (#6)

דָּבֵק מֵאָח

"clinging more than a brother"

Here Solomon refers to a person's friend being more loyal than **a brother** as if that friend were **clinging** to him **more than a brother** would cling. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [more faithful than family]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:24 (#1)

אִישׁ רֵעִים & אֹהֵב & מֵאָח

"A man of companions & one who loves & more than a brother"

A man, **one who loves**, and **a brother** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of

companions ... any person who loves ... more than any brother]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:24 (#5)

לְהִתְרֹעֵעַ

“is} to be broken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will experience ruin]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 18:24 (#3)

אִישׁ רֵעִים

“A man of companions”

This phrase could refer to: (1) a person who has false or unreliable **companions** who harm him, which contrasts with **one who loves** in the next clause. Alternate translation: [A man with unreliable companions]; (2) a person who has too many **companions**. Alternate translation: [A man with too many companions]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:24 (#4)

לְהִתְרֹעֵעַ

“is} to be broken”

Here Solomon refers to a person being destroyed as if he were **broken**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will experience destruction] or [will be destroyed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs - Chapter 19 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 19 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 19 also contains contrasting parallelism (19:4, 12, 14, 16, 21) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (19:5, 9). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 19:1 (#4)

מֵעִקֵּשׁ שְׂשָׂפָתָיו

“than one who is crooked {in} his lips”

Here Solomon uses the phrase **crooked in his lips** to refer to someone who speaks deceptively. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **crooked** in 2:15. Alternate translation: [than one who speaks with deception]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:1 (#3)

בְּתֻמּוֹ

“in his integrity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:1 (#2)

הוֹלֵךְ בְּתֻמּוֹ

“who walks in his integrity”

Here Solomon speaks of a person behaving with **integrity** as if **integrity** were a place that person **walks in**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of “walk” in 3:23. Alternate translation: [who behaves with integrity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:1 (#1)

רָאשׁ & בְּתֻמּוֹ מֵעִקֵּשׁ שְׂשָׂפָתָיו וְהוּא כְסִיל

“is} one who is poor & in his integrity than one who is crooked {in} his lips and he {is} a stupid one”

Here, **one who is poor**, **his**, **one who is crooked**, **he**, and **a stupid one** all refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [is a poor person ... in that person’s integrity than a person who is crooked in that one’s lips and is a stupid person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:2 (#2)

נֶ֫פֶשׁ

“zeal”

Here, the word translated as **zeal** could refer to: (1) a person’s desire or emotions. Alternate translation: [desire]; (2) a person’s life. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:2 (#5)

וְאָ֥ץ בְּרַגְלַ֗יִם חוֹטֵֽא

“and one who hurries with feet misses {the way”

Here Solomon speaks of a person doing something too hastily with the result that he makes mistakes as if he **hurries** by running **with** his **feet** and so he **misses the way** that he should have gone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and one who acts too quickly makes mistakes]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:2 (#3)

דַּ֣עַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:2 (#4)

לֹא־טֹ֑וב

“is} not good”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [is extremely bad]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 19:2 (#1)

וְאָ֥ץ

“and one who hurries”

Here, **one who hurries** refers to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [and any person who hurries]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:2 (#6)

חוֹטֵֽא

“misses {the way”

Here the word translated as **misses the way** could refer to: (1) someone making a mistake. Alternate translation: [makes a mistake] or [errs]; (2) someone acting sinfully, which this word often means in other contexts. Alternate translation: [acts sinfully]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:3 (#5)

וְעַל־יְהוָ֥ה יִזְעַ֗ף לִבּֽוֹ

“and his heart will rage against Yahweh”

Here Solomon implies that the foolish **man** rages **against Yahweh** because he blames **Yahweh** for his destruction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and his heart will rage against Yahweh because he blames Yahweh for his destruction]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:3 (#1)

אִוֶּ֣לֶת

“The folly of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:3 (#4)

דַּרְכּ֣וֹ

“his way”

Here, **way** refers to a person’s life circumstances. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:3 (#2)

אָדָ֑ם & דַּרְכּ֣וֹ & לִבּֽוֹ

“a man & his way & his heart”

Although **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes

both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... that person's way ... that person's heart]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:3 (#6)

לִבּוֹ

"his heart"

Here, **heart** refers to the whole person, with emphasis on that person's emotions. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 15:14.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 19:3 (#3)

תְּסַלֵּף

"will lead astray"

Here, **folly** is spoken of as if it were a person who could **lead** someone **astray**. This expression means that foolish people will ruin their lives because they act foolishly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will result in ruining]

See: Personification

Proverbs 19:4 (#3)

וְזָדָל

"but a lowly one"

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:4 (#4)

וְזָדָל & יִפָּרֵד

"but a lowly one is separated"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but poverty separates a lowly one]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 19:4 (#2)

וְזָדָל מֵרֵעֵהוּ

"but a lowly one & from his companions"

Here, **a lowly one** and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific lowly one. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [but any lowly person ... from that person's companions]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:4 (#1)

הוֹן יֹסִיף רֵעִים רַבִּים

"Wealth adds many companions"

Here Solomon implies that a person who is wealthy will have **many companions** because **wealth** attracts people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Wealth causes a person to have many friends]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:4 (#5)

מֵרֵעֵהוּ יִפָּרֵד

"is separated from his companions"

Solomon implies that **a lowly one is separated from** his friends because of his poverty. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is separated from his friends because of his poverty]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:5 (#5)

וְיָפִיחַ כְּזָבִים

"and he who breathes out lies"

See how you translated **breathes out lies** in 6:19.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:5 (#3)

עֵד שְׁקָרִים

"A witness of falsehoods"

See how you translated this phrase in 12:17.

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:5 (#1)

עֵד שְׁקָרִים לֹא יִנָּקֶה וְיָפִיחַ כְּזָבִים לֹא יִמָּלֵט

"A witness of falsehoods will not be blameless, and he who breathes out lies will not escape"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second phrase emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect

the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A witness of falsehoods will not be blameless; yes, he who breathes out lies will not escape]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 19:5 (#2)

עֵ֣ד שְׁקָרִ֣ים & וְיָפִ֣יחַ כְּזָבִ֣ים

“A witness of falsehoods & and he who breathes out lies”

A witness of falsehoods and **he who breathes out lies** refer to types of people, not a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any witness of falsehoods ... and any person who breathes out lies]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:5 (#7)

לֹ֣א יִמָּלֵֽט

“will not escape”

Here Solomon implies that someone **who breathes out lies will not escape** punishment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will not escape punishment]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:5 (#6)

לֹ֣א יִמָּלֵֽט

“will not escape”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will certainly be caught]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 19:5 (#4)

לֹ֣א יִנָּקֶֽה

“will not be blameless”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will certainly be guilty]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 19:6 (#4)

נָדִֽיב

“a noble”

Here, the word translated as **noble** can refer to someone who has noble character as well as to someone who is a member of the nobility, or ruling class. See how you translated the same use of “nobles” in 17:26.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:6 (#2)

פְּנֵי־נָדִ֣יב & הָֽרֹעֵ֣ עְ לְאִ֣ישׁ מַתָּֽן

“the face of a noble & is} the friend of a man of gift”

Here, **the face**, **a noble**, **the friend**, and **a man of gift** refer to faces and types of people in general, not a specific **face** or person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [the faces of any noble ... is any friend of any man of gift]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:6 (#3)

פְּנֵי־נָדִֽיב

“the face of a noble”

The phrase **face** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the noble person]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 19:6 (#5)

וְכֹ֖ל

“and everyone”

Solomon says **everyone** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and almost everyone]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 19:6 (#7)

לְאִ֣ישׁ מַתָּֽן

“of a man of gift”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by giving gifts. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [of a man who gives gifts]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:6 (#6)

הָֽלָהֲרֵ֥עַ

“is} the friend”

Here Solomon implies that **everyone** wants to be **the friend of a man of gift**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [wants to be the friend]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:6 (#1)

רַבִּ֑ים

“Many”

Here Solomon uses the adjective **many** as a noun to mean “many people.” Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [Many people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 19:7 (#1)

כָּל־אֲחֵ֣י רָ֭שׁ ׀ שְׂנֵאֻ֑הוּ

“All the brothers of one who is poor hate him”

Solomon says **All the brothers hate** the **one who is poor** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Even the relatives of a poor man often disdain him]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 19:7 (#3)

רָ֭שׁ ׀ שְׂנֵאֻ֑הוּ & מִמֶּ֝נּ֗וּ & מְאֹ֣דַּ֣ע & מְרַדֵּ֣ף

“one who is poor hate him & his friends & from him! He pursues”

Here, **one who is poor**, **him**, **his**, and **He** refer to a type of person in general, not one particular **poor** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated **one who is poor** in 14:20. Alternate translation: [any person who is poor hate that person ... that person’s friends ... from that person! That person pursues]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:7 (#5)

מְרַדֵּ֣ף אֲמָרִ֑ים

“He pursues {with} words”

Here Solomon refers to someone pleading for help from his **brothers** and **friends** as if he were using **words** to chase them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He pleads with them for help]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:7 (#2)

אֲחֵ֥י

“the brothers of”

Although the term **brothers** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. See how you translated the same use of **brothers** in 6:19.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:7 (#4)

מְרַדֵּ֣ף אֲמָרִ֑ים לֹא־הֵֽמָּה

“He pursues {with} words; they {are} not”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [He pursues them with words, but they are not there]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:7 (#6)

אֲמָרִ֑ים

“with} words”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:8 (#4)

נַפְשׁ֗וֹ

“his life”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 8:36.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:8 (#5)

שֹׁמֵ֣ר תְּ֭בוּנָה

“the one keeping understanding”

Here Solomon speaks of someone preserving or remembering **understanding** as if it were an object that someone is **keeping**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “keep” in 5:2. Alternate translation: [one who preserves understanding]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:8 (#3)

אֹהֵ֖ב נַפְשׁ֑וֹ

“is loving his life”

Here, **loves his life** has the positive meaning of taking care of oneself or doing what is best for one’s well-being. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [does what benefits his life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:8 (#2)

קֹנֵ֣ה־לֵ֑ב

“The one acquiring heart”

Here Solomon uses **heart** to refer to a person’s ability to reason. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who acquires the ability to reason]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:8 (#6)

תְּ֭בוּנָה

“understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:8 (#1)

קֹנֵ֣ה & נַפְשׁ֑וֹ שֹׁמֵ֣ר

“The one acquiring & his life; the one keeping”

The one acquiring, **his**, and **the one keeping** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated **one who keeps** in 10:17. Alternate translation: [any person who acquires ... that person’s life ... any person who keeps]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:8 (#7)

לִמְצֹ֣א

“is} to find”

Here, **is to find** means “is destined to achieve” or “is certain to obtain.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is destined to find] or [is certain of finding]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:8 (#8)

לִמְצֹא־טֽוֹב

“is} to find good {fortune”

See how you translated **find good** in 16:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:9 (#1)

עֵ֤ד שְׁ֭קָרִים לֹ֣א יִנָּקֶ֑ה וְיָפִ֖יחַ כְּזָבִ֣ים יֹאבֵֽד

“A witness of falsehoods will not be blameless, and one who breathes out lies will perish”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A witness of falsehoods will not be blameless; yes, one who breathes out lies will perish]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 19:9 (#2)

עֵ֤ד שְׁ֭קָרִים לֹ֣א יִנָּקֶ֑ה

“A witness of falsehoods will not be blameless”

See how you translated this clause in 19:5.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 19:9 (#3)

וְיָפִיחַ כְּזָבִים

“and one who breathes out lies”

See how you translated **breathes out lies** in 6:19 and 19:5.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:10 (#1)

תַּעֲנֻג

“Luxury”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **Luxury**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [What is luxurious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:10 (#2)

לִכְסִיל & לְעֶבֶד

“for a stupid one & for a slave”

See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18 and **a slave** in 11:29.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:10 (#3)

אַ֝אַף כִּי־לְעֶבֶד

“how much less for a slave”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [how much less suitable is it for a slave]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:11 (#3)

הֶאֱרִיךְ אַפּוֹ

“makes his nose long”

Here Solomon is using a **long nose** as a common expression of his culture to mean “slow to anger.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression “long of nostrils” in 14:29. Alternate translation: [causes him to not easily vent his spleen] or [causes him not to become angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:11 (#5)

פָּשַׁע

“a transgression”

Here, the word **transgression** represents transgressions in general, not one particular **transgression**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any transgression]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:11 (#2)

אָדָם & אַפּוֹ וְתִפְאַרְתּוֹ

“a man & his nose & and his splendor”

Although **a man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... that person’s nose ... and that person’s splendor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:11 (#1)

שֵׂכֶל & וְתִפְאַרְתּוֹ & פָּשַׁע

“The insight of & and his splendor & a transgression”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **insight** in 1:3, **splendor** in 4:9, and **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:11 (#6)

פָּשַׁע

“a transgression”

Here Solomon implies that this is **a transgression** that someone has committed against the person who passes **over** it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a transgression that someone has committed against him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:11 (#4)

עֲבֹר עַל

“is} to pass over”

Here Solomon refers to a person ignoring or forgiving **a transgression** as if that person passes **over** it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is to ignore] or [is to forgive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:12 (#3)

נַנַּהֲם כַּכְּפִיר

“is} a growling like the young lion”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is a growling like the growling of the young lion]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:12 (#1)

זַעַף & רְצוֹנוֹ

“The rage of & his favor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **rage** in 11:23 and **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:12 (#5)

וּכְטַל עַל־עֵשֶׂב רְצוֹנוֹ

“but his favor {is} like dew on vegetation”

Solomon is saying that a king’s **favor** is like **dew on vegetation** because both are refreshing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [but his favor is refreshing like dew on vegetation]

See: Simile

Proverbs 19:12 (#2)

כַּכְּפִיר & מֶלֶךְ & רְצוֹנוֹ

“a king & like the young lion & his favor”

Here, **a king**, **the young lion**, and **his** refer to kings and young lions in general, not to a specific **king** or **young lion**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any king … like any young lion … that king’s favor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:12 (#4)

נַנַּהֲם כַּכְּפִיר

“is} a growling like the young lion”

Solomon is saying that **The rage of a king** is like the **growling** of **the young lion** because both frighten people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [is frightening like the growling of the young lion]

See: Simile

Proverbs 19:13 (#2)

הַוַּת לְאָבִיו

“is} destruction to his father”

Here Solomon refers to a **stupid son** ruining the life of **his father** as if he were his father’s **destruction**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [ruins the life of his father] or [ruins the happiness of his father]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:13 (#6)

מִדְיְנֵי אִשָּׁה

“the quarrels of a wife”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **wife** who is characterized by **quarrels**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. The implication is that these are **quarrels** between **a wife** and her husband. Alternate translation: [a quarrelsome wife] or [the arguments that a wife has with her husband]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:13 (#1)

לְאָבִיו בֵּבֶן כְּסִיל

“A stupid son & to his father”

Although **son** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using those words in a generic sense that could refer to either a male or female child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [A stupid child … to that child’s father]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:13 (#5)

מִדְיְנֵי

“the quarrels of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **quarrels** in 6:14.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:13 (#7)

אֵשֶׁת

“a wife”

See how you translated **a wife** in 18:22.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:13 (#4)

וְדֶלֶף טֹטֵרֵד

“and a continual dripping”

Here Solomon speaks of **the quarrels of a wife** being annoying as if they were continually **dripping** water. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and endlessly bothersome] or [and as annoying as a continual dripping of water]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:13 (#3)

וְדֶלֶף טֹטֵרֵד מִדְיְנֵי אֵשֶׁת

“and a continual dripping, the quarrels of a wife”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a continual dripping is the quarrels of a wife]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:14 (#2)

נַחֲלַת & מַשְׂכֶּלֶת

“are} the inheritance of & who has insight”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **inheritance** in 17:2 and **insight** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:14 (#1)

בַּיִת וָהוֹן נַחֲלַת אָבוֹת & אִשָּׁה מַשְׂכֶּלֶת

“A house and wealth {are} the inheritance of fathers & is} a wife who has insight”

A house, **the inheritance**, and **a wife** here do not refer to specific things or people, but refer to these things and people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Houses and wealth are the inheritances of fathers ... are wives who have insight]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:15 (#2)

וְנֶפֶשׁ רְמִיָּה תִרְעָב

“and a life of idleness is hungry”

Many proverbs have two parts that have a relationship to each other. The second part may strengthen the first part, give more details about the first part, or say something that is a contrast to the first part. Here the second line strengthens and adds to the first part. Alternate translation: [and a lifestyle of laziness results in being hungry]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 19:15 (#5)

וְנֶפֶשׁ

“and a life of”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 8:36. Alternate translation: [and a person of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:15 (#4)

וְנֶפֶשׁ רְמִיָּה

“and a life of idleness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **life** that is characterized by **idleness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and an idle life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:15 (#3)

עַצְלָה & רְמִיָּה

“Laziness & idleness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Laziness** and **idleness**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **idleness** in 10:4. Alternate translation: [Being lazy ... being idle]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:15 (#1)

עַצְלָה תַּפִּיל תַּרְדֵּמָה

“Laziness causes deep sleep to fall”

Here Solomon speaks of a lazy person sleeping deeply as if **Laziness** were something that **causes deep sleep to fall** on that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Laziness makes a person sleep deeply] or [A lazy person sleeps deeply]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:16 (#6)

דְּרָכָיו

“his ways”

The pronoun **his** could refer to: (1) God. In this case, the **ways** refer to the **commandment**, which would also be from God, as in the UST. Or (2) the person. In this case, the person does not control his own conduct. Alternate translation: [controlling the way that he lives]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 19:16 (#2)

מִצְוָה

“a commandment”

See how you translated the abstract noun **commandment** in 6:20.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:16 (#5)

דְּרָכָיו

“his ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:16 (#3)

שֹׁמֵר נַפְשׁוֹ

“keeps his life”

See how you translated this phrase in 13:3.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:16 (#4)

בּוֹזֵה דְּרָכָיו יומת

“one who despises his ways will die”

The content of this clause is in strong contrast to the content of the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, one who despises his ways will die]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 19:16 (#1)

שֹׁמֵר מִצְוָה שֹׁמֵר נַפְשׁוֹ בּוֹזֵה דְּרָכָיו

“One who keeps a commandment keeps his life; one who despises his ways”

One who keeps, **a commandment**, **his**, and **one who despises** here do not refer to specific things or people, but refer to these things and people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Ones who keep commandments keep their lives; ones who despise their ways]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:17 (#2)

דָּל

“a lowly one”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:17 (#5)

יְשַׁלֶּם־לוֹ

“he will repay to him”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh rewarding someone for being **gracious to a lowly one** as if Yahweh were repaying a debt to him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will reward him for]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:17 (#3)

מַלְוֵה יְהוָה

“lends {to} Yahweh”

Here Solomon speaks of someone doing something kind for which Yahweh will reward that person as if that person **lends** something **to Yahweh** that **he will repay**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [does this on behalf of Yahweh] or [is like one who lends to Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:17 (#1)

חוֹנֵן דָּל וּגְמֻלֹּו יְשַׁלֶּם־לֹו

“One who is gracious {to} a lowly one & and his dealing he will repay to him”

One who is gracious, **a lowly one**, **him**, and **his** here refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who is gracious to any lowly person ... and that gracious person’s dealing he will repay to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:17 (#4)

וּגְמֻלֹּו

“and his dealing”

Here, **dealing** refers to what the person did to be **gracious to a lowly one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and his gracious deed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:18 (#4)

וְאֶל־הֲמִיתֹתֹו אַל־תִּשָּׂא נַפְשֶׁךָ

“and do not lift up your soul to put him to death”

The implication is that by failing to discipline the child, the parents would be acting like they want the son to die, because he would grow up to be the kind of person that everyone hates. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:18 (#1)

בִּבְנֶךָ & וְהֲמִיתֹתֹו

“your son & put him to death”

Although **son** and **him** are masculine, Solomon is using those words in a generic sense that could refer to either a male or female child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [your child ... put that child to death]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:18 (#3)

וְאֶל־הֲמִיתֹתֹו אַל־תִּשָּׂא נַפְשֶׁךָ

“and do not lift up your soul to put him to death”

Here, the phrase **lift up your soul** is an idiom that refers to being determined to do something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and do not set your heart on putting him to death] or [and do not be determined to put him to death]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:18 (#2)

כִּי־יֵשׁ תִּקְוָה

“when there is hope”

Here, the phrase **when there is hope** refers to the time when a child is still willing to accept discipline from his parents. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [while he can still be taught]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:19 (#2)

גרל־חֵמָה

“One great of heat”

One great of heat refers to someone who is extremely angry. Here, **heat** refers to anger, which causes the angry person’s body to become hot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **heat** in 6:34. Alternate translation: [An extremely angry person]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:19 (#1)

גרל־חֵמָה

“One great of heat”

One great of heat represents a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Any person great of heat]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:19 (#3)

נַּשֵּׂא עֹנֶשׁ

“lifts up a fine”

Here Solomon speaks of a person experiencing the consequences for what happens when he gets angry as if those consequences were a **fine** that he **lifts up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [must experience the consequences]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:19 (#4)

עֹנֶשׁ

“a fine”

Here Solomon implies that this **fine** is for something bad that the extremely angry person has done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a fine for what he does when he is angry]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:19 (#5)

אִם־תַּצִּיל

“if you rescue”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if you rescue him from paying a fine] or [if you rescue him from trouble]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:20 (#1)

עֵצָה & מוּסָר

“counsel & instruction”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **counsel** in 1:25 and **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:20 (#3)

בְּאַחֲרִיתֶךָ

“in your afterwards”

This could refer to: (1) the future in general. Alternate translation: [in the future] or [after you are taught]; (2) the time near the end of one’s life. Alternate translation: [when your life is almost over]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:20 (#2)

לְמַעַן תֶּחְכַּם

“so that you will become wise”

Here, **so that** indicates that what follows is the purpose for obeying the commands in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to express a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of becoming wise]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 19:21 (#4)

וַעֲצַת

“but the counsel of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **counsel** in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:21 (#2)

אִישׁ

“a man”

Although **man** is masculine, here it refers to any person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:21 (#5)

הִהְיֹא תָקוּם

“it will stand”

Here Solomon refers to **counsel** that is successful as if it were a person who could **stand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same phrase in 15:22. Alternate translation: [it will be successful]

See: Personification

Proverbs 19:21 (#3)

וַעֲצַת יְהוָה

“but the counsel of Yahweh”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **counsel** that **Yahweh** gives. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but the counsel that Yahweh gives]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:21 (#1)

מַחֲשָׁבוֹת בְּלֵב

“are} the plans in the heart of”

Here Solomon speaks of **the plans** that a person thinks about as if they were objects located **in** that person’s **heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of heart in 2:2. Alternate translation: [are the plans thought about by]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:22 (#2)

אָדָם חַסְדּוֹ & רָ֭שׁ מֵאִ֣ישׁ כָּזָֽב

“a man {is} his covenant faithfulness & is} one who is poor than a man of lying”

Here, **a man**, **his**, **one who is poor**, and **a man of lying** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [a person is that person’s covenant faithfulness ... is a person who is poor than a person of lying]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:22 (#3)

חַסְדּוֹ

“is} his covenant faithfulness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **covenant faithfulness** in 3:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:22 (#4)

מֵאִ֣ישׁ כָּזָֽב

“than a man of lying”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **lying**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [than a man characterized by lying] or [than a liar]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:22 (#1)

תַּאֲוַת אָדָם

“The desire of a man”

This phrase could mean: (1) what **a man** desires for himself. Alternate translation: [What a man desires] or (2) what others desire **a man** to be like. Alternate translation: [What people desire in a man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:23 (#3)

וְשָׂבֵ֣עַ יָ֭לִין

“and the satisfied {one} will stay overnight”

The phrase **stay overnight** here is an idiom that refers to resting or sleeping. The idea is that the person who fears Yahweh will have satisfying rest through the night. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and this person will rest satisfied]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:23 (#4)

וְשָׂבֵ֣עַ

“and the satisfied {one”

Solomon is using the adjective **satisfied** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and the satisfied person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 19:23 (#1)

יִרְאַ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“The fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:23 (#2)

לְחַיִּ֥ים

“is} to life”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:23 (#5)

בַּל־יִפָּ֥קֹד רָֽע

“he will not be visited by evil”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [evil will not visit him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 19:23 (#6)

בַּל־יִפָּקֵד רָֽע

“he will not be visited by evil”

Here Solomon speaks of a person experiencing **evil** as if **evil** were a person who could visit him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will not experience evil]

See: Personification

Proverbs 19:23 (#7)

רָֽע

“evil”

Here, **evil** refers to trouble that someone might experience as a result of **evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [trouble]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:24 (#2)

טָמַן יָדוֹ בַּצַּלָּחַת &

“hides his hand in the dish”

In Solomon’s culture, people usually ate with their hands and put their hands **in a dish** in order to pick up food and eat it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [puts his hand in the dish in order to pick up food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:24 (#1)

עָצֵל יָדוֹ & גַּם־אֶל־פִּיהוּ לֹא יְשִׁיבֶנָּה

“A lazy one & his hand & he will not even return it to his mouth”

A lazy one, **his**, and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated **A lazy one** in 10:26. Alternate translation: [Any lazy one ... that person’s hand ... that person will not even return it to that person’s own mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:24 (#3)

גַּם־אֶל־פִּיהוּ לֹא יְשִׁיבֶנָּה

“he will not even return it to his mouth”

Here Solomon implies that **A lazy one** does not **return** his hand **to his mouth** because he is too lazy to do so. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but he is too lazy to even bring his hand up to his mouth to feed himself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:25 (#3)

וּפְתִי יַעְרִם

“and a naive one will become prudent”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **a naive one will become prudent** as the result of seeing someone **Strike a mocker**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and a naive one will see this happen and become prudent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:25 (#1)

לֵץ תַּכֶּה

“You strike a mocker”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **Strike** refers to a way of punishing **a mocker**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Punish a mocker by striking him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:25 (#4)

דָּעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:25 (#2)

לֵץ & וּפְתִי & לְלָנְבוֹן יָבִֽין

“a mocker and a naive one & an understanding one —he will understand”

Here, **a mocker**, **a naive one**, **an understanding one**, and **he** refer to a types of person in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a mocker** in 9:7, **a naive one** in

14:15, and **an understanding one** in 17:10. Alternate translation: [any mocker and any naive one ... any understanding one—that person will understand]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:26 (#2)

מֻשַּׁדֵּד

“One who does violence”

One who does violence here refers to this type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who does violence]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:26 (#4)

בֵּ֑בֵּן

“is} a son”

Although **son** is masculine, Solomon is using those words in a generic sense that could refer to either a male or female child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [is a child]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:26 (#1)

מֻשַּׁדֵּד & מֵבִ֥יא וּמַחְפִּ֑יר

“One who does violence & who causes shame and causes embarrassment”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **violence**, **shame**, and **embarrassment**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **violence** in 3:31 and **shame** in 6:33. Alternate translation: [One who is violent ... who shames and embarrasses]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:26 (#3)

אָבִ֥יו & אִמּ֑וֹ

“to} a father & a mother”

Solomon implies that **father** and **mother** here refer to the **father** and **mother** of the **One who does violence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to his father ... his mother] or [to that person’s father ... that person’s mother]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:27 (#2)

חֲדַ֗ל & לִשְׁמֹ֥עַ מוּסָ֑ר לְ֝לִשְׁגּ֗וֹת מֵאִמְרֵי־דָֽעַת

“cease to hear instruction to stray from the words of knowledge”

Here Solomon is using an imperative sentence to introduce a condition. He is pointing out that if his son ceases to hear instruction, the result will be a life without knowledge. If a speaker of your language would not use an imperative to introduce a condition, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if you cease to hear instruction, you will stray from the words of knowledge] or [do not cease to hear instruction, and you will not stray from the words of knowledge]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 19:27 (#3)

מוּסָ֑ר

“instruction”

See how you translated the abstract noun **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:27 (#4)

דָֽעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:27 (#5)

לְ֝לִשְׁגּ֗וֹת

“to stray”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose of doing what was stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate that this is the ironic purpose of refusing to hear instruction. Alternate translation: [in order to stray] or [and then you will be far]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 19:27 (#8)

מֵאִמְרֵי

“from the words of”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23. Alternate translation: [from the sayings of] or [from the messages of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:27 (#1)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:27 (#6)

לִלְשְׁגּוֹת מֵאִמְרֵי־דָעַת

“to stray from the words of knowledge”

Here Solomon refers to a person straying or wandering from the **words of knowledge** to mean that the person is no longer heeding those **words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to stop accepting the words of knowledge]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:27 (#7)

מֵאִמְרֵי־דָעַת

“from the words of knowledge”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **words** that are characterized by **knowledge**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [from the words that give knowledge]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:28 (#3)

בְּלִיַּעַל & מִשְׁפָּט & אָוֶן

“worthlessness & justice & iniquity”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **worthlessness** and **iniquity** in 6:12 and **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:28 (#4)

וּפִי רְשָׁעִים יְבַלַּע־אָוֶן

“and the mouth of the wicked ones swallows iniquity”

Here Solomon speaks of **the wicked ones** enjoying doing **iniquity** as if **iniquity** were delicious food that they could swallow with their mouths. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [the wicked ones enjoy iniquity] or [the wicked enjoy doing iniquity as much as they enjoy eating food]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:28 (#2)

עֵד בְּלִיַּעַל

“A witness of worthlessness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **witness** who is characterized by **worthlessness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a worthless witness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:28 (#1)

עֵד בְּלִיַּעַל & וּפִי רְשָׁעִים יְבַלַּע

“A witness of worthlessness & and the mouth of the wicked ones swallows”

A witness of worthlessness and **the mouth** here refer to this type of people and mouths in general, not a specific **witness** or **mouth**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any witness of worthlessness ... and the mouths of the wicked ones swallow]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:29 (#2)

וּמַהֲלֻמוֹת

“and blows”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and blows are prepared]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:29 (#1)

נָכֹנוּ לַלֵּצִים שְׁפָטִים

“Judgments are prepared for the mockers”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **Judgments**, you could express the same

idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is prepared to judge mockers]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:29 (#3)

לְגֵ֣ו

“for the back of”

The word **back** represents the backs of **stupid ones** in general, not one particular **back**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [for the backs of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 20 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 20 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 20 also contains contrasting parallelism (20:3, 6, 14, 15, 17, 29) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (20:23). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 20:1 (#1)

לֵ֣ץ הַיַּ֑יִן

“The wine {is} a mocker”

Here Solomon speaks of people who drink too much **wine** as if they were **wine** itself. Alternate translation: [Someone who drinks too much wine is a mocker]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:1 (#2)

הֹ֭מָּה שֵׁכָ֣ר

“beer {is} a brawler”

Here Solomon speaks of people who drink too much **beer** as if they were **beer** itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [someone who drinks too much beer is a brawler]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:1 (#5)

לֹ֣א יֶחְכָּ֑ם

“is not wise”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [is quite foolish]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 20:1 (#3)

שֹׁגֶ֣ה

“who staggers”

Here, **staggers** refers to someone who **staggers** because they are intoxicated. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who staggers drunkenly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:1 (#4)

בּ֑וֹ

“by it”

Here, **it** refers to **wine** and **beer**, both mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by drinking too much alcohol]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 20:2 (#2)

כַּ֭כְּפִיר & מֶ֣לֶךְ מִֽתְעַבְּרֹ֑ו חוֹטֵ֖א נַפְשֹֽׁו

“a king & like the young lion; one who infuriates him {is} one who wrongs his life”

Here, **a king**, **the young lion**, **one who infuriates**, **him**, and **his** refer to types of people and young lions in general, not to specific people or a specific **young lion**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any king ... like any young lion ... any person who infuriates that king forfeits that person’s own life]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:2 (#3)

נַנֵּ֥הם כַּ֝כְּפִ֗יר

“is} a growling like the young lion”

See how you translated the same expression in 19:12.

See: Simile

Proverbs 20:2 (#1)

אֵימַ֣ת

“The terror of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **terror** in 10:24.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:2 (#4)

חוֹטְאֵ֖א נַפְשׁ֣וֹ

“is} one who wrongs his life”

Here, in a polite way Solomon refers to causing one’s own death by using the phrase **wrongs his life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [will cause his end] or [will cause himself to be killed]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 20:3 (#2)

לָאִ֑ישׁ

“for a man”

The word **man** represents people in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [for a person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:3 (#3)

יִתְגַּלָּֽע

“breaks out”

Here Solomon refers to a **fool** eagerly starting an argument as if the argument were something that suddenly **breaks out**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [eagerly gets into an argument] or [welcomes a quarrel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:3 (#1)

כָּבְב֣וֹד & שִׁ֭שָּׁבֶת מֵרִ֣יב

“Honor & is} cessation from strife”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Honor**, **cessation** and **strife**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [Being honorable ... is ceasing to strive]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:4 (#1)

עָצֵ֣ל & יִשְׁאַ֑ל

“A lazy one & and he begs”

A lazy one and **he** here refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any lazy person ... and that person begs]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:4 (#5)

בַּקָּצִ֗יר

“in the harvest”

Here, **the harvest** refers to the time of year when farmers **harvest** their crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [during the time of year when farmers harvest crops]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:4 (#2)

מֵחֹ֫רֶף

“from winter”

The phrase **from winter** refers to the time when the people in Solomon’s area would prepare their fields to grow crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [during the proper time to plow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:4 (#3)

יִשְׁאַ֑ל

“and he begs”

Here, **Then** introduces the result of what happened in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [and, because of that, he begs]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:4 (#4)

יִשְׁאַל

“and he begs”

Here Solomon refers to a **lazy one** looking carefully for crops in his field as if he were begging the field to provide crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he searches his fields carefully for crops]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:4 (#6)

וְאֵין

“but there is nothing”

Here Solomon implies that **there is nothing** for the **lazy one** to harvest **in the harvest**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but has nothing to harvest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:5 (#1)

עֵצָה

“Counsel”

See how you translated the abstract noun **Counsel** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:5 (#2)

בְּלֵב

“in the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:5 (#4)

מַיִם עֲמֻקִּים & יְדַלֶּנָּה

“is} deep waters & will draw it out”

Here Solomon speaks of how difficult it is to discern a person’s **Counsel** as if it were **waters** that one must **draw out** from a deep well. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is difficult to understand … is able to understand it] or [is as difficult to obtain as deep water … is able to draw it out]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:5 (#5)

וְאִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

“but a man of understanding”

See how you translated **a man of understanding** in 10:23.

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:5 (#3)

אִישׁ וְאִישׁ

“a man & but a man of”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person … and a person of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 20:6 (#4)

וְאִישׁ אֱמוּנִים

“but a man of faithful acts”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by doing **faithful acts**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but a man who does faithful acts]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:6 (#2)

חַסְדּוֹ

“his covenant faithfulness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **covenant faithfulness** in 3:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:6 (#3)

וְאִישׁ אֱמוּנִים מִי יִמְצָא

“but a man of faithful acts, who can find”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize how few people act faithfully. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [but it is very difficult to find a man of faithful acts!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 20:6 (#1)

אָדָם & אִישׁ חַסְדּוֹ וְאִישׁ

“a man & each} man, his covenant faithfulness, but a man of”

Although **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... each person, that person’s covenant faithfulness, but a person of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 20:7 (#4)

אַחֲרָיו

“after him”

Here, **after him** means that **his sons** were born **after** he was born. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who exist after him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:7 (#3)

בְּתֻמּוֹ

“in his integrity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:7 (#1)

בְּתֻמּוֹ צַדִּיק & בָּנָיו אַחֲרָיו

“A righteous {one & in his integrity & are} his sons after him”

A righteous one, **his**, **sons**, and **him** refer to people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated a **righteous one** in 9:9. Alternate translation: [Any righteous person ... in that person’s integrity ... are that person’s children after that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:7 (#2)

מִתְהַלֵּךְ בְּתֻמּוֹ

“walks about in his integrity”

Here Solomon speaks of a person behaving with **integrity** as if **integrity** were a place in which that person **walks about**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar phrase in 19:1. Alternate translation: [who behaves with integrity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:8 (#4)

דִּין & רָע

“judgment & evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **judgment** in 16:10 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:8 (#3)

כִּסֵּא־דִין

“the throne of judgment”

This phrase could refer to: (1) a **throne** that a **king sits on** for the purpose of **judgment**. Alternate translation: [the throne for judgment]; (2) a **throne** that is characterized by “justice,” which is another possible translation for the word **judgment**. Alternate translation: [the just throne]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:8 (#5)

מְזָרֶה

“is} one who winnows”

Here Solomon speaks of a **king** removing **evil** from his kingdom as if that **evil** were chaff that a farmer **winnows** out of the grain. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is one who removes] or [is one who removes like someone winnowing grain]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:8 (#6)

בְּעֵינָיו

“with his eyes”

Here, **eyes** refers to seeing, and seeing is a metaphor for perceiving something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to his perception] or [according to what he perceives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:8 (#2)

מֶ֭לֶךְ & כִּסֵּא־דִ֑ין מְזָרֶ֥ה בְעֵינָ֝יו כָּל־רָֽע

“A king & the throne of judgment {is} one who winnows all evil with his eyes”

A king, **the throne**, **one who winnows**, and **his** refers to righteous kings and their thrones, not a specific **king** or **throne**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any good king ... the throne of judgment is a king who winnows all evil with his eyes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:8 (#1)

מֶ֭לֶךְ

“A king”

This verse describes the traits of an ideal, righteous **king**, not any **king** in general. See how you translated the same use of **king** in 16:10.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:9 (#4)

לִבִּ֣י

“my heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:9 (#6)

מֵחַטָּאתִֽי

“from my sin”

See how you translated abstract noun **sin** in 5:22.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:9 (#5)

טָהַ֖רְתִּי מֵחַטָּאתִֽי

“I am clean from my sin”

Here Solomon refers to a person who no longer sins as if that person were **clean from** his **sin**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I no longer sin]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:9 (#1)

מִֽי־יֹ֭אמַר זִכִּ֣יתִי לִבִּ֑י טָהַ֖רְתִּי מֵחַטָּאתִֽי

“Who can say, “I have made my heart pure; I am clean from my sin”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize that no one is sinless. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Certainly no one can say, “I have made my heart pure; I am clean from my sin”!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 20:9 (#2)

מִֽי־יֹ֭אמַר זִכִּ֣יתִי לִבִּ֑י טָהַ֖רְתִּי מֵחַטָּאתִֽי

“Who can say, “I have made my heart pure; I am clean from my sin”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [Who can say that he has made his heart pure, that he is clean from his sin]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 20:9 (#3)

זִכִּ֣יתִי לִבִּ֑י

“I have made my heart pure”

Here Solomon refers to a person who no longer thinks sinfully as if that person **made** his **heart pure**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Now I only have good thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:10 (#4)

תּוֹעֲבַ֖ת יְהוָ֣ה

“are} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:10 (#3)

אֵיפָ֥ה וְאֵיפָֽה

“ephah and ephah”

An **ephah** is a measurement of volume equivalent to 22 liters of dry solids (such as grain). However, Solomon is using the word here to refer to volume measurement in general. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could use a general expression in your translation for volume measurement. Alternatively. Alternate translation: [measurement and measurement]

See: Biblical Volume

Proverbs 20:10 (#2)

אֶ֣בֶן וָאָ֣בֶן אֵיפָ֣ה וְאֵיפָ֣ה

“Stone and stone, ephah and ephah”

Solomon implies that these unequal weights and measurements are used to benefit the dishonest person who uses them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Unequal weights and unequal measurements that people use dishonestly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:10 (#1)

אֶ֣בֶן וָאָ֣בֶן אֵיפָ֣ה וְאֵיפָ֣ה

“Stone and stone, ephah and ephah”

Stone and stone here refers to two different stones used for weighing goods (See this use of **stone** in 11:1). The phrase **ephah and ephah** refers to two different measurements used for measuring amounts of grain. Solomon is referring to different weights and measurements that a merchant pretends are the same in order to deceive a customer. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Unequal weights and unequal measurements]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 20:10 (#5)

שְׁנֵיהֶ֖ם

“the two of them”

This phrase refers to the unequal weights and measurements called **Stone and stone** and **ephah and ephah** earlier in the verse. However, Solomon does not mean that **Yahweh** actually hates these weights and measurements. Rather, he means that **Yahweh** hates people using these things dishonestly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of these dishonest practices]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:11 (#1)

בְּבַֽמַּעֲלָלָ֗יו יִתְנַכֶּר־נָ֥עַר & פָּעֳלֽוֹ

“a young man will make himself known by his deeds & is} his behavior”

Here, **a young man**, **himself** and **his** refer to a young person in general, not a specific **young man**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [youths will make themselves known by their deeds ... is their behavior]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:11 (#2)

יִתְנַכֶּ֗ר

“will make himself known”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will make other people know him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 20:12 (#1)

אׇזֶן֮ שֹׁמַ֪עַת וְעַ֫יִן רֹ֥אָה & גַּם־שְׁנֵיהֶ֑ם

“A hearing ear and a seeing eye & both the two of them”

Here, **ear** and **eye** represent these body parts in general, not one particular **ear** and **eye**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Hearing ears and seeing eyes ... all of them]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:13 (#4)

פְּקַ֣ח עֵינֶ֣יךָ

“Open your eyes”

Here Solomon implies that the person who opens his **eyes** does so in order to work. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Open your eyes to do your work]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:13 (#6)

לֶ֗חֶם

“bread”

Here, **bread** is used to refer to food in general. See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 20:13 (#1)

אַל־תֶּאֱהַב שֵׁנָה

“Do not love sleep”

The phrase **love sleep** means to sleep a lot because one enjoys sleeping. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not sleep a lot]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:13 (#5)

שְׂבַע־לָחֶם

“be satisfied {with} bread”

This phrase states the result of obeying the command to **open your eyes** in the previous phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [you will be satisfied with bread]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:13 (#2)

פְּקַח עֵינֶיךָ שְׂבַע־לָחֶם

“Open your eyes; be satisfied {with} bread”

The idea of this clause is in contrast with the idea of the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [Instead, open your eyes; be satisfied with bread]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 20:13 (#3)

פְּקַח עֵינֶיךָ

“Open your eyes”

Here Solomon says **open your eyes** to refer to staying awake. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [remain awake]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:14 (#5)

וְאֹזֵל לֹוֹ אָז יִתְהַלָּל

“but when he departs on his way, then he praises himself”

Here Solomon implies that **the buyer** bought the item and boasts to his friends about the good price he paid for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but when he departs on his way after buying that thing, he boasts about the bargain that he got]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:14 (#1)

רַע רַע יֹאמַר הַקֹּנֶה

“Bad! Bad!” says the buyer”

Here, a **buyer** is criticizing the quality of something that he wants to buy in order to get the seller to decrease its price. **Bad** refers to bad quality. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [“These goods are bad quality! Bad quality!” says the buyer criticizing the seller’s goods]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:14 (#2)

רַע רַע יֹאמַר הַקֹּנֶה

“Bad! Bad!” says the buyer”

Solomon is repeating the same word twice for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [“It is really bad quality!” says the buyer]

See: Reduplication

Proverbs 20:14 (#3)

רַע רַע יֹאמַר הַקֹּנֶה

“Bad! Bad!” says the buyer”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [The buyer says that it is very bad]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 20:14 (#4)

הַקֹּנֶה וְאֹזֵל לֹוֹ אָז יִתְהַלָּל

“the buyer, but when he departs on his way, then he praises himself”

Here, **the buyer**, **he**, **his**, and **himself** represent buyers in general, not one particular **buyer**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any buyer, but when that buyer departs on his way, then that buyer praises himself]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:15 (#3)

שִׂפְתֵי־דָעַת

“lips of knowledge”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:7.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:15 (#2)

וּכְלִי יְקָקָר שִׂפְתֵי־דָעַת

“but lips of knowledge {are} a vessel of preciousness”

Here Solomon speaks of the value of **lips of knowledge** as if they were **a vessel of preciousness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but lips of knowledge are as valuable as a vessel of preciousness]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:15 (#1)

פְּנִינִים

“corals”

See how you translated **corals** in 3:15.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 20:15 (#5)

וּכְלִי יְקָקָר

“but & are} a vessel of preciousness”

Solomon contrasts **abundance** in the previous clause with **preciousness** in this clause in order to imply that **lips of knowledge** are rarer and more valuable than **gold** and **corals**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but ... are a vessel that is even more precious than those]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:15 (#4)

וּכְלִי יְקָקָר

“but & are} a vessel of preciousness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **vessel** that is characterized by **preciousness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but ... are a precious vessel]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:16 (#6)

חַבָלֵהוּ

“hold it in pledge”

Here, **it** refers to **his garment** in the previous clause. Solomon is referring to the practice of holding on to something that someone has given as a **pledge** to repay someone’s debt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [hold onto his garment as a guarantee of repayment]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 20:16 (#4)

עָעֲרַב זָר

“he has pledged {for} a stranger”

See how you translated the same use of “he pledges for a stranger” in 11:15.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:16 (#1)

לָקַח־בִּגְדוֹ כִּי־עָעֲרַב זָר וּבְעַד נכרים חַבָלֵהוּ

“Take his garment when he has pledged {for} a stranger, and on behalf of a foreign woman hold it in pledge”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Take his garment when he has pledged for a stranger, yes, on behalf of a foreign woman hold it in pledge]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 20:16 (#2)

בִּגְדוֹ כִּי־עָעֲרַב זָר וּבְעַד נכרים

“his garment when he has pledged {for} a stranger, and on behalf of a foreign woman”

Here, **his**, **he**, **a stranger** and **a foreign woman** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [a person’s garment when that person has pledged for any stranger, and on behalf of any foreign woman]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:16 (#5)

וּבְעַד נכרים

“and on behalf of a foreign woman”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and when he has pledged on behalf of a foreign woman]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 20:16 (#3)

לָקַח־בִּגְדּוֹ כִּי־עָרַב זָר

“Take his garment when he has pledged {for} a stranger”

When someone borrowed money in Solomon’s culture, the lender would take something such as a **garment** from the borrower as a guarantee of repayment. The lender would return the **garment** after the money was repaid. If the borrower was too poor, someone else could give something to the lender as a pledge for the poor person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Take a garment as security from the one who guarantees that what a stranger has borrowed will be paid back]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:17 (#4)

לֶחֶם

“is} bread of”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 20:17 (#5)

שֶׁקֶר

“falsehood”

See how you translated the abstract noun **falsehood** in 6:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:17 (#3)

לֶחֶם שֶׁקֶר

“is} bread of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **bread** that is obtained by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [bread obtained by falsehood]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:17 (#1)

עָרֵב

“Sweet”

Here Solomon speaks of a person being pleased by eating **bread of falsehood** as if the **bread** were **Sweet**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Pleasant] or [Pleasant like something sweet]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:17 (#2)

לָאִישׁ & פִּיהוּ

“to a man & his mouth”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [to a person ... that person’s mouth]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 20:17 (#6)

יִמָּלֵא־פִיהוּ חָצָץ

“his mouth will be filled {with} gravel”

Here Solomon speaks of a person experiencing bad results because of eating **bread of falsehood** as if **his mouth** were **filled with gravel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [he will experience unpleasantness] or [he will have bad results as if his mouth were filled with sand]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:18 (#3)

וּבְתַחְבֻּלוֹת

“and by guidance”

The first half of this verse provides the reason for the conclusion in the second half. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that the second half is

a purpose or conclusion from the first half. Alternate translation: [so, by guidance]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:18 (#2)

בְּעֵצָה

“by counsel”

See how you translated the abstract noun **counsel** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:18 (#4)

וּבְתַחְבֻּלוֹת עֲשֵׂה מִלְחָמָה

“and by guidance make war”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **guidance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and let others guide you when you make war]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:18 (#1)

מַחֲשָׁבוֹת בְּעֵצָה תִּכּוֹן

“Plans by counsel are established”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Counsel establishes plans]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 20:19 (#3)

וּלְפֹתֶה

“and with one who opens”

This clause states what Solomon wants people to do as a result of what he said in the previous clause. Use the most natural way to express an intended result in your language. Alternate translation: [therefore, with one who opens]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:19 (#2)

רָכִיל

“a gossip”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:13.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 20:19 (#4)

וּלְפֹתֶה שְׂפָתָיו

“and with one who opens his lips”

See how you translated **one who opens his lips** in 13:3.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 20:19 (#1)

גּוֹלֶה־סּוֹד הוֹלֵךְ רָכִיל וּלְפֹתֶה שְׂפָתָיו

“One who goes about {as} a gossip reveals a secret, and with one who opens his lips”

One who goes about, **a gossip**, **a secret**, and **one who opens his lips** refer to types of people and secrets in general, not a specific person or **secret**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who goes about as a gossip reveals secrets, and with any person who opens his lips]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:20 (#2)

יִדְעַךְ נֵרוֹ

“his lamp will be extinguished”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will extinguish his lamp]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 20:20 (#3)

יִדְעַךְ נֵרוֹ

“his lamp will be extinguished”

See how you translated the same use of **lamp** and **will be extinguished** in 13:9.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:20 (#4)

באישון חֹשֶׁךְ

“in the pupil of darkness”

Here Solomon refers to a very dark place as if it were **in the pupil**, which is the dark circle in the center of an eye. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the darkest darkness] or [in the deepest dark place]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:20 (#1)

מְקַלֵּל אָבִיו וְאִמּוֹ & נֵרוֹ

“One who curses his father and his mother, his lamp”

One who curses and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who curses that person’s father and mother, that person’s lamp]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:21 (#1)

נַחֲלָה

“An inheritance”

See how you translated the abstract noun **inheritance** in 17:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:21 (#3)

וְאַחֲרִיתָהּ

“its end”

See how you translated the same use of **its end** in 14:12.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:21 (#2)

בָּרִאשֹׁנָה

“in the beginning”

The phrase **in the beginning** refers to a person receiving his **inheritance** before he is supposed to receive it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [before the right time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:21 (#4)

לֹא תְבֹרָךְ

“will not be blessed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will not bless]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 20:22 (#6)

וְיֹשַׁע לָךְ

“and he will save you”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [and it will result in him saving you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:22 (#7)

וְיֹשַׁע לָךְ

“and he will save you”

Here Solomon uses **he will save you** to mean that **Yahweh** will resolve the situation mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he will make it right]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:22 (#3)

רָע

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:22 (#5)

קַוֵּה לַיהוָה

“Wait for Yahweh”

This could mean: (1) **Wait for Yahweh** to resolve the situation. Alternate translation: [Wait for Yahweh to take care of the issue]; (2) Trust Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Trust Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:22 (#2)

אֲשַׁלְּמָה־רָע

“I will repay evil”

Here Solomon refers to doing wrong to someone who has done wrong to **you** as if **you** were paying them back for something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will avenge evil] or [I will harm people who have harmed me]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:22 (#4)

קַוֵּה לַיהוָה וְיוֹשַׁע לָךְ

“Wait for Yahweh, and he will save you”

The idea of this clause is in contrast with the idea of the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [Instead, wait for Yahweh, and he will save you]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 20:22 (#1)

אַל־תֹּאמַר אֲשַׁלְּמָה־רָע

“Do not say, “I will repay evil”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [Do not say that you will repay evil]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 20:23 (#1)

תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה אֶבֶן וָאָבֶן וּמֹאזְנֵי מִרְמָה לֹא־טוֹב

“Stone and stone {are} an abomination to Yahweh, and scales of deceit {are} not good”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Stone and stone are an abomination to Yahweh; I say again, scales of deceit are not good]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 20:23 (#4)

וּמֹאזְנֵי מִרְמָה

“and scales of deceit”

See how you translated **scales of deceit** in 11:1.

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:23 (#2)

אֶבֶן וָאָבֶן

“Stone and stone”

See how you translated this phrase in 20:10.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 20:23 (#3)

תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה

“are} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 20:10.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:23 (#5)

לֹא־טוֹב

“are} not good”

See how you translated the same use of **not good** in 16:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 20:24 (#5)

דַּרְכּוֹ

“his way”

The pronoun **his** refers to **a man**, not to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [his own way]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 20:24 (#1)

מִצְעֲדֵי & דַּרְכּוֹ

“are} the steps of & his way”

In this verse, **steps** and **way** refer to the things that people experience during their lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “path” in 4:18. Alternate translation: [are the life experiences of ... his life experiences]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:24 (#3)

וְאָדָם מַה־יָּבִין דַּרְכּוֹ

“so how can a man understand his way”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [so surely a man cannot understand his way!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 20:24 (#2)

גֶּ֭בֶר וְאָדָ֣ם & דַּרְכּ֑וֹ

“a strong man, so & a man & his way”

Here, **a strong man**, **a man**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not to a specific **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any strong person, so ... a person ... that person’s way]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:24 (#4)

וְאָדָ֣ם מַה־יָּבִ֣ין

“so how can a man understand”

Here, **so** introduces the result of what was stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Therefore, how can a man understand]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:25 (#3)

אָ֭דָם יְלַ֣ע

“a man: He says rashly”

Although **a man** and **he** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person: that person says rashly]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 20:25 (#1)

מוֹקֵ֣שׁ אָ֭דָם יְלַ֣ע

“A snare of a man: He says rashly”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A snare of a man is when he says rashly]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 20:25 (#2)

מוֹקֵ֣שׁ

“A snare of”

Here Solomon refers to something a person says that can cause him trouble as if what he says were a **snare** that traps him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated the same use of **snare** in 18:7. Alternate translation: [What is dangerous for]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:25 (#4)

קֹ֑דֶשׁ

“It is} holy”

Here Solomon implies that this person has dedicated something to Yahweh by declaring it to be **holy**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I declare this thing to be holy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:25 (#5)

נְדָרִ֥ים

“vows”

Here, **vows** refers to declaring that something is holy and dedicated to Yahweh, which this person does in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [dedicating it to Yahweh] or [declaring it holy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:25 (#6)

לְבַקֵּֽר

“considers”

Here Solomon implies that this person **considers** the rash vow he just made in a negative way. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [reconsiders what he just vowed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:26 (#2)

מְזָרֶ֣ה רְ֭שָׁעִים מֶ֣לֶךְ חָכָ֑ם וַיָּ֖שֶׁב עֲלֵיהֶ֣ם אוֹפָֽן

“A wise king {is} one who winnows the wicked, and he brings back a wheel over them”

Here Solomon speaks of a **king** discovering and punishing **the wicked** as if he were a farmer and they were his grain crop. He imagines separating the wicked from the good people as a farmer separates

the chaff from the grain, then he crushes the wicked by bringing the threshing wheel back over them again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated the same use of **winnows** in 20:8. Alternate translation: [A wise king discovers the wicked people and he severely punishes them] or [A wise king separates out the wicked people and severely punishes them as though they were a grain crop that he winnows and crushes under a wheel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:26 (#3)

מְזֵרֶה רְשָׁעִים מֶלֶךְ חָכָם וַיָּשֶׁב עֲלֵיהֶם אוֹפָן

“A wise king {is} one who winnows the wicked, and he brings back a wheel over them”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A wise king {is} one who winnows wicked ones; in fact, he brings back a wheel over them]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 20:26 (#4)

אוֹפָן

“a wheel”

Here, **wheel** refers to a “threshing wheel.” This is a tool that farmers used to crush grain and help separate it from the straw and chaff. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of **wheel**, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a grain-crushing tool]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 20:26 (#1)

מְזֵרֶה & מֶלֶךְ חָכָם וַיָּשֶׁב

“A wise king {is} one who winnows & and he brings back”

A wise king, **one who scatters**, and **he** refer to a type of kings in general, not a specific **king**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any wise king is one who scatters ... and that king brings back]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:27 (#1)

נֵר יְהוָה נִשְׁמַת אָדָם חֹפֵשׂ כָּל־חַדְרֵי־בָטֶן

“The breath of a man {is} the lamp of Yahweh, searching all the rooms of the belly”

Here, **a man**, **the lamp**, and **the belly** refer to these things and people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [The breath of any person is a lamp of Yahweh, searching all the rooms of that person’s belly]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:27 (#3)

נֵר יְהוָה

“is} the lamp of Yahweh”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **lamp** that belongs to **Yahweh**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is Yahweh’s lamp]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:27 (#5)

חַדְרֵי־בָטֶן

“the rooms of the belly”

See how you translated this phrase in 18:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:27 (#2)

נִשְׁמַת

“The breath of”

Here, **breath** refers to the inner life force of a human being, which Yahweh gave to the first **man** by breathing it into him (Genesis 2:7). If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The breath of life of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:27 (#4)

נֵר יְהוָה & חֹפֵשׂ כָּל־חַדְרֵי־בָטֶן

“is} the lamp of Yahweh, searching all the rooms of the belly”

Here Solomon speaks of **Yahweh** knowing what is inside a person as though he were using a person's **breath** as a **lamp** that allows him to search all the inner **rooms** of that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [penetrates his entire inner being, like Yahweh's ability to know his innermost thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:28 (#1)

חֶסֶד וֶאֱמֶת יִצְּרוּ־מֶלֶךְ וְסָעַד בַּחֶסֶד כִּסְאוֹ

"Covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness guard a king, and his throne is sustained by covenant faithfulness"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness guard a king; yes, his throne is sustained by covenant faithfulness]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 20:28 (#2)

חֶסֶד וֶאֱמֶת & בַּחֶסֶד

"Covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness & by covenant faithfulness"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness** in 3:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:28 (#7)

וְסָעַד בַּחֶסֶד כִּסְאוֹ

"and his throne is sustained by covenant faithfulness"

Here Solomon refers to a **king** maintaining his authority by acting with **covenant faithfulness** as if **covenant faithfulness** were a person who could sustain him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and acting with covenant faithfulness enables him to maintain his authority]

See: Personification

Proverbs 20:28 (#5)

וְסָעַד בַּחֶסֶד כִּסְאוֹ

"and his throne is sustained by covenant faithfulness"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and covenant faithfulness sustains his throne]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 20:28 (#4)

מֶלֶךְ & כִּסְאוֹ

"a king & his throne"

Here, **a king** and **his throne** refer to righteous kings and their thrones, not a specific **king** or **throne**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any good king ... that king's throne]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:28 (#3)

יִצְּרוּ־מֶלֶךְ

"guard a king"

Here Solomon refers to a **king** protecting himself by acting with **Covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness** as if those two things were people who **guard** him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [enables a king to be protected]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:28 (#6)

וְסָעַד בַּחֶסֶד כִּסְאוֹ

"and his throne is sustained by covenant faithfulness"

Here, **throne** refers to a king's authority, which is represented by the **throne** that a king sits on. See how you translated the same use of **throne** in 16:12.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:29 (#1)

תִּפְאֶרֶת & כֹּחָם

“The splendor of & is} their strength”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **splendor** in 4:9 and **strength** in 5:10.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:29 (#3)

וַהֲדַ֣ר

“and the adornment of”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **adornment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and what adorns]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:29 (#4)

שֵׂיבָֽה

“is} gray hair”

Here, **gray hair** refers to the wisdom or experience often found in people have who have lived long enough to have **gray hair**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is their wisdom]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:29 (#2)

וַהֲדַ֣ר זְקֵנִ֣ים שֵׂיבָֽה

“and the adornment of old ones {is} gray hair”

The idea of this clause is in contrast with the idea of the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [However, the adornment of old ones is gray hair]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 20:30 (#3)

בְּרָ֑ע

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:30 (#5)

חַדְרֵי־בָֽטֶן

“the rooms & the belly”

See how you translated this phrase in 18:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:30 (#1)

חַבֻּרֹ֣ות פֶּ֭צַע

“Blows of a wound”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe severe **Blows** that cause **a wound**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Blows that cause a wound]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:30 (#2)

תמריק בְּרָ֑ע

“cleanse away evil”

Here Solomon refers to beatings that cause a person to stop doing **evil** things as if the beatings were cleaning away the **evil** from the person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [stop a person from doing evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:30 (#4)

וּ֝מַכּ֗וֹת חַדְרֵי־בָֽטֶן

“and strikes, the rooms of the belly”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and strikes cleanse away evil from the rooms of the belly]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs - Chapter 21 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 21 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 21 also contains contrasting parallelism (21:2, 5, 8, 15, 17, 20, 26, 28, 29, 31) and parallelism in which both clauses

have the same meaning for emphasis (21:14). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 21:1 (#2)

לֵב

“The heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:1 (#3)

פַּלְגֵי־מַ֣יִם & בְּיַד־יְהוָ֗ה & יַטֶּ֥נּוּ

“is} channels of water in the hand of Yahweh; he steers it”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **Yahweh** using the **heart of a king** to accomplish his purposes as if the **heart** were water streams that **he steers** to go to the places where he wants them to go. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a synonym. Alternate translation: [is controlled by Yahweh to do] or [is controlled by Yahweh like a farmer controls streams to act]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:1 (#1)

לֵב־מֶ֫לֶךְ

“The heart of a king”

The heart of a king refers to the **heart** of any **king** in general, not a specific **king**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The heart of any king]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:2 (#1)

דֶּ֣רֶךְ

“way of”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:2 (#2)

אִ֭ישׁ & בְּעֵינָ֑יו

“a man & in his eyes”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [any person ... in that person’s eyes]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 21:2 (#5)

לִבּ֥וֹת

“hearts”

See how you translated the same use of **hearts** in 15:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:2 (#4)

וְתֹכֵ֥ן & יְהוָֹ֗ה

“but Yahweh examines”

See how you translated this phrase in 16:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:2 (#3)

יָשָׁ֥ר בְּעֵינָ֗יו

“is} right in his eyes”

See how you translated the same phrase in 12:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:3 (#1)

צְדָקָ֖ה וּמִשְׁפָּ֑ט & מִזָּֽבַח

“righteousness and justice & more than a sacrifice”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness** and **justice** in 1:3 and **sacrifice** in 15:8.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:3 (#2)

נִבְחָ֖ר לַיהוָ֣ה

“is preferred to Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh prefers]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 21:4 (#4)

נֵ֣ר רְ֭שָׁעִים

“the lamp of wicked ones”

Here, the word translated as **lamp** could refer to: (1) the sins mentioned in the previous clause being like a **lamp** that shows **wicked ones** what to do. Alternate translation: [what guides the wicked ones]; (2) the sins in the previous clause being like "uncultivated ground" (another possible meaning for the Hebrew word used here) that produces nothing good. Alternate translation: [the fruitlessness of the wicked ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:4 (#3)

נִ֣ר רְשָׁעִ֑ים

"the lamp of wicked ones"

This phrase gives further information about the two sins described in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make the relationship between these phrases clearer. Alternate translation: [that is, the lamp of the wicked ones]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Proverbs 21:4 (#2)

וּרְחַב־לֵ֥ב

"and broadness of heart"

Here, **broadness of heart** refers to thinking arrogantly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and thinking arrogantly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 21:4 (#1)

רוּם־עֵ֭ינַיִם

"Height of eyes"

Here Solomon refers to pride as **Height of eyes**, which is a characteristic facial expression of proud people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression "uplifted eyes" in 6:17. Alternate translation: [Pride]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:5 (#4)

אָ֑ץ

"hurrying about"

Here, **hurrying about** refers to doing things more quickly than they should be done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who hurries about too quickly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:5 (#3)

לְמוֹתָ֥ר & לְמַחְסֽוֹר

"to profit & to lack"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **profit** in 3:14 and **lack** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:5 (#2)

לְמוֹתָ֥ר & לְמַחְסֽוֹר

"to profit & to lack"

Here, the phrases **are to** and **is to** indicate that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [result in profit ... results in lack]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 21:5 (#1)

חָרוּץ

"the diligent {one"

The phrase **the diligent one** represents diligent people in general, not one particular **diligent one**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any diligent one]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:6 (#5)

מְבַקְשֵׁי־מָ֑וֶת

"seekers of death"

Here Solomon speaks of people doing something that will kill them as if they were **seekers of death**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [leading such people to their deaths] or [they act as though they are seeking death]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:6 (#1)

פֹּ֭עַל אֹצָר֣וֹת

"The making of treasures"

Here Solomon speaks of acquiring wealth as if it were **treasures** that someone makes. If it would be helpful

in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Acquiring wealth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:6 (#4)

מְבַקְשֵׁי־מָוֶת

“seekers of death”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they that seek such treasures are seekers of death]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:6 (#2)

בִּלְשׁוֹן שָׁקֶר

“by a tongue of falsehood”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:6 (#3)

הֶבֶל נִדָּף

“is} scattered vapor”

Here Solomon speaks of the disappearance of **treasures** as if they were a **vapor** that quickly goes away. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [will cause them to disappear quickly] or [will be as unsuccessful as trying to hold scattered vapor]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:7 (#1)

שֹׁד & מִשְׁפָּט

“The violence of & justice”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **violence** in 3:31 and **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:7 (#2)

שֹׁד־רְשָׁעִים

“The violence of the wicked”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **violence** done by **the wicked**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [The violence done by wicked people]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:7 (#3)

יְגוֹרֵם

“will drag them away”

Here Solomon speaks of **the wicked** being destroyed because they act violently as if their **violence** were a person who could **drag them away**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will cause others to take them away]

See: Personification

Proverbs 21:8 (#1)

דֶּרֶךְ

“is} the way of”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:8 (#2)

אִישׁ וְזָר וְזַךְ יָשָׁר פָּעֳלוֹ

“a guilty man, but the pure {one}, upright {is} his behavior”

Here, **a guilty man**, **the pure one**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any guilty man, but any pure person, upright is that person’s behavior]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:9 (#2)

מֵאֵשֶׁת מִדְיָנִים

“than {with} a woman of quarrels”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **woman** who is characterized by **quarrels**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [than with a quarrelsome wife]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:9 (#1)

פִּנַּת־גָּג

“the corner of a roof”

Houses in Solomon’s time had flat roofs on which people could walk. Sometimes residents would build a shelter on a **corner** of the **roof**, providing an additional place in which a person could sleep. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information in a note. Alternate translation: [the corner of a flat roof]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:9 (#3)

וּבֵ֖ית חָבֶֽר

“and a house of companionship”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **house** in which people live together. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and live together in one house]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:10 (#5)

בְּעֵינָ֑יו

“in his eyes”

Here, **in his eyes** refers to the person’s judgment or attitude. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of this attitude] or [by him]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 21:10 (#2)

רָ֣ע & בְּעֵינָ֑יו רֵעֵ֖הוּ

“the wicked {one & his neighbor & in his eyes”

Here, **the wicked one**, **his**, and **neighbor** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **the wicked one** in 3:33. Alternate translation: [any wicked person ... that person’s neighbor ... in that person’s eyes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:10 (#3)

רָ֣ע

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:10 (#1)

נֶ֣פֶשׁ

“The soul of”

Here, **soul** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 21:10 (#4)

לֹא־יֻחַ֖ן בְּעֵינָ֑יו רֵעֵ֖הוּ

“his neighbor is not shown grace in his eyes”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [his eyes do not show grace to his neighbor]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 21:11 (#4)

וּבְהַשְׂכִּ֣יל & דָּ֑עַת

“and when giving insight & knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **insight** in 1:3 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:11 (#1)

לֵ֣ץ & פֶּ֭תִי & לְחָכָ֣ם

“a mocker, a naive one & to a wise one”

See how you translated **a mocker** in 9:7, **a naive one** in 14:15, and **a wise one** in 1:5.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:11 (#3)

וּבְהַשְׂכִּ֣יל

“and when giving insight”

Here Solomon speaks of someone teaching **insight to a wise one** as if **insight** were an object that a person gives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and when teaching insight]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:11 (#5)

יִקַּ֖ח־דָּֽעַת

“he receives knowledge”

Here Solomon speaks of someone learning **knowledge** as if it were an object that a person **receives**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he learns knowledge]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:11 (#2)

יֶחְכַּם־פֶּתִי

“a naive one becomes wise”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **a naive one** will become **wise** as the result of seeing someone **fining a mocker**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a naive one will see this happen and become wise]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:12 (#3)

רָשָׁע

“a wicked {one”

See how you translated **the wicked one** in 10:16.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:12 (#1)

צַדִּיק

“A righteous {one”

A righteous one could refer to: (1) a righteous person in general. Alternate translation: [Any righteous person]; (2) Yahweh, who is the Righteous One. Alternate translation: [The Righteous One]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:12 (#5)

לָרָע

“to evil”

Here, **evil** refers to trouble that someone might experience as a result of **evil**. See how you translated the similar use of **evil** in 12:21.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:12 (#2)

לְבֵית

“the house of”

Here, **house** refers to the family who lives in that **house** and what they do. See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:12 (#4)

מְסַלֵּף רְשָׁעִים לָרָע

“overturning the wicked to evil”

Here Solomon refers to a righteous one causing the **the wicked** to experience disaster as if he were **overturning** them **to evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causing the wicked to experience disaster]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:13 (#4)

דָּל

“a lowly one”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:13 (#6)

וְלֹא יֵעָנֶה

“but will not be answered”

Here, **answered** refers to the person who hears the cry responding by helping the person who cries out. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but will not be helped by anyone]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:13 (#3)

מִזַּעֲקַת & יִקְרָא

“from the outcry of & will cry out”

Here Solomon implies that **outcry** and **cry out** refer to someone crying out for help. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from the cry for help of … will cry for help]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:13 (#1)

אׇטֵם אָזְנוֹ מִזַּעֲקַת־דָּל גַּם־הוּא

“One who shuts his ears from the outcry of a lowly one, he also”

One who shuts, **his**, **a lowly one**, and **he** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who shuts his ears from the outcries of lowly ones, that person also]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:13 (#5)

וְלֹ֣א יֵעָנֶֽה

“but will not be answered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but no one will answer him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 21:13 (#2)

אֹטֵ֣ם אָזְנ֑וֹ

“One who shuts his ears”

Here Solomon refers to someone refusing to listen as if that person were shutting **his ears** so that he does not hear someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who will not listen]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:14 (#3)

יִכְפֶּה־אָ֭ף

“subdues nose”

Here, **subdues nose** refers to stopping a person from being angry. The word **nose** here means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes angry people to stop being angry]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 21:14 (#5)

בַּ֝חֵ֗ק

“in the bosom”

Here, **in the bosom** indicates that a **bribe** is given to someone secretly, as if it were hidden in a person’s clothes near that person’s **bosom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “from the bosom” in 17:23. Alternate translation: [in secret]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:14 (#4)

וְשֹׁ֣חַד בַּ֭חֵק חֵמָ֣ה עַזָּ֑ה

“and a bribe in the bosom, strong heat”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a bribe given in the bosom subdues strong heat]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:14 (#1)

מַתָּ֣ן בַּסֵּ֭תֶר יִכְפֶּה־אָ֑ף וְשֹׁ֣חַד בַּ֭חֵק חֵמָ֣ה עַזָּ֑ה

“A gift in secrecy subdues nose, and a bribe in the bosom, strong heat”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A gift in secrecy subdues nose; yes, a bribe in the bosom, strong heat]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 21:14 (#6)

חֵמָ֣ה עַזָּ֑ה

“strong heat”

Here, **strong heat** refers to extreme anger, which causes the angry person’s body to become hot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [rage]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:14 (#2)

מַתָּ֣ן בַּסֵּ֭תֶר

“A gift in secrecy”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be

complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A gift given in secrecy]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:15 (#2)

שִׂמְחָה & מִשְׁפָּט וּמְחִתָּה & אָוֶן

“A joy & justice, but a terror & iniquity”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **joy** in 10:28, **justice** in 13:23, **terror** in 10:24, and **iniquity** in 12:21.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:15 (#3)

וּמְחִתָּה לְפֹעֲלֵי אָוֶן

“but a terror for doers of iniquity”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but doing justice is a terror for doers of iniquity]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:15 (#1)

שִׂמְחָה לַצַּדִּיק & וּמְחִתָּה

“A joy for the righteous & but a terror”

A joy, **the righteous**, and **a terror** refer to these things and people in general, not to specific things or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Joy is for righteous ones ... but terror]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:16 (#3)

בִּקְהַל רְפָאִים יָנוּחַ

“will rest in the assembly of the spirits of the dead”

In this clause, Solomon refers to a person dying. The phrase **the assembly of the spirits of dead ones** refers to the place where people’s spirits go when they die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will end up in the place where the spirits of dead people dwell] or [will end up dead]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:16 (#2)

תֹּתֵעֶה מִדֶּרֶךְ הַשְׂכֶּל

“wandering from the way of understanding”

Here Solomon refers to a person who stops behaving wisely as if the right way to behave were a **way** that he wanders from. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [no longer living wisely]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:16 (#1)

אָדָם

“A man”

A man refers to people in general, not to a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:17 (#5)

יַיִן־וְשֶׁמֶן

“wine and oil”

wine and **oil** represent good food and drink. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [rich food and drink]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:17 (#3)

אִישׁ מַחְסוֹר

“A man of lack”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by lacking wealth. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A man who lacks goods] or [A man characterized by poverty]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:17 (#4)

שִׂמְחָה

“joy”

Here, **joy** refers to things and activities that cause people to feel **joy**. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what pleases him]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:17 (#1)

אִישׁ מַמְחְסוֹר אֹהֵב שִׂמְחָה אֹהֵב יַיִן־וָשֶׁמֶן לֹא יַעֲשִׁיר

“A man of lack loves joy; a lover of wine and oil will not become rich”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A man of lack loves joy; yes, a lover of wine and oil will not become rich]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 21:17 (#2)

אִישׁ & אֹהֵב

“A man of & a lover of”

A man and **a lover** refer to types of people in general, not to a specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of ... any lover of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:18 (#4)

בּוֹגֵד

“one who acts treacherously”

Here, **one who acts treacherously** represents this type of people in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who acts treacherously]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:18 (#3)

וְתַתַּחַת יְשָׁרִים בּוֹגֵד

“and instead of the upright, one who acts treacherously”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and instead of upright ones, one who acts treacherously is a ransom] or [and instead of upright ones, one who acts treacherously is punished]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:18 (#2)

לַצַּדִּיק רָשָׁע

“for the righteous {one} {is} a wicked {one”

See how you translated **the righteous one** in 10:3 and **a wicked one** in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:18 (#1)

כֹּפֶר לַצַּדִּיק רָשָׁע

“A ransom for the righteous {one} {is} a wicked {one”

Here Solomon refers to **a wicked one** who is punished instead of **the righteous one** as if **a wicked one** were a **ransom** that is paid on behalf of **the righteous one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A wicked one is punished instead of a righteous one]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:19 (#2)

מֵאֵשֶׁת מדונים

“than {with} a woman of quarrels”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **woman** that is characterized by **quarrels and vexation**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. See how you translated **a woman of quarrels** in 21:9. Alternate translation: [than with a woman who constantly argues and complains]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:19 (#1)

בְּאֶרֶץ־מִדְבָּר

“in a land of wilderness”

Since the **wilderness** is a place without people, Solomon implies dwelling alone in that place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by oneself in a land of wilderness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:20 (#3)

יְבַלְּעֶנּוּ

“swallows it up”

The pronoun **it** refers to the treasure and the oil. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [swallows them up] or [wastes them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 21:20 (#2)

יְבַלְּעֶנּוּ

“swallows it up”

Here Solomon refers to a **stupid** person wasting all his wealth as if it were something he **swallows**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wastes it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:20 (#1)

חָכָם וּכְסִיל אָדָם

“a wise {one}, but a stupid man”

See how you translated **a wise one** in 1:5 and **a stupid man** in 15:20.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:21 (#3)

צְדָקָה וְחָיִּים צְדָקָה וְכָבוֹד & חַסְדִּים

“righteousness and covenant faithfulness & life, righteousness, and honor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness** in 1:3, **covenant faithfulness** in 3:3, **life** in 10:16, and **honor** in 3:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:21 (#2)

רֹדֵף

“A pursuer of”

See how you translated the same use of **pursuer** in 15:9.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:21 (#4)

יִמְצָא

“will find”

See how you translated the same use of **find** in 8:35.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:21 (#1)

רֹדֵף

“A pursuer of”

A pursuer represents a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any pursuer of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:22 (#4)

וַיֹּרֶד

“and he brings down”

Here, **brings down** refers to the **wise one** leading his soldiers to destroy the fortifications that protect the **city** mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he causes his soldiers to destroy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:22 (#3)

עִיר גִּבֹּרִים

“a city of mighty ones”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **city** that is defended by **mighty ones**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a city defended by mighty ones]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:22 (#5)

עֹז מִבְטָחָהּ

“the strength of its confidence”

Here, **strength** refers to the strong walls and towers around the **city** mentioned in the previous clause. Here, **its** refers to the people in the city. They have **confidence** in the walls and do not think anyone will be able to destroy them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the strong fortifications in which they are confident]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:22 (#2)

עִעִיר & עָלָה

“ascends a city of”

Here, **ascends** refers to attacking a city and climbing over its wall. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [successfully attacks a city of] or [overruns a city of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:22 (#1)

עִעִיר & חָכָם וַיֹּרֶד

“A wise {one & a city of & and he brings down”

A wise one, **a city**, and **he** represent a type of person and city in general, not one particular person and city. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any wise one ... any city of ... and that person lowers]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:23 (#2)

שֹׁמֵר

“One who keeps”

Here Solomon refers to a person being careful about what he says with **his mouth and his tongue** as if they were objects that he **keeps**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who is careful with]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:23 (#4)

נַפְשׁוֹ

“his life”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [himself]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:23 (#3)

פִּיו וּלְשׁוֹנוֹ

“his mouth and his tongue”

The terms **mouth** and **tongue** mean similar things. They both refer to what a person says. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [whatever he says]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 21:23 (#5)

מִצָּרוֹת

“from distress”

See how you translated the abstract noun **distress** in 1:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:23 (#1)

שֹׁמֵר פִּיו וּלְשׁוֹנוֹ שֹׁמֵר & נַפְשׁוֹ

“One who keeps his mouth and his tongue keeps his life”

One who keeps and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not one specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who keeps that person’s own mouth and tongue keeps that person’s life]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:24 (#4)

בְּעֶבְרַת זָדוֹן

“with the rage of presumption”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **rage** or **presumption**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [in an arrogantly furious manner]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:24 (#2)

שְׁמוֹ

“is} his name”

Here, **name** refers to what people call a **presumptuous, haughty one**, not that person’s actual **name**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is what people call him]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:24 (#1)

זֵד יָהִיר & שְׁמוֹ

“A presumptuous, haughty one & is} his name”

A presumptuous, haughty one and **his** represent a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any presumptuous, haughty one ... is that person's name]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:24 (#3)

בְּעֶבְרַת זָדֹון

"with the rage of presumption"

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **rage** that is characterized by **presumption**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [with presumptuous rage]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:25 (#1)

עָצֵל תְּמִיתֶנּוּ & יָדָיו

"the lazy one causes him to die & his hands"

Here, **the lazy one**, **him**, and **his** refer to lazy people in general, not one specific **lazy one**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any lazy one causes that person to die ... that person's hands]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:25 (#2)

מֵאֲנוּ יָדָיו

"his hands refuse"

Here, **hands** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he refuses]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 21:26 (#2)

הִתְאַוָּה תַּאֲוָה

"he desires desire for himself"

Here, **desires desire** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [he adds desire onto desire for himself] or [he constantly desires things for himself]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 21:26 (#5)

יִתֵּן וְלֹא יַחְשֹׂךְ

"gives and does not withhold"

The terms **gives** and **does not withhold** mean the same thing. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [gives freely]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 21:26 (#3)

וְצַדִּיק

"but a righteous {one"

See how you translated **a righteous one** in 9:9.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:26 (#4)

יִתֵּן וְלֹא יַחְשֹׂךְ

"gives and does not withhold"

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [gives what he has and does not withhold it]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:26 (#1)

הִתְאַוָּה תַּאֲוָה

"he desires desire for himself"

Here, **he** and **himself** refer to the lazy person mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the lazy person desires desire for himself]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 21:27 (#6)

בְּזִמָּה

"with a wicked plan"

Here, **plan** refers to a purpose or motive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explic-

itly. Alternate translation: [with a wicked purpose] or [with wicked intent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:27 (#3)

תּוֹעֵבָה

“is} an abomination”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abomination**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is abominable]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:27 (#2)

זֶ֫בַח

“The sacrifice of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **sacrifice** in 15:8.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:27 (#5)

בְּזִמָּה

“with a wicked plan”

Here Solomon speaks of someone having **a wicked plan** while bringing a **sacrifice** as if the **plan** were an object that he brought **with** him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while having a wicked plan]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:27 (#1)

זֶ֫בַח & תּוֹעֲבָה & בְּזִמָּה יְבִיאֶנּוּ

“The sacrifice of & is} an abomination & he brings it with a wicked plan”

The sacrifice, **an abomination**, **he**, **it**, and **a wicked plan** refer to things and a type of person in general, not to a specific person or thing. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The sacrifices of … are abominations … they bring them with wicked plans]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:27 (#4)

אַ֫ף כִּי

“how much more when”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [how much more of an abomination is it when] or [how very abominable is it when]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:28 (#3)

לָ֫נֶצַח יְדַבֵּר

“will speak to perpetuity”

The context of this proverb is a legal setting, warning against witnesses who lie and commending the person who listens carefully to what the witnesses say. This last clause may be referring to the person listening to the lying witness in order to catch him in his lies, or it may be referring to the person listening to all of the witnesses in order to understand what happened. In either case, what this person says decides the case. The word translated as **to perpetuity** could mean: (1) for the duration, that is, until the end of the case. Alternate translation: [will speak until the end] or (2) successfully. Alternate translation: [will speak successfully]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:28 (#1)

עֵד־כְּזָבִים & וְאִישׁ שׁוֹמֵעַ

“A witness of lies & but a listening man”

A witness of lies and **a listening man** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any witness of lies … but any person who listens]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:28 (#2)

עֵד־כְּזָבִים

“A witness of lies”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **a witness** who tells **lies**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A lying witness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:29 (#4)

דרכיו

“his ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:29 (#1)

הֵעַז אִישׁ רָשָׁע בְּפָנָיו וְיָשָׁר הוּא ׀ יכין דרכיו

“A wicked man strengthens his face, but an upright one, he considers his ways”

A wicked man, **his**, **an upright one**, and **he** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **A wicked man** in 11:7. Alternate translation: [Any wicked person strengthens his own face, but any upright person considers his own ways]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:29 (#3)

יכין דרכיו

“considers his ways”

Many ancient manuscripts read **he considers his ways**, as in the ULT. Other ancient manuscripts read “he establishes his way.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Proverbs 21:29 (#2)

הֵעַז & בְּפָנָיו

“strengthens his face”

Here, **strengthens his face** means that the **wicked man** acts boldly and stubbornly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar expression from your language or express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression “strengthens her face” in 7:13. Alternate translation: [puts on a bold front] or [appears confident]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 21:30 (#2)

לְנֶגֶד

“in front of”

The word translated **in front of** could mean: (1) “before” or “in the presence of.” In this sense, all human wisdom is useless compared to Yahweh’s wisdom. Alternate translation: [that can stand before Yahweh] or [that compares to that of Yahweh]; (2) “in opposition to.” In this sense, there is no true wisdom that contradicts the wisdom of Yahweh. Alternate translation: [that contradicts the wisdom of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:30 (#1)

חָכְמָה & תְּבוּנָה & עֵצָה

“wisdom & understanding & counsel”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2 and **counsel** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:31 (#5)

הַתְּשׁוּעָה

“the salvation”

Here, **the salvation** refers to being saved from defeat in **battle**, which is another way of saying “the victory.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the victory] or [being saved from defeat]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:31 (#2)

סוּס מְמוּכָן

“A horse is made ready”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [A soldier makes a horse ready]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 21:31 (#3)

סוּס

“A horse”

A **horse** is a large animal that armies used to pull carts from which soldiers would fight. Armies with horses were usually more powerful than armies without horses. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term for something that soldiers use for fighting. Alternate translation: [An animal used for fighting] or [Fighting equipment]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 21:31 (#6)

וְלַיהוָֹה

“but & is} of Yahweh”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to indicate that **Yahweh** is the source of **the salvation**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but ... is from Yahweh]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:31 (#4)

לְיוֹם מִלְחָמָה

“for the day of battle”

Here, **day** refers to a point in time when something happens. It does not refer to a 24-hour length of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for the time of battle]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:31 (#1)

סוּס & לְיוֹם מִלְחָמָה

“A horse & for the day of battle”

A horse and **the day of battle** refer to these things in general, not a specific **horse** or **day of battle**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any horse ... for any day of battle]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 22 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Proverbs from Solomon (10:1–22:16)
2. Sayings from wise men (22:17–24:22)

- Introduction to the sayings (22:17–21)
- The sayings (22:22–24:22)

Chapter 22 concludes the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs. Solomon wrote all 375 proverbs in 10:1–22:16. In 22:17–21, it seems that Solomon himself introduces a section of proverbs written by an unknown group of people called “the wise ones.” Most of the proverbs of “the wise ones,” found in 22:22–24:22, are longer than one verse. Each of these longer proverbs will be marked in the notes.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism
Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 22 also contains contrasting parallelism (22:3, 12) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (22:1, 24, 26). (See: Parallelism)

Rhetorical questions
In 22:20–21 and 27, the author uses rhetorical questions to emphasize the importance of what he is saying. (See: Rhetorical Question)

Proverbs 22:1 (#5)

מִכֶּסֶף וּמִזָּהָב חֵן טוֹב

“favor {is} better than silver and than gold”

Here Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [having favor is better than having silver and gold] or [choosing favor is better than choosing silver or gold]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:1 (#1)

נִבְחָר שֵׁשֶׁם מֵעֹשֶׁר רָב מִכֶּסֶף וּמִזָּהָב חֵן טוֹב

“A name is to be chosen more than abundant riches; favor {is} better than silver and than gold”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A name is to be chosen more than abundant riches; yes, favor is better than silver and than gold]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 22:1 (#4)

מִכֶּסֶף וּמִזָּהָב חֵן טוֹב

“favor {is} better than silver and than gold”

This clause could also be translated as “good favor more than silver and than gold,” with **is to be chosen**

implied from the previous clause. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT. Alternate translation: [good favor is to be chosen more than silver and than gold] or [people should choose being favored by others rather than having silver and gold]

Proverbs 22:1 (#2)

שֵׁשֵׁם

“A name”

Here, **name** refers to a person’s reputation. Solomon implies that it is a good reputation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A good reputation]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:1 (#6)

חֵחֵן

“favor”

See how you translated **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:1 (#3)

נִבְחָ֫ר שֵׁשֵׁם

“A name is to be chosen”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [A person should choose having a good name]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 22:2 (#2)

נִפְגָּשׁוּ

“meet together”

Here Solomon speaks of people having something in common as if those people **meet together**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [have something in common]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:2 (#1)

עָשִׁ֫יר וְרָ֫שׁ

“A rich one and a poor one”

A rich one and **a poor one** represent types of people in general, not a particular **rich one** and **poor one**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any wise person and any rich person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:3 (#3)

עָבְרוּ

“pass on”

Here, **pass on** contrasts with **sees evil and hides himself** in the previous clause to indicate that **naive ones** walk right into a dangerous situation without noticing that they are in danger. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [unknowingly walk into a dangerous situation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:3 (#4)

וְנֶעֱנָשׁוּ

“and they are fined”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and they pay a penalty]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 22:3 (#1)

עָרְמִ֫ם

“A prudent {one”

See how you translated this phrase in 12:16.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:3 (#5)

וְנֶעֱנָשׁוּ

“and they are fined”

Here, **fined** refers to experiencing the negative consequences of not avoiding danger. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and they experience the consequences]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:3 (#2)

רָעָ֫ה

“evil”

Here, **evil** refers to danger caused by something **evil** happening. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [danger]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:4 (#3)

יִרְאַ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 22:4 (#5)

וְחַיִּ֥ים

“and life”

Here, **life** refers to a **life** that is long and good. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:4 (#4)

עֹ֖שֶׁר וְכָבֹ֣וד

“is} riches and honor”

See how you translated **riches and honor** in 3:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:4 (#1)

עֲקֵ֥ב עֲנָוָ֖ה יִרְאַ֥ת יְהוָֽה

“humility, the fear of Yahweh”

This could mean: (1) **humility** here refers specifically to **the fear of Yahweh**, as also suggested by the parallelism of these expressions in 15:33. Alternate translation: [humility, that is, the fear of Yahweh]; (2) **humility** and **the fear of Yahweh** are two different things. Alternate translation: [humility and the fear of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:4 (#2)

עֲנָוָ֖ה

“humility”

See how you translated the abstract noun **humility** in 15:33.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:5 (#5)

שׁוֹמֵ֣ר נַפְשׁ֑וֹ

“one guarding his life”

Here Solomon speaks of a person who wants to stay alive as if **his life** were something that he is **guarding**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar phrase “protects his life” in 16:17. Alternate translation: [one who tries to keep himself alive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:5 (#6)

מֵהֶ֗ם

“from them”

Here, **them** refers to the **Thorns** and **traps** mentioned in the previous phrase. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from those thorns and traps]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 22:5 (#3)

עִקֵּ֣שׁ

“the crooked”

Here Solomon uses the word **crooked** to refer to being deceptive. See how you translated the same use of **crooked** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:5 (#2)

צִנִּ֣ים פַּ֭חִים בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ עִקֵּ֑שׁ

“Thorns, traps {are} in the way of the crooked”

Here Solomon speaks of bad things that **the crooked** will experience during their lifetimes as if their lives consisted of a path with **Thorns** and **traps** on it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **way** in 15:19. Alternate translation: [The crooked will experience many troubles during their lifetimes] or [Crooked people will have a difficult life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:5 (#1)

בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ עִקֵּ֑שׁ שׁוֹמֵ֥ר נַפְשׁ֑וֹ

“are} in the way of the crooked; one guarding his life”

Here, **the way**, **the crooked**, and **one guarding his life** represent ways and types of people in general, not a specific **way** or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [are in the ways of the crooked ones; those who guard their lives]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:5 (#4)

שׁוֹמֵר נַפְשׁוֹ

“one guarding his life”

The content of this clause is in contrast to the content of the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, one guarding his life]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 22:6 (#2)

עַל־פִּי דַרְכּוֹ

“upon the mouth of his way”

Solomon is using **upon the mouth of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “according to.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to his way]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:6 (#3)

עַל־פִּי דַרְכּוֹ

“upon the mouth of his way”

Here, Solomon is speaking of the proper behavior of a child as **his way**, as in 1:15. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to live how he should live] or [to live in the right way]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:6 (#1)

לַנַּעַר & דַּרְכּוֹ & יַזְקִין לֹא־יָסוּר

“the boy & his way & he is old, he will not turn away”

Here, **the boy**, **his**, and **he** refer to children in general, not a specific **boy**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any child ... that child’s way ... that person is old, that person will not turn away]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:6 (#4)

לֹא־יָסוּר מִמֶּנָּה

“he will not turn away from it”

Here Solomon speaks of a person continuing to behave a certain way as if that person were not turning **away from** the right path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the phrase **turn away from** in 3:7. Alternate translation: [he will continue behaving that way]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:7 (#3)

וְעֶבֶד לְלֹוֶה לְאִישׁ מַלְוֶה

“and a borrower {is} a slave to a man who lends”

Here, Solomon is speaking as if a person who borrows money or goods actually became **a slave** to the lender. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a borrower comes under the control of the man who lends to him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:7 (#1)

עָשִׁיר & וְעֶבֶד לְלֹוֶה לְאִישׁ מַלְוֶה

“A rich one & and a borrower {is} a slave to a man who lends”

A rich one, **a borrower**, **a slave**, and **a man who lends** all refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any rich person ... and any borrower is a slave to any person who lends]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:7 (#2)

וְעֶבֶד לְלֹוֶה לְאִישׁ מַלְוֶה

“and a borrower {is} a slave to a man who lends”

Here Solomon implies that the **borrower** is borrowing money. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and a borrower of money is a slave to a man who lends money]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:8 (#4)

וְשֵׁ֖בֶט עֶבְרָתֹ֣ו

“and the rod of his rage”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **rod** that a **sower of iniquity** uses to express his **rage** by oppressing people. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and the rod he uses to oppressively express his rage]

See: Possession

Proverbs 22:8 (#5)

וְשֵׁ֖בֶט

“and the rod of”

Here Solomon refers to a person’s authority over other people as if it were a **rod**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the authority of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:8 (#3)

עַוְלָ֑ה

“iniquity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **iniquity** in 6:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:8 (#1)

זֹרֵ֣עַ עַוְלָ֑ה & עֶבְרָתֹ֣ו

“A sower of iniquity & his rage”

A sower of iniquity and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any sower of iniquity … that person’s rage]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:8 (#2)

זֹרֵ֣עַ עַוְלָ֑ה יקצור־אָ֝וֶן

“A sower of iniquity will reap disaster”

Here Solomon speaks of someone who does **iniquity** experiencing **disaster** as if **iniquity** were a seed that he plants and **disaster** were the plant that the seed becomes and that he harvests. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [A doer of iniquity will experience the consequences of that iniquity] or [A doer of iniquity will experience disaster as though he had planted disaster as a seed and harvested it as a crop]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:9 (#5)

לַדָּ֑ל

“to the lowly one”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:9 (#4)

מִלַּחְמֹ֣ו

“from his bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 22:9 (#1)

טֹוב־עַ֭יִן הֽוּא & נָתַ֣ן מִלַּחְמֹ֑ו

“The one good of eye, he & he gives from his bread”

The one good of eye, **he**, and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person good of eye, that person … that person gives from that person’s own bread]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:9 (#3)

הֽוּא יְבֹרָ֗ךְ

“he will be blessed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who will do the action, it is clear from the context that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will bless him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 22:9 (#2)

טֹוב־עַ֭יִן

“The one good of eye”

Here, **good of eye** refers to seeing what other people need and generously helping them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The generous one] or [The person who is generous to those in need]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:10 (#4)

דִּ֣ין

“judgment”

Here, **judgment** could refer to: (1) arguments or quarrels in general. Alternate translation: [arguments]; (2) lawsuits in a legal court. Alternate translation: [lawsuits]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:10 (#1)

לֵ֑ץ

“a mocker”

See how you translated **a mocker** in 9:7

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:10 (#2)

מָדְד֥וֹן & וְקָלֽוֹן

“strife & and dishonor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **strife** in 16:28 and **dishonor** in 3:35.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:10 (#3)

וְיֵצֵ֥א מָדְד֑וֹן

“and strife will go out”

Here Solomon speaks of **strife** as if it were a person who could **go out** from a place. He means that **strife** will cease. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and strife will stop]

See: Personification

Proverbs 22:11 (#2)

אֹהֵ֣ב טהור־לֵ֑בָב

“One who loves a pure heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and motives exist. Having a **pure heart** means to have good motives and thoughts about others. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2. Alternate translation: [One who wants to have good thoughts and motives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:11 (#1)

אֹהֵ֣ב & שִׂשְׂפָתָ֣יו רֵעֵ֖הוּ מֶ֣לֶךְ

“One who loves & his lips & the king {is} his friend”

One who loves, **his**, and **the king** refer to these types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who loves ... that person’s lips ... any king is that person’s friend]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:11 (#3)

שִׂשְׂפָתָ֣יו

“his lips”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:12 (#1)

עֵינֵ֣י יְהוָ֣ה

“The eyes of Yahweh”

This phrase refers to **Yahweh** himself, giving the sense of his watchfulness. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 22:12 (#2)

נָ֭צְרוּ דָּ֣עַת

“guard knowledge”

Here Solomon speaks of **knowledge** as if it were an object that Yahweh guards. He means that **Yahweh** maintains true **knowledge** against those who would want to promote lies, as in the following line. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [watch over those who speak what is true] or [give success to those who have true knowledge]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:12 (#3)

וַיְסַלֵּ֥ף

“but he overturns”

Here Solomon refers to **Yahweh** preventing **the words** of **treacherous** people from accomplishing their purposes as if **he overturns** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he prevents the success of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:12 (#4)

דִּבְרֵ֖י

“the words of”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:12 (#5)

בֹּגֵֽד

“a treacherous one”

Here, **a treacherous one** refers to this type of person in general, not a specific treacherous person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural phrase in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who is treacherous]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:13 (#3)

אָמַ֣ר

“says”

In this verse, Solomon implies that what the **lazy one** says is not true. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [says falsely]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:13 (#2)

אָמַ֣ר & אֲרִ֣י בַחֻ֑וץ בְּתוֹךְ֖ רְחֹב֣וֹת אֵרָצֵֽחַ

“says, “A lion {is} outside! I will be killed in the midst of the open areas”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [says that a lion is outside and he will be killed in the midst of the open areas]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 22:13 (#1)

עָ֣צֵל

“A lazy one”

See how you translated this phrase in 13:4.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:13 (#5)

אֵרָצֵֽחַ

“I will be killed”

Here, the **lazy one** implies that he **will be killed** if he goes outside. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [If I go outside, then I will be killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:13 (#4)

אֵרָצֵֽחַ

“I will be killed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The lion will kill me]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 22:14 (#5)

זְעֻ֣ם יְהוָ֣ה

“one who is cursed of Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [one whom Yahweh has cursed]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 22:14 (#2)

פִּ֣י

“The mouth of”

Here, **mouth** refers to the seductive things that **a strange woman** says with her **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The seductive speech of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:14 (#4)

שׁוּחָה עֲמֻקָּה & יפול־שָׁם

“is} a deep pit & will fall there”

Here Solomon speaks of the danger of obeying the seductive speech of **a strange woman** as if it were **a deep pit** that a person could **fall** into and die if they obeyed that speech. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is extremely dangerous ... will die because of it] or [is dangerous like a deep pit ... will fall there and die]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:14 (#3)

זָרוֹת

“a strange woman”

See how you translated this phrase in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:14 (#1)

פִּי זָרוֹת זְעוּם יְהוָה

“The mouth of a strange woman & one who is cursed of Yahweh”

The mouth, **a strange woman**, and **one cursed of Yahweh** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Mouths of strange women ... people who are cursed of Yahweh]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:15 (#5)

שֵׁבֶט מוּסָר

“the rod of discipline”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **rod** that is used to **discipline** someone. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the rod used for discipline]

See: Possession

Proverbs 22:15 (#3)

בְּלֶב

“in the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:15 (#6)

שֵׁבֶט

“the rod of”

See how you translated the same use of **rod** in 10:13 and 13:24.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:15 (#4)

נַּעַר & מִמֶּנּוּ

“a boy & from him”

Here, **a boy** and **him** refer to a child in general, not a specific boy. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any child ... from that child]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:15 (#1)

אִוֶּלֶת & מוּסָר

“Folly & discipline”

See how you translate the abstract nouns **Folly** in 5:23 and **discipline** in 13:24.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:15 (#7)

יַרְחִיקֶנָּה מִמֶּנּוּ

“will cause it to be far away from him”

Here Solomon speaks of **discipline** causing a child to stop being foolish as if **Folly** were an object that **the rod of discipline** could cause to go **far away**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will result in him ceasing from folly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:15 (#2)

קְשׁוּרָה בְּלֶב

“is bound up in the heart of”

Here Solomon refers to **a boy** inherently thinking foolishly as if **Folly** were an object **bound up** in that person’s **heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is inherently within the mind of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:16 (#4)

לְהַרְבּוֹת לוֹ

“to increase for him”

The pronoun **him** refers to: (1) the person who is oppressing the lowly one. Alternate translation: [to increase for himself]; (2) the lowly person. In this case, the statement describes an unexpected result of **oppressing a lowly one**, just as **surely will be to lack** is the unexpected result of giving to the rich. Alternate translation: [yet increases for him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 22:16 (#2)

דָּל

“a lowly {one”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:16 (#1)

עֹשֵׁק דָּל לְהַרְבּוֹת לוֹ נֹתֵן לְעָשִׁיר

“One oppressing a lowly {one} to increase for him, one giving to the rich”

One oppressing, **a lowly one**, **one giving**, and **the rich** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural phrases in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who oppresses any lowly person to increase for himself, any person who gives to any rich person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:16 (#6)

לְמַחְסוֹר

“will be} to lack”

Here, **will be to** indicates that what follows is the result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [will result in poverty]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 22:16 (#5)

נֹתֵן לְעָשִׁיר

“one giving to the rich”

Solomon is leaving out some words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context and previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [one who gives gifts to a rich one to increase wealth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 22:16 (#3)

לְהַרְבּוֹת

“to increase”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to increase wealth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 22:17 (#2)

דִּבְרֵי חֲכָמִים

“the words of the wise ones”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:17 (#4)

לְדַעְתִּי

“to my knowledge”

Here, **knowledge** refers to the **knowledge** that Solomon wants his readers to know. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [to what I want you to know]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:17 (#1)

הַטֵּ֣ה אָזְנְךָ֣ וּשְׁמַ֑ע

“Incline your ear and hear”

This phrase means “listen carefully.” See how you translated the same use of the shorter phrase **Incline your ear** in 4:20.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:17 (#3)

וְלִבְּךָ֥ תָּשִׁ֖ית לְדַעְתִּֽי

“and you must set your heart to my knowledge”

Here, **set your heart to** is an idiom that means "think carefully about." The word **heart** here refers to a person's mind, as in 2:2. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you must think carefully about my knowledge]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:18 (#1)

כִּי

"For"

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 22:18 (#2)

תִּשְׁמְרֵם בְּבִטְנֶךָ

"you keep them in your inner parts"

Here Solomon speaks of remembering something as if it were an object that someone should **keep** inside that person's **inner parts**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you remember them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:18 (#5)

יִכֹּנוּ יַחְדָּו עַל־שְׂפָתֶיךָ

"they are ready together on your lips"

Here Solomon speaks of someone always being able to repeat "the words of the wise" as if they were objects **on** someone's **lips** that **are ready** to come out. if it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and if you are prepared to say them all]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:18 (#3)

תִּשְׁמְרֵם & יִכֹּנוּ

"you keep them & they are ready"

Here, **them** and **they** refer to "the words of the wise" and "my knowledge" in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you keep those words ... those words are ready]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 22:18 (#4)

יִכֹּנוּ יַחְדָּו עַל־שְׂפָתֶיךָ

"they are ready together on your lips"

This clause refers to an additional condition for **it** being **pleasant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:19 (#1)

לִהְיוֹת בַּיהוָה מִבְטַחֶךָ הוֹדַעְתִּיךָ הַיּוֹם אַף־אָתָּה

"For} your trust to be in Yahweh, I have caused you to know today, even you"

The first clause of this verse is the purpose for the second clause. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the second clause before the first clause and connect them in a way that makes it clear that **For your trust to be in Yahweh** is the purpose of the teaching. Alternate translation: [I have caused you to know these things today, even you, in order for your trust to be in Yahweh]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 22:19 (#4)

אַף־אָתָּה

"even you"

Here Solomon repeats the pronoun **you** to emphasize to whom he is teaching these proverbs. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Yes, this is for you]

See: Reduplication

Proverbs 22:19 (#3)

הוֹדַעְתִּיךָ

"I have caused you to know"

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from 22:17 if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I have caused you to know the words of the wise]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 22:19 (#2)

הוֹדַעְתִּיךָ

“I have caused you to know”

Solomon uses the past tense here in order to refer to something that is happening while he is writing these verses, which is the time he calls **today**. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the present tense. Alternate translation: [I am causing you to know]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 22:20 (#3)

שלשום

“30 things”

The word translated as **30 things** could also refer to a type of military officer, which might imply that these are “excellent things.” Some translations follow that interpretation. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 22:20 (#2)

הֲלֹא כָתַבְתִּי

“Have I not written”

Solomon uses the past tense here in order to refer to something that is happening while he is writing these verses, which is the time he calls **today** in the previous verse. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the present tense. Alternate translation: [Am I not writing]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 22:20 (#4)

בְּמֹעֲצוֹת וָדָעַת

“with counsels and knowledge”

Here, **counsels and knowledge** refer to what the **30 things** are. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that are counsels and knowledge]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:20 (#1)

הֲלֹא כָתַבְתִּי

“Have I not written”

This phrase indicates that Solomon is using the question form in this verse and the next verse in order to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I have surely written]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 22:20 (#5)

בְּמֹעֲצוֹת וָדָעַת

“with counsels and knowledge”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **counsels** and **knowledge**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **knowledge** in 1:4. Alternate translation: [that can counsel you and make you knowledgeable]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:21 (#1)

לְהוֹדִיעֲךָ

“to cause you to know”

This verse continues the rhetorical question that began in the previous verse. If you divide these two verses into separate sentences, then you will need to repeat part of the previous sentence. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form to explain the purpose of writing something, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation rather than as a question. Alternate translation: [I have surely written these things to cause you to know]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 22:21 (#7)

לְשֹׁלְחֶיךָ

“to one who sent you”

Here Solomon implies that he is speaking to a messenger whom his master has **sent**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to your master who sent you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:21 (#3)

אִמְרֵי אֱמֶת

“the words of trustworthiness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **words** that are characterized by **trustworthiness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the trustworthy words]

See: Possession

Proverbs 22:21 (#2)

קְשֹׁט & אֱמֶת

“the truth of & trustworthiness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **truth** in 8:7 and **trustworthiness** in 3:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:21 (#6)

לְהָשִׁיב

“to return”

Here Solomon refers to replying to someone with **trustworthy words** as if they were objects that one returns to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to reply with]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:21 (#5)

לְהָשִׁיב

“to return”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is a second purpose for Solomon writing these “words of the wise”. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a second purpose. Alternate translation: [and to return]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 22:21 (#4)

אִמְרֵי & אֲמָרִים

“the words of & words”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:22 (#3)

דֶּדֶל & דַּל

“a lowly {one & is} a lowly {one”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:22 (#5)

בַּשָּׁעַר

“at the gate”

Here, **the gate** refers to the place in a city where people settled legal arguments (see Ruth 4:1–12). If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [at the place for settling legal arguments]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:22 (#1)

אַל־תִּגְזָל־דֶּדֶל כִּי דַל־הוּא וְאַל־תְּדַכֵּא עָנִי בַּשָּׁעַר

“Do not rob a lowly {one} because he {is} a lowly {one}, and do not crush an afflicted {one} at the gate”

22:22–23 is Saying 1 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 22:22 (#4)

וְאַל־תְּדַכֵּא

“and do not crush”

Here the writer refers to oppressing **an afflicted one** as if someone were crushing that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:22 (#2)

דֶּדֶל & דַּל־הוּא & עָנִי

“a lowly {one & he {is} a lowly {one & an afflicted {one”

Here, **a lowly one**, **he**, and **an afflicted one** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any lowly person ... that person is lowly ... any afflicted person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:23 (#4)

וְקָבַע & נָפֶשׁ

“and he will plunder of life”

Here, the writer refers to **Yahweh** killing a person who tries to **plunder** a poor person as if he were a thief who plunders that person’s **life**. If it would be helpful

in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will cause to die]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:23 (#3)

רִיבָם

“their dispute”

See how you translated the abstract noun **dispute** in 15:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:23 (#2)

רִיבָם & אֶת־קֹבְעֵיהֶם

“their dispute & those who plunder them”

In this verse, **their** and **them** refer to the afflicted and poor people referenced in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the dispute of poor people ... those who plunder poor people]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 22:23 (#1)

יְהוָה יָרִיב רִיבָם

“Yahweh will plead their dispute”

Here, the writer refers to **Yahweh** protecting “an afflicted one” as if he were a lawyer defending that person in court. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will protect them] or [Yahweh will protect them like a lawyer who defends them in court]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:24 (#5)

אִישׁ חֵמוֹת

“a man of heat”

See how you translated this phrase in 15:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:24 (#1)

אַל־תִּתְרַע אֶת־בַּעַל אָף וְאֶת־אִישׁ חֵמוֹת לֹא תָבוֹא

“Do not befriend an owner of nose, and do not go {with} a man of heat”

22:24–25 is Saying 2 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 22:24 (#4)

אֶת־בַּעַל אָף

“an owner of nose”

The phrase is an idiom that refers to a person who is characteristically angry. The word **nose** means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [an angry person]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:24 (#3)

אֶת־בַּעַל אָף & אִישׁ חֵמוֹת

“an owner of nose & a man of heat”

Here, **an owner of nose** and **a man of heat** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any owner of nose ... any person of heat]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:24 (#2)

אַל־תִּתְרַע אֶת־בַּעַל אָף וְאֶת־אִישׁ חֵמוֹת לֹא תָבוֹא

“Do not befriend an owner of nose, and do not go {with} a man of heat”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Do not befriend an owner of nose, yes, do not go with a man of heat]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 22:25 (#1)

פֶּן־תֶּאֱלַף אֹרְחֹתָו וְלָקַחְתָּ מוֹקֵשׁ לְנַפְשֶׁךָ

“lest you learn his paths and you take a snare for your life”

Here, **lest** introduces an outcome that the speaker does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives his hearers in verse 24 an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your lan-

guage that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction of verse 24. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Do not do that, so that you do not learn his paths or take a snare for your life]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 22:25 (#3)

וְלָקַחְתָּ֣ מוֹקֵ֣שׁ לְנַפְשֶׁ֑ךָ

“and you take a snare for your life”

Here, the writer speaks of a person causing his life to be in danger as if that person were an animal that gets caught in a **snare**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and you will put your life in danger] or [and you will be like an animal that gets caught in a snare and cannot escape]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:25 (#2)

תֶּאֱלַ֖ף ארחתו

“you learn his paths”

Here, the writer speaks of someone behaving like someone else as if that person **learns** the **paths** that the other person walks on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **paths** in 2:15. Alternate translation: [you behave like him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:26 (#5)

בְּתֹקְעֵי־כָ֑ף

“among those who clasp a palm”

See how you translated the same idiom in 6:1 and 17:18.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:26 (#2)

אַל־תְּהִ֥י בְתֹקְעֵי־כָ֑ף בַּעֲרְבִ֖ים מַשָּׁאֽוֹת

“Do not be among those who clasp a palm, among those who pledge for loans”

In the second clause, the writer is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Do not be among those who clasp a palm; do not be among those who pledge for loans]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 22:26 (#6)

בַּעֲרְבִ֖ים

“among those who pledge for”

See how you translated the same use of **pledge** in 6:1.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:26 (#3)

אַל־תְּהִ֥י בְתֹקְעֵי־כָ֑ף בַּעֲרְבִ֖ים מַשָּׁאֽוֹת

“Do not be among those who clasp a palm, among those who pledge for loans”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Do not be among those who clasp a palm; yes, do not be among those who pledge for loans]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 22:26 (#4)

אַל־תְּהִ֥י בְתֹקְעֵי־כָ֑ף

“Do not be among those who clasp a palm”

The phrase **do not be among** could refer to: (1) not participating in what **those who clasp a palm** do, which is promise to pay the debts of others. Alternate translation: [Do not be like those who clasp a palm] or [Do not clasp a palm]; (2) not associating with **those who clasp a palm**. Alternate translation: [Do not associate with those who clasp a palm]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:26 (#1)

אַל־תְּהִ֥י בְתֹקְעֵי־כָ֑ף בַּעֲרְבִ֖ים מַשָּׁאֽוֹת

“Do not be among those who clasp a palm, among those who pledge for loans”

22:26–27 is Saying 3 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 22:27 (#3)

לָ֤מָּה יִקַּ֣ח מִשְׁכָּבְךָ֣ מֵֽתַּחְתֶּ֑יךָ

“why should he take away your bed from under you”

The writer is using the question form to emphasize what will happen if a person cannot repay a loan for someone else. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [surely he will take away your bed from under you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 22:27 (#2)

אֵין־לְךָ֥ לְשַׁלֵּ֑ם

“there is nothing to you to make payment”

Here, the writer is referring to repaying the loans mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [there is no money for you to repay the loan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:27 (#1)

אִם

“If”

This verse gives a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do those things because if]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 22:27 (#4)

יִקַּ֥ח מִמַּשְׁכָּבְךָ֖ מִתַּחְתֶּֽיךָ

“should he take away your bed from under you”

This clause refers to a person who loaned money taking away the **bed** of someone because that person was unable to pay the loan that he had promised to pay for someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [should the lender take away your bed from under you because you were not able to repay the loan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:28 (#4)

אֲבוֹתֶֽיךָ

“your fathers”

Here, **fathers** means “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:28 (#1)

אַל־תַּ֭סֵּג גְּבֻ֣ל עוֹלָ֑ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשְׂ֝ש֗וּ אֲבוֹתֶֽיךָ

“Do not move the ancient boundary that your fathers made”

22:28 is Saying 4 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 22:28 (#3)

גְּבֻ֣ל עוֹלָ֑ם

“the ancient boundary”

The phrase **ancient boundary** refers to stones that people used to mark the boundaries of the land that they owned. These boundaries were **ancient** because they were originally placed by the landowner’s ancestors. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of **boundary** marker, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the stones placed long ago that mark the borders of someone’s land]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 22:28 (#2)

אַל־תַּ֭סֵּג גְּבֻ֣ל עוֹלָ֑ם

“Do not move the ancient boundary”

The writer implies that someone moves the **ancient boundary** in order to cheat the landowner by changing the boundaries of his land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Do not cheat a landowner by moving the ancient boundary]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:29 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֣י & יִתְיַצָּ֑ב בַּל־יִ֝תְיַצֵּ֗ב לִפְנֵ֥י

“He will station himself before the face of & he will not station himself before the face of”

The phrase **station himself before the face of** is an idiom that means “to enter the service of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will enter the service of ... he will not enter the service of]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:29 (#3)

אִ֭ישׁ ׀ מָ֣הִ֣יר בִּמְלַאכְתּ֑וֹ & יִתְיַצָּ֥ב בַּל־יִ֝תְיַצֵּ֗ב

“a skilled man in his work. He will station himself & he will not station himself”

Here, **a skilled man**, **his**, **he**, and **himself** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [people skilled in their work; those people will station themselves ... they will not station themselves]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:29 (#2)

חָזִ֥יתָ אִ֝ישׁ ׀ מָ֣הִ֣יר בִּמְלַאכְתּ֑וֹ

“You see a skilled man in his work”

Although the Hebrew text is not worded as a question, several translations make this clause into a rhetorical question. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this as a question. Alternate translation: [Have you seen a man skilled in his work?]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 22:29 (#1)

חָזִ֥יתָ אִ֝ישׁ ׀ מָ֣הִ֣יר בִּמְלַאכְתּ֑וֹ לִ֝פְנֵי־מְלָכִ֗ים יִתְיַצָּ֥ב בַּל־יִ֝תְיַצֵּ֗ב לִפְנֵי֥ חֲשֻׁכִּֽים

“You see a skilled man in his work. He will station himself before the face of kings; he will not station himself before the face of obscure ones”

22:29 is Saying 5 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs - Chapter 23 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Sayings from wise men (22:17–24:22)

- Introduction to the sayings (22:17–21)
- The sayings (22:22–24:22)

Chapter 23 continues the section of 30 sayings by “the wise ones” that began in 22:22. This chapter mostly contains longer proverbs, except for 23:9 and 23:12.

Proverbs 23:1 (#3)

אֶת־אֲשֶׁ֥ר

“what”

This could refer to: (1) the food that is put in front of you. Alternate translation: [what food] or [the food that]; (2) the person seated in front of you. Alternate translation: [who] or [the person who]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:1 (#1)

כִּֽי־תֵשֵׁ֥ב לִלְחֹ֗ום אֶת־מֹושֵׁ֥ל בְּבִ֑ין תָּ֝תָ֗בִ֥ין אֶת־אֲשֶׁ֥ר לְפָנֶֽיךָ׃

“When you sit to eat {with} a ruler, consider carefully what {is} before your face”

23:1–3 is Saying 6 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:1 (#2)

מֹושֵׁ֥ל

“a ruler”

The word **ruler** represents rulers in general, not one particular **ruler**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any ruler]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:2 (#2)

בַּבַּ֥עַל נֶ֝פֶ֗שׁ

“are} an owner of appetite”

The phrase **an owner of appetite** refers to a person who likes to eat a lot. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [have a big appetite] or [are a person who likes to eat]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:2 (#1)

וְשַׂמְתָּ֣ שַׂכִּ֣ין בְּלֹעֶ֑ךָ

“and you should put a knife at your throat”

This phrase is an idiom that means “restrain yourself.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you should cut down your appetite] or [and you should control yourself]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:3 (#4)

לֶ֝חֶ֗ם

“bread of”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 23:3 (#3)

לֶ֫חֶם כְּזָבִים

“bread of lies”

Here, the writer is using the possessive form to refer to **bread** that someone gives for the purpose of **lies**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is bread for deception]

See: Possession

Proverbs 23:3 (#2)

וְ֝הִ֗וא

“for it {is”

Although **it** is singular, it refers to the **delicious morsels** in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this with a plural form. Alternate translation: [for they are]

Proverbs 23:3 (#1)

לְמַטְעַמּוֹתָ֥יו

“his delicious morsels”

Here, **his** refers to the “ruler” mentioned in 23:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that ruler’s delicious morsels]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 23:4 (#2)

מִבִּינָתְךָ֣ חֲדָֽל

“from your understanding, cease”

This phrase could mean: (1) because you have **understanding**, you should **cease**. Alternate translation: [cease because of your understanding]; (2) you should cease from having an incorrect understanding, which would be thinking that it is good to weary yourself to gain riches. Alternate translation: [cease from your wrong understanding about gaining riches]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:4 (#1)

אַל־תִּיגַ֣ע לְ֭הַעֲשִׁ֑יר מִבִּינָתְךָ֣ חֲדָֽל

“Do not weary yourself to gain riches; from your understanding, cease”

23:4–5 is Saying 7 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:5 (#2)

התעוף עֵינֶ֥יךָ בּ֝בֹ֗ו

“Will you cause your eyes to fly to it”

Here, the writer speaks of someone looking at riches as if his **eyes** were a bird that could **fly** to the riches. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Will you look at it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:5 (#3)

בּ֝בֹ֗ו וְאֵ֣ינֶ֑נּוּ & יַעֲשֶׂה־לּ֥וֹ & ועיף

“to it, but it is not there & it will make & for itself & it will fly {into”

In this verse, **it** and **itself** refers to the riches mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the riches, but they are not there … those riches will make … for themselves … those riches will fly into]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 23:5 (#6)

עָשׂ֣וֹ יַעֲשֶׂה־לּ֣וֹ כְנָפַ֔יִם כְּ֝נֶ֗שֶׁר ועיף הַשָּׁמָֽיִם

“making, it will make wings for itself; like an eagle, it will fly {into} the sky”

Here, the writer speaks of a person quickly losing his wealth as if that wealth made **wings for itself** and flew away **into the sky like an eagle**. Just as eagles fly quickly, the wealth will disappear quickly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [it will surely disappear quickly] or [it will surely disappear as if it had wings and flew away quickly, as an eagle flies into the sky]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:5 (#7)

כְּ֝נֶ֗שֶׁר

“like an eagle”

An **eagle** is a bird that can fly rapidly. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [like a quick bird]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 23:5 (#5)

עָשׂשָׂה יַעֲשֶׂה

“making, it will make”

The writer is repeating the verb **make** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [it will surely make]

See: Reduplication

Proverbs 23:5 (#4)

וְאֵינֶנּוּ

“but it is not there”

The writer implies that a person loses his wealth as soon as he sees it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but it is lost]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:5 (#1)

התעוף עֵינֶיךָ בּוֹ וְאֵינֶנּוּ

“Will you cause your eyes to fly to it, but it is not there”

The writer is using the question form to emphasize how easily wealth is lost. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You will surely cause your eyes to fly to it, but it will not be there!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 23:6 (#2)

אֶת־לַחְמוֹ

“the bread of”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 23:6 (#1)

אַל־תִּלְחַם אֶת־לֶחֶם רַע עָיִן וְאַל־תתאו לְמַטְעַמֹּתָיו

“Do not eat the bread of {one} evil of eye, and do not desire his delicious morsels”

23:6–8 is Saying 8 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:6 (#5)

לְמַטְעַמֹּתָיו

“his delicious morsels”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:3.

Proverbs 23:6 (#4)

רַע עָיִן

“one} evil of eye”

The phrase **one evil of eye** is an idiom that means “a stingy person.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one who is stingy]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:6 (#3)

רַע עָיִן & לְמַטְעַמֹּתָיו

“one} evil of eye & his delicious morsels”

Here, **one evil of eye** and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person evil of eye … that person’s delicious morsels]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:7 (#3)

בְּנַפְשׁוֹ

“in his soul”

Here, the writer uses **soul** to refer a person’s inner being or mind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in his inner being] or [in his mind]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:7 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do those things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 23:7 (#5)

וְלִבּוֹ בַל־עִמָּךְ

“but his heart {is} not with you”

The phrase **his heart is not with you** is an idiom that means “he is not being sincere with you.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but he is not speaking sincerely to you] or [but he is not being honest with you]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:7 (#2)

כְּמוֹ־שָׁעַר

“like one who calculates”

The writer is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [like one who calculates the cost of the food]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 23:7 (#4)

אֱכֹל וּשְׁתֵה יֹאמַר לָךְ

“Eat and drink!” he will say to you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [He will tell you to eat and drink]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 23:8 (#4)

וְשִׁחַתָּ

“and you will ruin”

Here, the writer refers to speaking **words** in vain as if they were objects that one could **ruin**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and that will negate]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:8 (#5)

דְּבָרֶיךָ הַנְּעִימִים

“your pleasant words”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:8 (#3)

פִּתְּךָ

“your morsel”

Here, **morsel** most likely refers to a small amount of food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [your bit of food] or [your small amount of food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:8 (#1)

פִּתְּךָ־אָכַלְתָּ תְקִיאֶנָּה

“You will vomit up your morsel you ate”

This clause could mean: (1) the person feels like vomiting, in which case this clause is an exaggeration. Alternate translation: [You will feel like vomiting up what you ate]; (2) the person feels so bad that he actually vomits.

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 23:8 (#2)

תְקִיאֶנָּה

“You will vomit up”

The writer could imply that the person vomits or feels like vomiting because he is so disgusted at the attitude of the stingy person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [You will feel disgusted with him and vomit up]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:9 (#2)

בְּאָזְנֵי & אַל־תְּדַבֵּר

“Do not speak in the ears of”

The phrase **speak in the ears** refers to speaking directly to someone so that the person can clearly hear with his **ears** what is being said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not speak directly to]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:9 (#5)

מִלֶּיךָ

“your words”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:9 (#3)

כְּסִיל & יָבוּז

“a stupid {one & he will show contempt”

See how you translated the same use of **a stupid one** and **he** in 10:18.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:9 (#4)

לְשֵׂשֶׂכֶל

“for the insight of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **insight** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:9 (#1)

בְּאָזְנֵי כְסִיל אַל־תְּדַבֵּר כִּי־יָבוּז לְשֵׂשֶׂכֶל מִלֶּיךָ

“Do not speak in the ears of a stupid {one}, for he will show contempt for the insight of your words”

23:9 is Saying 9 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:10 (#4)

יְתוֹמִים

“fatherless ones”

The phrase **fatherless ones** refers to children who have lost their fathers and so do not have anyone to protect them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [children without fathers to protect them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:10 (#3)

וּבִשְׂדֵי יְתוֹמִים אַל־תָּבֹא

“and do not enter into the fields of fatherless ones”

The connection with the previous clause indicates that the phrase **enter into** here refers to taking over or using the land that belongs to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [do not take over the fields of fatherless ones] or [do not encroach on the fields of fatherless ones]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:10 (#1)

אַל־תַּסֵּג גְּבוּל עוֹלָם וּבִשְׂדֵי יְתוֹמִים אַל־תָּבֹא

“Do not move an ancient boundary, and do not enter into the fields of fatherless ones”

23:10–11 is Saying 10 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:10 (#2)

אַל־תַּסֵּג גְּבוּל עוֹלָם

“Do not move an ancient boundary”

See how you translated this clause in 22:28.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:11 (#3)

הוּא־יָרִיב

“he himself will plead”

The writer uses the word **himself** to emphasize how significant it was that Yahweh defends the defenseless. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [he indeed will plead]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 23:11 (#1)

גֹּאֲלָם

“their redeemer”

Here, **their redeemer** refers to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [their redeemer, Yahweh,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:11 (#4)

אֶת־רִיבָם

“their dispute”

See how you translated the abstract noun **dispute** in 15:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:11 (#2)

הוּא־יָרִיב אֶת־רִיבָם אִתָּךְ

“he himself will plead their dispute against you”

Here, the writer refers to Yahweh protecting “the fatherless ones” as if he were a lawyer who defends them in a legal **dispute**. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he himself will defend the orphans against you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:12 (#6)

וְאָזְנֶֽךָ

“and your ear”

See how you translated the same use of **ear** in 22:17.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:12 (#4)

הָבִ֣יאָה לַמּוּסָ֣ר לִבֶּ֑ךָ

“Bring your heart to correction”

Here, **bring your heart to** is an idiom that means “think carefully about.” The word **heart** here refers to a person’s mind, as in 2:2. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of the phrase “set your heart to” in 22:17. Alternate translation: [Think carefully about correction]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:12 (#1)

הָבִ֣יאָה לַמּוּסָ֣ר לִבֶּ֑ךָ וְאָזְנֶ֖ךָ לְאִמְרֵי־דָֽעַת

“Bring your heart to correction and your ear to words of knowledge”

23:12 is Saying 11 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:12 (#5)

לַמּוּסָ֣ר

“to correction”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **correction** in 3:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:12 (#7)

לְאִמְרֵי־דָֽעַת

“to words of knowledge”

See how you translated **words of knowledge** in 19:27.

See: Possession

Proverbs 23:12 (#3)

הָבִ֣יאָה לַמּוּסָ֣ר לִבֶּ֑ךָ וְאָזְנֶ֖ךָ לְאִמְרֵי־דָֽעַת

“Bring your heart to correction and your ear to words of knowledge”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Bring your heart to correction; yes, bring your ear to words of knowledge]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:12 (#2)

הָבִ֣יאָה לַמּוּסָ֣ר לִבֶּ֑ךָ וְאָזְנֶ֖ךָ לְאִמְרֵי־דָֽעַת

“Bring your heart to correction and your ear to words of knowledge”

The writer is leaving out a word in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Bring your heart to correction and bring your ear to words of knowledge]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 23:13 (#3)

מוּסָ֣ר

“discipline”

See how you translated the abstract noun **discipline** in 13:24.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:13 (#4)

מִנַּ֣עַר & תַּכֶּ֣נּוּ & לֹ֣א יָמֽוּת

“from a boy & you strike him & he will not die”

Here, **a boy**, **him**, and **he** refer to children in general, not to a specific **boy**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated the same use of **boy** and **he** in 22:6. Alternate translation: [from any child ... you strike that child ... that child will not die]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:13 (#5)

תַּכֶּנּוּ בַשֵּׁבֶט

“you strike him with the rod”

This phrase refers to a form of punishment that involved hitting a person with a wooden stick of some kind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a general expression for physical punishment. Alternate translation: [you punish him physically] or [you punish him by hitting him with a stick]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:13 (#2)

אַל־תִּמְנַע & מוּסָר

“Do not withhold discipline”

Here, the writer speaks of refusing to **discipline** a child as if **discipline** were an object that a parent refuses to give to his child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not hold back discipline]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:13 (#1)

אַל־תִּמְנַע מִנַּעַר מוּסָר כִּי־תַכֶּנּוּ בַשֵּׁבֶט לֹא יָמוּת

“Do not withhold discipline from a boy; when you strike him with the rod, he will not die”

23:13–14 is Saying 12 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:14 (#1)

אַתָּה

“You”

Here, the speaker includes the pronoun **you** even though the verb translated as **strike** already includes this meaning. Doing this adds emphasis to what he is saying. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [You must consider this]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 23:14 (#2)

בַּשֵּׁבֶט תַּכֶּנּוּ

“with the rod you will strike him”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:14 (#4)

וְנַפְשׁוֹ מִשְּׁאוֹל תַּצִּיל

“and you will rescue his life from Sheol”

Here, the writer speaks of someone preventing his child from dying as if he were rescuing **his life from Sheol**, which was considered to be the place where people’s spirits go when they die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will keep him alive]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:14 (#3)

וְנַפְשׁוֹ & תַּצִּיל

“and you will rescue his life”

Here, **and** introduces the result of doing what was stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do this, then you will rescue his life] or [This will result in you rescuing his life]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 23:15 (#3)

לִבֶּךָ & לִבִּי

“your heart & my heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:15 (#2)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 23:15 (#1)

בְּנִי אִם־חָכַם לִבֶּךָ יִשְׂמַח לִבִּי גַּם־אָנִי

“My son, if your heart {is} wise, my heart, even myself, will be glad”

23:15–16 is Saying 13 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:16 (#1)

כִּלְיוֹתָֽי

“my inner parts”

Here, **inner parts** is used as a parallel expression to “heart” in the previous verse, and so it also represents where a person’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [my inner being]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:16 (#2)

שְׂפָתֶֽיךָ

“your lips”

Here, **lips** represent the person in the act of speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:17 (#2)

לִבֶּֽךָ

“your heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts, feelings, and desires exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [yourself]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:17 (#3)

כִּֽי־אִם־בְּיִרְאַ֖ת־יְהוָֽה

“but rather in the fear of Yahweh”

The writer is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but rather, continue in the fear of Yahweh] or [but rather, let your heart be in the fear of Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 23:17 (#4)

בְּיִרְאַ֖ת־יְהוָֽה

“in the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated **the fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 23:17 (#1)

אַל־יְקַנֵּ֣א לִבְּךָ֣ בַּחַטָּאִ֑ים כִּֽי־אִם־בְּיִרְאַ֖ת־יְהוָ֣ה כָּל־הַיּ֔וֹם

“Do not let your heart be envious of sinners, but rather in the fear of Yahweh all the day”

23:17–18 is Saying 14 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:18 (#2)

יֵ֣שׁ אַחֲרִ֑ית

“there is a future”

Here, the writer implies that the **future** is good and is for the person addressed as **your** in the next clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [there is a good future for you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:18 (#4)

וְתִקְוָתְךָ֖

“and your hope”

See how you translated the abstract noun **hope** in 10:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:18 (#1)

כִּֽי־אִם־יֵ֣שׁ אַחֲרִ֑ית

“Surely there is a future”

Here the writer implies that the contents of the verse are true if the person has “the fear of Yahweh” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [If you have the fear of Yahweh, then surely there is a future]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:18 (#3)

וְתִקְוָתְךָ֖ לֹ֣א תִכָּרֵֽת

“and your hope will not be cut off”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will not cut off your hope]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 23:18 (#6)

לֹ֣א תִכָּרֵֽת

“will not be cut off”

The writer is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will surely become reality]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 23:18 (#5)

לֹ֣א תִכָּרֵֽת

“will not be cut off”

Here, the writer speaks of hope as if it were an object that could be cut off. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not remain unfulfilled] or [will not fail to become reality]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:19 (#3)

וַחֲכָ֑ם

“and be wise”

Here, **and** introduces the purpose for listening. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. See how you translated this phrase in 6:6.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 23:19 (#4)

וְאַשֵּׁ֖ר בַּדֶּ֣רֶךְ לִבֶּֽךָ

“and lead your heart in the way”

Here the writer refers to a person deciding to think about the right way to behave as if that person were leading his **heart** to go on a certain path. The word **heart** here refers to a person’s thoughts, as in 2:2, and **way** refers to right human behavior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and decide to think about right behavior]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:19 (#1)

שְׁמַע־אַתָּ֣ה בְנִ֣י וַחֲכָ֑ם וְאַשֵּׁ֖ר בַּדֶּ֣רֶךְ לִבֶּֽךָ

“Listen, you my son, and be wise, and lead your heart in the way”

23:19–21 is Saying 15 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:19 (#2)

בְנִ֣י

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 23:20 (#1)

אַל־תְּהִ֣י בְסֹבְאֵ֑י

“Do not be among drinkers of much”

See how you translated the same use of **Do not be among** in 22:26.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:20 (#3)

בָּשָׂ֣ר

“flesh”

Here, **flesh** refers to meat, which is animal **flesh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 23:20 (#2)

בְּזֹלְלֵ֖י בָּשָֽׂר

“among gluttonous eaters of flesh”

The writer is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and do not be among gluttonous eaters of flesh]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 23:21 (#4)

וּקְרָעִים תַּלְבִּישׁ נוּמָה

“and slumber will clothe {with} rags”

Here, **clothe with rags** indicates that a person is so poor that they only have **rags** for clothing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and slumber will make one so poor that he only has rags to wear]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:21 (#1)

סֹבֵא וְזוֹלֵל

“one who drinks much and one who eats gluttonously”

Here, **one who drinks much** and **one who eats gluttonously** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who drinks much and any person who eats gluttonously]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:21 (#3)

וּקְרָעִים תַּלְבִּישׁ נוּמָה

“and slumber will clothe {with} rags”

Here, the writer refers to people becoming poor because they sleep too much as if **slumber** were a person who clothes those people **with rags**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will be clothed with rags because they slept too much]

See: Personification

Proverbs 23:21 (#2)

סֹבֵא וְזוֹלֵל

“one who drinks much and one who eats gluttonously”

The writer implies that these people drink too much wine and gluttonously eat too much meat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated the similar phrases “drinkers of much wine” and “gluttonous eaters of flesh” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [one who drinks too much wine and one who gluttonously eats too much meat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:22 (#2)

וְאַל־תָּבֻז

“and do not despise”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **despise**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [and respect]

See: Double Negatives

Proverbs 23:22 (#1)

שְׁמַע לְאָבִיךָ זֶה יְלָדֶךָ וְאַל־תָּבֻז כִּי־זָקְנָה אִמֶּךָ

“Listen to your father, this {one} begot you, and do not despise your mother when she {is} old”

23:22–25 is Saying 16 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:23 (#3)

וְאַל־תִּמְכֹּר

“and do not sell”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **sell**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [and keep it]

See: Double Negatives

Proverbs 23:23 (#1)

אֱמֶת קְנֵה וְאַל־תִּמְכֹּר

“Acquire truth and do not sell”

Here the writer speaks of learning and remembering **truth** as if it were an object that someone can **Acquire** and **sell**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Learn truth and do not forget it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:23 (#2)

אֱמֶת & חָכְמָה וּמוּסָר וּבִינָה

“truth & wisdom and instruction and understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **truth** in 8:7 and **wisdom**, **instruction**, and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:23 (#4)

חָכְמָה וּמוּסָר וּבִינָה

“wisdom and instruction and understanding”

The writer is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and acquire wisdom and instruction and understanding]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 23:24 (#2)

אֲבִי צַדִּיק יולד חָכָם & בּוֹ

“The father of a righteous one & and one who begets a wise one & in him”

The father, **a righteous one**, **one who begets**, **a wise one**, and **him** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any father of any righteous person … and any person who begets any wise person … in that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:24 (#3)

גּוֹל יגוֹל

“rejoicing, will rejoice”

The writer is repeating the verb **rejoice** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [he will greatly rejoice]

See: Reduplication

Proverbs 23:24 (#4)

בּוֹ

“in him”

The word translated as **in** indicates that what follows is the reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [on account of him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 23:24 (#1)

גּוֹל יגוֹל אֲבִי צַדִּיק וְיוֹלֵד חָכָם יִשְׂמַח־בּוֹ

“QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: גּוֹל יגוֹל אֲבִי צַדִּיק וְיוֹלֵד חָכָם יִשְׂמַח־בּוֹ”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [The father of a righteous one, rejoicing, will rejoice; yes, one who begets a wise one, he will be glad in him]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:25 (#2)

יִשְׂמַח־אָבִיךְ וְאִמֶּךָ וְתָגֵל יוֹלַדְתֶּךָ

“May your father and your mother be glad, and may she who bore you rejoice”

The writer is using an appeal statement to give a command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command form. Alternate translation: [Cause your father and your mother to be glad, and cause she who bore you to rejoice]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Proverbs 23:25 (#1)

יִשְׂמַח־אָבִיךְ וְאִמֶּךָ וְתָגֵל יוֹלַדְתֶּךָ

“May your father and your mother be glad, and may she who bore you rejoice”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [May your father and your mother be glad; yes, may she who bore you rejoice]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:25 (#3)

יִשְׂמַח־אָבִיךְ וְאִמֶּךָ

“May your father and your mother be glad”

This verse states the intended result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is what should be the result of what came before. Alternate translation: [Therefore, may your father and your mother be glad]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 23:26 (#4)

וְעֵינֶ֗יךָ & תרצנה

“and may your eyes watch”

Here, **eyes** represent the ability of a person to learn through observation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and may you look carefully at]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:26 (#1)

תְּנָה־בְּנִ֥י לִבְּךָ֖ לִ֑י וְעֵינֶ֗יךָ דְּרָכַ֥י תרצנה

“My son, give your heart to me, and may your eyes watch my ways”

23:26–28 is Saying 17 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:26 (#5)

דְּרָכַ֥י

“my ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:26 (#3)

וְעֵינֶ֗יךָ דְּרָכַ֥י תרצנה

“and may your eyes watch my ways”

The writer is using an appeal statement to give a command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command form. Alternate translation: [and make your eyes watch my ways]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Proverbs 23:26 (#2)

תְּנָה & לִבְּךָ֖ לִ֑י

“give your heart to me”

Here, the writer refers to paying careful attention to someone as if the **son** were to **give** his **heart** to him. The word **heart** here refers to a person’s thoughts, as in 2:2. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [pay careful attention to me]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:27 (#4)

נָכְרִיָּ֑ה

“a foreign woman”

See how you translated this phrase in 2:16. As there, the woman is “strange” or **foreign** not because she is from a different ethnic group, but because she belongs to another man; she is a foreigner to the son’s own marriage. Alternate translation: [the wife of another man]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:27 (#3)

שׁוּחָ֣ה עֲמֻקָּ֑ה

“is} a deep pit”

See how you translated this phrase in 22:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:27 (#2)

שׁוּחָ֣ה עֲמֻקָּ֑ה זוֹנָ֥ה וּבְאֵ֖ר צָ֣רָה נָכְרִיָּֽה

“a prostitute {is} a deep pit, and a foreign woman {is} a narrow well”

Here, **a prostitute**, **a deep pit**, **a foreign woman**, and **a narrow well** refer to these things and types of people in general, not to specific things or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any prostitute is a deep pit, and any foreign woman is a narrow well]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:27 (#1)

כִּֽי־שׁוּחָ֣ה עֲמֻקָּ֑ה זוֹנָ֥ה וּבְאֵ֖ר צָ֣רָה נָכְרִיָּֽה

“For a prostitute {is} a deep pit, and a foreign woman {is} a narrow well”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something

additional. Alternate translation: [For a prostitute is a deep pit: yes, a foreign woman is a narrow well]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:27 (#5)

וּבְאֵ֣ר צָ֭רָה

“and & is} a narrow well”

Here, the writer speaks of the inescapable danger of **a foreign woman** as if she were a **narrow well** that a person could fall into and not get out of. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and ... is dangerous] or [and ... is dangerous like a narrow well]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:28 (#4)

בָּֽאָדָ֑ם

“among man”

In this verse, the word **man** is singular in form, but it refers to all men as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly, as in the UST.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 23:28 (#2)

הִ֭יא & תֶּאֱרֹ֣ב

“she herself lies in wait”

The writer uses the word **herself** to emphasize who it is who harms men. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [she is the very one who lies in wait]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 23:28 (#3)

וּ֝בוֹגְדִ֗ים & תּוֹסֵ֥ף

“and she adds to the treacherous ones”

Here the writer speaks of an immoral woman causing men to act unfaithfully as if she were adding them to a group of **treacherous ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she increases the number of those who betray their wives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:28 (#1)

הִ֭יא כְּחֶ֣תֶף תֶּאֱרֹ֣ב

“she herself lies in wait like a robber”

Here, the writer compares an immoral woman to a **robber** who **lies in wait** to actively attack him and take something from him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. See how you translated **lies in wait** in 7:12. Alternate translation: [she herself lies in wait like a robber to take from a man what is valuable]

See: Simile

Proverbs 23:29 (#4)

חַכְלִלּ֥וּת עֵינָֽיִם

“is} dullness of eyes”

The phrase **dullness of eyes** refers to **eyes** that look red because a person drank too much alcohol. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is red eyes, like the color of blood] or [is bloodshot eyes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:29 (#3)

לְמִ֣י אֹ֭וי לְמִ֣י אֲבֹ֑וי לְמִ֥י מְדוֹנִ֝֗ים ׀ לְמִ֣י שִׂ֭יחַ

“For whom {is} woe? For whom {is} sorrow? For whom {are} quarrels? For whom {is} a lament”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **woe**, **sorrow**, **quarrels**, and **lament**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [Who is woeful? Who is sorrowful? Who is quarrelsome? Who laments?]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:29 (#1)

לְמִ֣י אֹ֭וי לְמִ֣י אֲבֹ֑וי לְמִ֥י מְדוֹנִ֝֗ים ׀ לְמִ֣י שִׂ֭יחַ לְלָ֣מִי פְצָעִ֑ים חִנָּ֥ם לְלָ֝מִ֗י חַכְלִלּ֥וּת עֵינָֽיִם

“For whom {is} woe? For whom {is} sorrow? For whom {are} quarrels? For whom {is} a lament? For whom {are} wounds without reason? For whom {is} dullness of eyes”

23:29–35 is Saying 18 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:29 (#2)

לְמִ֣י אֹ֭וי לְמִ֣י אֲבֹ֑וי לְמִ֥י מְדוֹנִ֝֗ים ׀ לְמִ֣י שִׂ֭יחַ לְלָ֣מִי פְצָעִ֑ים חִנָּ֥ם לְלָ֝מִ֗י חַכְלִלּ֥וּת עֵינָֽיִם

“For whom {is} woe? For whom {is} sorrow? For whom {are} quarrels? For whom {is} a lament? For

whom {are} wounds without reason? For whom {is} dullness of eyes"

The writer uses these questions to prepare the reader for the point he is about to make about "those who linger over wine" in the next verse. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I will tell you what kind of person has woe, sorrow, quarrels, lament, wounds without reason, and dullness of eyes.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 23:30 (#4)

מִמְסָךְ

"mixed wine"

In ancient Israel, people often prepared **wine** for drinking by mixing it with water. See how you translated "mixed her wine" in 9:2 and the similar expression in 9:5.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:30 (#2)

לַמְאַחֲרִים עַל־הַיָּיִן

"For those who linger over wine"

Here the writer refers to people who spend a lot of time drinking a lot of wine as if they were lingering **over wine**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [For those who spend many hours drinking wine] or [For those who drink more and more wine]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:30 (#1)

לַמְאַחֲרִים עַל־הַיָּיִן

"For those who linger over wine"

This verse answers the rhetorical questions in the previous verse. If you did not use questions in the previous verse, then you may need to adjust this sentence. Alternate translation: [The kind of people who do these things are those who linger over wine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:30 (#3)

לַבָּאִים לַחְקֹר מִמְסָךְ

"for those coming to search out mixed wine"

Here, the writer implies that these people **search out mixed wine** in order to drink it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for those coming to search out and drink mixed wine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:31 (#1)

אַל־תֵּרֶא יַיִן

"Do not look {at} wine"

The writer says **Do not look at wine** as an overstatement for emphasis. He is warning the reader not to be enticed by the attractive qualities of wine that he describes here. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Do not be enticed by the attractiveness of wine]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 23:31 (#3)

יִתֵּתְן בכיס עֵינֹו

"its eye gives in the cup"

The phrase **its eye gives** refers to the way **wine** gleams or reflects light inside a **cup**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [it gleams in the cup]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:31 (#2)

כְּכִי יִתְאַדָּם כִּי־יִתֵּתְן בכיס עֵינֹו יִתְהַלֵּךְ בְּמֵישָׁרִים

"when it is red; when its eye gives in the cup, it goes with evenness"

These three clauses give reasons why someone is tempted to drink **wine**, in contrast to the command to **not look at** it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this contrast more explicit. Alternate translation: [despite it being red, giving its eye in the cup, and going with evenness]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 23:31 (#4)

יִתְהַלֵּךְ בְּמֵישָׁרִים

"it goes with evenness"

Here, the writer implies that the **wine goes** down a person's throat smoothly when he drinks it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this

explicitly. Alternate translation: [it flows down one's through smoothly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:32 (#3)

כְּנָחָשׁ יִשָּׁשֵׁךְ וְכִצְפְעֹנִי יַפְרִשׁ

"bites like a snake, and it stings like a viper"

The writer is saying that the result of drinking too much wine is **like a snake** or **a viper** biting the person, because it is painful and harms that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [hurts as badly as a snakebite]

See: Simile

Proverbs 23:32 (#1)

אַחֲרִיתוֹ כְּנָחָשׁ יִשָּׁשֵׁךְ וְכִצְפְעֹנִי יַפְרִשׁ

"Its end bites like a snake, and it stings like a viper"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Its end bites like a snake; yes, it stings like a viper]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:32 (#2)

אַחֲרִיתוֹ

"Its end"

Its end refers to the result of drinking too much wine. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The result of drinking too much of it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:33 (#1)

עֵינֶיךָ

"Your eyes"

In this verse, **eyes** refers to the capability of a person to see. In this case, the person will see things that are not there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 23:26.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:33 (#2)

וְלִבְּךָ יְדַבֵּר תַּהְפֻּכוֹת

"and your heart will speak perverse things"

Here, **heart** refers to the person's thoughts, in which case the person is thinking or imagining things that are not real. Alternate translation: [and you will think things that are not real] or [and your mind will be confused]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 23:33–35 (#1)

עֵינֶיךָ יִרְאוּ זָרוֹת

"Your eyes will see strange things"

The writer implies that what is described in these verses is what someone experiences when he drinks too much alcohol. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [These things will happen if you drink too much wine: your eyes will see strange things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:34 (#1)

וְהָיִיתָ כְּשֹׁכֵב בְּלֵב־יָם וּכְשֹׁכֵב בְּרֹאשׁ חִבֵּל

"And you will be like one who lies down in the heart of the sea and like one who lies down at the head of a mast"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And you will be like one who lies down in the heart of the sea; yes, like one who lies down at the head of a mast]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:34 (#5)

בְּרֹאשׁ חִבֵּל

"at the head of a mast"

The phrase **head of a mast** refers to the top of a long, wooden pole to which a very large cloth, called a sail, was attached. Wind blown into the sail propelled the ship. The top of the mast would sway back and forth more than any other part of the ship, so someone **at**

the head of a mast could easily become dizzy and nauseated. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of mast, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [at the highest point on a ship]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 23:34 (#2)

כְּשֹׁכֵב בְּלֵב־יָם

“like one who lies down in the heart of the sea”

The writer is saying that a drunk person is like someone **who lies down in the heart of the sea** because that person feels dizzy, nauseous, and unsteady, like someone on a boat in the middle of the ocean. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [dizzy and nauseous]

See: Simile

Proverbs 23:34 (#4)

וּכְשֹׁכֵב בְּרֹאשׁ חִבֵּל

“and like one who lies down at the head of a mast”

The writer is saying that a drunk person is like someone **who lies down at the head of a mast**, because that person feels dizzy and stumbles like someone who sways back and forth at the top of the mast of a ship in the ocean. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and swaying from side to side]

See: Simile

Proverbs 23:34 (#3)

בְּלֵב־יָם

“in the heart of the sea”

Here, **heart** refers to the middle of **the sea**, which is far away from land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the middle of the sea] or [far out in the ocean]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:35 (#7)

אֹסִיף אֲבַקְשֶׁנּוּ עוֹד

“I will add, I will seek it again”

The drunk person implies that he will **seek** more wine and drink it to **add** to the wine he has already drunk. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I will seek more wine to drink again]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:35 (#2)

הִכָּנִי בַל־חָלִיתִי

“They struck me. I was not hurt”

The drunk person implies a strong contrast between the first clause and the second. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [They struck me. However, I was not hurt]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 23:35 (#3)

הֲלָמֻנִי בַל־יָוָדָעְתִּי

“They beat me. I did not know”

The drunk person implies a strong contrast between the first clause and the second. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [They beat me. However, I did not know]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 23:35 (#1)

הִכָּנִי

“They struck me”

This verse describes what a drunk person would say. That person was referred to as “you” in the previous two verses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 23:35 (#6)

אֹסִיף אֲבַקְשֶׁנּוּ עוֹד

“I will add, I will seek it again”

The words **add** and **seek it again** express a single idea. The word **add** emphasizes the repetition of seeking more wine to drink. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [I will seek it yet again]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 23:35 (#5)

מָתַי אָקִיץ

“When will I awake”

Here, **wake up** refers to the drunk person becoming sober again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When will I become sober]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:35 (#4)

מָתַי אָקִיץ

“When will I awake”

The drunk person uses a question in order to emphasize his desire to be **awake**. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I want to wake up!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs - Chapter 24 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Sayings from wise men (22:17–24:22)

- Introduction to the sayings (22:17–21)
- The sayings (22:22–24:22)

1. More sayings from wise men (24:23–34)

24:1–22 finishes the section of 30 sayings by “the wise ones” that began in 22:22. This section mostly contains longer proverbs, except for 24:7 and 24:10.

24:23–34 contain an additional short collection of sayings by “the wise ones.” This section contains proverbs of varying lengths, the longest being 24:30–34.

Proverbs 24:1 (#3)

בְּאַנְשֵׁי

“of men of”

Although the term **men** is masculine, the writer is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [of people of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:1 (#1)

24:1–2 is Saying 19 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:1 (#2)

בְּאַנְשֵׁי רָעָה

“of men of evil”

Here the writer is using the possessive form to describe **men** who are characterized by **evil**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [of evil men]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:2 (#2)

לִבָּם

“their heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and intentions exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [their mind]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:2 (#4)

שִׂפְתֵיהֶם

“their lips”

Here, **lips** represents what people say with their lips. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:2 (#3)

שֹׁד

“violence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **violence** in 3:31.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:2 (#1)

יֶהְגֶּה לִבָּם

“their heart plots”

Although **heart** is singular, it refers to all the hearts of the people who plot **violence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form. Alternate translation: [their hearts plot]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 24:2 (#5)

וְעָמָל

“and & trouble”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **trouble**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and … what troubles people]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:3 (#1)

בְּחָכְמָה יִבָּנֶה בָּיִת וּתְבוּנָה יִתְכּוֹנָן

“By wisdom a house is built, and by understanding it is established”

24:3–4 is Saying 20 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:3 (#2)

בְּחָכְמָה & וּתְבוּנָה

“By wisdom & and by understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:3 (#3)

יִבָּנֶה בָּיִת & יִתְכּוֹנָן

“a house is built & it is established”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone builds a house … someone establishes it]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 24:3 (#4)

יִתְכּוֹנָן

“it is established”

Here, the word translated as **established** refers to being stable and secure. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [it is secure]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:4 (#2)

חֲדָרִים יִמָּלְאוּ

“the rooms are filled”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone fills the rooms]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 24:4 (#1)

וּבְדַעַת

“And by knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:4 (#3)

חֲדָרִים

“the rooms”

The writer implies that these are **the rooms** in the house described in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the rooms of that house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:5 (#3)

גֶּבֶר־חָכָם

“A man of wisdom”

Here, the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **wisdom**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A wise man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:5 (#1)

24:5–6 is Saying 21 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:5 (#5)

וְאִישׁ־דַּעַת

“and a man of knowledge”

Here, the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **knowledge**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and a knowledgeable man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:5 (#2)

גֶּבֶר־חָכָם & וְאִישׁ־דַּ֫עַת

“A man of wisdom & and a man of knowledge”

Although the term **man** is masculine, the writer is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [Any person of wisdom ... and any person of knowledge]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:5 (#4)

חָכְמָ֫ם בַּעֲוֹז & דַּ֫עַת & כֹּ֫חַ

“wisdom {is} with strength & knowledge & power”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **wisdom**, **strength**, **knowledge**, and **power**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **wisdom** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4. Alternate translation: [what is wise is with what is strong ... what is knowledgeable ... what is powerful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:6 (#2)

תַּעֲשֶׂה־לְּךָ֥ מִלְחָמָ֑ה

“you make war for yourself”

The writer implies fighting a successful **war**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you successfully make war for yourself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:6 (#1)

בְּ֝תַחְבֻּל֗וֹת

“by guidance”

See how you translated **guidance** in 20:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:6 (#3)

וּתְשׁוּעָ֥ה בְרֹ֝ב יוֹעֵֽץ

“and salvation {is} in an abundance of counsel”

See how you translated the same clause in 11:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:7 (#2)

רָ֭אמָוֹת לָאֱוִ֑יל

“are too} high for a fool”

Here, **high** is an idiom that means “too difficult to understand.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are over the head of a fool] or [are too difficult for a fool to understand]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:7 (#5)

לֹ֣א יִפְתַּח־פִּ֑יהוּ

“he will not open his mouth”

Here, **open his mouth** refers to a person speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will not speak]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:7 (#3)

לָאֱוִ֑יל & לֹ֣א יִפְתַּח־פִּ֑יהוּ

“for a fool & he will not open his mouth”

Here, **a fool**, **he**, and **his** represent fools in general, not a specific **fool**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [for any fool ... that person will not open that person’s own mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:7 (#1)

24:7 is Saying 22 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:7 (#4)

בַּ֝שַּׁ֗עַר

“at the gate”

See how you translated the same use of **gate** in 22:22.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:8 (#2)

מְחַשֵּׁ֥ב & לֹּֽו

“One who plans & him”

One who plans and **him** represent a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful,

you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who plans ... that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:8 (#1)

24:8–9 is Saying 23 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:8 (#3)

לְהָרֵֽעַ

“to do evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:8 (#4)

בַּעַל־מְזִמּוֹת

“an owner of schemes”

Here the writer refers to a person who has many **schemes** as **an owner of schemes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a person with many schemes] or [a troublemaker]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:9 (#4)

לְאָדָֽם

“to man”

The word **man** represents people in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [to mankind]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:9 (#2)

זִמַּת אִוֶּֽלֶת

“A scheme of folly”

Here, the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **scheme** that is characterized by **folly**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A scheme characterized by folly]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:9 (#1)

זִמַּת אִוֶּֽלֶת & לֵ֑ץ

“A scheme of folly & a mocker”

A scheme of folly and **a mocker** refer to schemes and mockers in general, not a specific **scheme** or **mocker**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any scheme of folly ... any mocker]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:9 (#3)

אִוֶּ֥לֶת & וְתוֹעֲבַ֖ת

“folly & and & is} an abomination”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **folly** in 5:23 and **abomination** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:10 (#2)

הִתְרַפִּ֥יתָ

“If} you make yourself slack”

The word **yourself** indicates that the object of the verb is the same as the subject of the verb. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person fills two roles in the sentence. Alternate translation: [If you falter]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 24:10 (#1)

24:10 is Saying 24 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:10 (#5)

צָרָ֖ה & כֹּחֶֽכָה

“distress, your strength”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **distress** in 1:27 and **strength** in 5:10.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:10 (#4)

בְּי֣וֹם צָרָ֑ה

“in the day of distress”

Here, **day** refers to a point in time when something happens. It does not refer to a 24-hour length of time. See how you translated the same use of **day** in 21:31.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:10 (#6)

צַ֣צְתָּ

“is} narrow”

Here, the writer refers to **your strength** being restricted or limited as if it were **narrow**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is restrained]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:10 (#3)

בְּיוֹם צָרָה

“in the day of distress”

Here, **the day of distress** refers to this type of **day** in general, not a particular **day of distress**. If it would be helpful, you could use a different expression in your language. Alternate translation: [in any day of distress]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:11 (#2)

הַהָצֵל לְקֻחִים לַמָּוֶת וּמָטִים לַלֶּהֱרֵג אִם־תַּחְשֹׂךְ

“Rescue those being taken for the death, and those staggering to the slaughter if you hold back”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Rescue those being taken for the death, yes, those staggering to the slaughter if you hold back]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 24:11 (#6)

וּמָטִים לַלֶּהֱרֵג

“and those staggering to the slaughter”

The writer is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply this word from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and rescue those staggering to the slaughter]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 24:11 (#3)

לְקֻחִים לַמָּוֶת וּמָטִים לַלֶּהֱרֵג

“those being taken for the death, and those staggering to the slaughter”

The writer implies that these people are wrongfully **taken to the death** and **stagger to the slaughter**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those who are wrongfully take to the death, and those who stagger to wrongful slaughter]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:11 (#4)

לְקֻחִים

“those being taken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [those whom people take]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 24:11 (#1)

24:11–12 is Saying 25 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:11 (#5)

לַמָּוֶת & לַלֶּהֱרֵג

“for the death & to the slaughter”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **death** in 2:18 and **slaughter** in 7:22.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:11 (#7)

אִם־תַּחְשֹׂךְ

“if you hold back”

Here, the writer refers to allowing the **slaughter** of these people as if one were holding oneself back from helping them. You may have a similar expression in your language, or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if you do nothing] or [if you do not stop it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:12 (#6)

תֹּכֵן לִבּוֹת

“the examiner of hearts”

Here, the writer speaks of one who discerns what people are thinking as if he were an **examiner of hearts**. The word **hearts** here refers to human minds, as in 15:11. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the discerner of minds]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:12 (#3)

זֶֽה

“this”

Here, **this** refers to what is happening to “those who are taken for the death,” who are also “those who stagger to the slaughter” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that those people were being taken to die] or [that those people were being unjustly killed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 24:12 (#5)

הֲלֹא־תֹכֵ֥ן לִבּ֑וֹת ׀ הֽוּא־יָ֝בִ֗ין וְנֹצֵ֣ר נַ֭פְשְׁךָ ה֣וּא יֵדָ֑ע וְהֵשִׁ֖יב

“does not he, the examiner of hearts, understand, and he, the guard of your life, know, and he, give back”

In this verse, **he** refers to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [does not Yahweh, the examiner of hearts, understand, and Yahweh, the guard of your life, know; and Yahweh will give back]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 24:12 (#7)

וְנֹצֵ֣ר נַ֭פְשְׁךָ ה֣וּא

“and he, the guard of your life”

Here, the writer speaks of someone who keeps a person alive as if he were **the guard** of that person’s **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he, the one who preserves your life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:12 (#8)

וְהֵשִׁ֖יב לְאָדָ֣ם

“and he, give back to a man”

Here, the writer refers to Yahweh causing **a man** to receive what he deserves for **his work** as if Yahweh were giving something **back** to that **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will make sure a man receives what is due to him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:12 (#1)

כִּֽי־תֹאמַ֑ר

“If you say”

Here, the writer implies that the speaker did **know** and is lying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [If you lie by saying]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:12 (#9)

לְאָדָ֣ם כְּפָעֳלֽוֹ

“to a man according to his work”

Although **man** and **he** are masculine, the writer is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person according to that person’s work]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:12 (#4)

הֲלֹא־תֹכֵ֥ן לִבּ֑וֹת ׀ הֽוּא־יָ֝בִ֗ין וְנֹצֵ֣ר נַ֭פְשְׁךָ ה֣וּא יֵדָ֑ע וְהֵשִׁ֖יב לְאָדָ֣ם כְּפָעֳלֽוֹ

“does not he, the examiner of hearts, understand, and he, the guard of your life, know, and he, give back to a man according to his work”

The writer is using the question form to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [he, the examiner of hearts, surely understands, and he, the guard of your life, surely knows, and he will surely give back to a man according to his work!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 24:12 (#2)

הֵ֤ן

“Behold”

The speaker is using the term **Behold** to focus attention on what he is about to say, which is an objection to an unspoken accusation. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Listen] or [But look]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:13 (#1)

24:13–14 is Saying 26 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:13 (#2)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 10:1.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:14 (#1)

כֵּ֭ן

“is} thus”

Here, **thus** indicates that the writer is comparing **wisdom** with honey, which was mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [is similar to honey]

See: Simile

Proverbs 24:14 (#2)

חָכְמָ֣ה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:14 (#3)

לְנַפְשֶׁ֑ךָ

“for your soul”

See how you translated the same use of **soul** in 2:10.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 24:14 (#4)

מָ֭צָאתָ

“you find {it”

See how you translated the same use of **find** in 16:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:14 (#5)

וְיֵ֣שׁ אַחֲרִ֣ית וְ֭תִקְוָתְךָ לֹ֣א תִכָּרֵֽת

“then there will be a future and your hope will not be cut off”

See how you translated the same clauses in 23:18.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:15 (#1)

24:15–16 is Saying 27 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:15 (#3)

רָ֭שָׁע & צַדִּ֣יק

“like} a wicked {one & the righteous”

See how you translated **a wicked one** in 9:9 and **the righteous** in 10:3.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:15 (#2)

אַל־תֶּאֱרֹ֣ב רָ֭שָׁע לְנִוֵּ֣ה צַדִּ֑יק

“Do not lie in wait {like} a wicked {one} against the abode of the righteous”

Here, the writer implies that someone would **lie in wait** in order to attack **the abode of the righteous one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Do not lie in wait like a wicked one to attack the abode of the righteous one]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:16 (#1)

שֶׁ֣שׁ

“seven {times”

Here, **seven times** is used to refer to multiple occurrences in general, not specifically **seven**. In Hebrew, **seven** often symbolizes the idea of completion. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [numerous times]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:16 (#2)

צַדִּ֣יק

“a righteous {one”

See how you translated **a righteous one** in 9:9.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:16 (#4)

יִכָּשְׁלוּ בְרָעָה

“stumble into calamity”

Here, the writer speaks of someone experiencing **calamity** as if that person stumbled into it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [experience calamity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:16 (#5)

בְרָעָה

“into calamity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:16 (#3)

יִפֹּל & וָקָם

“falls and rises up”

Here, the writer speaks of someone experiencing disaster as if that person **falls**, and he speaks of recovering from that disaster as if that person **rises up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will experience disaster and recover from it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:17 (#4)

לִבֶּךָ

“your heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [your spirit]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:17 (#2)

בִּנְפֹּל אויביך אַל־תִּשְׂמָח וּבִכָּשְׁלוֹ אַל־יָגֵל לִבֶּךָ

“When your enemy falls, do not be glad, and when he stumbles, do not let your heart rejoice”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [When your enemy falls, do not be glad; yes, when he stumbles, do not let your heart rejoice]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 24:17 (#1)

24:17–18 is Saying 28 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:17 (#3)

בִּנְפֹּל אויביך & וּבִכָּשְׁלוֹ

“When your enemy falls & and when he stumbles”

Here, **falls** and **stumbles** both refer to experiencing disaster. See how you translated the same use of **falls** and “stumble” in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:18 (#1)

פֶּן־יִרְאֶה יְהוָה וְרַע בְּעֵינָיו וְהֵשִׁשִׁיב מֵעָלָיו אַפּוֹ

“lest Yahweh see, and {it be} evil in his eyes, and he turn away his nose from upon him”

Here, **lest** indicates that what follows is what the writer does not want to happen, but it would happen if someone does not obey the instruction of verse 17. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise, Yahweh will see, and it will be evil in his eyes, and he may turn away his nose from upon him]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 24:18 (#5)

וְהֵשִׁשִׁיב מֵעָלָיו אַפּוֹ

“and he turn away his nose from upon him”

Here, **nose** refers to anger, as in 15:1. It also implies the punishment that Yahweh does to those with whom he is angry. Alternate translation: [and he ceases from being angry with him] or [and he ceases punishing him]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:18 (#2)

יִרְאֶה יְהוָה

“Yahweh see”

Here, **see** refers to perceiving something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh perceive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:18 (#4)

וְהֵשִׁ֖יב

“and he turn away”

Here, **and** introduces the result of something being **evil in his eyes**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [As a result, he will turn away]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 24:18 (#3)

וְרַ֥ע בְּעֵינָ֑יו

“and {it be} evil in his eyes”

The phrase **evil in his eyes** refers to having a negative opinion about something or someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **in his eyes** in 3:4. Alternate translation: [and he will think negatively of it]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:19 (#2)

אַל־תִּתְחַ֣ר

“Do not make yourself hot”

Here, **hot** refers to an intense emotion, which causes a person’s body to become **hot**. This emotion could be: (1) worry or anxiety. Alternate translation: [Do not make yourself fret]; (2) anger, as does “heat” in 6:34. Alternate translation: [Do not make yourself angry]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:19 (#1)

24:19–20 is Saying 29 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:20 (#4)

נֵ֣ר רְ֭שָׁעִים יִדְעָ֑ךְ

“the lamp of the wicked will be extinguished”

See how you translated the same clause in 13:9.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:20 (#2)

אַחֲרִ֥ית

“a future”

Here, the writer refers to **a future** that is good. See how you translated the same use of **future** in 23:18.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:20 (#3)

לָ֝רָ֗ע

“for an evil {one”

See how you translated **an evil one** in 17:11.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:20 (#1)

כִּֽי־

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 24:21 (#3)

וְ֝מֶ֗לֶךְ

“and the king”

See how you translated **the king** in 16:15.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:21 (#1)

24:21–22 is Saying 30 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:21 (#4)

שׁ֭שֹׁנִים

“ones who change”

Here, **ones who change** refers to people who **change** from respecting authorities, such as **Yahweh and the king**, to rebelling against them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [ones who rebel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:21 (#2)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:22 (#4)

וּפִ֣יד שְׁשְׁנֵיהֶ֣ם

“and & the destruction of the two of them”

the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **destruction** that is brought about by **the two of them**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how destructive the two of them can be]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:22 (#5)

שְׁשְׁנֵיהֶ֣ם

“the two of them”

This phrase refers to “Yahweh and the king” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh and the king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:22 (#2)

יָקֻ֑ומ

“will arise”

Here, the writer speaks of **calamity** occurring as if it were an object that arises. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will occur]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:22 (#3)

וּפִ֣יד שְׁשְׁנֵיהֶ֣ם מִ֭י יוֹדֵ֣עַ

“and who {is} knowing the destruction of the two of them”

The writer is using the question form to emphasize how terrible the **destruction** will be. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [and no one knows how terrible the destruction will be from the two of them!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 24:22 (#1)

אֵידָ֗ם

“their calamity”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:23 (#4)

בַּל־טֹ֑וב

“is} not good”

See how you translated the same use of **not good** in 16:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 24:23 (#3)

בְּמִשְׁפָּ֣ט

“in judgment”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [when judging]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:23 (#2)

הַכֵּר־פָּנִ֥ים

“Recognizing faces”

Recognizing faces is an idiom that means “to show partiality” or “to favor” someone. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “lift the face” in 18:5. Alternate translation: [Giving pride of place to certain people] or [Being partial to certain people]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:23 (#1)

גַּם־אֵ֣לֶּה לַחֲכָמִ֑ים

“These also {are} of the wise ones”

These here refers to a new collection of proverbs that continues from this verse to the last verse of this chapter. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The following proverbs are additional sayings of the wise ones]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:24 (#1)

אֹמֵ֣ר ׀ לָרָ֣שָׁע֮ & יְקֻבֻּ֪הוּ & יִזְעָמֻ֫הוּ

“One saying to a wicked {one & will curse him & will denounce him”

One who says, **the wicked one**, and **him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who says to any wicked person ... will curse that person ... will denounce that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:24 (#2)

אֹמֵ֣ר ׀ לָרָ֣שָׁע֮ צַדִּ֪יק אָ֫תָּה

“One saying to a wicked {one}, “You {are} righteous”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [One who says to a wicked one that he is righteous]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 24:24 (#5)

לְאֻמִּ֑ים

“nations”

Here, **nations** refers to the people who live in those **nations**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [entire nations of people]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:24 (#3)

לָרָ֣שָׁע֮ צַדִּ֪יק

“to a wicked {one & are} righteous”

In this verse, **wicked** refers to being guilty of doing something **wicked** and **righteous** refers to being innocent of doing something **wicked**. See how you translated the same use of **wicked** and **righteous** in 17:15.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:24 (#4)

עַמִּ֑ים

“peoples”

See how you translated the same use of **peoples** in 14:34.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 24:25 (#3)

וַעֲלֵיהֶ֥ם תָּבֹ֗וא בִּרְכַּ֣ת־טֽוֹב

“and over them will come a blessing of goodness”

Here, the writer refers to people experiencing a **blessing** as if it were a large covering that could **come over** those people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will experience a blessing of goodness]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:25 (#2)

יִנְעָ֑ם

“it will be pleasant”

Here, **it** refers to the lives of **the rebukers**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [life will be pleasant]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 24:25 (#1)

וְלַמּוֹכִיחִ֣ים

“But for the rebukers”

Here, **the rebukers** refers to judges who rightly condemn guilty people for the wicked things they have done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [But for those who convict the guilty ones]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:25 (#4)

בִּרְכַּ֣ת־טֽוֹב

“a blessing of goodness”

Here, the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **blessing** that is characterized by **goodness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a good blessing]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:26 (#1)

שְׂפָתַיִם יִשָּׁק

“He kisses lips”

Here, kissing someone’s **lips** is a symbolic action to show true friendship and loyalty. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [He confirms his loyalty by kissing one’s lips]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 24:26 (#2)

מֵשִׁיב דְּבָרִים נְכֹחִים

“who returns straightforward words”

Here the writer refers to someone speaking an honest reply to someone else as if he were returning **straightforward words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who speaks an honest reply]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:27 (#1)

הָכֵן בַּחוּץ ׀ מְלַאכְתֶּךָ וְעַתְּדָהּ בַּשָּׂדֶה לָךְ

“Prepare your work in the outdoors, and make it ready for yourself in the field”

The implication in this verse is that the primary work of men is farming. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Do your job outside and prepare your fields for farming]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:27 (#2)

וְאַחַר תִּבְנֶה בֵּיתֶךָ

“and after, you will build”

Solomon is using a future statement to give an instruction or command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command or instruction form. Alternate translation: [and only after, build]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Proverbs 24:28 (#2)

בִּשְׂפָתֶיךָ

“with your lips”

Here, **lips** refers to what people say by using their **lips**. See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [through the things you say]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:28 (#1)

וַהֲפִתִּיתָ בִּשְׂפָתֶיךָ

“And would you deceive with your lips”

The writer is using the question form to emphasize what a person should not do. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [And you should surely not deceive with your lips!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 24:29 (#2)

עָשָׂה & לוֹ & לְאִישׁ כְּפָעֳלוֹ

“he did & to him & to the man according to his deed”

Although **he**, **him**, **the man**, and **his** are masculine, the writer is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful, you could use phrases that make this clear in your language. Alternate translation: [a person did … to that person … to that person according to that person’s deed]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:29 (#3)

עָשָׂה & אֶעֱשֶׂה & כְּפָעֳלוֹ

“he did & I will do & according to his deed”

The speaker implies that this **deed** was something bad or harmful to the person speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he did something bad … I will do something bad … according to his bad deed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:29 (#1)

אַל־תֹּאמַר כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה־לִי כֵּן אֶעֱשֶׂה־לּוֹ אָשִׁיב לָאִישׁ כְּפָעֳלוֹ

“Do not say, “Just as he did to me, so I will do to him; I will return to the man according to his deed”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [Do not say that you will do to him just as he

did to you, or that you will return to the man according to his deed]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 24:30 (#2)

אָדָ֣ם חֲסַר־לֵֽב

“a man lacking of heart”

See how you translated this phrase in 17:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:30 (#1)

עַל־שְׂדֵ֣ה אִ֭ישׁ־עָצֵ֑ל עָבַ֥רְתִּי וְעַל־כֶּ֝֗רֶם אָדָ֥ם חֲסַר־לֵֽב

“I passed over the field of a lazy man and over the vineyard of a man lacking of heart”

Verses 24:30–24:34 are one long proverb that warns against being lazy.

Proverbs 24:31 (#2)

עָ֭לָה כֻּלּ֣וֹ ׀ קִמְשֹׂנִ֑ים

“all of it went up {with} thorns”

SPEAKER is using **all of it went up** as a common expression of his culture to mean “it was all overgrown.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of it was overgrown with thorns] or [thorns had grown up everywhere]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:31 (#6)

וְגֶ֖דֶר אַבְנָ֣יו

“and the wall of its stones”

Here the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **wall** that is made of **stones**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and the wall made of stones]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:31 (#1)

וְהִנֵּ֑ה

“And behold”

Here, **behold** is a term meant to focus the attention of the reader to what is about to happen next in the story. See how you translated the same use of **behold** in 7:10.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:31 (#3)

כֻּלּ֣וֹ & פָּנָ֑יו

“all of it & its face”

Here, **it** and **its** refer to all the land that includes both the field and vineyard mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [all of that land ... that land’s face]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 24:31 (#7)

נֶֽהֱרָסָ֥ה

“was torn down”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [had collapsed]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 24:31 (#5)

פָּנָ֑יו

“its face”

Here, **face** refers to the surface of the ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [its surface]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:31 (#4)

כָּסּ֥וּ פָ֝נָ֗יו חֲרֻלִּ֥ים

“its face was covered {with} weeds”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [weeds covered its face]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 24:32 (#5)

לָ֭קַחְתִּי מ֣וּסָ֑ר

“I received instruction”

The writer assumes that his readers will understand that what follows in the next two verses is the **instruction** he refers to here. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I received the following instruction] or [I learned the following lesson]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:32 (#2)

וְאֶחֱזֶה אֲנָֽכִי

“And I myself looked”

Here, the writer uses the word **myself** to emphasize the significance of his observations about the lazy person’s land. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [And I looked with my own eyes]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 24:32 (#3)

אָשִׁ֥ית לִבִּֽי

“I set my heart”

See how you translated the same use of “set your heart” in 22:17.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:32 (#4)

לָקַ֖חְתִּי מוּסָֽר

“I received instruction”

See how you translated the same use of **instruction** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:32 (#1)

וְאֶחֱזֶה אֲנָֽכִי & רָ֖אִיתִי

“And I myself looked & I saw”

The writer is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous two verses if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And I myself looked at that field and vineyard … I saw them]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 24:33 (#1)

מְעַ֣ט שֵׁנ֣וֹת מְעַ֣ט תְּנוּמ֣וֹת מְעַ֣ט חִבֻּ֣ק יָדַ֔יִם לִשְׁכָּֽב

“A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to lie down”

See how you translated the same clauses in 6:10.

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 24:34 (#1)

וּבָ֣א כִמְהַלֵּ֣ךְ רֵישֶׁ֑ךָ וּמַחְסֹרְךָ֖ כְּאִ֣ישׁ מָגֵֽן

“and your poverty will come {like} one who walks around, and your needs like a man of shield”

See how you translated the almost identical clauses in 6:11.

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs - Chapter 25 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Hezekiah’s proverbs from Solomon (25:1–29:27)

- Warnings and admonitions (25:1–27:27)
- Contrastive wise sayings (28:1–29:27)

Chapter 25 begins the section of the book containing proverbs written by Solomon that were copied by scribes during the reign of Hezekiah. This section contains two parts, the first part in 25:1–27:27 mostly contains proverbs that warn or admonish.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism
Chapters 25–27 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 25 also contains one instance of contrasting parallelism (25:2). (See: Parallelism)

Metaphors
Solomon uses many different metaphors in this chapter to warn his readers against acting unwisely. (See: Metaphor)

Proverbs 25:1 (#2)

מִשְׁלֵ֣י שְׁלֹמֹ֔ה

“are} proverbs of Solomon”

See how you translated **proverbs of Solomon** in 1:1.

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:1 (#4)

הֶעְתִּ֖יקוּ

“copied”

Here, **copied** implies that **the men of Hezekiah copied** these **proverbs** from a scroll that was written by **Solomon** or one of his scribes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [copied from a scroll written by Solomon]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:1 (#1)

גַּם־אֵ֣לֶּה מִשְׁלֵ֔י שְׁלֹמֹ֑ה

“These also {are} proverbs of Solomon”

These here refers to a new collection of proverbs that continues from this verse to the last verse of chapter 29. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The following proverbs are additional sayings of Solomon]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:1 (#3)

אַנְשֵׁ֖י ׀ חִזְקִיָּֽהוּ

“the men of Hezekiah”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the men** who served **Hezekiah**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the men who served Hezekiah]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:2 (#4)

חֲקֹ֥ר דָּבָֽר

“is} to search out a matter”

Here Solomon speaks of **kings** explaining **a matter** that is mysterious or difficult to understand as if they **search** for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is to explain a mysterious matter]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:2 (#1)

כְּבֹ֣ד & וּכְבֹ֔ד

“The glory of & but the glory of”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [What is glorious about ... but what is glorious about]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:2 (#3)

דָּבָ֑ר & דָּבָֽר

“a matter & a matter”

The word **matter** represents matters in general, not one particular **matter**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any matter ... that matter]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:2 (#2)

הַסְתֵּ֣ר דָּבָ֔ר

“is} to hide a matter”

Here Solomon speaks of God making **a matter** that is mysterious or difficult to understand as if he were hiding it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is to make a matter mysterious]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:3 (#4)

וְלֵ֣ב מְלָכִ֔ים אֵ֥ין חֵֽקֶר

“and the heart of kings is not searchable”

The word **heart** represents the hearts of kings in general, not one particular king’s **heart**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [and the hearts of kings are not searchable]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:3 (#1)

שָׁמַ֣יִם לָ֭רוּם וְאֶ֣רֶץ לָעֹ֑מֶק

“Heavens for height and earth for depth”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Heavens are an example of height and earth is an example of depth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 25:3 (#5)

וְלֵ֣ב

“and the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of “hearts” in 15:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:3 (#2)

לָֽרוּם & לָעֹ֣מֶק

“for height & for depth”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **height** and **depth**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [for what is high ... for what is deep]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:3 (#3)

וְלֵ֣בָ מְ֭לָכִים

“and the heart of kings”

Here, **and** introduces a comparison between what follows and what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that **the heart of kings** cannot be fully known, just like the extent of the **Heavens** and **earth** cannot be fully known. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way the heart of kings]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:3 (#6)

אֵ֣ין חֵֽקֶר

“is not searchable”

Here Solomon speaks of it being difficult to understand **the heart of kings** as if it were something that could not be searched for. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is difficult to comprehend]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:4 (#1)

סִיגִ֣ים

“dross”

The word **dross** refers to material in metal that people do not want, so **the refiner** removes the impurities by melting the metal and taking the **dross** out of the melted metal. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of process, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the unwanted material]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 25:4 (#2)

וְיֵצֵ֖א & כֶּ֣לִי

“and a vessel comes out”

The word translated **and** at the beginning of this clause indicates that the event in the previous clause happens before the event in the second clause can happen. Use a natural form in your language to introduce the next event in a story. Alternate translation: [before a vessel comes out] or [so then a vessel can come out]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Proverbs 25:4 (#4)

לַצּוֹרֵֽף

“for the refiner”

Here, **the refiner** refers to someone who removes unwanted material from metal by melting the metal and taking the **dross** out of the melted metal. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of person, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the person who removes unwanted material from metal]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 25:4 (#3)

וְיֵצֵ֖א לַצּוֹרֵ֑ף כֶּ֣לִי

“and a vessel comes out for the refiner”

Here Solomon refers to **the refiner** making **a vessel** from the **silver** mentioned in the previous clause as if that **vessel comes out** from the **silver**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a vessel is made by the refiner]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:5 (#1)

הָגְל֣וּ

“Remove”

In this verse, Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous verse. In the same way that “dross” must be removed from silver in order to make a vessel, **a wicked one** must be removed from **before the face of the king** in order for that king’s **throne** to **be established by righteousness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could

state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Similarly, remove] or [So also remove]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:5 (#2)

רָשָׁע & מֶלֶךְ & כִּסְאוֹ

“a wicked one & the king & his throne”

Here, **a wicked one**, **the king**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. See how you translated the same use of **a wicked one** in 9:7 and **the king** and **his** in 16:13.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:5 (#4)

וְיִכּוֹן בַּצֶּדֶק כִּסְאוֹ

“and his throne will be established by righteousness”

See how you translated the similar phrase “by righteousness is a throne established” in 16:12.

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 25:5 (#3)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 14:19.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:6 (#2)

לִפְנֵי־מֶלֶךְ

“to the face of the king”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:6 (#1)

אַל־תִּתְהַדַּר לִפְנֵי־מֶלֶךְ וּבִמְקוֹם גְּדֹלִים אַל־תַּעֲמֹד

“Do not honor yourself to the face of the king, and in the place of the great ones do not stand”

The two clauses in this verse say similar things, but the phrases in the second clause are in reverse order. This is a literary device called a chiasm. Here, the writer does this in order to emphasize the importance of not honoring yourself in front of kings. See the discussion of chiasms in the book introduction.

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 25:6 (#3)

וּבִמְקוֹם גְּדֹלִים אַל־תַּעֲמֹד

“and in the place of the great ones do not stand”

This could refer to: (1) considering oneself to be a **great** person who belongs to a group of **great ones**. Alternate translation: [and do not consider yourself to be one of the great ones] or [and do not consider yourself to be a great one]; (2) standing among a group of **great ones**. Alternate translation: [and among the great ones do not stand]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:7 (#8)

עֵינֶיךָ

“your eyes”

Here, **eyes** represents the ability of a person to see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly, as in the UST. See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 23:26.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:7 (#6)

לִפְנֵנִי

“to the face of”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:7 (#5)

מֵֽהַשְׁפִּיל לְךָ

“than to humiliate you”

Solomon implies that this humiliation is due to someone telling the person to move farther away from the king in order for more important people to be near him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [than to humiliate you by telling you to take a lower place]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:7 (#4)

מֵֽהַשְׁפִּיל לְךָ

“than to humiliate you”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [than for a person to humiliate you]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 25:7 (#2)

לְךָ֥ עֲלֵ֖ה הֵנָּ֑ה

“to you, “Come up here”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [to you that you should come up there]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 25:7 (#7)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר רָא֖וּ עֵינֶֽיךָ

“whom your eyes have seen”

This clause could refer to: (1) the **noble** mentioned in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [whom your eyes have observed]; (2) what someone sees that causes them to begin the dispute mentioned in the next verse, in which case **whom** would be translated as “what,” and this clause would start a new sentence that continues into the next verse. Alternate translation: [What your eyes have witnessed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:7 (#3)

עֲלֵ֖ה הֵנָּ֑ה

“Come up here”

Come up here means to move to a place near the king, which is a great honor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Come up here, near the king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:7 (#1)

טֹ֣וב אֱמֹר־לְךָ֗

“better to say to you”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [it is better for a person to say to you] or [it is better for the king to say to you]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 25:8 (#2)

מַה־תַּ֭עֲשֶׂה בְּאַחֲרִיתָ֑הּ בְּהַכְלִ֖ים אֹתְךָ֣ רֵעֶֽךָ

“what will you do in its end when your neighbor humiliates you”

Solomon is using the question form to make the reader consider what would happen if they lose the **dispute**. The way in which the neighbor might put the reader to shame can be stated plainly. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [you will not know what to do in its end when your neighbor humiliates you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 25:8 (#3)

בְּהַכְלִ֖ים אֹתְךָ֣ רֵעֶֽךָ

“when your neighbor humiliates you”

Solomon implies that **your neighbor humiliates you** because **you** lose the legal dispute. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [when you lose and your neighbor humiliates you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:8 (#1)

לָרֹ֑ב

“to dispute”

Here, **dispute** refers to arguing a legal case against someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to argue a legal case against your neighbor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:9 (#1)

רָ֭רִיבְךָ רִ֣יב

“Dispute your dispute”

Here, **Dispute your dispute** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that both come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis.

See: Poetry

Proverbs 25:9 (#4)

וְסֹ֣וד אַחֵ֣ר אַל־תְּגָלֶ֑ה

“and the secret of another do not uncover”

Here, **another** could refer to: (1) **your neighbor**. Alternate translation: [and the secret of that neighbor]; (2) someone other than **your neighbor**, which would indicate telling someone else’s **secret** to win the **dispute** against one’s **neighbor**. Alternate translation: [and the secret of another person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:9 (#2)

רִ֭יבְךָ רִ֣יב

“Dispute your dispute”

Dispute is an imperative, but it introduces a conditional situation. Use a form in your language that communicates this, such as in the UST.

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 25:9 (#3)

וְסֹ֣וד אַחֵ֣ר אַל־תְּגָלֶ֑ה

“and the secret of another do not uncover”

See how you translated the similar phrase “uncovering a secret” in 11:13.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:10 (#4)

לֹ֣א תָשִׁ֑וב

“not turn back”

Here Solomon speaks of a **rumor**, meaning the news that a secret has been betrayed, as if it were a person who continues to travel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [spreads continually]

See: Personification

Proverbs 25:10 (#5)

לֹ֣א תָשִׁ֑וב

“not turn back”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will keep going] or [will continue to spread]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 25:10 (#3)

וְ֝דִבָּתְךָ֗

“and the rumor {of} you”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rumor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and what is rumored about you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:10 (#2)

שֹׁמֵֽעַ

“one who hears”

Here, **one who hears** represents a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [anyone hears]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:10 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

Here, **lest** indicates that what follows would be an undesirable outcome of doing what Solomon prohibited in the previous verse. See how you translated the same use of **lest** in 24:18.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 25:11 (#6)

דְּבֵרָ֣ר

“spoken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone speaks]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 25:11 (#7)

עַל־אָפְנָ֑יו

“according to its circumstance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **circumstance**, you could express the same

idea in another way. Alternate translation: [appropriately]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:11 (#4)

בְּמַשְׂכִּיּוֹת כָּסֶף

“in sculptures of silver”

Here, the word translated as **sculptures** refers to **silver** that someone carved into a beautiful shape. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in beautiful carvings of silver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:11 (#5)

דְּבָרָ֑ר

“is} a word”

Here, **word** refers to what someone speaks by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is something] or [are words]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:11 (#1)

תַּפּוּחֵי זָהָב בְּמַשְׂכִּיּוֹת כָּסֶף דָּבָר דָּבֻר עַל־אָפְנָיו

“Apples of gold in sculptures of silver {is} a word spoken according to its circumstance”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A word spoken according to its circumstance is apples of gold in sculptures of silver]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:11 (#3)

תַּפּוּחֵי זָהָב בְּמַשְׂכִּיּוֹת כָּסֶף

“Apples of gold in sculptures of silver”

Here Solomon is using possessive forms to describe **Apples** made from **gold** and **sculptures** made from **silver**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use different expressions. Alternate translation: [Apples made of gold in sculptures made of silver]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:11 (#2)

תַּפּוּחֵי זָהָב בְּמַשְׂכִּיּוֹת כָּסֶף

“Apples of gold in sculptures of silver”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a word spoken according to its circumstance** pleasing those who hear it as if it were **Apples of gold in sculptures of silver**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very pleasing] or [Like apples of gold in sculptures of silver]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:12 (#5)

אׇזֶן שֹׁמַעַת

“a listening ear”

Here, **a listening ear** refers to someone who not only hears the rebuke, but accepts it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **ear** in 18:15. Alternate translation: [someone who accepts it]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:12 (#3)

נֶזֶם זָהָב וַחֲלִי־כָתֶם

“A ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold”

Here Solomon is using possessive forms to describe a **ring** made from **gold** and **jewelry** made from **fine gold**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use different expressions. Alternate translation: [A ring made of gold and jewelry made of fine gold]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:12 (#4)

מוֹכִיחַ חָכָם עַל

“is} a wise rebuke to”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rebuke**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is when someone wisely corrects]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:12 (#2)

נֶזֶם זָהָב וַחֲלִי־כָתֶם

“A ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a wise rebuke** being valuable to those who hear it as if it were **A ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold**. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very valuable] or [Like a ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:12 (#1)

נֶזֶם זָהָב וְחִלְיֵי־כָתֶם מוֹכִיחַ חָכָם עַל־אׇזֶן שֹׁמַעַת

“A ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold {is} a wise rebuke to a listening ear”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A wise rebuke to a listening ear is a ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:13 (#2)

בְּיוֹם קָצִיר

“in the day of harvest”

Here, **day** refers to a period of time when something happens. It does not refer to a single 24-hour length of time. This probably refers to the time of the wheat and barley harvest in May-June, when the weather is hot and snow very unlikely, which is why it would be welcome and refreshing. See how you translated the same use of **day** in 21:31.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:13 (#3)

צִיר נֶאֱמָן לְשֹׁלְחָיו וְנֶפֶשׁ אֲדֹנָיו יָשִׁיב

“is} a faithful envoy for his senders, and he brings back the life of his masters”

Here, **a faithful envoy**, **his**, and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [is any faithful envoy for that person’s senders, and that brings back the life of that person’s masters]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:13 (#4)

וְנֶפֶשׁ אֲדֹנָיו יָשִׁיב

“and he brings back the life of his masters”

The phrase **brings back the life** is an idiom that refers to causing a tired person to feel refreshed or strong again. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he causes his masters to feel refreshed]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 25:13 (#1)

כְּצִנַּת־שֶׁלֶג ׀ בְּיוֹם קָצִיר

“Like the coolness of snow in the day of harvest”

Here Solomon compares **a faithful envoy** to **the coolness of snow on the day of harvest** because both are refreshing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly: Alternate translation: [Very refreshing] or [Refreshing like the coolness of snow in the day of harvest]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:14 (#2)

נְשִׂיאִים וְרוּחַ וְגֶשֶׁם אָיִן

“Clouds and wind but without rain”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **the man who boasts in a gift of falsehood** being disappointing as if he were **Clouds and wind but without rain**. Clouds and wind usually indicate that there will also be rain, so **Clouds and wind without rain** would disappoint farmers who need rain for their crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very disappointing] or [Like clouds and wind but no rain]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:14 (#4)

בְּמַתַּת־שֶׁקֶר

“in a gift of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **gift** that is characterized by **falsehood**. This refers to a **gift** the someone promises to give but does not give. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [in a false gift] or [in a gift that he falsely promises to give]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:14 (#3)

אִישׁ

“is} the man”

The word **man** represents people in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use

a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [is any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:14 (#1)

נְשִׂיאִים וְרוּחַ וְגֶשֶׁם אָיִן אִישׁ מִתְהַלֵּל בְּמַתַּת־שָׁקֶר

“Clouds and wind but without rain {is} the man who boasts in a gift of falsehood”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [The man who boasts in a gift of falsehood is clouds and wind but without rain]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:15 (#1)

בְּאֹרֶךְ אַפַּיִם

“By length of nostrils”

The phrase **length of nostrils** refers to being patient and not getting angry quickly. The word **nostrils** means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose, causing his **nostrils** to open wide. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. See how you translated the similar phrase “long of nostrils” in 14:29. Alternate translation: [By keeping a cool head] or [By not getting angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 25:15 (#5)

תִּשְׁבָּר־גֶּרֶם

“can break a bone”

Here Solomon speaks of overcoming strong opposition as if someone were breaking **a bone**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [can overcome strong opposition]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:15 (#4)

וְלָשׁוֹן רַכָּה

“and a soft tongue”

Here Solomon is speaking of something spoken in a gentle manner as if someone were speaking with a **soft tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and speaking gently]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:15 (#2)

יְפֻתֶּה קָצִין

“a commander may be persuaded”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone may persuade a commander]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 25:15 (#3)

קָצִין וְלָשׁוֹן רַכָּה תִּשְׁבָּר־גֶּרֶם

“a commander & and a soft tongue can break a bone”

Here, **a commander**, **a soft tongue**, and **a bone** refer to these people and things in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any commander ... and any soft tongue can break bones]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:16 (#3)

פֶּן־תִּתְּשְׂבָּעֶנּוּ וְהַקֵּאתְוֹ

“lest you become satiated with it and you vomit it up”

Solomon is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise you will become satiated with it and vomit it up]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 25:16 (#1)

דְּבַשׁ מָצָאתָ

“If} you find honey”

Here Solomon refers to someone unexpectedly discovering **wild honey**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [If you happen to come across honey]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:16 (#4)

תִּתְּשְׂבָּעֶנּוּ

“you become satiated with it”

Here, the word translated as **satiated** refers to someone overeating to the degree that he becomes sick. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you eat yourself sick with it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:16 (#2)

אֶכְלְךָ דַּיֶּיךָ

“eat enough {for} you”

Here Solomon implies that someone should only **eat enough** and not more than that. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [only eat enough for you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:17 (#5)

יִּשְׂבָּעֲךָ

“he become satiated with you”

Here, Solomon is comparing the visitor to a food of which the neighbor has eaten too much. This expression refers to people being annoyed with someone because that person visits them too frequently. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. If your language has a word that can be used for both this occurrence of **satiated** and the occurrence in the previous verse, consider using it here. Alternate translation: [he become sick of you] or [he become tired of seeing you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:17 (#4)

מִבֵּית רֵעֶךָ פֶּן־יִּשְׂבָּעֲךָ

“from the house of your neighbor, lest he become satiated with you”

Here, **your neighbor** and **he** refer to neighbors in general, not a specific **neighbor**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [from any house of any of your neighbors, lest that neighbor become satiated with you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:17 (#2)

הַקֶּר רַגְלְךָ מִבֵּית רֵעֶךָ

“Make rare your foot from the house of your neighbor”

Alternate translation: [Prevent your foot from frequently being in the house of your neighbor]

Proverbs 25:17 (#1)

הַקֶּר

“Make rare”

In this verse, Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous verse. In the same way that a person must not eat too much honey, a person must also avoid visiting his neighbor’s house too frequently. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Similarly, make rare] or [So also make rare]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:17 (#3)

רַגְלְךָ

“your foot”

Here, **foot** represents the whole person. See how you translated the similar use of **foot** in 1:15.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 25:18 (#2)

מַפִּיץ וְחֶרֶב וְחֵץ שָׁנוּן

“A hammer and a sword and a sharp arrow”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a man who answers a testimony of falsehood against his neighbor** being deadly as if he were **A hammer and a sword and a sharp arrow**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very deadly] or [Like a hammer and a sword and a sharp arrow]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:18 (#3)

אִישׁ עֹנֶה בְרֵעֵהוּ

“is} a man who answers & against his neighbor”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this

clear. Alternate translation: [is a person who answers ... against that person's neighbor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 25:18 (#4)

עֹנֶה בְרֵעֵהוּ עֵד שָׁקֶר

"who answers a testimony of falsehood against his neighbor"

In the original language, the words translated as **answers** and **against** mean "testifies against." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who testifies against his neighbor with a testimony of falsehood]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:18 (#1)

מַפִּיץ וְחֶרֶב וְחֵץ שָׁנוּן אִישׁ עֹנֶה בְרֵעֵהוּ עֵד שָׁקֶר

"A hammer and a sword and a sharp arrow {is} a man who answers a testimony of falsehood against his neighbor"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A man who answers a testimony of falsehood against his neighbor is a hammer and a sword and a sharp arrow]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:18 (#5)

עֵד שָׁקֶר

"a testimony of falsehood"

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **testimony** that is characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a false testimony]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:19 (#3)

מִבְטָחָה

"is} confidence"

See how you translated the abstract noun **confidence** in 3:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:19 (#4)

בֹּגֵד

"in} one who acts treacherously"

See how you translated **one who acts treacherously** in 21:18.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:19 (#5)

בְּיוֹם צָרָה

"in the day of distress"

See how you translated this phrase in 24:10.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:19 (#2)

שֵׁן רֹעָה וְרֶגֶל מוּעָדֶת

"A broken tooth and a shaky foot"

In this verse, Solomon speaks of the uselessness of having **confidence** in a treacherous person as if that **confidence** were **A broken tooth and a shaky foot**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very useless] or [Like a broken tooth and a shaky foot]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:19 (#1)

שֵׁן רֹעָה וְרֶגֶל מוּעָדֶת מִבְטָחָה בֹּגֵד בְּיוֹם צָרָה

"A broken tooth and a shaky foot {is} confidence {in} one who acts treacherously in the day of distress"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Confidence in one who acts treacherously in the day of distress is a broken tooth and a shaky foot]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:20 (#4)

חֹמֶץ עַל־נָתֶר

"vinegar on natron"

The substance **natron** is a naturally-occurring mineral salt that is mostly sodium carbonate. In the ancient world, it was used for cleaning and some other things. When mixed with **vinegar**, it causes a violent chemical reaction. Therefore, this clause refers to two things that should not be put together. If your readers would not be familiar with these two materials, you could use the names of similar things in your area, or you

could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [chemicals that react violently when put together]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 25:20 (#8)

לֵ֖ב־רָֽע

“a heart of misery”

Here, **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [a miserable person]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:20 (#1)

מַעֲדֶ֤ה בֶּ֙גֶד֙ ׀ בְּי֣וֹם קָ֔רָה חֹ֖מֶץ עַל־נָ֑תֶר וְשָׁ֥ר בַּשִּׁרִ֖ים עַ֥ל לֵֽב־רָֽע

“One removing a garment on a cold day, vinegar on natron, so {is} a singer with songs to a heart of misery”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One who sings with songs to a heart of misery is like one who removes a garment on a cold day, vinegar on natron]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:20 (#3)

מַעֲדֶ֤ה בֶּ֙גֶד֙

“One removing a garment”

Here Solomon implies that **a garment** is removed from someone’s body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who removes a garment from someone’s body]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:20 (#7)

לֵ֖ב־רָֽע

“a heart of misery”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **heart** that is characterized by **misery**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a miserable heart]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:20 (#6)

וְשָׁ֥ר בַּשִּׁרִֽים

“so {is} a singer with songs”

Here, **sings with songs** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis.

See: Poetry

Proverbs 25:20 (#5)

וְשָׁ֥ר בַּשִּׁרִ֖ים עַ֥ל לֵֽב־רָֽע

“so {is} a singer with songs to a heart of misery”

Solomon is saying that **one who sings with songs to a heart of misery** is like **One who removes a garment on a cold day** and like **vinegar on natron**, because all of these are inappropriate and unhelpful when put together. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [so also is one who sings with songs to a heart of misery inappropriate]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:20 (#2)

מַעֲדֶ֤ה בֶּ֙גֶד֙ & וְשָׁ֥ר & לֵֽב־רָֽע

“One removing a garment & so {is} a singer & a heart of misery”

One who removes a garment, **one who sings**, and **a heart of misery** refer to types of people and hearts in general, not specific people or a specific **heart**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who removes a garment ... so is any person who sings ... any heart of misery]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:21 (#1)

שֹׂנַאֲךָ֣ הַאֲכִלֵ֔הוּ & הַשְׁקֵ֖הוּ מָֽיִם

“one who hates you & cause him to eat & cause him to drink water”

Here, **one who hates you** and **him** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who hates you ... cause that person to eat ... cause that person to drink water]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:21 (#2)

לֶ֖חֶם

“bread”

Here, **bread** is used to refer to food in general. See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 25:22 (#1)

גָּחָלִ֥ים אַתָּ֛ה חֹתֶ֖ה עַל־רֹאשׁ֑וֹ

“you are heaping embers on his head”

Here, Solomon is speaking of causing an enemy to feel the pain of shame and embarrassment as if he were causing the physical pain of **heaping embers on his head**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [you are causing him to feel ashamed for what he has done] or [you are making him feel ashamed, as if you were heaping embers on his head]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:22 (#2)

יְשַׁלֶּם־לָ֖ךְ

“will repay to you”

See how you translated the same use of **repay** in 19:17.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:23 (#1)

רַ֥ח צָפ֖וֹן

“The wind of the north”

Here, **wind of the north** refers to cold **wind** that came from **the north**. In Israel, this type of **wind** often brought rain. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The cold wind that comes from the north]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:23 (#4)

וּפָנִ֣ים נִזְעָמִ֑ים

“and indignant faces”

Here, **faces** refers to the people whose faces show that they are **indignant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and indignant people]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:23 (#3)

וּפָנִ֣ים נִזְעָמִ֑ים

“and indignant faces”

In this verse, Solomon compares **The wind of the north** bringing **rain** to **a tongue of secrecy** bringing **indignant faces**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly: Alternate translation: [and similarly, indignant faces]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:23 (#2)

וּפָנִ֣ים נִזְעָמִ֑ים לְשׁ֖וֹן סֵתֶ֣ר

“and indignant faces, a tongue of secrecy”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. Here, the first phrase is the result of the second phrase. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a tongue of secrecy brings forth indignant faces] or [and a tongue of secrecy causes indignant faces]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 25:23 (#5)

לְשׁ֖וֹן סֵתֶ֣ר

“a tongue of secrecy”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **a tongue** that tells the secrets of others. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a tongue that tells the secrets of others]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:23 (#6)

לְשׁ֖וֹן סֵתֶ֣ר

“a tongue of secrecy”

Here, **tongue** refers to the person who speaks with his tongue. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a person who tells secrets]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 25:24 (#1)

טֹ֣וב שֶׁ֭שֶׁבֶת עַל־פִּנַּ֣ת גָּ֑גג מֵאֵ֥שֶׁת מִדֹונִ֗ים וּבְבֵ֣ית חָבֶֽר

“Better to dwell on the corner of a roof than {with} a wife of quarrels and a house of companionship”

See how you translated the same sentence in 21:9.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:25 (#2)

נֶ֣פֶשׁ עֲיֵפָ֑ה

“a weary soul”

Here Solomon implies that this **soul** is **weary** with thirst. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a soul weary from thirst]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:25 (#4)

וּשְׁמוּעָ֥ה טוֹבָ֖ה מֵאֶ֥רֶץ מֶרְחָֽק

“so {is} good news from a distant land”

Solomon is saying that **good news from a distant land** is like **Cool water over a weary soul** because both of these are refreshing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [so also is good news from a distant land refreshing]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:25 (#3)

נֶ֣פֶשׁ

“a & soul”

See how you translated the same use of **soul** in 2:10.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 25:25 (#1)

מַ֭יִם קָרִ֣ים עַל־נֶ֣פֶשׁ עֲיֵפָ֑ה וּשְׁמוּעָ֥ה טוֹבָ֖ה מֵאֶ֥רֶץ מֶרְחָֽק

“Cool water over a weary soul, so {is} good news from a distant land”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Good news from a distant land is like cool water over a weary soul]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:25 (#5)

וּשְׁמוּעָ֥ה טוֹבָֽה

“so {is} good news”

See how you translated **good news** in 15:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:26 (#5)

מָ֑ט

“swaying”

Here, **swaying** refers to **a righteous one** yielding to the influence of **a wicked one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who yields] or [who gives in]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:26 (#2)

מַעְיָ֣ן נִ֭רְפָּשׁ וּמָקֹ֣ור מָשְׁחָ֑ת

“A spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a righteous one swaying before the face of a wicked one** being bad as if that person were **A spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very bad] or [Like a spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:26 (#1)

מַעְיָ֣ן נִ֭רְפָּשׁ וּמָקֹ֣ור מָשְׁחָ֑ת צַ֝דִּ֗יק מָ֥ט לִפְנֵי־רָשָֽׁע

“A spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled {is} a righteous {one} swaying to the face of a wicked {one”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A righteous one swaying before the face of a wicked one is a spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:26 (#4)

צַ֝דִּ֗יק & רָשָֽׁע

“is} a righteous {one & a wicked {one”

See how you translated **a righteous one** in 9:9 and **a wicked one** in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:26 (#6)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See how you translated the same use of **to the face of** in 14:19.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:26 (#3)

מַעְיָ֣ן נָ֭רְפָּשׁ וּמָקֹ֣ור מָשְׁחָ֑ת

“A spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [A spring someone muddied by trampling and a fountain someone spoiled]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 25:27 (#3)

וְחֵ֖קֶר

“also the searching out {of”

In this verse, Solomon compares eating **much honey** to **searching out** one’s own **honor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly: Alternate translation: [and similarly, the searching out of]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:27 (#1)

לֹא־טֹ֣וב

“is} not good”

See how you translated the same use of **not good** in 16:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 25:27 (#4)

וְחֵ֖קֶר כְּבֹדָ֑ם

“also the searching out {of} their honor”

Here Solomon speaks of someone trying to get other people to **honor** him as if **honor** were an object that a person could search for. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and trying to make other people honor you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:27 (#2)

וְחֵ֖קֶר כְּבֹדָ֑ם כָּבֹֽוד

“also the searching out {of} their honor, honor”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the searching out of their honor is not honor]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 25:28 (#2)

עִ֣יר פְּ֭רוּצָה אֵ֣ין חֹומָ֑ה

“A breached city without a wall”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a man who has no restraint for his spirit** being defenseless or unprotected as if that person were **A breached city without a wall**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very defenseless] or [Like a breached city without a wall]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:28 (#3)

עִ֣יר פְּ֭רוּצָה אֵ֣ין חֹומָ֑ה

“A breached city without a wall”

Here Solomon implies that there is no **wall** because it was broken down when people **breached** the **city**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [A city whose walls an army has knocked down]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:28 (#5)

אֲשֶׁ֖ר אֵ֣ין מַעְצָ֑ר לְרוּחֹֽו

“who has no restraint for his spirit”

Here Solomon refers to someone who lacks self-control as if that person were not able to restrain **his spirit**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who has no self-control]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:28 (#4)

אִ֭ישׁ & לְרוּחֹֽו

“is} a man & for his spirit”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear in your language. Alternate translation: [is a person ... for that person's spirit]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 25:28 (#1)

עִ֭יר פְּרוּצָ֣ה אֵ֑ין חוֹמָ֥ה אִ֝֗ישׁ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אֵ֣ין מַעְצָ֣ר לְרוּחֽוֹ

"A breached city without a wall {is} a man who has no restraint for his spirit"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A man who has no restraint for his spirit is a breached city without a wall]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs - Chapter 26 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Hezekiah's proverbs from Solomon (25:1–29:27)

- Warnings and admonitions (25:1–27:27)
- Contrastive wise sayings (28:1–29:27)

Chapter 26 continues the section of the book containing proverbs written by Solomon that were copied by scribes during the reign of Hezekiah. This section contains two parts, the first part in 25:1–27:27 mostly contains proverbs that warn or admonish.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 25–27 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 26 contains only this type of parallelism. (See: Parallelism)

Similes

Solomon uses many different similes in this chapter to warn his readers against acting unwisely. (See: Simile)

Proverbs 26:1 (#1)

כַּשֶּׁ֣לֶג ׀ בַּקַּ֣יִץ וְכַמָּטָ֣ר בַּקָּצִ֑יר כֵּ֥ן לֹא־נָ֝א֗וָה לִכְסִ֥יל כָּבֽוֹד

"Like the snow in the summer and like the rain in the harvest, so honor {is} not suitable for a stupid one"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Honor is not suitable for a stupid one like the snow in the summer and like the rain in the harvest]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:1 (#3)

כַּשֶּׁ֣לֶג ׀ בַּקַּ֣יִץ וְכַמָּטָ֣ר בַּקָּצִ֑יר

"Like the snow in the summer and like the rain in the harvest"

The words **Like** and **so** in this verse indicate that Solomon is comparing **snow in the summer** and **rain in the harvest** with **honor for a stupid one**. The point is that all three of these are **not suitable** or inappropriate. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [Just as the snow in the summer or the rain in the harvest are not suitable]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:1 (#2)

כַּשֶּׁ֣לֶג ׀ בַּקַּ֣יִץ וְכַמָּטָ֣ר בַּקָּצִ֑יר & לִכְסִ֥יל

"Like the snow in the summer and like the rain in the harvest & for a stupid one"

Here, **the snow**, **the summer**, **the rain**, **the harvest**, and **a stupid one**, refer to these things and that type of person in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [Like any snow in any summer and like any rain in any harvest ... for any stupid person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:1 (#4)

כָּבֽוֹד

"honor"

See how you translated the abstract noun **honor** in 3:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:2 (#6)

לֹא תָבֹֽא

"does not come"

Here Solomon speaks of a person not being affected by **a curse** as if that **curse** were a person who **does not come**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [does not occur]

See: Personification

Proverbs 26:2 (#5)

כַּדְּרוֹר

“like the swallow”

A **swallow** is a small bird that quickly flies back and forth. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [as the quickly moving small bird]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 26:2 (#4)

כַּצִּפּוֹר לָנוּד כַּדְּרוֹר לָעוּף

“Like the bird for fluttering, like the swallow for flying”

The phrases **the bird for fluttering** and **the swallow for flying** mean similar things. Solomon is using the two phrases together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [As birds that are flying around]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 26:2 (#2)

כַּצִּפּוֹר לָנוּד כַּדְּרוֹר לָעוּף כֵּן קְלָלַת

“Like the bird for fluttering, like the swallow for flying, so a curse”

Here, **the bird**, **the swallow**, and **a curse** refer to these things in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Like any bird for fluttering, and like any swallow for flying, so any curse]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:2 (#3)

כַּצִּפּוֹר לָנוּד כַּדְּרוֹר לָעוּף

“Like the bird for fluttering, like the swallow for flying”

The words **Like** and **so** in this verse indicate that Solomon is comparing **the bird for fluttering** and **the swallow for flying** with **a curse without cause**. The point is that **a curse** does not affect a person who does not deserve it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [Just like the fluttering bird and the flying swallow do not land]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:2 (#1)

כַּצִּפּוֹר לָנוּד כַּדְּרוֹר לָעוּף כֵּן קְלָלַת חִנָּם לֹא תָבֹא

“Like the bird for fluttering, like the swallow for flying, so a curse without cause does not come”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A curse without cause does not come, like the bird for fluttering, like the swallow for flying]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:3 (#2)

שׁוֹט לַסּוּס מֶתֶג לַחֲמוֹר וְשֵׁבֶט לְגֵו כְּסִילִים

“A whip for the horse, a bridle for the donkey, and a rod for the back of stupid ones”

A whip, **the horse**, **a bridle**, **the donkey**, **a rod**, and **the back** refer to these things and animals in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Whips are for horses, bridles are for donkeys, and rods are for backs of stupid ones]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:3 (#1)

שׁוֹט לַסּוּס מֶתֶג לַחֲמוֹר וְשֵׁבֶט לְגֵו כְּסִילִים

“A whip for the horse, a bridle for the donkey, and a rod for the back of stupid ones”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A whip is for the horse, a bridle is for the donkey, and a rod is for the back of stupid ones]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 26:3 (#4)

וְשֵׁבֶט לְגֵו

“and a rod for the back of”

See how you translated the same use of **rod for the back** in 10:13.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:3 (#3)

וְשֵׁבֶט

“and a rod”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that people must hit **stupid ones** with **a rod** in order to control them, just like they must use a **whip** to control horses and a **bridle** to control donkeys. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way a rod]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:4 (#4)

פֶּן־תִּשָּׁוֶה־לּוֹ גַּם־אָתָּה

“lest you yourself also become like him”

Solomon is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the instruction to **not answer a stupid one** so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise you might become like him]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 26:4 (#3)

כְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ

“according to his folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:4 (#1)

כְּכֶסִיל כְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ & לֹא

“a stupid one according to his folly & him”

Here, **a stupid one**, **his**, and **him** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [any stupid person according to that person’s folly ... that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:4 (#5)

תִּשָּׁוֶה & גַּם־אָתָּה

“you yourself also become like”

Solomon uses the word **yourself** to emphasize how important it is to not **become like a stupid one**. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [even you become like]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 26:4 (#2)

כְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ

“according to his folly”

This could mean: (1) **according to** the reasoning of **a stupid one**. Alternate translation: [according to his foolish reasoning]; (2) in the same manner as **a stupid one**. Alternate translation: [in a foolish manner]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:4–5 (#1)

אַל־תַּתַּעַן כְּכֶסִיל כְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ & עֲנֵה כְכֶסִיל כְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ

“Do not answer a stupid one according to his folly & Answer a stupid one according to his folly”

These two proverbs appear to contradict each other. It may be that we are to understand the command in 24:4 to apply in some situations and the command in 24:5 to apply in other situations. Or it may be that we are to understand **according to his folly** in different senses in the two verses, such as “Do not answer a stupid one with more of the same foolishness” in verse 4, and “Answer a stupid one who is saying foolish things” in verse 5. But it appears that Solomon intended his readers to read the same words and to ponder how both could be true.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:5 (#3)

פֶּן־יִהְיֶה חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו

“lest he become wise in his eyes”

Solomon is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the instruction to **Answer a stupid one** so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise he might become wise in his eyes]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 26:5 (#2)

כְּסִיל כְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ

“a stupid one according to his folly”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:5 (#4)

חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו

“wise in his eyes”

See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 3:7.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:5 (#1)

כְּסִיל כְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ פֶּן־יִהְיֶה חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו

“a stupid one according to his folly, lest he become wise in his eyes”

Here, **a stupid one**, **his**, and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [any stupid person according to that person’s folly, lest that person become wise in that person’s own eyes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:6 (#1)

מְקַצֶּצָה רַגְלַיִם חָמָס שֹׁתֶה שֹׁלֵחַ דְּבָרִים בְּיַד־כְּסִיל

“One cutting off feet, one drinking violence, {is} one sending words by the hand of a stupid {one”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One who sends words by the hand of a stupid one is one who cuts off feet, one who drinks violence]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:6 (#7)

בְּיַד־כְּסִיל

“by the hand of a stupid {one”

Here, **hand** represents the control that a person has. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the care of a stupid one]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 26:6 (#5)

חָמָס

“violence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **violence** in 3:31.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:6 (#2)

מְקַצֶּצָה רַגְלַיִם חָמָס שֹׁתֶה שֹׁלֵחַ דְּבָרִים בְּיַד־כְּסִיל

“One cutting off feet, one drinking violence, {is} one sending words by the hand of a stupid {one”

One who cuts off, **one who drinks**, **one who sends**, **the hand**, and **a stupid one** refer to types of people and hands in general, not specific people or a specific **hand**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [Any person who cuts off feet, any person who drinks violence, is any person who sends words by a hand of any stupid person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:6 (#6)

שֹׁלֵחַ דְּבָרִים

“is} one sending words”

Here Solomon refers to a message that is communicated by using **words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is one who sends a message]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:6 (#3)

מְקַצֶּצָה רַגְלַיִם חָמָס שֹׁתֶה

“One cutting off feet, one drinking violence”

Here Solomon implies that a person **cuts off** his own **feet** and **drinks violence** against himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who cuts off his own feet, one who drinks violence against himself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:6 (#4)

מְקַצֶּצָה רַגְלַיִם חָמָס שֹׁתֶה

“One cutting off feet, one drinking violence”

Here Solomon refers to someone who does something that harms himself as if that person **cuts off** his own **feet** and **drinks violence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [One who harms himself] or [Like one who cuts off his feet or drinks violence]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:7 (#1)

דַּלְיָיו

“dangle”

Here Solomon implies that these **Legs dangle** uselessly because the legs of **a lame one** do not function. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [dangle uselessly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:7 (#3)

וּמָשָׁל

“and a proverb”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that **a proverb in the mouth of stupid ones** is like the **Legs** of **a lame one** because it is useless. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way a proverb]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:7 (#4)

וּמָשָׁל בְּפִי

“and a proverb in the mouth of”

Here, **a proverb** and **the mouth** refer to proverbs and mouths in general, not a specific **proverb** or **mouth**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any proverb in the mouths of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:7 (#2)

וּמָשָׁל

“and a proverb”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a proverb dangles]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 26:7 (#5)

וּמָשָׁל בְּפִי

“and a proverb in the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** refers to what a person says by using his **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a proverb spoken by]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:8 (#2)

כִּצְרֹר אֶבֶן בְּמַרְגֵּמָה

“Like tying a stone in a sling”

The words **Like** and **so** in this verse indicate that Solomon is comparing **tying a stone in a sling** with giving **honor to a stupid one**. The point is that both of these are useless. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [Just as tying a stone in a sling is useless]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:8 (#3)

כִּצְרֹר אֶבֶן בְּמַרְגֵּמָה

“Like tying a stone in a sling”

A **sling** is a weapon used to throw **a stone** at someone. The act of **tying a stone in a sling** would make that **sling** useless. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of weapon, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [Like tying an arrow to a bow] or [Like a weapon that cannot hurt anyone]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 26:8 (#5)

לִכְסִיל

“to a stupid one”

See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:8 (#4)

נוֹתֵן & כָּבוֹד

“is} one who gives honor”

Here Solomon refers to honoring someone as if **honor** were an object that someone **gives** to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is one who honors]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:8 (#1)

כִּצְרֹר֣וֹר אֶ֭בֶן בְּמַרְגֵּמָ֑ה כֵּן־נוֹתֵ֖ן לִכְסִ֣יל כָּבֽוֹד

“Like tying a stone in a sling, so {is} one who gives honor to a stupid one”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One who gives honor to a stupid one is like tying a stone in a sling]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:9 (#2)

וּמָשָׁ֥ל

“and a proverb”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a proverb goes up]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 26:9 (#1)

חֹ֭חַ עָלָ֣ה בְיַד־שִׁכּ֑וֹר

“A thorn goes up into the hand of a drunkard”

This could refer to: (1) **a drunkard** picking up a thorn or a thorn bush to swing it at people (the word translated as **thorn** could also refer to a thorn bush). Alternate translation: [A thorn bush waved around in the hand of a drunkard]; (2) a thorn pricking the hand of **a drunkard**. Alternate translation: [A thorn pricking the hand of a drunkard]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 26:9 (#4)

וּמָשָׁ֥ל בְּפִ֖י כְּסִילִֽים

“and a proverb in the mouth of stupid ones”

See how you translated this clause in 26:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:9 (#3)

וּמָשָׁ֥ל

“and a proverb”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that **a proverb in the mouth of stupid ones** is like **A thorn** that **goes up into the hand of a drunkard** because it is harmful. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way a proverb is harmful]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:10 (#2)

מְחֹולֵ֣ל־כֹּ֑ל

“piercing everyone”

Here Solomon implies that the **archer** shoots arrows at **everyone** and those arrows pierce them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who shoots arrows at everyone that pierce them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:10 (#4)

וְשֹׂכֵ֖ר כְּסִ֣יל

“so {is} one hiring a stupid {one”

Here, **one who hires** and **a stupid one** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [so is any person who hires any stupid person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:10 (#3)

וְשֹׂכֵ֖ר כְּסִ֣יל וְשֹׂכֵ֣ר עֹבְרִֽים

“so {is} one hiring a stupid {one} and hiring passersby”

The word **so** here indicates that Solomon is comparing **An archer piercing everyone** with **one hiring a stupid one and hiring passersby**. The point is that both of these are dangerous. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [so one who hires a stupid one and hires those passing by is dangerous]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:10 (#1)

רַב מְחוֹלֵל־כֹּל וְשֹׂכֵר כְּסִיל וְשֹׂכֵר עֹבְרִים

“An archer piercing everyone, so {is} one hiring a stupid {one} and hiring passersby”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One hiring a stupid one and hiring passersby is like an archer piercing everyone]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:11 (#5)

בְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ

“his folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:11 (#2)

כְּכֶלֶב שָׁשֵׁב עַל־קֵאוֹ כְּסִיל שֹׁנֶה בְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ

“Like a dog returning to its vomit {is} a stupid {one} who repeats his folly”

Here, **a dog**, **its**, **a stupid one**, and **his** refer to dogs and a type of person in general, not a specific **dog** or person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [Like any dog that returns to that dog’s vomit is any stupid person who repeats that person’s own folly]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:11 (#1)

כְּכֶלֶב שָׁשֵׁב עַל־קֵאוֹ כְּסִיל שֹׁנֶה בְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ

“Like a dog returning to its vomit {is} a stupid {one} who repeats his folly”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A stupid one who repeats his folly is like a dog that returns to its vomit]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:11 (#4)

שָׁשֵׁב עַל־קֵאוֹ

“returning to its vomit”

Here Solomon implies that the **dog returns to its vomit** in order to eat it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that returns to eat its vomit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:11 (#3)

כְּכֶלֶב

“Like a dog”

A **dog** is an animal that is considered to be unclean and disgusting by Jews and many cultures of the Ancient Near East. Therefore, comparing someone to a dog is insulting. If dogs are unfamiliar to your culture and you have a different animal that is considered unclean and disgusting or whose name is used as an insult, you could use the name of that animal instead.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 26:12 (#5)

תִּקְוָה

“There is more} hope”

See how you translated the abstract noun **hope** in 10:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:12 (#2)

אִישׁ חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו & לִכְסִיל מִמֶּנּוּ

“a man wise in his eyes & for a stupid {one} than for him”

Here, **a man**, **his**, **a stupid one**, and **him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [any person wise in that person’s eyes … for any stupid person than that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:12 (#1)

רָאִיתָ אִישׁ חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו

“You see a man wise in his eyes”

Although the Hebrew text is not marked as a question, many translations consider this clause to be a rhetorical question. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this as a question. See how you translated the similar use of **You see** in 22:29. Alternate translation: [Have you seen a man wise in his eyes?]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 26:12 (#4)

בְּעֵינָ֑יו

“in his eyes”

See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 3:7.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:12 (#3)

חָכָ֥ם בְּעֵינָ֑יו

“wise in his eyes”

Here Solomon implies that this **man** is not actually **wise**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [wise in his eyes who is not really wise]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:13 (#3)

אָמַ֥ר

“says”

In this verse, Solomon implies that what the **lazy one** says is not true. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [says falsely]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:13 (#2)

אָמַ֥ר & שַׁ֖חַל בַּדָּ֣רֶךְ אֲאָרִ֑י בֵּ֖ין הָרְחֹבֽוֹת

“says, “A young lion {is} on the road! A lion {is} between the open areas”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. See how you translated the similar phrases in 22:13. Alternate translation: [says that a lion is on the road and a lion is between the open areas]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 26:13 (#1)

עָ֝צֵֽל

“A lazy {one”

See how you translated this phrase in 13:4.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:14 (#3)

וְ֝עָצֵ֗ל עַל־מִטָּתֽוֹ

“and a lazy {one} on his bed”

See how you translated “a lazy one, his” in 13:4.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:14 (#4)

וְ֝עָצֵ֗ל

“and a lazy {one”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that **a lazy one on his bed** is like a **door** that **turns on its hinge** because both move without going anywhere. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way, a lazy one]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:14 (#1)

הַ֭דֶּלֶת תִּסּ֣וֹב עַל־צִירָ֑הּ

“The door turns on its hinge”

A **hinge** is a metal or leather piece attached to a **door** in order to allow the **door** to swing back and forth. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of item, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [The door swings back and forth] or [The door swings open and shut]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 26:14 (#2)

וְ֝עָצֵ֗ל עַל־מִטָּתֽוֹ

“and a lazy {one} on his bed”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a lazy one turns on his bed]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 26:15 (#1)

טָ֭מַן עָצֵ֣ל יָד֑וֹ בַּצַּלָּ֥חַת נִ֝לְאָ֗ה לַהֲשִׁיבָ֥הּ אֶל־פִּֽיו

“A lazy {one} hides his hand in the dish; he is {too} weary to return it to his mouth”

See how you translated the nearly identical sentence in 19:24.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:16 (#5)

מִשִּׁבְעָ֑ה

“than seven”

Here, **seven** is used to refer to multiple people, not specifically **seven** people. In Hebrew, **seven** often symbolizes the idea of completion. If it would be helpful, you could use a similar expression in your language, or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [than a dozen] or [than a whole group of people]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:16 (#7)

מְשִׁ֣יבֵי טָ֔עַם

“returning discernment”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **discernment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [who answer discerningly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:16 (#2)

חָכָ֖ם & בְּעֵינָֽיו

“is} wiser in his eyes”

Here Solomon implies that **A lazy one** is not actually wise. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [wrongly considers himself wiser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:16 (#1)

עָצֵ֣ל בְּעֵינָ֔יו

“A lazy {one & in his eyes”

See how you translated **A lazy one** and **his** in the previous verse.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:16 (#6)

מְשִׁ֣יבֵי טָ֔עַם

“returning discernment”

Here Solomon refers to people speaking a reply with **discernment** to someone else as if they were returning **discernment**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “returns” in 24:26. Alternate translation: [who speak a discerning reply]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 26:16 (#4)

מִשִּׁבְעָ֑ה

“than seven”

Solomon is using the adjective **seven** as a noun to mean “seven people.” Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [seven people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 26:16 (#3)

בְּעֵינָֽיו

“in his eyes”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 26:12.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:17 (#5)

עֹבֵ֥ר מִתְעַבֵּ֖ר

“passing by {is} one infuriating himself”

Some translators consider **passing by** to apply to **one infuriating himself** rather than to **a dog**. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT. Alternate translation: [is one passing by, infuriating himself]

Proverbs 26:17 (#1)

מַחֲזִ֣יק בְּאָזְנֵי־כֶ֔לֶב עֹבֵ֥ר מִתְעַבֵּ֖ר עַל־רִ֥ב לֹא־לֽוֹ

“One grabbing the ears of a dog passing by {is} one infuriating himself over a dispute not for him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One who infuriates himself over a dispute not for him is one who grabs the ears of a dog passing by]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:17 (#3)

מַחֲזִיק בְּאָזְנֵי־כֶלֶב עֹבֵר

“One grabbing the ears of a dog passing by”

Here Solomon implies that grabbing **the ears of a dog** is a reckless or foolish act because the dog will react by biting the person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who foolishly causes a dog to bite him by grabbing its ears]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:17 (#4)

כֶּלֶב

“a dog”

See how you translated **dog** in 26:11.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 26:17 (#2)

מַחֲזִיק בְּאָזְנֵי־כֶלֶב עֹבֵר

“One grabbing the ears of a dog passing by”

In this verse, Solomon refers to someone **infuriating himself over a dispute not for him** as if that person were **One grabbing the ears of a dog passing by**. Both clauses are examples of a reckless or foolish act that would only harm the person who does it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [One who foolishly harms himself] or [Like one who grabs the ears of a dog passing by]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:17 (#6)

לֹא־לוֹ

“not for him”

Alternate translation: [not about him] or [that he has nothing to do with]

Proverbs 26:18 (#2)

זִקִּים חִצִּים וָמָוֶת

“firebrands, arrows, and death”

The words **firebrands**, **arrows**, and **death** are used together here to emphasize a single idea. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [burning arrows that kill] or [deadly, burning arrows] or [deadly arrows, even burning ones]

See: Hendiadys

Proverbs 26:18 (#1)

כָּכָמִתְלַהְלֵהַּ הַיֹּרֶה זִקִּים חִצִּים וָמָוֶת

“Like an insane {one} shooting firebrands, arrows, and death”

Like in this verse and **so** in the next verse indicate that Solomon is comparing **an insane one who shoots arrows, firebrands, and death** with **a man who deceives his neighbor and says, “Was I not joking?”** The point is that these are harmful and dangerous acts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [Just as an insane one who shoots firebrands, arrows, and death is reckless]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:18–19 (#1)

כָּכָמִתְלַהְלֵהַּ הַיֹּרֶה זִקִּים חִצִּים וָמָוֶת׃ כֵּן־אִישׁ רִמָּה אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ וְאָמַר הֲלֹא־מְשַׂחֵק אָנִי

“Like an insane {one} shooting firebrands, arrows, and death,so {is} a man who deceives his neighbor and says, “Was I not joking”

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine 26:18 and 26:19 into a verse bridge, as the UST does, in order to keep this sentence together.

See: Verse Bridges

Proverbs 26:18–19 (#2)

כָּכָמִתְלַהְלֵהַּ הַיֹּרֶה זִקִּים חִצִּים וָמָוֶת׃ כֵּן־אִישׁ רִמָּה אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ וְאָמַר הֲלֹא־מְשַׂחֵק אָנִי

“Like an insane {one} shooting firebrands, arrows, and death,so {is} a man who deceives his neighbor and says, “Was I not joking”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A man who deceives his neighbor and says, “Was I not joking?” is like an insane one who shoots firebrands, arrows, and death]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:19 (#2)

וְאָמַר הֲלֹא־מְשַׂחֵק אָנִי

“and says, “Was I not joking”

Here, **a man who deceives** is using this question to emphasize that he was **joking**. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language,

you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [and says, “Just kidding!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 26:19 (#1)

אִישׁ & אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ

“is} a man & his neighbor”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [is a person ... that person’s neighbor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 26:19 (#3)

וְאָמַר הֲלֹא־מְשַׂחֵק אָנִי

“and says, “Was I not joking”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [and says that he was joking]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 26:20 (#2)

וּבְאֵין

“and when there is no”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. In the same way that **a fire goes out** when there are no more **wood pieces**, **a quarrel** stops when there is no **murmurer**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and similarly, when there is no]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:20 (#1)

בְּאֶפֶס

“With the end of”

Here, **end** refers to a lack of **wood pieces**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated the similar use of **With the end of** in 14:28. Alternate translation: [With the lack of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:20 (#4)

מָדוֹן

“a quarrel”

See how you translated the abstract noun **quarrel** in 15:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:20 (#3)

יִשְׁתֹּתֵק מָדוֹן

“a quarrel becomes silent”

Here Solomon speaks of **a quarrel** ceasing as if it were a person who **becomes silent**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a quarrel ceases]

See: Personification

Proverbs 26:21 (#6)

רִיב

“a dispute”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **dispute** in 15:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:21 (#3)

וְאִישׁ מדונים & רִיב

“so a man of quarrels & a dispute”

Here, **a man of quarrels** and **a dispute** refer to a type of people and disputes in general, not a specific **man** or **dispute**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [and any person of quarrels ... any dispute]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:21 (#1)

פֶּחָמִים לְגֶחָלִים וְעֵצִים לְאֵשׁ

“Charcoal to burning coals and wood to fire”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **Charcoal** helps **burning coals** burn and **wood** helps **fire** burn. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [As charcoal is fuel for coals to burn, and wood feeds a fire]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:21 (#5)

לְהַרְחַר־רִיב

“is} to kindling of a dispute”

Here Solomon refers to causing a **dispute** to continue as if it were a fire to which someone adds small, highly flammable sticks of wood, called **kindling**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is to starting an argument]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:21 (#2)

וְאִישׁ מדונים

“so a man of quarrels”

Here, **so** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. In the same way that **Charcoal** helps **burning coals** burn and **wood** helps **fire** burn, **a man of quarrels** produces disputes among other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way, a man of quarrels]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:21 (#4)

וְאִישׁ מדונים

“so a man of quarrels”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **quarrels**. See how you translated “a woman of quarrels” in 21:9.

See: Possession

Proverbs 26:22 (#1)

דִּבְרֵי נִרְגָּן כְּמִתְלַהֲמִּים וְהֵמָּה יָרְדוּ חַדְרֵי־בָטֶן

“The words of a murmurer {are} like things swallowed greedily, and they themselves go down into the rooms of the belly”

See how you translated the identical sentence in 18:8.

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:23 (#4)

מְצֻפֶּה

“overlaid”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that someone overlaid]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 26:23 (#6)

שִׂפְתַיִם דֹּלְקִים

“are} burning lips”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:23 (#9)

וְלֵב

“and a heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:23 (#3)

כֶּסֶף סְיגִים

“Silver of dross”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **dross** that is removed from **silver** when someone refines it. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Dross from silver]

See: Possession

Proverbs 26:23 (#7)

דֹּלְקִים

“burning”

Here Solomon refers to something being emotional or fervent as if that thing were **burning**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [passionate]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:23 (#2)

כֶּסֶף סְיגִים מְצֻפֶּה עַל־חָרֶשׂ

“Silver of dross overlaid on a clay vessel”

Here Solomon refers to **burning lips and a heart of evil** as if they are **Silver of dross overlaid on a clay vessel**. The point is that both are deceptive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very deceptive] or [Like silver of dross overlaid on a clay vessel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:23 (#8)

וְלֵ֖ב־רָֽע

“and a heart of evil”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **heart** that is characterized by **evil**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and an evil heart]

See: Possession

Proverbs 26:23 (#1)

כֶּ֭סֶף סִיגִ֣ים מְצֻפֶּ֑ה עַל־חֶ֝֗רֶשׂ שְׂפָתַ֥יִם דֹּלְקִ֗ים וְלֵ֖ב־רָֽע

“Silver of dross overlaid on a clay vessel {are} burning lips and a heart of evil”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Burning lips and a heart of evil are silver of dross overlaid on a clay vessel]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:23 (#5)

שְׂפָתַ֥יִם דֹּלְקִ֗ים וְלֵ֖ב־רָֽע

“are} burning lips and a heart of evil”

Here, **and** indicates that someone has both **burning lips and a heart of evil** at the same time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [are burning lips with a heart of evil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:24 (#4)

יָשִׁ֣ית מִרְמָ֑ה

“he sets deceit”

Here Solomon speaks of the **one who hates** planning how to deceive someone as if **deceit** were an object that **he sets within him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he secretly plans to deceive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:24 (#5)

מִרְמָ֑ה

“deceit”

Here Solomon implies that the **one who hates** plans to deceive the person whom he **hates**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [deceit for the one whom he hates]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:24 (#3)

יְנַכֵּ֗ר & וּ֝בְקִרְבּ֗וֹ

“disguises himself, but within him”

Here, **himself** and **within him** refer to what the **one who hates** is thinking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [disguises what he is thinking, but in his mind]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:24 (#1)

בשפתו יְנַכֵּ֗ר שׂוֹנֵ֥א וּ֝בְקִרְבּ֗וֹ יָשִׁ֣ית מִרְמָֽה

“With his lips one who hates disguises himself, but within him he sets deceit”

Here, **his**, **one who hates**, **himself**, **him**, and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [With the lips of any person who hates, that person disguises himself, but that person sets deceit within that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:24 (#2)

בשפתו

“With his lips”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:25 (#5)

בְּלִבּ֑וֹ

“are} in his heart”

See how you translated **in his heart** in 6:14.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:25 (#3)

שֶׁ֣שׁ תּוֹעֵבֹ֣ות

“seven abominations”

Here Solomon uses **seven** to refer to multiple **abominations**, not specifically **seven**. See how you translated **seven abominations** in 6:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:25 (#4)

תּוֹעֲבֹ֣ות

“abominations”

As in the rest of Proverbs, the word **abominations** here refers to what Yahweh considers to be abominable acts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [things that are abominable to Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:25 (#2)

קֹלֹ֑ו

“his voice”

Here, **voice** refers to what the person says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what he says]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:25 (#1)

יְחַנֵּ֣ן קֹלֹ֑ו & בּ֝וֹ & בְּלִבֹּ֗ו

“he makes his voice gracious & in him & are} in his heart”

In this verse, **he**, **his**, and **him** refer to the type of person “who hates,” as stated in the previous verse. See how you translated these words in the previous verse.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:26 (#5)

תִּגָּלֶ֣ה רָעָתֹ֑ו בְּקָהָ֥ל

“his evil will be uncovered in the assembly”

This clause is a strong contrast to the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [however, his evil will be uncovered in the assembly]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 26:26 (#4)

תְּכַסֶּ֣ה & תִּגָּלֶ֣ה

“is covered & will be uncovered”

Here Solomon refers to **Hatred** being concealed as if it were an object that **is covered**, and he refers to **evil** being revealed as if it were an object that is **uncovered**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of “covers” in 10:6. Alternate translation: [is concealed ... will be revealed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:26 (#7)

רָעָתֹ֑ו

“his evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:26 (#3)

שִׂנְאָ֗ה

“Hatred”

Solomon implies that this **Hatred** belongs to the person with “a heart of evil,” who is described in 26:23–26. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [His hatred]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:26 (#2)

שִׂנְאָ֥ה בְמִרְמָֽה

“Hatred & by guile”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Hatred** and **guile**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated the abstract noun **hatred** in 10:12. Alternate translation: [Hating someone ... by deceiving others]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:26 (#1)

תְּכַסֶּ֣ה שִׂנְאָ֥ה בְמִרְמָֽה

“Hatred is covered by guile”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Guile covers hatred]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 26:26 (#6)

תִּגָּלֶה רָעָתֹו

“his evil will be uncovered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will discover his evil]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 26:27 (#1)

כֹּרֶה־שַׁחַת בָּהּ יִפֹּל

“One who digs a pit will fall into it”

Here Solomon uses **One who digs a pit** to refer to anyone who tries to harm another person, and he uses **fall into it** to refer to that person being harmed as a result. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [One who tries to harm someone will be harmed instead] or [One who tries to harm someone is like one who digs a pit and falls into it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:27 (#3)

כֹּרֶה־שַׁחַת & וְגֹלֵל אֶבֶן אֵלָיו

“One who digs a pit & and one who rolls a stone & to him”

One who digs a pit, **one who rolls a stone**, and **him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who digs a pit ... and any person who rolls a stone ... to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:27 (#2)

כֹּרֶה־שַׁחַת בָּהּ יִפֹּל

“One who digs a pit will fall into it”

Here Solomon implies that the person **digs a pit** in order to trap someone in it, but then ends up falling **into** that pit himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who digs a pit to trap someone will fall into that pit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:27 (#4)

וְגֹלֵל אֶבֶן אֵלָיו תָּשׁוּב

“and one who rolls a stone, it will come back to him”

Here Solomon uses **one who rolls a stone** to refer to anyone who tries to harm another person. Solomon uses **come back to him** to refer to that person being harmed as a result. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning carefully or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and one who tries to harm someone will be harmed instead] or [One who tries to harm someone is like one who rolls a stone, and the stone comes back to him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:27 (#6)

אֵלָיו תָּשׁוּב

“it will come back to him”

Here Solomon implies that the person himself will be crushed by the **stone** that he rolled up a hill to crush someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [it will roll down and crush him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:27 (#5)

וְגֹלֵל אֶבֶן

“and one who rolls a stone”

Here Solomon implies that the person pushed a large **stone** up a hill so that it would roll down and crush someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and one who rolls a stone up a hill so that it will roll down and crush someone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:28 (#1)

לְשׁוֹן־שֶׁקֶר

“A tongue of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **tongue** that is characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. See how you translated the similar use of this phrase in 6:17. Alternate translation: [A false tongue]

See: Possession

Proverbs 26:28 (#4)

חָלָק

“smooth”

Here Solomon speaks of this person speaking flatteringly as if he were making what he says **smooth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [flattering]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:28 (#2)

לָשׁוֹן & דַּכָּיו

“A tongue of & its oppressed ones”

Here, **tongue** and **its** refer to what a person says with his tongue. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A person speaking with ... that person’s oppressed ones]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:28 (#3)

וּפֶה חָלָק

“and a smooth mouth”

As with **tongue**, **mouth** also refers to what a person says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 4:5. Alternate translation: [and a person who speaks smoothly]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:28 (#5)

מִדָּחֶה

“calamity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs - Chapter 27 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Hezekiah’s proverbs from Solomon (25:1–29:27)

- Warnings and admonitions (25:1–27:27)
- Contrastive wise sayings (28:1–29:27)

Chapter 27 continues the section of the book containing proverbs written by Solomon that were copied by scribes during the reign of Hezekiah. This section contains two parts, the first part in 25:1–27:27 mostly contains proverbs that warn or admonish.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism
Chapters 25–27 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 27 also contains contrasting parallelism (27:3, 27:4, 6, 7, 12) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (27:2, 23). (See: Parallelism)

Similes
Solomon uses many different similes in this chapter to warn his readers against acting unwisely. (See: Simile)

Proverbs 27:1 (#1)

יֵלֵד יוֹם

“a day will bring forth”

Here Solomon refers to what will happen on a certain **day** as if that **day** were a person who brings **forth** that event. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what will occur on a day]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:2 (#4)

פִּיךָ & שְׂפָתֶיךָ

“your mouth & your lips”

In this verse, **mouth** and **lips** refer to what a person says using his mouth and lips. See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 4:5 and **lips** in 23:16.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:2 (#2)

יְהַלֶּלְךָ זָר וְלֹא־פִיךָ נָכְרִי וְאַל־שְׂפָתֶיךָ

“Let a stranger praise you and not your mouth, a foreigner and not your lips”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Let a stranger praise you and not your mouth; yes, let a foreigner praise you and not your lips]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 27:2 (#1)

יְהַלֶּלְךָ זָר וְלֹא־פִיךָ נָכְרִי וְאַל־שְׂפָתֶיךָ

“Let a stranger praise you and not your mouth, a foreigner and not your lips”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words in the second clause that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the first clause. Alternate translation: [Let a stranger praise you and not your mouth; let a foreigner praise you and not your lips]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 27:2 (#3)

זָר & נָכְרִי

“a stranger & a foreigner”

Here, **a stranger** and **a foreigner** refer to unfamiliar people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any stranger ... any foreigner] or [any other person ... any outsider]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:3 (#1)

כֹּבֶד־אֶבֶן וְנֵטֶל הַחוֹל

“The heaviness of a stone and the weightiness of the sand”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to state that **a stone** is heavy and **sand** is weighty. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A stone is heavy and sand is weighty]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:3 (#2)

וְכַעַס אֱוִיל כָּבֵד מִשְּׁנֵיהֶם

“yet the vexation of a fool {is} heavier than the two of them”

Here Solomon refers to how vexing fools are to other people as if the **vexation** they cause were **heavier than** the weight of **a stone** and **sand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [yet the vexation of a fool is harder to tolerate than lifting either of them] or [yet the vexation of a fool is like something heavier than the two of them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:3 (#3)

וְכַעַס אֱוִיל

“yet the vexation of a fool”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe **the vexation** that is caused by **a fool**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [yet how vexing a fool can be]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:4 (#3)

וְשֶׁשֶׁף אָף

“and a flood of nose”

Here Solomon speaks of the destructive power of anger as if it were **a flood**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and anger destroys like a flood]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:4 (#2)

חֵמָה & אָף

“heat & nose”

Here, **heat** and **nose** refer to anger. See how you translated the same use of **heat** and **nose** in 15:1.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:4 (#1)

אַכְזְרִיּוּת חֵמָה וְשֶׁשֶׁף אָף

“Cruelty of heat and a flood of nose”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe **heat** that is characterized by **Cruelty** and **nose** that is characterized by **a flood**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Heat is cruel and nose is a flood]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:4 (#5)

יַעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי

“can stand to the face of”

Here, **stand to the face of** means “resist.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [can successfully oppose]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 27:4 (#6)

קִנְאָה

“jealousy”

See how you translated the abstract noun **jealousy** in 6:34.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 27:4 (#4)

וּמִמִּי יַעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי קִנְאָה

“but who can stand to the face of jealousy”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize how dangerous **jealousy** is. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [but surely no one can stand before the face of jealousy!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 27:5 (#1)

מְגֻלֶּה & מְסֻתָּרֶת

“open & hidden”

Here, **open** refers to a **rebuke** that someone notices, while **hidden** refers to **love** that someone does not notice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [noticeable ... unnoticeable]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:5 (#2)

תּוֹכֵחַת & מֵאַהֲבָה

“is & rebuke than & love”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **rebuke** in 1:23 and **love** in 10:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 27:6 (#3)

פִּצְעֵי אוֹהֵב

“are} the wounds of one loving”

Here Solomon speaks of the sadness that a person feels when **one loving** rebukes that person as if it were **wounds**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the sadness caused by one who loves and rebukes]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:6 (#1)

נֶאֱמָנִים פִּצְעֵי אוֹהֵב

“Faithful {are} the wounds of one loving”

Here Solomon speaks of the faithfulness of the **one loving** as if the **wounds** he causes were a **Faithful** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The wounds of one who loves show his faithfulness] or [The wounds of one who loves show how faithful he is]

See: Personification

Proverbs 27:6 (#2)

פִּצְעֵי אוֹהֵב

“are} the wounds of one loving”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **wounds** that are caused by **one loving**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [are the wounds caused by one who loves]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:6 (#5)

וְנַעְתָּרוֹת

“but deceptive”

The word translated as **deceptive** can also mean “excessive.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 27:6 (#7)

נְשִׁיקוֹת

“are} the kisses of”

Here, **kisses** is a symbolic action that shows friendship and loyalty. See how you translated the same use of the word in 24:26.

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 27:6 (#6)

נְשִׁיקוֹת שׂוֹנֵא

“are} the kisses of one hating”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **kisses** that are given by **one hating**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [are the kisses given by one who hates]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:6 (#4)

וְנַעְתָּרוֹת נְשִׁיקְקוֹת שׂוֹנֵא

“but deceptive {are} the kisses of one hating”

Here Solomon speaks of the deceptiveness of the **one hating** as if the **kisses** themselves were being **deceptive**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the kisses of one who hates show his deceptiveness] or [but the kisses of one who hates show how deceptive he is]

See: Personification

Proverbs 27:7 (#2)

נֶפֶשׁ שְׂשָׂבֵעָה

“A satiated appetite”

Here, **appetite** refers to the whole **satiated** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A person who is satisfied] or [A person who has eaten enough to be full]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 27:7 (#3)

נֶפֶשׁ & וְנֶפֶשׁ

“appetite & but {for} the appetite of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **appetite** in 6:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 27:7 (#4)

תָּבוּס נֹפֶת & מָתוֹק

“tramples fresh honey & is} sweet”

Here Solomon implies that the **satiated** person **tramples fresh honey** because he is not hungry and does not want to eat it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [shuns fresh honey because he is not hungry]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:7 (#5)

וְנֶפֶשׁ רְעֵבָה

“but {for} the appetite of a hungry one”

Here, **appetite** refers to the whole **hungry one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but a person who is hungry]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 27:7 (#6)

כָּל־מַמָּר מָתוֹק

“everything bitter {is} sweet”

Here, **bitter** and **sweet** refer to how things taste. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [everything that usually tastes bitter seems to taste sweet]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:7 (#1)

נֶפֶשׁ שְׂשָׂבֵעָה & וְנֶפֶשׁ רְעֵבָה

“A satiated appetite & but {for} the appetite of a hungry one”

A satiated appetite and **the appetite of a hungry one** refers to these appetites in general, not specific appetites. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any satiated appetite ... but for any appetite of any hungry person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:8 (#1)

כְּצִפּוֹר נוֹדֶדֶת מִן־קִנָּהּ כֵּן־אִישׁ נוֹדֵד מִמְּקוֹמוֹ

“Like a bird wandering from her nest, so {is} a man who wanders from his place”

The point of this comparison is that just as it is not good for **a bird** to wander far from its nest, so it is not good for **a man** to wander far from his home and family If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [Just as it is dangerous for a bird to wander from her nest, so it is for a man to wander from his place]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:8 (#2)

אִישׁ & מִמְּקוֹמוֹ

“is} a man & from his place”

See how you translated the same use of **a man** and **his** in 6:27.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 27:9 (#6)

מֵעֲצַת־נָפֶשׁ

“is} from the counsel of the soul”

The phrase **counsel of the soul** could refer to: (1) sincere advice. Alternate translation: [is from sincere counsel]; (2) one’s own (internal) advice. Alternate translation: [is better than one’s own counsel]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 27:9 (#3)

וּמֶמָּתֶק

“and the sweetness of”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. In the same way that **Oil and incense gladden the heart**, **the sweetness of his friend is from the counsel of the soul**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and similarly, the sweetness of]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:9 (#4)

וּמֶמָּתֶק

“and the sweetness of”

Here Solomon speaks of the kindness of a **friend** as if it were **sweetness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the kindness of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:9 (#2)

יְשַׂמַּח־לֵבָב

“gladden the heart”

Here Solomon speaks of a person feeling glad as if that person’s **heart** were a person who could be gladdened. If it would be helpful in you language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [make a person happy]

See: Personification

Proverbs 27:9 (#1)

שֶׁמֶן וּקְטֹרֶת

“Oil and incense”

Oil and incense here refers to pleasant-smelling substances that are put on a person’s skin. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Pleasant-smelling oils and perfumes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:9 (#5)

רֵעֵ֑הוּ

“his friend”

Although **his** is masculine, here it refers to a person in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [any person’s friend]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 27:10 (#2)

בְּיוֹם

“in the day of”

Here, **day** refers to a time when something happens. It does not refer to a 24-hour length of time. See how you translated the same use of **day** in 21:31.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:10 (#1)

רֵעֲךָ֣ וְרֵעַ & וּבֵ֣ית אָחִ֗יךָ אַל־תָּ֫בוֹא & שָׁכֵ֣ן קָ֭רוֹב מֵאָ֣ח רָחֽוֹק

“your friend and the friend of & and do not enter the house of your brother & is} a nearby inhabitant than a distant brother”

Here, **friend**, **house**, **brother**, **a nearby inhabitant**, and **a distant brother** represent these things and people in general, not specific things or people. In this verse, **brother** refers to relatives in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any friend of yours and any friend of … and do not enter any house of any relative of yours … is any nearby inhabitant than any distant relative]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:10 (#4)

טוֹב שָׁכֵ֣ן קָ֭רוֹב מֵאָ֣ח רָחֽוֹק

“Better {is} a nearby inhabitant than a distant brother”

Here Solomon implies that this situation is true **in the day of your calamity**, as mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When you need help, a nearby inhabitant is better than a distant brother]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:10 (#3)

אֵידֶֽךָ

“your calamity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 27:11 (#2)

וְשַׂמַּח לִבִּי

“and gladden my heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [make my spirit happy]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 27:11 (#3)

וְאָשִׁיבָה & דָּבָר

“and I shall return a word”

Here Solomon refers to replying to someone as if the **word** spoken were an object that one returns to that other person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I shall reply with a word]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:11 (#4)

וְאָשִׁיבָה

“and I shall return”

Here, **and** introduces the result of the **son** being **wise**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [As a result, I shall return]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 27:11 (#6)

חֹרְפִֽי

“to one reproaching me”

Here, **one who reproaches me** represents a person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [to any person who reproaches me]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:11 (#5)

דָּבָר

“a word”

See how you translated the similar use of **word** in 12:25.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:11 (#1)

בְּנִי

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 27:12 (#1)

עָרוּם רָאָה רָעָה נִסְתָּֽר פְּתָאיִם עָבְרוּ נֶעֱנָשׁוּ

“A prudent one sees evil, he hides himself; naive ones pass on, they are fined”

See how you translated the nearly identical sentence in 22:3.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:13 (#1)

קַח־בִּגְדוֹ כִּי־עָרַב זָר וּבְעַד נָכְרִיָּה חַבָּלֻֽהוּ

“Take his garment when he has pledged {for} a stranger, and on behalf of a foreign woman hold it in pledge”

See how you translated the identical sentence in 20:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:14 (#1)

מְבָרֵךְ רֵעֵהוּ & בַּבֹּקֶר הַשְׁכֵּים & לוֹ

“One who blesses his neighbor & in the rising morning & to him”

One who blesses, **his neighbor**, **the rising morning**, and **him** represent types of people and mornings in general, not a specific people or **morning**. If it would

be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who blesses any neighbor ... in any rising morning ... to that neighbor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:14 (#3)

בַּבֹּ֣קֶר הַשְׁכֵּ֔ים

“in the rising morning”

Here Solomon refers to the early **morning** as if it were **rising** because the sun appears to rise on the horizon at dawn. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at dawn]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:14 (#4)

קְלָלָ֥ה תֵהָ֖שֵׁב לֽוֹ

“it will be considered a curse to him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that neighbor will consider it to be a curse]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 27:14 (#2)

בְּקֹ֣ול גָּדֹ֑ול

“with a great voice”

Here, **great** refers to the **voice** being loud. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [with a loud voice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:15 (#2)

וְאֵ֣שֶׁת מדונים

“and a woman of quarrels”

See how you translated **a woman of quarrels** in 21:9.

Proverbs 27:15 (#1)

דֶּ֣לֶף טְטֹורַ֣ד בְּי֣וֹם סַגְרִ֑יר וְאֵ֣שֶׁת מדונים נְשָׁתָֽוה

“A continual dripping on a day of steady rain and a woman of quarrels are alike”

Here, **alike** indicates that Solomon is comparing **a woman of quarrels** to continually **dripping** water on a rainy **day** because both are annoying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **dripping** in 19:13. Alternate translation: [Bothersome as a continual dripping on a day of steady rain is a woman of quarrels] or [As annoying as a continual dripping of water on a rainy day is a woman of quarrels]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:16 (#2)

צֹפְנֶ֥יהָ

“The one hiding her”

Here, **her** refers to “a woman of quarrels” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The one who hides a woman of quarrels]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 27:16 (#3)

צֹפְנֶ֥יהָ & יְמִינֹ֖ו

“The one hiding her & his right hand”

The one who hides and **his** represent any man with a quarrelsome wife in general, not a specific man. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who hides her ... that person’s right hand]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:16 (#1)

צֹפְנֶ֥יהָ צָפֶ֑ן

“The one hiding her hides”

The word translated as **hiding** and **hides** in this verse is considered by some scholars to also mean “restrains.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 27:16 (#4)

צָפַ֣ן־רֽוּחַ֭ וְשֶׁ֣מֶן יְמִינֹ֑ו יִקְרָֽא

“hides the wind, and oil meets his right hand”

Here Solomon speaks of hiding a quarrelsome woman as if one were trying to hide **the wind** or grasp **oil** in his hand, both of which are impossible tasks. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is doing something impossible] or [is like one

who tries to hide the wind or grasp oil in his right hand]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:17 (#4)

יַחַד פְּנֵי

“sharpens the face of”

Here Solomon uses **sharpens** to refer to developing or improving someone, and **face** to refer to a person’s character or how a person thinks. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [helps to improve the character of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:17 (#3)

וְאִישׁ & רֵעֵהוּ

“and a man & his neighbor”

Although **a man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful, you could use phrases that make this clear in your language. Alternate translation: [and a person … that person’s neighbor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 27:17 (#2)

בַּרְזֶל בְּבַרְזֶל יֵחַד וְאִישׁ יַחַד פְּנֵי־רֵעֵהוּ

“Iron sharpens against iron, and a man sharpens the face of his neighbor”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A man sharpens the face of his neighbor as iron sharpens against iron]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 27:17 (#1)

בַּרְזֶל בְּבַרְזֶל יֵחַד וְאִישׁ יַחַד פְּנֵי־רֵעֵהוּ

“Iron sharpens against iron, and a man sharpens the face of his neighbor”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what he says in the second clause to what he says in the first clause. In the same way that **Iron sharpens against iron**, **a man sharpens the face of his neighbor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Iron sharpens against iron; similarly, a man sharpens the face of his neighbor]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:18 (#3)

יְכֻבָּד

“will be honored”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that master will honor]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 27:18 (#2)

וְשֹׁמֵר

“and one protecting”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that **one protecting his master** is like **One guarding a fig tree** because both receive a reward for their work. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and in the same way, one who protects]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:18 (#1)

נֹצֵר תְּאֵנָה יֹאכַל פִּרְיָהּ וְשֹׁמֵר אֲדֹנָיו

“One guarding a fig tree will eat its fruit, and one protecting his master”

One guarding, **a fig tree**, **its**, **one protecting**, and **his** represent fig trees and types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who guards any fig tree will eat the fruit of that tree, and any person who protects that person’s master]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:19 (#1)

כַּמַּיִם הַפָּנִים לַפָּנִים כֵּן לֵב־הָאָדָם לָאָדָם

“As the water, the face to the face, so the heart of the man, to the man”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alter-

nate translation: [As the water reflects the face to the face, so the heart of the man reflects to the man]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 27:19 (#4)

לֵב

“the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:19 (#3)

כַּמַּ֤יִם הַפָּנִים֙ לַפָּנִ֔ים כֵּ֖ן לֵ֣ב־הָאָדָ֑ם לָאָדָ֖ם

“As the water, the face to the face, so the heart of the man, to the man”

Here, **the water**, **the face**, **the heart**, and **the man** refer to things and people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [As water reflects any face to itself, so any person’s heart reflects to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:19 (#2)

כַּמַּ֤יִם הַפָּנִים֙ לַפָּנִ֔ים כֵּ֖ן לֵ֣ב־הָאָדָ֑ם לָאָדָ֖ם

“As the water, the face to the face, so the heart of the man, to the man”

The words **As** and **so** in this verse indicate that Solomon is comparing **water** with **the heart of a man**. The point is that both reveal what someone really is. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [Just like the water shows the face to the face, so the heart of a man shows to the man who he really is]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:20 (#3)

לֹ֣א תִשְׂבַּ֔עְנָה

“are not satisfied”

Here Solomon speaks of **Sheol and Abaddon** never lacking room for more dead people as if those places were people who **are not satisfied** with what they already have. He means that there will always be people who die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [never lack space] or [always have room for more]

See: Personification

Proverbs 27:20 (#5)

וְעֵינֵ֥י הָאָדָ֖ם לֹ֣א תִשְׂבַּ֑עְנָה

“and the eyes of the man are not satisfied”

Here **the eyes** refers to desires. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the desires of the man are not satisfied]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:20 (#4)

וְעֵינֵ֥י הָאָדָ֖ם לֹ֣א תִשְׂבַּ֑עְנָה

“and the eyes of the man are not satisfied”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. In the same way that **Sheol and Abaddon are not satisfied**, **the eyes of the man are not satisfied**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and similarly, the eyes of the man are not satisfied]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:20 (#1)

שְׁאוֹל ואבדה

“Sheol and Abaddon”

See how you translated this phrase in 15:11.

See: Doublet

Proverbs 27:20 (#2)

לֹ֣א תִשְׂבַּ֔עְנָה & לֹ֣א תִשְׂבַּ֑עְנָה

“are not satisfied & are not satisfied”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one can satisfy ... no one can satisfy]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 27:20 (#6)

הָאָדָ֖ם

“the man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person] or [any person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 27:21 (#4)

לְפִ֥י מַהֲלָל֑וֹ

“for the mouth of one who praises him”

Solomon implies that **a man** is tested by **the mouth of one who praises him**, just as **silver** and **gold** are tested by someone melting them in a **smelting-pot** or **furnace**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [tested by the mouth of one who praises]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:21 (#1)

מַצְרֵ֣ף לַ֭כֶּסֶף וְכ֣וּר לַזָּהָ֑ב

“The smelting-pot {is} for the silver and the furnace {is} for the gold”

See how you translated the identical clause in 17:3.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:21 (#5)

לְפִ֥י

“for the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** refers to what the person **who praises him** says. See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 10:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:21 (#2)

וְ֝אִ֗ישׁ

“so {is} a man”

Here, **so** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. In the same way that the **smelting-pot** reveals the impurities in **silver** and the **furnace** reveals the impurities in **gold**, the character of **a man** is revealed by how he responds to **the mouth of one who praises him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way, a man is]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:21 (#3)

וְ֝אִ֗ישׁ לְפִ֥י מַהֲלָל֑וֹ

“so {is} a man for the mouth of one who praises him”

Here, **a man** and **one who praises him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [so is any person for the mouth of any person who praises that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:22 (#1)

אִם־תְּכַתֵּ֣ושׁ אֶת־הָ֭אֱוִיל ׀ בְּמַכְתֵּ֣שׁ בְּתוֹךְ֮ הָרִיפ֒וֹת בָּעֶלְלִ֗י

“Even if you pound a fool in a mortar with a pestle in the midst of ground grains”

Solomon introduces an imaginary situation to help explain how futile it is to try to stop **a fool** from being foolish. Use a natural method in your language for introducing an imaginary situation. Alternate translation: [Suppose you were to pound a fool in a mortar with a pestle in the midst of ground grains]

See: Hypothetical Situations

Proverbs 27:22 (#5)

אִוַּלְתּ֑וֹ

“his folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 27:22 (#2)

תְּכַתֵּ֣ושׁ אֶת־הָ֭אֱוִיל ׀ בְּמַכְתֵּ֣שׁ בְּתוֹךְ֮ הָרִיפ֒וֹת בָּעֶלְלִ֗י

“you pound a fool in a mortar with a pestle in the midst of ground grains”

The terms **mortar** and **pestle** refer to hard tools that are smashed together to crush **grains**. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of tool, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [you pound a fool with tools used for crushing grain]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 27:22 (#3)

אֶת־הָ֭אֱוִיל & מֵעָלָ֗יו אִוַּלְתּ֑וֹ

“a fool & his folly & from on him”

Here, **a fool**, **his**, and **him** refer to fools in general, not one particular **fool**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any fool ... that fool’s folly ... from on that fool]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:22 (#4)

לֹא־תָסִיר מֶנֶּנּוּ אִוַּלְתּוֹ

“his folly will not turn away from on him”

Here Solomon speaks of a person being unable to stop behaving foolishly as if **his folly** were a person who **will not turn away from on him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will not stop his folly]

See: Personification

Proverbs 27:23 (#3)

צֹאנֶךָ

“your flock”

In this verse, the word **flock** is singular in form, but it refers to all sheep or goats as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [your group of sheep]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 27:23 (#1)

יָדֹעַ תֵּדַע פְּנֵי צֹאנֶךָ שִׁיתָ לִבְּךָ לַעֲדָרִים

“Know well the faces of your flock; set your heart to the herds”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Know well the faces of your flock; yes, set your heart to the herds]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 27:23 (#4)

שִׁיתָ לִבְּךָ

“set your heart”

See how you translated this phrase in 22:17.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 27:23 (#5)

לַעֲדָרִים

“to the herds”

The parallelism with the previous clause indicates that Solomon is referring to the condition of **the herds**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the condition of the herds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:23 (#2)

פְּנֵי

“the faces of”

Here, **faces** refers to what the animals in the **flock** look like, which would indicate the condition of their health. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the condition of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:24 (#2)

לְדֹר דור

“for generation and generation”

This is an idiom that means “forever.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 27:24 (#1)

נֵזֶר

“a crown”

Here, **crown** refers to a king’s rule over his kingdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a king’s rule]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:25 (#4)

עִשְׂבוֹת הָרִים

“the herbs of the mountains”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe **the herbs** that grow on **the mountains**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the herbs that grow on the mountains]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:25 (#1)

גָּלְיָה חָצִיר

“The grass disappears”

Here Solomon implies that the **grass disappears** because the farmer harvested it in order to feed it to livestock. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Then grass disappears when you harvest it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:25 (#2)

וְנִרְאָה־דֶּשֶׁא

“and fresh grass is seen”

The word translated **and** at the beginning of this phrase indicates that this event happened after the event described in the previous phrase. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the next event in a series of events. Alternate translation: [and next, fresh grass is seen]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Proverbs 27:25 (#3)

וְנִרְאָה־דֶּשֶׁא וְנֶאֶסְפוּ עִשְׂבְּוֹת הָרִים

“and fresh grass is seen, and the herbs of the mountains are gathered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and you see fresh grass, and you gather the herbs of the mountains]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 27:25–26 (#1)

גָּלְלָה חָצִיר וְנִרְאָה־דֶּשֶׁא וְנֶאֶסְפוּ עִשְׂבְּוֹת הָרִים׃ כְּבָשִׂים לִלְבוּשֶׁךָ וּמְחִיר שָׂדֶה עַתּוּדִים

“The grass disappears, and fresh grass is seen, and the herbs of the mountains are gathered;lambs {will be} for your clothing, and male goats the price of a field”

These two verses are one conditional sentence. If the conditions in 27:25 are met, then the situation in 27:26 will occur. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate conditional statements.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Proverbs 27:26 (#2)

וּמְחִיר שָׂדֶה עַתּוּדִים

“and male goats the price of a field”

Here Solomon implies that the **male goats** will be sold for an amount of money that will be enough to buy **a field**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and selling your goats will provide enough money to pay the price for a field]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:26 (#1)

כְּבָשִׂים לִלְבוּשֶׁךָ

“lambs {will be} for your clothing”

Here Solomon implies that the **lambs** will provide the wool that is used to make **clothing**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [lambs will provide the wool for your clothing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:27 (#1)

וְחַיִּים לְנַעֲרוֹתָיִךְ

“and life for your young women”

Here Solomon implies that there will also be enough **milk of female goats** to provide **life for your young women**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and there will be enough goat’s milk to sustain the life of your young women]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:27 (#2)

וְחַיִּים

“and life”

Here, **life** refers to the nourishment needed to sustain **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and nourishment]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs - Chapter 28 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Hezekiah’s proverbs from Solomon (25:1–29:27)

- Warnings and admonitions (25:1–27:27)
- Contrastive wise sayings (28:1–29:27)

Chapter 28 begins the second part of this section of the book that contains proverbs written by Solomon that were copied by scribes during the reign of

Hezekiah. This part in 28:1–29:27 mostly contains general proverbs that use contrastive parallelism.

Proverbs 28:1 (#1)

רָשָׁעֶת וְצַדִּיקִים

“The wicked & but the righteous”

Solomon is using the adjectives **wicked** and **righteous** as nouns to mean **wicked** and **righteous** people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate these words with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [Wicked people ... but righteous people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 28:1 (#2)

וְאֵין־רֹדֵף

“and there is no pursuer”

Here, **and** indicates a contrast between the previous phrase and the next phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [despite their being no pursuer]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 28:2 (#6)

יַאֲרִיךְ

“it will endure”

The pronoun **it** refers to the **land**, meaning the government of that land. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the government of that land will endure]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 28:2 (#5)

מֵבִין יֹדֵעַ

“who understands, who knows”

The words **understands** and **knows** mean the same thing. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [who really understands]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 28:2 (#2)

בְּפֶשַׁע

“By the transgression of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:2 (#4)

וּבְאָדָם

“but by a man”

Here Solomon implies that **a man** is a ruler. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but by a ruler]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:2 (#1)

בְּפֶשַׁע אֶרֶץ רַבִּים שָׂרֶיהָ

“By the transgression of a land many {are} its rulers”

By here indicates that having **transgression** is one reason why **a land** has **many rulers**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a reason. Alternate translation: [Transgression is one reason why a land has many rulers]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 28:2 (#3)

אֶרֶץ & שָׂרֶיהָ

“a land & are} its rulers”

Here, **land** and **its** refer to the people who live in a **land**. If it would be helpful, you could express the meaning plainly in your language. Alternate translation: [the people in a land ... are their rulers]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 28:3 (#6)

לֶחֶם

“bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 28:3 (#4)

סֹחֵחַ

“that} washes away”

Here Solomon implies that the **rain washes away** all the crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that washes all the crops away]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:3 (#2)

דַּלִּ֑ים

“the lowly”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:3 (#3)

מָטָ֣ר סֹ֭חֵף וְאֵ֣ין לָ֑חֶם

“is} a rain {that} washes away, and there is no bread”

Here Solomon refers to **A man who is poor and who oppresses the lowly ones** as if that person were **a rain that washes away**. The point is that both are destructive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is very destructive] or [is like rain that washes away, and there is no bread]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:3 (#1)

גֶּ֭בֶר

“A man”

A man here refers to this type of person in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:3 (#5)

וְאֵ֣ין

“and there is no”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [and it results in their being no]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 28:4 (#3)

רָ֝שָׁ֗ע

“the wicked”

See how you translated **the wicked** in 3:25.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 28:4 (#1)

עֹזְבֵ֣י

“Those forsaking”

See how you translated the same use of **forsake** in 1:8.

See: Personification

Proverbs 28:4 (#4)

וְ֝שֹׁמְרֵ֗י

“but those keeping”

Here Solomon speaks of obeying **the law** as if it were an object that someone can **keep**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:4 (#2)

תּוֹרָ֑ה & תּוֹרָ֥ה

“the law & the law”

Here, the word **law** is singular in form, but it refers to several laws as a group. In this verse, **law** could refer to: (1) Yahweh’s laws. Alternate translation: [the laws of Yahweh … his laws]; (2) wise instruction in general. Alternate translation: [wise instructions … those instructions]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 28:4 (#5)

בָּ֝֗ם

“against them”

Here, **them** refers to **wicked** people, who are called **the wicked** in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [against those wicked people]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 28:5 (#4)

וּ֝מְבַקְשֵׁ֗י

“but seekers of”

Here Solomon refers to trying to know and please **Yahweh** as if he were an object that people can seek. See how you translated the similar use of “seeks” in 11:27. Alternate translation: [but people who try to please]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:5 (#2)

אַנְשֵׁי

“Men of”

Although the term **men** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [People of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 28:5 (#3)

מִשְׁפָּט

“justice”

See how you translated the abstract noun **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:5 (#5)

כֹּל

“everything”

Here Solomon implies that the people **understand everything** about **justice**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [completely understand what is just]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:5 (#1)

אַנְשֵׁי־רָע

“Men of evil”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **men** who are characterized by **evil**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Evil men]

See: Possession

Proverbs 28:6 (#5)

דְּרָכַיִם

“ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:6 (#3)

בְּתֻמּוֹ

“in his integrity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:6 (#4)

מֵעִקֵּשׁ

“than one crooked of”

See how you translated the same use of **crooked** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:6 (#2)

הוֹלֵךְ בְּתֻמּוֹ

“who walks in his integrity”

Here, **walks** refers to how a person behaves, in this case behaving with **integrity**. See how you translated the similar use of “walk” in 3:23. Alternate translation: [who behaves with integrity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:6 (#1)

רָאשׁ הוֹלֵךְ בְּתֻמּוֹ מֵעִקֵּשׁ דְּרָכַיִם וְהוּא

“one who is poor who walks in his integrity than one crooked of ways, yet he”

Here, **one who is poor**, **his**, **one crooked of ways**, and **he** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who is poor who walks in that person’s integrity than any person who is crooked of ways, yet that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:7 (#2)

נוֹצֵר

“One who guards”

Here Solomon speaks of obeying **the law** as if it were an object that someone **guards**. See how you translated the same use of “keep” in 28:4.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:7 (#1)

נוֹצֵר & וְרֹעֶה & אָבִיו

“One who guards & but one who associates with & his father”

One who guards, **one who associates**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who guards ... but any person who associates with ... that person’s father]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:7 (#3)

תּוֹרָה

“the law”

See how you translated the same use of **the law** in 28:4.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 28:7 (#4)

בֵּ֣ן

“is} a son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 28:8 (#5)

דַּלִּ֖ים

“the lowly”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:8 (#3)

יִקְבְּצֶ֥נּוּ

“gathers it”

Here Solomon implies that the **One who increases his wealth** unknowingly **gathers** his **wealth** for someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [unknowingly gathers it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:8 (#1)

מַרְבֶּ֣ה הוֹנ֣וֹ & לְחוֹנֵ֑ן

“One increasing his wealth & for one showing favor {to”

One who increases, **his**, and **one who shows favor** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who increases that person’s own wealth ... for any person who shows favor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:8 (#4)

לְחוֹנֵ֑ן

“for one showing favor {to”

See how you translated the same use of **shows favor** in 14:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:8 (#2)

בְּנֶ֖שֶׁךְ ובתרבית

“by interest and usury”

The two words **interest** and **usury** express a single idea. The word **usury** indicates that this person is charging an unreasonably large amount of **interest** to those who borrow money from him. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [by charging extra money to borrow]

See: Hendiadys

Proverbs 28:9 (#1)

מֵסִ֣יר אָזְנ֣וֹ & תְּפִלָּתֽוֹ

“One turning away his ear & his prayer”

One turning away and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who turns away that person’s own ear ... that person’s prayer]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:9 (#2)

מֵסִ֣יר אָזְנ֣וֹ מִשְּׁמֹ֑עַ

“One turning away his ear from hearing”

The phrase **turning away his ear** is an idiom that refers to refusing to listen to what someone is saying as if the listener were turning **his ear** from the person speaking. If this phrase does not have this meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who refuses to listen to]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:9 (#3)

תּוֹרָֽה

“the law”

See how you translated the same use of **the law** in 28:4.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 28:9 (#5)

תּוֹעֵבָֽה

“is} an abomination”

See how you translated the abstract noun **abomination** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:9 (#4)

תּוֹעֵבָֽה

“is} an abomination”

As in the rest of Proverbs, **abomination** here refers to what Yahweh considers to be an **abomination**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is what is abominable to Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:10 (#6)

יִנְחֲלוּ־טֽוֹב

“will inherit good”

Here Solomon speaks of **the blameless** receiving many **good** things as if **good** were property or wealth that they could **inherit** from a family member. See how you translated the same use of **inherit** in 3:35.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:10 (#5)

וּתְמִימִ֥ים

“but the blameless”

See how you translated **the blameless** in 2:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:10 (#1)

מַשְׁגֶּ֣ה יְשָׁרִ֔ים & בְּשִׁחוּתָ֖ו הִ֣וא־יִפֹּֽול

“One leading the upright astray & into his pit he himself will fall”

One leading, **his**, **he**, and **himself** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who leads upright ones astray … into that person’s own pit that person will fall]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:10 (#7)

טֽוֹב

“good”

See how you translated the abstract noun **good** in 11:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:10 (#2)

מַשְׁגֶּ֣ה יְשָׁרִ֔ים ׀ בְּדֶ֖רֶךְ רָ֑ע

“One leading the upright astray in the way of evil”

Here Solomon refers to someone causing **the upright** to behave in a manner that is **evil** as if he were leading those people down a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of “lead them astray” in 12:26 and **way** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [One who causes upright ones to behave in an evil manner]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:10 (#4)

בְּשִׁחוּתָ֖ו הִ֣וא־יִפֹּֽול

“into his pit he himself will fall”

Here Solomon refers to a person unintentionally destroying himself by trying to harm someone else as if that person falls **into his pit** that he dug to trap someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will end up destroying himself by his behavior]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:10 (#3)

בְּדֶ֖רֶךְ רָ֑ע

“in the way of evil”

See how you translated **way of evil** in 2:12.

See: Possession

Proverbs 28:11 (#3)

וְדַל

“but a & lowly {one”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:11 (#1)

בְּעֵינָיו אִישׁ עָשִׁיר וְדַל & יַחְקְרֶנּוּ

“A rich man & in his eyes, but a & lowly {one} will search him out”

A rich man, **his**, **a lowly one**, and **him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any rich person … in that person’s eyes, but any lowly one … will search that person out]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:11 (#2)

חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו

“is} wise in his eyes”

See how you translated **wise in his eyes** in 26:5.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:11 (#4)

יַחְקְרֶנּוּ

“will search him out”

The phrase means that **a lowly one** will be able to investigate and determine if **A rich man** is not really **wise**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [can determine if he is not truly wise]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:12 (#3)

וּבְקוּם רְשָׁעִים

“but when the wicked arise”

Here Solomon speaks of **wicked ones** becoming powerful as if they were objects that could **arise**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but when wicked ones become prosperous]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:12 (#1)

רַבָּה תִפְאָרֶת

“there is} great splendor”

Here, **splendor** could refer to: (1) people rejoicing or celebrating that **righteous ones** have become powerful. Alternate translation: [there is great celebration]; (2) the rule of the **righteous ones** being glorious. Alternate translation: [it is very glorious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:12 (#2)

בַּעֲלֹץ צַדִּיקִים

“When the righteous exult”

Here Solomon implies that **the righteous exult** because they have become prosperous or powerful. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When the righteous become prosperous]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:12 (#4)

יְחֻפַּשׂ אָדָם

“a man is searched for”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people search for a man]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 28:12 (#6)

יְחֻפַּשׂ אָדָם

“a man is searched for”

Here Solomon implies that **a man is searched for** because every good person has hidden himself to escape from the powerful **wicked** people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [every good person hides from them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:12 (#5)

יְחֻפַּשׂ אָדָם

“a man is searched for”

Here, **a man** refers any good person in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any good person is searched for]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:13 (#4)

וּמוֹדֶה וְעֹזֵב

“but one confessing and forsaking”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but one who confesses and forsakes his transgressions]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 28:13 (#1)

מְכַסֶּה פְּשָׁעָיו & וּמוֹדֶה

“One covering his transgressions & but one confessing”

One covering, **his**, and **one confessing** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who covers that person’s own transgressions ... but any person who confesses]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:13 (#2)

מְכַסֶּה

“One covering”

Here Solomon refers to someone concealing **his transgressions** as if **transgressions** were objects that someone is **covering**. See how you translated **covers** in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:13 (#3)

פְּשָׁעָיו

“his transgressions”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgressions** in 10:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:13 (#5)

יְרֻחָם

“will be shown mercy”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will show mercy to]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 28:14 (#2)

מְפַחֵד תָּמִיד

“fearing continually”

Here, **fearing** could refer to: (1) being cautious in the way that a person lives so as not to **fall into evil**, as also in 14:16. Alternate translation: [who is continually on guard about his behavior]; (2) reverently fearing Yahweh. Alternate translation: [who reveres Yahweh continually]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:14 (#4)

יִפֹּל בְּרָעָה

“will fall into evil”

See how you translated the nearly identical phrase “falls into evil” in 13:17.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:14 (#1)

אַשְׁרֵי & וּמַקְשֶׁה לִבּוֹ

“is} a man & but one hardening his heart”

Here, **a man**, **one hardening**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [is any person ... but any person who hardens that person’s own heart]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:14 (#3)

וּמַקְשֶׁה לִבּוֹ

“but one hardening his heart”

Here Solomon speaks of a person stubbornly deciding to live by his own rules as if he made **his heart** hard. The word **heart** here refers to a person’s mind and will, as in 2:2. If the heart is not the body part

your culture uses to refer to a person's will, consider using whichever organ your culture would use for this image. If a translation is available in your language, see how it translated a similar expression in Exodus 7:3. Alternate translation: [but one who stubbornly decides to live in his own way]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:15 (#4)

דָּל

"lowly"

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:15 (#2)

אֲרִי־נֹהֵם וְדֹבֵ֥ב שׁוֹקֵֽק

"A lion growling and a bear charging"

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a wicked ruler over a lowly people** being frightening and dangerous as if he were **A lion growling and a bear charging**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very dangerous] or [Like a lion growling or a bear charging]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:15 (#3)

מֹשֵׁ֣ל רָ֭שָׁע עַ֣ל עַם־דָּֽל

"is} a wicked ruler over a lowly people"

Here, **a wicked ruler** and **a lowly people** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [is any wicked ruler over any lowly people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:15 (#5)

עַם

"a & people"

See how you translated the same use of **people** in 11:14.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 28:15 (#1)

אֲרִי־נֹהֵם וְדֹבֵ֥ב שׁוֹקֵ֑ק מֹשֵׁ֣ל רָ֭שָׁע עַ֣ל עַם־דָּֽל

"A lion growling and a bear charging {is} a wicked ruler over a lowly people"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A wicked ruler over a lowly people is a lion growling and a bear charging]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 28:16 (#3)

וְרַ֖ב מַעֲשַׁקּ֣וֹת

"is} also abundant of oppressions"

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe an **abundant** number of oppressive acts. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [does many oppressive acts]

See: Possession

Proverbs 28:16 (#6)

יַאֲרִ֣יךְ יָמִ֑ים

"will lengthen days"

See how you translated the similar phrase "length of days" in 3:2.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:16 (#4)

שנאי

"one hating"

This clause is a strong contrast to the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [however, one who hates]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 28:16 (#5)

בֶּ֫צַע

"unjust gain"

See how you translated this phrase in 1:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:16 (#2)

תְּבוּנ֑וֹת

"understanding"

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:16 (#1)

נָגִ֗יד & שנאי

“A leader & one hating”

A leader and **one hating** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any leader ... any person who hates]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:17 (#8)

אַל־יִתְמְכוּ־בֽוֹ

“let them not support him”

Here, **them** refers to any people in general who may think about helping the murderer, and **him** refers to the murderer. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [let no one support such a person] or [no one should assist the murderer]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 28:17 (#3)

עָשֻׁ֣שֶׁק בְּדַם־נָ֭פֶשׁ

“oppressed by the blood of a life”

Here, **oppressed** refers to a person being guilty of murdering someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [guilty for the blood of a life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:17 (#5)

נָ֭פֶשׁ

“a life”

Here, **life** refers to a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 28:17 (#2)

עָשֻׁ֣שֶׁק בְּדַם־נָ֭פֶשׁ

“oppressed by the blood of a life”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom the blood of a life oppresses]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 28:17 (#1)

אָדָ֣ם & נָ֭פֶשׁ & בַּבּ֣וֹר & בּֽוֹ

“A man & a life & a pit & him”

A man, **a life**, **a pit**, and **him** refer to a type of person and these things in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person ... any life ... any pit ... that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:17 (#4)

בְּדַ֣ם

“by the blood of”

Here, **blood** refers to violently murdering someone, which usually causes **blood** to come out of the person who is murdered. See how you translated the same use of **blood** in 1:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 28:17 (#6)

יָ֝נ֗וּס

“will flee”

Here, **flee** implies that the murderer is fleeing from punishment for what he has done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will flee from punishment] or [will flee from those who want to punish him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:17 (#7)

בַּבּ֣וֹר

“a pit”

Here, **pit** could refer to: (1) death, which is when that person would be buried in **a pit**. Alternate translation: [the grave] or [death]; (2) a deep hole or well where the murderer would try to hide. Alternate translation: [a pit to hide in]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 28:18 (#6)

בְּאֶחָת

“into one”

Here, **into one** could refer to: (1) falling into a pit, so **one** would refer back to “pit” in the previous verse. This continues the idea of the person walking in a crooked manner. Alternate translation: [into a pit]; (2) one moment, which emphasizes the suddenness of falling. Alternate translation: [at once]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:18 (#4)

וְנֶעְקָשׁ דְּרָכַיִם

“but one crooked of ways”

See how you translated **one crooked of ways** in 28:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:18 (#5)

יִפֹּל

“will fall”

See how you translated the same use of **fall** in 11:5.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:18 (#2)

הוֹלֵךְ תָּמִים

“One walking blameless”

Here Solomon refers to someone behaving in a blameless manner as if that person **walks blameless**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of “walk” in 3:23. Alternate translation: [One who conducts his life in a blameless manner]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:18 (#1)

הוֹלֵךְ & וְנֶעְקָשׁ

“One walking & but one crooked of”

The phrases **One walking** and **one crooked of ways** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who walks ... but any person who is crooked]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:18 (#3)

יִוָּשֵׁעַ

“will be saved”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will save]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 28:19 (#1)

עֹבֵד אַדְמָתוֹ יִשְׂבַּע־לָחֶם

“One working his ground will be satisfied {with} bread”

See how you translated the identical clause in 12:11.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:19 (#2)

וּמְרַדֵּף רֵקִים

“but one pursuing empty things”

See how you translated the identical phrase in 12:11.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:19 (#4)

רִישׁ

“with} poverty”

See how you translated the abstract noun **poverty** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:19 (#3)

יִשְׂבַּע־רִישׁ

“will be satisfied {with} poverty”

Here Solomon is using irony. By doing so, Solomon actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of his words. The **one who pursues empty things** is spoken of as being **satisfied with poverty**, but **poverty** is not satisfying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will only have poverty]

See: Irony

Proverbs 28:20 (#2)

אִישׁ אֱמוּנוֹת

“A man of faithfulness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **faithfulness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A faithful man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 28:20 (#3)

רַב

“has} an abundance of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **abundance** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:20 (#4)

לֹא יִנָּקֶה

“will not remain blameless”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 28:20 (#1)

אִישׁ אֱמוּנוֹת & וְאָץ

“A man of faithfulness & but one hurrying”

A man of faithfulness and **one who hurries** refer to these types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of faithfulness ... but any person who hurries]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:21 (#3)

וְעַל־פַּת־לֶחֶם

“yet for a bit of bread”

Here, **a bit of bread** is an extreme statement for emphasis, exaggerating how tiny the reward is that some people will accept for doing something evil. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [yet for a very small bribe] or [yet for just a small amount of food]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 28:21 (#2)

לֹא־טוֹב

“is} not good”

See how you translated the same use of **not good** in 16:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 28:21 (#5)

יִפְשַׁע

“will transgress”

Here Solomon implies that this person **will transgress** by **Recognizing faces**, as mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will transgress by recognizing faces] or [will transgress by unjustly favoring someone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:21 (#1)

הַכֵּר־פָּנִים

“Recognizing faces”

See how you translated this phrase in 24:23.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:21 (#4)

גָּבֶר

“a man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 28:22 (#2)

נִבְהָל לַהוֹן

“One hurrying to the wealth”

Here Solomon implies that this person **hurries to** obtain **wealth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated the similar phrase “one who hurries to become rich” in 28:20. Alternate translation: [One who hurries to gain wealth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:22 (#4)

חֶסֶר

“lack”

See how you translated the abstract noun **lack** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:22 (#5)

חֶסֶר יְבֹאֶנּוּ

“lack will come to him”

Here Solomon speaks of experiencing **lack** as if “lack” were a person who could **come** to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will experience lack]

See: Personification

Proverbs 28:22 (#1)

נִבְהָל & אִישׁ & וְלֹא־יֹדֵעַ & יְבֹאֶנּוּ

“One hurrying & is} a man of & but he does not know & will come to him”

One hurrying, **a man**, **he**, and **him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who hurries ... is a person of ... but that person does not know ... will come to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:22 (#3)

אִישׁ רַע עָיִן

“is} a man of an evil eye”

See how you translated the similar phrase “one evil of eye” in 23:6.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:23 (#4)

חֵן

“favor”

Here Solomon implies that **One who rebukes will find favor** with the person whom he rebukes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [favor with the one he rebuked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:23 (#2)

יִמְצָא

“will find”

See how you translated the same use of **find** in 16:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:23 (#1)

מֹוכִיחַ אָדָם & מֵמַחֲלִיק לָשׁוֹן

“One rebuking a man & more than one making the tongue smooth”

One rebuking, **a man**, **one making** and **the tongue** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who rebukes any other person ... more than any person who makes that person’s own tongue smooth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:23 (#3)

חֵן

“favor”

See how you translated the abstract noun **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:23 (#5)

מֵמַחֲלִיק לָשׁוֹן

“more than one making the tongue smooth”

Here Solomon refers to someone speaking flatteringly as if that person **makes** his **tongue smooth**. Here, **tongue** refers to speaking, as in 6:17. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [more than one who flatters by what he says]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:24 (#3)

פֹּשֵׁעַ

“transgression”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:24 (#1)

גּוֹזֵל ׀ אָבִיו וְאִמּוֹ & הוּא לְאִישׁ מַשְׁחִית

“One robbing his father and his mother & he & of a man of destruction”

One robbing, **his**, **he**, and **a man** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who robs that person’s own mother and father … that person … of a person of destruction]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:24 (#4)

חָבֵר & לְאִישׁ מַשְׁחִית

“is} the companion of a man of destruction”

Here, **companion** refers to being just like **a man of destruction**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the same kind of person as a man of destruction]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:24 (#2)

וְאֹמֵר אֵין־פָּשַׁע

“and says, “There is no transgression”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [and says that there is no transgression]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 28:24 (#5)

לְאִישׁ מַשְׁחִית

“of a man of destruction”

The phrase **man of destruction** can refer to a person who destroys people and property. In this case, the property is being removed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of a vandal]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:25 (#3)

יְגָרֶה

“stirs up”

Here Solomon refers to starting **strife** as if it were something that a person **stirs up**. See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 15:18.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:25 (#4)

מָדוֹן

“strife”

See how you translated the abstract noun **strife** in 16:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:25 (#1)

רְחַב־נֶפֶשׁ & וּבוֹטֵחַ

“One wide of appetite & but one who trusts”

One wide of appetite and **one who trusts** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person wide of appetite … but any person who trusts]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:25 (#5)

יְדֻשָּׁן

“will be fattened”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he will fatten]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 28:25 (#6)

יְדֻשָּׁן

“will be fattened”

See how you translated the same use of **fattened** in 11:25.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:25 (#2)

רְחַב־נֶפֶשׁ

“One wide of appetite”

The phrase **wide of appetite** refers to being greedy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A greedy one]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:26 (#2)

בְּלִבּוֹ

“in his heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts, feelings, and intentions exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [in his own brain] or [in his own thoughts and feelings]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:26 (#5)

הוּא יִמָּלֵט

“he himself will flee”

Solomon uses the word **himself** to emphasize the kind of person who **will flee**. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [that very person will flee]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 28:26 (#4)

בְּחָכְמָה

“in wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:26 (#6)

הוּא יִמָּלֵט

“he himself will flee”

Here Solomon implies that this person **will flee** from danger. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he himself will flee from danger]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:26 (#3)

וְהוֹלֵךְ

“but one walking”

Here Solomon speaks of a person behaving with **wisdom** as if **wisdom** were a place that person **walks in**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of “walk” in 3:23. Alternate translation: [who behaves with wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:26 (#1)

בּוֹטֵחַ בְּלִבּוֹ הוּא כְסִיל וְהוֹלֵךְ בְּחָכְמָה הוּא יִמָּלֵט

“One trusting in his heart, he {is} a stupid one, but one walking in wisdom, he himself will flee”

One trusting, **his**, **he**, **a stupid one**, **one walking**, and **himself** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who trusts in that person’s own heart, that person is stupid, but any person who walks in wisdom, that person will flee]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:27 (#6)

רַב־מְאֵרוֹת

“an abundance of curses”

Here, **an abundance of curses** could mean: (1) many people will curse the person **who hides his eyes**. Alternate translation: [many people will curse him]; (2) Yahweh will curse the person abundantly **who hides his eyes**. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will curse that person abundantly]

Proverbs 28:27 (#3)

מַחְסוֹר & רַב

“lack & an abundance of”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **lack** in 6:11 and **abundance** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:27 (#5)

וּמַעְלִים עֵינָיו

“but one hiding his eyes”

Here, **hides his eyes** refers to ignoring the needs of poor people as if one closes his **eyes** to avoid seeing them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who refuses to notice]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 28:27 (#2)

אֵין מַחְסוֹר

“there is no lack”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [has plenty]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 28:27 (#1)

נוֹתֵ֣ן לָ֭רָשׁ & וּמַעְלִ֣ים עֵינָ֑יו

“One giving to the one who is poor & but one hiding his eyes”

One who gives, **the one who is poor**, **one who hides**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who gives to any person who is poor … but any person who hides that person’s own eyes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:27 (#4)

וּמַעְלִ֣ים עֵינָ֑יו

“but one hiding his eyes”

Here Solomon implies that this person **hides his eyes** from seeing **the one who is poor**, who is mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but one who hides his eyes so that he does not see the poor] or [but one who hides his eyes from seeing the poor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:28 (#1)

בְּקוּם֥ רְ֝שָׁעִ֗ים

“When wicked ones arise”

See how you translated the same use of **arise** in 28:12.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:28 (#2)

יִסָּתֵ֥ר אָ֝דָ֗ם

“a man will hide himself”

Here, **a man** and **himself** refer to people in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any person will hide]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 29 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Hezekiah’s proverbs from Solomon (25:1–29:27)

- Warnings and admonitions (25:1–27:27)
- Contrastive wise sayings (28:1–29:27)

Chapter 29 finishes the second part of this section of the book that contains proverbs written by Solomon that were copied by scribes during the reign of Hezekiah. This part in 28:1–29:27 mostly contains general proverbs that use contrastive parallelism.

Proverbs 29:1 (#2)

אִ֭ישׁ תּוֹכָח֣וֹת

“A man of rebukes”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe **A man** who has received many **rebukes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A man who is often rebuked]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:1 (#1)

אִ֭ישׁ תּוֹכָח֣וֹת

“A man of rebukes”

A man of rebukes here represents a type of person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of rebukes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:1 (#3)

מַקְשֶׁ֣ה־עֹ֭רֶף

“who stiffens the neck”

Here Solomon speaks of a person becoming stubborn as if that person **stiffens** his **neck**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who becomes stubborn] or [who refuses to listen]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:1 (#4)

פֶּ֭תַע יִשָּׁבֵ֣ר וְאֵ֑ין מַרְפֵּֽא

“will suddenly be broken and without healing”

See how you translated the same clause in 6:15.

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 29:2 (#2)

הָעָ֣ם & עָ֑ם

“the people & a people”

In this verse, the word **people** is singular in form, but it refers to multiple **people** as a group. See how you translated the same use of **people** in 11:14.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 29:2 (#4)

יֵאָנֵֽחַ

“groans”

Here, **groans** refers to the sound **people** make to express that they are miserable, which is the opposite of **rejoice** in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [groans in misery]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:2 (#1)

בְּרִבְב֣וֹת צַדִּיקִ֣ים

“When the righteous increase”

Here, **increase** could refer to: (1) the **righteous ones** increasing in power or authority. This fits the parallelism with the second line. Alternate translation: [When righteous ones increase in power] or [When righteous ones become more powerful]; (2) the number of **righteous ones** increasing. Alternate translation: [When righteous ones increase in number] or [When righteous ones multiply greatly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:2 (#3)

רָ֝שָׁ֗ע

“a wicked {one”

See how you translated **a wicked one** in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:3 (#4)

יְאַבֵּד־הֽוֹן

“destroys wealth”

Here, **destroys wealth** implies that this person has wasted all his money. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [squanders his wealth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:3 (#3)

וְרֹעֶ֥ה

“but one who associates with”

Solomon is referring to a person having sex with **prostitutes** in a polite way by using the phrase **associates with**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who sleeps with] or [but one who has sexual relations with]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 29:3 (#2)

חָכְמָ֑ה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:3 (#1)

אִ֤ישׁ & אָבִ֗יו וְרֹעֶ֥ה

“A man & his father, but one who associates with”

A man, **his**, and **one who associates** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person ... that person’s father, but any person who associates with]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:4 (#5)

וְאִ֥ישׁ תְּרוּמ֗וֹת

“but a man of contributions”

This refers to a leader who demands money from people. This could refer more specifically to: (1) someone who demands bribes. Alternate translation: [but a man who demands bribes]; (2) a ruler who demands excessive taxes from the people he rules over. Alternate translation: [but a man who demands tribute] or [but a man who extorts his people]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:4 (#6)

וְאִישׁ

“but a man of”

The parallelism between the two clauses in this verse indicates that the phrase **a man** here refers to a **king** or leader in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but a ruler of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:4 (#1)

מֶ֭לֶךְ & וְאִישׁ תְּרוּמ֣וֹת

“A king & but a man of contributions”

A king and **a man of contributions** refer to a types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any king is one who scatters ... but any man of contributions]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:4 (#3)

אָ֑רֶץ & יֲהָרְסֶ֣נָּה

“the land & tears it down”

Here, **land** and **it** refer to the people who live in a **land**. See how you translated the same use of these words in 28:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:4 (#2)

בְּ֝מִשְׁפָּ֗ט

“by justice”

See how you translated the abstract noun **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:4 (#7)

יֲהָרְסֶ֣נָּה

“tears it down”

Here Solomon refers to the people of **the land** failing as if someone **tears** them **down**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes the people of the land to fail]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:4 (#4)

יַעֲמִ֣יד אָ֑רֶץ

“causes the land to stand”

Here Solomon refers to the people of **the land** being successful as if they would continue **to stand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes the land to be successful]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:5 (#1)

גָּ֭בֶר & רֵעֵ֣הוּ & פְּעָמָ֑יו

“A man & his neighbor & his steps”

A man and **his** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person ... that person’s neighbor ... that person’s feet]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:5 (#2)

מַֽחֲלִ֥יק עַל־רֵעֵ֗הוּ

“who makes smooth for his neighbor”

Here Solomon writes of someone speaking flatteringly as if that person were making their speech **smooth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who flatters his neighbor]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:5 (#3)

רָ֭שֶׁת פֹּרֵ֣שׂ עַל־פְּעָמָ֑יו

“spreads out a net for his steps”

Here Solomon refers to deceiving a person as if someone **spreads out a net** in order to trap their neighbor by **his steps**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is actually his enemy] or [is like someone who spreads out a net where he knows that his neighbor will walk]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:6 (#1)

בְּפֶ֣שַׁע

“In the transgression of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:6 (#2)

אִישׁ רָ֭עַ & וְ֣צַדִּ֑יק

“an evil man & but a righteous {one”

Here, **an evil man** and **a righteous one** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a righteous one** in 9:9. Alternate translation: [any evil person ... but any righteous person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:6 (#3)

מוֹקֵ֥שׁ

“a snare & is”

Here Solomon speaks of a person causing his life to be in danger as if he were an animal that gets caught in **a snare**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated **snare** in 22:25. Alternate translation: [he endangers his life] or [there is danger]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:7 (#4)

דַּלִּ֗ים

“the lowly”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:7 (#1)

צַדִּ֣יק & רָ֭שָׁע

“A righteous {one & a wicked {one”

See how you translated **A righteous one** in 9:9 and **a wicked one** in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:7 (#3)

דִּ֣ין

“the legal claim of”

Here, **legal claim** refers to the legal rights of **lowly ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [justice for]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:7 (#5)

רָ֭שָׁע

“a wicked {one”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, a wicked one]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 29:7 (#2)

יֹדֵ֣עַ & דָּ֑עַת

“knows & knowledge”

In this verse, **knows** and **knowledge** refer to having concern for **the legal claim of lowly ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is concerned about ... concern]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:8 (#4)

יָשִׁ֖יבוּ אָ֣ף

“turn away nose”

Here Solomon refers to people ceasing to feel angry as if they were turning their noses away from the person with whom they are angry. See how you translated the similar phrase “turns away his nose” in 24:18. Alternate translation: [stop others from being angry]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:8 (#1)

אַנְשֵׁי־לֵ֣צוֹן

“Men of mockery”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **Men** who are characterized by **mockery**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Men who are mockers]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:8 (#2)

יָפִ֥יחוּ

“inflame”

Here Solomon refers to people causing the people in **a city** to become angry and violent as if they were setting the **city** on fire. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [enrage] or [cause turmoil in]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:8 (#3)

קִרְיָ֣ה

“a city”

Here, **city** refers to the people who live in a **city**. See how you translated the same use of **city** in 11:10.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:9 (#4)

וְאֵ֥ין נָ֖חַת

“and there is no rest”

This could mean: (1) there will be no resolution to the **judgment**. Alternate translation: [and they will not be able to settle the problem]; (2) the **foolish** person will not be quiet. Alternate translation: [and will not stop doing so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:9 (#1)

אִישׁ־חָכָ֗ם & אֶת־אִ֣ישׁ אֱוִ֣יל וְרָגַ֔ז

“A wise man & with a foolish man, but he rages”

A wise man, **a foolish man**, and **he** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **A wise man** in 16:14. Alternate translation: [Any wise person ... with any foolish person, but that foolish person trembles]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:9 (#3)

וְ֝שָׂחַ֗ק

“and he laughs”

Here, **laughs** refers to laughing in a mocking manner, not joyful laughter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he laughs mockingly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:9 (#2)

וְרָגַ֔ז

“but he rages”

Here, **rages** refers to the **foolish** person gesturing violently because he is angry. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but he gestures violently]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:10 (#3)

וְ֝יִשָּׁרִ֗ים יְבַקְּשׁ֥וּ נַפְשׁ֑וֹ

“but upright {ones} seek his life”

Here, the phrase **seek his life** refers to: (1) **upright ones** seeking the **life** of **a blameless one** in a good way, that is, desiring to protect his life. Alternate translation: [but upright ones want to protect his life]; (2) **Men of bloodshed** desiring to kill **upright ones**. This would allow the phrase **seek his life** to have its normal meaning of “want to kill him,” but it would force the singular pronoun **his** to refer to the plural phrase, **upright ones**. Alternate translation: [as for upright ones, him they want to kill]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:10 (#1)

אַנְשֵׁ֣י דָ֭מִים

“Men of bloodshed”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to refer to **Men** who shed the blood of other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Men who shed the blood of others] or [Men who kill others]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:10 (#2)

תָּ֑מִים

“a blameless {one”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:5 and “blameless ones” in 2:21.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:11 (#1)

כְּסִ֣יל ׀ וְחָכָ֣ם

“A stupid {one & but a wise {one”

See how you translated **A stupid one** in 10:18 and **a wise one** in 1:5.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:11 (#2)

כָּל־רוּחוֹ יוֹצִיא

“brings out all his spirit”

Here Solomon refers to a person openly expressing **all** of his emotions as if his emotions were a **spirit** that he **brings out** of himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [openly expresses all his emotions]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:11 (#3)

בְּאָחוֹר יְשַׁבְּחֶנָּה

“soothes it backward”

Here Solomon refers to a person controlling the expression of his emotions as if he **soothes** those emotions so that they go **backward** into him. The meaning of this phrase is the opposite of the meaning of **brings out all his spirit** in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [restrains himself from openly expressing his emotions]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:12 (#3)

דְּבַר־שָׁקֶר

“a word of falsehood”

See how you translated this phrase in 13:5.

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:12 (#2)

מַקְשִׁיב עַל

“who listens attentively to”

Here, **listens attentively** implies that this **ruler** believes what he **listens** to. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who believes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:12 (#1)

מֹשֵׁל & דְּבַר־שָׁקֶר & מְשָׁרְתָיו

“A ruler & a word of falsehood & his servants”

A ruler, **a word of falsehood**, and **his** refer to people and false words in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any ruler … any word of falsehood … that person’s servants]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:13 (#2)

וְאִישׁ תְּכָכִים

“and a man of oppression”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by oppressing other people. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a man who oppresses others]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:13 (#4)

מְמָאִיר־עֵינֵי שְׁנֵיהֶם

“the one enlightening the eyes of the two of them”

Here, **enlightens the eyes** is an idiom that means “gives life to someone” or “makes someone alive” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one who enables both of them to live]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:13 (#3)

נִפְגָּשׁוּ

“meet together”

See how you translated the same use of **meet together** in 22:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:13 (#1)

רָשׁ וְאִישׁ תְּכָכִים

“A poor one and a man of oppression”

One who is poor and **a man of oppression** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use different more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who is poor and any man of oppression]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:14 (#2)

דַּלִּֽים

“the lowly”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:14 (#4)

כִּסְאֹ֖ו & יִכּ֥וֹן

“his throne will be established”

See how you translated this phrase in 25:5.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:14 (#1)

מֶ֣לֶךְ & כִּסְאֹ֖ו

“A king & his throne”

A king and **his** refer to kings in general, not a specific **king**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **A king** in 29:4. Alternate translation: [Any king ... that king’s throne]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:14 (#5)

לָעַ֥ד

“to perpetuity”

Solomon uses the phrase **to perpetuity** here as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [for a very long time]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 29:14 (#3)

בֶּאֱמֶֽת

“with truth”

See how you translated the abstract noun **truth** in 8:7.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:15 (#4)

וְתוֹכַ֣חַת & חָכְמָ֑ה & מְבִישׁ

“and rebuke & wisdom & causes & shame”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **rebuke** in 1:25, **wisdom** in 1:2, and **shame** in 6:33.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:15 (#3)

שֵׁ֖בֶט

“A rod”

See how you translated the same use of **rod** in 10:13 and 13:24.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:15 (#1)

שֵׁ֖בֶט וְתוֹכַ֣חַת יִתֵּ֑ן חָכְמָ֗ה

“A rod and rebuke give wisdom”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the next clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A rod and rebuke give a boy wisdom]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 29:15 (#2)

שֵׁ֖בֶט וְתוֹכַ֣חַת יִתֵּ֑ן חָכְמָ֗ה

“A rod and rebuke give wisdom”

Here Solomon speaks of people using a **rod and rebuke** to make someone wiser as if a **rod and rebuke** were people who could **give** something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Through discipline and correction parents give a boy wisdom]

See: Personification

Proverbs 29:15 (#5)

וְנַ֖עַר & אִמּֽוֹ

“but a boy & his mother”

Here, **a boy** and **his** refer to children in general, not a specific **boy**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [but any child ... that child’s mother]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:15 (#6)

מְשֻׁלָּֽח

“let loose”

Here, **let loose** is an idiom that refers to permitting someone do whatever that person wants to do. If it

would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who is left to himself] or [who is unrestrained]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:15 (#7)

מְשֻׁלָּח

“let loose”

The expression **let loose** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom his parents let go] or [whom his parents do not discipline]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 29:16 (#3)

בָּמַפַּלְתָּתָם

“see their downfall”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **downfall**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [them being destroyed] or [it when they can no longer rule]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:16 (#2)

פָּשַׁע

“transgression”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:16 (#1)

בִּרְבֹות רְשָׁעִים

“When the wicked increase”

Here, **increase** could refer to: (1) **the wicked** increasing their influence or authority in society. Alternate translation: [When wicked ones increase in authority]; (2) the number of **the wicked** increasing. Alternate translation: [When wicked ones increase in number] or [When wicked ones multiply greatly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:16 (#4)

בָּמַפַּלְתָּתָם

“see their downfall”

Here, **downfall** refers to **the wicked** losing the power and influence that is described in the first line of this verse as when they **increase**. Therefore, **downfall** here would have a meaning similar to “fall” in 11:5. Alternate translation: [their loss of power] or [their destruction]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:17 (#2)

יַסֵּר בִּנְךָ וְיָנִיחֶךָּ

“Discipline your son, and he will cause you to rest”

The word translated as **Discipline** is an imperative, but it communicates a condition rather than a command. If your language does not use an imperative in this way, then use a form in your language that communicates a condition. Alternate translation: [If you discipline your son, then he will cause you to rest]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 29:17 (#4)

וְיָנִיחֶךָּ

“and he will cause you to rest”

Here, Solomon is speaking as if being free from worry were actually resting. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will put you at ease] or [and he will make you feel peaceful]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:17 (#6)

לְנַפְשֶׁךָּ

“to your soul”

See how you translated the same use of **soul** in 2:10. Alternate translate: “to your inner being” or “to you”

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:17 (#3)

וְיָנִיחֶךָּ

“and he will cause you to rest”

Here, **and** introduces the result of disciplining one’s **son**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [As a result, he will cause you to rest]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 29:17 (#5)

וְיִתֵּ֣ן מַעֲדַנֵּ֔ים לְנַפְשֶׁ֖ךָ

“and he will give delights to your soul”

Here Solomon speaks of a **son** causing his parents to feel delighted as if **delights** were objects that he can **give** to them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translate: “and he will delight you”

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:17 (#1)

בִּנְךָ

“your son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 29:18 (#5)

וְשֹׁמֵ֥ר תּוֹרָ֖ה

“but one keeping the law”

See how you translated the similar phrase “keep the law” in 28:4.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:18 (#2)

עָ֑ם

“the people”

See how you translated the same use of **people** in 11:14.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 29:18 (#3)

יִפָּ֣רַֽע

“are let loose”

Here Solomon refers to **people** acting disorderly or uncontrollably, as if they were **let loose** from being restrained. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [act disorderly] or [are out of control]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:18 (#4)

וְשֹׁמֵ֥ר תּוֹרָ֖ה אַשְׁרֵ֥הוּ

“but one keeping the law, happy {is} he”

Here, **one keeping** and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [but any person who keeps the law, happy is that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:18 (#1)

חָזֹ֖ון

“vision”

Here, **vision** refers specifically to information that Yahweh reveals to prophets so that they can tell it to **the people**. It is also called “prophecy” or “divine revelation”. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [prophecy] or [revelation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:19 (#4)

מַעֲנֶ֑ה

“answer”

Here, **answer** refers to the servant responding by obeying. Alternate translation: [obedient response]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:19 (#2)

לֹא־יִוָּסֵ֥ר עָ֖בֶד

“A servant will not be instructed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [No one can instruct a servant]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 29:19 (#3)

בִּדְבָרִ֑ים

“by words”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:19 (#1)

עָ֖בֶד & יָבִ֥ין

“A servant & he understands”

A servant and **he** refer to servants in general, not a specific **servant**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any servant ... that person understands]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:20 (#2)

אִ֣ישׁ אָ֭צַ֣ן בִּדְבָרָ֑יו

“a man hurrying in his words”

See how you translated **a man** and **his** in 6:27.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 29:20 (#1)

חָזִ֥יתָ אִ֝֗ישׁ אָ֭צַ֣ן בִּדְבָרָ֑יו

“You see a man hurrying in his words”

Although the Hebrew text is not marked as a question, many translators consider this clause to be a rhetorical question. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this as a question. See how you translated the similar use of **You see** in 22:29. Alternate translation: [Do you see a man hurrying in his words?]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 29:20 (#4)

תִּקְוָ֣ה לִכְסִ֣יל מִמֶּ֣נּוּ

“There is more} hope for a stupid one than him”

See how you translated this sentence in 26:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:20 (#3)

אָ֭צַ֣ן בִּדְבָרָ֑יו

“hurrying in his words”

Here, **hurrying in his words** is an idiom that means “speaking before thinking about what to say.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [talking off the cuff] or [who speaks without thinking]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:21 (#2)

מְפַנֵּ֣ק מִנֹּ֣עַר עַ֭בְדּ֑וֹ

“Pampering his servant from youth”

The pronoun **his** refers to the master of the servant, who has not been stated in the verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [If a master pampers his servant from youth]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 29:21 (#3)

מִנֹּ֣עַר

“from youth”

See how you translated the abstract noun **youth** in 2:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:21 (#4)

וְ֝אַחֲרִיתֹ֗ו

“then his end”

Here, **end** refers to the result. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated the same use of **end** in 14:12.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:21 (#1)

מִנֹּ֣עַר

“from youth”

Here Solomon implies that **youth** refers to the **youth** of the **servant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from that servant’s youth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:21 (#5)

מָנ֑וֹן

“insolence”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **insolence**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [acting disrespectfully]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:22 (#4)

יְגָרֶ֥ה מָ֝דֹ֗ון

“stirs up strife”

See how you translated the same phrase in 15:18.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:22 (#6)

פָּשַׁע

“transgression”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:22 (#3)

אִישׁ־אַף & וּבַעַל חֵמָה

“A man of nose & and an owner of heat”

See how you translated the same use of **nose** and **heat** in 22:24.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:22 (#2)

אִישׁ־אַף & וּבַעַל חֵמָה

“A man of nose & and an owner of heat”

A man of nose and **an owner of heat** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of nose ... and any owner of heat]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:22 (#1)

אִישׁ־אַף יְגָרֶה מָדוֹן וּבַעַל חֵמָה רַב־פָּשַׁע

“A man of nose stirs up strife, and an owner of heat, much transgression”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** that indicates that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A man of nose stirs up strife; indeed, an owner of heat stirs up much transgression]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 29:22 (#5)

וּבַעַל חֵמָה רַב־פָּשַׁע

“and an owner of heat, much transgression”

Solomon is leaving out some words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and an owner of heat stirs up much transgression]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 29:23 (#5)

רוּחַ

“spirit”

Here, **spirit** refers to a person’s attitude. See how you translated the same use of **spirit** in 18:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:23 (#4)

וּשְׁפַל־רוּחַ

“but {one} lowly of spirit”

Here, **lowly** refers to being humble. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one humble of spirit]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:23 (#1)

גַּאֲוַת

“The pride of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **pride** in 8:13.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:23 (#6)

יִתְמֹךְ כָּבוֹד

“will grasp honor”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:23 (#3)

תַּשְׁפִּילֶנּוּ

“will make him low”

Here, **low** refers to being humiliated or ashamed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will make him ashamed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:23 (#2)

אָדָם תַּשְׁפִּילֶנּוּ וּשְׁפַל־רוּחַ

“a man will make him low, but {one} lowly of spirit”

Here, **a man**, **him**, and **one** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person will make that person low, but any person lowly of spirit]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:24 (#2)

חוֹלֵק עִם־גַּנָּב

“One who shares with a thief”

Here, **shares** implies that this person helps **a thief** and that **thief** gives him part of what he has stolen. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who helps a thief and shares in his spoil] or [An accomplice of a thief]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:24 (#4)

נַפְשׁוֹ

“his life”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 8:36.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:24 (#3)

שׂוֹנֵא

“hates”

Here Solomon refers to a person doing what is harmful to himself as if he hates himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [harms] or [acts as if he hates]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:24 (#1)

חוֹלֵק עִם־גַּנָּב שׂוֹנֵא נַפְשׁוֹ אָלָה יִשְׁמַע

“One who shares with a thief hates his life; he hears the oath”

One who shares, **a thief**, **his**, and **he** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who shares with any thief hates that person’s own life; that person will hear an oath]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:24 (#5)

אָלָה יִשְׁמַע

“he hears the oath”

Here, **oath** refers to the curse that would be spoken against someone who did not speak the truth or reveal important information in a criminal case, as described in Leviticus 5:1–6. The witness who hears this **oath** knows that Yahweh will punish him if he does not speak the truth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he will hear the curse spoken against those who keep silent about the crime] or [he will hear and know that he will be cursed if he does not say anything]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:24 (#6)

וְלֹא יַגִּיד

“but does not tell”

Here Solomon implies that this person **will not tell** anything about the crime that he knows the **thief** has committed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but will not say what the thief did]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:25 (#1)

חֶרְדַּת

“The anxiety of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **anxiety** in 15:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:25 (#3)

יִתֵּתֵּן מוֹקֵקֵשׁ

“sets a snare”

Here Solomon speaks of someone causing trouble for himself as if his **anxiety** were a person who **sets a snare** that traps him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [causes him to get into trouble] or [is like someone who sets a trap]

See: Personification

Proverbs 29:25 (#2)

אָדָם & וּבוֹטֵחַ

“a man & but the one trusting”

Here, **a man** and **one trusting** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person ... but any person who trusts]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:25 (#4)

יְשֻׂגָּב

“will be set on high”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will set him on high]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 29:25 (#5)

יְשֻׂגָּב

“will be set on high”

See how you translated the same use of **set on high** in 18:10.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:26 (#1)

מְבַקְשִׁים פְּנֵי־מוֹשֵׁל

“are} those who seek the face of a ruler”

Here Solomon implies that these people **seek the face of a ruler** in order to ask him to help them in some way. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [are those who seek the face of a ruler to ask for his help]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:26 (#5)

מִשְׁפַּט־אִישׁ

“is} justice of a man”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **justice** that is for the benefit of **a man**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is justice for a man] or [is justice on behalf of a man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:26 (#4)

מוֹשֵׁל & אִישׁ

“a ruler & a man”

Here, **a ruler** and **a man** refer to rulers and other people in general, not a specific **ruler** or **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any ruler ... any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:26 (#2)

מְבַקְשִׁים פְּנֵי

“are} those who seek the face of”

Here Solomon speaks of people trying to meet **a ruler** as if the ruler’s **face** were an object that people **seek** to find. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are those who try to meet]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:26 (#6)

מִשְׁפַּט

“is} justice of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:26 (#3)

פְּנֵי

“the face of”

Here, **face** refers to being in the presence of the person. See how you translated the same use of **face** in 7:15.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:27 (#4)

יְשַׁר־דָּרֶךְ

“is} {one} upright of way”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **way** that is characterized by being **upright**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this,

you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is one whose way is upright]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:27 (#1)

תוֹעֲבַת & וְתוֹעֲבַת

“An abomination to & but an abomination to”

See how you translated the abstract noun **abomination** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:27 (#2)

אִישׁ עָוֶל וְתוֹעֲבַת רָשָׁעָע יְשַׁר־דָּרֶךְ

“is} a man of injustice, but an abomination to the wicked {is} {one} upright of way”

Here, **a man of injustice**, **a wicked one**, and **one upright of way** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a wicked one** in 9:7. Alternate translation: [is any person of injustice, but an abomination to any wicked person is a person upright of way]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:27 (#3)

אִישׁ עָוֶל

“is} a man of injustice”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **injustice**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is an unjust man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:27 (#5)

דָּרֶךְ

“way”

Here Solomon uses **way** to refer to how people behave. See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs - Chapter 30 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Sayings from Agur (30:1–33)

- Agur’s confession and prayer (30:1–9)
- Seven numerical sayings (30:10–31)
- Concluding warning (30:32–33)

Chapter 30 is the chapter in this book written by Agur, who is only mentioned here in the Bible.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Numerical sayings
In Proverbs 30:10–31, Agur uses a rhetorical device in which he names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. If your language does not use numbers in this way, then consider more natural ways to express the emphasis. Although he does not state the number of illustrations in 30:10–14, he does state the number of illustrations for the sayings in 30:15–16, 18–19, 21–23, 24–28, and 29–31.

Proverbs 30:1 (#1)

דִּבְרֵי

“The words of”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:1 (#5)

לְאִיתִיאֵל לְאִיתִיאֵל וְאָכָל

“to Ithiel, to Ithiel and Ucal”

All Hebrew manuscripts read **to Ithiel, to Ithiel and Ucal**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient translations of this text read “I am weary, O God. I am worn out and weary, O God,” which is based on a possible meaning for the Hebrew words. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 30:1 (#4)

הַגֶּבֶר

“the strong man”

Here, **the strong man** refers to **Agur**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Agur, the strong man,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:1 (#2)

אָגוּר & יָקֶה & לְאִיתִיאֵל לְאִיתִיאֵל וְאָכָל

“Agur & Jakeh & to Ithiel, to Ithiel and Ucal”

Agur, **Jakeh**, **Ithiel**, and **Ucal** are names of men.

See: How to Translate Names

Proverbs 30:1 (#3)

הַמַּשָּׂ֑א

“the burden”

Here, **burden** refers to a warning message that Yahweh reveals to prophets so that they can tell the warning to other people. Because this message contained a warning or threat, it was considered to be a **burden** to the person who heard it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the warning from Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:2 (#2)

כִּֽי

“Surely”

30:2–33 is a long quotation of what Agur said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Proverbs 30:2 (#5)

בִּינַ֥ת

“the understanding of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 30:2 (#1)

בַּבַּ֣עַר אָנֹכִ֣י מֵאִ֣ישׁ וְלֹא־בִינַ֣ת אָדָ֣ם לִֽי

“I {am} more stupid than a man, and the understanding of man {is} not mine”

Agur says these two clauses as extreme statements for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [I feel like I am more stupid than a man, and that the understanding of mankind is not mine]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 30:2 (#3)

בַּבַּ֣עַר אָנֹכִ֣י מֵאִ֣ישׁ וְלֹא־בִינַ֣ת אָדָ֣ם לִֽי

“I {am} more stupid than a man, and the understanding of man {is} not mine”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I am more stupid than a man; indeed, the understanding of mankind in not mine]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:2 (#4)

מֵאִ֣ישׁ & אָדָ֣ם

“than a man & man”

In this verse, **man** refers to people in general, not to a specific **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [than any person ... any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:3 (#2)

חָכְמָ֑ה וְדַ֖עַת

“wisdom, nor the knowledge of”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 30:3 (#3)

קְדֹשִֽׁים

“holy ones”

Here, **holy ones** could refer to: (1) Yahweh as the Holy One, in which case the plural form is used to emphasize his greatness. Alternate translation: [the Holy One]; (2) heavenly beings, including God and angels. Alternate translation: [holy beings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:3 (#1)

וְלֹא־לָמַ֥דְתִּי חָכְמָ֑ה וְדַ֖עַת קְדֹשִׁ֣ים אֵדָֽע

“And I have not learned wisdom, nor the knowledge of holy ones do I know”

Agur says these two clauses as extreme statements for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And I feel like I have not learned wisdom, nor the knowledge of holy ones do I know]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 30:4 (#1)

מִֽי עָלָה־שָׁמַ֥יִם ׀ וַיֵּרַ֑ד מִֽי אָסַ֥ף־רוּחַ֙ ׀ בְּחָפְנָ֔יו מִֽי צָרַר־מַ֖יִם ׀ בַּשִּׂמְלָ֑ה מִֽי הֵקִ֥ים כָּל־אַפְסֵי־אָ֖רֶץ מַה־שְּׁמ֥וֹ וּמַה־שֵּׁ֖ם בְּנ֣וֹ

“Who has ascended {to} heaven and descended? Who has gathered the wind in the hollow of his hands? Who has wrapped waters in the cloak? Who has raised up all the ends of the earth? What {is} his name? And what {is} the name of his son”

In this verse, the writer uses the question form six times to emphasize how much greater Yahweh is than people. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation, as in the UST.

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 30:4 (#6)

מִֽי הֵקִ֥ים כָּל־אַפְסֵי־אָ֖רֶץ

“Who has raised up all the ends of the earth”

Here, Agur speaks of setting the boundaries of the dry land on **the earth** as if the **ends of the earth** were something that a person could raise **up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has set up the limits for where the land ends] or [has marked the boundaries for the ends of the earth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:4 (#3)

מִֽי אָסַ֥ף־רוּחַ֙ ׀ בְּחָפְנָ֔יו

“Who has gathered the wind in the hollow of his hands”

Here, Agur speaks of controlling **the wind** as if it were something that a person could catch and hold in the palm of one’s hand. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Who has controlled the wind]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:4 (#4)

בְּחָפְנָ֔יו

“in the hollow of his hands”

Here, the word translated **hollow** refers to the palm of someone’s hand. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the palms of his hands]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:4 (#5)

מִֽי צָרַר־מַ֖יִם ׀ בַּשִּׂמְלָ֑ה

“Who has wrapped waters in the cloak”

Here, Agur speaks of storing rainwater in clouds as if the **waters** were something that a person could wrap inside a **cloak**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. If a translation is available in your language, see the similar use of **waters** in Job 26:8. Alternate translation: [Who has stored the water in clouds]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:4 (#2)

עָלָה־שָׁמַ֥יִם ׀ וַיֵּרַ֑ד

“has ascended {to} heaven and descended”

Here, Agur speaks of someone going to the place where God dwells and returning from there as if **heaven** were a place that someone could go up to or come down from. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has gone to and returned from the place where Yahweh dwells]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:4 (#7)

מַה־שְּׁמ֥וֹ וּמַה־שֵּׁ֖ם בְּנ֣וֹ כִּֽי־תֵדָֽע

“What {is} his name? And what {is} the name of his son? Surely you know”

Agur uses irony here to emphasize that no one knows of any person who can do those things described earlier in the verse, because such a person does not exist. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Surely, none of you knows the name of someone who has done this or the name of his son, so you cannot claim to know a lot about God]

See: Irony

Proverbs 30:5 (#1)

צְרוּפָ֣ה

“is refined”

Here Agur speaks of the truth of God's words as if his sayings were metal that contained no impurities. See how you translated the phrase "refined gold" in 8:19. Alternate translation: [is tested and proven to be true]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:5 (#2)

מָגֵן הֽוּא

"he {is} a shield"

Here, Agur speaks of **God** protecting people as if he were a **shield**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he is a protector]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:5 (#3)

לַחֹסִים בּוֹ

"for those who take refuge in him"

Here, Agur speaks of people trusting **God** to protect them as if he were a shelter in which people **take refuge**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for those who rely on him to protect them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:6 (#1)

אַל־תּוֹסֵף עַל־דְּבָרָיו

"Do not add upon his words"

Here, Agur refers to someone claiming God said something that he did not say as if that person were adding more **words** to what God has said. Here, **words** refers to what is said, as in 1:23. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not claim that God has said something that he did not really say]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:6 (#2)

וְנִכְזָבְתָּ

"and you be shown a liar"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he show you to be a liar]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:7 (#1)

מֵאִתָּךְ

"from with you"

The pronoun **you** refers to God. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Use the form of address that is appropriate for addressing God in your language. Alternate translation: [from you, God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 30:7 (#2)

אַל־תִּמְנַע

"do not withhold"

This phrase is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please do not withhold]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 30:7 (#3)

אַל־תִּמְנַע

"do not withhold"

Agur is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [do not withhold these two things I request]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 30:7–9 (#1)

שְׁתַּיִם שָׁאַלְתִּי מֵאִתָּךְ

"Two things I ask from with you"

These three verses are a prayer that Agur prays to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Two things I ask from you, O Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:8 (#10)

לֶחֶם

"the bread of"

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 30:8 (#3)

שָׁוְא

“Emptiness”

Emptiness here refers to dishonesty or deception. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Dishonesty]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:8 (#2)

שָׁוְא ׀ וּדְבַר־כָּזָב הַרְחֵק מִמֶּנִּי

“Emptiness and the word of a lie put far away from me”

Here, Agur speaks of **Emptiness** and **the word of a lie** as if they were objects that could be **put far away from** a person. He means that he wants God to prevent him from acting or speaking with **Emptiness and the word of a lie**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Keep me from acting with emptiness and speaking the word of a lie]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:8 (#6)

רֵאשׁ וְעֹשֶׁר אַל־תִּתֶּן־לִי הַלְּטְרִיפֵנִי לֶחֶם חֻקִּי

“Do not give to me poverty or riches; cause me to receive the bread of my portion”

These two clauses are imperative clauses, but they communicate polite requests rather than commands. Use a form in your language that communicates polite requests. It may be helpful to add expressions such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please do not give to me poverty or riches; please cause me to receive the bread of my portion]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 30:8 (#7)

רֵאשׁ וְעֹשֶׁר אַל־תִּתֶּן־לִי

“Do not give to me poverty or riches”

Here, Agur speaks of being poor or rich as if **poverty** and **riches** were physical objects that someone could **give** to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not allow me to be poor or rich]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:8 (#5)

וּדְבַר

“and the word of”

See how you translated the same use of **word** in 12:25.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:8 (#1)

שָׁוְא ׀ וּדְבַר־כָּזָב הַרְחֵק מִמֶּנִּי

“Emptiness and the word of a lie put far away from me”

This is an imperative clause, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please put far away from me emptiness and the word of a lie]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 30:8 (#8)

לֶחֶם חֻקִּי

“the bread of my portion”

This could refer to: (1) an amount of **bread** that Yahweh has allotted for Agur. Alternate translation: [the bread you have apportioned for me]; (2) the amount of **bread** Agur needs to live. Alternate translation: [the bread I need]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:8 (#4)

וּדְבַר־כָּזָב

“and the word of a lie”

Here, Agur is using the possessive form to describe a **word** that is **a lie**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and a lying word]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:8 (#9)

הַלְּטְרִיפֵנִי

“cause me to receive”

This clause is a contrast to the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [rather, cause me to receive] or [cause me to receive instead]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 30:9 (#1)

פֶּֽן־אֶשְׂבַּ֣ע ׀ וְכִחַשְׁתִּי֮ וְאָמַ֪רְתִּי

“Lest I be satiated, and I deny and say”

Agur is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first makes a request of God so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the request. Alternate translation: [otherwise I may become satiated and deny and say]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 30:9 (#6)

וּפֶן־אִוָּרֵ֥שׁ וְגָנַ֑בְתִּי וְ֝תָפַשְׂתִּי

“And lest I become dispossessed and steal, and I seize”

Agur is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first makes a request of God so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the request. Alternate translation: [otherwise I may become dispossessed and steal and seize]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 30:9 (#2)

אֶשְׂבַּ֣ע

“I be satiated”

Here, **satiated** refers to having too much food and possessions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I possess too much]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:9 (#7)

אִוָּרֵ֥שׁ

“I become dispossessed”

Here, **dispossessed** refers to someone becoming so poor that he loses everything that he owns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I become so poor that I own nothing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:9 (#8)

וְ֝תָפַשְׂתִּי

“and I seize”

Here, **and** introduces the result of stealing. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. Alternate translation: [and so I seize]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 30:9 (#10)

שֵׁ֣שֶׁם

“the name of”

Here, **name** refers to a person’s reputation. See how you translated the same use of **name** in 22:1.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:9 (#9)

וְ֝תָפַשְׂתִּי

“and I seize”

Here, Agur speaks of disgracing **the name of my God** as if **the name** were an object that someone could violently **seize** and hurt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I might disgrace]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:9 (#3)

וְכִחַשְׁתִּי֮

“and I deny”

Agur is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and I deny Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 30:9 (#5)

מִ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“Who {is} Yahweh”

Agur is using the question form to emphasize what might happen to him if he became too rich. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I do not know Yahweh!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 30:9 (#4)

וְאָמַ֣רְתִּי מִֽי יְהוָ֑ה

“and say, ‘Who {is} Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [and ask what importance Yahweh has.]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 30:10 (#1)

עֶ֭בֶד אֶל־אדניו & וְיִקָּלְלְךָ

“a slave to his master & he curse you”

Here, **a slave**, **his**, and **he** refer to slaves in general, not a specific **slave**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any slave to that slave’s master ... that slave curse you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:10 (#2)

וְאָשַׁ֥מְתָּ

“and you be found guilty”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people consider you to be guilty]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:10 (#3)

וְאָשַׁ֥מְתָּ

“and you be found guilty”

Agur implies that this person is **guilty** of slandering. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and you be found guilty of slander]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:11 (#3)

אָבִ֥יו יְקַלֵּ֑ל וְאֶת־אִמּ֥וֹ לֹ֝א יְבָרֵֽךְ

“it curses its father and does not bless its mother”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine these clauses and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [it regularly curses its father and mother]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:11 (#2)

דּ֭וֹר אָבִ֣יו יְקַלֵּ֑ל & אִמּ֥וֹ

“There is} a generation, it curses its father & its mother”

In this verse, the words **generation**, **it**, and **its** are singular in form, but they refer to some people as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [There is a group of people, those people curse their fathers ... their mothers]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 30:11 (#1)

דּ֭וֹר אָבִ֣יו יְקַלֵּ֑ל וְאֶת־אִמּ֥וֹ לֹ֝א יְבָרֵֽךְ

“There is} a generation, it curses its father and does not bless its mother”

30:11–14 is the first of six numerical sayings in this chapter, even though this saying does not state the number of illustrations. See the discussion of this in the introduction for this chapter.

Proverbs 30:12 (#2)

טָהֳרָ֑ה

“clean”

Here, Agur speaks of people being innocent of doing anything wrong as if those people were **clean**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [innocent]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:12 (#3)

בְּעֵינֶ֑יו

“in its eyes”

See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 3:4.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:12 (#4)

וּ֝מִצֹּאָתֹ֗ו לֹ֣א רֻחָֽץ

“but it is not washed from its excrement”

Here, Agur speaks of people being guilty of doing something wrong as if those people were **not washed**

and as if the wrong things they did were **excrement**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but it is guilty of doing bad things] or [but it is guilty, as if it has not washed off its excrement]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:12 (#5)

לֹ֣א רֻחָֽץ

“it is not washed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [it has not washed itself]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:12 (#1)

דּ֭וֹר & בְּעֵינָ֣יו וּ֑מְצֹאָתֹ֥ו לֹ֣א רֻחָֽץ

“There is} a generation & in its eyes, but it is not washed from its excrement”

See how you translated the same use of **generation**, **it**, and **its** in the previous verse.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 30:13 (#2)

מָה־רָ֭מוּ עֵינָ֣יו וְ֑עַפְעַפָּ֥יו נִשָּֽׂאוּ

“how its eyes are raised up, and its eyelids are lifted up”

Here, **how** indicates that what follows is an exclamation that emphasizes the pride of this **generation**. Use an exclamation that would communicate that meaning in your language. Alternate translation: [its eyes are so raised up, and their eyelids are so lifted up]

See: Exclamations

Proverbs 30:13 (#1)

דּ֭וֹר & עֵינָ֣יו וְ֑עַפְעַפָּ֥יו

“There is} a generation & its eyes & and its eyelids”

See how you translated the same use of **generation** and **its** in 30:11.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 30:13 (#4)

רָ֭מוּ עֵינָ֣יו וְ֑עַפְעַפָּ֥יו נִשָּֽׂאוּ

“its eyes are raised up, and its eyelids are lifted up”

The phrases **eyes are raised up** and **eyelids are lifted up** mean similar things. Agur is using the two phrases together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [how completely proud they are]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:13 (#3)

רָ֭מוּ עֵינָ֣יו וְ֑עַפְעַפָּ֥יו נִשָּֽׂאוּ

“its eyes are raised up, and its eyelids are lifted up”

Here, Agur refers to pride as **eyes** that **are raised up** and **eyelids** that **are lifted up**, which is are characteristic facial expressions of proud people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [proud they are, and they are arrogant]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:14 (#2)

חֲרָבֹ֣ות שִׁנָּ֭יו וּ֑מַאֲכָלֹ֥ות מַתְלְעֹתָ֗יו לֶאֱכֹ֥ל

“its teeth {are} swords and its fangs {are} knives for devouring”

Here, Agur refers to people who oppress **the afflicted** and **the needy** as if they were wild animals that are **devouring** those people by using **teeth** or **fangs** that are dangerous like **swords** or **knives**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [it cruelly oppresses] or [it oppresses others like a wild animal that uses sword-like teeth or knife-like fangs to consume]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:14 (#4)

עֲנִיִּ֥ים מֵ֝אָ֗רֶץ וְ֣אֶבְיוֹנִ֑ים מֵאָדָֽם

“the afflicted from the earth and the needy from man”

The phrases **afflicted ones from the earth** and **needy ones from man** mean the same thing. Agur is using the two phrases together for emphasis. Here, **the afflicted** and **the needy** both refer to poor people. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [poor people from the world]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:14 (#1)

דּוֹר & שִׁנָּיו֙ & מָתַלְעֹתָ֔יו

“There is} a generation, its teeth & its fangs”

See how you translated the same use of **generation** and **its** in 30:11.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 30:14 (#3)

חֲרָבֹ֣ות שִׁנָּיו֮ וּמַאֲכָלֹ֣ות מָתַלְעֹתָ֒יו

“its teeth {are} swords and its fangs {are} knives”

The phrases **its teeth are swords** and **its fangs are knives** mean the same thing. Agur is using the two phrases together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [its teeth are very sharp]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:14 (#5)

מֵאָדָ֑ם

“from man”

Here, **man** refers to all people in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [from mankind] or [from all human beings]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:15 (#6)

לֹ֣א תִשְׂבַּ֔עְנָה

“are not satisfied”

The expression **are not satisfied** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [never have enough for themselves]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:15 (#2)

לָֽעֲלוּקָ֗ה

“are} to the leech”

A **leech** is a type of worm that attaches itself to the skin of a person or animal in order to suck blood. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [are for the blood-sucking animal] or [are for the parasite]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 30:15 (#4)

שְׁלֹשָׁ֣ה הֵ֭נָּה לֹ֣א תִשְׂבַּ֑עְנָה אַ֝רְבַּ֗ע לֹא־אָ֣מְרוּ הֹ֑ון

“There are} three, they are not satisfied; four, they do not say, ‘Enough”

The second half of 30:15 and all of 30:16 are the second of six numerical sayings in this chapter. See the discussion of numerical sayings in the Chapter Introduction.

Proverbs 30:15 (#3)

הַ֣בָ ׀ הַ֣בָ

“Give! Give”

This could refer to: (1) the names of the **Two daughters**. Alternate translation: [they are named Give and Give]; (2) what the **Two daughters** say. Alternate translation: [they say, ‘Give! Give]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:15 (#5)

שְׁלֹשָׁ֣ה הֵ֭נָּה לֹ֣א תִשְׂבַּ֑עְנָה אַ֝רְבַּ֗ע לֹא־אָ֣מְרוּ הֹ֑ון

“There are} three, they are not satisfied; four, they do not say, ‘Enough”

To make a comprehensive statement, Agur is using a poetic form in which the speaker names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. Since the meaning of both clauses is the same, you could also combine them into one clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [These four things are absolutely never satisfied]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:15 (#1)

לָֽעֲלוּקָ֗ה ׀ שְׁתֵּ֣י בָנֹ֣ות֮

“Two daughters {are} to the leech”

Here, Agur speaks of greedy people as if they were **daughters** of a **leech**. Leeches and greedy people are similar because they both live off of what they take from others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Greedy people always say] or

[Greedy people are like a leech with two daughters that say]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:16 (#3)

וְעֹ֣צֶר רָ֔חַם

“and the closure of the womb”

Here, **the closure of the womb** refers to the inability of the woman to conceive or bear a child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a woman unable to bear a child]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:16 (#1)

וְעֹ֣צֶר רָ֔חַם אֶ֖רֶץ לֹא־שָׂבְעָ֣ה מַ֑יִם וְ֝אֵ֗שׁ

“and the closure of the womb, a land not satisfied with water, and a fire”

Here, **the womb**, **a land**, and **a fire** refer to these things in general, not specific things. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [and the closure of any womb, any land not satisfied with water, and any fire]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:16 (#2)

וְעֹ֣צֶר

“and the closure of”

Here Agur refers to a woman being unable to bear children as if her **womb** were closed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the barrenness of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:16 (#5)

וְ֝אֵ֗שׁ לֹא־אָ֣מְרָ֔ה הֽוֹן

“and a fire—it does not say, ‘Enough”

Here, Agur speaks of **fire** requiring fuel to keep burning as if it were a person who never says **Enough**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a fire that never stops needing fuel to keep burning]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:16 (#4)

אֶ֖רֶץ לֹא־שָׂבְעָ֣ה מַ֑יִם

“a land not satisfied with water”

Here, Agur speaks of **land** that does not have enough **water** to grow crops as if it were a person who does not have enough water to drink. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a land that never gets enough water to grow crops]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:17 (#2)

עַ֤יִן

“An eye”

Here, **eye** represents the attitude of a person, as displayed in the eyes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Anyone who has an evil eye and so] or [A person who]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:17 (#5)

יִקְּרָ֡וּהָ עֹרְבֵ֣י־נַ֭חַל וְיֹאכְלֻ֣והָ בְנֵי־נָ֑שֶׁר

“the ravens of the valley will peck it out, and the sons of the vulture will eat it”

Here, Agur is continuing to speak about the mocking and contemptuous **eye** as if it were the problem, rather than the person with those attitudes. If you have chosen to refer to the person directly rather than to the eye of the person in this verse, you could also state the meaning of this part of the verse plainly. Alternate translation: [he will be eaten by scavengers] or [this person will be punished severely]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:17 (#6)

יִקְּרָ֡וּהָ עֹרְבֵ֣י־נַ֭חַל

“the ravens of the valley will peck it out”

Since **ravens** and vultures usually eat dead animals, Agur implies here that this person will be killed before the birds eat him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that person will die and the ravens of the valley will peck out that person’s eye]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:17 (#4)

עׇרְבֵי־נַחַל & נָשֶׁר

“the ravens of the valley & the vulture”

Both **the ravens** and **the vulture** refer to large birds that eat dead animals. If your readers would not be familiar with these types of birds, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [birds that scavenge in the valley ... other birds that scavenge] or [scavenger birds ... scavenger birds]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 30:17 (#1)

עַיִן ׀ תִּלְעַג לְאָבִ֡

“An eye mocks a father”

Agur is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Concerning an eye that mocks a father]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 30:17 (#3)

לְאָבִ֡ & אֵ֠ם

“a father & to} a mother”

Here Agur implies that **a father** and **a mother** are the parents of the person who **mocks** and **shows contempt**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that person’s father ... to that person’s mother]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:17 (#7)

בְּנֵי־נָשֶׁר

“the sons of the vulture”

Here Agur refers to young vultures as if they were **sons** from the **vulture** family. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the young vultures]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:18 (#2)

שְׁלֹשָׁה הֵ֣מָּה נִפְלְאוּ֩ מִמֶּ֨נִּי וארבע

“Three things, they {are} too wonderful for me, and four”

This is poetic language. If your language has a way to indicate poetry, you could use it here. To make a comprehensive statement, Agur is using a poetic form in which the speaker names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **Three things** and **four** in 30:15. Alternate translation: [These four things are absolutely too wonderful for me]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 30:18 (#1)

שְׁלֹשָׁה֮ הֵ֣מָּה נִפְלְאוּ֩ מִמֶּ֨נִּי וארבע לֹ֜א יְדַעְתִּ֗ים

“Three things, they {are} too wonderful for me, and four, I do not understand them”

30:18–19 is the third of six numerical sayings in this chapter. See the discussion of numerical sayings in the Chapter Introduction.

Proverbs 30:19 (#7)

וְדֶ֣רֶךְ גֶּ֭בֶר בְּעַלְמָ֑ה

“and the way of a young man with a young woman”

Here Agur is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that **a young man** interacts **with a young woman**. This refers to a young couple’s loving relationship, which would include sexual relations. Alternate translation: [and the way that a young man lovingly interacts with a young woman]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:19 (#6)

בְּלֵב־יָ֗ם

“in the heart of the sea”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:34.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:19 (#5)

דֶּ֣רֶךְ־אֳנִ֭יָּה

“the way of a ship”

Here Agur is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that **a ship** sails **in the heart of the sea**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the way that a ship sails]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:19 (#1)

דֶּ֣רֶךְ & דֶּ֣רֶךְ & דֶּ֣רֶךְ & וְדֶ֣רֶךְ

“the way of & the way of & the way of & and the way of”

In this verse, **way** refers to the manner of doing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the manner of … the manner of … the manner of … and the manner of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:19 (#4)

דֶּ֣רֶךְ נָחָ֔שׁ עֲלֵ֖י צֽוּר

“the way of a snake on a rock”

Here Agur is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that **a snake** slithers **on a rock**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the way that a snake slithers on a rock]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:19 (#3)

דֶּ֣רֶךְ הַנֶּ֔שֶׁר ׀ בַּשָּׁמַ֖יִם

“the way of the eagle in the sky”

Here Agur is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that **the eagle** flies **in the sky**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the way that the eagle flies in the sky]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:19 (#2)

הַנֶּ֔שֶׁר & נָחָ֔שׁ & אֳנִיָּ֖ה & יָ֑ם & גֶּ֖בֶר בְּעַלְמָֽה

“the eagle & a snake & a ship & the sea & a young man with a young woman”

These phrases refer to these things or people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any eagle … any snake … any ship … any sea … any young man with any young woman]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:20 (#3)

אָכְלָ֔ה וּמָחֲתָ֖ה פִּ֑יהָ

“She eats and wipes her mouth”

Agur is referring to an adulterous **woman** easily committing **adultery** as if she were eating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [she commits adultery easily] or [she is like a woman who eats and wipes her mouth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:20 (#2)

אִשָּׁ֔ה & אָכְלָ֔ה וּמָחֲתָ֖ה פִּ֑יהָ

“a woman & She eats and wipes her mouth”

Here, **a woman**, **she**, and **her** refer to a type of women in general, not a specific **woman**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any woman … that woman eats and wipes her mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:20 (#1)

דֶּ֣רֶךְ

“is} the way of”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:20 (#4)

וְאָמְרָ֖ה לֹ֣א־פָעַ֑לְתִּי אָ֖וֶן

“and says, ‘I have not done iniquity”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [and says that she has not done iniquity]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 30:20 (#5)

אָ֖וֶן

“iniquity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **iniquity** in 6:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 30:21 (#3)

תַּחַ֔ת & וְתַחַ֖ת

“Under & and under”

Here, Agur is speaking of several things that people cannot tolerate as if they were standing **under** them.

Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Regarding ... and regarding]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:21 (#4)

רָגְזָה אֶ֭רֶץ & לֹא־תוּכַ֣ל שְׂאֵ֑ת

“the earth quakes & it is not able to hold up”

Here, Agur is speaking as if **the earth quakes** and **is not able to hold up** to express how much people in general dislike the things he is about to mention. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people shudder ... they cannot endure]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:21 (#1)

תַּחַת שָׁ֥שָׁה רָגְזָה אֶ֑רֶץ וְתַחַת֮ אַ֤רְבַּע לֹא־תוּכַ֣ל שְׂאֵ֑ת

“Under three things the earth quakes, and under four it is not able to hold up”

30:21–23 is the fourth of six numerical sayings in this chapter. See the discussion of numerical sayings in the introduction for this chapter.

Proverbs 30:21 (#2)

תַּחַת שָׁ֥שָׁה רָגְזָה אֶ֑רֶץ וְתַחַת֮ אַ֤רְבַּע לֹא־תוּכַ֣ל שְׂאֵ֑ת

“Under three things the earth quakes, and under four it is not able to hold up”

This is poetic language. If your language has a way to indicate poetry, you could use it here. To make a comprehensive statement, Agur is using a poetic form in which the speaker names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Since the meaning of both clauses is similar, you could also combine them into one clause. See how you translated the similar use of **three things** and **four** in 30:15. Alternate translation: [Under these four things the earth truly shakes]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 30:22 (#1)

תַּחַת

“under”

See how you translated **under** in 30:21.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:22 (#4)

לָ֑חֶם

“bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 30:22 (#2)

עֶ֭בֶד כִּֽי־יִמְלֹ֣וךְ וְ֭נָבָל כִּֽי־יִשְׂבַּ֣ע

“a slave when he becomes king and a worthless one when he is satisfied with”

Here, **a slave**, **he**, and **a worthless one** refer types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any slave when that slave becomes king, and any worthless one when that person is satisfied with]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:22 (#3)

יִשְׂבַּ֣ע

“he is satisfied with”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he gets enough]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:23 (#4)

תִּירַ֣שׁ גְּבִרְתָּ֑הּ

“she dispossesses her mistress”

Here, **dispossesses** refers to **a female servant** replacing her master’s wife as the lead woman of the household. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she becomes her master’s wife in place of her mistress]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:23 (#2)

שְׂנוּאָ֣ה כִֽי־תִבָּעֵ֑ל וְ֭שִׁפְחָה כִּֽי־תִירַ֣שׁ גְּבִרְתָּ֑הּ

“a hated woman when she is married and a female servant when she dispossesses her mistress”

Here, **a hated woman**, **she**, and **a female servant**, and **her** refer to types of women in general, not specific women. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any hated woman when that woman is married, and any female servant when that servant dispossesses her mistress]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:23 (#3)

כִּֽי־תִבָּעֵ֖ל

“when she is married”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when someone marries her]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:23 (#1)

תַּחַ֥ת

“under”

See how you translated **under** in 30:21.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:24 (#2)

קְטַנֵּי־אָ֑רֶץ

“are} small things of the earth”

Here Agur is using the possessive form to describe **small things** that exist on **the earth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [are smalls things that exist on the earth]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:24 (#3)

חֲכָמִ֣ים מְחֻכָּמִֽים

“are} wise things, being made wise”

Here, **wise things, being made wise** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [are wise, very skilled]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 30:24 (#1)

אַרְבָּעָ֥ה הֵ֖מָּה קְטַנֵּי־אָ֑רֶץ וְ֝הֵ֗מָּה חֲכָמִ֣ים מְחֻכָּמִֽים

“Four things, they {are} small things of the earth but they {are} wise things, being made wise”

30:24–28 is the fifth of six numerical sayings in this chapter. See the discussion of numerical sayings in the Chapter Introduction.

Proverbs 30:25 (#2)

וַיְכִינ֣וּ בַ֭קַּיִץ לַחְמָֽם

“but they prepare their food in the summer”

See how you translated the similar phrase “prepares its bread in the summer” in 6:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:25 (#1)

עַ֣ם

“are} a people”

Here Agur refers to the whole species of **ants** as if they were a group of **people**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are a species]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:26 (#1)

שְׁשָׁפַ֥נִּים

“Rock badgers”

Rock badgers are small animals also called “hyraxes” that live in the cracks between rocks in the wilderness. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [Small mammals that live among rocks]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 30:26 (#4)

בֵּיתָֽם

“their house”

Here Agur refers to the places where **Rock badgers** live as if those places were houses such as humans live in. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their dwelling places] or [their holes]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:26 (#3)

בַּסֶּלַע בֵּיתָם

“their house in the cliff”

Although **house** and **the cliff** are singular, they refer to these things in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [their houses in the cliffs]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:26 (#2)

עַ֭ם

“are} a people”

See how you translated the same use of **people** in the previous verse.

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:27 (#1)

לְאַרְבֶּה & כֻּלּוֹ

“for the locust & each of it”

Here, **the locust** and **it** represent locusts in general, not one particular **locust**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [for locusts ... every one of them]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:27 (#2)

וַיֵּצֵא חֻצֵֽץ

“but & goes out divided {into groups”

Here Agur speaks of the orderly ways that locusts travel as if they were an army of soldiers who **go out divided into groups**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but ... move together in an organized manner] or [but ... march ahead like ranks of soldiers]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:28 (#1)

שְׂגָמְמִית & וְ֝הִיא & מֶ֗לֶךְ

“a lizard & yet it & the king”

Here, **a lizard**, **it**, and **the king** represent lizards and kings in general, not one particular **lizard** or **king**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any lizard ... yet any lizard ... any king]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:28 (#2)

שְׂגָמְמִית

“a lizard”

A **lizard** is a small animal that crawls on the ground and can hide in houses. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a gecko] or [a small crawling reptile]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 30:29 (#4)

שְׁלֹשָׁה֮ הֵ֤מָּה מֵיטִ֪יבֵי צָ֫עַד וְ֭אַרְבָּעָה מֵיטִ֣בֵי לָכֶֽת

“Three things, they are doing well of step, and four are doing well of walking”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Three things, they are doing well of step, indeed, four are doing well of walking]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:29 (#2)

שְׁלֹשָׁה֮ הֵ֤מָּה מֵיטִ֪יבֵי צָ֫עַד וְ֭אַרְבָּעָה מֵיטִ֣בֵי לָכֶֽת

“Three things, they are doing well of step, and four are doing well of walking”

This is poetic language. If your language has a way to indicate poetry, you could use it here. To make a comprehensive statement, Agur is using a poetic form in which the speaker names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Since the meaning of both clauses is the same, you could also combine them into one clause. See how you translated the similar use of **Three things** and **four** in 30:15. Alternate translation: [These four things truly walk well]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 30:29 (#3)

מֵיטִ֪יבֵי צָ֫עַד & מֵיטִ֣בֵי לָכֶֽת

“are doing well of step & are doing well of walking”

The phrases **doing well of step** and **doing well of walking** both refer to animals or people who walk impressively. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [walk in an impressive manner … stride in a stately manner]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 30:29 (#1)

שְׁלֹשָׁה הֵמָּה מֵיטִיבֵי צָעֲדָ֑ וְאַרְבָּעָה מֵיטִיבֵי לָכֶת

“Three things, they are doing well of step, and four are doing well of walking”

30:29–31 is the sixth of six numerical sayings in this chapter. See the discussion of numerical sayings in the Chapter Introduction.

Proverbs 30:30 (#1)

לַ֭לַיִשׁ & וְלֹא־יָשׁ֣וּב

“a lion & and it will not turn away”

Here, **a lion** and **it** refer to lions in general, not a specific **lion**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any lion … and that lion will not turn away]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:30 (#3)

וְלֹא־יָשׁ֣וּב מִפְּנֵי

“and it will not turn away from the face of”

Here, **turn away from the face** means “does not run away from” because one would have to **turn** one’s face away from the **face** of someone in order to run away from that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will not run away from]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:30 (#2)

גִּבּ֥וֹר בַּבְּהֵמָ֑ה

“mighty among the animals”

Here, **mighty among the animals** refers to being the mightiest animal among them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the mightiest animal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:31 (#2)

זַרְזִ֣יר מָתְנַ֑יִם

“a rooster of loins”

Many scholars believe that the word translated as **a rooster** refers to a fighting cock, which is a type of rooster. Roosters are male birds that walk around in a proud manner and some are trained to fight each other. Some have coloring that makes them appear to be wearing protective fighting clothing, which may explain the phrase **of loins**, which would refer to a man prepared for battle. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Other scholars believe that this word may refer to some other animal. If a Bible translation exists in your region, you may want to use the translation that it uses. Alternate translation: [strutting roosters] or [a male bird that struts proudly]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 30:31 (#3)

אַלְקָ֥וֹם עִמּֽוֹ

“against whom one does not rise up”

The phrase translated as **against whom one does not rise up** could also be translated as “whose army is with him.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 30:31 (#1)

זַרְזִ֣יר מָתְנַ֑יִם א֥וֹ־תָ֝יִ֗שׁ וּמֶ֥לֶךְ אַלְקָ֥וֹם עִמּֽוֹ

“a rooster of loins, or a male goat, and a king against whom one does not rise up”

Here, **one girded of loins**, **a male goat**, **a king**, and **one** refer to animals or people in general, not specific animals or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [those girded of loins, or any male goat, and any king against whom any person does not rise up]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:32 (#2)

יָ֣ד לְפֶ֑ה

“a hand {be} to mouth”

Here Agur uses the phrase **a hand be to mouth** to refer to telling someone to stop doing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [stop doing those things]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:32 (#1)

בְּהִתְנַשֵּׂאת

“by lifting up yourself”

Here Agur speaks of someone honoring himself as if he were **lifting up** himself for everyone to see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by honoring yourself]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:33 (#2)

מְמֵ֣יץ חָלָ֔ב יֹוצִ֖יא חֶמְאָ֑ה וּמְמֵ֥יץ־אַ֙אַף֙ יֹוצִ֣יא דָ֔ם וּמְמֵ֥יץ אַפַּ֖יִם יֹוצִ֥יא רִֽיב

“the squeezing of milk brings out butter, and the squeezing of the nose brings out blood, and the squeezing of nostrils brings out strife”

Here, Agur mentions three cause-and-effect relationships in order to teach that doing what he described in the previous verse will have bad results. The third phrase is what will happen if a person continues to do the things mentioned in verse 32. That is, if he continues to exalt himself or make evil schemes, people will become angry with him and start to fight with him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [just like the squeezing of milk brings out butter, and the squeezing of the nose brings out blood, and the squeezing of nostrils brings out strife, that is what will happen if you keep doing these things]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:33 (#4)

וּמְמֵ֥יץ אַפַּ֖יִם

“and the squeezing of nostrils”

Here, the phrase **squeezing of nostrils** is a common expression of the culture that means that the person is becoming angry. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and making people foam at the mouth] or [and angering people]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 30:33 (#5)

יֹוצִ֥יא רִֽיב

“brings out strife”

Here, Agur refers to causing people to argue as if **strife** were an object that someone **brings out**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes strife between people]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:33 (#6)

רִֽיב

“strife”

See how you translated the abstract noun **strife** in 16:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 30:33 (#1)

כִּֽי־

“For”

For here introduces the reason for obeying the command stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate reason. Alternate translation: [Stop doing these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 30:33 (#3)

מְמֵ֣יץ חָלָ֔ב יֹוצִ֖יא חֶמְאָ֑ה

“the squeezing of milk brings out butter”

Here, Agur refers to stirring liquid milk until it thickens into a solid food substance called **butter**. If your readers would not be familiar with milk or the process for making **butter**, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [stirring some liquids causes them to harden]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs - Chapter 31 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Sayings from Lemuel (31:1–9)

2. Description of a good and capable wife (31:10–31)

Chapter 31 is the chapter in this book written by Lemuel, who wrote down the advice that his mother told him. Within the Bible, here is the only place that Lemuel is mentioned.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Acrostic poem
Proverbs 31:10–31 is an acrostic poem, that is, a poem in which each line begins with a successive letter of the alphabet in the original language. Using every letter of the language in that way expresses the idea of comprehensiveness and also helps people memorize the poem. In 31:10–31 the acrostic poem emphasizes that virtuous women demonstrate their virtue in everything that they do. If using the letters of your alphabet in this way would not communicate that this is a poem, you could use a different way in your language to indicate that these verses are one poem about the same topic. (See: Poetry)

Proverbs 31:1 (#1)

דִּבְרֵי

“The words of”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:1 (#2)

מַשָּׂא

“a burden”

See how you translated the same use of **burden** in 30:1.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:2 (#3)

מַה־בְּרִי וּמַה־בַּר־בִּטְנִי וּמָה בַּר־נְדָרָי

“What, my son? And what, son of my womb? And what, son of my vows”

These three questions could be: (1) rhetorical questions that Lemuel’s mother asks in order to emphasize that her **son** should listen to what she is about to say. Alternate translation: [This is what I should tell you, my son! And this is what I should tell you, son of my womb! And this is what I should tell you, son of my vows!]; (2) exclamations in which **What** is not introducing a question. Alternate translation: [O, my son! O, son of my womb! O, son of my vows!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 31:2 (#2)

מַה־בְּרִי וּמַה־בַּר־בִּטְנִי וּמָה בַּר־נְדָרָי

“What, my son? And what, son of my womb? And what, son of my vows”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [What should I say to you, my son? And what should I say to you, son of my womb? And what should I say to you, son of my vows?]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:2 (#1)

מַה־בְּרִי

“What, my son”

31:2–31 is a long quotation of what Lemuel’s mother told him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Proverbs 31:2 (#4)

בַּר־בִּטְנִי

“son of my womb”

Here, Lemuel’s mother is using the possessive form to describe a **son** whom she had carried in her **womb**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [son whom I carried in my womb]

See: Possession

Proverbs 31:2 (#5)

בַּר־נְדָרָי

“son of my vows”

Here, **vows** could mean: (1) the promise Lemuel’s mother made to dedicate her **son** to God if he allowed her to have a child. Alternate translation: [son whom I dedicated to Yahweh]; (2) Lemuel is the result of God hearing his mother’s **vows**, in which case **vows** would refer to prayers. Alternate translation: [son for whom I prayed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:3 (#1)

אַל־תִּתֵּ֣ן לַנָּשִׁ֔ים חֵילֶ֑ךָ

“Do not give to women your strength”

Lemuel’s mother is referring to sex in a polite way by using the phrase **give your strength to women**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not tire yourself out with women] or [Do not waste your energy on having sex with women]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 31:3 (#3)

לַמְחֹתֹ֖ת מְלָכִֽין

“to cause kings to be wiped out”

The parallelism between this clause and the previous clause indicates that this phrase refers to **women** who **cause kings to be wiped out**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to those women who cause kings to be wiped out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:3 (#2)

וּדְרָכֶ֖יךָ

“or your ways”

Here, **your ways** could mean: (1) the same as **your strength** in the previous clause, which is parallel to this clause. Alternate translation: [or your vigor]; (2) a person’s regular behavior, which is what **ways** usually means in Proverbs. Alternate translation: [or what you do]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:4 (#1)

אַ֣אַל לַ֭מְלָכִים ׀ לְמוּאֵ֑ל אַ֣אַל לַ֭מְלָכִים

“It is} not for kings, Lemuel, {it is} not for kings”

Here, Lemuel’s mother repeats the same phrase for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could use one phrase and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [It is absolutely not for kings, Lemuel]

See: Reduplication

Proverbs 31:4 (#2)

אַ֣אַל לַ֭מְלָכִים & אַ֣אַל לַ֭מְלָכִים

“It is} not for kings & it is} not for kings”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [It is not appropriate for kings … it is not appropriate for kings]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:4 (#3)

אוֹ

“or”

Some ancient copies and translations say that the word translated as **or** is a different word that means “desire” or “crave,” which makes sense because of the parallelism with **drink wine** in the previous clause. If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider using the reading in that translation. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, you may wish to follow the reading of the UST.

See: Textual Variants

Proverbs 31:5 (#1)

פֶּן־יִ֭שְׁתֶּה

“Lest he drink”

Lemuel’s mother is using the word translated as **Lest** to introduce an outcome that she does not want to happen. Because of this, she first gives Lemuel an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [Otherwise he may drink]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 31:5 (#5)

דִּ֝ין כָּל־בְּנֵי־עֹנִֽי

“the legal claim of all the sons of the afflicted one”

Here, **the legal claim** and **the afflicted one** refer to claims and afflicted people in general, not a specific **claim** or **afflicted one**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any legal claim of all the sons of any afflicted person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:5 (#2)

יִ֭שְׁתֶּה

“he drink”

Here, **he** refers to the kings and dignitaries mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those kings or dignitaries drink]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 31:5 (#4)

וְיַשַּׁנֶּה דִּדֵּ֣ין

“and pervert the legal claim of”

Here, **pervert the legal claim** refers to depriving people of their legal rights. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and deny the legal rights of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:5 (#6)

בְּנֵי־עֹנִֽי

“the sons of the afflicted one”

Here, **the sons of the afflicted one** refers to all afflicted people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [afflicted people]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 31:5 (#3)

מְחֻקָּֽק

“what has been decreed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. This phrase refers to the laws of the country that these kings or dignitaries rule over. Alternate translation: [what the law decrees] or [their laws]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 31:6 (#3)

לְמָרֵי נָֽפֶשׁ

“to those bitter of soul”

Here, Lemuel’s mother refers to people who feel miserable as if their souls are **bitter**. Here, **soul** refers to a person’s inner being or mind, as in 23:7. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to those who are miserable]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:6 (#2)

וְיַ֣יִן

“and wine”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and give wine]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:6 (#1)

לְאוֹבֵֽד

“to the perishing one”

Here, **the perishing one** refers to dying people in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [to any perishing person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:7 (#1)

יִשְׁתֶּ֣ה וְיִשְׁכַּ֣ח רִישׁ֑וֹ וַֽעֲמָל֖וֹ לֹ֣א יִזְכָּר־עֽוֹד

“He will drink and forget his poverty, and his trouble he will not remember again”

He and **his** refer to “the perishing one” and “those bitter of soul,” who are mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Those dying and miserable people will drink and forget their poverty, and their trouble they will not remember again]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 31:7 (#3)

רִישׁ֑וֹ וַֽעֲמָל֖וֹ

“his poverty, and his trouble”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **poverty** in 6:11 and **trouble** in 24:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:7 (#2)

יִשְׁתֶּ֣ה

“He will drink”

Lemuel’s mother implies that **He will drink** wine or some other intoxicating drink, as mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [He will drink wine or intoxicating drink]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:8 (#4)

בְּנֵי֥ חָלֽוֹף

“the sons of the one passing away”

See how you translated the same use of **the sons of** in 31:5.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 31:8 (#1)

פְּתַח־פִּ֭יךָ לְאִלֵּ֑ם

“Open your mouth for a mute one”

Open your mouth refers to doing so in order to say something to defend someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Open your mouth to speak on behalf of a mute one]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:8 (#5)

חָלֽוֹף

“the one passing away”

Lemuel’s mother is referring to death in a polite way by using the phrase **passing away**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more normal polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [the dying one]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 31:8 (#2)

לְאִלֵּ֑ם אֶל־דִּ֝֗ין כָּל־בְּנֵי֥ חָלֽוֹף

“for a mute one, for the legal claim of all the sons of the one passing away”

Here, **a mute one**, **the legal claim**, and **the one passing away** refer to these people and things in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [for any mute person, for any legal claim of all the sons of any person passing away]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:8 (#3)

אֶל־דִּ֗ין

“for the legal claim of”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence or use a connecting word if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [open your mouth for the legal claim of] or [and for the legal claim of]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:9 (#2)

פְּתַח־פִּ֭יךָ

“Open your mouth”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:9 (#4)

וְדִ֣ין עָנִ֑י וְאֶבְי֝וֹן

“and plead the legal case of the afflicted one and poor one”

Here, **the legal case**, **the afflicted one**, and **poor one** refer to legal cases and types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [and plead any legal case of any afflicted person and any poor person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:9 (#3)

צֶ֝֗דֶק

“with} righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **righteousness** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:9 (#1)

פְּתַח־פִּ֭יךָ שְׁפָט־צֶ֑דֶק

“Open your mouth, judge {with} righteousness”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the second clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Open your mouth for the afflicted one and poor one and judge them with righteousness]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:10 (#4)

חַיִל

“worth”

Here, **worth** refers to both physical ability and moral **worth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [physical and moral worth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:10 (#3)

אֵשֶׁת־חַיִל

“A woman of worth”

Here, Lemuel’s mother is using the possessive form to describe a **woman** who is characterized by **worth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A worthy woman]

See: Possession

Proverbs 31:10 (#2)

אֵשֶׁת־חַיִל & מִכְרָהּ

“A woman of worth & her value”

A woman of worth and **her** refer to a type of **woman** in general, not a particular **woman**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any woman of worth ... that woman’s value]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:10 (#1)

אֵשֶׁת־חַיִל מִמְּי יִמְצָאָה

“A woman of worth, who can find”

Lemuel’s mother is using the question form to emphasize the difficulty of finding a wife of **worth**. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Not many men can find a woman of worth!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 31:10 (#5)

מִפְּנִינִים

“more than coral pearls”

See how you translated **coral pearls** in 3:15.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 31:11 (#1)

לֵב בַּעְלָהּ

“The heart of her husband”

Here, the **heart** represents where the husband’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [Her husband’s inner being]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:11 (#2)

וְשָׁלָל

“and spoil”

Although the word translated as **spoil** usually refers to wealth that soldiers seize after winning a battle or that thieves steal, here it refers to the valuable things that this **husband** gains because of his wife. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and great wealth from her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:11 (#3)

לֹא יֶחְסָר

“he will not lack”

Lemuel’s mother is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [he will always have]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 31:12 (#1)

טוֹב וְלֹא־רָע

“good and not evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **good** in 11:27 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:12 (#3)

חַיֶּיהָ

“her life”

See how you translated the abstract noun **life** in 10:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:12 (#2)

טוֹב וְלֹא־רָעָ֖ה

“good and not evil”

The expressions **good** and **not evil** mean the same thing. Lemuel’s mother is using the two expressions together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [extremely good]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 31:13 (#5)

בְּחֵ֖פֶץ כַּפֶּֽיהָ

“with the delight of her palms”

Here, Lemuel’s mother speaks of this woman feeling **delight** while she uses **her palms** to make clothing as if **her palms** were feeling that **delight**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [delightfully with her palms]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 31:13 (#2)

צֶ֥מֶר

“wool”

The term **wool** refers to the hair of sheep, which was used to make warm clothing for winter. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of material, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [warm fabric] or [material to make into winter clothing]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 31:13 (#1)

דָּ֭דְרְשָׁה

“She searches {for”

The fact that she **works** in the next clause indicates that this woman finds what she **searches** for. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She finds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:13 (#4)

וַתַּ֣עַשׂ

“and works”

Here, **works** refers to making clothing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and makes clothing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:13 (#3)

וּפִשְׁתִּ֑ים

“and linens”

The term **linens** refers to a type of plant that was used to make cool clothing for summer. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of material, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [cool fabric] or [material to make into summer clothing]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 31:14 (#2)

הָֽיְתָה כָּאֳנִיּ֣וֹת סוֹחֵ֑ר

“She is like the ships of a merchant”

The point of this comparison is that just as **ships** bring valuable things from far away, so does the “woman of worth.” If this is not clear from the second line, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [She travels far to get good things, like the ships of a merchant]

See: Simile

Proverbs 31:14 (#3)

לַחְמָ֣הּ

“her bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 31:14 (#1)

הָֽיְתָה כָּאֳנִיּ֣וֹת סוֹחֵ֑ר מִמֶּרְחָ֖ק תָּבִ֣יא לַחְמָֽהּ

“She is like the ships of a merchant; she brings her bread from far away”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [She brings her bread from far away, like the ships of a merchant]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 31:15 (#4)

וְחֹק

“and a portion”

Here, **portion** refers to **a portion** of **food**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and a portion of food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:15 (#1)

בְּעֹוד לַיְלָה

“while still night”

Here, **while still night** refers to the time before the sun rises in the morning, not the middle of the night. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [while it is still dark] or [before the sun rises]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:15 (#3)

לְבֵיתָהּ

“to her house”

Here, **house** represents the family who lives in **her house**. See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:15 (#5)

לְנַעֲרֹתֶיהָ

“to her young women”

Here, **young women** refers to female servants who serve this woman and live in her home. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to her servant girls]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:15 (#2)

וַתִּתֵּן

“and gives”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is the purpose for the woman rising **while still night**. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of giving]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 31:16 (#2)

מִפְּרִי כַפֶּיהָ

“from the fruit of her palms”

Here, **the fruit of her palms** refers to the money that the woman has earned by selling the clothing she made with **her palms** in 31:13. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the money she has earned]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:16 (#1)

זָמְמָה שָׂדֶה

“She considers a field”

Here, **considers** refers to planning carefully before buying **a field**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She considers carefully about buying a field]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:17 (#1)

חָגְרָה & מָתְנֶיהָ

“She girds her loins”

Here, **strength** is spoken of as if it were a kind of clothing that could be girded around a persons **loins**, which refers to the hips and waist. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She puts on strength as though it were clothing] or [She strengthens her body]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:17 (#2)

וַתְּאַמֵּץ זְרֹעוֹתֶיהָ

“and she strengthens her arms”

Here, Lemuel’s mother implies that this woman **strengthens her arms** by working hard. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she strengthens her arms by doing hard work]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:18 (#1)

סַחְרָהּ

“her profit”

See how you translated the abstract noun **profit** in 3:14.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:18 (#2)

לֹא־יִכְבֶּה בַלַּיְלָה נֵרָהּ

“her lamp does not go out in the night”

Here, Lemuel’s mother implies that this woman’s **lamp does not go out** because the woman is working. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [her lamp does not go out in the night because she is working]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:18 (#3)

לֹא־יִכְבֶּה בַלַּיְלָה נֵרָהּ

“her lamp does not go out in the night”

Lemuel’s mother uses this clause as an overstatement in order emphasize that such a woman works until late at **night**, but not necessarily all night long. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [she uses a lamp to work until late at night]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 31:19 (#4)

פָּלֶךְ

“the spindle”

The word **spindle** refers to a piece of wood around which someone wraps the thread when making thread. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of tool, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the tool for holding thread]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 31:19 (#3)

בַּכִּישׁוֹר

“at the distaff”

The word **distaff** refers to a thin rod with pointed ends that is used to make thread. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of tool, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [on the tool for making thread]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 31:19 (#1)

יָדֶיהָ שִׁלְּחָה בַכִּישׁוֹר וְכַפֶּיהָ תָּמְכוּ פָלֶךְ

“She stretches out her hands at the distaff, and her palms grasp the spindle”

This verse refers to the process of making thread, which is used to make clothing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She stretches out her hands at the distaff, and she grasps the spindle in order to make thread]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:19 (#2)

יָדֶיהָ שִׁלְּחָה בַכִּישׁוֹר

“She stretches out her hands at the distaff”

Here, **stretches out her hands** means to holding something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She takes hold of the distaff]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 31:20 (#2)

כַּפָּהּ פָּרְשָׂה לֶעָנִי וְיָדֶיהָ שִׁלְּחָה לָאֶבְיוֹן

“She spreads out her palm to the afflicted one, and she stretches out her hands to the poor one”

These two phrases **She spreads out her palm to the afflicted one** and **she stretches out her hands to the poor one** mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way, as in the UST.

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 31:20 (#3)

לֶעָנִי & לָאֶבְיוֹן

“to the afflicted one & to the poor one”

See how you translated **the afflicted one** in 15:15 and **poor one** in 13:8.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:20 (#1)

כַּפָּהּ פָּרְשָׂה לֶעָנִי וְיָדֶיהָ שִׁלְּחָה לָאֶבְיוֹן

“She spreads out her palm to the afflicted one, and she stretches out her hands to the poor one”

The phrases **spreads out her palm** and **stretches out her hands** both refer to helping someone by using one’s hands to give something to that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She helps the afflicted one, and she helps the poor one]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:21 (#5)

שָׁנִים

“with} crimson”

Here, **crimson** refers to clothing that is made from expensive **crimson** cloth. The idea is that this family can afford the best clothing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [have expensive, warm clothing]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:21 (#2)

לֹא־תִירָא לְבֵיתָהּ

“She does not fear for her house”

Here, Lemuel’s mother implies that this woman **does not fear for her house** to become cold. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She does not fear for her house to become cold]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:21 (#3)

מִשָּׁשֶׁלֶג

“because of snow”

Here, **snow** refers to cold weather, which is the time when **snow** falls. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of cold weather] or [because of winter]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:21 (#4)

לָבֵשׁ שָׁנִים

“is clothed {with} crimson”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [she has clothed with crimson]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 31:21 (#1)

לְבֵיתָהּ & כָּל־בֵּבֵיתָהּ

“for her house & all her house”

See how you translated the same use of **her house** in 31:15.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:22 (#2)

שֵׁשׁ וְאַרְגָּמָן לְבוּשָׁהּ

“fine linen and purple for her clothing”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [she wears fine linen and purple for her clothing]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:22 (#3)

שֵׁשׁ וְאַרְגָּמָן

“fine linen and purple”

Here, **fine linen** and **purple** both refer to very expensive cloth. Lemuel’s mother is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [very expensive materials]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 31:22 (#1)

מַרְבַדִּים

“coverings”

Here, **coverings** refers to pieces of cloth used to cover beds. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated **coverings** in 7:16. Alternate translation: [blankets] or [cloth that covers beds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:23 (#3)

בַּשְּׁעָרִֽים

“at the gates”

Here, **the gates** refers to the place in a town or city where many people would gather and where the elders would sit to discuss matters and make legal decisions. See how you translated the same use of **the gates** in 1:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:23 (#1)

נוֹדָ֣ע & בַּעְלָ֑הּ

“Her husband is known”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [People know her husband]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 31:23 (#4)

בְּשִׁבְתּ֣וֹ עִ֭ם

“when he sits with”

Here, **sits with** refers to sitting down **with the elders of the land** in order to make laws and resolve legal disputes. Someone who **sits with the elders** is actually one of them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he sits down to make legal decisions with]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:23 (#5)

זִקְנֵי־אָֽרֶץ

“the elders of the land”

The phrase **the elders of the land** refers to the leaders of the town or city in which this woman lives with her **husband**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the leaders of the town]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:23 (#2)

נוֹדָ֣ע

“is known”

Here, the phrase **is known** implies that this woman’s **husband** is respected by many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is respected]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:24 (#2)

וַתִּמְכֹּ֖ר

“and sells”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and sells that garment]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:24 (#4)

לַֽכְּנַעֲנִ֔י

“to the Canaanite”

Here, **Canaanite** refers specifically to **Canaanite** traders. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the Canaanite trader] or [to someone who trades goods]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:24 (#3)

נָתְנָ֖ה

“she gives”

Here, **gives** means that she supplies this **belt** to a **Canaanite** who is a merchant and so pays her for the item and then sells it to others. It does not refer to giving the **belt** away for free. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she supplies]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:24 (#1)

סָדִ֣ין & וַחֲגוֹר֙ & לַֽכְּנַעֲנִ֔י

“a linen garment & and a belt & to the Canaanite”

Here, **a linen garment**, **a belt**, and **the Canaanite** refer to these things and people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [linen garments ... belts ... to Canaanites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:25 (#2)

עֹז־וְהָדָר

“Strength and splendor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Strength** in 5:10 and **splendor** in 4:9.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:25 (#3)

וַתִּשְׂחַק לְיוֹם אַחֲרוֹן

“and she laughs at a future day”

Here, the woman **laughs** because she feels confident and cheerful about what will happen in the future. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she is confident about a future day]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:25 (#4)

לְיוֹם אַחֲרוֹן

“at a future day”

Here, **a future day** refers to what will happen in the future. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at what will happen in the future]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:25 (#1)

עֹז־וְהָדָר לְבוּשָׁהּ

“Strength and splendor {are} her clothing”

Here Lemuel’s mother speaks of this woman having **Strength and splendor** that other people notice. It’s as if she were wearing those qualities as **clothing** that other people could see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Everyone notices her strength and splendor] or [People notice her strength and splendor as if they were her clothing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:26 (#2)

בְּחָכְמָה

“with wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:26 (#5)

חֶסֶד

“covenant faithfulness”

See how you translated the same use of **covenant faithfulness** in 11:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:26 (#3)

וְתוֹרַת־חֶסֶד

“and the law of covenant faithfulness”

Here, Lemuel’s mother is using the possessive form to describe **the law** that is characterized by **covenant faithfulness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and the law that is characterized by covenant faithfulness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 31:26 (#4)

וְתוֹרַת

“and the law of”

Although **the law** here is singular, it refers to what this woman teaches or instructs others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the instructions of] or [and the teachings of]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 31:26 (#6)

עַל־לְשׁוֹנָהּ

“is} on her tongue”

Here, **on her tongue** refers to her speaking, which involved using **her tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is spoken by her]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:26 (#1)

פִּיהָ פָּתְחָה

“Her mouth opens”

Here, **mouth opens** refers to speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She talks]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:27 (#1)

הֲלִיכוֹת בֵּיתָהּ

“the goings on of her house”

Here, **the goings on of her house** could refer to: (1) what happens inside her home. Alternate translation: [what happens in her home]; (2) what the people who live in **her house** do, in which case **her house** has the same meaning as in 31:15. Alternate translation: [what her family does]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:27 (#2)

וְלֶחֶם עַצְלֻת֣וֹת לֹ֣א תֹאכֵֽל

“and the bread of laziness she does not eat”

Here, Lemuel’s mother speaks of someone being lazy as if **laziness** were **bread** that a person **eats**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she does not act idly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:28 (#2)

קָ֭מוּ

“rise up”

Here, the phrase **rise up** refers to a symbolic action to show respect for someone. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [stand to show respect]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 31:28 (#1)

בָּנֶ֑יהָ

“Her sons”

See how you translated the same use of **sons** in 4:1.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 31:29 (#2)

בָּנ֣וֹת

“daughters”

Here, the woman’s husband uses **daughters** to refer to women in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:29 (#3)

חָ֭יִל

“with} worth”

Here, **worth** refers to both physical ability and moral **worth**. See how you translated the same use of **worth** in 31:10.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:29 (#5)

וְ֝אַתְּ עָלִ֗ית עַל

“but you yourself have ascended over”

Here, the woman’s husband speaks of his wife acting more admirably than all other woman as if she **ascended over** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but you yourself have acted more worthily than] or [but you yourself are more excellent than]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:29 (#4)

וְ֝אַתְּ עָלִ֗ית

“but you yourself have ascended”

The woman’s husband uses the word **yourself** to emphasize how excellent his wife is. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [but you, yes, you have ascended]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 31:29 (#1)

רַבּ֣וֹת בָּנ֣וֹת עָ֭שׂוּ חָ֑יִל וְ֝אַתְּ עָלִ֗ית עַל־כֻּלָּֽנָה

“Many daughters have acted {with} worth, but you yourself have ascended over all of them”

This verse is a quotation of what the woman’s husband said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Proverbs 31:30 (#8)

הִ֭הָיא תִּתְהַלָּ֣ל

“she herself will be praised”

The intensive pronoun **herself** represents the pronoun “her” that Lemuel’s mother uses in the original even

though the verb translated as **she will be praised** already includes this meaning. Doing this adds emphasis to what she is saying. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [she will certainly be praised] or [people will certainly praise her]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 31:30 (#6)

אִשָּׁ֣ה יִרְאַת־יְהוָ֣ה

“a woman fearful of Yahweh”

This half of the verse is a strong contrast with the previous half. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, a woman fearful of Yahweh]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 31:30 (#4)

וְהֶ֣בֶל הַיֹּ֑פִי

“and the beauty {is} vapor”

Here, Lemuel’s mother speaks of the disappearance of **beauty** as if it were a **vapor** that quickly goes away. See how you translated the same use of **vapor** in 21:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:30 (#2)

שֶׁ֭קֶר הַחֵ֣ן וְהֶ֣בֶל הַיֹּ֑פִי

“The charm {is} falsehood and the beauty {is} vapor”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **charm**, **falsehood**, and **beauty**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **falsehood** in 6:17 and **beauty** in 6:25. Alternate translation: [What is charming is false and what is beautiful is vapor]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:30 (#3)

שֶׁ֭קֶר הַחֵ֣ן וְהֶ֣בֶל הַיֹּ֑פִי

“The charm {is} falsehood and the beauty {is} vapor”

The parallelism between this half of the verse and the second half indicates that **charm** and **beauty** refer to the physical attractiveness of women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [A woman’s charm can be deceptive and a woman’s beauty is vapor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:30 (#5)

אִשָּׁ֣ה יִרְאַת־יְהוָ֣ה הִ֭יא תִּתְהַלָּֽל

“a woman fearful of Yahweh, she herself will be praised”

Here, **a woman**, **she**, and **herself** refer to a type of **woman** in general, not a specific **woman**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any woman fearful of Yahweh, that woman herself will be praised]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:30 (#1)

הַחֵ֣ן & הַיֹּ֑פִי

“The charm & the beauty”

Here, **The charm** and **the beauty** refer to these qualities in general, not any specific **charm** or **beauty**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any charm ... any beauty]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:30 (#7)

הִ֭יא תִּתְהַלָּֽל

“she herself will be praised”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will certainly praise her]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 31:31 (#4)

בַּשְּׁעָרִֽים

“at the gates”

See how you translated the same use of **the gates** in 1:21 and 31:23.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:31 (#1)

לָ֑הּ & יָדֶ֣יהָ וִיהַלְלוּהָ & מַעֲשֶׂ֣יהָ

“to her & her hands and let her works praise her”

In this verse, **her** refers to the "woman fearful of Yahweh" mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to a woman fearful of Yahweh ... that woman's hands, and let that woman's works praise her]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 31:31 (#2)

מִפְּרִי יָדֶיהָ

"from the fruit of her hands"

Here, **the fruit of her hands** could refer to: (1) any kind of reward that the woman deserves for her hard work. Alternate translation: [the reward for her work]; (2) the money that the woman has earned by selling the clothing she made in 31:13, like the nearly identical phrase "from the fruit of her palms" in 31:16. Alternate translation: [from the money she has earned]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:31 (#3)

וִיהַלְלוּהָ & מַעֲשֶׂיהָ

"and let her works praise her"

Here, Lemuel's mother speaks of people praising this woman because of **her works** as if the **works** were people who were the ones praising her. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and let people praise her for her works]

See: Personification